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THE MAN WHO WOULD CHANGE RUSSIA

A top oligarch
speaks out



The Economist

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The world this week

本周的世界

Politics

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Donald Trump began the [NATO summit](#) in Ankara, Turkey's capital, by airing his grievances with allies. He grumbled about their lack of support for the Iran war and said that the row over Greenland had also "hurt my relationship" with Europe, reiterating his belief that America should control the Danish territory. But he softened his tone during the gathering and signed up to a communiqué that

reasserted NATO's "ironclad commitment to our collective defence".

唐纳德·特朗普在土耳其首都安卡拉开始了北约峰会。他在会上表达了对盟友的不满，抱怨他们未能支持对伊朗的战争，并提到格陵兰岛的争端也“损害了”他与欧洲的关系。他重申了美国应该控制丹麦领土的观点。不过，在会议期间，他缓和了语气，并同意签署一份声明，重申了北约“对共同防御的坚定承诺”。

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Mr Trump also made a significant concession to **Ukraine** by granting it a licence to make Patriot surface-to-air interceptor missiles, a response to a plea from Volodymyr Zelensky for more air-defence systems. The Ukrainian president's request came after **Russia** again pounded Kyiv, killing 28 people. A bombardment a few days earlier killed 30. Ukraine could not stop the ballistic missiles used in the attacks. Meanwhile, Ukrainian drones struck Russia's largest oil refinery at Omsk, 2,700km (1,680 miles) from Ukraine. Mr Trump said he backed Ukraine striking deep inside Russia as a means to end the war.

特朗普先生还向乌克兰做出了重大让步，允许乌克兰制造“Patriot”地对空导弹，这是回应沃洛迪米尔·泽连斯基关于增加防空系统的请求。乌克兰总统的这一请求是在俄罗斯再次袭击基辅、导致 28 人死亡的事件之后提出的。几天前发生的袭击事件中又有 30 人丧生。乌克兰无法阻止用于此次袭击的弹道导弹。与此同时，乌克兰的无人机袭击了俄罗斯位于奥姆斯克的炼油厂，该工厂距离乌克兰有 2700 公里（1680 英里）。特朗普表示支持乌克兰对俄罗斯境内进行打击，以此作为结束战争的一种方式。

Iran launched drone attacks on three tankers it said had ignored designated shipping routes through the Strait of Hormuz. Mr Trump ordered new strikes on Iran and revoked the waiver of sanctions covering Iranian oil exports. Mark Rutte, NATO's secretary-general,

supported America's actions as "absolutely necessary". Iran responded with attacks on Bahrain, Kuwait and Qatar. The American president said that Iran's leaders were "scum" and the ceasefire was "over".

伊朗发动了无人机攻击，袭击了三艘油轮，称这些油轮违反了霍尔木兹海峡的禁运路线。特朗普下令对伊朗进行新的打击，并撤销了针对伊朗石油出口的制裁豁免措施。北约秘书长马克·罗特支持美国的行动，认为这些行动“绝对必要”。伊朗则对巴林、科威特和卡塔尔发动了攻击。美国总统称伊朗的领导人都是“垃圾”，并宣布停火协定已经结束。

The funeral was held of [Ayatollah Ali Khamenei](#), Iran's former supreme leader, who was killed in February on the first day of the war. His coffin travelled for six days over 2,600km (1,600 miles), across five cities in Iran and Iraq. Mojtaba Khamenei, his son and successor, did not appear at the funeral; he has not been seen since the strike that killed his father.

伊朗前最高领袖阿亚图拉·阿里·哈梅内伊的葬礼于 2 月份举行。他在战争开始的第一天就遇害了。他的棺材在两天半的时间里，穿越了伊朗和伊拉克的五个城市，行程长达 2600 公里。他的儿子兼继任者莫杰塔巴·哈梅内伊并未出席葬礼；自父亲遇害后，他就一直杳无音信。

In **Algeria**, the result of a recent election confirmed that the ruling National Liberation Front and allied parties retained a majority in the parliament, which usually rubber-stamps decisions by the president. Only 21% of those registered bothered to vote, the lowest turnout ever recorded.

在阿尔及利亚，最近选举的结果表明，执政的民族解放阵线及其盟友政党仍然在议会中占据多数席位。而议会通常只是对总统的决策进行盖章认可而已。只有 21% 的登记选民参与了投票，这是有史以来最低的投票率。

The paramilitary Rapid Support Forces encircled el-Obeid in central **Sudan**, trapping half a million civilians. Reports emerging from the

city are eerily reminiscent of those from el-Fasher, where the RSF is accused of massacring perhaps tens of thousands of civilians last October.

准军事组织快速支援部队包围了苏丹中部的埃尔奥贝德镇，使 50 万平民陷入困境。从该城市传出的报道让人不禁想起埃尔法舍尔镇的情况——去年十月，快速支援部队被指控杀害了数万名平民。

Large parts of Bamako, **Mali's** capital, were left without water and electricity after suspected sabotage damaged a power line serving the city, highlighting the vulnerability of infrastructure in a worsening security crisis. Separately, jihadists and separatists launched coordinated attacks on military installation in the country's north, where the ruling junta has been losing territory.

马里首都巴马科的大部分地区在疑似破坏行为导致供电线路受损后陷入了水与电的短缺状态。这一情况凸显了在日益严峻的安全危机下基础设施的脆弱性。与此同时，极端分子和分离主义者在该国北部对军事设施发起了协同攻击，而执政的军政府在该地区正不断失去控制。

Zimbabwe's president signed into law constitutional amendments to extend and cement his hold on power. The change abolishes direct presidential elections and postpones the next vote. Emmerson Mnangagwa, who is 83, had previously promised to step down once his term ends in 2028.

津巴布韦总统签署了这些宪法修正案，以巩固他对权力的掌控。这一变更取消了总统直选制度，将下一次选举的日期推迟。现年 83 岁的埃默森·姆南加瓦曾承诺在 2028 年任期结束后退休。

In the latest hit to **South Africa's** reputation from anti-migrant protests, **Ghana** asked Cyril Ramaphosa, South Africa's president, to postpone a visit planned for next month. This follows the killing of a Ghanaian in Cape Town. Ghana says at least 15 of its citizens have been seriously injured in anti-foreigner protests in South Africa.

在南非因反移民抗议活动而受损的最新事件中，加纳要求南非总统西里尔·拉马福萨推迟原定下个月进行的访问。这一决定是在开普敦发生

一起加纳公民遇害事件之后做出的。加纳称，至少有 15 名加纳公民在南非的反外国人抗议活动中受到重伤。

China carried out a [rare test of a long-range ballistic missile](#) over the Pacific Ocean. The missile, with a dummy warhead, was launched from a submarine, and alarmed countries in the region. Japan said it was an example of the “intensification of China’s military activities”.

中国进行了一次罕见的远程弹道导弹测试，导弹发射地点位于太平洋上。该导弹携带了空包弹头，从潜艇上发射，这一举动引起了该地区国家的警觉。日本称这是“中国军事活动加剧”的一个例子。

A prison riot in **Sri Lanka** left 20 convicts and seven guards dead. The violence in Negombo, just north of Colombo, was sparked by an argument among inmates about who controlled the drug-trafficking trade inside the prison.

在斯里兰卡的某座监狱内发生了暴乱，导致 20 名囚犯和 7 名狱警死亡。这场暴力事件发生在科伦坡以北的尼贡博市，起因是囚犯之间关于谁应该掌控监狱内毒品交易权的争执。

Pakistan said that 42 security personnel had been killed in three attacks by militants on Balochistan, a province where separatists have waged a terrorist campaign for decades. The army said 54 militants were killed in the clashes.

巴基斯坦表示，在俾路支省发生的三次武装分子袭击中，有 42 名安全人员丧生。该省是分离主义者数十年来进行恐怖活动的地区。军方称，在冲突中共有 54 名武装分子被击毙。

The **Democratic candidate** in Maine’s Senate race [suspended his campaign](#), after a woman accused him of raping her. Graham Platner has also faced other claims of misconduct. He denies the allegations. Democrats will now try to select another candidate in the race, which they must win if they hope to gain control of the

Senate in the midterms.

缅因州参议院竞选中的民主党候选人因一名女性指控他强奸她而暂停了竞选活动。格雷厄姆·普拉特纳还面临其他一些不当行为的指控。他否认了这些指控。民主党现在将试图选出另一位候选人来继续竞选，如果他们希望在中期内赢得参议院控制权，就必须赢得这次选举。

In France, the court of appeal upheld **Marine Le Pen's** conviction for misusing European funds, but [enabled her to run for the presidency](#) next year by shortening a ban on her standing for elected office. The leader of the populist-right National Rally announced that she would indeed be a candidate for president again and would appeal against her conviction at France's highest court, the Cour de Cassation.

在法国，上诉法院维持了对玛丽娜·勒庞的定罪，她因滥用欧洲资金而被判有罪。不过，该判决缩短了她担任公职的禁令期限，从而让她能够在明年竞选总统。这位极右翼政党领袖宣布，她确实会再次参选总统，并且会将这一定罪案件向法国最高法院——上诉法院提出上诉。

Farage's farce

法阿吉的闹剧

Nigel Farage, the leader of Britain's populist-right Reform UK, [resigned from his seat in Parliament](#), triggering a by-election. Mr Farage has come under scrutiny and criticism for a £5m (\$6.7m) donation he received. Mr Farage says his constituents "should be the judges" of his actions. The main political parties won't stand in the by-election, so Mr Farage will do battle with the likes of Count Binface and the Monster Raving Loony party in an attempt to re-establish his credibility.

英国民族主义右翼政党“改革党”的领袖尼杰尔·法阿吉已经辞去了他在议会中的席位，这引发了一场补选。法阿吉因为收到了 500 万英镑的捐款而受到审查和批评。法阿吉表示，他的选民应该对他的行为进行评判。由于主要政党都不愿意参加这次补选，法阿吉将不得不与包括

“伯爵班费斯”党和“怪物雷文·洛尼党”在内的政党竞争，试图恢复自己的信誉。

The British government issued a conditional pardon to **Ruth Ellis**, the last woman to be executed in Britain. Ellis shot her lover dead in 1955 following an abusive relationship, during which he punched her in the stomach, causing the miscarriage of their baby. The government recognises that Ellis killed David Blakely, but said her execution had been a “historic injustice”.

英国政府有条件地赦免了露丝·埃利斯，她是英国最后一位被处决的女性。1955 年，埃利斯因一段不稳定的恋爱关系而枪杀了她的恋人。在那段关系中，她的恋人曾殴打她的腹部，导致他们的小宝宝流产。虽然政府承认埃利斯确实杀害了大卫·布莱克利，但表示她的死刑判决是一种“历史性的不公”。

The suspect in the parcel bombing of a **Ukrainian oligarch** and his family in Monaco was found dead in Ukraine with gunshot wounds to her head. An employee at Ukraine’s intelligence service and a former police officer were arrested in connection with her murder.

在摩纳哥，一名乌克兰寡头及其家人遭遇包裹炸弹袭击的嫌疑人，在乌克兰被发现死亡，头部有枪伤。与这起谋杀案相关的乌克兰情报部门工作人员以及一名前警察已被逮捕。

Keiko Fujimori was declared the winner of **Peru’s** presidential election, which was held on June 7th. Ms Fujimori, the conservative candidate, took 50.1% of the vote in the run-off. Her margin of victory was just 50,000 votes over Roberto Sánchez, her left-wing opponent. During the long count of the ballot Mr Sánchez alleged, without evidence, that the election had been manipulated to benefit Ms Fujimori, but he has now said he recognises that she has been officially elected.

费米莫莉·凯科在 6 月 7 日举行的秘鲁总统选举中获胜。这位保守派候选人获得了 50.1% 的选票。她的胜差仅为 5 万票，而她的左翼对手罗伯托·桑切斯获得了 49.9% 的选票。在计票过程中，桑切斯毫无根

据地声称选举被操纵以有利于费米莫莉，但现在他表示承认她确实当选了总统。

The authorities in **Cuba** struggled to restore power following another collapse of the electricity grid. Meanwhile, Raúl Guillermo Rodríguez Castro, the grandson of Raúl Castro, Cuba's former leader, said he was willing to negotiate with America. Mr Rodríguez Castro held a secret meeting with Marco Rubio, America's secretary of state, in February.

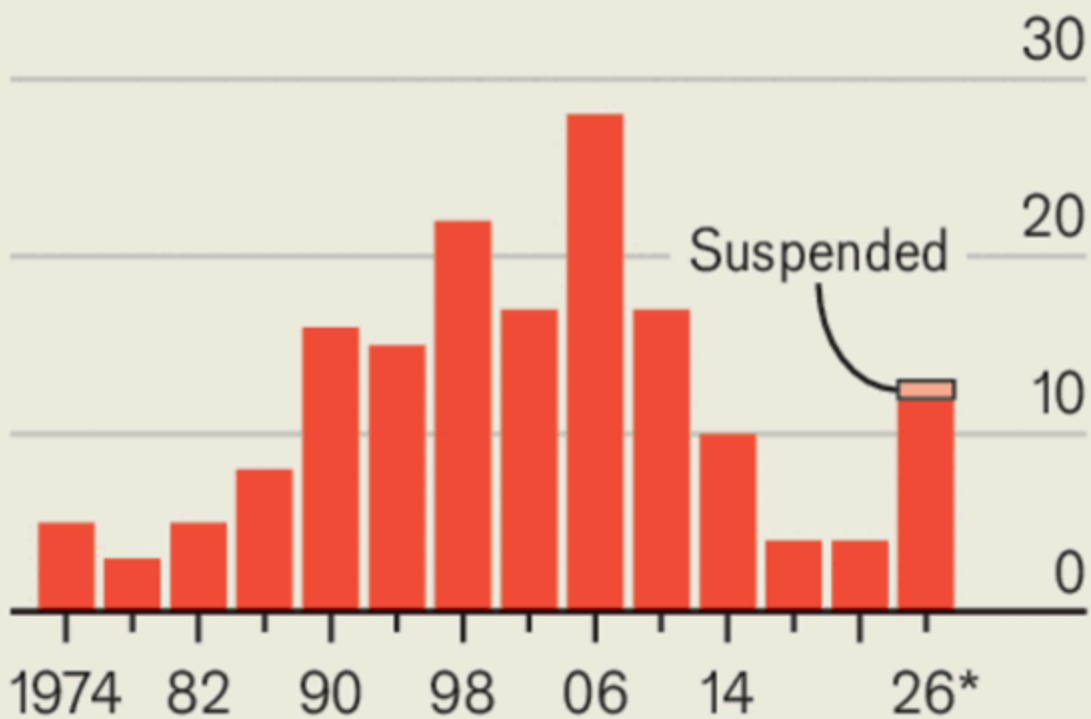
在电网再次发生故障后，古巴当局在恢复电力供应方面遇到了困难。与此同时，古巴前领导人劳尔·卡斯特罗的孙子劳尔·吉列尔梅·罗德里格斯·卡斯特罗表示，他愿意与美国进行谈判。罗德里格斯·卡斯特罗在二月与美国的国务卿马科·鲁比奥举行了秘密会议。

The International Olympic Committee provisionally lifted its suspension of **Russian athletes**, though it hasn't decided if the Russian flag and anthem will still be barred. The suspension was introduced in October 2023 because Russia was organising Olympic committees in occupied Ukraine.

国际奥委会暂时取消了对俄罗斯运动员的禁赛措施，不过目前尚未决定是否仍会禁止俄罗斯国旗和国歌在奥运赛事中使用。这一禁赛措施是在 2023 年 10 月实施的，原因是俄罗斯在被占领的乌克兰地区组织了奥运项目的比赛。

Men's football World Cup

Red cards issued



Source: FIFA

*To July 7th

At the **World Cup** Folarin Balogun, America's star player, received a red card for a dangerous challenge on an opposing player, which meant he should have been suspended from America's next game, against Belgium. Donald Trump complained to the president of FIFA, football's world body. FIFA has the discretion to suspend the ban, which it duly did after Mr Trump's intervention. It is the only time a red card has been suspended at a World Cup since automatic bans were standardised in 1970. UEFA, Europe's governing body, said FIFA had "crossed a red line". The us team was subsequently thrashed 4-

1 by Belgium.

在世界杯比赛中，美国队的明星球员福拉林·巴洛贡因为对对手球员进行危险挑逗行为而被出示红牌。这意味着他应该被禁止参加美国队接下来的比赛，对手是比利时队。唐纳德·特朗普向国际足球联合会主席提出了投诉。国际足球联合会有权决定是否暂停执行这项禁令，在特朗普的干预下，他们最终决定暂停执行该禁令。这是自 1970 年自动禁赛制度实施后，世界杯上首次出现红牌被暂停的情况。欧洲足球协会联合会表示，国际足球联合会已经“越过了界限”。结果，美国队在比赛中以 1 比 4 败给比利时队。

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The world this week

本周的世界

Business

商业

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A year after legislation passed to create them, “[Trump Accounts](#)” became operational. American babies born from 2025 to 2028, the four years of Donald Trump’s second term, can register and have \$1,000 invested for them in American shares. Despite being named after the president, the scheme is funded mostly by the taxpayer, with companies, wealthy individuals and parents adding top-ups. Last year the Michael and Susan Dell Foundation pledged \$6.3bn for

the programme. The Treasury has said that 6m Trump Accounts have been opened so far.

在相关立法通过一年后，这些“特朗普账户”正式开始运作。从 2025 年到 2028 年，也就是唐纳德·特朗普第二个任期内的四年期间出生的婴儿，可以注册这些账户，并为其投资 1000 美元购买美国股票。虽然这些账户以总统的名字命名，但实际上这些资金主要由纳税人提供，而企业、富人和父母则会追加投资。去年，迈克尔和苏珊·戴尔基金会为该计划提供了 63 亿美元的资金支持。财政部表示，迄今为止已经开设了 600 万个特朗普账户。

A week after the Trump administration lifted its ban on Anthropic's latest AI models, OpenAI rolled out **GPT-5.6**, its most advanced machine-learning system. The launch had been delayed by the government's request that it be released to only a [limited number of vetted users](#) to assess the security risks; it is now reportedly satisfied that GPT-5.6 has passed those extra checks.

在特朗普政府解除对 Anthropic 公司最新人工智能模型的禁令一周后，OpenAI 推出了其最先进的机器学习系统 GPT-5.6。该系统的发布因政府的要求而推迟，政府要求仅向少数经过审核的用户发布该系统，以便评估安全风险；据报道，现在政府认为 GPT-5.6 已经通过了这些额外的安全检查。

sk Hynix's share offering on the Nasdaq exchange was heavily oversubscribed ahead of the stock's debut on July 10th. The South Korean chipmaker is seeking to raise \$28bn through the sale of American depositary receipts (enabling investors in the us to buy its stock), which after SpaceX would be the second-biggest share offering on record.

SK Hynix 在纳斯达克证券交易所进行的股票发行活动，在 7 月 10 日股票首次上市之前就出现了严重的超额认购情况。这家韩国芯片制造商希望通过出售美国存托凭证来筹集 280 亿美元的资金（这样美国的投资者就可以购买其股票）。此次发行将成为继 SpaceX 之后，历史上第二大规模的股票发行活动。

Samsung, which is also [benefiting from the demand for memory chips](#), said it expects to log an operating profit for the second quarter of 89.4trn Korean won (\$59bn), another record for the company and double its operating profit for all of 2025. But the share prices of Samsung and sk Hynix fell heavily amid more investor jitters about the durability of AI spending.

三星也受益于对内存芯片的需求增长，该公司表示预计第二季度营业利润将达到 89.4 万亿韩元（约 590 亿美元），这将是公司的又一个历史新高。不过，由于投资者对人工智能相关支出的稳定性感到担忧，三星和 SK하이닉스의股价出现了大幅下跌。

SpaceX's stock was added to the Nasdaq 100, a weighted index of leading non-financial companies, including Apple, Nvidia and Walmart. A rule change allowed the rockets-and-AI company to join the Nasdaq 100 less than a month after it floated shares in an initial public offering. Its stock will now be tracked by hundreds of passive investment funds. SpaceX's share price is still trading above the \$135 it was priced at in the IPO.

SpaceX 的股票被纳入了纳斯达克 100 指数，该指数包含了许多非金融领域的领先企业，比如苹果、英伟达和沃尔玛等公司。由于一项规则变更，这家专注于火箭技术和人工智能领域的公司能够在首次公开募股后不到一个月的时间内加入纳斯达克 100 指数。现在，有数百只被动投资基金在跟踪 SpaceX 的股票价格。SpaceX 的股票价格目前仍然高于 IPO 时的定价水平，达到了 135 美元以上。

A new frontier

新的边界

The European Central Bank asked 110 banks to present credible plans for dealing with the security threat from advanced AI models. The Bank of England also mentioned the threat from frontier AI in its latest report on **financial stability**, warning that the technology will “increase the sophistication and impact of cyber-attacks” on financial

institutions and market infrastructure. Andrew Bailey, the Bank of England's governor, called for co-operation among regulators in dealing with the security implications of AI, but said, unlike the ECB, he would not be issuing edicts to banks.

欧洲中央银行要求 110 家银行提出可行的计划，以应对来自先进人工智能模型的安全威胁。英格兰银行也在其最新的金融稳定报告中提到了人工智能带来的威胁，警告称这项技术将“增强网络攻击的复杂性和影响力”，对金融机构和市场基础设施构成严重威胁。英格兰银行行长安德鲁·贝利呼吁监管机构在应对人工智能带来的安全问题时进行合作，但他表示，与欧洲中央银行不同，英格兰银行不会向银行发布强制性规定。

Yields on **Japan's** ten-year government bonds reached 2.9%, the highest since 1996, pushing up the costs of borrowing. Gross public debt is over 200% of GDP. As well as being concerned about the weak yen, investors are said to be worried about how the government is going to fund its recently announced \$2.3trn, 14-year investment plan.

日本十年期政府债券的收益率达到了 2.9%，这一数值是自 1996 年以来的最高水平，从而推高了借贷成本。公共债务总额超过 GDP 的 200%。除了对日元疲软的担忧之外，投资者似乎还担心政府如何为最近宣布的 23 万亿美元、为期 14 年的投资计划提供资金。

After holding out for a higher offer, **easyJet**, a European low-cost airline based in Britain, reached a preliminary agreement to be sold to **Castlelake**, an American investment firm, which would value the carrier at £5.5bn (\$7.3bn). Castlelake, which has managed hundreds of planes through its leasing business, must make its offer official by August 3rd under British regulatory law.

在等待更高的收购报价后，总部位于英国的欧洲低成本航空公司 EasyJet 终于与美国投资公司 Castlelake 达成了初步出售协议。根据英国监管法规，Castlake 提出的收购价格为 55 亿英镑（73 亿美元）。这家以租赁方式管理数百架飞机的公司必须在 8 月 3 日之前正式宣布其收购提议。

UniCredit, a big Italian bank, announced that it had increased its stake in **Commerzbank**, a German lender, to 47.6%. UniCredit has been trying to take over Commerzbank for over a year, but its overtures have been rejected by the German company and the German government.

意大利大型银行 UniCredit 宣布，其持有的德国银行 Commerzbank 的股份已增至 47.6%。UniCredit 已经试图收购 Commerzbank 超过一年，但其收购提议一直被这家德国公司和德国政府拒绝。

Call of duty

任务挑战

After declaring that the games industry is “facing the most severe hardware crisis in its history”, [Microsoft cut 3,200 jobs at its 'Xbox business'](#), 1,600 of which were lost immediately. Profit margins at Xbox are lower than at its rivals and the wide availability of online gaming has eaten into demand for its consoles. It will also get rid of five of its gaming studios and reduce costs at Activision Blizzard, a games publisher it acquired in 2023 for \$70bn.

微软宣布游戏行业正“面临历史上最严重的硬件危机”，随后在其 Xbox 业务领域裁掉了 3,200 个工作岗位，其中 1,600 个岗位需要立即裁员。Xbox 的利润率低于竞争对手，而在线游戏的大量普及也削弱了对其游戏机的需求。此外，微软还将关闭五个游戏工作室，并削减 2023 年以 700 亿美元收购的游戏发行商 Activision Blizzard 的运营成本。

Sky, a European broadcaster, struck an agreement to buy **ITV Media and Entertainment** in a £1.6bn (\$2.1bn) deal. ITV M&E

operates the network and streaming platforms of ITV, Britain's legacy commercial channel. The transaction does not include the more lucrative ITV Studios, which produces ITV's programmes, such as "Coronation Street" and "Poirot". Sky is a subsidiary of Comcast, which intends to spin off Sky and NBCUniversal into a separate company.

欧洲广播公司 Sky 达成了一项协议，以 16 亿英镑（约 2.1 亿美元）的价格收购了 ITV Media and Entertainment。ITV M&E 负责运营 ITV 的电视网络和流媒体平台。该交易并未包括更盈利的 ITV Studios，后者负责制作 ITV 的节目，例如《加冕街》和《波洛》等知名剧集。Sky 是 Comcast 的子公司，而 Comcast 计划将 Sky 和 NBCUniversal 合并为独立的公司。

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漫画：对全球经济增长的真正威胁

A lighter take on the news

对新闻报道更轻快的看法

Jul 09, 2026 05:22 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:22



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Andrey Melnichenko

安德烈·梅尔尼琴科

The man who would change Russia

那个将改变俄罗斯的国家领袖

A leading oligarch speaks out, warning of the looming disaster facing his country

一位著名的寡头政治家发声警告，称他的国家面临着迫在眉睫的灾难

Jul 09, 2026 10:40 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 10:40



WHEN ENOUGH Russians feel the endless fighting in Ukraine is futile and that they are paying the price, their president, Vladimir Putin, will be forced to do something spectacular to break the deadlock. This is why it pays to watch Russia for warnings of fatigue or discontent. Our cover this week features the most stunning such

warning so far.

当越来越多的俄罗斯人意识到乌克兰的持续战争是毫无意义的，并且他们正在为此付出代价时，俄罗斯总统弗拉基米尔·普京将不得不采取一些大胆的行动来打破这一僵局。因此，关注俄罗斯的动态以捕捉他们可能发出的疲劳或不满的信号是非常有意义的。本周的报道中，出现了迄今为止最令人震惊的此类信号。

It comes from Andrey Melnichenko, the world's fertiliser king and Russia's biggest industrialist. Mr Melnichenko is hardly a member of the anti-Putin opposition. Far from criticising the invasion, he is an insider whose factories have supported the war economy. Nor is he being high-minded. Having run his companies outside Russia, Mr Melnichenko returned in 2023 as the scope for global business shrank. Like most oligarchs, he has lived by Mr Putin's rules—make money, but keep your nose out of politics. He is talking now because he and his fellow tycoons can no longer afford to ignore the rot in a country they watched descend into tyranny.

这位人物就是安德烈·梅尔尼琴科，被誉为“世界肥料大王”以及俄罗斯最大的实业家。梅尔尼琴科显然并非反普京的反对派成员。他远非那种批评入侵行为的人，实际上他是该行业的内部人士，他的工厂一直为战争经济提供支持。不过，他并非出于高尚的动机行事。在俄罗斯境外经营企业后，梅尔尼琴科于 2023 年重返俄罗斯，因为全球商业机会已经缩小了。像大多数寡头一样，他遵循普京的规则——赚钱，但不要插手政治事务。他现在之所以发声，是因为他和他的同僚们再也无法忽视这个国家所陷入的混乱与暴政了。

Read the rest of our cover package

阅读我们封面文章的全文吧。

- [A top oligarch breaks his silence](#)
[一位顶级寡头打破了他的沉默](#)
- [Russians are growing anxious and angry:](#)
[俄罗斯人越来越感到焦虑和愤怒了。](#)

Mr Melnichenko issued his warning over nearly [60 hours of interviews](#) with *The Economist* and more guardedly in an [essay](#) we are publishing online. It is the first time an oligarch in Russia has spoken out at such length. We are giving him space not because we agree with all his views or because he is a champion of democracy and human rights. Instead, he is a pragmatist who wants his firms to thrive. That is why his call could resonate in a country where wars gone wrong, including the defeat to Japan in 1905, have led to campaigns by industrialists for political change.

梅尔尼切宁先生在《经济学人》杂志上发表了近 60 小时访谈内容，他的言论更加谨慎。这是俄罗斯寡头首次如此长篇大篇地发表意见。我们给予他这样的空间，并非因为认同他的所有观点，也不是因为他主张民主和人权。实际上，他是个务实主义者，希望自己的企业能够蓬勃发展。正因如此，他的观点在这个国家可能会产生共鸣——在这个国家，由于战争失败，包括 1905 年对日本的战败，工业家们一直在推动政治变革。

Mr Melnichenko's words go far beyond the war, to the bleak outlook for Russia and its neighbours. He warns the West not to wish for Russia to descend into chaos, brutal autarky or a sullen, dangerous dependency. Although he does not say that Mr Putin must be removed from power, the change he wants would amount to an end to one-man rule.

梅尔尼切宁先生的言论远远超出了战争的范围，它们揭示了俄罗斯及其邻国所面临的严峻形势。他警告西方不要希望俄罗斯陷入混乱、实行残酷的自治制度，或者陷入一种消极且危险的依赖状态。虽然他并没有说必须让普京下台，但他所期望的变革，本质上就是结束由一个人掌控国家权力的局面。

What makes Mr Melnichenko's intervention so striking is that the Ukraine war has come home to Russia. After Ukrainian attacks on its energy industry, the country is witnessing queues for fuel and fistfights at filling stations. The annexation of Crimea in 2014

boosted Mr Putin's popularity; today the peninsula is being isolated by Ukrainian drone strikes. Forced military enlistment is feeding resentment. Influencers' complaints about the war are going viral on social media.

让梅尔尼切宁先生的干预如此引人注目的原因是，乌克兰战争实际上已经变成了俄罗斯的问题。在乌克兰对俄罗斯能源产业发动攻击之后，俄罗斯人不得不面对燃料短缺的困境，甚至还要在加油站发生斗殴事件。2014 年克里米亚被吞并时，普京的声望得到了提升；而如今，克里米亚又遭到了乌克兰无人机的袭击。强制征兵也加剧了民众的不满情绪。一些网红对战争的抱怨在社交媒体上迅速传播开来。

This reality belies Mr Putin's repeated promises that the special military operation is on track and a breakthrough is at hand. Although the Russian economy is not about to collapse and people are not about to rise up, Russians increasingly feel that their country has [reached a dead end](#).

这一现实与普京反复承诺的“特别军事行动正在顺利进行，突破口即将出现”的说法相矛盾。尽管俄罗斯经济不会崩溃，民众也不会爆发起义，但俄罗斯人越来越觉得自己的国家已经陷入了一个死胡同。

Mr Putin may well try to reassert his authority by escalating the war and repressing people at home. Some Western intelligence services have recently reported that Russia is about to intensify its confrontation with NATO. At his darkest, Mr Melnichenko fears the use of a tactical nuclear weapon in an attempt to terrorise Ukraine's European backers—though Western analysts still discount that.

普京先生可能会试图通过升级战争和镇压国内民众来重新确立自己的权威。一些西方情报机构最近报告称，俄罗斯即将加强与北约的对抗。在最糟糕的情况下，梅尔尼琴科担心俄罗斯可能会使用战术核武器来恐吓乌克兰的欧洲支持者——不过，西方分析人士仍然认为这种可能性很低。

Mr Melnichenko argues that escalation would not lead to a lasting peace between Russia, Ukraine and Europe. Left unsaid is that, if

ordinary Russians become alarmed by the war and more resentful because of a broad mobilisation and political repression, that will only exacerbate Mr Putin's problems at home—leading to the next round of escalation.

梅尔尼切宁先生认为，这种升级行为并不会带来俄罗斯、乌克兰和欧洲之间的持久和平。然而，如果普通俄罗斯人因战争而感到不安，再加上对大规模动员和政治镇压的不满，那么这将只会加剧普京在国内的问题——进而引发下一轮升级。

These gloomy thoughts take Mr Melnichenko to the heart of his argument. He sets out his thesis in a series of long-term scenarios for Russia, all of which, he says, would be dangerous for Russia and the world.

这些悲观的想法让梅尔尼琴科先生陷入了深深的思考之中。他通过一系列长期性的情景来阐述自己的论点，他认为，所有这些情景都会对俄罗斯以及整个世界带来危险。

Most alarmingly, Russia could collapse into anarchy, as warlords struggle for control of resources and nuclear weapons. That fear was real enough to lead the Biden administration to seek to avoid Russia being humiliated in Ukraine.

最令人担忧的是，俄罗斯可能会陷入混乱状态，因为军阀们会争夺资源与核武器的控制权。这种担忧非常现实，以至于拜登政府试图避免俄罗斯在乌克兰问题上遭受耻辱。

Or Russia could come under the thumb of foreign powers. It may be dominated by China, which could use it to supply raw materials and serve as a buffer against America. Or, after a war of attrition, maybe Russia will exist on the periphery of Europe, an impoverished dependant. Both outcomes would breed resentment and discontent, he predicts, incubating a violent nationalism that may one day explode into conflict.

或者，俄罗斯可能会陷入外国势力的控制之下。它可能会被中国所支配，而中国可以利用俄罗斯作为原料供应地，同时利用俄罗斯来制衡

美国。或者，在经历一场消耗战之后，俄罗斯可能会沦为欧洲的边缘国家，成为一个贫困的附属国。他预测，这两种情况都会引发怨恨和不满，进而滋生暴力民族主义情绪，最终可能导致冲突的爆发。

In the last scenario Russia would turn inward, like North Korea, a closed fortress under siege, starved of growth and capital. This is apparently being actively discussed in the bowels of the Kremlin. Yet, like North Korea, Russia would be in a state of permanent war against the world.

在最后一种情况下，俄罗斯会像朝鲜一样走向内部封闭，成为一个被围困的封闭堡垒，陷入经济增长和资本枯竭的困境。显然，这种想法已经在克里姆林宫内部被积极讨论过了。不过，和朝鲜一样，俄罗斯也会一直处于与世界的永久战争状态。

Mr Melnichenko is enigmatic about how precisely to avoid these outcomes. Self-servingly, he urges Western countries to resist the temptation to push the war to its limits. Instead, they and Russia must find a way to live in peace. To this end, he calls on them to grant Russia "sovereignty"—an immunity that sounds a lot like China's demand for non-interference. About reform in Russia, he is elusive. The country must be predictable to the outside world and must win over its people without resorting to coercion. Implicitly, he wants Mr Putin to relinquish one-man rule and devolve power. But he does not talk about democracy.

梅尔尼切宁先生对于如何避免出现这些结果则含糊其辞。他建议西方国家不要试图将战争推向极端。相反，他们和俄罗斯应该找到和平共处的办法。为此，他呼吁给予俄罗斯“主权”——这种要求与中国主张不干涉别国事务的立场颇为相似。至于俄罗斯的改革问题，他则避而不谈。俄罗斯应该对外保持可预测性，并且应该在不使用强制手段的情况下赢得民众的支持。从字面上看，他希望普京能放弃独裁统治，将权力下放。不过，他并没有提及民主制度。

Even that will run up against the securocrats, top dogs since Mr Putin banished the original post-Soviet oligarchs from politics over

two decades ago. If Russia becomes a more normal country, they will be the losers. Perhaps, though, technocrats and moguls fearful for Russia will take Mr Melnichenko's side. Mr Putin may refuse to yield. But he is in a bind. Grinding on, escalation and reform would each carry costs.

即便如此，这还是会与那些安全官僚们发生冲突。这些高官自从普京在二十年前将原苏联时期的寡头们赶下台之后，就一直占据着重要的位置。如果俄罗斯成为一个更正常的国家，他们将会成为输家。不过，那些担心俄罗斯未来的官僚们或许会站在梅尔尼琴科那边。普京可能不会轻易让步。但他目前处于困境之中。继续升级冲突和进行改革都会带来代价。

Reform has a precedent. In 1905 Russia lost a 19-month war to Japan. Industrialists and technocrats blamed the dictatorial Nicholas II. It showed, they said, that one-man rule doomed Russia to be behind the rest of Europe. That year, after an uprising, they forced the tsar to accept the October Manifesto, which proposed civil liberties and a legislative assembly.

改革确实有先例。1905 年，俄罗斯在长达 19 个月的战争失败后败给了日本。工业家和官僚们将责任归咎于独裁的尼古拉二世。他们认为，个人统治注定会让俄罗斯落后于欧洲其他国家。那一年，在一次起义之后，他们迫使沙皇接受了《十月宣言》，该宣言提出了公民自由以及立法议会的构想。

By mid-1907 Nicholas had crushed the reforms; a decade later he was toppled in the revolution. The hope must be that Russia learns this lesson: it needs reforms that last. ■

到 1907 年中期，尼古拉已经彻底镇压了那些改革运动；十年后，他在一次革命中被推翻。希望俄罗斯能从中吸取教训：它需要的是那些能够持久的改革。■

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Baby steps

慢慢来

Two cheers for Trump Accounts 为特朗普的账号鼓掌两次吧。

The grubby scheme contains the seeds of a good idea
这个拙劣的计划中蕴含着一个好主意的种子。

Jul 09, 2026 06:30 AM

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DONALD TRUMP likes putting his name on things, from Manhattan skyscrapers (with permission) to Washington's Kennedy Centre

(without). From July 4th Americans have started seeing the president's name show up in their children's financial statements. Babies born between 2025 and 2028 are getting "Trump Accounts": \$1,000 invested in American stocks, which will be theirs to spend when they turn 18. Some billionaires and big companies have donated top-ups, and parents can make their own contributions.

唐纳德·特朗普喜欢在各种事物上标注自己的名字，从曼哈顿的摩天大楼到华盛顿的肯尼迪中心，甚至一些地方并没有这么做。从 7 月 4 日开始，美国的家长们开始看到总统的名字出现在孩子们的财务报表上。那些出生于 2025 年至 2028 年之间的婴儿将会拥有“特朗普账户”：有 1000 美元投资于美国股票，这些钱在他们年满 18 岁后就可以使用。一些亿万富翁和大公司也捐赠了额外的资金，家长们也可以自行捐款。

The name is not the only Trumpy thing about the new handouts: they are also partisan, grubby and funded mostly by borrowing. Only babies who are born from 2025 onward, when Mr Trump returned to the White House, will qualify. Roping in America's wealthiest to chip in alongside the taxpayer carries a whiff of the cronyism that is sadly too familiar in today's Washington.

这些新发布的宣传材料除了名字之外，其实没什么值得注意的“特朗普特色”：它们仍然具有党派性，手段卑劣，而且大部分资金都是通过借贷获得的。只有那些在 2025 年之后出生的孩子，也就是在特朗普重返白宫之后出生的孩子，才符合这一政策的要求。让美国最富有的人群也参与到这项计划中，这无疑体现了当今华盛顿那种腐败的作风——那种我们早已熟悉的权贵主义现象。

However, beneath the unsavoury execution there sits an experiment worth watching. The idea of giving children equity stakes in the economy is sound in principle. It is also well-timed, as societies face up to the looming economic disruption from artificial intelligence.

不过，在这看似不光彩的做法之下，其实有一个值得关注的实验。给孩子们参与经济的机会这一想法在原则上是非常合理的。而且，这一

举措来得正是时候，因为当前社会正面临着人工智能带来的经济变革所带来的挑战。

So far, the scale of this experiment is, admittedly, rather small. The \$1,000 each child receives could be worth around \$4,500 by the time they turn 18, which is more like \$3,000 in today's prices. Still, it could make a modest but helpful dent in a deposit for a home or car, or in university fees. Many young people already rely on handouts to help buy their first home, but how much they get depends largely on how deep their parents' pockets are. This undermines the notion that working hard is enough to succeed, a principle without which public support for free markets wanes.

目前，这个实验的规模确实相当小。每个孩子获得的 1000 美元，到他们 18 岁时总价值约为 4500 美元，按今天的物价计算大约相当于 3000 美元。不过，这笔钱仍然可以在购买房屋或汽车时起到一定的帮助作用，或者用于支付大学学费。许多年轻人依赖政府救济来购买他们的第一套住房，但他们能得到多少补助则很大程度上取决于父母的经济状况。这削弱了“努力就能成功”的观念，而这一观念正是支持自由市场的重要原则。

Indeed, a troublingly high share of young people profess to feel more enthusiasm for socialism than capitalism. *The Economist* has spotted a worrying rise in what we call "[Gen-Z socialism](#)", a politics that combines soaking the rich with calls for price controls on everything from rental housing to groceries. Winning the next generation back to the side of free enterprise may require giving them a personal stake in the private sector that goes beyond the labour market.

事实上，有相当高比例的年轻人声称，他们对比资本主义来说，更倾向于支持社会主义。《经济学人》指出，所谓的“Z 世代社会主义”现象正在出现令人担忧的上升趋势。这种政治理念将压榨富人与要求对从租赁房到食品杂货等一切商品实施价格管制结合起来。要重新赢得下一代人的支持，或许需要让他们在私营部门中拥有超出劳动力市场的个人利益。

Compared with other rich countries, America has already done a good job of making investors of everybody: the poorest fifth of Americans have 15% of their assets in stocks, versus just 3% in 1990. Trump Accounts could build on that start by offering a national lesson in financial literacy as children and families watch their money grow.

与其他富裕国家相比，美国在吸引各类投资者方面做得相当出色：美国最贫困的五分之一人口拥有 15% 的资产投资于股票，而 1990 年时这一比例仅为 3%。特朗普政府可以通过向儿童和家庭传授金融知识来进一步拓展这一领域，让他们了解如何管理自己的财富。

The experiment is particularly useful preparation for the turmoil that the spread of AI may bring. The more radical forecasts for AI's economic effects involve vast returns for capital-holders and a tough time for workers. Under that scenario, a direct and highly visible public stake in the technology might be necessary to forestall runaway inequality and political instability.

这项实验对于预测人工智能普及可能带来的混乱局势非常有帮助。那些对人工智能经济影响持激进观点的预测认为，资本持有者将获得巨大收益，而劳动者则会面临困境。在这种情况下，有必要让公众直接参与到这项技术中来，以避免不平等现象加剧和政治不稳定情况的发生。

Instead of the government running the show of managing, say, the 5% of OpenAI that Sam Altman has suggested handing over, shares could be passed along to citizens via Trump-like accounts. Even if AI does not make capital eclipse labour, the mechanism could encourage a healthy new form of philanthropy in which some billionaires voluntarily pass on parts of their fortunes to all Americans.

与其由政府来管理，比如管理 Sam Altman 所建议的 OpenAI 中那 5% 的股份，不如将这些股份通过类似特朗普式的账户分配给公民。即使人工智能技术不会让资本超越劳动力的重要性，这种机制仍可以促

进一种新的慈善形式——即一些亿万富翁自愿将部分财富分配给全体美国人。

The scheme's deficit-financing is not ideal, but at least the borrowing funds savings rather than—as with most government handouts—immediate consumption. In any case, at its current size the effect of the scheme on the deficit is microscopic: 0.005% of annual GDP. So Trump Accounts get two cheers from *The Economist*. We hope they outlast the president's term—and that his successor sorts out a name for them that Democrats and Republicans alike can get behind. ■

该计划的赤字融资方式并不理想，但至少所借来的资金能够用于储蓄，而不是像大多数政府拨款那样被用于即时消费。无论如何，以目前的规模来看，该计划对赤字的影响微乎其微：占年度 GDP 的 0.005%。因此，《经济学人》对特朗普的“账户计划”表示赞赏。我们希望这一计划能在特朗普的任期内持续下去，并且他的继任者能找到一个让民主党人和共和党人都支持的名称。■

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The wrong fix

错误的修复方法

England needs fewer council homes, not more

英格兰需要的的是更少的公共住房，而不是更多的住房。

Andy Burnham's plan is no way to ease the housing crisis

安迪·伯纳姆的计划根本无法解决住房危机问题。

Jul 09, 2026 07:33 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 7:33



YOUNG BRITONS are a gloomy bunch. One poll found that 38% expect to lead worse lives than their parents (only 36% think they will do better). Much of the blame can be laid at the locked door of unaffordable housing. In big cities, where the good jobs are, rents are extortionate. In London the average is around half of mean earnings. Anger about housing frays the social contract and leads some to scapegoat vulnerable groups, such as refugees.

年轻的英国人似乎都是些情绪消极的人。一项调查显示，有 38% 的人认为自己的生活质量会比他们的父母更差（只有 36% 的人认为情况会更好）。造成这种现象的主要原因在于房价过高，人们难以负担住房费用。在大城市里，好的工作机会往往伴随着极高的租金。在伦敦，平均租金大约是平均收入的一半。对住房问题的不满使得人们开始将一些弱势群体，比如难民，当作替罪羊。

Andy Burnham, the man almost certain to be the next prime minister, has an answer. He has promised "[the biggest council-housebuilding programme since the post-war period](#)". This policy is popular: 72% of the public support more social housing, which in England means homes owned by councils or charities and let at below-market rents. Over 1.3m households are on waiting lists for such homes.

安迪·伯纳姆几乎肯定会成为下一任首相，他给出了答案。他承诺将实施“自战后时期以来规模最大的公共住房建设项目”。这一政策很受欢迎：72% 的民众支持建造更多社会住房，在英格兰，这些住房由地方政府或慈善机构拥有，并以低于市场价的价格出租给居民。目前，有超过 13 万户家庭正在等待这些住房的分配。

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深入一点吧

- [How realistic is Andy Burnham's council-house building pledge?](#)

[安迪·伯纳姆提出的建造市政厅的设想有多现实呢？](#)

- [Britain's social housing subsidises the wrong people](#)
[英国的社会住房政策补贴的是那些并不需要帮助的人。](#)

Yet Mr Burnham's plan would be like adding a floor on top of a crumbling tower block. England does not have too little social housing. It has too much: at 16% of the total stock, more than any other G7 country. In some London boroughs nearly 40% of homes are social housing. And far from being "the foundation for everything", as Mr Burnham says, the council-housing system is wasteful, unfair and a barrier to growth.

然而，伯纳姆先生的计划就像是在一个摇摇欲坠的高层建筑上再加盖一层地基。英国的公共住房数量并不少，而是太多了：占总住房总数的 16%，这一比例超过了 G7 国家中的任何其他国家。在一些伦敦的行政区，近 40% 的住房都是公共住房。而正如伯纳姆所说，公共住房制度并非“一切的基础”，它实际上是一种浪费、不公平的制度，并且会成为经济增长的障碍。

England has two types of housing support. First, tenants in social housing enjoy discounted rents. Second, anyone deemed needy after a means test, whether in a private home or a social one, can receive a rent subsidy ("housing benefit"). *The Economist* crudely calculates that discounted rents to the first group add up to an implicit subsidy of £20bn (\$25bn) a year. For the two-thirds of social-housing tenants who are on welfare, this saving is mostly recycled within government, lowering the benefit bill needed to cover rent. But for the remaining one-third not on welfare, it's a bonanza.

英格兰有两种类型的住房支持措施。首先，居住在社会住房中的租户可以享受到优惠租金。其次，任何经过经济状况评估后被认定为贫困的人群，无论他们居住在私人住宅还是社会住房中，都可以获得租金补贴。据《经济学人》的粗略计算，对第一类租户提供的优惠租金每年总计相当于 200 亿英镑（250 亿美元）的隐性补贴。对于三分之二享受社会福利的社会住房租户来说，这种优惠待遇大多被政府内部循环利用，从而减少了他们支付租金所需的资金。但对于剩下的三分之一没有享受社会福利的租户来说，这则是一个巨大的福利机会。

New social lets in Kensington and Chelsea were nearly 80% below market rents in 2024-25, a £32,000 annual saving per household. Social tenancies are often for life and can even be inherited. Once you're in, [there's no more means-testing](#), regardless of how much your fortunes improve. Of the 4m households in social housing in England, more than 10% have incomes in the national top 40%. Some are rich. The wife of the president of Sierra Leone, who lives in a palace, was recently found to have a council home in London as well.

位于肯辛顿和切尔西的新社会住房在 2024-25 年期间，其租金水平比市场租金低近 80%，这意味着每户家庭每年可节省 32,000 英镑。社会住房的租约通常是终身有效的，甚至可以被继承。一旦入住，就无需再考虑收入状况了——无论你的财富如何增长。在英格兰的 400 万套社会住房中，有超过 10% 的住户收入属于全国前 40% 之列。有些人确实很富有。例如，塞拉利昂总统的妻子就住在一套豪华住宅中，而她名下还拥有一套伦敦的政府住房。

Thus, some high earners enjoy ultra-cheap social housing, while more than 1m households on benefits rent from private landlords. In much of the country, housing benefits are stingy and rents are high, so this latter group is at risk of homelessness. A system that arbitrarily foists feast on some and famine on others is not just.

因此，一些高收入者能够享受到极其廉价的住房，而超过 100 万户领取福利金的家庭则不得不向私人房东租房居住。在国家的许多地区，

住房福利金很少，租金却很高，因此这部分人面临着无家可归的风险。一个将资源任意分配给某些人的制度，显然是不公平的。

Antisocial housing

反社会型住房

It also slows economic growth by making people less mobile. If you have a lifelong council tenancy, you don't want to lose it. So you are less likely to move elsewhere in search of a better job. And many of the council homes in city centres are occupied by pensioners, who are also frozen in place, blocking young jobseekers from moving in. (Some 60% of adults in social housing do not work.) Mr Burnham seems to think immobility is a virtue: he vows to build a country where "No one has to leave to get on in life."

此外，这种状况还会因为限制人们的流动性而减缓经济增长。如果你拥有终身租住的公寓，你肯定不想失去它。因此，你就不太可能为了寻找更好的工作而搬到其他地方去。而城市中心的许多公共住房都被老年人占据，他们也被束缚在原来的住所里，这也就阻碍了年轻求职者的入注意愿。（大约 60% 的社会住房居住者并不工作。）伯纳姆先生似乎认为，不流动是一种美德：他承诺要建设一个“没有人需要离开才能获得更好生活”的国家。

Rather than spending vast sums on building new council homes, Mr Burnham should instead raise all social rents to market rates. Then, those who truly need support could be given extra means-tested benefits to cover the difference. When the Tories tried and failed to introduce a similar scheme in 2015, opponents labelled it "social cleansing". Yet the proposal is not to evict tenants, merely to charge them market rents. It would direct spending to people as and when they need it, instead of pinning it to a pile of bricks and mortar. Such a reform should be phased in gradually, to give people time to

adjust. It would free up billions.

伯纳姆先生不应该在建造新的市政住房上投入巨额资金，而应该将所有的社会租金提高到市场水平。这样，那些真正需要帮助的人就可以获得额外的福利补贴来弥补差额。当保守党在 2015 年试图推出类似的计划时，反对者将其称为“社会清洗”。但实际上，这个提议并不是为了驱逐租户，而是让他们支付市场租金。这种方式可以让资金在人们需要的时候才被使用，而不是被浪费在毫无意义的建筑上。这样的改革应该逐步实施，以便人们有时间适应。这样就能节省数十亿的资金。

Fixing social housing would not solve all England's housing woes. To do that, the country also needs to let builders put up more homes. Sir Keir Starmer enacted some reforms to make England's planning system less insanely slow and obstructive. But other changes, such as stricter safety rules, gummed it up again. Fewer new homes were added last year than the year before. To pick up the pace, England needs a nationwide zoning system, in which it is harder to veto development, and looser quotas for "affordable housing" in private projects, which currently make many of them unprofitable.

改善社会住房状况并不能解决英格兰所有与住房相关的问题。要真正解决问题，国家还需要允许建筑商建造更多的住宅。凯尔·斯塔默爵士实施了一些改革，旨在让英格兰的规划体系不那么迟缓且更具操作性。然而，其他方面的改革，比如更严格的安全标准，却让问题再次复杂化。去年的新住宅建设数量比前一年还要少。为了加快建设进度，英格兰需要建立一个全国性的分区制度，这样就能更有效地限制对开发的干预，同时放宽对私人项目“经济适用房”建设的限制条件——因为目前的政策使得许多私人项目难以盈利。

Mr Burnham has given no sign of entertaining such ideas. On the contrary, he has said that "undue weight" has been placed on planning reform. That's a pity. For too long England has been failed by cuddly-sounding housing policies that are in fact toxic. Social housing is one example; another is the "green belt" restriction around cities, which chokes off housebuilding, even on wasteland.

Our proposal to scrap sub-market rents is the opposite kind of policy. It sounds harsh, but would act like a tonic. ■

伯纳姆先生并未表现出对这类观点的兴趣。相反，他声称规划改革受到了不适当的重视。这真遗憾。长期以来，英格兰一直受到那些看似温馨但实际上有害的住房政策的影响。社会住房政策就是其中一个例子；另一个例子就是城市周围的“绿带”限制措施，这些措施甚至在荒地上也抑制了住宅建设。而我们提出的取消次级市场租金政策的方案，恰恰相反。这听起来可能有些严厉，但实际上会起到积极的作用。

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Sharp as a tack

像剪刀一样锋利

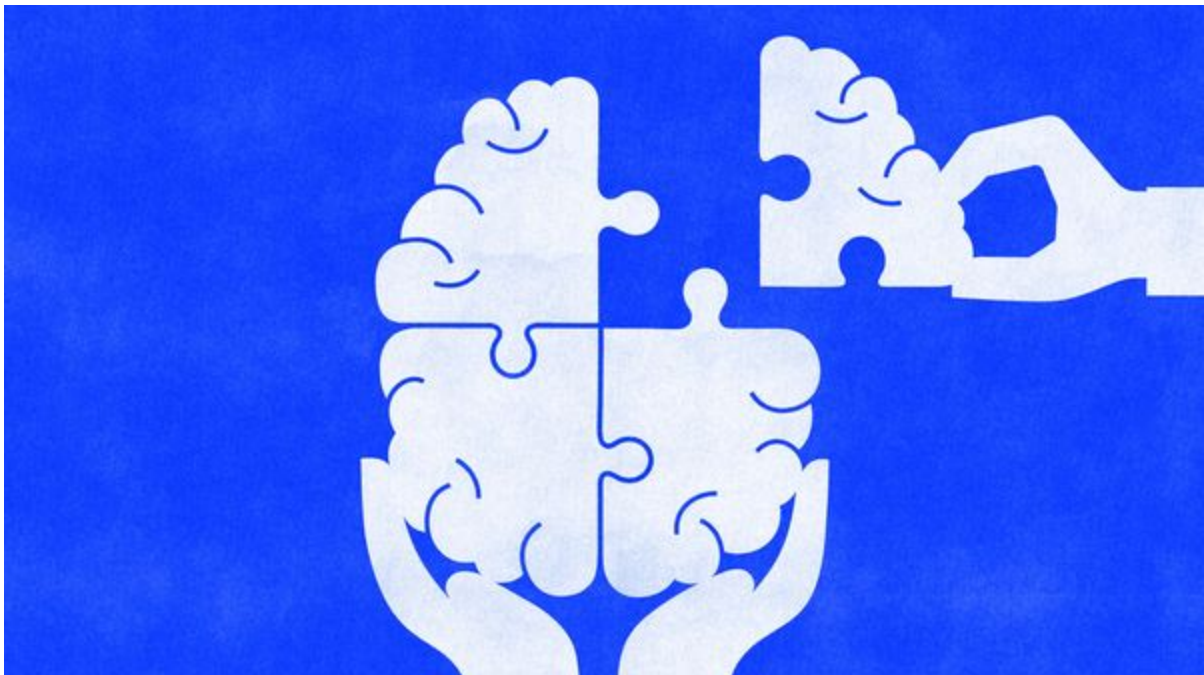
A no-brainer for protecting your brain

保护大脑简直是件再简单不过的事情。

One simple vaccination may dramatically reduce the risk of dementia
简单的疫苗接种或许能够显著降低患痴呆症的风险。

Jul 09, 2026 06:30 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:30



FEW CONDITIONS are as feared as dementia, of which Alzheimer's is the most common cause. This is mostly because of its insidious nature, since it strips people of their sense of self and leaves those who love them caring for a stranger. "Alzheimer's is me unwinding, losing trust in myself, a butt of my own jokes and, on bad days, capable of playing hunt the slipper by myself, and losing," wrote the late Sir Terry Pratchett, a novelist who had a rare form of it. "I felt totally alone, with the world receding from me in every direction."

几乎没有什么病症会像痴呆症那样令人恐惧，而阿尔茨海默病则是最常见的病因。这主要是因为痴呆症的隐蔽性很强，它会逐渐剥夺一个人的自我认知，让那些爱他们的人不得不照顾一个陌生人。“阿尔茨海默病就像是在自我崩溃，对自己失去信心，成为自己笑柄……在病情严重的日子里，甚至可能会独自玩‘寻找鞋垫’的游戏，然后陷入孤独之中。”已故的小说家特里·普拉切特如此描述自己的经历：“我感到自己孤立无援，整个世界都在向我远离。”

It is also dreaded because many believe it is becoming far more common and so will inevitably strike them or those closest to them. Some epidemiologists in the field seem only to fan those fears. Models predict that the number of people suffering from dementia may triple to 153m by 2050 as societies age. In truth, the outlook is cheerier than that, especially in rich countries where, if adjusted for age, the risk of getting dementia has [dropped sharply in recent decades](#). Most models assume these declines will not continue, or will even reverse. A mountain of new evidence shows that need not be.

这也令人担忧，因为许多人认为痴呆症变得越来越常见，因此很可能会影响到他们或他们身边亲近的人。该领域的某些流行病学家似乎只是加剧了这些担忧。模型预测，随着社会人口老龄化，患痴呆症的人数可能增至 1.53 亿。但实际上，前景比这更乐观，尤其是在富裕国家，如果考虑到年龄因素，近几十年来患痴呆症的风险已经显著下降。大多数模型认为这种下降趋势不会持续，甚至可能会逆转。然而，大量的新证据表明，情况并非如此。

Dig deeper

深入探索吧

- [The world is making heady progress in the fight against dementia](#)

[世界在对抗痴呆症方面取得了显著进展。](#)

Recent studies point out the numerous ways in which people are already reducing their risk of dementia. Many are lifestyle changes that you already know you should be making, such as eating healthily, exercising more and keeping your brain active. Others are medical interventions, such as treating hearing loss, depression, high blood pressure and high cholesterol. But getting people to adopt, and then stick to, healthy habits is hard. It does not help that, ideally, you should be working out more and boozing less for many years before your brain will thank you.

最近的研究指出，人们已经采取了多种方法来降低患痴呆症的风险。这些方法包括一些众所周知的生活方式改变，比如健康饮食、增加锻炼、保持大脑活跃等。此外，还有一些医疗干预措施，比如治疗听力损失、抑郁症、高血压和高胆固醇等问题。不过，让人们养成并坚持健康的习惯并不容易。而且，理想情况下，人们还需要在多年内持续进行锻炼并减少饮酒，只有这样，大脑才会感受到这些努力带来的好处。

Yet there is one direct way to improve your chances of staying mentally sharp, and it involves almost no toil, tears or sweat. One of the most exciting scientific findings in recent years is that a course of the shingles vaccine may reduce the risk of dementia by about 20%. For a simple intervention, that is a huge benefit. Exactly why this happens is still being debated. One theory is that the varicella-zoster virus, which causes both shingles and chickenpox, contributes to dementia by causing damage or inflammation to the nervous system even while it is supposedly dormant. Another is that the vaccination gives the immune system a firm kick up its B-cells,

activating it against other bugs that might contribute to dementia.

不过，其实有一种简单的方法可以提升你保持思维敏锐的机会，而且这种方法的操作几乎不需要任何辛苦或付出。近年来最令人兴奋的科学发现之一是：接种带状疱疹疫苗或许可以将患痴呆症的风险降低约 20%。对于如此简单的干预措施来说，这确实是一个巨大的好处。至于为什么会如此，目前仍存在一些争议。有一种理论认为，引起带状疱疹和水痘的带状疱疹病毒，在处于休眠状态时仍可能对神经系统造成损伤或炎症，从而加剧痴呆症的发展。另一种理论认为，接种疫苗能够刺激免疫系统的 B 细胞，使其激活起来，从而对抗那些可能导致痴呆症的病原体。

Too many public-health systems fail to offer the vaccine to more than just a small share of those who would benefit. Several studies have shown that, taking into account only the shingles cases prevented, it would be cost-effective to vaccinate almost everyone from about the age of 55. Yet many countries have rationed the vaccine to keep down the upfront costs. Britain, for instance, lowered the eligibility age from 70 to 65 in 2023, but has since been too slow to vaccinate those who were already in their late 60s. Among the 27 members of the European Union, just 17 recommend the vaccine at all, and several reserve it for the over-65s.

许多公共卫生系统未能为足够多的受益人群提供疫苗。多项研究表明，如果只考虑预防带状疱疹病例的成本效益，那么对大约 55 岁及以上的所有人进行疫苗接种是划算的。然而，许多国家为了降低初期成本，采取了限量分配疫苗的方式。例如，英国在 2023 年将接种资格年龄从 70 岁降低至 65 岁，但之后在为 60 多岁的人群接种疫苗时却显得过于迟缓。在欧盟 27 个成员国中，只有 17 个成员国建议为所有人接种该疫苗，而另有几个成员国则只为 65 岁以上的人群提供疫苗。

That makes little sense when considering only its efficacy against shingles, which afflicts 20-30% of unvaccinated people. It makes even less sense given its potential as a weapon in the fight against

dementia.

仅从其对带状疱疹的疗效来看，这种疗法的效果似乎并不明显。毕竟，有 20-30% 的未接种疫苗的人会患上带状疱疹。而考虑到这种疗法在对抗痴呆症方面的潜力，它的作用就更不显著了。

Most of the evidence of its anti-dementia effect relates to an earlier version of the vaccine, which used a weakened form of the live virus. It has since been largely replaced by a new one, Shingrix, which contains just a sprinkling of proteins from the virus and is seen as safer because it cannot cause an infection. Some studies suggest the new jab may be at least as powerful against dementia as the old one. Even so, it would make sense to run randomised trials to learn which is better, the optimal age for getting it and whether boosters are needed.

关于该疫苗抗痴呆效果的证据大多来自其早期版本，当时使用的疫苗是采用弱化形式的活病毒。后来，这种疫苗被新的疫苗——Shingrix 所取代。新疫苗仅含有少量病毒的蛋白质，因此被认为更安全，因为它不会引发感染。一些研究表明，新疫苗在预防痴呆方面的效果至少与旧疫苗相当。不过，还是有必要进行随机试验，以确定哪种疫苗更有效，最佳的接种年龄是多少，以及是否需要加强针。

In the meantime, health authorities should not wait. A full two-dose course of Shingrix costs Britain's health service £320 (\$430) and federal immunisation programmes in America around \$270: a bargain, given the potential savings in long-term care costs. As for individuals, even the retail cost (around £460 in Britain) is a small price to reduce by one-fifth the chances of having the world recede in every direction. ■

与此同时，卫生当局不应等待。完成两剂 Shingrix 的接种费用对英国卫生系统来说为 320 英镑（430 美元），而在美国的联邦免疫计划中的费用约为 270 美元——考虑到长期护理成本的节省，这确实是一个划算的选择。对于个人来说，即使零售价格约为 460 英镑（在英国），减少五分之一的患病风险也是值得的。■

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Children and the law

儿童与法律

Who is capable of evil? 谁能够做出邪恶的行为呢?

Stop lowering the age of criminal responsibility

不要再降低刑事责任年龄了。

Jul 09, 2026 06:30 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:30



How do you judge whether children are responsible for their actions? The answer often depends on age. Given how slowly human character develops, most countries do not hold the youngest to be criminally responsible, even if they commit heinous acts. In the eyes

of the law the least mature, who cannot grasp the consequences of what they do, are reckoned to be *doli incapax*—incapable of evil.

如何判断一个孩子是否对自己的行为负责呢？这个判断往往取决于孩子的年龄。由于人类的性格发展过程非常缓慢，大多数国家都不会认为年龄最小的孩子有刑事责任，即使他们做出了极其恶劣的行为。在法律上，那些尚未成熟、无法理解自己行为的后果的人，被认定为“*doli incapax*”——即不具备犯下恶行的能力。

Yet that raises a second question: how old is old enough to count? Countries answer this in wildly different ways, as they wrestle with the task of defining the age of criminal responsibility. Now, regrettably, [lawmakers in many places are pushing it downwards](#). In February Argentina lowered its age from 16 to 14. Others, from the Maldives to South Korea, may do something similar. Gangs have been a scourge in Sweden for many years. It now plans to reduce the age of responsibility for the most serious crimes. Last month Northern Ireland blocked a motion that would have raised the age from just ten—the joint-lowest in Europe—to 14.

不过，这又引出了第二个问题：到底多少岁才算成年呢？各国对这个问题的处理方式大相径庭，因为他们都在努力界定刑事责任的年龄。遗憾的是，许多地方的立法者正在将这一年龄标准降低。例如，阿根廷在二月将年龄下限从 16 岁降至 14 岁。马尔代夫和韩国等其他国家也可能采取类似的措施。多年来，帮派一直是瑞典的祸害。现在，瑞典计划降低严重犯罪的刑事责任年龄。上个月，北爱尔兰否决了一项法案，该法案原本旨在将年龄下限从 10 岁（欧洲最低年龄）提高到 14 岁。

Dig deeper

深入探索吧

- [Child suspects are being prosecuted at younger ages:](#)
[那些年幼的犯罪嫌疑人正在被起诉。](#)

Politicians are listening to voters angry about dramatic and well-publicised crimes—and you can understand why. Indonesians were horrified when a 12-year-old stabbed her mother 26 times, killing her. In Colombia a 15-year-old boy last year shot and killed a senator campaigning to be president. In Sweden and elsewhere, gangs use children to attack properties or people.

政客们正在倾听那些对那些令人发指、广受关注的犯罪行为感到愤怒的选民的声音——而人们也能理解为什么会这样。当一名 12 岁的女孩刺伤了她的母亲 26 刀，导致她死亡时，印尼民众感到震惊。去年在哥伦比亚，一名 15 岁的男孩枪杀了一位试图竞选总统的参议员。在瑞典和其他国家，犯罪团伙利用儿童来袭击房屋或伤害他人。

Criminals like to recruit young foot soldiers because they are cheap and pliable. They often lack the impulse-control and judgment that most adults possess. Neuroscientists suggest that the brain keeps developing well into adulthood, perhaps even into the mid-20s, which may be why so much crime is committed by the young. Teens are often enticed into gangs by the promise of quick money. Criminals also calculate that the youngest may dodge punishment if caught. In Britain drug-dealers use children precisely because they are under-age.

罪犯喜欢招募年轻的步兵作为手下，因为年轻人既便宜又容易操控。他们通常缺乏大多数成年人所拥有的冲动控制能力和判断力。神经科学家指出，大脑的发育过程一直持续到成年后期，甚至到 25 岁左右仍在继续发展，这或许就是为什么那么多犯罪行为是由年轻人实施的。青少年往往因为能快速赚钱而加入犯罪团伙。罪犯还考虑到，年龄最小的受害者在被抓获后可能能够逃避惩罚。在英国，毒贩专门利用儿童作为帮手，因为孩子们年龄较小，不容易受到惩罚。

You can see, therefore, why lawmakers want to criminalise the acts of ever younger people. Authorities may hope that doing so will remove an incentive for gangs to recruit them. They should reconsider, if only because lowering the age of responsibility is unjust—especially if that involves children younger than the low

teens.

因此，我们可以理解为什么立法者希望将这种行为定为犯罪。当局可能认为，这样做可以消除帮派招募年轻人的动机。不过，他们应该重新考虑一下——毕竟，降低刑事责任年龄是不公平的，尤其是当被招募的年轻人还不到十几岁的时候。

Even if you disagree with the moral argument, you should heed the practical one. Experience suggests that lowering the age will not work. When Denmark took it from 15 to 14 in 2010, crime rates rose. The country reversed course soon after. Britain found that, when the age of responsibility drops, gangs just recruit even younger children.

即使你不同意这种道德上的论点，也应该考虑一下实际效果。经验表明，降低年龄限制并没有什么用。2010 年丹麦将这一年龄限制从 15 岁降至 14 岁后，犯罪率反而上升了。该国家很快又恢复了原来的政策。而英国发现，当责任年龄降低时，犯罪团伙往往会招募更年幼的孩子加入。

Prosecuting young children as criminals is also a way of ensuring that ever more of them will emerge from the system as hardened villains. In Queensland, Australia, where ten-year-olds are counted as criminally responsible, 96% of children who are released from prison go on to reoffend within a year.

将年幼的儿童视为罪犯是一种确保他们越来越多地成为社会中的恶棍的方式。在澳大利亚的昆士兰州，那些被认定为有犯罪责任的人从十岁开始就被视为罪犯。在那里，有 96% 从监狱释放出来的儿童在一年内会再次犯罪。

It is wiser to try rehabilitation. That will often mean securing young wrongdoers safely away from wider society. But rather than punishing them, the goal should be to tackle the social, educational and other factors that first drew them into criminality. One focus should be on those brains. In Britain a fifth of children in the youth-justice system have learning difficulties. Another should be to deal

with social problems early by, say, providing mentors. In Sweden around half of all kids who are investigated for a serious crime were flagged to social services for worrying behaviour before the age of 12.

尝试进行改造教育更为明智。这通常意味着要将那些年少犯错的年轻人安全地隔离起来，远离社会的影响。但我们的目标不是惩罚他们，而是解决那些导致他们走上犯罪道路的社会、教育及其他因素。其中一个重点就是针对那些有犯罪倾向的年轻人。在英国，青少年司法系统中，有五分之一的儿童存在学习障碍。另一个办法是及早解决社会问题，比如提供导师来帮助这些孩子。在瑞典，大约一半因严重犯罪而被调查的儿童在 12 岁之前就被通知需要接受社会服务的帮助，因为他们表现出令人担忧的行为。

Nothing will stop all wrongdoing by children. There should be severe criminal penalties for adults who recruit and exploit the young. But the goal for children should be to create better childhoods, with fewer reasons to go into crime, and to prevent criminal children from becoming criminal adults. ■

没有任何东西能够阻止孩子们做出违法行为。对于那些招募并利用年轻人的成年人来说，应该施加严厉的刑事处罚。但是，对于孩子们来说，我们的目标是创造更美好的童年时光，让他们有更少的理由走上犯罪道路。同时，也要防止那些有犯罪倾向的孩子们成长为真正的罪犯。■

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Calculating war casualties

计算战争伤亡人数

You reported on [why big artificial-intelligence labs are hiring so many philosophers](#) and noted its impact on the ethics of war (“Computo, ergo sum”, June 27th). Philosophers excel at formulating questions, but they have no agreed answers to how military objectives should be weighed against civilian deaths. For example, if a military objective of killing a wartime leader in a foreign country can be achieved only at the expense of the deaths of innocent civilians, what is the maximum number of such deaths that is acceptable? This number, known as the non-combatant casualty cut-off value

(NCV), is often specified by military authorities but has varied widely (for example, between 0 and 30) across campaigns and over time. Its variability betrays the uncertainty of those who set it.

你曾在文章中探讨了大规模的人工智能实验室为何要雇佣如此多的哲学家，并分析了这一行为对战争伦理的影响（“计算即我”，6月27日）。哲学家擅长提出问题，但他们对于如何权衡军事目标与平民死亡之间的利害关系并没有达成一致意见。例如，如果某个军事目标——比如杀死一个外国国家的战争领袖——必须以无辜平民的死亡为代价来实现，那么允许的最大死亡人数是多少呢？这个数值被称为“非战斗人员伤亡上限值”，通常由军事当局规定，但不同战役和时期之间这一数值存在很大差异（例如，可能在0到30之间）。这种差异性反映了制定这一标准的人的不确定性。

There is no “correct” NCV for human judges or for AI systems. If we knew how many future deaths a wartime leader would be responsible for the problem would resolve itself into the well-known trolley dilemma. But we don’t know that. And even if we did, there is no universally acceptable solution to that dilemma.

对于人类裁判或人工智能系统来说，并不存在“正确”的 NCV 方案。如果我们知道战时领导人会导致多少人死亡，那么这个问题就相当于一个众所周知的两难选择。但实际上我们并不清楚这一点。即便我们知道了，也找不到一个普遍适用的解决方案来应对这种两难局面。

NIGEL HARVEY

尼杰尔·哈维

Professor of judgment and decision research

判断与决策研究教授

University College London

伦敦大学学院

Turning on a dime

突然转向

“Cancelled penalty” (June 27th) was [correct in its central contention about America’s waiver of sanctions on Iranian oil](#). It is a huge concession. But what looks significant on paper—an apparent aberration against more than 40 years of sanctions pressure—is decidedly less so in reality. The twin pressures of European and British sanctions will hold back any potential flood of Western buyers. Instead, the waiver will chiefly facilitate Iranian state actors’ exports to pre-existing trading partners.

“取消制裁”这一决定（6月27日）在关于美国放弃对伊朗石油制裁的论点上是正确的。这确实是一个重大的让步。不过，从纸面上看，这一决定似乎很有意义——毕竟它打破了过去40年来对伊朗的制裁压力。但实际上，这种改变并没有那么重要。欧洲和英国的制裁压力将会阻碍西方买家的大量涌入。因此，这项决定实际上只是让伊朗的国有企业能够继续向现有的贸易伙伴出口石油而已。

Then there is the prospect of the Strait of Hormuz being closed again with comparative ease, which still lingers over the global economy. All the while, it is entirely possible that Iran continues to build up its nuclear capability.

此外，霍尔穆特海峡可能再次被关闭的问题仍然困扰着全球经济。与此同时，伊朗仍有可能继续发展其核能力。

What could mark a break is if alternative trading routes that bypass the strait were to be established, which could check Iranian leverage. The big question here is not only how quickly this can be achieved, but whether the attendant legal and political agreements can be reached. For all the talk of waivers and sanctions, this is the dime on which the global economy might turn in the future.

或许能够带来转折点的是，如果建立一些绕过该海峡的替代贸易路线，这样就能限制伊朗的影响力。这里的关键问题不仅仅是能否迅速

实现这一目标，还有是否能够达成相关的法律和政治协议。尽管人们谈论着豁免和制裁的问题，但这一因素确实可能是未来全球经济能否顺利运转的关键所在。

JAMES WILLN

詹姆斯·威尔恩

Reed Smith

里德·史密斯

Dubai

迪拜

[The Iran war is indeed the third shock in a decade to hit Africa after covid-19 and Russia's invasion of Ukraine](#) ("Third time unlucky", June 20th). But the deeper problem is that many African economies still lack quick, affordable financing when such shocks arrive.

伊朗战争确实是在新冠疫情和俄罗斯入侵乌克兰之后，非洲面临的第三个冲击事件（类似于“第三次倒霉”，6月20日）。但更深层次的问题是，许多非洲国家在遭遇此类冲击时，仍然缺乏快速且负担得起的融资支持。

Kenya illustrates this. Reserves are being rapidly eroded and fuel protests have turned deadly, yet the government's main recourse is slow; a fresh \$600m loan from the World Bank now and probably an IMF facility later. Full IMF arrangements typically involve months of negotiation over conditions. That is time a country in a live currency crisis can least afford. Kenya is far from alone in this bind. Egypt, Ethiopia, Mozambique and Rwanda also face the same choice between burning through reserves and waiting on a negotiated rescue.

肯尼亚就是一个典型的例子。国家的储备正在迅速减少，而燃料相关的抗议活动也变得十分危险。然而，政府的主要应对方式却非常缓慢

——目前，世界银行已经提供了 6 亿美元的贷款，或许之后还会得到国际货币基金组织的援助。不过，国际货币基金组织的救助方案通常需要数月的时间来协商各种条件。这对于一个正处于货币危机中的国家来说，实在是不可承受的时间成本。肯尼亚并非唯一一个面临这种困境的国家。埃及、埃塞俄比亚、莫桑比克和卢旺达也都面临着同样的抉择：要么消耗掉储备金，要么等待国际货币基金组织提供的救助。

The architecture for faster support already exists and has worked for Africa before. In September 2022 the IMF opened a temporary food-shock window, which let countries hit by the Ukraine war's effect on grain and fertiliser prices borrow on top of normal limits, with minimal conditionality and no lengthy programme required. By the time it closed in mid-2023 it had disbursed \$1.8bn across six countries, including Burkina Faso, Guinea, Malawi and South Sudan.

实现更快援助支持的机制早已存在，并且之前也曾在非洲实施过。2022 年 9 月，国际货币基金组织开启了一个临时性的粮食危机融资窗口，这使得受乌克兰战争影响而面临粮食和化肥价格上涨问题的国家能够在正常限制条件下获得贷款，且无需经过繁琐的程序。到 2023 年中期该窗口关闭时，已有 6 个国家获得了 18 亿美元的贷款支持，包括布基纳法索、几内亚、马拉维和南苏丹等国家。

That window should be reopened and adapted into an oil-shock window for net energy importers exposed to the shocks from the Iran war, with comparable access limits and the same rapid disbursement. Although this would not solve Africa's underlying debt burden, it would recognise that liquidity, not just solvency, determines whether a price shock becomes a currency crisis.

那个窗口应该重新打开，并调整为适用于那些因伊朗战争而遭受冲击的能源进口国的机制。同时，应设定类似的资金限制，并实行同样的快速分配机制。虽然这样做并不能解决非洲的债务问题，但至少能认识到，是流动性而非偿付能力决定了价格冲击是否会演变成货币危机。

FAITH NYABUTO

Cambridge

剑桥

Diverging universities

分歧的大学

[Your leader on falling academic standards](#) (“Don’t dumb down”, June 27th) rightly noted that pushing young people up the educational ladder without the skills to match helps no one and is, at its core, cowardly. Yet the challenge of cheating posed by AI may carry its own corrective.

你在关于降低学术标准的问题上的发言（“不要降低标准”，6月27日）指出，如果让年轻人攀登教育阶梯，却无法让他们掌握相应的技能，那么这样做对任何人都没有好处，而且本质上是一种懦弱的行为。不过，人工智能带来的作弊问题或许可以作为一种纠正手段。

By collapsing the cost of fabricated coursework, generative AI confronts every university with a blunt choice: pay for much costlier enforcement, or in effect abandon the pretence of academic integrity. Institutions with thin defences and less academic intakes will rationally give up, lowering fees and operating openly as credential mills. Those with serious invigilation and abler students will instead double down, as Harvard did recently by capping the number of A grades handed out in each course to roughly 20% of enrolled students (the policy comes into effect next year). Colleges of this type will still charge a premium for a degree that still certifies genuine learning. This would result in what economists call a separating equilibrium, the market sorting what administrators cannot.

通过降低伪造课程的成本，生成式 AI 让每所大学面临一个艰难的选择：是支付更高的费用来维护学术诚信，还是放弃这种伪装的学术诚

信。那些防御薄弱、招生人数较少的院校会理性地选择放弃学术诚信，从而降低费用，以低成本的方式运营文凭制造厂。而那些有严格监考制度且学生素质较高的院校则会坚持学术诚信，就像哈佛大学最近所做的那样，将每门课程可授予的 A 等级成绩比例限制在约 20% 以内（该政策将于明年实施）。这类院校仍然会收取较高的费用，以获得能够证明真正学习成果的学位。这将导致经济学家所说的“分离均衡”状态——市场能够解决那些管理者无法解决的问题。

This need not be lamented. For the many jobs that reward reliability and persistence above any particular syllabus, a degree was always mostly a signal. An honest credential may serve its holder better, and far more cheaply, than one that pretends otherwise.

这并不值得惋惜。对于那些重视可靠性和坚持精神而非特定学科知识的职业来说，学位始终是一种重要的标志。一份真实的证书能够比那些假装重视其他方面的证书，更好地服务于持有者，而且成本也更低。

PETER DONAHUE

彼得·多纳休

Houston

休斯顿

Degree standards are experiencing astonishing grade inflation. About 30% of students now achieve a first-class degree in Britain. In the 1960s, usually only one or two students would achieve this elusive prize, and sometimes none at all.

学位标准正经历着惊人的等级膨胀现象。在英国，现在大约有 30% 的学生能够获得一等学位。而在 1960 年代，通常只有一两个学生能够获得这一殊荣，有时甚至根本没有人能够做到这一点。

Policymakers should indeed “widen the ways in which people can continue learning after they leave school”. As adult education is a

permissive rather than statutory level of education the starving of local government funding has caused the shredding of the once valuable network of adult centres with their attractive courses across so many subjects. Now the only service in many areas is the excellent University of the Third Age, which utilises voluntary pro bono teachers (such as myself) in classes available at a small subscription fee. One hopes that in this latter area at least the u3a model can be used as a cost-effective provision in what is at present a wilderness.

政策制定者确实应该“拓宽人们在校外继续学习的途径”。由于成人教育属于非强制性的教育形式，而当地政府的资金短缺导致了曾经宝贵的成人教育中心的瓦解，这些中心曾经提供涵盖众多科目的优质课程。现在，在许多地区，唯一可用的服务就是第三时代大学所提供的优质教育服务。这些学校依靠志愿者教师（比如我这样的人）来授课，学生只需支付少量的费用即可享受课程。希望至少在这个领域，第三时代大学的模式能够作为一种经济有效的教育方式，在当前这个混乱的局面中发挥作用。

BILL JONES

比尔·琼斯

Director of extra-mural studies at Manchester University, 1986-93
1986 年至 1993 年，担任曼彻斯特大学校外研究项目的负责人

Beverley, East Yorkshire

贝弗利，东约克郡



The highs and lows

起伏跌宕的人生

[Tall men earn more, date more and are generally happier all round](#), you say (Graphic Detail, June 19th). As a six-foot, four-inch male I would like to point out that it's not all a bed of roses. The world is designed by short people for short people. Your privileged tall man is crushed into small aircraft seats and bangs his head on low doorways. Hotel beds are often too short. There have been times in my life when I have had to order shoes from abroad. And then there's clothing and pants that finish at mid-calf. There seems to be a convention in clothing stores that all large and extra-large sizes are placed on the bottom shelves, requiring tall men to get on hands and knees to retrieve an article.

你们说，高个子男性赚得更多，约会的机会也更多，整体来说生活更幸福吧？（《细节分析》，6月19日）作为一个身高六英尺四英寸的男性，我想指出并非一切都是如此美好的。这个世界是为矮小的人设计的。那些特权高的男性不得不坐在狭窄的飞机座椅上，他们的头部还会撞到低矮的门口。酒店的床往往又太短了。在我的生活中，有

时我不得不从国外订购鞋子。此外，还有些衣服和裤子只到胯部处。在服装店里，似乎有一种惯例：所有大尺码和特大尺码的衣服都放在最下面的货架层，这就需要高个子男性不得不弯腰或跪着才能取到衣服。

So it does seem an act of celestial justice that we score better with the ladies.

看来，我们能够获得女性的青睐，真是天赐的恩惠啊。

BILL CLARKE

比尔·克拉克

Madrid

马德里

A reliable source

可靠的消息来源

Spot-on as your June 27th [obituary of Alan Greenspan](#) was, it might have added a detail pertinent to *The Economist*. Economics coverage in the paper in the 1960s relied heavily on a single resident genius, Norman Macrae. Clandestine extra input to both Macrae and coverage of the United States was supplied by Alan Greenspan. Each week a junior in the Washington office would make two telephone calls to New York: one was to Henry Kaufman, chief economist at Salomon Brothers; the second was to Greenspan, then main partner of Townsend Greenspan.

正如你在 6 月 27 日发布的关于艾伦·格林斯潘的讣告中所写的那样，或许可以补充一些与《经济学人》相关的细节。在 20 世纪 60 年代，《经济学人》的财经报道很大程度上依赖于一位杰出的专家——诺曼·麦克拉尼。而艾伦·格林斯潘则秘密地为麦克拉尼以及美国的报道提供了额外的信息支持。每周，华盛顿办公室的一名年轻员工都会向纽约

方面打两次电话：一次是给索罗门兄弟银行的经济学家亨利·考夫曼；另一次则是给当时与汤森·格林斯潘合作的重要人物格林斯潘。

His dry wit, analysis and parsing of often obscure labour and stock level statistics much deepened *The Economist's* columns at the time.

他敏锐的洞察力、分析能力以及对那些往往晦涩难懂的劳动力统计数据解读，极大地提升了《经济学人》杂志的专栏影响力。

ANDREW KNIGHT

安德鲁·奈特

Editor of *The Economist*, 1974-86

《经济学人》杂志编辑，1974 年至 1986 年任职期间

Shipston-on-Stour, Warwickshire

斯普斯顿-昂-斯特尔，沃里克郡

Much derided, much loved

备受嘲笑，却深受喜爱

["Warrington is not a glamorous place"](#), as you acknowledge in your article on the economic miracle of this town in northern England ("Meet the Warrington model", June 27th). You mention the Royal Society of Arts ranking the town last out of 325 places for cultural amenities (yes, even behind Luton).

“沃灵顿并不是一个充满魅力的地方，”你在关于英格兰北部这个小镇经济奇迹的文章中如此指出（“了解沃灵顿模式”，6 月 27 日）。你提到英国皇家艺术学会将沃灵顿在 325 个城镇中排在最后，尤其是在文化设施方面。是的，它甚至排在卢顿之后。

As Eric Turner, a local artist who's been called Warrington's secret Lowry, would have said, "Rubbish...have they ever been to Widnes?"

正如当地艺术家埃里克·特纳所说，他被誉为沃灵顿的“秘密洛瑞”，他可能会说：“真是垃圾.....他们到底去过威德恩斯吗？”

NICK RIGBY

尼克·里格比

Cambridge

剑桥

Does anyone remember the contest from some years back? First prize: one week in Warrington. Second prize: two weeks in Warrington.

还有人记得几年前那次比赛吗？一等奖：在沃灵顿度过一周时间。二等奖：在沃灵顿度过两周时间。

HENRY MA

亨利·马

Manila

马尼拉

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By Invitation

经邀请而来

- [**Prepare for a world of ad hoc coalitions**](#)

[**准备好迎接由临时联盟组成的世界吧。**](#)

Variable-geometry lesson :: Neither wishful multilateralism nor cold realpolitik will do. Mark Carney and Alexander Stubb suggest a third way

可变几何结构方案 :: 无论是理想化的多边主义，还是冷酷的现实主义政策，都无法解决问题。马克·卡尼和亚历山大·斯塔布提出了第三种解决方案。

- [**Medicine can treat obesity, but can't agree on what obesity is**](#)

[**医学可以治疗肥胖问题，但对于什么是肥胖却存在不同的看法。**](#)

Cure before diagnosis :: Labelling it a disease means millions will get treatment they may not need, writes Francesco Rubino

在确诊之前就进行治疗吧：将疾病贴上标签意味着数百万人会接受他们可能不需要的治疗，弗朗切斯科·鲁比诺写道。

Variable-geometry lesson

变截面几何课程

Prepare for a world of ad hoc coalitions

准备好迎接由临时组成的联盟所构成的世界吧。

Neither wishful multilateralism nor cold realpolitik will do. Mark Carney and Alexander Stubb suggest a third way

无论是怀揣美好愿景的多边主义，还是冷酷的现实主义政策，都无法解决问题。马克·卡尼和亚历山大·斯塔布提出了第三种解决方案。

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2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:22



WE LEAD TWO countries that do not have the luxury of relying on old orders of geography. Finland [shares a border](#) with a Russia that is waging a war of aggression against [Ukraine](#) and actively interfering in other societies instead of reforming its own. Canada shares the world's longest land border with a United States that is [reassessing](#) its priorities and transforming all its commercial relationships.

我们领导着两个国家，这两个国家没有机会依赖传统的地理格局。芬兰与俄罗斯接壤，而俄罗斯正在对乌克兰发动侵略战争，还积极干涉其他国家的事务，而不是努力改革自己的国家。加拿大则与美国拥有世界上最长的陆地边界，美国正在重新评估自己的优先事项，并正在改变与其所有商业关系。

At the same time, we are striking closer relations with powers like India and, while avoiding strategic dependencies, China, as well as with countries of the Global South, because power no longer exclusively sits at a single Western centre. Power is spread across three groupings: a Global West, a Global East and a Global South, each increasingly autonomous. Truly global trends, including power over compute, data and artificial-intelligence models, are spawning a fourth, technology-driven grouping, shaping how we live, work and

connect—unconstrained by borders and accountable to few rules.

与此同时，我们正在与像印度这样的强国建立更紧密的关系，同时避免形成战略上的依赖关系。此外，中国也与全球南方国家建立了联系，因为权力不再仅仅集中在单一的西方中心。权力现在分散到了三个集团：全球西方、全球东方和全球南方，每个集团都越来越具有自主性。真正的全球性趋势，包括在计算能力、数据和人工智能模型方面的权力，正在催生第四个由技术驱动集团，这个集团决定了我们的生活方式、工作方式以及联系方式——不再受边界限制，也无需遵循少数规则来约束。

The world order built after 1945 is [unravelling](#). Institutions as they stand are ill-prepared to avert this decline. This is a moment that comes once in a century, in which our collective prosperity is defined by what we choose to build, and how we build it.

1945 年之后建立的世界秩序正在瓦解。现有的制度显然无法有效应对这种衰退趋势。这是一个百年一遇的时刻——我们的集体繁荣取决于我们如何选择建设未来，以及我们如何实现这一目标。

The work ahead requires neither wishful multilateralism, which only defends the status quo, nor cold realpolitik that dismantles it altogether. The alternative is values-based realism. A new approach that is both principled and pragmatic. Principled in its commitment to fundamental values of freedom, human rights, sustainability and solidarity. Pragmatic in recognising that not every partner will share all of our values. Put simply, we must form calibrated alliances, integrating deeply with those countries that share our values, and remain open-eyed with those that do not.

未来的工作不需要那种只维护现状的幻想性多边主义，也不需要那种彻底破坏现状的冷酷现实主义。我们需要的是基于价值观的现实主义——一种既遵循原则又具有实用性的新方法。在原则方面，我们要坚持自由、人权、可持续性和团结等基本价值观；在实用性方面，我们要认识到并非每个合作伙伴都会认同我们的所有价值观。简而言之，

我们必须建立合理的联盟关系，与那些持有相同价值观的国家紧密合作，同时对那些持有不同价值观的国家保持清醒的认识。

At its core, this means actively taking on the world as it is, not passively waiting for a world we wish to be. It means engaging with the reality that progress is incremental and that interests diverge. It requires recognising the inevitable differences between our countries and others, and then focusing our efforts to work together where we are aligned and where we can make the greatest impact. Progress can be signalled through monologue, but it will be achieved only through dialogue.

从根本上说，这意味着要主动面对现实世界，而不是被动地等待一个我们渴望拥有的理想世界。这意味着要接受这样一个事实：进步是渐进的，人们的利益也会不断分化。这需要认识到各国之间不可避免地存在差异，然后集中精力在那些我们能够达成共识、并能产生最大影响力的领域进行合作。进步的迹象可以通过独白来感知，但实际上，真正的进步只有通过对话才能实现。

Another reality is that the world is moving from a more multilateral stance to a more multipolar one. Multilateral order, despite its shortcomings, is governed by co-operation and a clear set of rules and norms. A multipolar world, conversely, is one characterised by deals, transactions and chaos. Yet instead of a binary choice between multilateral and multipolar, there is another scenario, one that revolves around plurilateralism. We must strive for a revival of multilateralism with better representation and reformed institutions. At the same time, we should develop plurilateral arrangements.

另一个现实是，世界正从更加多边主义的格局转向更加多极化的格局。尽管多边主义存在缺陷，但它仍然依靠合作以及明确的规则和准则来运作。而多极世界则是一个由各种协议、交易和混乱所构成的格局。不过，与其在多边主义和多极主义之间做出二元选择，我们更应该追求一种以多边主义为基础的格局。我们必须努力恢复多边主义，同时完善相关机构，使其更具代表性。与此同时，我们也应该发展多边的合作安排。

This approach, a form of variable geometry, will build a dense web of connections—ad hoc coalitions that work, issue by issue. In many cases it will be most effective when dealing with countries with which we disagree on many issues but share enough common ground to act on some. Dynamic, purpose-built coalitions will be increasingly formed around shared interests, rather than a single shared institution. The coalition of the willing now planning Ukraine's post-war security has become a premier forum for like-minded nations and NATO to co-ordinate efforts. The European Union's instruments, including the SAFE pact, enable partners to cut through bureaucracy and to build and partner on defence capabilities, at speed. The G7's critical-minerals alliance is securing and diversifying the supply chains on which every modern economy depends. In AI we could build coalitions to enhance safety and accessibility by leveraging our expertise and capabilities in critical areas such as quantum computing and energy. The question is no longer whether to partner, but how fast we can build successful coalitions that scale across every region.

这种策略属于可变几何结构的一种形式，它能够构建出一个紧密的合作关系网络——由各个联盟组成，这些联盟可以针对具体问题进行协作。在许多情况下，这种策略在处理那些我们在许多问题上存在分歧但又有足够共同点的国家时最为有效。动态的、基于共同目标的联盟将越来越多地围绕共同利益而建立，而非基于单一的共同机构。现在，那些愿意参与乌克兰战后安全事务的国家们已经形成了一个重要的论坛，让志同道合的国家和北约能够协调各自的行动。欧盟的各类机制，包括 SAFE 协议，使得各合作伙伴能够迅速克服官僚主义障碍，并共同构建防御能力。G7 的关键矿产联盟则确保了每个现代经济都离不开的稳定和多样化的供应链。在人工智能领域，我们可以借助各自的专长来构建联盟，从而提升安全性和可用性。在量子计算、能源等关键领域的能力。问题不再在于是否要合作，而在于我们能否迅速建立起能够在各个地区都取得成功的联盟。

The answer to shifting orders of geography, trade and commerce—and the anxieties which they understandably cause for citizens—is

not to mourn the world that was; it is to build for the world as it is. To build with code, concrete and steel; with institutions that work and strong alliances that protect them. To deepen our countries' partnerships with as much of the world as we can, clear-eyed and with confidence.

应对地理、贸易和商业格局的变化所带来的挑战，以及这些变化给公民带来的种种困扰，并不是要哀悼过去的世界；而是要为现实的世界而建设。用代码、混凝土和钢铁来建造我们的城市；建立能够运作的体制，以及能保护我们的强大联盟。我们要以清醒而自信的态度，与尽可能多的国家建立紧密的合作关系。

Middle powers of the world, unite!

世界上的中等强国们，团结起来吧！

In this effort Canada and Finland can be pivotal, because we are among the most connected economies on Earth through our enviable trade access; powerful, in our capabilities as nations increasing our defence spending to record levels; and purposeful, in our shared commitment to territorial integrity, human rights and pluralism. In a rapidly changing world, we have the grit and the *sisu* to chart the path ahead—and we know that so have many others whom we invite to join us on this quest.■

在这一进程中，加拿大和芬兰可以发挥关键作用。因为我们拥有全球最发达的贸易网络之一；作为国家，我们在军事能力方面也处于领先地位，正在将国防开支提升到历史新高；同时，我们秉持着对领土完整、人权和多元文化的坚定承诺。在这个瞬息万变的世界里，我们有足够的勇气和决心来引领前进的方向——我们也知道，许多其他国家同样有这种决心，我们邀请他们加入我们的行列，共同追求这一目标。

Mark Carney is the prime minister of Canada. Alexander Stubb is the president of Finland.

马克·卡尼是加拿大的总理。亚历山大·斯塔布是芬兰的总统。

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Cure before diagnosis

在确诊前进行治疗

Medicine can treat obesity, but can't agree on what obesity is

医学可以治疗肥胖问题，但对于什么是肥胖却存在不同的看法。

Labelling it a disease means millions will get treatment they may not need, writes Francesco Rubino

将这种病症称为“疾病”，意味着数百万人会接受他们可能不需要的治疗，弗朗切斯科·鲁比诺写道。

Jul 09, 2026 05:23 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:23



IN THE SPACE of less than a decade, medicine acquired a means of doing what millennia of diets and exhortation could not. A new class of drugs, GLP-1 receptor agonists, can strip a fifth or more from a patient's body weight. This week Britain became the second large market, after America, to make one such treatment, Novo Nordisk's Wegovy, available in tablet form as an alternative to injecting it.

在不到十年的时间里，医学取得了前所未有的成就，超越了数千年来各种饮食疗法和劝诫手段所无法达到的效果。一类新的药物——GLP-1受体激动剂，能够帮助患者减轻五分之一甚至更多的体重。本周，英国成为第二个允许以片剂形式提供这种疗法的国家，这种疗法由诺和诺德公司研发，名为 W Govy。与注射疗法相比，这种片剂形式为患者提供了另一种选择。

This pharmacological leap builds on the proven safety and durability of metabolic surgery, expanding a therapeutic arsenal that can now reach millions. And yet, as it deploys these extraordinary tools, medicine cannot answer a more fundamental question: what, exactly, is it treating? Astonishingly, obesity still lacks a universally

accepted clinical definition.

这种药物疗法建立在代谢手术已被证明的安全性和持久性基础上，从而扩展了能够惠及数百万人的治疗手段。然而，在运用这些卓越的治疗方法时，医学界仍无法解决一个更为根本的问题：究竟是在治疗什么？令人惊讶的是，目前还没有一个被普遍认可的肥胖症临床定义。

A growing view is that obesity should be defined as a chronic, progressive, relapsing disease. But not all of the one billion people living with obesity are ill, and distinguishing those who are sick because of obesity from those who are not is precisely what medicine's definitions and diagnoses are meant to do.

越来越多的人认为，肥胖应该被定义为一种慢性、进行性、反复发作的疾病。不过，并非所有患有肥胖问题的人都会生病，区分那些因肥胖而患病的人与那些没有患病的人，正是医学领域定义和诊断的目的所在。

Medicine leans on body-mass index (BMI), a number that reflects little beyond body size and population-level risk, while saying nothing about whether the patient is actually ill. Without a clinically meaningful definition, therapies cannot be deployed rationally. Doses, durations and intensities cannot be matched to need; financial cost cannot be matched to medical benefit. Health systems already straining under demand are being asked to fund treatment for up to a third of all adults in some countries, with no reliable basis for deciding who truly requires it, and at what cost.

医学界依赖体重指数来衡量患者的健康状况，但这个指标仅反映了体型与人群中的风险因素，却无法说明患者是否真的生病了。由于缺乏科学的定义，就无法合理地制定治疗方案。剂量、疗程和强度都无法根据患者的实际需求来设定；医疗费用与医疗效益之间也缺乏合理的匹配。在一些国家，医疗系统已经因需求压力而不堪重负，yet 这些系统仍被要求为多达三分之一的成年人提供治疗，而决定谁真正需要治疗以及以何种代价提供治疗，却没有任何可靠的依据。

The roots of the muddle lie in the fact that obesity has never yielded a clean clinical identity, like diabetes or cancer. That is because at the bedside it has never behaved as a single thing. Even Hippocrates viewed it as a spectrum—a warning of future illness in some, an active malady in others. Because obesity lacked a consistent pattern, for most of medical history doctors sensibly declined to characterise it as a uniform condition.

这种混乱的根源在于：肥胖从未像糖尿病或癌症那样，能够形成一个明确的临床定义。因为在临床实践中，肥胖从来都不是一种单一的疾病。甚至希波克拉也将其视为一个连续谱——对一些人来说，肥胖只是未来疾病的预兆；而对另一些人来说，则是一种严重的疾病。由于肥胖缺乏一致性的特征，所以在医学史上，医生们普遍不愿意将肥胖视为一种统一的疾病。

That intuition was discarded in the 20th century—and, tellingly, not by doctors. Armed with actuarial tables linking weight to early death, the life-insurance industry recast all obesity as a risk state. BMI, a 19th-century measure of people's average size never meant for clinical use, was pressed into service to quantify that risk, and became the very definition of the condition.

这种直觉在 20 世纪被摒弃了——值得注意的是，摒弃这种直觉的并非医生。那些利用与体重相关的统计表格来将肥胖视为一种风险状态的人寿保险行业，把肥胖重新定义为一种风险状态。而 BMI 这一 19 世纪用来衡量人们平均体型的指标，原本并不适用于临床用途，但后来被用作量化这种风险的方法，从而成为了肥胖这一状况的官方定义。

Obesity came to be defined not by its direct toll—starving the lungs, straining the heart, wearing the joints—but by the other diseases it keeps company with. Yet in medicine a disease is defined by the damage it actually causes, not its statistical associations. This inversion of medical logic has had practical consequences. For decades, people whose excess weight was itself choking their breathing, burdening their hearts or crippling their mobility were refused treatment if they lacked the “right” comorbidity, because

obesity was conceived as a risk, not a disease. No diabetes, no therapy. Active disease went unseen because the diagnostic apparatus could not see it.

肥胖的定义不再以其直接造成的危害来界定——比如损害肺部、加重心脏负担、使关节受损等——而是以它伴随的其他疾病来判定。然而在医学领域，疾病的界定是基于其实际造成的损害，而非统计上的关联。这种医学逻辑的反转带来了实际后果。几十年来，那些因过度肥胖而面临呼吸障碍、心脏负担过重或行动能力受限的人，如果缺乏“必要的”并发症，就不会被治疗。因为肥胖被视为一种风险，而非疾病。没有糖尿病，就没有治疗方法。这种活跃的疾病因为诊断工具无法检测到而一直未被发现。

The current push to call obesity a disease is largely an effort to right this wrong. But the pendulum now threatens to swing to the opposite, equally implausible extreme. Population-level risks of obesity apply unevenly across individuals: many never develop adverse outcomes, even over decades. Declare obesity always a risk, as we did for much of the 20th century, and the genuinely sick are abandoned. Declare it always a disease, as a growing narrative now implies, and millions are marked ill for conditions they do not have and exposed to treatments they may not need.

目前将肥胖称为一种疾病的努力，主要是试图纠正这一错误。但如今，情况有可能走向另一个同样不切实际的极端。肥胖对个人的影响并不相同：许多人即使经过数十年时间，也不会出现不良后果。如果我们像在 20 世纪大部分时间里那样，一直将肥胖视为一种风险，那么那些真正患病的人就会被忽视。而如果像现在越来越多的观点所建议的那样，将肥胖视为一种疾病，那么数百万人在没有患病的情况下也会被标记为“患病者”，并被迫接受可能并非必要的治疗。

GLP-1 drugs are strikingly safe, yet carry side-effects such as muscle loss and, rarely, pancreatitis; metabolic surgery's mortality can be as low as 0.1%, with serious complications in only 1-4% of patients. Even risks this small are disproportionate when the patient has little

to gain.

GLP-1 类药物的安全性非常高，不过仍存在一些副作用，如肌肉损失，极少数情况下还会出现胰腺炎。而代谢手术的死亡率可以低至 0.1%，只有 1-4% 的患者会出现严重并发症。即使这些风险很小，但如果患者实际上获益甚微，那么这些风险仍然显得相当严重。

Last year, a Lancet commission of 56 experts, which I chaired, proposed a way out. It distinguished clinical obesity, a disease state where excess fat directly causes demonstrable organ dysfunction or impairs daily life, from pre-clinical obesity, a risk state in which organ function is preserved. This is how the rest of medicine works. A polyp is not cancer; prediabetes is not diabetes; high blood pressure is not heart disease. Such boundaries exist not to ration care but to make it proportionate: clinical obesity warrants disease-level treatment; pre-clinical obesity still warrants attention—lifestyle change, drugs, sometimes surgery—but at a dose and intensity calibrated to a risk, not to an established illness.

去年，由我担任主席的 56 位专家组成的《柳叶刀》委员会提出了一项解决方案。他们区分了临床性肥胖和前期性肥胖：临床性肥胖是一种疾病状态，其中多余的脂肪直接导致器官功能受损或影响日常生活；而前期性肥胖则是一种风险状态，此时器官功能仍然保持正常。医学就是这样运作的。息肉不是癌症；糖尿病前期并不等于糖尿病；高血压并不等于心脏病。这些分类的存在不是为了分配治疗资源，而是为了使治疗更加合理：临床性肥胖需要疾病级别的治疗；而前期性肥胖仍然需要关注——可以通过生活方式改变、药物治疗，有时需要手术来治疗，但这种治疗方式和强度应该是根据风险来调整的，而不是基于某种已确定的疾病类型来决定的。

The framework now carries the endorsement of 76 medical organisations, but also its share of criticism. The fear is that defining pre-clinical obesity as a risk state will hand insurers an excuse to withhold cover. The concern rests on a false premise: that medicine and insurance treat only disease and ignore risk. They do no such thing. Statins for high cholesterol, drugs for high blood pressure and

pre-emptive surgery for inherited cancer risk are all routinely funded.

该框架现已获得 76 个医学组织的认可，但同时也引发了不少批评。人们担心，将临床前的肥胖定义为一种风险状态，可能会给保险公司提供借口来拒绝提供保险服务。这种担忧基于一个错误的假设：认为医学和保险行业只关注疾病的治疗，而忽略风险因素的考量。但实际上，针对高胆固醇、高血压等问题所采用的药物，以及针对遗传癌症风险的预防性手术，都是得到常规资助的。

Even drugmakers, who may be assumed to favour the broadest possible definition, stand to lose from a uniform-disease label. Developing metabolic therapies takes vast capital and precise, defensible indications. A world in which all obesity is a disease, yet many patients will never suffer the harms the drugs are designed to avert, is one in which the cost-effectiveness case collapses. Separating clinical from pre-clinical obesity lets dose, duration and price track the patient's actual state—the only basis on which such investment earns sustainable returns, clinical and commercial alike.

即使是那些通常倾向于采用最广泛定义的制药公司，也会因统一的疾病分类标准而遭受损失。开发新的代谢疗法需要大量的资金，并且需要明确、可辩护的适应症。在一个所有肥胖都被视为疾病的世界里，许多患者却永远不会面临这些药物所旨在避免的不良后果。在这种情况下，成本效益分析就变得毫无意义了。将临床研究与临床前研究区分开来，就能根据患者的实际状况来制定剂量、疗程和价格方案——这才是实现可持续回报的唯一基础，无论是从临床还是商业角度来看都是如此。

To those who spent decades fighting merely to have obesity taken seriously, a framework that declines to call every case a disease can feel like retreat. It is the opposite: the diagnostic discipline that aligns obesity, at last, with the rest of medicine. ■

对于那些花费数十年时间努力让肥胖问题得到重视的人来说，一个拒绝将每一种肥胖情况都称为疾病的框架，或许会让他们感到退步。但

实际上，这种框架恰恰是将肥胖与其他医学疾病相联系的诊断标准。

■

Francesco Rubino is a professor of metabolic surgery at King's College London. He chaired a Lancet commission on clinical obesity.

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Brain gain

大脑能力的提升

How dementia is being defeated

如何战胜痴呆症

Incidence among the elderly is falling fast

老年人群中的发病率正在迅速下降

Jul 10, 2026 08:36 AM | Helsinki

2026 年 7 月 10 日 上午 08:36 | 赫尔辛基



WHEN ERIC STALLARD, an actuary and academic, began looking into the incidence of dementia among elderly Americans, he was so

stunned by his findings that he held off publishing his first paper on the subject for two and a half years while he double-checked his work. "I wanted to be absolutely certain," he recalls, since the numbers defied all expectation. Instead of confirming the received wisdom that America faced an intensifying plague of the condition, they showed that the proportion of old people succumbing to it was in fact shrinking fast. "I was shocked by the declines," he says.

当保险专家兼学者埃里克·斯塔拉德开始研究美国老年人中痴呆症的发病率时，他发现的结果让他震惊不已，以至于他推迟了两年半才发表关于这一主题的第一篇论文。“我必须确保自己没有弄错什么，”他回忆说，因为这些数据完全超出了人们的预期。实际上，这些数据显示，患痴呆症的老年人比例正在迅速减少，而不是像人们预期的那样在增加。他说：“我对这一下降幅度感到非常震惊。”

Mr Stallard has been working for a decade to corroborate this revelation. His findings have, if anything, become even more striking. Last year he and some colleagues published research in the *Journal of the American Medical Association* showing that, whereas 40 years ago three in every ten Americans aged 85-89 had dementia, by 2024 just one in ten had it (see chart 1). What is more, America is not the only beneficiary of this trend. Between 1988 and 2015 the share of older people being diagnosed with dementia fell by 13% a decade across six countries in North America and Europe, according to a study of almost 50,000 people by Frank Wolters of the Erasmus Medical Centre in Rotterdam, and colleagues.

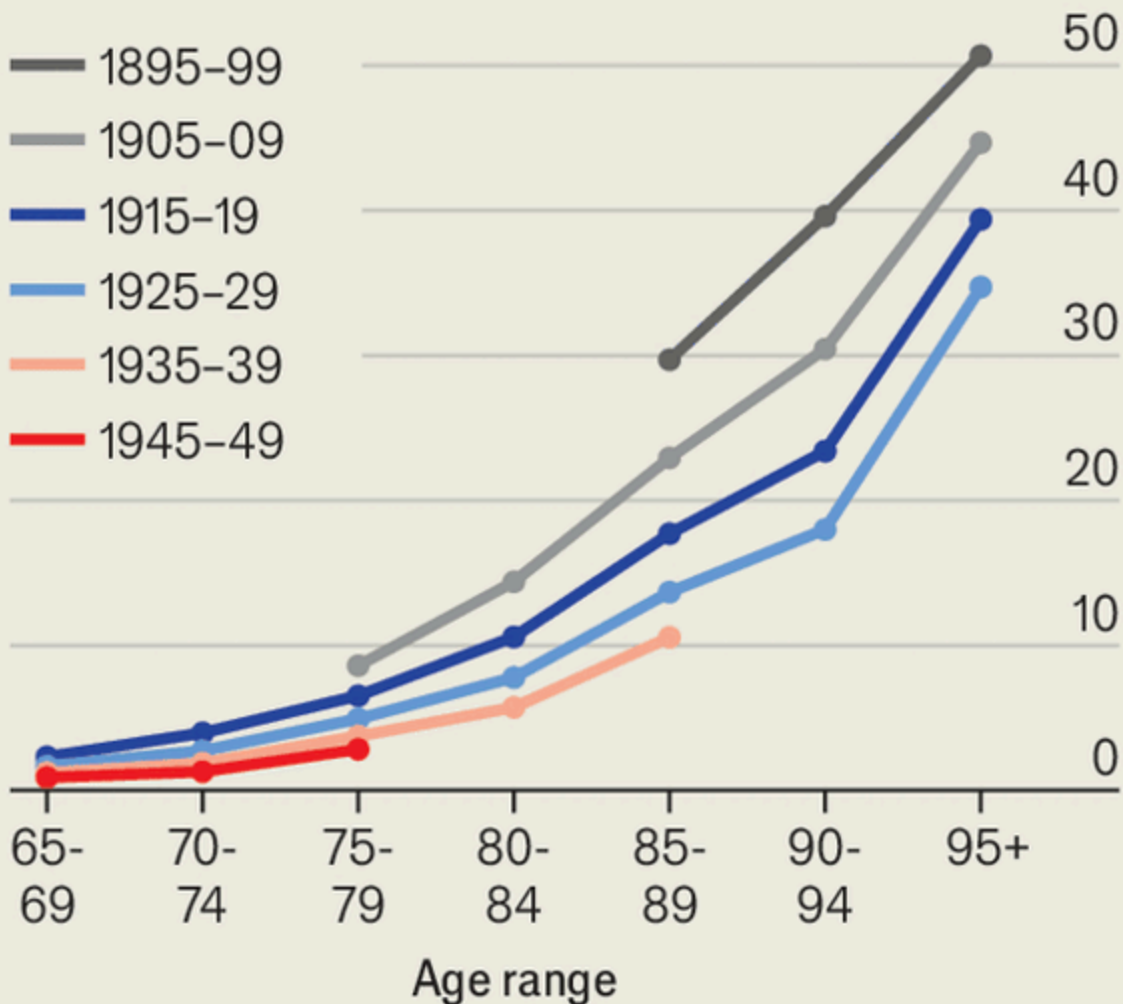
斯塔拉德先生已经努力研究这一现象长达十年之久。他的研究结果实际上更加令人震惊。去年，他与几位同事在《美国医学会杂志》上发表了研究论文，指出：在 40 年前，每 10 个 85 至 89 岁的美国人中有 3 人患有痴呆症，而到了 2024 年，这一比例下降到了每 10 人中只有 1 人。此外，美国并非唯一受到这一趋势影响的国家。根据鹿特丹伊拉斯谟医学中心弗兰克·沃尔特斯及其同事对近 5 万人的研究，从 1988 年到 2015 年，北美和欧洲六个国家中，老年人群中被诊断出患有痴呆症的人数每十年减少 13%。

Cognitive coup

1

United States, % with dementia by age

Selected birth cohorts



Source: "Changing story of the dementia epidemic", by E. Stallard et al., *Journal of the American Medical Association*, May 2025

Some smaller studies have also found big declines. Data from the Framingham Heart Study, which has tracked three generations in an American town, show an average drop in new dementia cases of 20% per decade over almost 40 years between the late 1970s and

early 2010s. Those who were entering their dotage when Daft Punk's "Get Lucky" was topping the charts (2013) were 44% less likely to have dementia than those who were doing so when Sting was urging Roxanne to switch off her red light (1978).

一些规模较小的研究也发现了显著的下降现象。来自弗雷明汉心脏研究的数据表明，在一个美国小镇上，三代人的研究中，在 1970 年代末到 2010 年代这段时间里，新的痴呆症病例平均每十年减少 20%。那些在达夫·普克演唱《Get Lucky》成为热门歌曲时（2013 年）进入老年阶段的人，其患痴呆症的风险比那些在斯汀鼓励罗克珊关闭红灯时（1978 年）进入老年阶段的人要低 44%。

Whereas most earlier studies had simply pooled elderly people and then applied a statistical adjustment for age, Mr Stallard looked at narrow bands of ages to compare different cohorts of people over 50 years. By examining the changes between each successive cohort, he calculates that dementia rates have been declining by 2.5-3% for each calendar-year cohort. "In my view it was the Copernican revolution in the field," he says, turning assumptions about dementia's spread upside down. Similar cohort studies in various European countries and Japan have found comparable trends there, too.

虽然早期的研究大多只是将老年人汇总在一起，然后针对年龄进行统计调整，但斯塔拉德先生却关注了特定年龄段的群体，以比较 50 岁以上不同群体的情况。通过对比各个年龄段之间的变化，他计算出每一年痴呆症的发病率都在下降，降幅为 2.5%到 3%。他说：“在我看来，这堪称该领域的一场‘哥白尼革命’。”他对痴呆症传播趋势的假设被彻底颠覆了。在欧洲各国和日本进行的类似群体研究也发现了类似的趋势。

Making memories

创造回忆

Big questions remain about why dementia rates are falling and whether they will continue to drop. The growing number of old people in most countries and increasing longevity mean that overall case numbers are still rising, even if a smaller share of the elderly are afflicted. And the good news is largely confined to rich countries, at least for now. But the fear that an epidemic of dementia will soon be running out of control, blighting ever more lives and placing an impossible burden on health systems, is mercifully overblown.

关于痴呆症发病率下降的原因以及这种下降趋势是否会持续下去，仍然存在许多疑问。在大多数国家，老年人口数量不断增加，人均寿命也有所延长，因此尽管受痴呆症影响的老年人比例可能有所减少，但整体病例数量仍然在上升。好消息是，这一情况主要局限于富裕国家，至少目前是这样。不过，人们担心痴呆症会迅速失控，夺走越来越多人的生命，给医疗系统带来难以承受的负担，这种担忧显然被夸大了。

The single biggest risk factor for dementia is age. Prevalence doubles roughly every five years after 70. In America in 2016, for instance, just 4% of people aged 70-74 had dementia, but the rate jumped to 9% for those who were 75-79 and again to 18% for 80- to 84-year olds. More than a quarter of those over 85 had the condition.

痴呆症最大的风险因素就是年龄。在 70 岁以后，患病几率大约每五年就会翻倍。例如，在 2016 年的美国，70 至 74 岁人群中只有 4% 患有痴呆症，而 75 至 79 岁这一年龄段的患病率则上升到了 9%，而 80 至 84 岁的人群中这一比例则达到了 18%。超过四分之一的 85 岁以上人群患有痴呆症。

This near-exponential pattern, combined with the rising life expectancy, has long fuelled alarming predictions. In a study published last year in the journal *Nature Medicine* Josef Coresh, Michael Fang and their co-authors projected that the number of new cases in America would double from around 500,000 a year in 2020 to 1m a year by 2060. A study published in 2022 calculated that the

global population of people with dementia will almost triple from around 57m people in 2019 to 153m people in 2050.

这种近乎指数级的增长趋势，加上人们预期寿命的延长，长期以来引发了诸多担忧。在去年发表于《自然医学》杂志的一项研究中，约瑟夫·科雷斯、迈克尔·方及其合作者们预测，美国的新的痴呆症病例数量将从 2020 年的约 50 万例增加到 2060 年的 100 万例。而在 2022 年的一项研究则计算出，全球患有痴呆症的人口数量将从 2019 年的约 5700 万人增加到 2050 年的 1.53 亿人。

Mind-bending

令人难以置信的体验

Such numbers, in turn, feed frightening estimates of the likely future cost of dementia. The direct cost of care (including informally in the home) probably came to around \$1.3trn worldwide in 2019 (or roughly 0.8% of global GDP). The burden becomes even greater if one accounts for indirect costs such as patients' diminished quality of life. These added up to around \$781bn last year in America alone (or about 2.5% of GDP), according to a model funded by America's National Institutes of Health. A paper by Arindam Nandi of the Population Council, David Bloom at Harvard University and others uses an even broader measure that tries to put a price on patients' suffering (by estimating a willingness to pay to prevent it). It put the global cost of dementia at \$2.8trn in 2019 increasing to \$4.7trn by 2030, \$8.5trn in 2040 and \$16.9trn by 2050.

这样的数字让人对痴呆症未来的成本估计出奇地高。仅直接护理成本（包括在家庭中的非正规护理）在 2019 年就可能达到约 1.3 万亿美元（约占全球 GDP 的 0.8%）。如果再加上间接成本，比如患者生活质量的下降，那么负担会更大。根据美国国立卫生研究院资助的一项模型研究，仅在美国，去年的这些额外成本就达到了约 7810 亿美元（约占 GDP 的 2.5%）。人口委员会的研究员 Arindam Nandi、哈佛大学的 David Bloom 等人发表的一篇论文采用了更全面的衡量标准，试图为患者的痛苦定价——通过估算人们为预防疾病而愿意支付的费

用。该论文指出，2019 年全球痴呆症的医疗成本为 2.8 万亿美元，到 2030 年将达到 4.7 万亿美元，到 2040 年达到 8.5 万亿美元，而到 2050 年则将达到 16.9 万亿美元。

Yet such terrifying projections are almost certainly wrong, at least with respect to rich, Western countries. Almost all are based on models in which there is little, if any, reduction in the age-adjusted rate of dementia over the coming decades. Since there will be growing numbers of old people in most Western countries in the coming years, and since those old people will live longer, such assumptions lead to gigantic increases in the projected number of dementia cases. Yet even relatively small annual changes in the rate of dementia, when compounded over 30 years, can lead to much happier outcomes.

然而，这些令人担忧的预测几乎可以肯定是错误的，至少对于富裕的西方国家来说如此。几乎所有预测都基于这样的模型：在未来几十年内，痴呆症的发生率几乎没有或根本没有下降。由于在未来几年里，大多数西方国家的老年人口数量将会增加，而这些老年人的人均寿命也会延长，因此这些假设导致对痴呆症病例数量的预测出现了巨大的高估。不过，即使痴呆症发病率每年有微小的变化，在 30 年的时间里，这些变化仍然可以带来显著的好结果。

To show this Chiara Celine Brück and her co-authors at the Erasmus Medical Centre built a detailed computer simulation of 10m Dutch people and then looked at how dementia would progress under two different scenarios. In the first they assumed there would be no change in the underlying risk of dementia over time (other than from ageing) and found, as other mainstream projections have, that the number of Dutch people with dementia would more than double by 2050. In another, they used the research of their co-author, Mr Wolters, who found that the incidence of dementia had been falling by 13% a decade after adjusting for age, and simulated what would happen if the trend continued. They found that, although the number of dementia cases would still increase because of the growing ranks of elderly people, instead of more than doubling by

2050, it would grow by just 43% from the level of 2020.

为了向 Chiara Celine Brück 及其在 Erasmus Medical Centre 的同事们展示这一结果，他们构建了一个详细的计算机模拟模型，该模型涵盖了 100 万荷兰人的情况。然后，他们研究了在两种不同情况下痴呆症的进展情况。在第一种情况下，他们认为随着时间的推移，痴呆症的风险不会发生变化（除了因年龄增长导致的风险增加）。正如其他主流预测所预测的那样，到 2050 年时，患有痴呆症的荷兰人数量将会翻倍以上。而在第二种情况下，他们参考了他们的合作者 Wolters 的研究结果，他发现尽管经过年龄因素调整后，痴呆症的发病率仍持续下降 13%。如果这一趋势继续下去，那么从 2020 年的水平来看，痴呆症病例的数量仅会增长 43%，而不是翻倍以上。

To be more confident about such projections, researchers must determine why so many more people have been keeping their wits and so be able to make a more reasoned judgment about whether the trend will continue. That is not easy, in large part because dementia is a condition with multiple causes that typically develops slowly over decades before clearly manifesting itself.

为了更确信这些预测的准确性，研究人员必须找出为什么有如此多的人保持沉默，从而能够更理性地判断这一趋势是否会持续下去。这并不容易，因为痴呆症是一种由多种原因引起的疾病，通常需要几十年时间才会逐渐显现出来。

Scientists have long known that dementia has a genetic component. Roughly 25% of the population carries a single copy of a gene known as ApoE4, which is associated with a risk of getting Alzheimer's (much the most common of the dozens of diseases that can cause dementia) that is 2-3 times greater than the norm. For the 2-3% of the population with two copies of this gene, the risk is 10-15 times greater.

科学家们早就知道，痴呆症具有遗传因素。大约 25% 的人口携带一种名为 ApoE4 的基因，拥有这一基因的人患阿尔茨海默病的风险会比正

常人高出 2-3 倍。而对于那些拥有两个 ApoE4 基因拷贝的人来说，风险则会高出 10-15 倍。

Yet many people without these genes get dementia and many who have them do not. The search for other causes of the condition was given a boost in the 1970s in North Karelia, a remote and hard-living region of Finland which had one of the world's highest rates of heart attacks. To reduce this scourge, health authorities discouraged smoking, monitored blood pressure and encouraged healthy eating. The public-health campaign eventually cut deaths from heart attacks by 84%. An unexpected benefit, says Tiia Ngandu, a researcher at the Finnish Institute for Health and Welfare, was the opportunity for researchers to examine some 40 years of detailed health records for a large population.

然而，许多没有这些基因的人也会患上痴呆症，而拥有这些基因的人却不会患病。在 20 世纪 70 年代，芬兰北卡莱里亚地区发现了这种疾病的其他可能原因。这个地区环境恶劣，心脏病发作的发病率非常高。为了降低这一疾病的发生率，当地卫生部门鼓励人们戒烟、监测血压并提倡健康饮食。这一公共卫生措施最终使心脏病发作的死亡率降低了 84%。芬兰健康与福利研究所的研究员 Tiia Ngandu 指出，一个意想不到的好处是，研究人员能够利用大量人口长达 40 年的详细健康记录来进行研究。

Memory laws

记忆法法规

The result was a groundbreaking series of observational studies showing that high blood pressure, high cholesterol, obesity and poor fitness in mid-life all increased the risks of dementia 20 years later. "It really changed the way we think about dementia," says Miia Kivipelto of the Karolinska Institute in Stockholm, who led some of these studies. "We saw that it was not only a late-life disease that can't be prevented, but more of a process that starts in mid-life with

the possibilities to at least slow the progression.”

研究结果揭示了一项具有开创性的观察性研究，该研究表明：高血压、高胆固醇、肥胖以及中年时期健康状况不佳等因素，都会增加 20 年后患痴呆症的风险。斯德哥尔摩卡罗林斯卡研究所的 Miia Kivipelto 说：“这一研究真正改变了我们对痴呆症的认知。我们发现，痴呆症并非一种只能在晚年才会出现且无法预防的疾病，而是一个从中年时期就开始的过程，至少我们可以减缓其发展速度。”

Observational studies, however, cannot account for variables that researchers are not able to (or do not think to) measure, but that may nonetheless contribute to the outcome. The best way of eliminating these is by using a randomised controlled trial (RCT), the gold standard in clinical research, in which people are divided into two groups, only one of which receives the intervention being tested. In 2009 Dr Ngandu and a team led by Ms Kivipelto began the world's first big RCT to see whether two years of healthy eating, exercise, cognitive training and heart treatment could reduce dementia among old people at high risk of it. Sure enough, the results of FINGER (Finnish Geriatric Intervention Study to Prevent Cognitive Impairment and Disability), which were published in 2015, proved that people could significantly diminish the risk of cognitive decline by adopting a healthy lifestyle.

然而，观察性研究无法考虑到那些研究人员无法测量或认为不需要测量的变量，而这些变量或许确实会对结果产生影响。要消除这些影响，最好的方法就是进行随机对照试验（RCT），这是临床研究中的黄金标准。在这种试验中，参与者会被分成两组，只有其中一组会接受所测试的干预措施。2009 年，Ngandu 博士和 Kivipelto 女士领导的团队开始了世界上首个大规模随机对照试验，旨在研究两年的健康饮食、锻炼、认知训练以及心脏治疗是否能够降低高风险老年人患痴呆症的风险。果然，2015 年发布的 FINGER 研究结果证明，通过采取健康的生活方式，人们可以显著降低认知衰退的风险。

Several similar RCTs have found significant benefits from such changes in lifestyle in America, Australia and Japan, among other

places. Because these studies are comparable, pooling their results has also given researchers a big enough sample group to study interactions between lifestyle and genes. This has produced a particularly hopeful result for those with the ApoE4 gene, who saw a bigger benefit from the interventions than those without. "You can't change your genes," says Ms Kivipelto, "but you can do things to postpone the onset of the disease or reduce the effect of genetics."

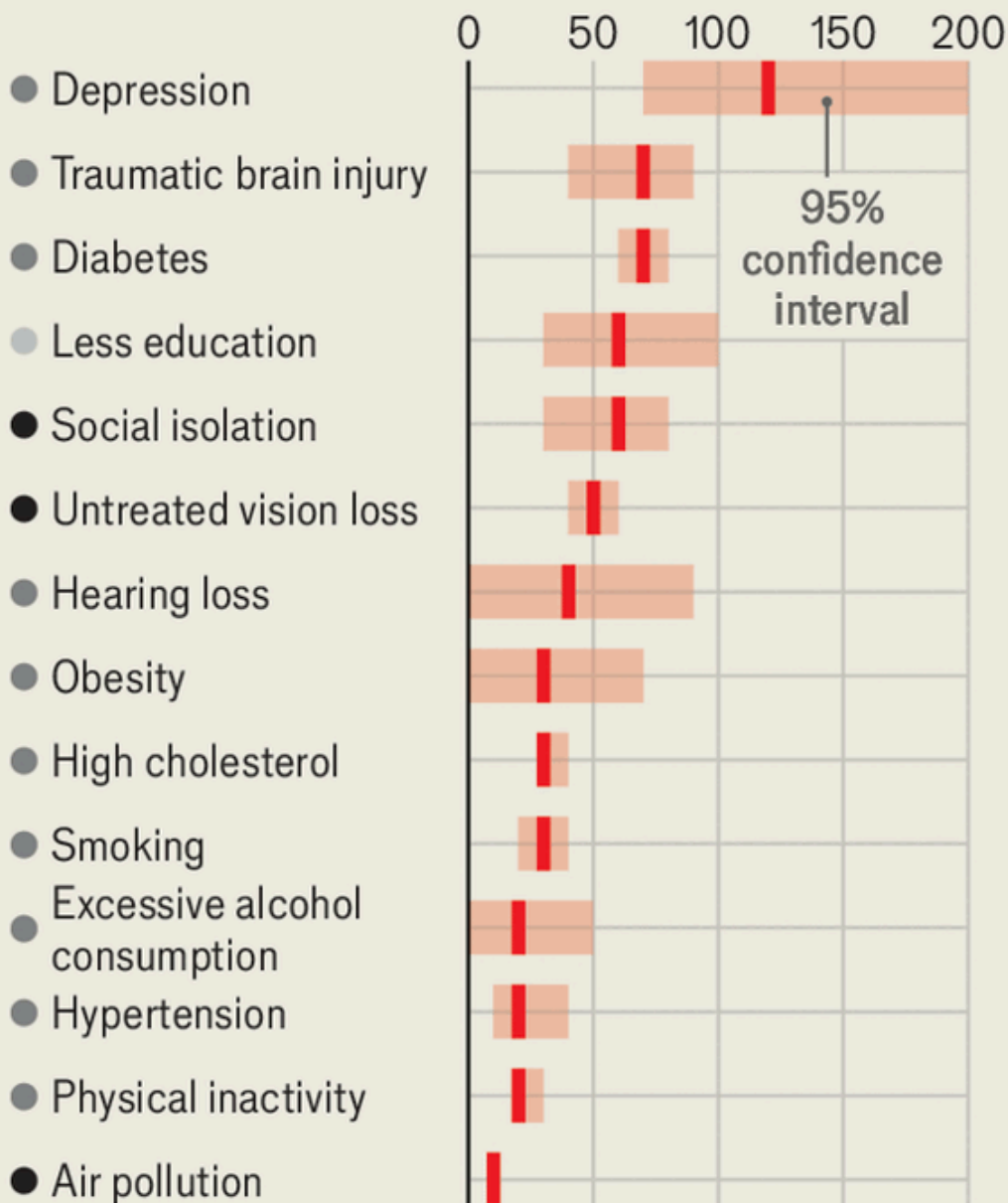
在美国、澳大利亚、日本等国家和地区，多项类似的随机对照研究都发现，改变生活方式确实能带来显著的好处。由于这些研究具有可比性，将它们的结果汇总起来后，研究人员就能拥有一个足够大的样本组，从而深入研究生活方式与基因之间的相互作用。对于那些拥有 ApoE4 基因的人来说，这一研究结果尤其令人欣慰——他们从这些干预措施中获益的程度比没有该基因的人要高。“虽然无法改变自己的基因，”Kivipelto 女士说，“但可以通过一些措施来推迟疾病的发作或减轻遗传因素的影响。”

Mind map

2

Potentially modifiable risk factors for dementia, higher relative risk, %

● Early life ● Middle life ● Late life



Source: "Dementia prevention, intervention and care",
Lancet Commission report, 2024

The implications are vast. The Lancet Commission on Dementia, an international collaboration of leading experts, reckons that as many as 45% of dementia cases worldwide could be delayed or prevented through addressing 14 “modifiable risk factors” at various stages in life. These range from better schooling for children (insufficient education is associated with a 60% higher risk of dementia), to treating deafness, high cholesterol and depression in mid-life and avoiding social isolation when older (see chart 2).

其影响非常深远。《柳叶刀》关于痴呆症的委员会是由顶尖专家组成的国际合作团队，他们认为通过应对人生各个阶段中的 14 个“可改变的风险因素”，可以延缓或预防全球范围内高达 45% 的痴呆症病例。这些风险因素包括：改善儿童的教育水平（受教育程度不足与痴呆症的风险增加 60% 有关）；治疗中年人的听力障碍、高胆固醇问题及抑郁症；以及避免老年时期的社会孤立现象（详见图表 2）。

The commission’s findings offer important lessons for policymakers about how to reduce the incidence (and cost) of dementia. The first is not to focus exclusively on the factors with the strongest association with dementia, such as untreated depression (which brings a 120% bigger risk of developing the condition than the norm). Instead, attending to factors that are associated with lower risk but are more common can have a bigger impact. Treating people with hearing loss and high cholesterol, for instance, could cut total dementia cases by 14%, the commission finds.

该委员会的调研结果为政策制定者提供了重要的启示，帮助他们了解如何降低痴呆症的发生率和相关成本。首先，不应只关注那些与痴呆症关联最密切的因素，比如未治疗的抑郁症——患有抑郁症的人患痴呆症的风险比正常人群高出 120%。相反，关注那些虽然关联较低但较为常见的影响因素可能会产生更大的效果。例如，对听力受损和高胆固醇人群进行治疗，可以使得总痴呆症病例减少 14%，委员会指出。

Mind control

思维控制

Such advances help explain why the incidence of dementia has fallen so rapidly over the past 40 years. Improvements in education and successful efforts to reduce heart disease and strokes have also, by happenstance, improved brain health. "When I graduated from medical school, which was quite a long time ago, we thought that dementia was just like one of these things that hit you from outer space in a totally random fashion," says Gill Livingston of University College London, who leads the Lancet Commission. "It is hugely positive and hopeful that we now know that policy and individuals can do a huge amount to change that."

这些进展有助于解释为什么在过去 40 年里，痴呆症的发病率下降得如此之快。教育水平的提高，以及成功控制心脏病和中风的努力，也间接改善了大脑健康。“当我从医学院毕业时，那已经是很久以前的事了。当时我们认为痴呆症就像是从外太空随机降临的一种疾病而已，”伦敦大学学院的 Gill Livingston 说，他负责领导《柳叶刀》委员会的工作。“现在我们知道，政策和个人的努力能够带来巨大的改变，这真是令人感到非常积极和充满希望。”

Researchers continue to discover new risk factors. In 2024, for instance, the Lancet Commission added untreated vision loss and high levels of LDL, a type of cholesterol. Among the bewildering array of possible additions researchers are examining are some that can be easily acted on, such as regularly flossing teeth (inflammation from infected gums may harm the brain). Others, such as poor sleep, may simply give anxious insomniacs one more thing to lie awake worrying about. And some may prove to be double-edged swords, says Ms Kivipelto. People with demanding and engaging jobs (such as medical researchers and journalists, she says, perhaps a little generously) have little need to do extra cognitive exercises to keep their brains nimble. But such jobs may also be more stressful,

which may well turn out to be a risk factor, too.

研究人员不断发现新的风险因素。例如，在 2024 年，《柳叶刀》委员会指出，未经治疗的视力丧失以及高水平的低密度脂蛋白胆固醇可能是风险因素。在众多可能的风险因素中，有一些是可以轻易应对的，比如定期使用牙线清洁牙齿（牙龈感染引起的炎症可能会损害大脑）。而另一些因素，如睡眠不足，可能会让焦虑的失眠者更加担忧。Kivipelto 女士指出，有些因素可能具有双重影响。那些从事要求高且需要高度专注的工作的人（比如医学研究人员和记者），可能不需要进行额外的认知训练来保持大脑的活跃。不过，这类工作也可能带来更大的压力，这同样可能成为一个风险因素。

Research is also revealing unexpected interventions that help to keep ageing minds sharp. One of the most promising derives from an analysis by Pascal Geldsetzer of Stanford University and his team of a natural experiment in Wales. In 2013 the British region started offering people aged 70-79 free vaccinations through the public-health system. This change resembled an RCT, in that a large number of people were separated almost at random into two groups: those who had already turned 80 in the weeks before the programme started, and so were not eligible to be jabbed; and those who turned 80 in the weeks after, roughly half of whom were duly vaccinated.

研究还发现了一些意想不到的干预措施，这些措施有助于保持思维敏捷。其中一项最有前景的发现来自斯坦福大学的 Pascal Geldsetzer 及其团队的研究。他们在威尔士进行了一项自然实验的分析。2013 年，英国该地区开始为 70 至 79 岁的人群提供免费疫苗接种服务，这些服务通过公共卫生系统提供。这一举措类似于随机对照试验，因为大量人群被随机分为两组：一组是在项目开始前的几周内就已经达到 80 岁年龄的人，他们没有资格接种疫苗；另一组则是在项目开始后的几周内达到 80 岁的人，其中大约一半人成功接种了疫苗。

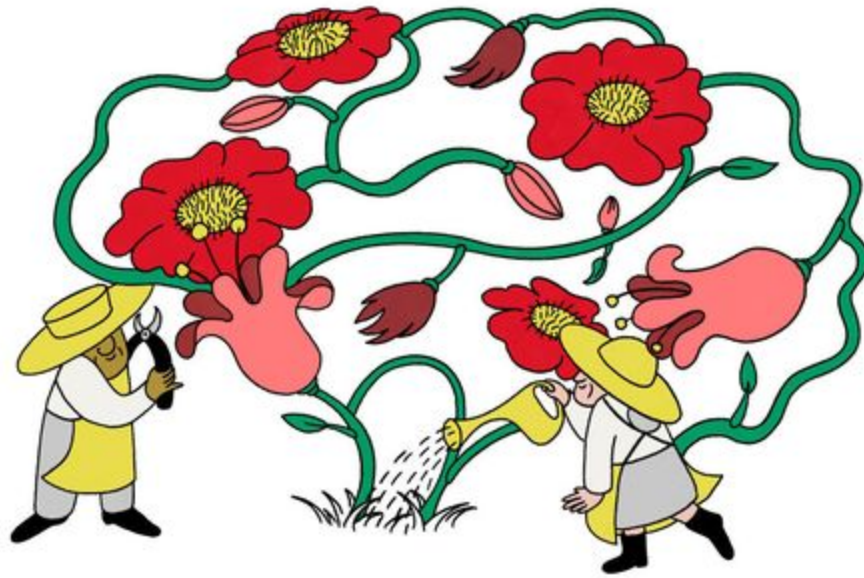
The study found that a vaccine intended to prevent shingles, a form of chickenpox, suffered chiefly by the elderly, also reduced the risk of developing dementia by 20% for at least seven years after it was

administered. This conclusion has been validated by similar studies in Australia and Canada. "We were super-excited by this finding," says Mr Geldsetzer, "because it showed that such a simple and cheap intervention could potentially avert one-fifth of cases." A more recent study by the same team suggests that the vaccine also slows the progression of dementia in people who already have it before they get vaccinated.

研究发现，一种旨在预防带状疱疹（一种由水痘引起的疾病）的疫苗，这种疾病主要困扰老年人。该疫苗在接种后至少七年内，还能将患痴呆症的风险降低 20%。这一结论得到了澳大利亚和加拿大进行的相关研究的验证。“我们对这一发现感到非常兴奋，”Geldsetzer 先生说，“因为这表明如此简单且廉价的干预措施，就有可能避免五分之一的病例发生。”同一研究团队最近的一项研究还表明，这种疫苗还能减缓已经患有痴呆症的人病情的发展。

These results are not only encouraging in themselves, but also raise tantalising prospects of further benefits. Should people be jabbed at a younger age—50, say—given that dementia can take years to manifest? Should the elderly receive regular booster vaccines over the years?

这些结果不仅令人鼓舞，而且还预示着未来可能带来更多的好处。如果人们在更年轻的时候就接受接种——比如 50 岁时——考虑到痴呆症可能需要数年才会显现出来，那么是否应该让老年人定期接种加强针呢？



The news regarding treatments developed expressly for dementia is less heartening. Until recently the most promising drugs were thought to be antibodies such as Lecanemab and Donanemab that bind to and clear out amyloid-beta, a protein that clogs up the brains of people with Alzheimer's. But studies suggest they offer modest real-world benefits and carry hefty risks of bleeding or swelling in the brain, especially for people with the ApoE4 gene. In other words, the people most in need of these drugs are also at greatest risk of being harmed by them. For some, these findings also call into question the [hypothesis](#) that tangles of amyloid cause Alzheimer's and that clearing them could cure it. Others argue that these drugs need to be given earlier in life to have an impact.

关于为痴呆症开发的治疗方法的消息并不令人乐观。直到最近，人们认为最有前景的药物是那些能够结合并清除β淀粉样蛋白的抗体，比如 Lecanemab 和 Donanemab。β淀粉样蛋白是一种蛋白质，它会堵塞阿尔茨海默病患者的大脑。但研究表明，这些药物的实际效果有限，而且还会带来严重的出血或脑肿胀风险，尤其是对于那些携带 ApoE4 基因的人来说。换句话说，最需要这些药物的人反而最容易受到药物的伤害。对于一些人来说，这些研究结果也质疑了β淀粉样蛋白缠结是导致阿尔茨海默病的假设，以及清除这些蛋白质就能治愈疾

病的观点。另一些人则认为，这些药物需要在更早的年龄就开始使用，才能发挥效果。

Some observers hope that GLP-1s, weight-loss drugs often heralded as a miracle cure for practically everything, might make brains as trim as they do waistlines. An RCT has found that it offers no benefits to people who already have Alzheimer's, although earlier observational studies had suggested that people on these sorts of drugs had a lower risk of getting dementia in the first place.

一些观察家认为，GLP-1 这种常被用作减肥药物的物质，或许能像帮助人们减轻腰围一样，让大脑变得更健康。一项随机对照试验表明，这种药物对已经患有阿尔茨海默病的人并没有任何益处；不过，早期的观察性研究则表明，服用这类药物的人患痴呆症的风险较低。

Trials are under way to test lots of drugs as treatments for dementia, including many that were originally developed for other ailments. In the EasyFit gym in central Helsinki, a group of grey-haired women clad in lycra are in the vanguard of this effort. They start their warm-up exercises at the gentle cajoling of a physiotherapist. For the next hour they lift weights, swing kettlebells, horse around and laugh heartily, as part of an RCT. "Alzheimer's is a real problem," says Riita, aged 77. "If something can be done to improve the methods of helping people I would very much like to be part of it."

目前正在进行多项试验，旨在测试多种药物作为治疗痴呆症的方法，其中许多药物最初是用于治疗其他疾病的。在赫尔辛基市中心的 EasyFit 健身房里，一群头发灰白的女性穿着莱卡运动服，处于这项研究的先锋地位。在理疗师的鼓励下，她们开始进行热身运动。接下来的一个小时里，她们会举重、摆动壶铃、做各种动作，并开心地笑着——这些都是随机对照试验的一部分。“阿尔茨海默病确实是一个严重的问题，”77 岁的里塔说。“如果有什么办法可以改善帮助患者的治疗方法，我非常愿意参与其中。”

Riita and her buddies are among almost 600 people in three countries taking part in the MET-FINGER study, which combines

healthier lifestyles with metformin, a diabetes drug, to see if these can prevent or at least delay the onset of various sorts of dementia. Other studies are examining activities from saunas to ice baths in search of methods to sharpen the mind.

里塔和她的朋友们是来自三个国家的大约 600 名参与者中的一部分，他们参与了 MET-FINGER 研究。这项研究的目的是将健康的生活方式与二甲双胍这种糖尿病药物结合起来，以观察这两种方法是否能够预防或至少延缓各种类型痴呆症的发作。其他研究则着眼于从桑拿浴到冰浴等各种活动，试图找到能够锻炼大脑的方法。

For now even the most optimistic projections still entail a rise in the total number of dementia cases over the coming decades, albeit at a far slower rate than before, as the ranks of the elderly grow. Yet there are good reasons to hope that a combination of drugs, vaccinations, lifestyle and policy changes could bend this curve further. It is even possible that the total number of people with dementia may soon begin to fall in rich countries.

目前，即使是最乐观的预测也表明，在未来几十年内，痴呆症病例的总数仍会上升，不过上升的速度会比以前慢得多，因为老年人口的数量在不断增加。不过，我们有理由相信，通过药物、疫苗接种、生活方式调整以及政策改革等多种手段，我们可以进一步扭转这一趋势。甚至有可能在富裕国家，痴呆症患者的总数很快就会开始减少。

Ms Livingston and Ms Kivipelto both point out that the grim arithmetic whereby dementia rates double every five years after the age of 70 also offers huge possibilities. Simply delaying the average onset of dementia by five years would cut the total number of cases by around 50%. "I'm optimistic it's possible," says Ms Livingston. So is Lisa, a 66-year-old working out in the gym in Helsinki. She lifts weights or exercises five times a week, motivated, in part, by personal experience. "It's not nice to see your own mother becoming a different person," she says. "I know Alzheimer's can come to

anyone, so it is good to do these things if you can.” ■

利文斯顿女士和基维佩尔托女士都指出，随着年龄增长，痴呆症的发病率每五年就会翻倍这一令人担忧的趋势，其实也蕴含着巨大的机会。只要能将痴呆症的平均发病年龄推迟五年，那么病例总数就可以减少约 50%。“我认为这是有可能的，”利文斯顿女士说。66 岁的丽莎也在赫尔辛基的健身房里锻炼。她每周进行五次力量训练或锻炼活动，她的动力部分来自于自己的经历。“看到自己的母亲变成另一个人，真是让人难过，”她说。“我知道阿尔茨海默病可能发生在任何人身上，所以如果你能的话，做这些事情是非常好的。”■

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Jul 09, 2026 05:23 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:23



THE “PEOPLE’S HOUSE” in Desford, Leicestershire, was a humble home. With three small bedrooms and hot water heated by a coal fire, in 1952 it was the Conservative government’s model solution to Britain’s post-war housing crisis. Taking just 12 weeks and £952 to build (£24,500, or \$33,000, in today’s prices), the house was rented from the council for 16 shillings a week, a 30% market discount and equivalent to about 10% of average manual wages.

位于莱斯特郡德斯福德的“人民之家”是一座简朴的住宅。这座房子只有三个小卧室，热水则由煤火提供。1952年，这座房子成为了保守党政府解决英国战后住房危机的典范方案。这座房子仅用了12周时间和952英镑的成本就建成了（按照今天的货币价值，相当于24,500英镑或33,000美元）。政府以每周16先令的价格租下了这座房子，这一价格比市场价低了30%，相当于平均手工劳动工资水平的10%左右。

Andy Burnham, the prime-minister-in-waiting, is nostalgic about these post-war council homes, which he thinks used to be “the foundation for everything”. In a speech on June 29th he asked: “If you don’t give people a good home, what chance have they got of having a good life?” One of his few bold policy promises was to

“oversee the biggest council-housebuilding programme since the post-war period”.

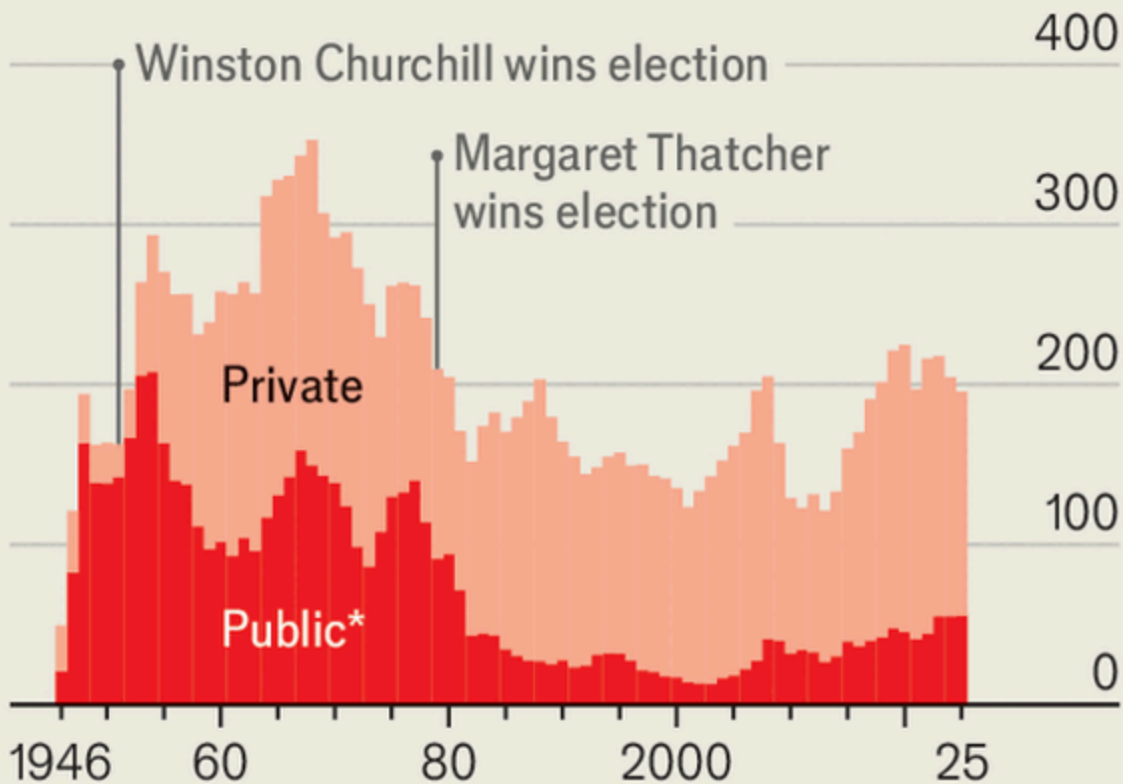
首席部长安迪·伯纳姆对这些战后建造的市政住宅感到怀旧，他认为这些住宅曾经是“一切的基础”。在 6 月 29 日的一次演讲中，他问道：“如果不为人们提供良好的居住环境，他们又有什么机会过上美好的生活呢？”他提出的少数几项大胆的政策承诺之一就是“实施自战后时期以来最大规模的市政住宅建设计划”。

But council housing is not the only way to give people a good home. Sir Keir Starmer, the outgoing prime minister, focused on enabling private housebuilding, through planning reform, rather than the state picking up the shovel. The most sensible thing for Mr Burnham to do would be to ease planning restrictions further and to relax regulations, such as environmental requirements. Instead, he has said that “undue weight” has been placed on planning reform—he wants to return housing to its post-war heyday of state-led intervention.

不过，市政住房并不是给人们提供良好居所的唯一途径。即将离任的首相基尔·斯塔默先生强调，应该通过规划改革来促进私人住宅的建设，而不是由政府完全主导一切。对于伯纳姆先生来说，最明智的做法是进一步放宽规划限制，简化相关法规，比如环境方面的要求。然而，他却声称，规划改革被赋予了“过重的意义”——他希望能让住房建设重新回到战后那种由政府主导干预的时代。

A private affair

England, houses built, '000



*Local authorities and housing associations
Sources: Ministry of Housing, Communities and Local Government; *The Economist*

In 1952, the year the People's House was built, local authorities funded the construction of four in five of the 200,000 new homes built in England that year. A little under half of housebuilding was public for most of the pre-Thatcher decades. Last year, by contrast, only 12,500 of the 190,000 new homes, or one in 16, were built for what is now called "social rent" (the tenure Mr Burnham seems to have in mind when he talks of council houses), priced at 50% of the market rate on average. Mr Burnham's announcement implies that he wants to build 75,000 social-rent homes a year, as that was the

record level achieved after Margaret Thatcher won power in 1979, often seen as the end of the post-war period. As well as being costly it would take years to reach that level.

在 1952 年，也就是“人民之家”建成那年，英国地方当局资助了当年在英格兰新建的 200,000 栋住宅中五栋的建造工作。在撒切尔夫人执政之前的几十年里，大约一半的住宅建设是由政府承担的。而去年，在 190,000 栋新住宅中，只有 12,500 栋是用于所谓的“社会租赁房”的——这些房屋的价格平均仅为市场价格的 50%。伯纳姆先生的声明表明，他希望每年建造 75,000 套这样的社会租赁房，这一数字是在 1979 年玛格丽特·撒切尔上台后创下的纪录，而那一年通常被视为战后时期的结束。此外，要达到这一数量水平需要数年时间，而且成本也非常高昂。

The promise to build a lot more housing for more people would seem to be a no-brainer. Politicians of all persuasions agree that Britain does not build enough. Between 1955 and 1979 new homes added around 1.9% to the housing stock each year, according to the Centre for Cities, a think-tank. Between 1980 and 2015 that rate fell to 0.8%, the lowest in all but one of 11 other European countries studied.

为更多的人建造更多住房的承诺似乎是个显而易见的事情。各种政党的政治家都认同：英国的住房供应确实不足。根据智库“城市中心”的数据，在 1955 年至 1979 年间，每年新增的住房数量约为 1.9%。而在 1980 年至 2015 年间，这一比例下降到了 0.8%，这是其他 11 个欧洲国家中除一个国家之外所有国家的最低水平。

Sir Keir's solution was simple: build more homes. His government set a target that 300,000 homes a year would be built in England—housing policy is devolved to the nations—over its five-year term. He introduced welcome reforms, including a tweak to mandatory housing targets and a change in the rules to give a presumption in favour of development around well-connected railway stations. But some of these reforms won't be implemented until later this year at the earliest and they are in any case not sufficient. By our

calculations, the number of homes added to the stock fell from 222,000 in the year to June 2024, when Sir Keir came to power, to 208,000 in the year to March 2026.

凯尔爵士的解决方案很简单：建造更多的住宅。他的政府设定了目标，即在他的五年任期内，每年在英格兰建造 30 万套住宅。他提出了一些令人欣慰的改革措施，包括调整强制性的住房目标，以及修改规则，以优先考虑在交通便利的火车站周边进行开发。不过，这些改革中的某些内容至少要到今年晚些时候才能实施，而且这些改革本身也远远不够。根据我们的计算，自凯尔爵士上台以来，到 2024 年 6 月，英格兰的住宅数量从 22.2 万套下降到了 20.8 万套。

The biggest reason is that, while the government freed one hand from planning restrictions, it tied down the other. A slew of fresh taxes and regulations—from a building-safety levy to new climate standards—have added to the cost and complexity of construction. Add to that an increase in the price of labour and materials, and the Home Builders Federation, a lobby group, estimates that construction costs for a typical home have risen by £76,000 over the past five years (equivalent to 20% of the average sale price), causing a “viability crunch”. A new rule requiring second staircases in buildings over seven storeys is halting the construction of new-build flats, particularly in London. Construction began on just 7,500 private homes in the capital last year, against a target of 88,000.

最主要的原因是，虽然政府解除了一些规划限制，但却又增加了其他方面的负担。一系列新的税收和法规——从建筑安全税到新的气候标准——使得建筑成本变得更加高昂且复杂。此外，劳动力和材料的价格也有所上涨。据建筑行业协会估计，过去五年中，普通住宅的建设成本增加了 76,000 英镑（相当于平均售价的 20%），这导致了项目的可行性受到挑战。新的规定要求超过七层的建筑必须配备第二层楼梯，这阻碍了新公寓项目的建设，尤其是在伦敦。去年，伦敦只有 7,500 套私人住宅开工建设，而原本的目标是建造 88,000 套。

A nation of homebuilders

一个以住宅建设为主的国家

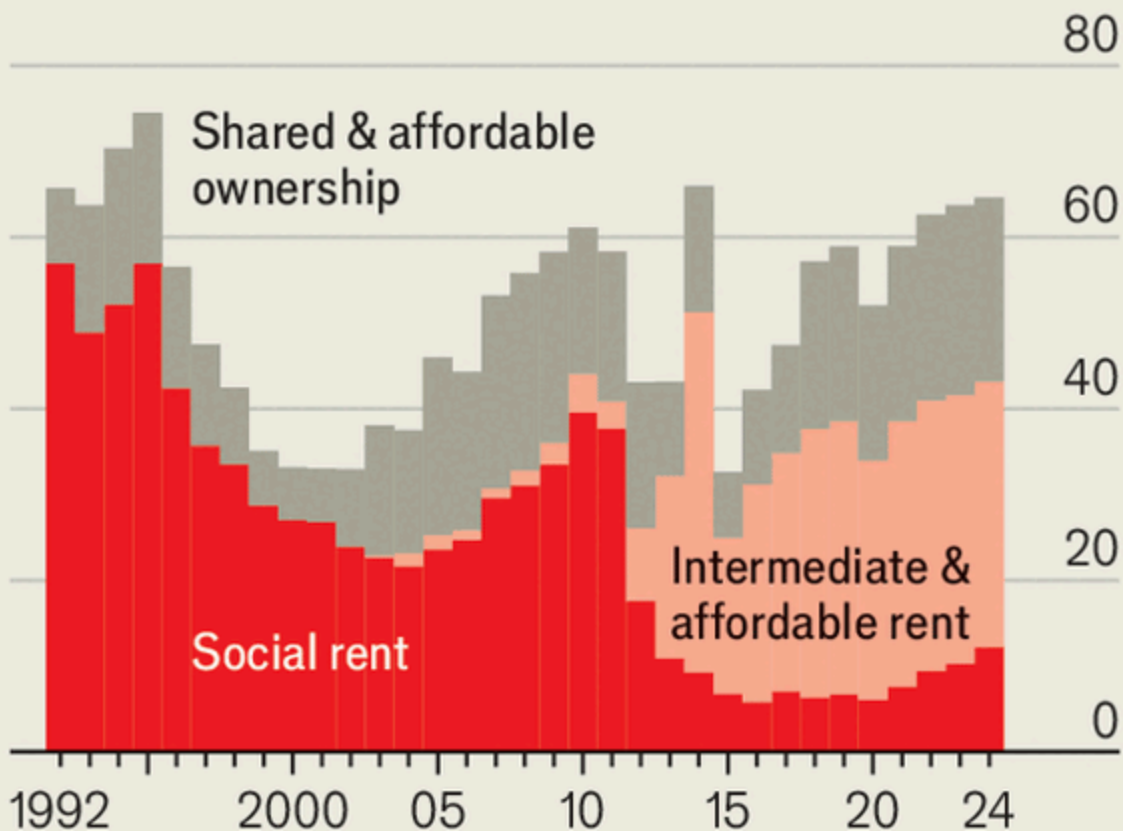
If Mr Burnham is serious about building more homes, further planning reforms and regulatory changes would be the easiest and cheapest way to do so. He should also look at the [inefficient allocation of existing council homes](#). Attempting to build more council homes is a far inferior solution. The first problem is funding. The government has allocated £39bn over the next decade to build 300,000 affordable homes, including 18,000 social-rent homes, each year. The National Housing Federation, another industry lobby, reckons it costs £183,000 on average to build a social-rent home. If Mr Burnham earmarked all the current funds, perhaps 21,000 social-rent homes a year could be built. That suggests raising output to 75,000 homes a year would cost the government an extra £10bn annually (equivalent to more than a penny on every rate of income tax).

如果伯纳姆先生真的想建造更多的住宅，那么进一步的规划改革和监管调整将是实现这一目标最简单且最经济的方式。他还应该考虑如何更有效地分配现有的公共住房资源。试图建造更多的公共住房显然是一个糟糕的解决方案。首先的问题是资金问题。政府计划在未来十年内拨款 390 亿英镑来建造 30 万套经济适用房，其中包括 18,000 套廉租房。全国住房联合会这个行业组织认为，建造一套廉租房的平均成本约为 183,000 英镑。如果伯纳姆先生将所有现有资金用于此目的，那么每年或许可以建造 21,000 套廉租房。这意味着，将建造数量增加到每年 75,000 套住房的话，政府每年需要额外投入 10 亿英镑（相当于每收入超过 1 英镑的人需要多缴纳 1 便士的税收）。

All mixed up

England, “affordable” houses built, '000

By tenure



Source: Ministry of Housing, Communities and Local Government

Finding such sums will be difficult given the pressures on spending. Another option would be to increase the share of homes that developers are required to set aside for affordable tenures in return for planning permission for private projects. Developers complain that these obligations—amounting to 15% of homes, on average—slow the building process and impair viability. Sir Sadiq Khan, London’s Labour mayor and a social-housing enthusiast, reluctantly reduced the obligations in the capital from 35% to 20% to unlock

stalled schemes.

在支出压力如此大的情况下，要找到这样的资金供应将会非常困难。另一个办法是要求开发商在规划许可下，必须预留一定比例的建筑物用于提供经济适用房，以换取私人项目的建设许可。开发商抱怨说，这些义务平均占建筑项目的 15%，这大大阻碍了建筑进程，并影响了项目的可行性。伦敦的工党市长萨迪克·汗是一位热衷于社会住房政策的人士，他不得不将首都的这项要求从 35%降低到 20%，以推动那些停滞不前的项目。

Mr Burnham has said that he can reduce the costs of his ambitious plans by making use of “vacant public land”. That seems fanciful. The 2015 Conservative government tried something similar, with a target of building 160,000 homes over five years on public land. In practice, the state had little understanding about the land it held and much of it required expensive remediation. Only a fraction of the target was reached before being quietly dropped.

伯纳姆先生声称，他可以通过利用“闲置的公共土地”来降低其宏伟计划的成本。不过这听起来似乎有些不切实际。2015 年的保守党政府也尝试过类似的做法，计划在五年内利用公共土地建造 16 万套住房。但实际上，政府对于所拥有的土地了解甚少，许多土地需要进行昂贵的修复工作。最终，这一计划只实现了目标的一小部分，之后便被悄然放弃了。

And then there are concerns about whether local authorities can even deliver all these houses. They have not built at scale since the 1970s and no longer employ the armies of architects and structural engineers to do so. Outsourcing that expertise is likely to be expensive and hiring their own experts will take councils time, which Mr Burnham does not have.

此外，人们还担心当地政府是否能够真正建造出所有这些房屋。自 20 世纪 70 年代以来，当地政府就再也没有大规模进行房屋建设了，而且现在也不再雇佣大量的建筑师和结构工程师来从事这项工作了。将

这些专业人才外包可能会成本很高，而自行招聘专家则会让地方政府花费大量时间，而伯纳姆先生并没有那么多时间可供分配。

The most defensible part of his ambitious council-housing push concerns the loss of the existing stock. In 1980 Thatcher gave tenants the “right to buy” their homes at a generous discount; and nearly 2m have since been sold on the cheap. The current government already intends to make the discounts less generous (capping them at 15%). Mr Burnham, who laments the sale of council housing, will probably push this policy through.

他雄心勃勃的廉租房计划中最有道理的部分在于解决现有公房的问题。1980 年，撒切尔夫人为租户提供了“购买权”，并以优惠价格出售了一定数量的房屋；从那时起，已有近 20 万套公房以低价出售给租户。现任政府打算将这种优惠幅度降低至 15%。而伯纳姆先生虽然对出售公房表示遗憾，但很可能还是会推动这一政策的实施。

But when it comes to building new homes, he needs only to look north to see the fruits that a housebuilding programme led by the private sector can bring. Under his watch as mayor of Greater Manchester housing supply increased by 61% over nine years thanks to better local co-ordination, a pragmatic approach to high-rise building and not burdening the private sector with excessive affordable-housing obligations. Indeed Sir Richard Leese, the former leader of the city council, said in 2021 that if the council had tried to impose such requirements, “It would have delivered no housing at all, zero.” If Mr Burnham wants to solve the housing crisis he should practise Manchesterism.■

不过，当涉及到新建住宅时，他只需向北看一眼，就能看到由私营部门主导的住宅建设计划所能带来的成果。在他的领导下，大曼彻斯特市的住房供应在九年内增加了 61%，这得益于更有效的地方协调、对高层建筑的务实规划，以及避免给私营部门带来过重的经济适用房负担。实际上，前市议会议长理查德·利塞爵士在 2021 年表示，如果市议会试图强制执行这些要求，那么“根本不会产生任何住房，零住房都

算不上。”如果伯纳姆先生想要解决住房危机，他应该借鉴曼彻斯特的做法。

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The rent is too damn low

租金实在是太低了

Britain's social housing subsidises the wrong people

英国的社会住房政策补贴了那些并不应该获得帮助的人。

And is bad for growth

这对经济增长不利。

Jul 09, 2026 10:14 PM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 晚上 10:14



LOOK FOR a house on HomeSwapper, a property-comparison website, and the deals seem too good to be true. Three-bed houses in leafy London postcodes are being rented for less than £800 (\$1070) a month; on other sites similar properties go for well over three times that. Try to put in an offer, though, and you will probably be blocked. HomeSwapper is a service that lets existing social-housing tenants swap their homes. Anybody living in the private sector doesn't get a look-in.

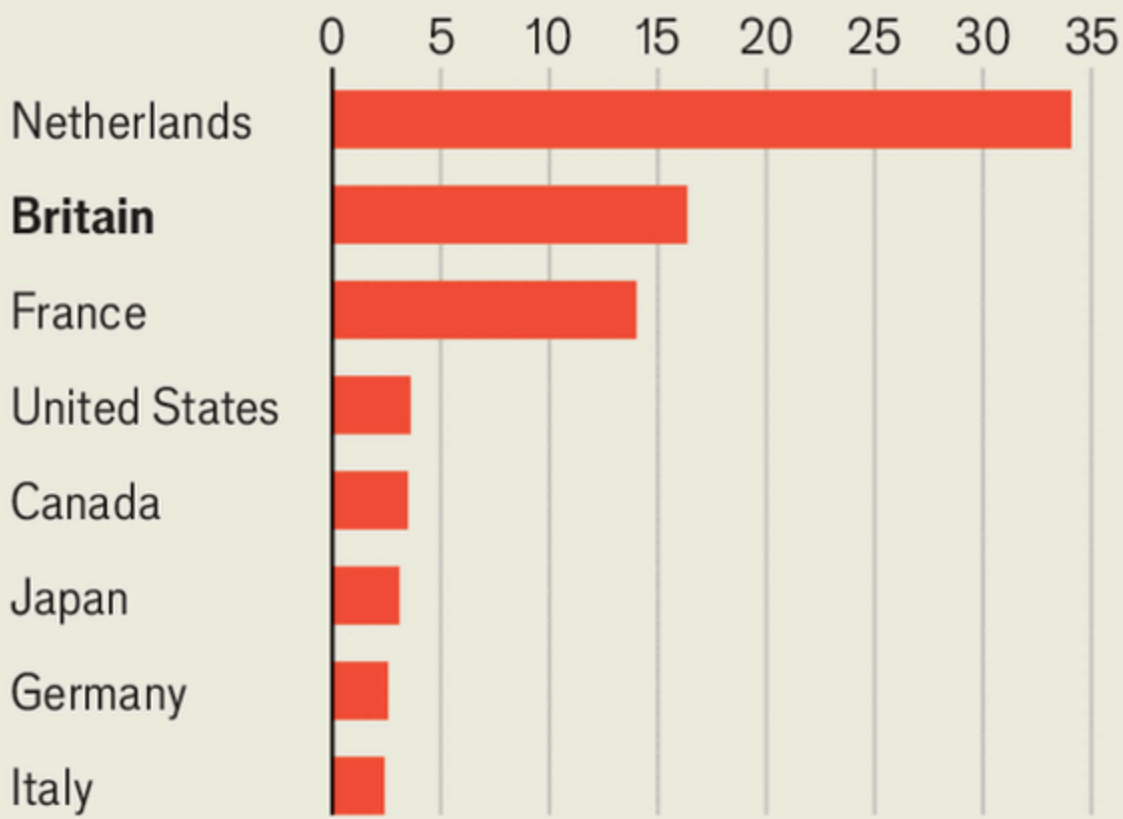
可以在房产比较网站 HomeSwapper 上寻找合适的房子。那些位于伦敦闹市区、拥有三间卧室的房子，每月租金却不到 800 英镑（1070 美元）。而在其他网站上，类似的房产价格往往是其三倍以上。不过，尽管可以尝试提交报价，但很可能被拒绝。HomeSwapper 是一项让现有社会住房租户交换房子的服务。而那些生活在私人部门的人则不会被考虑。

Land of hope and subsidy

1

Social housing as % of total housing stock

Selected countries, 2018-22



Source: OECD

Many private-sector renters, used to handing over a third of their pre-tax income to landlords, look enviously at social-housing residents. These homes are owned by local councils or charities and let at sub-market rates. Although England already has one of the highest levels of social housing in Europe (see chart 1), over 1.3m households are on waiting lists for a social home. Andy Burnham is clamouring to build more. The probable next prime minister has made a [major council-house building programme](#) a cornerstone of

his platform.

许多私营部门的租户过去需要将税前收入的三分之一交给房东，现在他们羡慕那些住在社会住房中的居民。这些住房由当地议会或慈善机构拥有，并以低于市场水平的租金出租。虽然英格兰的社会住房比例在欧洲处于较高水平（参见图表 1），但仍有超过 13 万户家庭处于社会住房的等待名单中。安迪·伯纳姆呼吁建造更多的社会住房。这位可能的下一任首相将建造大量市政住房作为自己竞选纲领的核心内容。

One problem with his plan is that it would be expensive: we estimate it could cost as much as £10bn a year. The other is that it keeps intact England's broken system of housing support, which rests on two overlapping subsidies. Social housing gives over 4m households (16% of the total) discounted rents. Means-tested benefits meanwhile provide cash to those on low incomes or out of work, to cover some or all rent. Two-thirds of social-housing tenants draw on both, using the cash to shrink their rent further. In addition, more than 1m households in private accommodation (24% of all private renters) get cash alone.

他的计划存在一个问题，那就是成本很高：我们估计每年所需的成本可能达到 100 亿英镑。另一个问题是，该计划会维持英格兰现有的混乱的住房支持体系，而这个体系依赖于两种相互重叠的补贴机制。社会住房为 400 万户家庭提供折扣租金，而基于经济状况的福利则向低收入者或失业者提供现金援助，以支付部分或全部租金。三分之二的社会住房租户同时享受这两种补贴，并利用这些现金进一步降低租金。此外，还有超过 100 万户私人住房的住户仅获得现金援助。

Rich social-housing tenants win from this messy system. Applicants for social housing tend to be hard-up. But they mostly get lifetime tenancies, and fortunes can improve. The unemployed teenage mum can become a well-paid empty-nester, yet her rent stays cut-price. In some cases her children would be able to inherit the tenancy. Eleven per cent of all social homes are lived in by the country's richest 40%. Around 1.4m tenants don't claim housing-related benefits, often

because they are too rich to pass the means test. The media periodically work themselves into a fury about extreme cases, from union barons on six-figure salaries to Sierra Leone's first lady.

那些拥有丰厚收入的社会住房租户从这一混乱的体系中获益。申请社会住房的人往往处于经济困境之中。不过，他们通常可以获得终身租赁权，经济状况也会随之改善。那个失业的年轻母亲能够成为一位收入丰厚的空巢家庭主妇，而她的租金却仍然保持在较低水平。在某些情况下，她的孩子甚至有可能继承这份租赁权。在所有社会住房中，有 11% 的住房是由最富有的 40% 人群居住的。大约 14 万租户没有申请与住房相关的福利，因为他们太富有，不符合福利申请的资格标准。媒体经常报道一些极端案例，从那些拿着六位数的工资的工会领袖，到塞拉利昂的首席夫人。

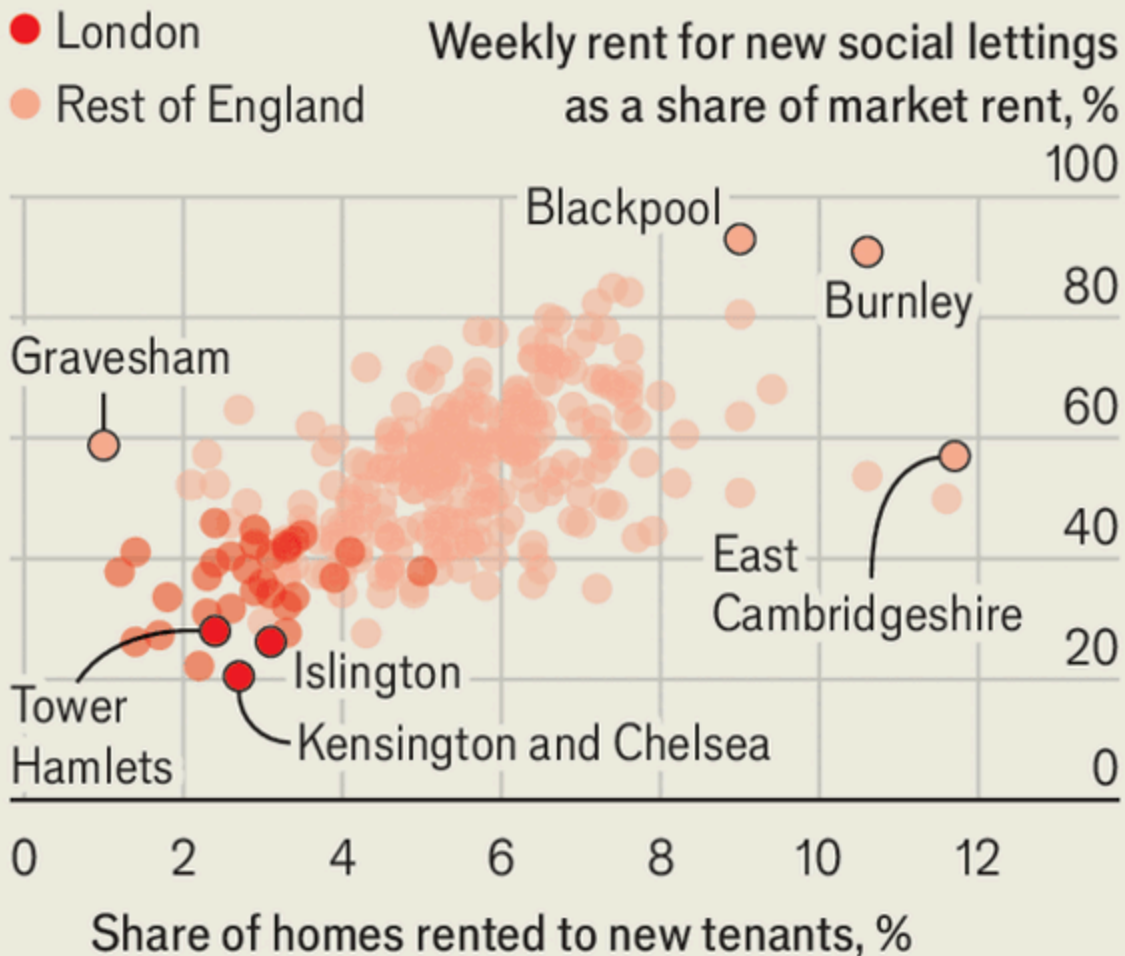
Social rents across England are typically 50% of market rent, but in London the discounts are steeper. Newly let social houses in Kensington and Chelsea went for 21% of market rent in 2024-25 (a £32,000-a-year saving). A crude calculation comparing average social and private rents suggests that the government in effect subsidises English social-housing tenants by as much as £20bn a year. This probably overstates the true cost, since social-housing stock tends to be less desirable than equivalent private properties. Yet it shows the spending to be far from small change.

在英格兰，社会住房的租金通常占市场租金的 50%，但在伦敦，这一折扣幅度更为明显。例如，2024-25 年度，肯辛顿和切尔西地区新交付的社会住房租金仅为市场租金的 21%（相当于每年节省 32,000 英镑）。粗略计算表明，政府实际上每年通过补贴，让英格兰的社会住房租户获得高达 200 亿英镑的优惠。不过，这一数字可能高估了实际成本，因为社会住房的吸引力通常不如相应的私人房产。不过，这一开支显然不是小钱。

Postcode lottery

2

England, social housing by local authority 2024-25



Source: Ministry for Housing, Communities and Local Government

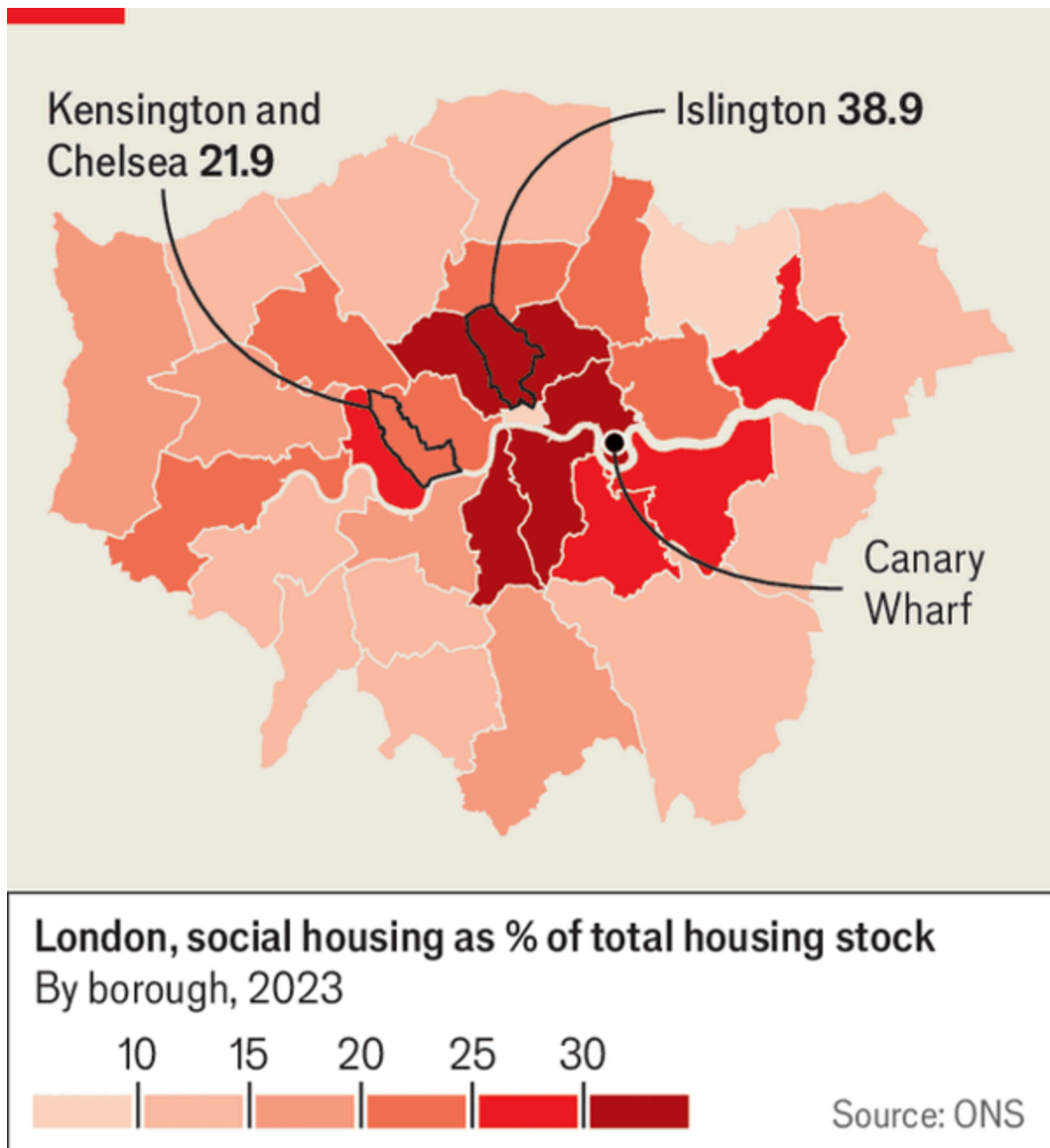
When the Conservative government tried to charge market rents to high-earning tenants in 2015, it backed down in the face of furious objections. But the counter-arguments were weak. Some tenants claimed they weren't subsidised because their rent more than covered their property's maintenance costs. However, this ignores the opportunity cost. The government owns an asset for which it

could charge significantly higher rates and use the extra money on more deserving causes, like tackling homelessness.

在 2015 年，保守党政府试图向高收入租户收取市场租金时，由于遭到强烈反对，最终不得不让步。不过，他们的反驳理由并不充分。一些租户声称自己并没有得到补贴，因为他们的租金已经足以支付房产的维护费用。然而，这种看法忽略了机会成本的问题。政府拥有这些资产，完全有理由收取更高的租金，并将多余的资金用于更有意义的事业，比如解决无家可归问题。

Others worried that driving better-off tenants away would turn social housing into ghettos. Yet the proposal was never to evict anyone, just to charge market rates. True, a sharp rent increase would be difficult for tenants to navigate and should be phased in slowly. Again the opportunity cost is significant. Housing benefits for private renters are particularly stingy. In some areas, allowances cover the full rent in fewer than 5% of local properties, forcing tenants to skimp on food or heating. Prioritising subsidies for wealthy social tenants over that group makes no sense.

有些人担心，将条件较好的租户赶走会让社会住房变成贫民窟。然而，该提案的本质并不是驱逐任何人，而是对租户收取市场价租金。当然，突然提高租金会让租户难以应对，因此应该逐步实施。此外，这种做法还会带来巨大的机会成本。对于私人租户来说，住房补贴实在太少了。在某些地区，只有不到 5% 的当地房产能够获得足够的补贴，这迫使租户在食物和取暖方面做出牺牲。将补贴优先分配给富裕的社会租户，显然是不合理的。



The system is also bad for growth. The subsidies are so big that they stop people moving for better-paid jobs elsewhere. Others are incentivised to cling to homes in city centres despite not working (over half of social-housing residents don't work). The problem is acute in London, where the turnover of social housing is particularly low (around 3% a year), partly because the subsidies there are so high. With social housing making up nearly 40% of the stock in inner

boroughs like Islington (see map), the result is a serious misallocation of the capital's housing.

这个系统也不利于经济增长。补贴过高，以至于人们不愿意去其他地方寻找更高收入的工作。此外，许多人即使不工作，也仍然愿意留在城市中心的老房子中。这种情况在伦敦尤为严重，因为伦敦的社会住房更新速度非常慢，每年只有大约 3% 的住房得到更新。部分原因是那里的补贴水平过高。在伊灵顿这样的内城区，社会住房占住房总面积的近 40%，这种严重的住房分配不均现象使得首都的住房资源没有得到有效利用。

Mr Burnham claims that new council homes will cut the benefits bill. But this holds only if they go to people on benefits who would otherwise be privately renting or homeless and in emergency shelter. Fewer than half of new social-housing tenants fitted that description in 2024-25. A quarter were previously living with friends and family. Housing them might be kind (living with one's parents can be painful), but if it creates a fresh benefits claim, it will cost the exchequer more, not less.

伯纳姆先生声称，新的市政住房将会减少政府的福利支出。不过，这一说法只有在那些原本需要领取福利金却无法自己租房或处于无家可归状态的人身上才成立。在 2024-25 年度，符合这一条件的新社会住房租户不到一半。而其中四分之一的人之前是和亲友一起生活的。虽然让这些人住在一起可能看起来很体贴（和父母住可能会带来一些不便），但如果这样做会导致新的福利支出，那么政府将会花费更多的资金，而不是减少开支。

Britain's system of housing subsidies is like a leaky pipe, spraying cash out to those who don't need it. Rather than turning up the pressure with new council homes, Mr Burnham should fix the holes.

■

英国的住房补贴制度就像一根漏气的管道，把资金浪费给了那些并不需要帮助的人。伯纳姆先生不应该通过建造新的公共住房来增加压力，而应该解决这些漏洞问题。

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A hot topic

一个热门话题

Why Britons now trust weather forecasters

为什么英国人现在会信任天气预报员呢？

Credit greater accuracy and better communication

提升了精准度，增强了沟通效果

Jul 09, 2026 05:57 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:57



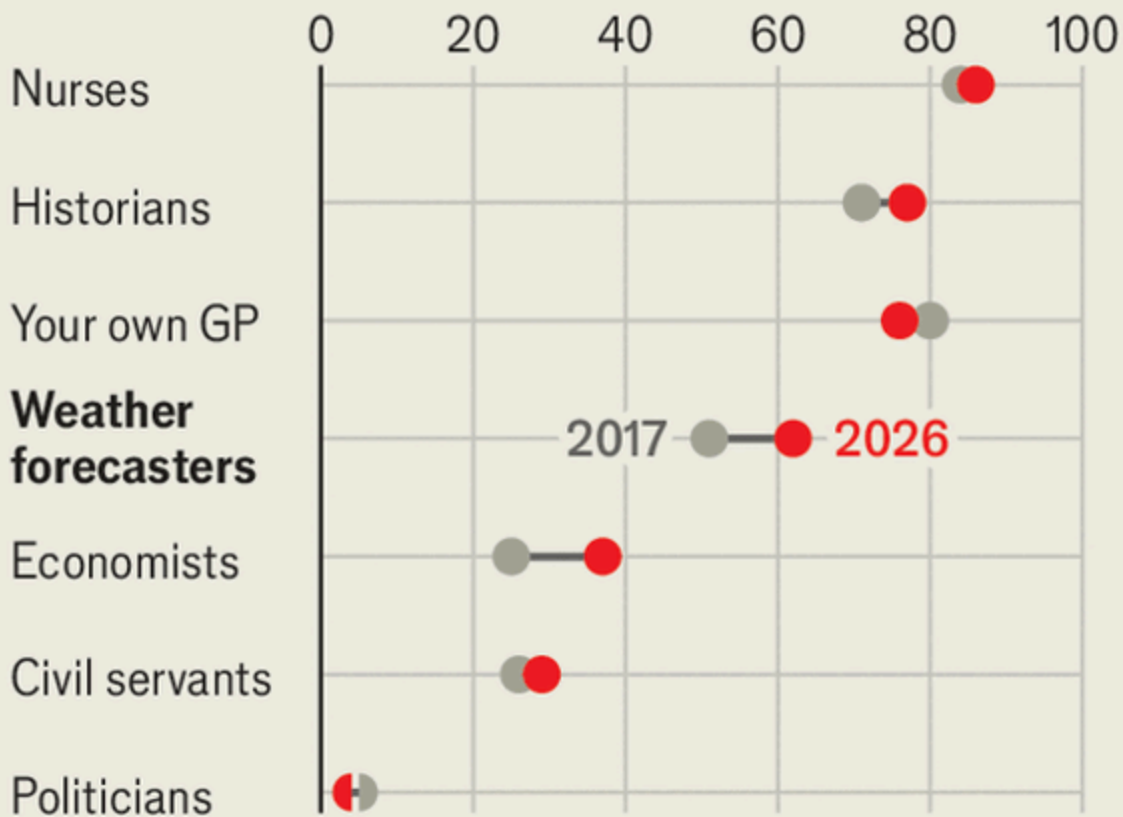
CHATTING ABOUT the weather is a national pastime in Britain—and successive heatwaves have recently given Britons lots to discuss. In the past, the obsession did not translate into faith in weather forecasters. Memories lingered of the “great storm” of 1987, a deadly cyclone. The BBC’s best-known forecaster, Michael Fish (pictured), said on air that a woman had called in worrying there might be a “hurricane” approaching Britain. “If you’re watching, don’t worry, there isn’t!” he quipped. Hours later the storm struck.

在英国，谈论天气是一种全国性的消遣活动——最近连续的热浪让英国人有了很多话题可以讨论。过去，人们并没有因为对天气预报的信任而盲目相信天气预报员的说法。人们还记得 1987 年的那场“大风暴”，那是一场致命的飓风。英国广播公司最著名的天气预报员迈克尔·菲什在节目中宣布，有一名女性打电话来担心英国可能即将遭遇“飓风”。他开玩笑说：“如果你在看电视，不用担心，实际上并没有飓风发生！”然而几小时后，风暴真的降临了。

Distinctly brighter...

“Whose opinions do you trust?”

Britain, % responding



Source: YouGov

YouGov, a pollster, found in 2017 that barely half of people trusted forecasters to give them accurate information about the weather. But that has changed. A recent YouGov survey finds that now 62% of Britons trust them and just 25% are sceptical—still far behind trust in nurses (86%), but well ahead of economists (37%), let alone politicians (a mere 4%). The change is partly because forecasts are more accurate than ever thanks to advances in technology, suggests Alex Deakin of the Met Office. It also helps that fewer people today

remember the 1987 storm.

民意调查机构 YouGov 在 2017 年的调查显示，几乎只有一半的人认为气象预报员能够准确提供天气信息。但这种情况已经发生了变化。根据 YouGov 最近的调查，现在 62% 的英国人信任气象预报员，而持怀疑态度的人仅占 25%——这一比例仍然远低于对护士的信任度（86%），但远远高于经济学家（37%），更不用说政客了（只有 4%）。Met Office 的 Alex Deakin 指出，这种变化部分是因为技术的进步使得天气预报比以往更加准确。此外，由于人们不再记得 1987 年的那场风暴，这也有助于提升人们对气象预报的信任。

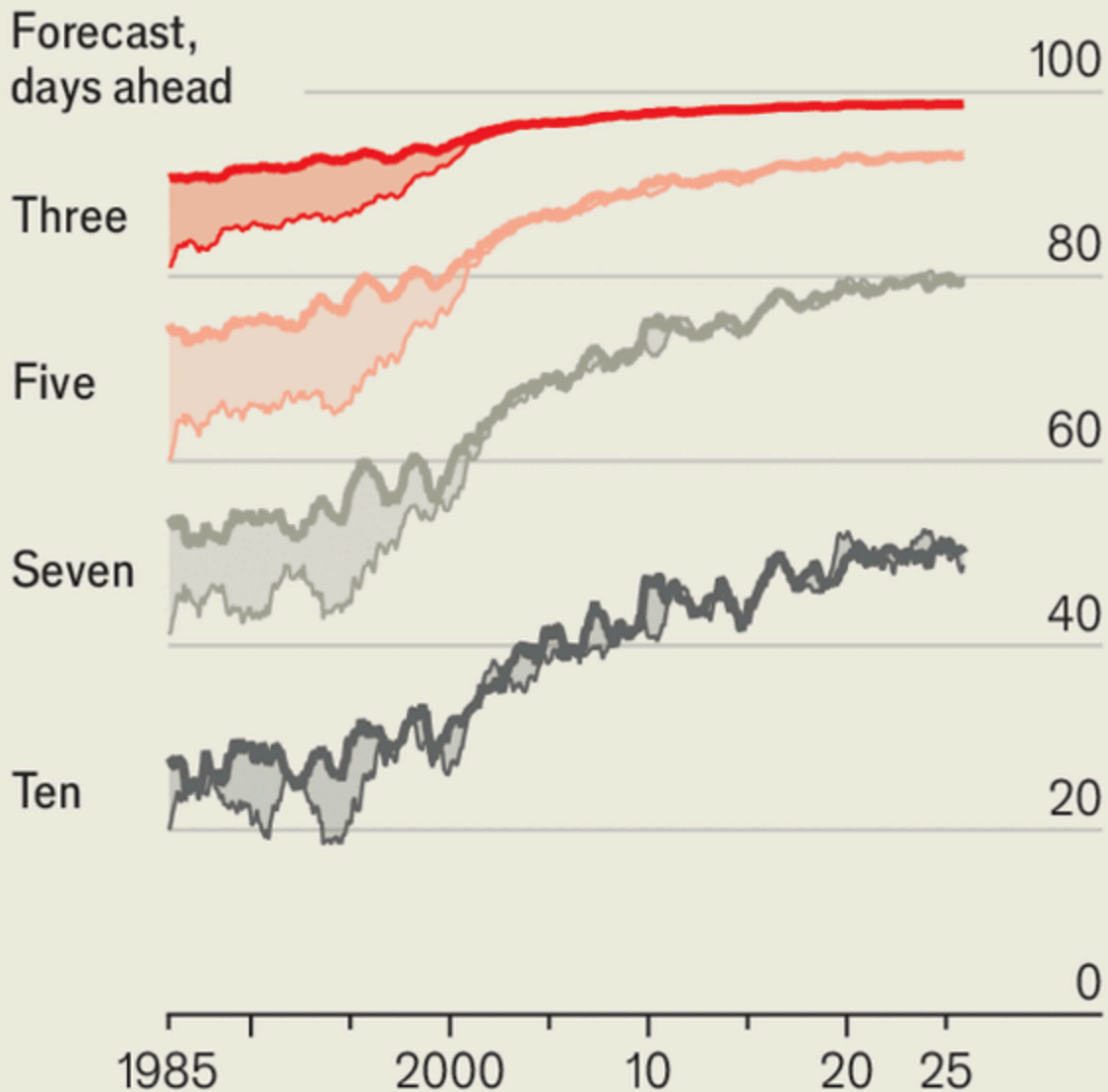
Indeed, that storm prompted investment in weather-forecasting tech and communications protocols. Liam Dutton, a weather presenter for Channel 4 News, says the model he relies on divides Britain into squares of 2km (1.2 miles) a side, whereas a decade ago the highest resolution possible was 12km. The average accuracy of a forecast four days into the future is comparable to that of a one-day forecast in the 1990s. Under-25s, who grew up in an era of reliable forecasts, are by a large margin most likely to trust forecasters.

事实上，那场风暴促使人们投资于天气预报技术和通信协议的发展。Channel 4 新闻台的天气预报主持人利亚姆·达顿表示，他所使用的模型将英国划分为边长为 2 公里（1.2 英里）的区域。而在十年前，当时最高精度的天气预报只能达到 12 公里。对未来四天天气预报的准确程度，已经可以与 20 世纪 90 年代的一日天气预报相媲美了。那些成长在可靠天气预报时代的人，他们更有可能信任天气预报员。

...and less cloudy

Weather-forecast accuracy*, air pressure, %

— Northern hemisphere — Southern hemisphere



*Model accuracy v observations

Source: European Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasts

Climate change has raised the stakes by causing more extreme, [sometimes life-threatening shocks](#) such as prolonged heatwaves and sudden heavy downpours. “Being more accurate when it comes to those extreme events builds trust,” says Mr Deakin (though climate change also makes forecasting trickier). Since 2015, following the practice in America since the 1950s, the Met Office has given names to the biggest storms. The most recent was Storm Dave, in April. The agency believes this has helped engage the public. There are also colour-coded warnings for heat. A [red alert in June](#) was Britain’s second, after one in 2022.

气候变化加剧了极端天气事件的风险，使得天气状况更加极端，有时甚至危及生命。德金先生说：“能够更准确地预测这些极端事件，有助于建立公众的信任。”自 2015 年以来，英国气象局开始为最严重的风暴命名。最近一次命名的是 4 月的风暴“戴夫”。该机构认为，这种做法有助于吸引公众的关注。此外，气象局还提供了彩色预警信息。6 月发布的红色预警是英国自 2022 年以来的第二次此类预警。

Though it is now easier to predict the British weather, dealing with it remains a challenge. Older houses are built to hoard heat in the chilly winter; regulations mean that even most new-build homes lack air conditioning. The government has at least started to offer grants for homeowners to install heat pumps that also have a cooling function, which had previously been excluded from the most popular subsidy scheme. Nonetheless, when the mercury passes 30°C most Britons will continue to lose their cool. ■

虽然现在预测英国的天气变得更加容易，但应对这种天气仍然是一个挑战。老式的房屋设计是为了在寒冷的冬季保存热量；而由于各种规定，即使是最新的住宅也往往没有空调系统。不过，政府至少已经开始提供补贴，鼓励房主安装兼具制冷功能的热泵设备，而这一功能在过去并不在常见的补贴政策范围内。尽管如此，当气温超过 30 摄氏度时，大多数英国人仍然会感到不适。■

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The Reform circus

改革马戏团

Nigel Farage's stunts made him a successful politician. They won't make him PM

尼杰尔·法阿吉的出色表现使他成为了一位成功的政治家。这些成就使他有资格担任总理一职。

The theatrics could point to Reform UK's weaknesses

这种戏剧性的表现可能揭示了 Reform UK 的弱点。

Jul 09, 2026 06:51 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:51



Comfort zone

舒适区

IN BRITAIN, YOU can pay £500 (\$670) to stand next to the prime minister on live TV. A humbling election-night tradition sees politicians line up on stage with fellow candidates as the votes in their constituency are read out. Plenty of publicity-seekers think the election deposit is a fair price to pay for a moment in the spotlight. In 2024 Sir Keir Starmer—for now still the prime minister—gave his acceptance speech flanked by a man dressed as Elmo, a furry red children’s-TV character.

在英国，人们可以支付 500 英镑（670 美元）的费用，在电视直播中站在首相旁边。在选举之夜，政客们通常会与其他候选人一起站在舞台上，同时宣读他们所在选区的投票结果。许多寻求关注的人认为，支付这笔费用来获得在聚光灯下的一刻是值得的。2024 年，现任首相基尔·斯塔默爵士在接受采访时，身边站着一个穿着埃尔莫服装的人——埃尔莫是著名的红色儿童电视角色。

Later this year Nigel Farage, the leader of the populist-right Reform UK party, will be treated to a particularly surreal election-night spectacle. No candidates for the major parties will stand against him

in the by-election he triggered with great fanfare on July 7th, by resigning as MP for Clacton in a televised address (he hopes to be re-elected). Instead, the man who aspires to become prime minister at the next general election will be surrounded by satirists and loonies. [Count Binface](#), whose real name is Jonathan Harvey, has already emerged as a leading challenger.

今年晚些时候，民粹主义右翼政党“改革英国”的领袖尼杰尔·法拉奇将经历一场极其荒诞的选举之夜。在 7 月 7 日他公开宣布辞职离开克拉克顿的议员职位后，主要政党没有任何候选人能够与他竞争这一补选。相反，那个渴望在下次大选中成为首相的人，将会被一群讽刺作家和疯子包围。真正的名字是乔纳森·哈维的班费斯已经成为了主要的挑战者之一。

The farce is befitting of the by-election. Mr Farage called it to set the cat among the pigeons while he faces scrutiny of his finances, including an investigation by Parliament's standards commissioner. The body is reviewing a £5m gift made to him by cryptocurrency billionaire Christopher Harborne. Mr Farage told viewers the by-election would be the "people versus the establishment". In reality, it is a squalid attempt to have the residents of Reform's safest constituency clear him of wrongdoing. Now it looks as though the joke might be on the rabble-rousing populist.

这场闹剧很适合这次补选。法拉吉先生试图在面临财务调查的情况下制造混乱，其中包括议会标准委员会的调查。该机构正在审查加密货币亿万富翁克里斯托弗·哈伯恩赠予他的 500 万英镑资金。法拉吉告诉观众，这次补选将是“民众与当权派之间的较量”。但实际上，这不过是一场试图让改革党的选民们摆脱他不当行为的拙劣尝试。看来，这种闹剧可能让那些鼓吹民粹主义的政客自己笑掉大牙吧。

The misstep is revealing. Mr Farage has built his career on political mischief-making. His stunts as a member of the European Parliament caught the attention of British voters in the 2000s. In the 2010s, they made him a household name, culminating in the Brexit referendum in 2016. His dramatic returns to politics in 2019 and

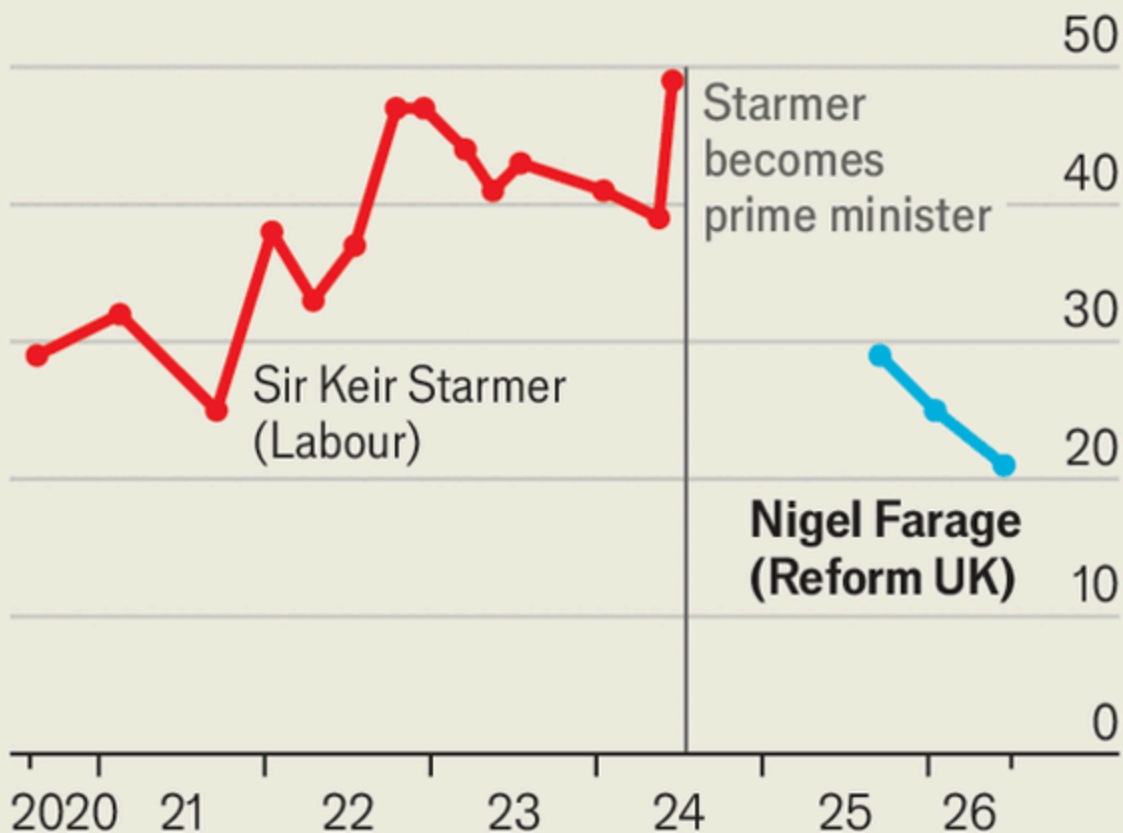
2024 allowed his new party, the Brexit Party (now Reform), to give the Conservatives a bloody nose. In these moments, he dominated British politics.

这一失误暴露了问题。法拉吉先生凭借搞政治闹剧的手段积累了自己的政治生涯。他在欧洲议会的表现 在 21 世纪初吸引了英国选民的注意。到了 2010 年代，他的名字已经家喻户晓，最终在 2016 年的英国脱欧公投中达到了顶峰。他在 2019 年和 2024 年的戏剧性重返政坛，使得他的新政党——脱欧党（现名为改革党）——能够给保守党以致命的一击。在这些时刻，他主导了英国政治舞台。

Half-baked?

1

Britain, opposition parties “are ready to form next government”, % agreeing



Source: Ipsos

The challenge facing Reform now is different. It has led opinion polls for more than a year and must transform from a loud insurgency into a credible alternative government—a tall order for a party with just eight MPs. After setting an artificial deadline of May 2026 for accepting defectors, fewer crossed the floor than Mr Farage might have hoped. Two, Robert Jenrick and Suella Braverman, were given official spokesperson roles, for the treasury and education, along with the party's deputy leader, Richard Tice (business, trade and energy), and its former chairman, Zia Yusuf (home affairs). But the

party still has no spokespeople on issues including defence, foreign policy, health and welfare.

改革党目前面临的挑战有所不同。这一运动已经持续了超过一年，改革党必须从一个声势浩大的抗议活动转变为一个可信的替代政府——对于一个只有八名议员的政党来说，这确实是一项艰巨的任务。在设定了 2026 年 5 月作为接纳叛逃者的最后期限之后，实际加入改革党的人数比法拉吉所期望的要少。罗伯特·詹里克和苏埃拉·布拉弗曼被任命为官方发言人，分别负责财政和教育事务；此外，该党的副领袖理查德·泰斯（负责商业、贸易和能源事务）以及前主席齐亚·尤苏夫（负责内政事务）也分别担任了这些职务。不过，该党在国防、外交政策、医疗保健以及福利等问题上的发言人仍然空缺。

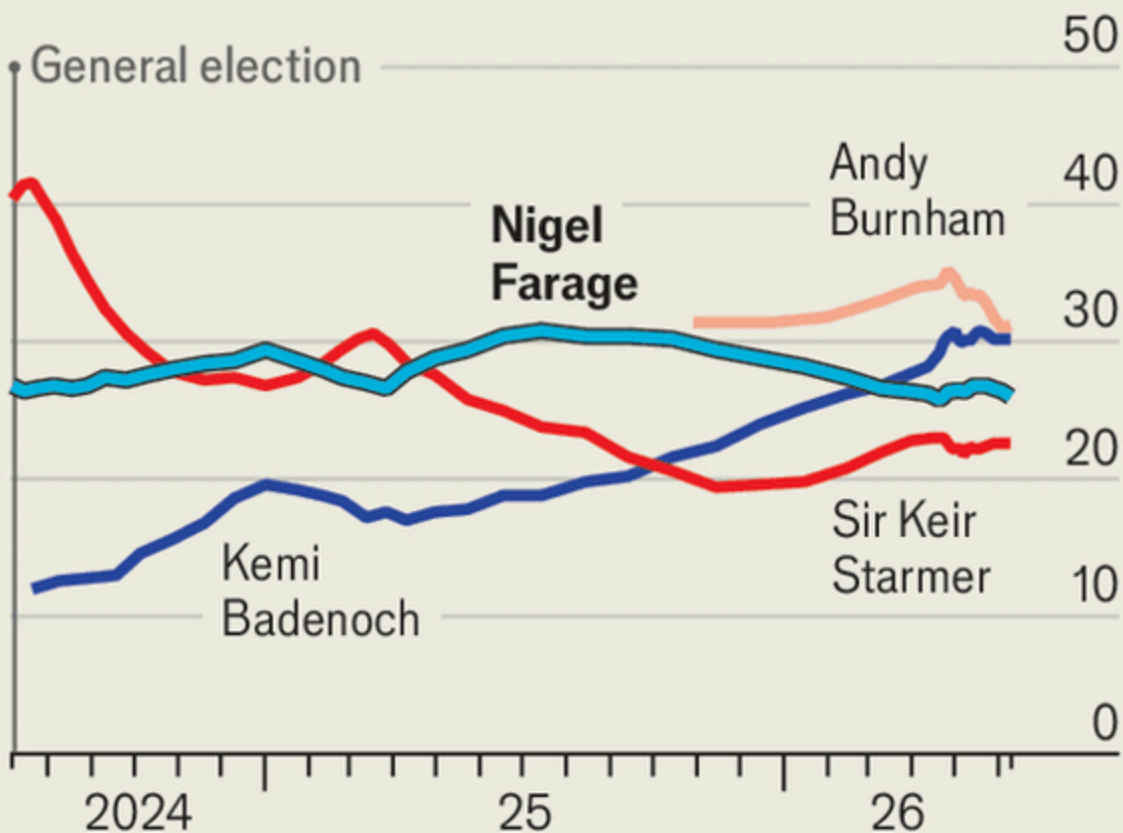
Neither does it seem as if the party is substantiating its policy platform. Though Mr Jenrick has rowed back on Reform's previous profligate tax-and-spend plans, the party has adopted unworkable proposals for mass deportations. It has offered little detail on policy for the National Health Service or Britain's armed forces. The public seems to have noticed. According to Ipsos, a polling firm, the share of Britons who say Reform is "ready to form the next government" has fallen from 29% in September 2025 to 21% in June 2026 (see chart 1).

看起来，该政党也没有能够充分阐述自己的政策主张。虽然詹里克先生已经收回了之前那些过于激进的减税计划，但该政党仍然提出了一些不可行的驱逐大规模移民的提案。关于国家医疗服务体系或英国武装部队的政策方面，该政党也几乎没有提供任何具体的方案。公众似乎已经注意到了这一点。根据民意调查公司 Ipsos 的数据，认为改革党“愿意组建下一届政府”的英国人比例从 2025 年 9 月的 29% 下降到了 2026 年 6 月的 21%（参见图表 1）。

Nothing special

2

Britain, "Do you have a favourable opinion of the following?", % responding favourable*



Source: YouGov

*Five-poll moving average

At the same time, Reform's political space has shrunk. In July 2025 around 30% of people had a favourable view of Mr Farage, according to YouGov, another pollster. That was far higher than of his rivals, Sir Keir and Kemi Badenoch, the leader of the Conservatives. Since then Mr Farage's rating has fallen to 25%; Ms Badenoch has experienced a surge, to 31%; and Labour has all but replaced Sir Keir with his presumed successor Andy Burnham, who is viewed favourably by 34% (see chart 2). Restore Britain, a new far-right party, has siphoned some voters from Reform's right.

Meanwhile the share of Britons saying immigration—the party’s *raison d’être*—is their top issue has fallen, perhaps owing to declining migration rates and a slight slowdown in small-boat arrivals across the channel.

与此同时，改革党的政治空间也缩小了。根据民意调查机构 YouGov 的数据，2025 年 7 月，大约 30% 的人对法拉吉先生持积极态度。这一比例远高于他的竞争对手——凯尔爵士和保守党领袖凯米·巴德诺赫。此后，法拉吉先生的支持率降至 25%；巴德诺赫则上升了 31%；而工党几乎取代了凯尔爵士的位置，其支持率达到了 34%（参见图表 2）。新成立的极右翼政党“恢复英国党”也吸引了一些改革党的选民。此外，认为移民问题是该党核心议题的英国人的比例有所下降，这可能是由于移民率下降以及跨大西洋移民数量略有减少所致。

That is not to say Reform has hit a ceiling. Plenty of voters hold views similar to Mr Farage’s and are dissatisfied with Labour and the Conservatives. His party continues to lead opinion polls and did well in the local elections in May. The political conditions for the populist right could improve, not least if Mr Burnham turns out to be a dud. But Mr Farage’s party has not expanded its appeal in the past year.

这并不是说改革党已经达到了极限。还有很多选民持有与法拉吉先生类似的观点，他们对工党和保守党感到不满。他的政党在民意调查中持续领先，在 5 月的地方选举中也表现良好。对于右翼民粹主义政党来说，政治局势可能会有所改善，尤其是如果伯纳姆先生最终证明自己是失败者。不过，法拉吉的政党在过去一年中并没有扩大其影响力。

Amid these challenges, a by-election in Clacton is not so much a show of defiance—as Mr Farage would portray it—as a retreat to his comfort zone. The populist leader would rather be pouring pints for a photo-op than poring over policy proposals. Playing ringmaster for the media circus comes more naturally than marshalling prospective ministers. There is every chance that Mr Farage wins Clacton (barring an unthinkable victory for Count Binface) while dashing his

chances of becoming prime minister at the same time.■

在这些挑战面前，克拉克顿的选举并非像法拉吉所描绘的那样是一种反抗的表现，而更像是一种回归到他熟悉的领域。这位民粹主义领袖更愿意为了拍照而喝啤酒，而不是仔细研究政策方案。对于他来说，充当媒体马戏团的演员比组织未来的部长们要更自然。很有可能法拉吉会在克拉克顿赢得胜利（除非宾法伯爵取得不可思议的胜利），同时也会失去成为总理的机会。

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Claude, MP

克劳德，国会议员

Is AI writing taking over Westminster?

人工智能写作是否会逐渐取代人类的写作方式呢？

Several influential policy papers are failing AI detectors

几份具有影响力的政策文件未能认可人工智能检测器的有效性

Jul 09, 2026 05:22 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:22



WHAT COMES to mind, reading these sentences? “The challenge is not technical but political, requiring careful sequencing, clear communication, and sustained commitment.” Or: “Private ownership is not rewarding innovation but collecting a toll on Victorian infrastructure while deferring the investment required to keep it functional. The technology has not changed. The ownership has—and the ownership is the problem.”

读到这些句子时，你会想到什么呢？“挑战并不在于技术层面，而在于政治层面。需要精心安排步骤、清晰传达信息，并且持续投入精力才能解决问题。”或者：“私有制虽然能激励创新，但却给维多利亚时代的基础设施带来了负担，同时也推迟了维护这些设施所需的投资。技术本身并没有改变，而改变的是所有权制度——而所有权制度正是问题所在。”

Boredom first, probably. Policy writing can be sandpaper-dry. But something else might stand out too, at least to anyone who often interacts with artificial-intelligence models like ChatGPT or Claude. Prose produced by those AI tools has a distinctive smell. One telltale whiff is a love of contrasts: “not technical but political”; “The technology has not changed. The ownership has”. Another is tricolons. Humans have long appreciated groups of three (Cicero studded his speeches with them), but AI’s enthusiasm is superhuman: “careful sequencing, clear communication, and sustained commitment”. And then there are the em-dashes—everywhere.

首先，可能是因为厌倦感吧。撰写政策文章的过程就像在砂纸上打磨一样枯燥乏味。不过，还有其他一些特点可能会显得特别突出，至少对于那些经常与 ChatGPT 或 Claude 这样的人工智能模型互动的人来说是这样。这些人工智能工具生成的文本有一种独特的风格。其中一个特点是喜欢使用三音节重复的结构：“非技术性的，但具有政治性”；又如：“技术本身没有变化，但所有权已经发生了改变。”另一个特点是大量使用三音节重复的结构。人类长期以来一直喜欢使用三音节重复的结构（西塞罗在他的演讲中经常使用这种结构），而人工智

能则表现出超人的热情：“谨慎的安排、清晰的沟通以及持续的承诺。”此外，还有无处不在的破折号。

Readers today can do better than guesswork and amateur stylometry, though. Over the past few years, AI detection technology has improved dramatically. These tools use similar machine-learning techniques to AI models. Pangram, a market leader, boasts of a 0.01% false-positive rate. A study by researchers at the University of Chicago found it had a “near-zero” error rate on longer texts.

如今的读者能够超越单纯的猜测和业余式的统计方法。在过去几年中，人工智能检测技术取得了显著的进步。这些工具采用了与人工智能模型类似的机器学习技术。Pangram 作为市场领导者，其误报率仅为 0.01%。芝加哥大学的研究人员进行的实验表明，该工具在处理较长的文本时，其错误率几乎为零。

Pangram flags each of the policy papers those quotes came from as being mostly written by AI. One was by Louise Haigh, an MP and close adviser to Andy Burnham, Britain’s prime-minister-in-waiting. The other was “The Productive State”, a manifesto of nearly 70 pages published by Mainstream, a Labour group linked to Mr Burnham; it offers a “Framework for Manchesterism”, Mr Burnham’s still-loosely-defined economic programme. Ms Haigh said, in a statement to the *Telegraph*, that AI was used for “version control”. Mainstream told *The Economist* that one co-author used Claude to “expose line-level differences and unify the voice of both authors’ independently drafted sections through copy editing”.

这些报道中引用的每份政策文件，都被指出主要由人工智能编写而成。其中一份文件是由路易丝·海格撰写的，她是英国首相安迪·伯纳姆的亲密顾问兼议员。另一份文件是《生产型国家》——这是一份长达近 70 页的宣言，由与伯纳姆有联系的工党团体“主流”组织发布。该文件提出了伯纳姆所提出的“曼彻斯特主义”经济计划。海格在给《telegraph》杂志的声明中表示，人工智能被用于“版本控制”方面。而“主流”组织则向《经济学人》透露，该文件的另一位作者使用人工智

能来“揭示各章节之间的差异，并通过文字编辑的方式统一了两位作者各自独立撰写的章节的语气。”

That raises two questions. Is this AI writing a problem? And why the links to Mr Burnham? Start with the first. Politics is full of prose not written by the apparent author: politicians have speechwriters, intellectuals employ research assistants. Perhaps AI is no different, even if the prose is clunkier. But people setting out ideas in politics are asking for something quite audacious: to reshape how a country is governed around what they think. Any writer knows how much putting words on a page can tighten one's arguments. Even subcontracting that to an aide beats skipping the (sometimes painful) process entirely. AI certainly produces sloppy prose, but it also papers over sloppy thinking.

这引出了两个问题：这种人工智能生成的文字是否构成了问题？另外，为什么还要引用伯纳姆先生的观点呢？先来回答第一个问题。政治领域充满了并非由作者亲自撰写的文字——政客们有演讲撰稿人，知识分子则依赖研究助理来协助工作。或许人工智能也是如此，尽管它生成的文字看起来不够流畅。但在政治领域，那些提出新观点的人其实是在尝试一种大胆的做法：根据他们的想法来重新塑造一个国家的治理方式。任何作家都明白，把文字写下来会让人们的论点变得更加严谨。即使将这项任务外包给助手来完成，也比完全跳过这个（有时很繁琐）的过程要好得多。当然，人工智能生成的文字可能不够精炼，但它至少能掩盖那些不成熟的思考。

Maybe that matters less if, as Ms Haigh and the “Productive State” authors say, AI is used only for a late polish. The trouble is that readers can detect whether AI wrote the final product, but not how authors used it. And when AI's involvement is disclosed only after the press come knocking, trust takes some earning back.

或许，如果像海伊女士和《productive state》的作者们所说的那样，人工智能只是用于最后的润色工作，那么这一点就变得不那么重要了。不过，读者可以判断出最终的作品是否是由人工智能生成的，但

却无法知道作者是如何使用人工智能的。而当人工智能的参与情况在出版后才被揭露时，人们的信任就会大打折扣。

What about the potential Burnham factor? Mr Burnham's coup was plotted slowly, but executed quickly. From the moment he won the Makerfield by-election, he was all but guaranteed to end up in Number 10. Yet he is still vague on many of the big questions facing Britain. That mismatch offers political entrepreneurs a chance to try to shape the wet clay of Burnhamism around their own priorities. The currency of ideas in Westminster is PDFs, ideally long ones. And when you need one quickly, who better to turn to than Claude?■

那么，伯纳姆的潜在影响又该如何看待呢？伯纳姆先生的政变虽然策划得相当缓慢，但执行起来却非常迅速。从他赢得梅克菲尔德补选的那一刻起，他几乎可以肯定能登上首相之位。然而，他对英国面临的许多重大问题仍然含糊其辞。这种不匹配为政治人物提供了机会，让他们能够按照自己的优先事项来塑造伯纳姆主义这一理念。在威斯敏斯特，人们更青睐以 PDF 格式呈现的思想，最好是那些篇幅较长的文件。而当你需要快速获取某种信息时，谁比克劳德更合适呢？■

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Tubby troglodytidae

胖乎乎的洞穴居民科

Some Scottish wrens are a striking case of “island syndrome”

一些苏格兰雷鸟就表现出典型的“岛屿综合征”症状。

They have got much bigger than their mainland cousins
它们比大陆上的同类要大得多。

Jul 09, 2026 06:30 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:30



ANIMALS LIVING on islands can develop strange characteristics. (Just look at the British.) Isolated, safe from mainland predators and facing less competition for resources, island-dwellers often evolve differently from mainland relatives. Some develop “island syndromes”. For example, small animals get bigger and big animals get smaller. The dodo of Mauritius evolved from the size of a pigeon to that of a large turkey, losing the use of its wings along the way.

生活在岛屿上的动物可能会发展出一些奇特的特征。（想想英国的鸟类吧。）由于远离大陆，免受大陆捕食者的威胁，且资源竞争较少，岛上的动物往往会与大陆上的同类有所不同。有些动物会呈现出“岛屿综合征”的特征。例如，小型动物会变得更大，而大型动物则会变得更小。毛里求斯的渡渡鸟就从鸽子大小逐渐进化到像大型火鸡那么大，同时翅膀的功能也逐渐消失了。

Some wrens in Scotland have developed the syndrome. Cut off from mainland Britain for thousands of years, two subspecies on St Kilda and Shetland, a pair of archipelagoes, have evolved to be much larger than mainland wrens, says a recent paper in the *Evolutionary*

Journal of the Linnean Society.

在苏格兰的一些地区，有一些鹈鹕种群出现了这种变异现象。根据《林奈学会进化杂志》上的一篇论文，由于与英国大陆隔绝了数千年，位于圣基尔达岛和设得兰群岛上的两个亚种逐渐演化成了比大陆上的鹈鹕体型要大得多的物种。

Researchers set mist nets beside speakers playing recordings of wren song across Shetland, Fair Isle, the Outer Hebrides and St Kilda—a method to lure birds out of cover. “Catching them was a nightmare,” says Michal Jezierski, the paper’s lead author. Wrens are so territorial that when song played, the birds simply sang back, refusing to budge. Still, the team caught 45 wrens, enough to study systematically. Using data of historical specimens from the National Museums Scotland, and body-mass records from the British Trust for Ornithology, they compared the island wrens with their mainland relatives—and with 695 other island-mainland bird pairs.

研究人员在播放了石尔特兰群岛、费尔岛、外赫布里德群岛以及圣基尔达群岛上的鹈鹕鸟歌声的扬声器旁边设置了雾网，以此来将鸟类从藏身之处引出来。“捕捉它们简直是一场噩梦，”论文的主要作者米哈尔·杰齐尔斯基说。鹈鹕鸟非常具有领地意识，当播放歌声时，它们只会回应歌声，而不会移动位置。尽管如此，研究团队还是成功捕捉到了 45 只鹈鹕鸟，这些样本足以进行系统的研究。他们利用苏格兰国家博物馆保存的历史标本数据，以及英国鸟类学信托基金提供的体重数据，将岛上的鹈鹕鸟与大陆上的同类进行了比较——同时还比较了其他 695 对岛屿与大陆之间的鸟类。

Fair Isle wrens were a similar size to mainland ones, and those on the Outer Hebrides were a tad larger. But St Kilda and Shetland wrens were gigantic: the largest was twice as heavy as the smallest mainland wren. They are in the top 25% most extreme cases of “island gigantism” recorded, much like New Zealand’s kakapo, the world’s heaviest parrot. They also had distinctive songs.

费尔岛鹈鹕鸟的大小与大陆上的鹈鹕鸟相当，而外赫布里恩群岛上的鹈鹕鸟则稍大一些。不过，圣基尔达和设得兰群岛上的鹈鹕鸟体型非常巨大：

最大的鹪鹩体重是最小的大陆鹪鹩的两倍。这些鹪鹩属于记录中最极端的“岛屿巨型化”物种之一，就像新西兰的巨鸮一样，是地球上体重最重的鸮。此外，这些鹪鹩还有独特的鸣叫声。

Only a small share of the genes that govern size overlapped in the two bird populations, despite them being similarly large. This suggests they evolved in parallel, via different genetic paths. It is still unclear why island animals become giants (or dwarfs). But Scottish wrens provide a piece of the puzzle. ■

尽管这两种鸟体型相似，但控制体型的基因中只有一小部分在这两个种群中是相同的。这表明它们的进化是平行进行的，即通过不同的遗传途径发展而来的。目前仍不清楚为什么岛屿上的动物会变成巨人（或矮人）。不过，苏格兰鹪鹩为我们揭示了部分答案。■

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Bagehot

巴吉霍特

Theresa May: Britain's first—and last—woke prime minister

特蕾莎·梅：英国第一位也是最后一位“觉醒型”首相

That whooshing sound was the Overton window hurtling by
那种呼啸的声音，就是奥弗顿窗口在飞速掠过的声音。

Jul 10, 2026 12:29 AM

2026 年 7 月 10 日 凌晨 12:29



ON JULY 13TH 2016 Theresa May strode to a podium in Downing Street and launched an assault on the “burning injustices” of Britain. Under her government, young black men would no longer fear the police; women would no longer endure lower pay than men. Social concerns would trump economic ones. Their systemic causes would be eradicated. It was a hymn to identity politics. It was, in short, woke.

2016 年 7 月 13 日，特蕾莎·梅站在唐宁街的讲台上，向英国存在的“严重不公正现象”发起了挑战。在她执政期间，年轻的黑人男性将不再害怕警察；女性也将不再忍受低于男性的薪酬待遇。社会问题将优先于经济问题被解决。这些系统性问题将被彻底消除。这简直就是一场关于身份政治的颂歌。简而言之，这就是所谓的“觉醒主义”。

Mrs May—now Lady May—was Britain’s first and probably last woke prime minister. It is a strain to accept this, at first. The thought makes both her allies and enemies wince. The MP who in 2000 voted against the repeal of Section 28, which forbade the “promotion” (or rather acceptance) of homosexuality in schools? The authoritarian home secretary, rigidly in favour of the Conservatives’ attempts to reduce immigration at any cost? The prime minister who railed against “citizens of nowhere”? How can Mrs May, a creature of

curtain-twitching suburban England, be woke?

梅夫人——现在的梅女士——是英国第一位，也可能是最后一位具有启蒙思想的首相。一开始，人们很难接受这一点。这个想法让她的盟友和敌人都感到不安。那个在 2000 年投票反对废除第 28 条的议员，该条款曾禁止在学校中宣扬同性恋观念；那个坚决支持保守党不惜一切代价减少移民数量的威权性内政大臣；那个谴责“无国籍公民”的领导人……梅夫人，一个来自英格兰郊区、行事诡秘的人，怎么可能具有启蒙思想呢？

If the idea seems absurd, it is because Britain has drifted so far from the ideas and ideologies that dominated the country barely a decade ago. The policies Mrs May pursued—from trans rights to hammering the police for anti-black racism to pursuing “net zero” and eliminating “modern slavery”—are now seen as excesses from a different era. Mrs May is Britain’s only woke prime minister in the same way that Richard Nixon—responsible for environmental reforms and affirmative action as well as the carpet bombing of Cambodia—is probably America’s last truly liberal president. Mrs May was right-wing and right-on. An iron fist wrapped in a Pride flag; Britannia in a rainbow lanyard. Mrs May was woke.

如果这个想法看起来荒谬，那是因为英国已经与十年前主导国家的理念和意识形态相去甚远。梅女士所推行的一系列政策——从保护跨性别者的权利，到打击针对黑人的种族主义行为，再到追求“净零排放”和消除“现代奴隶制”——现在看来都是过时的做法。梅女士是英国唯一的“觉醒派”首相，而理查德·尼克松则可能是美国最后一位真正自由派的总统。尼克松不仅推行了环境改革和 affirmative action 政策，还发动了针对柬埔寨的空袭行动。梅女士则属于那种极端保守派，她的行为就像一面披着骄傲旗帜的铁拳；而英国则像一条穿着彩虹色领带的小狗。梅女士真是“觉醒派”人物啊。

Consider the way she treated the police. During one speech at the Police Federation, the de facto trade union for coppers, she in effect labelled them racist for unfairly targeting young black men and misogynistic for calling a domestic-abuse victim a “slag”. “It is an

attitude that betrays contempt for the public," said Mrs May, the then home secretary. She had entered the stage to polite applause. She left it to silence.

看看她对待警察的方式吧。在警察协会的一次演讲中，她实际上将警察们称为种族主义者，因为警察不公平地针对年轻的黑人男性；她还称那些处理家庭暴力案件的警察是“恶毒的人”。当时担任内政部长的梅夫人说：“这种态度充分体现了对公众的蔑视。”她的演讲赢得了一些礼貌的掌声，但结束后则是一片沉默。

A decade on, and such a speech by almost any politician would be impossible. The police are racist against black people? Britain in 2026 is a land where the police are seen on the right as, if anything, racist against white people. [Nigel Farage](#), the leader of Reform UK, which tops the polls for now, has attacked the police for an “obsessive commitment to anti-white discrimination” in a 7,000-word screed decrying “two-tier” Britain. It is woke means, with group identity and systemic injustice shaping everything, for unwoke ends.

十年过去了，现在几乎任何政治家都不会发表这样的演讲了。警察竟然对黑人抱有种族歧视态度？在 2026 年的英国，警方被右翼人士视为对白人抱有种族歧视的行为。目前民调中排名靠前的“改革英国”组织的领袖尼杰尔·法拉吉在一篇长达 7000 字的文章中攻击警方“对反白人歧视的过度执着”，并谴责英国存在的“双层社会结构”。这就是所谓的“觉醒主义”，群体身份和系统性不公正现象主导着一切，而“未觉醒”的人则无法改变这种状况。

In her moral crusade against the mistreatment of British ethnic minorities, Mrs May in 2016 commissioned a “racial-disparity audit”, which would reveal the everyday inequities against ethnic minorities. “There isn’t anywhere to hide,” she said. “If these disparities cannot be explained, they must be changed.” Now prejudice against the majority is of utmost political concern. “Anti-white racism is embedded into the heart of the state,” wrote Mr Farage.

在反对对英国少数民族的歧视行为的道德斗争中，梅女士于 2016 年下令进行了一次“种族差异调查”，旨在揭示针对少数民族的日常不平

等现象。“无处可藏，”她说，“如果这些差异无法得到解释，那就必须加以改变。”如今，对少数群体的偏见已成为最紧迫的政治问题。法拉吉先生指出：“反白人种族主义已经深深植根于国家体制之中。”

What Mrs May sees as her crowning achievement, her successors now see as a pain in the neck. The Modern Slavery Act was a world first, rolling various anti-exploitation laws into a single act. Mrs May shone a light on the miserable existence of people forced to work in brothels, nail bars or building sites and car washes. Now, in British politics, claims of “modern slavery” are painted by each major party as little more than a ruse to dodge deportation.

对于梅夫人来说，这项立法是她的重大成就；但她的继任者们却认为它是一种麻烦。《现代奴隶制法案》是全世界首次出台此类法律，它将各种反剥削法规整合到了一项法案中。梅夫人曾关注那些被迫在妓院、钉制厂或建筑工地工作的人们的悲惨生活状况。如今，在英国政治中，各主要政党都将“现代奴隶制”这一说法当作一种逃避驱逐的借口来使用。

In Downing Street Mrs May was a staunch advocate of trans rights. She considered adopting self-ID, allowing trans people to change gender without the say-so of a doctor. At the time, her position was mainstream. Today such views leave her on the fringe of British politics. A decade on, and a vociferous backlash to Mrs May’s proposals has left Britain with a de facto “bathroom ban” for trans people. Front-rank politicians who once baldly declared that “trans women are women” now cower when it comes to the subject. Cynical they may be, but it is probably for their own good: Mrs May’s views would likely bar her from high office today.

在唐宁街，梅夫人一直是跨性别权利的坚定倡导者。她支持采用自我识别制度，让跨性别者无需医生的许可即可改变性别。当时，她的观点属于主流立场。然而如今，这种观点已使她处于英国政治的边缘。十年过去了，对梅夫人提议的强烈反对使得英国实际上实行了一项“卫生间禁令”。那些曾经直言“跨性别女性也是女性”的顶尖政治家们，现在在涉及这一话题时都变得小心翼翼。他们或许心怀恶意，但这样做

或许也是为了自己的利益——因为按照梅夫人的观点，她今天恐怕无法担任高级职务了。

When politicians rail against the excesses of woke in 2026, they are often railing against the May government. Sweeping changes were adopted unthinkingly. In one of Mrs May's final acts in office, Britain bound itself to being "net zero" by 2050, the first big economy to do so. There was a quick 90-minute debate, marked by broad consensus—a sharp contrast with the Brexit rows that curtailed her tenure in Downing Street. Now "net zero" is a fundamental fracture, with even Labour split on it.

当政客们在 2026 年批评“觉醒主义”的过度行为时，他们实际上往往是在批评梅政府。一些重大的变革被不假思索地采纳了。在梅女士执政的最后阶段，英国宣布将在 2050 年前实现“净零排放”，这将是第一个实现这一目标的大国。这次讨论仅持续了 90 分钟，但达成了广泛的共识——这与她执政期间因脱欧问题而引发的纷争形成了鲜明对比。如今，“净零排放”已经成为一个根本性的分歧点，甚至工党内部也对此存在分歧。

Woke whiggery

觉醒的保守派主义

Social change is not a ratchet. The woke world over which Mrs May briefly ruled has collapsed. "Who would not want to be woke?" she asked in her 2023 memoir "The Abuse of Power: Confronting Injustice in Public Life". Well, all her successors for a start. Boris Johnson's government started a "war on woke". Rishi Sunak promised to "take on this lefty woke culture". Sir Keir Starmer shuddered at the accusation that he, a human-rights lawyer, was in any way woke.

社会变革并非是单向的。梅夫人短暂统治下的那个“觉醒主义世界”已经崩溃了。“谁不想成为一位觉醒主义者呢？”她在 2023 年出版的回忆录《权力的滥用：面对公共生活中的不公正》中这样问道。嗯，至

少她的继任者们都是如此。鲍里斯·约翰逊的政府开始了一场“对抗觉醒主义文化的战争”。里希·苏纳克承诺要“对抗这种左派觉醒主义文化”。而凯尔·斯塔默爵士则对被称为“觉醒主义者”这一标签感到震惊，毕竟他作为一名人权律师，绝不可能持有这样的观点。

Politics is downstream of culture. In office Mrs May reflected society; she did not shape it. The shibboleths of her era were accepted with little introspection. Perhaps progressivism provided an oasis of political calm compared with the hysterical rows about Brexit, which defined her premiership. Now society has shifted and Lady May cannot move with it. Out of office, prime ministers become frozen in time, stuck in the period they ruled. In the House of Lords Lady May appears only occasionally to defend her modern-slavery reforms or to despair at racial disparity in the Mental Health Act, little more than an ermine-clad ghost from an era that is now long gone. ■

政治是文化发展的下游环节。当梅女士掌权时，她只是反映社会现实，而非真正塑造社会形态。那个时代的准则几乎无需深思熟虑就被广泛接受。或许，与关于英国脱欧的激烈争论相比，进步主义思想为政治领域带来了一些平静。如今，社会已经发生了变化，梅女士也无法再适应这种变化了。一旦卸任，首相们就仿佛被冻结在时间之中，停留在他们执政的那个时代。在贵族院里，梅女士偶尔会出现，试图为她的现代奴隶制改革辩护，或者对《心理健康法》中存在的种族不平等现象感到绝望。她就像是一个幽灵般的出现，来自一个早已逝去的时代。

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[woke-prime-minister](#)

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Guns and sputter

枪支与尘土

Europe has promised cash for defence. It's failing to provide it

欧洲承诺提供资金用于国防开支。但实际上并没有履行这一承诺。

Most Europeans want stronger armed forces, but are unwilling to pay for them

大多数欧洲人希望拥有更强大的武装力量，但不愿意为此付出相应的代价。

Jul 09, 2026 06:45 AM | Ornskoldsvik

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:45 | 奥尔恩斯科尔德维克



A UKRAINIAN FLAG inscribed in Cyrillic with the words “Thanks, always” hangs at a factory in northern Sweden, where slabs of steel are transformed into hundreds of armoured vehicles each year. The flag was presented by Ukraine’s 21st Brigade, which operates the cv90 infantry fighting vehicle made here. Its soldiers affectionately call it “the Scandinavian beast”. The flag is a daily reminder to employees of how they are contributing to the security of Europe. “It is good to see that we have helped people,” says Julia, who works on an assembly line.

在瑞典北部的一家工厂里，悬挂着一面用西里尔字母书写的乌克兰国旗，上面写着“永远感谢”。这家工厂每年都会将钢铁板材加工成数百辆装甲车辆。这面旗帜是由乌克兰第 21 旅赠送的，该旅负责生产这款本土制造的 CV90 步兵战车。士兵们亲切地称这款战车为“斯堪的纳维亚巨兽”。这面旗帜每天都提醒着员工们，他们是如何为欧洲的安全做出贡献的。“能看到我们为人们做出了贡献，真是令人欣慰，”在装配线上工作的朱莉娅说道。

A decade ago the Hagglunds factory, owned by BAE Systems, Britain’s biggest defence firm, was cutting costs to survive. Today it is expanding its capacity five- or six-fold to fulfil soaring orders.

Revenue has surged from \$211m in 2018 to \$1.1bn in 2025, and is heading “north of \$2bn” a year, says Tommy Gustafsson-Rask, the general manager. The workforce has more than tripled since 2021, to around 2,600.

十年前，由英国最大的国防企业 BAE 系统公司拥有的 Haggglund 工厂为了生存而开始削减成本。如今，该工厂的产能已经扩大了五到六倍，以满足日益增长的订单需求。根据总经理 Tommy Gustafsson-Rask 的说法，公司收入从 2018 年的 2.11 亿美元增长到 2025 年的 11 亿美元，并且预计每年收入将超过 20 亿美元。自 2021 年以来，员工数量也增加了两倍多，达到了约 2600 人。

Prosperity in Ornskoldsvik is one side of Europe’s rearmament boom, as the continent rushes to meet a year-old NATO agreement to raise defence spending to 3.5% of GDP (plus another 1.5% on security infrastructure) by 2035. Much of this money will go towards new equipment, from missiles to drones, tanks and warships. European NATO members must rebuild their armed forces to counter a potential Russian attack, [possibly without American support](#). For countries with substantial defence industries, this investment will create economic growth.

在奥恩斯科尔德维克，欧洲的重新武装浪潮正在兴起。欧洲大陆急于履行一项为期一年的北约协议，即到 2035 年，国防开支需达到 GDP 的 3.5%（此外还需在安全基础设施上投入 1.5% 的资金）。这些资金将主要用于购买各种新装备，从导弹到无人机、坦克和军舰等。没有美国的支持，欧洲的北约成员国必须重建自己的武装力量，以应对潜在的俄罗斯攻击。对于拥有强大国防工业的国家来说，这种投资将促进经济增长。

The other side of the rearmament spree, however, showed up at a recent demonstration in Brussels, where thousands marched under the banner “welfare, not warfare”. Last year in Italy trade unions put some 500,000 people on the street in protest against higher defence spending. If Europe wants more capable armed forces, it faces a trade-off. It will need more public borrowing, higher taxes, cuts to

social spending or a mix of all three.

然而，重新武装运动的另一面则体现在最近在布鲁塞尔举行的示威活动中。成千上万的人高举着“追求福利而非战争”的旗帜走上街头。去年在意大利，工会组织让约 50 万人走上街头，抗议更高的国防开支。如果欧洲想要拥有更强大的武装力量，就必须做出一些权衡：要么增加公共债务、提高税收；要么削减社会开支；要么同时采取这三种措施。

A fistful of euros

几欧元的现金

Yet a close look at the finances of Europe's biggest military powers shows that many, including Britain and France, are on a trajectory that is unlikely to reach the 3.5% target. Donald Trump and his secretary for war, Pete Hegseth, see NATO's European members as freeloaders mooching off America's security guarantees while giving their citizens generous benefits and long holidays. On July 3rd Mr Trump posted a chart on social media showing American defence spending towering above that of several NATO members, and commenting: "Ridiculous for the U.S.A. to continue along this one sided path."

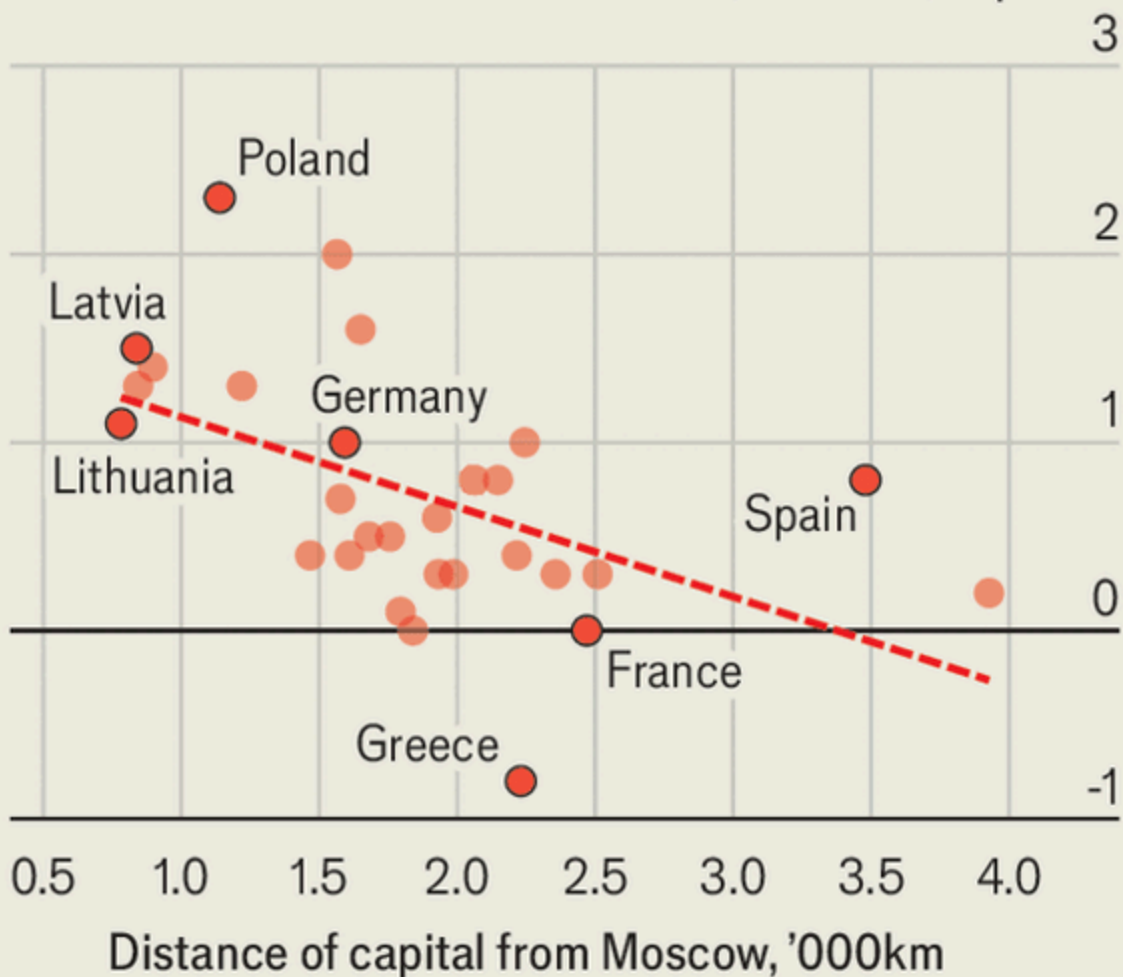
然而，仔细审视欧洲最大军事强国的财务状况后可以发现，包括英国和法国在内的许多国家，其发展轨迹不太可能达到 3.5% 的目标。唐纳德·特朗普和他的战争事务顾问皮特·赫格塞思认为，北约的欧洲成员国들은依靠美国的安保保障来获取利益，同时给予本国公民丰厚的福利和长假期。7 月 3 日，特朗普在社交媒体上发布了一张图表，显示美国的国防开支远高于几个北约成员国，并评论说：“美国继续走这条单边的道路真是荒谬。”

Where they stand, where they sit

1

European NATO
members*

Change in defence spending
as % of GDP, 2021-25, % points



Sources: SIPRI; Google Maps

*Excluding Iceland

The 3.5% spending goal was intended to keep Mr Trump on board. To understand why many European countries may fail to live up to the promise, it helps to sort them into three groups: the good, the

sad and the smugly indifferent.

3.5%的支出目标旨在让特朗普继续留在团队中。要理解为什么许多欧洲国家未能履行这一承诺，可以将它们分为三类：表现好的、表现一般的以及自满无动于衷的。

Countries that have reached the target or are on track to do so soon are mainly those that feel most threatened by Russia, such as the Baltics and Poland (see chart 1). This often involves hard choices. Lithuania is introducing a new "security contribution" tax. Finland is slashing spending on health care. In total, 11 European countries are financing at least half of their increase in defence spending by raising taxes or cutting spending, reckons Fitch, a rating agency.

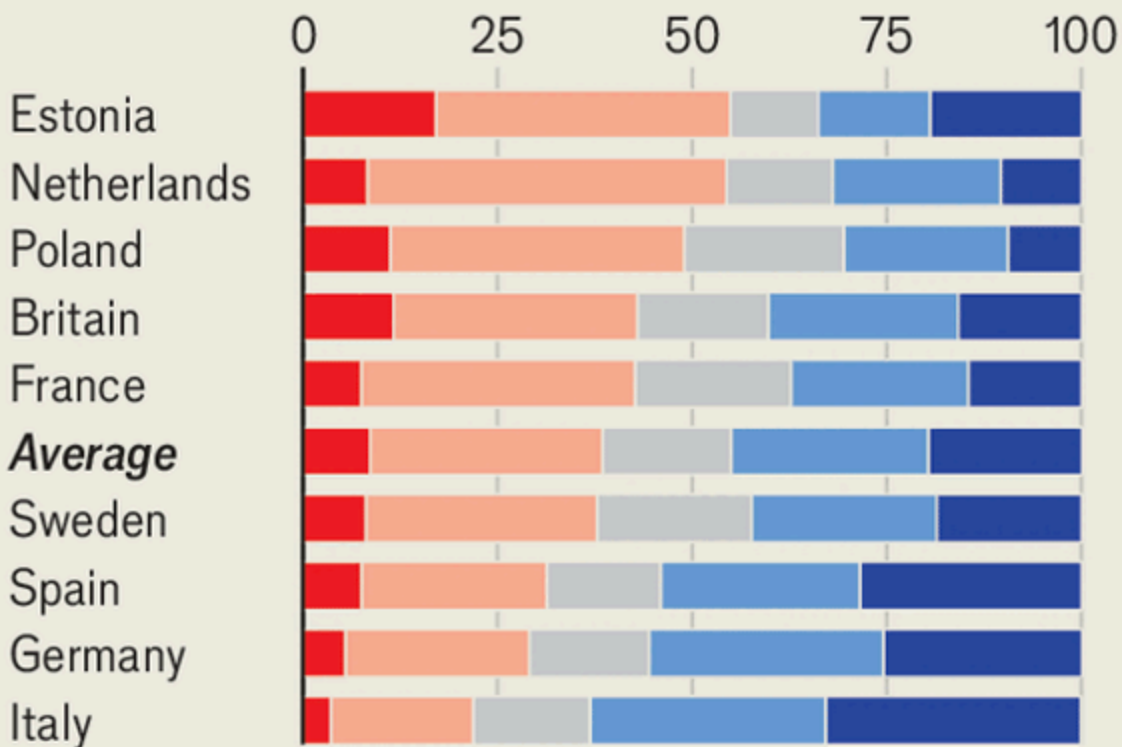
那些已经实现目标或即将实现目标的国家，主要是那些认为受到俄罗斯威胁最大的国家，比如波罗的海地区国家和波兰（参见图表 1）。这通常意味着要做出艰难的选择。立陶宛正在引入一种新的“安全贡献”税。芬兰则正在削减医疗保健方面的支出。据评级机构 Fitch 称，总共有 11 个欧洲国家通过增税或削减开支来承担至少一半的国防开支增加成本。

Biting the bullet

2

Support for cutting other public spending to invest in defence, % responding, May 2026

Strongly support Tend to support Don't know
Tend to oppose Strongly oppose



Source: European Council on Foreign Relations

This is generally easier in front-line countries, where most people support cutting social spending to fund defence, according to polling by the European Council on Foreign Relations, a think-tank (see chart 2). Other countries on the “good” list have plenty of room to borrow, such as Denmark, Sweden and above all Germany, which aims to hit 3.7% by 2030. Their low public debt allows politicians to

duck choices between guns and butter, for now.

根据欧洲理事会外交关系委员会这一智库进行的民意调查，这种情况在那些支持削减社会开支以资助国防开支的国家中更为常见（参见图表 2）。其他处于“良好”状态的国家则拥有充足的借贷空间，比如丹麦、瑞典，尤其是德国——该国计划在 2030 年前将公共债务降至 3.7%。这些国家较低的公共债务水平使得政客们暂时可以不必在“枪与黄油”之间做出选择。

Countries in the “sad” group aim to reach the target, but have little room to borrow and low support for higher taxes or welfare cuts. Alas, this includes both Europe’s nuclear powers, Britain and France. Britain [is in such tight straits](#) that last month the defence secretary, John Healey, resigned over the miserly planned increase to his budget. Further wrangling produced a small increase of 0.1% of GDP by 2030, for a total of 2.7%. Analysts doubt Britain will hit 3.5% by 2035. France is even further behind. It plans to raise defence spending to just 2.5% of GDP by 2030. Even this will require “significant trade-offs” in higher taxes or budget cuts in other areas, according to France’s Court of Auditors.

属于“负面”类别的国家虽然试图实现目标，但几乎没有借款的空间，而且对于增加税收或削减福利计划也缺乏支持。遗憾的是，这包括欧洲的核大国——英国和法国。英国的情况十分严峻，上个月，国防部长约翰·希利因为预算削减计划过于保守而辞职。经过进一步的讨论，到 2030 年，国防开支仅增加 0.1% 的 GDP，总计 2.7%。分析人士怀疑英国到 2035 年可能无法达到 3.5% 的目标。法国的状况更为糟糕，该国计划将国防开支在 2030 年之前增加到 GDP 的 2.5%。不过，根据法国审计院的评估，即便达到这一目标，也需要在其他领域进行重大的权衡，比如增加税收或削减其他开支。

Then there are the smugly indifferent. Spain managed to get itself exempted, saying it would cap spending at 2.1% of GDP. Others, such as Portugal, solemnly swear they will reach the target but have made almost no effort to do so. Italy came up with its own creative solution, reporting a 39% increase to hit 2% of GDP last year. But the

actual increase in spending was just 7%; the rest was accounting chicanery.

还有一些人则表现得极其漠不关心。西班牙成功获得了豁免资格，声称会将支出控制在 GDP 的 2.1%。而像葡萄牙这样的国家则郑重承诺会达到目标，但实际上几乎没有采取任何措施来实现这一目标。意大利则想出了自己的“创意解决方案”——去年他们的支出增加了 39%，从而达到了 GDP 的 2%。但实际上，他们的实际支出增长仅为 7%；其余的增额都是靠各种会计手段制造的。

Countries that fail to hit 3% by 2030 will have an even bigger hill to climb by 2035. Many may delay until the last few years, as when NATO set a guideline of 2% at a summit in 2014, warns Fenella McGerty of the International Institute for Strategic Studies, a British think-tank. The resulting “hockey-stick” jump in spending made allies bid against each other for limited kit, driving up prices and waiting times.

那些在 2030 年无法达到 3%增长率的国家，到 2035 年将会面临更大的挑战。许多国家可能会推迟实现这一目标，直到最后几年才采取行动。正如英国智库国际战略研究所的芬内拉·麦格蒂在 2014 年的一次会议上所警告的那样，当时北约规定增长率为 2%。这种“曲线式”的增长方式导致各成员国竞相争夺有限的资源，从而推高了价格并延长了消费者的等待时间。

The politics is difficult. Many countries have both left-wing populists who oppose defence spending for social reasons, and right-wing populists who do not see Russia as a threat. The fiscal side will be hard, too: countries that borrow for defence budgets, such as Germany, will struggle to sustain them as interest payments and the costs of their ageing populations rise.

政治局势十分复杂。许多国家的左翼民粹主义者出于社会原因反对国防开支，而右翼民粹主义者则并不认为俄罗斯构成威胁。财政方面的情况同样困难：像德国这样的国家，由于需要为国防预算融资而举

债，因此难以维持债务偿还，再加上人口老龄化带来的成本上升，这些国家的财政状况将变得更加严峻。

The problem is not just that countries may miss the targets, but that they also use the money poorly. Spending too much on their own industries leads to fragmentation. Europe operates 12 sorts of tanks and makes five different howitzers, compared with one of each in America. Then there are the boondoggles. Last month Germany cancelled a €10bn (\$11.4bn) shipbuilding programme because it was running late and costs had ballooned. Taxpayers have reason to be furious, having blown €2.3bn on frigates the navy will never get.

问题不仅仅在于各国可能无法实现目标，还在于它们在使用资金方面也很糟糕。在自身产业上投入过多资金会导致产业分散化。例如，欧洲生产 12 种不同类型的坦克，同时制造 5 种不同的榴弹炮，而美国则每种武器只生产一种。此外，还有一些不必要的浪费行为。上个月，德国因为造船项目延期且成本飙升而取消了价值 100 亿欧元（约合 114 亿美元）的造船计划。纳税人实在气愤不已，因为他们花费了 23 亿欧元来购买海军永远用不上的护卫舰。

Instead of simply looking at spending, countries should consider what that money is buying, and whether it is providing the capabilities (such as armoured brigades) that they pledged to NATO. Secrecy surrounds many of these targets, for good reason, but lifting the veil a bit would increase accountability. The most intense budget fights are still to come. Governments will be better able to make the case for defence if they can show they are putting the money to good use. ■

与其仅仅关注支出情况，各国更应该考虑这些资金究竟用于了什么，以及这些资金是否真的帮助实现了他们向北约承诺的承诺——比如组建装甲部队之类的能力建设。许多这些目标都笼罩着神秘的面纱，这是有正当理由的；但稍微揭开一些面纱，就能提高问责性了。接下来还将面临许多关于预算的激烈争论。如果政府能够证明这些资金被妥善使用，那么他们就能更好地为国防事业辩护了。■

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Le Pen's decision

勒庞的决定

Marine Le Pen is running for the French presidency

玛丽·勒庞正在竞选法国总统职位

Despite being found guilty by the Paris court of appeal

尽管被巴黎上诉法院判定有罪

Jul 09, 2026 05:23 AM | PARIS

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:23 | 巴黎



Le Pen is mightier

勒庞更有实力

FOR OVER half a century, a member of the Le Pen family has stood at every French presidential election bar one. Then, after a court in 2025 banned Marine Le Pen, the leader of the populist-right National Rally (RN), from running for elected office for five years, it had looked as if the presidential vote next year would mark the end of a dynastic era.

半个多世纪以来，勒庞家族的成员每次参加法国总统选举时都成功当选。然而，在 2025 年，法院裁定民粹主义右翼政党国民联盟的领袖勒庞五年内不得竞选任何公职。看起来，明年的总统选举将标志着这一王朝时代的终结。

But on July 7th, in an unexpected twist, the court of appeal in Paris upheld Ms Le Pen's conviction for the misuse of European Parliament funds for party ends—yet lightened her sentence, freeing her to run. Hours later Ms Le Pen announced that she, not Jordan Bardella, her 30-year-old lieutenant, would make a bid for the presidency after all.

但在 7 月 7 日，出乎意料的是，巴黎上诉法院维持了对勒彭女士的定罪，因为她滥用欧洲议会的资金来为政党谋利。不过，法院的判决较为宽松，因此勒彭女士仍然可以竞选总统职位。几小时后，勒彭女士宣布，最终由她自己来竞选总统，而不是她的 30 岁副手乔丹·巴德拉。

The RN leader's decision ends 15 months of uncertainty, and sets France up for a highly unusual election. In its ruling, the court of appeal handed her a three-year jail sentence; two are suspended, and one is to be served with an electronic ankle tag. Crucially for Ms Le Pen, the court also shortened her ban and ruled that she had already served the ineligibility penalty.

这位 RN 领袖的决定结束了长达 15 个月的不确定性，也为法国带来了一次非常特殊的选举局面。上诉法院判处她三年监禁；其中两年刑期可以缓期执行，另一年的刑期则通过电子脚环进行监管。对勒彭女士来说，重要的是，法院缩短了她的禁令期限，并裁定她已经履行了禁止参选的处罚措施。

In announcing her candidacy, Ms Le Pen said that the ban had posed “an enormous democratic problem” and that its ending changed everything, enabling “the French people to judge”. That ruling, in effect, took the political decision out of the judges’ hands and put it firmly into hers. Ms Le Pen continues to claim that she is innocent. She is now taking her case to the highest court, the Cour de Cassation, in part to contest the requirement that she wear a tag (which will not be imposed while the appeal is under way). That court says it could review her case before the election next April and May. If it rejects her appeal, she will have to campaign while wearing the tag.

在宣布参选时，勒庞女士表示这项禁令构成了“巨大的民主问题”，而其废除则让一切变得可能，从而“让法国人民能够进行评判”。实际上，这一裁决将政治决策从法官手中夺走，完全交到了她手中。勒庞女士继续声称自己是无辜的。她现在正将此事提交至最高法庭——上诉法院，部分目的是质疑关于她必须佩戴标签的要求（在上诉过程中不会实施这一要求）。该法院表示可以在明年四月或五月选举之前重新审理她的案件。如果她的上诉被驳回，她将不得不佩戴标签进行竞选活动。

For the RN, her decision brings clarity and will allow the party to begin its campaign proper. Ms Le Pen will have the authority to shape its direction, take decisions on which there is policy disagreement (she wants to reduce the legal minimum pension age for some workers to as low as 60, from around 63; Mr Bardella is less sure) and keep the party’s identity as a populist outfit that promises to defend ordinary working families. She is a deputy for a constituency in the mining basin of northern France.

对于 RN 来说，她的决定带来了清晰的方向，这将使该政党能够正式开始其竞选活动。勒庞女士将拥有制定政策方向的权力，可以就那些存在政策分歧的问题做出决定（她希望将某些工人的法定最低退休年龄降低到 60 岁，而不是目前的约 63 岁；巴德拉先生则对此不太确定）。同时，她还能保持该政党作为承诺保护普通劳动家庭的政治党的身份。她是法国北部矿业区某个选区的代表。

Ms Le Pen's candidacy, however, will not resolve all tensions within the party. Mr Bardella, who had for months geared himself up to stand for the presidency in her stead, is now relegated back into second place. The young RN president has been pushing a different electoral strategy—based on marrying the party's traditional working-class base and its politics of indignation to a middle-class electorate—by sounding more fiscally responsible and business friendly. The pair insist that they will work together seamlessly. Indeed, the day after the verdict they made a joint trip to a market in rural France. Ms Le Pen described them as a "ticket", and confirmed that she would make him her prime minister if she wins the presidency. But over the coming months such differences will inevitably strain the tie.

不过，勒庞女士的候选资格并不能解决党内所有的矛盾。原本准备接替她竞选总统的巴德拉先生，现在则被降到了第二位。这位年轻的共和党主席提出了不同的竞选策略——试图将党的传统工人阶级基础与愤世嫉俗的政治理念与中产阶级选民结合起来。他主张更加节俭且亲商的政策。两人都表示会携手合作。事实上，在选举结果公布后的第二天，他们一起前往法国农村的一个市场。勒庞女士称他们为“理想的搭档”，并承诺如果自己赢得总统职位，就会让他担任总理。不过，在接下来的几个月里，这些分歧无疑会不断加剧两人之间的合作关系。

Ms Le Pen now begins her campaign with a handsome lead: she is on 36% in first-round voting, according to an Ifop poll conducted after the verdict, well ahead of either 19% for Edouard Philippe or 15% for Gabriel Attal (two of President Emmanuel Macron's former prime ministers), depending on which of them is tested. In the run-off, polls suggest she has a chance of winning and doing just as well as Mr Bardella would have. Ms Le Pen remains a fearsome campaigner, with three presidential bids and bitter lessons learned behind her. One of France's most popular figures, the RN leader will draw support from those who think that it is—at last—her time. "She

will be very hard to beat," says a centrist figure.

勒庞女士以明显的优势开始了她的竞选活动：根据 Ifop 在投票结果后的调查，她在第一轮投票中获得了 36% 的选票，远远超过了爱德华·菲利普 19% 和加布里埃尔·阿塔尔的 15% 的得票率（后者分别是埃马纽埃尔·马克龙的前两位总理）。在决选中，民调显示她有获胜的可能性，并且胜算与巴德拉先生相当。勒庞女士仍然是一位强大的竞选者，她已经经历了三次总统竞选的失败，但从中吸取了宝贵的经验。作为法国最受欢迎的人物之一，这位国民阵线的领袖将获得那些认为现在是她的时候了的人们的支持。“她非常难以击败，”一位中间派人士说道。

Even so, polls nine months ahead of voting are seldom an accurate indicator of the final result. It remains unclear who she would be up against in the broad centre; at the moment both Mr Philippe and Mr Attal have formally declared their candidacies and are out campaigning. Ms Le Pen lacks the freshness and sense of renewal that a Bardella candidacy would have brought the party. Above all, the prospect of a leading presidential contender, however popular, possibly campaigning under house arrest with an electronic ankle tag puts France in uncharted territory.

即便如此，在投票前九个月进行的民意调查往往并不能准确反映最终的选举结果。目前尚不清楚她将在中翼选区面对谁；目前，菲利普先生和阿塔尔先生都已经正式宣布参选，并正在开展竞选活动。勒庞女士缺乏巴德利亚尔那样的新鲜感和活力，而一个有影响力的总统候选人，即使他很受欢迎，但如果他因为电子脚环的约束而不得不在家进行竞选活动，那对法国来说无疑是一个未知的情况。

The opposition has lost no time condemning Ms Le Pen's decision to stand, and reminding voters that she has now been found guilty by two courts, even if the second conviction is suspended by her latest appeal. Out on the streets the day after the verdict, with Mr Bardella at her side, a defiant Ms Le Pen declared that voters "know full well" that the accusations against her "do not deserve a criminal conviction". Mr Attal accused her of "Trumpian rhetoric". Playing the

victim may go down well with her base, which has long suspected that the judges are out to get her. But it could make it more difficult for her to widen her appeal. ■

反对派毫不迟疑地谴责勒庞女士参选的决定，并提醒选民：她已经两次被法院判定有罪，即便她最近的上诉使第二次定罪被暂缓执行。在判决公布的第二天，勒庞女士在巴德拉先生的陪同下出现在街头，她坚定地表示，选民“完全明白”针对她的指控“不值得判处刑事定罪”。阿塔尔先生则指责她使用了“特朗普式的言辞”。虽然扮演受害者可能会让她的支持者感到满意，因为长期以来他们一直怀疑法官们有意针对她。但这样做可能会让她更难扩大自己的支持基础。■

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Battered, then loved

曾经被摧毁，后来又被爱着

NATO survives its bipolar summit

北约在双极峰会上成功存活下来

Allies breath a sigh of relief; Ukraine may even cheer

盟友们松了一口气；乌克兰甚至可能会欢呼起来。

Jul 09, 2026 05:22 AM | ANKARA

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:22 | 安卡拉



DONALD TRUMP came to insult NATO, not to bury it. He arrived in Ankara for the alliance's annual summit threatening to withdraw

American troops from Europe unless he got Greenland, a Danish territory. He repeatedly said he was “not happy” with allies for failing to help with his war in Iran, and vowed to sever trade with Spain. Yet by the time he left he was waxing about the “tremendous love” among allies.

唐纳德·特朗普前来是为了羞辱北约，而不是要解散它。他出席了北约的年度峰会，并威胁说如果得不到格陵兰岛——一个丹麦领土，他就会从欧洲撤军。他反复表示对盟友在支持他在伊朗的战争方面未能提供足够帮助感到不满，并誓言要切断与西班牙的贸易关系。然而，在他离开时，他又开始谈论盟友之间的“深厚友谊”。

For those who feared the summit could bring a potentially catastrophic break-up of NATO, the happy parting is a relief. Mr Trump signed up to a joint declaration that reaffirmed NATO’s “ironclad commitment to our collective defence” including Article 5, which holds that “an attack on one is an attack on all”. Even so, Mr Trump’s declaration of affection will seem, to many Europeans, akin to the love of a wife-beater.

对于那些担心峰会可能导致北约分崩离析的人来说，这次顺利的告别无疑是一种解脱。特朗普签署了联合声明，重申了北约“对集体防御的坚定承诺”，其中包括第五条内容，即“对其中一个国家发动的攻击，实际上就是对所有国家的攻击”。不过，对许多欧洲人来说，特朗普的这种表态似乎就像是一个糟糕的情人一样。

Another crisis will surely come. As one European official put it, Mr Trump’s commitment helps to preserve deterrence against Russia, “but we cannot be naive”. The Pentagon, having cut both front-line troops in Eastern Europe and the backup forces it promises to send to reinforce NATO in any war, is conducting a six-month review that may yet bring more reductions. Pete Hegseth, the secretary of war, is thought to have wanted to withdraw all troops, but was checked by Marco Rubio, the secretary of state. Moreover, the resumption of hostilities with Iran may keep stoking Mr Trump’s resentment at

Europeans' refusal to join the fight.

另一个危机肯定会到来。正如一位欧洲官员所说，特朗普的承诺有助于保持对俄罗斯的威慑力，“但我们不能天真”。五角大楼已经削减了在东欧的前线部队，同时也承诺在任何与北约的战争中派遣更多部队支援。目前正在进行为期六个月的评估，可能会进一步减少军事力量。据称，战争部长皮特·赫格塞思想要撤回所有部队，但这一计划受到了国务卿马科·鲁比奥的阻止。此外，与伊朗的敌对关系恢复可能会继续加剧特朗普对欧洲人拒绝参与战斗的不满情绪。

Even so, with every bust-up averted, Europeans buy a bit more time to strengthen their defences. And they are. Britain will lead a 12-country, \$50bn European initiative to develop missiles able to hit targets 2,000km away. These are a replacement for the deep-strike ones Mr Trump has been withholding, though Germany also struck a deal to buy American Tomahawk missiles. Other contract announcements showed that Europeans are trying to fill the gaps in “enablers” provided by America, for instance mid-air refuelling aircraft and long-range drones; they also served to tell Mr Trump that American firms had much to gain by keeping close to Europe.

尽管如此，每次冲突都被避免后，欧洲人获得了更多时间来加强自己的防御能力。实际上，他们确实这么做了。英国将领导一个由 12 个国家组成的、价值 500 亿美元的计划，旨在研发能够打击 2000 公里外目标的导弹。这些导弹可以替代特朗普先生一直拒绝提供的远程打击武器。不过，德国也达成了一项协议，购买美国的“战斧”导弹。其他合同公告表明，欧洲人试图填补美国提供的“支持性装备”的空白，比如空中加油飞机和远程无人机。这些合作也向特朗普先生表明，与欧洲保持紧密关系对美国企业来说是非常有利的。

Ukraine's ability to fend off Russia's invading army, and to inflict palpable damage far behind the front lines, is also buying vital time for Europeans. Volodymyr Zelensky, Ukraine's president, emerged as one of the winners from the summit. Mr Trump once told him he had “no cards” and threw him out of the Oval Office. Now he promises to give him an ace: a licence to make desperately needed Patriot

interceptors, the only weapons Ukraine has that can shoot down Russian ballistic and hypersonic missiles. Ukraine failed to intercept any of the 29 missiles Russia fired on July 6th, killing 28 people in and around Kyiv. The licence is no quick fix, even if it goes ahead. Getting production up and running will be a long process.

乌克兰有能力抵御俄罗斯的入侵军队，并能在前线后方造成严重的破坏，这也为欧洲人赢得了宝贵的时间。乌克兰总统沃罗德米르·泽连斯基成为这次峰会上的胜利者之一。特朗普曾称他“毫无实力”，并将他赶出了白宫办公室。现在，特朗普承诺将给予他一项重要许可：制造那些极其重要的爱国者拦截导弹——这是乌克兰唯一能够击落俄罗斯弹道导弹和高超音速导弹的武器。然而，在 7 月 6 日，乌克兰未能拦截俄罗斯发射的 29 枚导弹，导致基辅及周边地区有 28 人丧生。尽管有这项许可，但生产这些导弹的过程绝非一朝一夕就能完成。

Mr Trump seemed to give Mr Zelensky the nod of approval for Ukraine's strikes against Russian oil facilities and other targets that are bringing the war to Moscow and St Petersburg. J.D. Vance, America's vice-president, had urged Ukraine to be "maximally defensive", but Mr Trump suggested long-distance strikes could bring Russia to the negotiating table. "It's an escalation, but it's also an escalation that can help lead to an end," said Mr Trump.

特朗普似乎对泽连斯基关于对俄罗斯石油设施及其他目标的打击表示赞同。这些打击使得战争蔓延到了莫斯科和圣彼得堡。美国副总统 J.D.万斯曾敦促乌克兰采取“最积极的防御措施”，但特朗普认为，远程打击或许能够促使俄罗斯坐下来进行谈判。“这是一种升级，但也是有可能促成和平的解决方案，”特朗普说道。

Mr Trump's marked friendliness towards Mr Zelensky, think some, may be a sign that he now regards Ukraine's president as a fighter and a winner. "It's hard to believe, right?" Mr Trump told reporters. "From the Oval Office to now, I think we've developed a very good relationship." Mr Trump is mercurial, however. His next conversation

with Mr Putin may yet steer him closer to the Kremlin's viewpoint.

有些人认为，特朗普对泽连斯基表现出的友好态度，可能表明他现在将乌克兰总统视为一位勇敢且成功的领导者。“这很难相信，对吧？”特朗普对记者说。“从白宫办公室到现在，我们认为我们建立了非常良好的关系。”不过，特朗普的情绪变化无常。他下一次与普京的对话可能会让他更加接近克里姆林宫的立场。

Another winner from the summit was its host, Recep Tayyip Erdogan, Turkey's strongman president. Ahead of the summit, Turkish officials had privately said just getting Mr Trump to show up would count as success. He did, and came bearing gifts. He suggested he would move ahead with the sale of F-35 fighters to Turkey, which America had blocked in 2020 after Mr Erdogan purchased an S-400 air-defence system from Russia. He also promised to roll back CAATSA sanctions the US had imposed the same year against Turkey's defence-procurement agency.

峰会的另一个胜利者就是其主持人——土耳其的强人总统雷杰普·塔伊普·埃尔多安。在峰会召开之前，土耳其官员私下表示，只要让特朗普出席就足以被视为成功。实际上，特朗普确实出席了会议，并且还带来了礼物。他表示会继续推进将 F-35 战斗机出售给土耳其的计划，而这一计划在 2020 年被美国否决，当时埃尔多安从俄罗斯购买了 S-400 防空系统。此外，他还承诺会撤销美国同年对土耳其国防采购机构的 CAATSA 制裁措施。

Congress says America can provide Turkey with the F-35s only when the latter “no longer possesses” the Russian air defence batteries. Even so, the prospect of a breakthrough seems closer, despite the [objections](#) of Binyamin Netanyahu, Israel's prime minister, who warned that selling Turkey the jets would “destroy the power balance in the Middle East”.

国会表示，美国只有在土耳其不再拥有俄罗斯的防空系统之后，才能向土耳其提供 F-35 战斗机。不过，尽管以色列总理本雅明·内塔尼亚胡反对这一计划，认为向土耳其出售这些战斗机会“破坏中东的势力平衡”，但取得突破的可能性似乎还是存在的。

Having salvaged the summit, and in many ways done better than expected, the allies are in no rush to repeat the experience. The next one is set to take place in Albania, but the leaders pointedly did not give a date. Some think they should henceforth be held every two years, rather than yearly. The fewer get-togethers with Mr Trump, they argue, the fewer the chances of a family meltdown. ■

经过这次峰会，盟国们不仅成功避免了危机，而且成果远超预期。因此，他们并不急于再次举办这样的会议。下一次会议定于阿尔巴尼亚举行，不过与会领导人并未明确具体的日期。有些人认为，从现在起应该每两年举行一次这样的会议，而不是每年一次。他们认为，如果减少与特朗普的会面次数，那么出现家庭矛盾的可能性也会降低。■

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War over the past

过去的战争

Poland and Ukraine have fallen out over history

波兰和乌克兰在历史上曾经发生过争执。

The row could have lasting consequences for Europe's security
这一冲突可能会对欧洲的安全产生长期影响。

Jul 09, 2026 06:29 AM | Kyiv

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:29 | 基辅



Tusk and Zelensky trying to hold it together

图斯克和泽伦斯基试图维持局面的稳定

ON JULY 11TH Poland commemorates the Volhynia massacres, in which some 100,000 Polish civilians were killed by Ukrainian nationalists in 1943 in what is now western Ukraine. The day used to be an occasion for dialogue. Polish and Ukrainian leaders together honoured the victims of the killings and of reprisals by Polish partisans. Local officials and priests organised vigils on both sides of the border.

7月11日，波兰纪念了沃利尼亚大屠杀。在1943年，大约10万名波兰平民被乌克兰民族主义者杀害，这些事件发生在现在的西乌克兰地区。这一日子过去曾是双方进行对话的契机。波兰和乌克兰的领导人共同纪念了这些受害者的命运，同时也悼念了波兰游击队员对报复行为所做出的牺牲。当地官员和牧师在边境两侧组织了守夜活动。

Not this year. Poland and Ukraine, long close allies, are entangled in a fight over Volhynia's legacy. A Polish minister has warned that his country may block Ukraine's accession to the European Union. And Poland has reneged on a deal to give Ukraine MIG-29 fighters, citing its unwillingness to share drone technology. Donald Tusk, Poland's prime minister, has suggested he may withhold aid. The squabble threatens lasting damage to one of Europe's most crucial partnerships.

今年不会如此。波兰和乌克兰是长期亲密的盟友，但现在却因沃利尼亚的遗产问题而陷入争执。一位波兰部长警告称，波兰可能会阻止乌克兰加入欧盟。此外，波兰还因不愿共享无人机技术而放弃了向乌克兰提供 MIG-29 战斗机的协议。波兰总理唐纳德·图斯克甚至暗示可能会暂停对乌克兰的援助。这场争端可能会给欧洲最重要的合作伙伴关系带来长期的影响。

The latest dispute began in late May, after Ukraine's president, Volodymyr Zelensky, named a special-forces unit after the Ukrainian Insurgent Army (UPA), which during the second world war fought the Soviets and the Nazis (though it occasionally co-operated with the

latter). Ukrainians celebrate the insurgents as a symbol of resistance against Moscow. Poles revile them for the massacres, which Poland officially considers a genocide.

最近的冲突发生在 5 月底，当时乌克兰总统沃洛迪米尔·泽连斯基以“乌克兰起义军”的名称命名了一个特种部队单位。在第二次世界大战期间，乌克兰起义军曾与苏联和纳粹势力作战（尽管他们偶尔也会与纳粹合作）。乌克兰人将起义军视为反抗莫斯科力量的象征而予以赞扬。而波兰人则因起义军所犯下的屠杀行为而谴责他们，波兰方面正式将这些屠杀行为视为种族灭绝行为。

The provocation may have been unintentional. The request to rename the unit came from its officers, not from Mr Zelensky. It appears to have inadvertently bypassed diplomatic review. Ukraine had unveiled monuments to UPA commanders in the past, drawing pro forma protests from Poland. But this time Karol Nawrocki, Poland's right-wing populist president, decided to escalate. On June 19th he stripped Mr Zelensky of Poland's highest state honour, awarded in 2023. Mr Zelensky was initially taken aback. But he leaned into the fight, sending his medal back by commercial mail rather than diplomatic courier.

这种挑衅行为可能是无意的。要求改名其实是由该单位的官员提出的，而不是由泽连斯基先生提出的。看来这一举动无意中绕过了外交上的审查程序。过去，乌克兰曾为乌帕武装组织的指挥官竖立纪念碑，这引发了波兰的强烈抗议。但这次，波兰的右翼民粹主义总统卡罗尔·纳沃罗基决定采取更激进的手段。6 月 19 日，他剥夺了泽连斯基在 2023 年获得的波兰最高荣誉。泽连斯基起初感到非常震惊，但他决定继续抗争，通过邮政方式将勋章寄回，而不是通过外交途径。

The two countries' nationalist politics then made it hard to untangle the dispute. Three former Ukrainian presidents renounced their own Polish honours. Mr Zelensky doubled down, unveiling plans for a National Pantheon that will showcase Ukraine's historical great and good. "No one will ever dictate...which heroes we should honour," he growled. Some officials on both sides, notably the countries' foreign

ministers, have tried to lower the temperature, but without success. The hard-right opposition in Warsaw hopes to use the July 11th commemorations to whip up new anger against Ukraine.

两国的民族主义政策使得这场争端难以解决。三位前乌克兰总统宣布放弃他们所拥有的波兰荣誉。泽连斯基则进一步强调自己的立场，宣布计划建立一座国家纪念碑，以表彰乌克兰的历史伟人。“没有人能够决定我们应该纪念哪些英雄，”他说道。双方的一些官员，尤其是两国的外交部长，试图缓和紧张局势，但未能成功。华沙的极右翼反对派希望利用 7 月 11 日的纪念活动来激发人们对乌克兰的愤怒情绪。

At the start of Russia's invasion in 2022, the friendship between Poland and Ukraine reached new heights. Western weapons poured into Ukraine through Poland, while millions of Ukrainian refugees crossed the other way. But many Poles gradually lost enthusiasm. Farmers resented Ukraine's tariff-free grain exports to the European Union. Poles grumbled that Ukrainians were crowding schools and driving up rents. Such divisions were exploited by Russian influence campaigns and by Poland's own nationalist opposition.

在 2022 年俄罗斯入侵初期，波兰和乌克兰之间的友谊达到了新的高度。西方武器通过波兰流入乌克兰，而数百万乌克兰难民则移居到了波兰。然而，许多波兰人逐渐失去了热情。农民们对乌克兰向欧盟出口免关税的谷物感到不满，而波兰人则抱怨乌克兰人挤占了学校的资源，并推高了房租水平。这些分歧被俄罗斯的宣传手段以及波兰国内的民族主义反对派所利用。

The dispute over the UPA threatens to poison relations for the foreseeable future. Mr Nawrocki may table a bill that would criminalise "glorifying" the UPA. Ukraine's parliament, meanwhile, is weighing a law to combat "Ukrainophobia", which could ban criticising the UPA. Unless cooler heads prevail, says Bartosz Cichocki, a former Polish ambassador to Ukraine, "Poland's support for Ukraine's EU accession, military assistance and even economic co-

operation" may be at stake.

关于乌克兰联盟的争议在可预见的未来会持续破坏两国关系。纳沃罗基先生可能会提出一项法案，将贬低乌克兰联盟的行为定为犯罪。与此同时，乌克兰议会正在考虑一项反对“乌克兰恐惧症”的法律，该法律可能会禁止批评乌克兰联盟的行为。正如前波兰驻乌克兰大使巴托兹·奇乔茨基所说，除非局势能够冷静下来，否则波兰对乌克兰加入欧盟的支持、军事援助甚至经济合作都可能面临风险。

That would have grave implications for Europe. Cracks in solidarity with Ukraine would embolden Russia. The end of military co-operation with Poland would undermine Ukraine's war effort. A setback to Ukraine's EU membership bid would hand Russia another reason to celebrate.

这对欧洲来说将产生严重的后果。如果欧洲与乌克兰的团结关系出现裂痕，那么俄罗斯就会得寸进尺。与波兰的军事合作中断将削弱乌克兰的战争努力。而乌克兰申请加入欧盟的努力遭遇挫折，又会让俄罗斯有另一个理由庆祝自己的胜利。

Ancient quarrels

古老的石斧

Much of the problem is political. Mr Nawrocki is backed by Poland's populist-right opposition Law and Justice (Pis) party, and is wooing far-right voters ahead of parliamentary elections next year. For him and for Pis, the dispute is "political gold", says Renata Mienkowska-Norkiene, a political scientist. Mr Tusk and the other members of Poland's governing alliance, she says, are simply trying to keep pace.

这个问题在很大程度上是政治性的。纳沃罗基得到了波兰民粹主义右翼政党“法律与正义”党的支持，他正在争取明年议会选举中的极右翼选民。政治学家雷纳塔·米恩科夫斯卡-诺尔基耶内表示，对他和“法律与正义”党来说，这场争论就是“政治上的金矿”。她说，图斯克以及波兰执政联盟的其他成员只是试图跟上这一趋势。

For Mr Zelensky, the turn towards nationalist grandstanding is a departure. He previously joined in commemorating the victims of the Volhynia massacres. Last year his government approved allowing Polish researchers and civic groups to exhume victims' bodies, a long-standing Polish demand. That conciliatory diplomatic attitude is sorely needed now, on both sides. Instead the two countries are allowing historical squabbles to inflict severe damage on their relationship, to the detriment of Europe and themselves, and to the benefit of Russia.■

对于泽伦斯基先生来说，这种转向民族主义作秀的做法是一种背离。他之前曾参与纪念沃里尼亚大屠杀的受害者。去年，他的政府批准让波兰研究人员和民间组织挖掘遇难者遗体，这是波兰长期以来的诉求。现在，双方都迫切需要这种和解性的外交态度。然而，两国却让历史恩怨继续损害彼此的关系，这不仅对欧洲有害，也对波兰自身不利，而俄罗斯则从中获利。

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Darkening mood

阴郁的情绪

Russians are growing anxious and angry

俄罗斯人越来越感到焦虑和愤怒了。

The war has come home and is everyone's problem

战争已经回归到人们的生活中，成了每个人的问题。

Jul 09, 2026 05:22 AM | MOSCOW AND ROSTOV

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:22 | 莫斯科和罗斯托夫



Operating steadily, apparently
似乎运行得非常稳定。

IN MIDSUMMER THE Moscow railway stations that serve southbound routes are usually bustling with holiday-makers. For the past four years stressed parents and children gazing towards the distant promise of the sea have mingled with men in uniforms. This summer the stations feel entirely different. Trains heading towards [Crimea](#) are spookily empty, the khaki is more prominent and there is a pervading sense of anxiety. As is the case everywhere in Russia, the talk is of petrol shortages, [drone strikes](#), internet outages and the threat of a new round of mobilisation.

在仲夏时节，莫斯科的火车站对于那些前往南方的旅客来说，通常都是热闹非凡的。在过去的四年里，那些带着孩子、面带疲惫的家长，与穿着制服的军人们一起，共同期待着远方的海景。然而今年夏天，火车站的气氛却截然不同。前往克里米亚的火车上空无一人，军装更加显眼，而空气中弥漫着一种不安的气氛。就像在俄罗斯的其他地方一样，人们都在谈论着石油短缺、无人机袭击、网络中断，以及新一轮军事动员的威胁。

Not since reservists were first mobilised to fight in Ukraine in 2022 have Russians felt so [unnerved](#). On July 2nd the Public Opinion Foundation (FOM), a pollster close to the Kremlin, reported that 55% said their colleagues and relatives felt anxious, up from 40% last year. Russia's social contract, whereby citizens stayed out of politics and the authorities left them alone, has been broken. The war has come home and is everyone's problem. Drone attacks, once confined to the border cities of Kursk and Belgorod, now threaten much of the country. On July 6th [Ukrainian drones](#) struck Russia's largest refinery in Omsk, some 2,500km from the front line.

自 2022 年预备役军人被动员前往乌克兰参战以来，俄罗斯人从未如此感到不安。7 月 2 日，与克里姆林宫关系密切的民意调查机构 FOM 报道称，有 55% 的人表示他们的同事和亲戚感到焦虑，而去年这一比例为 40%。俄罗斯所依赖的社会契约——即公民不参与政治事务，而

政府也不干预民众生活——已经破裂。战争已经深入到普通民众的生活之中，成为每个人的问题。无人机袭击从最初仅限于库尔斯克和别尔哥罗德等边境城市，现在已威胁到整个俄罗斯。7月6日，乌克兰的无人机袭击了距离前线约2500公里的俄罗斯最大炼油厂——奥姆斯克炼油厂。

[*Read more of our recent coverage of the Ukraine war*](#)

[*阅读我们关于乌克兰战争的最新报道。*](#)

Petrol is being rationed across the country. Drivers wait two or three hours to buy the maximum daily allowance of 20 or 30 litres. Some filling stations have run dry. In Crimea and Novorossiysk, a city on the Black Sea, authorities have banned retail petrol sales; only officials, public services and businessmen connected to fuel operators may fill up. Two oil facilities near Novorossiysk have been destroyed. Valery, who owns a grocery shop in the city, expects fuel shortages to have a knock-on effect on food deliveries and other logistics. Food prices have already been affected: in June the cost of potatoes rose by 4.5% from a month earlier. Some farmers say they will not be able to harvest their crops if fuel shortages continue.

全国范围内正在对汽油进行配给供应。司机们需要等待两三个小时才能购买每天最多20或30升的汽油。一些加油站已经断货了。在克里米亚和黑海沿岸的城市诺沃罗西斯克，当局禁止了汽油的零售销售；只有与石油公司有关联的官员、公共服务机构以及商人们才能加注汽油。诺沃罗西斯克附近的两座石油设施已被摧毁。在该市经营杂货店的瓦莱里预计，燃料短缺将会对食品配送和其他物流业务产生连锁影响。食品价格已经受到影响：六月份，土豆的价格比上个月上涨了4.5%。一些农民表示，如果燃料短缺持续下去，他们将无法收获庄稼。

In the Rostov region, in southern Russia, the owner of several stalls that sell local produce says she dreams of having her own fuel tanker. "They can all go to hell with their ideas and grand ambitions," she says. "They" include Vladimir Putin, Donald Trump, Volodymyr

Zelensky, Emmanuel Macron and local governors. "We used to live just fine. Now all you do is scramble from one problem to the next."

在俄罗斯南部的罗斯托夫地区，几家销售当地农产品的商店的老板表示，她们都梦想能拥有自己的燃料运输船。“那些人带着他们的想法和宏伟计划去见鬼吧，”她说。“那些人”包括弗拉基米尔·普京、唐纳德·特朗普、沃洛迪米尔·泽连斯基、埃马纽埃尔·马克龙以及当地省长们。“以前我们生活得挺好的。现在呢，我们总是从一个问题陷入另一个问题之中。”



● Ukrainian air/drone strikes in Russia, 2026*

■ Russian-controlled, July 8th 2026

*To June 29th, targets at least 100km from the Ukrainian border

Sources: ACLED; Institute for the Study of War; AEI's Critical Threats Project

Elena Panfilova, who conducts focus groups in Moscow, says the mood is turning from frustration to seething hatred of the authorities. It is not just the fuel shortages and internet outages that make people angry, but the widening gap between reality and the Kremlin's rhetoric. "The only way out is to stop [hostilities]," says Valery. "We have been hearing upbeat reports that 'Russian troops are confidently advancing along the entire front line' for all four years. Yet if you look at the maps, everything is bogged down in a swamp."

在莫斯科进行焦点小组调查的埃琳娜·帕尼洛夫表示，人们的情绪正从沮丧转向对当局的强烈仇恨。让人们愤怒的不仅仅是燃料短缺和互联网中断问题，还有现实与克里姆林宫的言辞之间的巨大差距。“唯一的出路就是停止敌对行动，”瓦莱里说。“四年来，我们一直听到一些乐观的消息，称‘俄罗斯军队正在全线顺利推进’。然而，如果你看看地图，就会发现一切都在沼泽中陷入停滞。”

Mr Putin continues to insist that the war is mostly going to plan. In a recent interview, reading his answers from an autocue, he said: "Everything is operating steadily and with a substantial margin of resilience." His bare acknowledgment of the change in circumstances suggests he may still be deciding on his next course of action. Many Russians fear that instead of cutting his losses and scaling back, he will double down on the conflict.

普京先生继续坚称战争目前处于可控状态。在最近的一次采访中，他通过读自动生成的回答来表述自己的观点，他说：“一切都在顺利进行中，而且具有相当大的抗衡能力。”他虽然承认形势已经发生变化，但似乎仍可能在考虑下一步的行动方案。许多俄罗斯人担心，他不会放弃战争，而是会加大战争的力度。

Talk of mobilisation has intensified. In early June Sergei Gurulev, a deputy in parliament, wrote on social media that a decision to mobilise in autumn had already been made. Later he deleted his post, claiming it had been hacked. "It always happens like this: first there are rumours that something bad will happen, then the

authorities start denying it, and then it happens,” says another Sergei, who works for an advertising firm in Nizhny Novgorod, east of Moscow. He is thinking of moving to the countryside, where it would be harder for recruiters to find him: “Going to the office will become suicide.” Many of his colleagues are considering fleeing the country. Discussion of emigration is at its most persistent since 2022.

关于动员行动的讨论日益激烈。6月初，议会议员谢尔盖·古鲁列夫在社交媒体上写道，秋季动员的决定已经做出了。后来他删除了那条帖子，声称帖子被黑客攻击了。“这种情况总是如此：一开始会有谣言说会有不好的事情发生，然后当局会否认这些谣言，最后事情真的发生了。”另一位名叫谢尔盖的人说道，他在莫斯科东部的下诺夫哥罗德的一家广告公司工作。他考虑搬去乡下，那样招聘人员就很难找到他了：“回到办公室简直就是自杀行为。”许多同事都在考虑离开这个国家。自2022年以来，关于移民的讨论一直很活跃。

Tests for another round of mobilisation may be under way in the Penza region, south-east of Moscow. Since mid-June locals have been reporting that men are being grabbed in public and in door-to-door sweeps, taken to assembly points and forced to sign contracts with the army. Noticeably fewer men are now on the streets. “The atmosphere in the city is terrible,” says Elena, a resident. “I forbade my husband from leaving the house. When I go out, I lock him from the outside. We keep the curtains drawn all day.” Andrey Surkov, Penza’s military commissar, claimed the raids were simply to hunt for draft dodgers and deserters.

在莫斯科东南部的佩扎地区，可能正在开展新一轮动员测试。自6月中旬以来，当地居民报告称，有男子在公共场合被抓走，被带到集中地，并被迫与军队签订协议。现在，街上的男子数量明显减少了。“城市里的气氛非常糟糕，”一位居民埃琳娜说。“我禁止我的丈夫外出。当我出门时，我会把他锁在屋外。我们整天都紧闭着窗帘。”佩扎的军事指挥官安德烈·苏尔科夫声称，这些搜捕行动只是为了寻找那些逃避兵役和叛逃的人。

Bolshier brigades

更大的部队

Dissent is becoming more open. On June 25th a former soldier posted an appeal to Mr Putin on Instagram, saying soldiers were being tortured for refusing to hand over their earnings to commanders or to carry out suicidal missions, with many “zeroed out” (killed). “Vladimir Vladimirovich, pay attention to this. Invite me to meet you. Otherwise the army will turn its weapons on the Kremlin.” The man was predictably arrested (and later released), but by then the video had gained 20m views. From soldiers to street merchants, discontent is rising. As Sergei in Nizhny Novgorod says, “Nobody understands what all this is for, other than perhaps to satisfy Putin’s ego. If people protest, they go to jail. All we can hope for now is that he dies.” ■

反对的声音越来越明显了。6月25日，一名前士兵在 Instagram 上向普京先生发出呼吁，称那些拒绝将收入交给指挥官或执行自杀式任务士兵们正在遭受折磨，许多人因此丧命。“弗拉基米尔·弗拉基米罗维奇，请关注这件事。请安排我与您会面。否则，军队将会把武器对准克里姆林宫。”不出所料，这名士兵被逮捕了（之后被释放），但那时该视频的浏览量已经达到了 2000 万。从士兵到街头小贩，不满的情绪正在上升。正如尼什尼诺夫哥罗德的谢尔盖所说：“除了满足普京的虚荣心之外，没人明白这一切是为了什么。当人们抗议时，他们就会入狱。现在我们所能希望的，就是让他死去。”■

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查理曼

Europe's public broadcasters go from prime time to hard-to-find

欧洲的公共广播机构正在努力让黄金时段变得不那么容易找到。

Apathetic teenagers and culture warriors are hobbling venerable state media outlets

毫无热情的青少年和那些热衷于文化斗争的人正在拖着沉重的身躯行走在那些老旧的媒体机构上

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2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:22



EVERY EVENING in dozens of European countries, a soothingly familiar ritual unfolds. Cued in by a few bars of portentous music, a much-loved newsreader delivers the day's happenings with the solemnity of a suburban accountant. A cheery meteorologist then gestures at a map in a segment not much changed since the 1950s, bar the warming weather. Later a costume drama reminds viewers of a more decorous past. As the evening trundles on, a series imported from America passes the time, or a game show with unfathomable rules. On the other side of the television screen, meanwhile, teenagers slumped on the living-room sofa are utterly unaware that any of this exists as they guzzle another hour of TikTok on their phones before turning their attentions to YouTube.

在每个欧洲的夜晚，都会上演着一种既熟悉又温馨的仪式。随着几段充满预兆的音乐响起，一位深受喜爱的新闻主播会以一种像郊区会计一样严肃的态度报道当天的新闻。接着，一位热情洋溢的气象学家会在地图上指指点点，而地图上的内容其实和 20 世纪 50 年代没什么不同，只是天气情况有所改善而已。之后，一段关于历史故事的节目会让观众想起更美好的过去。随着夜晚的流逝，一些从美国引进的节目也会继续播放，或者是一档规则复杂的游戏节目。与此同时，在电视屏幕的另一边，一些青少年正瘫坐在客厅的沙发上，他们完全不知道

这些事情的存在，他们继续在手机上刷着 TikTok，然后才转向 YouTube。

Likely as not, the content being studiously ignored by youngsters is the work of a public-service broadcaster, or PSB. These enduring mastodons are often known by their mere initials—RAI in Italy, ZDF in Germany, TVP in Poland or the BBC in Britain. They are integral to modern European polities. Funded by the state but somehow not of it, they have long been as recognisable to citizens as royal families and the postal service. (Brits call theirs “Auntie”.) Turn on an old-fashioned television set and it will probably serve up a channel hosting a PSB as the cathode ray tubes warm up. Fiddle with your car’s radio and soon enough the sound coming through the static will belong to a publicly funded disc jockey.

很可能，那些被年轻人刻意忽视的内容，其实是由一些公共广播机构制作的。这些历史悠久的广播机构通常以首字母来命名——比如意大利的 RAI、德国的 ZDF、波兰的 TVP，以及英国的 BBC。它们是现代欧洲社会中不可或缺的一部分。这些机构虽然由国家资助，但实际上并不属于国家所有。长期以来，它们已经与皇室家族和邮政服务一样，成为民众熟悉且信赖的机构。（英国人把它们称为“阿姨”电台。）打开一台老式的电视机，可能会看到某个频道由这样的公共广播机构运营着，而阴极射线管在加热的过程中也会发出相应的声音。调整一下汽车收音机，很快，从收音机中传出的声音就会属于某个由公共资金支持广播主持人了。

For decades after their founding in the 20th century, PSBs had a charmed life: the public in search of information or titillation had few alternatives. Commercial rivals sometimes made inroads, beating PSBs in the ratings by offering racier shows. But public broadcasters’ funding was guaranteed by a dedicated licence fee levied on households, with advertising a handy sideline. Everyone knew where to find them. Their news set the national agenda. Once a year PSBs from Portugal to Finland joined forces for the Eurovision Song Contest, a festival of kitschy pop put on by the European

Broadcasting Union (EBU), their umbrella group.

在 20 世纪成立以来的几十年里，这些公共广播机构一直享有得天独厚的地位：那些寻求信息或娱乐内容的公众几乎没有其他选择。虽然商业竞争对手有时会试图打入这一领域，通过提供更吸引人的节目来击败公共广播机构在收视率上的优势。不过，公共广播机构的资金是由对家庭征收的特许费来保障的，而广告则成为了它们的重要收入来源。大家都清楚去哪里可以找到这些公共广播机构。它们的新闻节目成为了全国性的焦点。每年，从葡萄牙到芬兰的公共广播机构都会联合起来举办欧洲歌唱大赛——这是由欧洲广播联盟举办的、充满趣味味的流行音乐盛会。

Alas, times have changed as jarringly as the key in a 1990s Eurovision ballad. These days PSBs are under attack from an unlikely alliance of apathetic teenagers, American tech giants and culture-warring politicians. Without changes in regulation, broadcasters whose brands were once synonymous with radio and television fear they will be forgotten, if not gone. Should that happen, they argue, a venerable part of Europe's social fabric will have frayed.

唉，时代已经发生了巨大的变化，就像 1990 年代的欧洲歌唱大赛中的旋律一样。如今，公共广播公司面临着由冷漠的青少年、美国科技巨头以及热衷于文化冲突的政客们组成的联盟的攻击。如果不进行监管方面的改革，那些曾经与广播和电视紧密相连的公共广播公司就可能会被遗忘，甚至消失。他们认为，如果这种情况发生，欧洲社会结构中一个重要的组成部分就会逐渐瓦解。

The politicians offer the noisiest spectacle. Once the biggest threat from officialdom was meddling in editorial affairs, particularly in central Europe, where autocrats sometimes turned PSBs into mouthpieces. (The Hungarian one once controlled by Viktor Orban's regime apologised on July 7th for its past lies, and paused news programming.) Now the threat is more subtle, but also more widespread. Populists, particularly on the hard right, dislike PSBs, which they see as run by air-kissing urbanistas who turn up their noses at rural and working-class types. Alternative for Germany and

France's National Rally have vowed to privatise their respective state broadcasters. Giorgia Meloni in Italy has been accused of politicising RAI. In Switzerland a recent referendum called for a slashing of the licence fee—though it was comfortably defeated.

那些政客们总是制造各种麻烦。过去，官方势力最大的威胁就是干涉媒体事务，尤其是在中欧地区，一些独裁者甚至将公共电视台变成自己的宣传工具。（例如，匈牙利的一个电视台在 7 月 7 日因过去的虚假报道而道歉，并暂停了新闻节目播放。）现在，这种威胁更加隐蔽，但范围却更广。民粹主义者，尤其是极右翼分子，非常讨厌公共电视台，他们认为这些电视台由那些喜欢讨好城市精英的人掌控，而他们则对农村和工人阶级群体嗤之以鼻。德国的“德国选择”和法国的“法国国民联盟”都承诺要私有化各自的国有电视台。在意大利，乔尔吉亚·梅洛尼被指责将 RAI 电视台政治化。在瑞士，最近的一次公投呼吁降低电视订阅费，不过这一提议以微弱优势被否决了。

Partly as a result, PSB budgets have been squeezed. They have fallen by a tenth in the past decade, says the EBU—even as pricey obligations, such as running regional radio broadcasts or maintaining classical-music orchestras, have not disappeared. Licence fees that guaranteed editorial independence are sometimes being replaced by straight-up government funding. The populist Czech government is mulling such a move, alongside funding cuts. That would erode the safeguards against politicians meddling in editorial output, warns René Zavoral, head of the public radio there.

因此，波西米亚广播公司的预算受到了压力。根据 EBU 的数据，在过去的十年里，其预算减少了十分之一。不过，那些昂贵的义务，比如进行地区性广播节目播放或维持古典音乐乐团的工作，却并未消失。那些用于保障新闻独立性的许可费用，现在有时被政府的直接资金所取代。民粹主义的捷克政府正在考虑采取这样的措施，同时也会考虑削减相关资金。公共广播电台的负责人雷内·扎沃拉尔警告说，这样做会削弱防止政客干预新闻内容的保障措施。

Worse, the funding squeeze comes just as PSBs are no longer so sure of finding an audience. Like newspapers and other traditional media,

they are facing stiffer competition. Younger viewers go for streamed series over linear television, and prefer podcasts to radio. Though PSBs offer these, they often do so via platforms controlled by tech giants. These serve up content based not on the public interest, but on what keeps up engagement. Buy a TV these days and the remote control may well include a Netflix or YouTube button. Finding a PSB's output might take quite a bit of fiddling, buried on the 15th page of a television menu between a Korean yoga app and a shopping channel that has paid to be featured.

更糟糕的是，在公共电视台面临资金压力的同时，它们也难以确保能找到合适的受众群体。就像报纸和其他传统媒体一样，公共电视台面临着更加激烈的竞争。年轻的观众更喜欢在线流媒体服务，而他们也更喜欢播客而不是广播节目。虽然公共电视台也会提供这些服务，但往往是通过科技巨头控制的平台来提供这些内容。这些平台提供的内容并非基于公众利益，而是为了维持观众的兴趣。如今，只要购买一台电视，你会发现遥控器上很可能就有 Netflix 或 YouTube 的按钮。要找到公共电视台的节目，可能需要花费大量时间，因为节目信息可能被隐藏在电视菜单的第十五页，介于某个韩国瑜伽应用或那些花钱获得展示位置的购物频道之间。

The state broadcasters' latest gambit is thus to find regulatory ways to keep their perch. The EBU is lobbying for the European Union to mandate "prominence" rules for PSBs. These might force makers of TV sets or car radios, for example, to ensure it is easy to find state media. More controversially, it might result in social-media titans like TikTok, YouTube or Facebook being forced to serve up state-funded content, on the dubious logic that this is somehow of higher quality. "What we want is for people to have the choice to see our content," says Noel Curran, the EBU's boss.

因此，这些国有媒体机构最新的策略就是寻找各种监管手段来维持自己的地位。EBU 正在游说欧盟制定“优先级”规定，以要求国有电视台遵循这一标准。这可能会迫使电视设备制造商或车载收音机制造商确保用户能够轻松找到国有媒体的内容。更具争议的是，这可能会迫使像 TikTok、YouTube 和 Facebook 这样的社交媒体巨头提供国有媒体

内容，其背后的逻辑是认为这类内容在某种程度上质量更高。“我们希望人们能够有选择地观看我们的内容，”EBU 的负责人 Noel Curran 说道。

But who then killed the video star?

那么，到底是谁杀了这个视频明星呢？

Whether teenagers know it or not, public-service broadcasters matter. Yes, they overplay their distinctiveness: on a recent evening France 2 aired six back-to-back episodes of a dubbed detective series, while those in other countries served up World Cup football. That is hardly fare the commercial sector would shun. Some PSBs are bloated, their stars overpaid. But even if imperfect, these stalwarts of shared public consciousness offer a remedy against the polarisation affecting European societies, a trusted place for nations to see themselves reflected. In case of a war or crisis, the public would not turn to some YouTube influencer for information—they would flock to established state-run outlets. If they could remember how to find the channel, that is.■

无论青少年是否意识到，公共服务型媒体仍然具有重要意义。当然，这些媒体的独特性被过度夸大了：比如，最近有一期法国电视台连续播放了六集译制版的侦探剧；而其他国家则播放了世界杯足球比赛。这样的内容显然不是商业媒体会选择的。一些公共服务型媒体过于臃肿，其明星员工的薪酬也过高。不过，即便这些媒体存在不足，它们仍然是欧洲社会两极分化现象的一个解决方案，是各国民众可以信赖的媒体平台。在战争或危机发生时，人们不会去依赖一些 YouTube 上的网红来获取信息——他们会转向那些经过验证的国有媒体平台。当然，前提是人们还能记得如何找到这些频道。

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EIGHTEEN MONTHS ago Republicans in Texas took on a new fight. It began in February 2025, when Greg Abbott, the governor, described a housing development proposed by the East Plano Islamic Centre as an example of “sharia cities”. A dozen state agencies then launched investigations. In November he designated the Council on American-Islamic Relations (CAIR), America’s biggest Muslim civil-rights group, a “foreign terrorist organisation” and barred it from buying land in the state. In March the state comptroller shut Muslim schools out of Texas’s new voucher scheme. The state Republican Party now ranks “Stop the Islamification of Texas” second on its list of legislative priorities.

十八个月前，德州的共和党人开始了一场新的斗争。这一切始于 2025 年 2 月，当时州长格雷格·阿博特将东普兰伊斯兰中心提议建设的住宅开发项目称为“伊斯兰教城市”的典范。随后，十几个州政府机构开始对此展开调查。11 月，他宣布美国伊斯兰关系委员会——这个美国最大的穆斯林民权组织——为“外国恐怖组织”，并禁止其在该州购买土地。3 月，州审计局将穆斯林学校排除在德克萨斯州新的奖学金计划之外。目前，德克萨斯州共和党党纲将“阻止德克萨斯州的伊斯兰化”列为第二大立法优先事项。

On its face, this looks like a revival of the backlash to radical Islam that followed the 9/11 attacks. But today’s campaign is driven by fear not so much of external violence as of internal transformation. Across the country, support is swelling for ideas that fuse American civic life with Christian values, loosely defined as Christian nationalism. How this agenda will evolve is still unclear. But Texas, America’s largest Republican state, is now showing one way forward, asserting America’s Christian roots while battling fiercely against a perceived threat.

从表面上看，这似乎是对 9/11 袭击事件之后对激进伊斯兰思想的反弹的再现。但今天的这场运动背后的驱动力并非对外暴力行为的恐惧，而是对内部变革的担忧。在全国范围内，越来越多的人支持将美国公民生活与基督教价值观相结合的理念，这种基督教民族主义可以被看作是一种新的政治思潮。不过，这一理念的具体发展方向仍不清

楚。不过，美国最大的共和党州——德克萨斯州，正在提供一种可行的解决方案：在强调美国基督教根源的同时，坚决抵制那些被视为威胁的伊斯兰思想。

“The United States of America was founded as a Christian nation,” Mr Abbott stated earlier this year, as part of a defence of religious freedom. Other prominent proponents of America’s Christian identity include J.D. Vance, the vice-president, Pete Hegseth, the secretary of war, and Charlie Kirk, a conservative influencer assassinated in 2025. Kirk, to whom Donald Trump posthumously awarded the Presidential Medal of Freedom, tied America’s Christian character to a specific composition of citizenry. America, he argued, was living through a “constitutional crisis” because “you cannot have liberty if you do not have a Christian population”.

“美国作为一个基督教国家而建立起来，”阿博特先生在今年早些时候表示。他以此来捍卫宗教自由。其他支持美国基督教身份的重要人物包括副总统 J.D.万斯、战争部长皮特·赫格塞斯，以及 2025 年被暗杀的保守派影响者查理·柯克。柯克被唐纳德·特朗普追授总统自由勋章，他将美国的基督教特性与公民的特定构成联系在一起。他认为，美国正经历着一场“宪法危机”，因为“如果没有基督教信徒，就无法实现自由”。

A growing number of politicians view Islam, in particular, as a threat to the country’s identity. In the 13 months to March, 46 Republican elected officials across America published 1,111 anti-Muslim posts, a 15-fold increase in monthly volume, according to the Centre for the Study of Organised Hate, a watchdog group. Many painted Islam as a death cult working to indoctrinate children and take over society. Tommy Tuberville, a senator from Alabama, shared a post that paired photos of New York’s Muslim mayor with the burning twin towers, warning that “the enemy is inside the gates.” Andy Ogles, a Tennessee congressman, said that “Muslims don’t belong in

American society.”

越来越多的政客认为，伊斯兰教尤其是对国家身份认同的威胁。根据有监督作用的组织“有组织仇恨研究中心”的数据，在截至 3 月的 13 个月里，全美有 46 位共和党当选官员发布了 1,111 篇反对穆斯林的帖子，每月的发文数量增加了 15 倍。许多人在这些帖子中将伊斯兰教描绘成一个试图灌输思想、控制社会的死亡教派。阿拉巴马州的参议员汤米·塔伯维尔在帖子中分享了纽约穆斯林市长照片与双子塔燃烧的照片，并警告说“敌人就在城门口”。田纳西州的国会议员安迪·奥格尔斯则声称“穆斯林不应该存在于美国社会之中”。

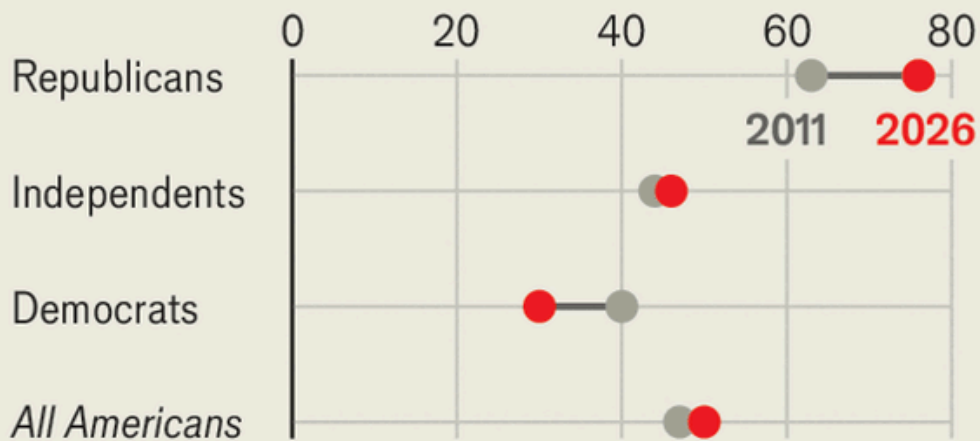
Mr Trump likes to point to European cities as disastrous parables, with Paris and London “no longer recognisable” and the latter moving towards “sharia law”. Last year two Texas congressmen, Chip Roy and Keith Self, founded the “Sharia-free America Caucus” in Congress. It has since recruited 66 other members from 25 states.

特朗普经常以欧洲城市为例，称其已经陷入灾难性境地。他指称巴黎和伦敦已经无法再被辨认，而伦敦正朝着“伊斯兰教法统治”的方向发展。去年，两位来自德克萨斯州的国会议员——奇普·罗伊和基思·塞尔夫——在国会成立了“无伊斯兰教法美国委员会”。自那以后，该委员会已经从 25 个州招募了 66 名成员。

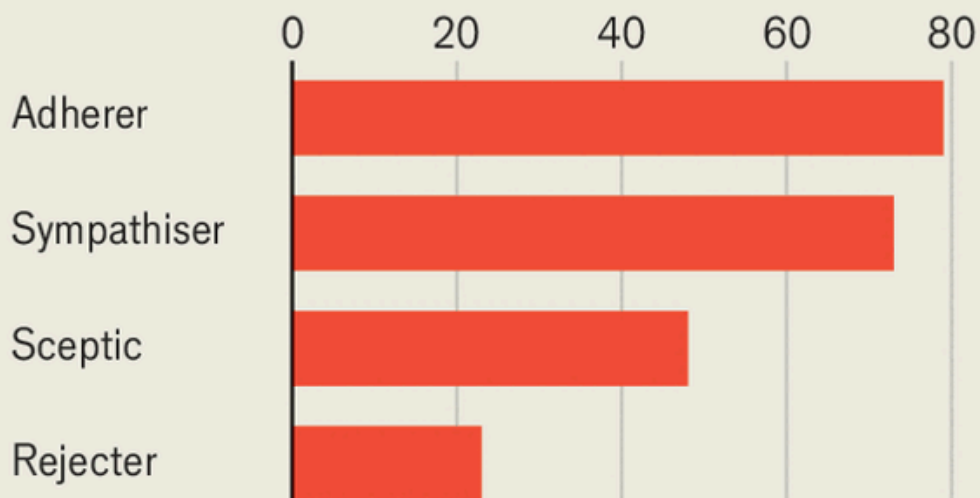
In conflict

“The values of Islam are at odds with American values and way of life”

% agreeing by party



% agreeing by support for Christian nationalist ideas, May 2026



Source: PRRI American Identity Surveys

This reflects a spreading anxiety within pockets of the electorate. Three-quarters of Republicans think that American values and Islam are in conflict, according to the Public Religion Research Institute, compared with 30% of Democrats, a partisan gap that has doubled since 2011 (see chart). Those who support the idea of America as a Christian nation are even more likely to think Islam is a risk.

这反映出部分选民中普遍存在焦虑情绪。根据公共宗教研究所的数据，四分之三的共和党人认为美国的价值观与伊斯兰教存在冲突；而民主党人中这一比例仅为 30%。这种党派差异自 2011 年以来已经翻了一番（参见图表）。那些认为美国是一个基督教国家的人，更有可能认为伊斯兰教是一种威胁。

With Muslims making up about 1% of the country's population, fears of a takeover may seem misplaced. To the movement's proponents, that isn't the point. "Christian values form the foundation of our nation and the constitutional system that governs our daily lives," noted Mr Self in a recent press release celebrating the success of the anti-sharia caucus. "Sharia and its principles", he added, "stand in direct opposition to those foundations." Muslims are the perfect foil for defining who is a "true citizen", says Andrew Whitehead, who studies Christian nationalism at the University of Indiana.

由于穆斯林占该国人口的约 1%，因此担心他们可能掌控政权似乎有些不合时宜。但对于该运动的支持者来说，这并非关键所在。“基督教价值观构成了我们国家以及管理我们日常生活的宪法体系的基础，”在最近一篇关于反伊斯兰教法派别成功的新闻稿中，塞斯先生如此说道。“而伊斯兰教法及其原则则直接与这些基础背道而驰。”印第安纳大学研究基督教民族主义问题的安德鲁·怀特黑德认为，穆斯林正是界定谁是“真正的公民”的最佳人选。

Congress has a few nascent bills. Mr Roy has introduced legislation to bar foreigners who observe sharia law from entering the country, and Randy Fine of Florida has filed a facetious one to "protect puppies" from sharia bans. Texas is a few steps ahead. Mr Abbott's office told *The Economist* that the governor's policies do not vilify

“law-abiding Texas Muslims”, but target “those who aid terrorism or attempt to impose foreign law on American soil”.

国会正在审议一些新的法案。罗伊先生提出了一项立法，旨在禁止遵守伊斯兰教法的外国人进入该国；而佛罗里达州的兰迪·芬则提出了一项看似荒谬的法案，其目的是“保护小狗免受伊斯兰教法的限制”。德克萨斯州则领先一步。阿巴顿先生的办公室向《经济学人》透露，州长的政策并非针对那些“遵守法律的德克萨斯州穆斯林”，而是针对那些“协助恐怖主义活动或试图在美利坚合众国境内实施外国法律的人”。

In practice, Republican ideas are wide-ranging, from the attempt to stop taxpayer funds going to any organisation that has “allegiance to a foreign legal system” to a push “to deport advocates of sharia law”. After the Texas legislature required the Ten Commandments to be displayed in classrooms last year, in late June the state board of education overhauled its curriculum. New guidelines drop a middle-school “World Cultures” class and replace high-school units that “explain the significant beliefs of Islam” with ones that “describe the teachings of jihad and how they led to the expansion of Islam and the conquest of Christian land”. Pupils will now be required to read more Bible stories.

在实践中，共和党的理念非常广泛，从试图阻止纳税人的资金被用于那些“遵循外国法律体系”的组织，到推动将“伊斯兰教法倡导者驱逐出学校”。去年，德克萨斯州立法机构要求在学校课程中教授《十诫》，因此在该州的教育委员会于6月底对课程大纲进行了改革。新的指导方针取消了中学阶段的“世界文化”课程，并用新的课程来替代高中阶段的课程，这些课程不再讲解伊斯兰教的信仰，而是讲述圣战的理念以及它们如何推动伊斯兰教的扩张和征服基督教土地的过程。现在，学生们需要阅读更多的圣经故事。

For Republicans who have defended religious liberty, this is awkward. Shaimaa Zayan of CAIR, the non-profit Mr Abbott branded a terrorist organisation, says what was once “Islamophobia” has now turned into “religious persecution”. “They’re trying to make our lives

hell so we self-deport,” she contends. Sam Westrop of the Texas Public Policy Foundation argues that the “mob-like noise” on social media obscures a genuinely dangerous rise in Islamist extremism in America. The right, he says, needs to realise that ordinary Muslims could be allies in the fight against it.

对于那些为宗教自由辩护的共和党人来说，这种情况令人尴尬。CAIR组织的 Shaimaa Zayan 指出，原本被称为“伊斯兰恐惧症”的现象，现在却变成了“宗教迫害”。她认为，那些人试图让我们生活陷入困境，从而迫使我们自己自我遣返。Texas Public Policy Foundation 的 Sam Westrop 则认为，社交媒体上那种狂热的言论掩盖了美国伊斯兰极端主义日益严重的现实。他说，右翼势力应该意识到，普通的穆斯林们可以成为反对伊斯兰极端主义的盟友。

When Oklahoma tried to quash consideration of sharia law by courts over a decade ago, a judge overturned the rule. Mr Abbott’s efforts in Texas have so far fared only slightly better. Courts have blocked the state’s attempt to exclude Islamic schools from the voucher programme and have allowed a religious-discrimination lawsuit brought by the East Plano Islamic Centre to proceed. A judge appointed by Ronald Reagan rebuked the state, observing that “no evidence has been presented” that the mosque intends to impose sharia law on Texans.

当俄克拉荷马州在十年前试图阻止法院审理伊斯兰教法相关案件时，一位法官否决了这一规定。阿博特先生在德克萨斯州的努力也仅取得了一些成果。法院阻止了该州将伊斯兰学校排除在券制教育计划之外的尝试，同时允许由东普兰伊斯兰中心提起的宗教歧视诉讼继续进行。由罗纳德·里根任命的法官批评了州政府的行为，指出“没有任何证据表明该清真寺打算对德克萨斯州的居民实施伊斯兰教法”。

This is unlikely to deter Texan legislators, who are due to reconvene in January. They will take cues from Mr Abbott. “The governor will not allow empathy to enable bad actors who would destroy Texas and America from the inside, as has already happened in the United

Kingdom,” says Andrew Mahaleris, his press secretary.

这不太可能阻止德克萨斯州的立法者们，他们预计将在一月再次召开会议。他们会效仿阿博特先生的做法。“州长不会允许那些试图从内部破坏德克萨斯州和美国的邪恶势力得逞，就像在英国已经发生的那样，”他的新闻秘书安德鲁·马海尔里斯说道。

Other states are taking note. Mr Fine, the Florida congressman, says a recent poll of Republican primary voters in his district found they cared seven times more about “Islam in America” than abortion, and six times more than about gun rights. When asked by *The Economist* to define “sharia law”, Mr Fine skirted the question, instead reiterating that Islam is rooted in an ideology of “conquest and submission” that threatens democracy. As for others who are pushing their religion into public life? The Jewish lawmaker is conciliatory. “The United States is a Christian nation,” he says. “We need to understand where we live.”■

其他州也注意到了这一现象。佛罗里达州的共和党议员 Fine 先生指出，对他所在选区进行的共和党候选人民意调查显示，选民们对“美国的伊斯兰教”的关注是堕胎问题的七倍，而对枪支权利的关注则是六倍。当《经济学人》杂志询问他如何定义“伊斯兰教法”时，Fine 先生避开了这个问题，而是重申伊斯兰教是一种以“征服与屈服”为核心的意识形态，这种意识形态威胁着民主制度。至于那些将宗教引入公共生活的人呢？这位犹太裔议员表示赞同：“美国是一个基督教国家，”他说，“我们必须明白自己生活的环境。”

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A reckoning

清算

What Graham Platner's collapse means for the Democrats

格雷厄姆·普拉特纳的崩溃对民主党意味着什么

The troubled Senate nominee has suspended his campaign in Maine
这位陷入麻烦的参议院候选人已经暂停了在缅因州的竞选活动。

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Shucked

剥了

GRAHAM PLATNER'S downfall is somehow both unsurprising and startling. For months Maine's Democratic nominee for Senate had weathered a [stream of controversies](#): from a tattoo resembling a Nazi symbol to years of inflammatory Reddit posts so prolific that a Maine newspaper created a searchable database of them. In spite of it all he managed to cling on.

格雷厄姆·普拉特纳的落败既不出乎意料，又令人惊讶。数月来，这位缅因州的民主党参议员候选人一直面临一系列争议：从带有纳粹符号的纹身，到在 Reddit 上发布的那些煽动性帖子——这些帖子数量之多，以至于缅因州的一家报纸甚至制作了一个可供搜索这些帖子的数据库。尽管如此，他仍然成功保住了自己的地位。

Then, on July 6th, *Politico* reported that Jenny Racicot, a former girlfriend of Mr Platner's, was accusing him of raping her in 2021. She alleges that he entered her home without permission and sexually assaulted her. Mr Platner denies this.

随后，在 7 月 6 日，Politico 报道称，普拉特纳的前女友珍妮·拉西科特指控他在 2021 年强奸了她。她声称普拉特纳未经允许进入她的家

中，并对她进行了性侵犯。普拉特纳对此予以否认。

But on the evening of July 8th, he announced that he was suspending his campaign. His selfie video is 11 minutes long and indignant: in it he accuses the “corporate media system and the political establishment” of serving as his “judge, jury and executioner”.

但在 7 月 8 日傍晚，他宣布暂停自己的竞选活动。他的自拍视频长达 11 分钟，他在视频中愤怒地指责“企业媒体系统和政治机构”充当他的“法官、陪审团和刽子手”的角色。

Many Democrats will now breathe a sigh of relief. Mr Platner’s odds of beating the Republican incumbent, Susan Collins, had dropped from 81% in late May to 56% this week, according to [*The Economist’s election model*](#). Mr Platner’s rise and fall is nonetheless an indictment of his party.

现在，许多民主党人可以松一口气了。根据《经济学人》的选举模型显示，普拉特纳击败共和党现任议员苏珊·柯林斯的几率，从 5 月底的 81% 下降到了本周的 56%。不过，普拉特纳的胜负情况实际上反映了他所在政党的不足。

For more than a decade Democrats have struggled to find a formula to win in the Trump era. In Maine Mr Platner, a former marine and plain-spoken oyster farmer, offered one answer. He quickly eclipsed Janet Mills, the state’s governor, who had been backed by party chieftains such as Chuck Schumer, the Senate majority leader. Ms Mills suspended her campaign in April. Prominent national Democrats brushed aside concerns about Mr Platner’s tattoo and posts, throwing their weight behind the new guy. Elizabeth Warren, a senator from Massachusetts, called Mr Platner “my kind of man”.

十多年来，民主党一直难以找到在特朗普时代获胜的策略。在缅因州，前海军陆战队员、直言不讳的牡蛎养殖者普拉特纳提出了一种解决方案。他的观点很快便超过了该州州长珍妮·米尔斯，后者得到了参议院多数党领袖查克·舒默等党内重要人物的支持。米尔斯在四月暂停

了竞选活动。那些著名的全国民主党人士并没有在意普拉特纳的纹身和社交媒体上的帖子，而是全力支持这位新候选人。来自马萨诸塞州的参议员伊丽莎白·沃伦称普拉特纳为“我喜欢的类型的人”。

The political stakes of choosing the right candidate could not have been higher. Of all the states with Republican-held Senate seats up for re-election this cycle, Maine alone voted for Kamala Harris in 2024. That makes it one of Democrats' best chances to flip a Republican seat—and probably essential to any hope the party has of winning a Senate majority.

选择合适的候选人所带来的政治意义不言而喻。在本轮选举中，有多个由共和党控制的参议院席位面临重新选举，但只有缅因州投票支持了卡玛拉·哈里斯成为 2024 年的候选人。这无疑是民主党扭转局势的最佳机会之一——对于任何希望赢得参议院多数席位的人来说，这至关重要。

The race's importance may have contributed to the myopia that followed. The *New York Times* reported in June that Lyndsey Fifeild, another former partner and current Republican strategist, was accusing Mr Platner of physical aggression. Ms Fifeild alleged that a decade earlier he twisted her arm behind her back, shoved her into a bedroom and prevented her from leaving, telling her she needed to stay there until she calmed down. She said he often grabbed her hard enough to leave marks. Mr Platner denied wrongdoing.

这项比赛的重要性或许导致了随后出现的这些问题。《纽约时报》在六月报道称，另一位前合作伙伴、现任共和党策略师林德西·菲菲尔德指控普拉特纳实施了身体攻击。菲菲尔德声称，十年前普拉特纳曾在她背后扭她的手臂，将她推进卧室内，并阻止她离开，还告诉她必须留在那里直到她平静下来。她还表示，普拉特纳经常用力抓住她的身体，以至于留下了痕迹。普拉特纳则否认了这些指控。

Sheldon Whitehouse, a senator from Rhode Island, dismissed Ms Fifeild's allegations as the tale of someone working in "right-wing political operations". Jennifer Welch, a liberal podcast host, told

listeners of her popular show: "I don't give a fuck if somebody had a toxic relationship...that's part of the human experience." Ms Racicot told *Politico* that the dismissive responses to Ms Fifield's allegations were one reason she decided to come forward.

罗德岛州的参议员谢尔登·怀特豪斯认为菲菲尔德女士的指控只是某个参与“右翼政治活动”的人所编造的谎言。自由派播客主持人詹妮弗·韦尔奇在她的热门节目中对听众说：“我根本不在乎某人是否有着糟糕的人际关系.....那都是人类生活的一部分。”拉西科特女士向《政治报》表示，对菲菲尔德女士的指控采取漠然态度，正是她决定站出来指控的原因之一。

In the hours after Ms Racicot's allegations were published, Democrats began rescinding their endorsements. Ro Khanna, the Democratic congressman for Silicon Valley and one of Mr Platner's staunchest supporters, said that "sexual assault or violence against women is a red line." Ms Warren and Ruben Gallego of Arizona withdrew their endorsements. The Maine Democratic Party said he should drop out, as did Bernie Sanders, a progressive senator from Vermont, who had helped to catapult Mr Platner's campaign.

在拉西科特女士的指控被公开后的几个小时内，民主党人士开始撤销对他们的支持。作为硅谷的民主党议员，罗·康纳是普拉特纳最坚定的支持者之一，他表示“对女性的性侵犯或暴力行为是不可容忍的”。亚利桑那州的沃伦女士和鲁本·加列戈也撤回了他们对普拉特纳的支持。缅因州的民主党方面表示，普拉特纳应该退出竞选，同样支持这一立场的还有来自佛蒙特州的进步派参议员伯尼·桑德斯，他曾帮助推动了普拉特纳的竞选活动。

Mr Platner had until July 13th to withdraw, and contends that deadline prompted his new accuser to come forward. "This was the last week to try to get me off of the ballot," he claimed in his video, bitterly.

普拉特纳先生有直到 7 月 13 日为止的退赔期限，但他认为这个期限促使新的指控者站出来指控他。“这是最后一周，他们试图让我摆脱这次投票的麻烦，”他在视频中痛苦地声称道。

Democrats now have two weeks to find a good nominee to replace him and unite the party. Many of Mr Platner's supporters will be reluctant to move on—he told them that the political system “is built structurally to make sure that movements like ours cannot flourish”. His easiest replacement would be Ms Mills, because she suspended her campaign rather than end it. But what she offers in logistical ease she lacks in political appeal. She has performed poorly in head-to-head polls against Ms Collins.

民主党现在只有两周的时间来选出合适的候选人来取代他，并团结党内力量。普拉特纳的许多支持者都不愿意放弃他的职位——他曾告诉这些人，政治体系“从结构上就注定无法让像我们这样的运动得以蓬勃发展”。对他来说，最简单的替代人选就是米尔斯女士，因为她选择暂停竞选活动，而不是放弃竞选。不过，米尔斯在后勤安排上确实比较方便，但在政治魅力方面则有所欠缺。在与柯林斯的直接对比中，她的表现并不理想。

Other candidates may fare better. Troy Jackson, a logger and former president of the state Senate, came third in the state's Democratic primary for governor, and Nirav Shah, a former health official, finished second. *The Economist's* election model estimates that a generic Democratic candidate would be a roughly five-point favourite over Ms Collins.

其他候选人或许会表现得更好。林业工人出身、曾担任州参议院议长的特洛伊·杰克逊在州民主党总统候选人竞选中获得了第三名，而前卫生部门官员尼拉夫·沙阿则位居第二。《经济学人》的选举模型估计，普通的民主党候选人相对于柯林斯女士来说，拥有大约五点的优势。

Ordinarily losing a nominee in a crucial Senate race in July would be catastrophic. In Maine this may give Democrats a way out of a candidacy that had become a liability. That still leaves Democrats

with a larger question: what kind of party do they want to be, and why did so many leaders embrace Mr Platner in the first place? ■

通常在 7 月份，如果在一个关键的参议院选举中失去一名候选人，那将是一个灾难性的结果。在缅因州，这或许能为民主党提供一个摆脱困境的机会。不过，民主党仍然面临一个更大的问题：他们究竟想成为什么样的政党？为什么有那么多领导人最初选择支持普拉特纳呢？

■

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Save yourself

请拯救你自己吧。

Why Donald Trump won't let a doomed bill die

为什么唐纳德·特朗普不会让这项注定失败的法案继续存在呢？

The SAVE Act is unlikely to pass Congress. Donald Trump may prefer it that way

SAVE 法案不太可能获得国会的通过。唐纳德·特朗普或许希望如此。

Jul 09, 2026 05:22 AM | WASHINGTON, DC

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:22 | 华盛顿特区



Sir, I'm gonna need to see some ID

先生，请您出示一些身份证明文件以便我确认您的身份。

AS THE MIDTERMS approach, Congress often becomes less productive. Members spend more time on the campaign trail, where they don't want to have to defend controversial votes. The incentive to compromise diminishes, not that there was much to begin with. Yet this Congress recently passed a bipartisan bill aimed at lowering housing costs. In the coming months it is due to take up other measures, including annual defence legislation and government-funding bills.

与中期选举的方式不同，在国会会议期间，议员们往往花费更多的时间在竞选活动上，他们并不愿意为那些有争议的投票结果负责。因此，达成妥协的动力就减弱了——毕竟一开始就没有多少东西可以妥协。不过，本届国会最近通过了一项两党合作的法案，旨在降低住房成本。在接下来的几个月里，还将讨论其他议题，包括年度国防立法和政府资助项目等。

But even that modest agenda has been thrown into doubt by Donald Trump's fixation on a bill with little chance of becoming law. Mr Trump says he will not sign any legislation until the SAVE Act is approved. Prediction markets put its odds at less than one in ten. John Thune, the Republican leader in the Senate, has repeatedly told the president that the measure lacks the 60 votes needed to overcome a filibuster. "This is a distraction," says a Republican aide. "We would like to be done with this, but it's an issue that won't go away." Why, then, won't the president let it?

不过，就连这个看似温和的议程也因唐纳德·特朗普对这项几乎不可能成为法律的法案的执着而变得难以确定。特朗普表示，在《拯救美国法案》获得批准之前，他不会签署任何相关立法。预测市场预计该法案通过的概率低于十分之一。参议院共和党领袖约翰·图恩多次提醒总统，该法案缺乏通过阻挠议事程序所需的 60 票支持。一位共和党助手说：“这纯粹是一种干扰行为。我们希望这个问题能尽快解决，但它确实不会轻易消失。”那么，为什么总统还要继续拖延呢？

At its core the SAVE Act would require voters to provide proof of citizenship, such as a passport or birth certificate, when registering to vote. They would also have to present photo identification to cast a ballot. States would be required to compare voter-registration rolls with federal citizenship records. Supporters describe the measure as an election-integrity reform that would increase public confidence and ensure that only citizens vote. Yet evidence of voter fraud by non-citizens—or anyone else—is vanishingly rare.

《拯救选举法案》的核心要求选民在登记投票时提供公民身份证明，例如护照或出生证明。此外，他们还需要出示带有照片的身份证件才能投票。各州必须将选民登记名单与联邦公民身份记录进行比对。支持者将这一措施视为一种提高选举公正性的改革措施，它能够增强公众的信心，确保只有公民才能参与投票。然而，非公民或其他人进行投票欺诈的行为却极为罕见。

The SAVE Act would, however, make it harder for citizens to register and vote. Around 12% of registered voters could not produce documentary proof of citizenship on short notice, according to the Bipartisan Policy Centre, a think-tank. Roughly half of Americans do not have a valid passport. Democrats and Republicans are about equally apt to have at least one qualifying document. Yet Republicans rely more heavily on birth certificates, which are more likely than passports to be rejected because of discrepancies. The SAVE Act could therefore hurt Mr Trump's own party more than Democrats.

然而，SAVE 法案可能会让公民更难进行注册和投票。根据两党政策中心的调查，大约 12% 的登记选民在短时间内无法提供公民身份证明文件。大约一半的美国公民没有有效的护照。民主党和共和党成员中，有至少一份符合条件的证件的人数量大致相同。不过，共和党人更依赖出生证明，而出生证明因信息不符而被拒签的可能性比护照要高。因此，SAVE 法案可能会给特朗普的政党带来更大的负面影响，而不是民主党。

For Mr Trump, the politics of the act may matter more than its practical effects. A recent *Economist*/YouGov poll found that 82% of Republicans thought voting by non-citizens in American elections was a serious issue, compared with 41% of independents and just 13% of Democrats. A majority of Americans (56%) support requiring documentary proof of citizenship to register to vote, but that view is held by almost all self-identified MAGA supporters (94%). “They love this, and so Trump’s going to continue talking about it,” says Douglas Heye, a Republican strategist. “And if Trump puts himself in a place where he’s fighting the leadership of his own party, his base loves that, too.”

对于特朗普来说，这项法案的政治意义可能比其实际效果更为重要。根据《经济学人》与 YouGov 最近的一项调查，82%的共和党人认为非公民参与美国选举投票是一个严重的问题，而独立派中只有 41%的人持这种观点，民主党人则只有 13%。大多数美国人（56%）支持要求选民提供公民身份证明才能登记投票，而这一观点几乎得到了所有自称“MAGA”支持者的认同（94%）。“他们喜欢这个想法，所以特朗普会继续谈论这个问题，”共和党策略师道格拉斯·海耶说。“如果特朗普让自己陷入与自己政党领导层的对抗，他的支持者也会喜欢这种局面。”

In private, Republican aides concede that Mr Trump will probably use the bill’s failure as a pretext to blame lawmakers if the party loses seats in the midterms. Critics see a broader purpose. They argue that the SAVE Act is part of an effort to undermine trust in elections. “The strategy was never about necessarily passing this bill,” argues Alexandra Chandler of Protect Democracy, a non-profit. “It’s about setting the pretext to claim that if Democrats win, then the election can’t be trusted.” Mr Trump has repeatedly made such claims. Earlier this month his administration ordered the FBI to beef up an investigation related to the 2020 election in Georgia, reviving his baseless allegations of widespread fraud in the contest he lost.

在私下里，共和党助手们承认，如果共和党在中期选举中失去席位，特朗普很可能会利用这项法案的失败作为借口来指责议员们。批评者

则认为这一法案有更深远的目的。他们认为，SAVE 法案是破坏人们对选举信任的一种手段。“这一策略并非一定要通过这项法案，”非营利组织“保护民主”的亚历山德拉·钱德勒说道。“其目的是制造借口，声称如果民主党人获胜，那么选举结果就不值得信任。”特朗普多次提出这样的主张。本月早些时候，他的政府命令 FBI 加强针对 2020 年乔治亚州选举的调查工作，重新提起他那些毫无根据的指控，称在那场选举中出现了大规模的欺诈行为。

Whatever the fate of the SAVE Act, Americans' trust in the electoral process has already been deeply eroded, not least by Mr Trump's repeated attacks on election integrity. Around 60% say they are confident votes will be counted accurately—a 17-point drop from two years ago. Only 25% say they are confident the midterms will not suffer interference.

无论 SAVE 法案的最终结果如何，美国人对选举过程的信任已经严重受损，这主要源于特朗普对选举公正性的不断攻击。大约 60% 的人认为选票会被准确统计——这一比例比两年前下降了 17 个百分点。只有 25% 的人认为中期选举不会受到干扰。

Meanwhile, the work of Congress has stalled. On June 30th a group of Republicans in the House blocked a defence bill from advancing in an effort to force Senate action on the SAVE Act. A week earlier, inside one of the Capitol's gilded halls, lawmakers from both parties milled around a stage, waiting for Mr Trump to sign the housing bill. But he was a no-show, refusing to do so until the SAVE Act was passed. To Mr Trump, “just about everything is a big yawn” by comparison. ■

与此同时，国会的审议工作也陷入了停滞。6 月 30 日，众议院中的一些共和党议员阻止了国防法案的审议，试图迫使参议院对 SAVE 法案采取行动。一周前，在国会大厦的某个华丽大厅里，来自两党的议员们围坐在舞台上，等待特朗普先生签署住房法案。但特朗普并没有出现，他拒绝在 SAVE 法案通过之前签署该法案。对特朗普来说，“几乎一切事情都让人感到无趣”。■

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Tech and its discontents

科技及其反对者

Rise of the Gen-Z Luddite

Z 世代的反对派崛起

Resistance to tech is brewing among digital natives

在数字原住民中，对技术的抵触情绪正在逐渐兴起。

Jul 09, 2026 06:42 AM | NEW YORK

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:42 | 纽约



“WE WILL FREE the iPad babies,” went one chant at the Summer of Ludd. **“No Gemini, no GPT, no Grok, no Claude,”** went another. The festival for big-tech sceptics, held in New York from June 28th to July 5th, stayed mostly true to its principles. Phones were banned.

The event had no social-media presence. Organisers relied on posters and word of mouth to publicise the festival. Perhaps as a result, the crowds were small. Yet those who came, most of them in their 20s, reflect an ambivalence about technology that is increasingly common among Generation Z.

“我们要解放那些被 iPad 束缚的人，”有人在“卢德之夏”音乐节上高喊道。“没有双子座系统，没有 GPT，没有格洛克，也没有克劳德，”另一个人补充道。这个针对科技怀疑论者的节日从 6 月 28 日持续到 7 月 5 日，基本上遵循了它的宗旨。人们被禁止使用手机。这个活动没有社交媒体宣传，而是通过海报和口口相传的方式来传播信息。或许正因为如此，参加活动的人数相对较少。不过，那些参加活动的人，大多数都在 20 岁左右，他们对于技术的态度表现出一种矛盾心理，这种态度在 Z 世代中越来越常见。

Members of this cohort are the first to have grown up entirely in the age of the smartphone. Now many are reflecting on what it has cost them. In 2024 nearly a quarter of Gen Z-ers told Harris, a pollster, that they wished smartphones had never been invented. More recent polling by Pew found that over half support banning under-16s from social media. Many are trying to reduce their own screen time, deleting apps or setting limits. Others, like the self-described Luddites in Manhattan, go further. At one point during the festival, devices were “executed” after standing trial.

这个群体中的成员是第一批完全在智能手机时代成长起来的人。现在，许多人都在思考智能手机给他们带来了什么代价。在 2024 年，近四分之一的 Z 世代年轻人表示，他们希望智能手机从未被发明出来。皮尤研究中心的最新调查显示，超过一半的人支持禁止 16 岁以下的人使用社交媒体。许多人试图减少自己的屏幕使用时间，删除一些应用程序或设定使用限制。还有一些人，比如曼哈顿那些自称“卢德派”的人，甚至采取了更激进的做法。在节日期间，甚至有设备因为“违法”而遭到销毁。

The original Luddites were 19th-century textile workers who resented the mechanisation of their industry. They were not opposed

to all technology, but feared for their livelihoods. Today's young Luddites do not shun the digital world entirely, but object to tracking tools, invasive algorithms and devices' effect on their social lives. Artificial intelligence has added another fear: 70% of Gen Z think AI will have a negative impact on jobs, according to Marist.

最初的“卢德派”是 19 世纪的纺织工人，他们不满于工业领域的机械化进程。他们并非完全反对所有技术，而是担心自己的生计会受到威胁。如今的“年轻卢德派”并非完全拒绝数字世界，但他们反对那些追踪工具、侵入性算法以及这些技术对社交生活的影响。根据 Marist 的调查，人工智能又增加了一个新的担忧：据该机构称，70% 的 Z 世代认为人工智能会对就业产生负面影响。



Some Gen Z-ers are trying to lead more analogue lives, swapping screen time for offline pursuits. Sales of flip phones and cassette tapes have risen. New “Luddite clubs” encourage people to give up their smartphones and social media, at least for a while. Ironically, going offline is being popularised online. Influencers post about gardening and puzzles as antidotes to doomscrolling, reframing tactile activities as a “luxury” lifestyle. A video on TikTok, encouraging a switch to an old iPod, has 3m views. (One commenter

asks how the device works without streaming.) Pinterest, a social network, is courting users by promising “it’s about life, not likes”.

一些 Z 世代的人试图过上更贴近现实生活的生活方式，减少在屏幕前的时间，转而从事线下活动。翻盖手机和磁带录音机的销量有所上升。一些新的“反科技俱乐部”鼓励人们暂时放下智能手机和社交媒体。讽刺的是，这种离线生活的方式其实是在线上被推广开来。一些网红在视频中分享园艺和谜题等内容，以此作为避免无休止刷屏的良策，并将触觉活动视为一种“奢侈”的生活方式。在 TikTok 上有一个视频，鼓励人们回归使用老式的 iPod 设备，该视频获得了 300 万次观看次数。有一位评论者甚至询问这种设备在没有流媒体服务的情况下还能如何使用。Pinterest 这个社交网络则通过承诺“这关乎生活，而非喜好”来吸引用户。

Even the Summer of Ludd is not entirely free from the tensions of the modern world. One attendee admits she was her group’s “designated smartphone user”, helping everyone else navigate the city. Still, the Luddites believe in their cause. Since giving up his smartphone three years ago, Nick Plante, 25, reports milestones such as being able to finish a book again. “This is the best I’ve felt, probably ever in my life.” ■

即便在“卢德之夏”这个节日里，现代世界的紧张局势也依然存在。有一位参与者坦言，自己是她的团队中的“指定智能手机使用者”，负责帮助其他人在城市中导航。不过，卢德派仍然坚信自己的信念。自从三年前放弃智能手机后，25 岁的尼克·普兰特表示，他能够再次读完一本书，这些都是值得纪念的成就。“这是我一生中最美好的感觉。”■

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The wizard

巫师

Mehmet Oz, Donald Trump's most effective TV star

梅赫梅特·奥兹，唐纳德·特朗普最出色的电视明星之一

The telegenic doctor enacting the president's agenda with professionalism and zeal

那位善于言辞的医生，以专业的态度和热情来执行总统的议程。

Jul 09, 2026 05:23 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:23



Get ready for your colonoscopy, America

准备好接受结肠镜检查吧，美国人！

FEW STUNTS were too bonkers for “The Dr Oz Show”, a TV programme, notionally on health, which ran from 2009 to 2022. Mediums and mentalists were regular visitors and quackery was common, with segments on green-coffee extract and raspberry ketone supplements. Mehmet Oz, the host, documented his own colonoscopy. The show was much loved, at its height getting 3m viewers a day.

在 2009 年至 2022 年期间播出的这档关于健康的电视节目《Dr. Oz Show》中，几乎没有哪个噱头是太过疯狂的了。经常会有魔术师和心理学家出现在这个节目中，各种伪科学内容也屡见不鲜——比如关于绿茶提取物以及黑莓酮补充剂的宣传内容。主持人 Mehmet Oz 甚至亲自体验了结肠镜检查。这个节目非常受欢迎，巅峰时期每天有 300 万观众观看。

None of this primed health-care wonks to be pleased when Donald Trump nominated Dr Oz as administrator of the Centres for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS), among the most important roles in Washington. Like Pete Hegseth, a former TV commentator appointed secretary of war, and Dan Bongino, a conservative podcaster turned deputy director of the FBI, Dr Oz seemed an odd choice for a serious job. The CMS administrator’s duties include running Medicare, the health-insurance programme for the old, and Medicaid, the programme for the poor. Dr Oz oversees \$1.6trn in annual payments and the health care of nearly two in five Americans.

当唐纳德·特朗普任命奥兹博士为医疗保险和医疗补助服务局的管理员时，那些热衷于医疗保健的专家们显然并不高兴。奥兹博士担任这一职务似乎是个奇怪的选择——毕竟，他并非适合担任这一重要职位的合适人选。医疗保险和医疗补助服务局的管理员负责运营医疗保险体系，该体系为老年人提供医疗保障，而医疗补助体系则为贫困人群提供医疗服务。奥兹博士负责监督每年 16 万亿美元的支付金额，以及近五分之一美国人的医疗保障事务。

But 14 months in, Dr Oz has emerged as one of Mr Trump's most effective lieutenants, advancing the president's priorities with competence and zeal. On June 29th Democrat-run states sued to challenge his implementation of health-care cuts for being too aggressive. On June 30th a New York fraud unit learned it would not receive federal money because it was being too soft. While other health agencies are plagued by turmoil, Dr Oz's CMS is reshaping swathes of American health care.

然而在 14 个月后，奥兹博士已经成为了特朗普最得力的助手之一，他以出色的能力和热情推动着总统的议程。6 月 29 日，由民主党控制的州提起诉讼，质疑他实施医疗改革措施的方式过于激进。6 月 30 日，纽约的一个反欺诈部门发现，由于他们的政策过于温和，因此无法获得联邦政府的资金支持。虽然其他卫生机构面临着诸多问题，但奥兹博士领导的医疗系统却正在重塑美国的医疗保健体系。

His propensity for videoed colonoscopies might, understandably, obscure other qualifications for his current role. He studied at Harvard and the University of Pennsylvania before becoming a heart surgeon. High-profile transplants gave him a springboard into his second career, as the man whom Oprah Winfrey crowned "America's Doctor". He ran for the Senate in Pennsylvania in 2022 and lost, amid criticism that he was out of touch.

他热衷于拍摄结肠镜检查的视频，这一点可以理解。不过，这一特点可能会掩盖他担任当前职务的其他资质。他在成为心脏外科医生之前，曾在哈佛大学和宾夕法尼亚大学学习。一些备受瞩目的移植手术经历为他打开了第二职业的大门，因此他被奥普拉·温弗瑞誉为“美国的医生”。2022 年，他竞选宾夕法尼亚州参议院席位，但败北，因为人们批评他与现实脱节。

But at CMS Dr Oz has hit his stride, energetically implementing the president's agenda: cutting Medicaid, slashing drug prices and [cracking down on fraud](#). Together these add up to a mishmash of policies that limit some Americans' access to care, expand it for others and provide ample opportunity for Mr Trump to put pressure

on states of his choosing.

但在 CMS 机构，奥兹博士正全力以赴地实施总统的议程：削减医疗补助支出、降低药品价格以及打击欺诈行为。这些政策加起来实际上限制了一些美国人获得医疗服务的能力，而让其他人的机会却得到了扩大。这为特朗普提供了充足的机会，让他能够对自己选择的州施加压力。

Having lobbied Congress for the Medicaid cuts in the One Big Beautiful Bill Act (OBBBA), Dr Oz is not just enacting the reductions but often stretching the interpretation of the law. For instance, OBBBA requires many Medicaid recipients to work 80 hours a month. But new rules from CMS are stricter than many states expected, prompting the lawsuit on June 29th.

通过游说国会，奥兹博士成功推动了《One Big Beautiful Bill 法案》中的医疗补助削减措施的实施。不过，他不仅实现了这一削减目标，还经常曲解该法律的条款。例如，根据《One Big Beautiful Bill 法案》的规定，许多医疗补助受益人每月需要工作 80 小时。但美国医疗补助服务中心新制定的规则比许多州预期的要严格得多，这便引发了 6 月 29 日的那场诉讼。

Americans with other forms of health insurance, meanwhile, stand to benefit from Dr Oz and the president's agenda. CMS has bypassed traditional rulemaking to cajole businesses, securing a promise from insurers to cut the number of treatments that require insurance reviews. Dr Oz has lobbied pharmaceutical firms to include more of their drugs on TrumpRx, the administration's marketplace for cut-price medicine. Separately, on July 1st CMS launched a pilot to let some Americans on Medicare get GLP-1 medications for \$50 a month. Nearly 4m people may qualify.

拥有其他形式健康保险的美国人也将从中受益。美国卫生与公共服务部通过绕过传统的规定程序来说服企业合作，从而获得了保险公司的承诺，即减少需要保险审批的治疗项目数量。奥兹博士还游说制药公司将其更多药物纳入特朗普处方药市场，该市场提供价格低廉的药品。此外，7 月 1 日，美国卫生与公共服务部启动了一项试点计划，

允许一些享受医疗保险的美国人以每月 50 美元的价格获得 GLP-1 类药物。大约有 400 万人可能有资格享受这一政策。

Dr Oz's crusade against health-care fraud makes use of different skills, and follows a particularly Trumpian pattern: identify a problem that is real but difficult to quantify, then unleash enforcement that, according to opponents, seems political. This CMS administrator is surely the first to invite the press on armed stings targeting alleged fraudsters. He accused the "Russian-Armenian mafia" of running "quite a bit" of fraud in Los Angeles, prompting Gavin Newsom, California's governor, to file a civil-rights complaint. (Dr Oz responded on X that Mr Newsom "will do literally anything to avoid talking about the rampant Medicare fraud in his state".)

奥兹博士在反对医疗欺诈方面的努力运用了多种手段，其做法颇具特朗普的风格：先找出一个真实但难以量化的问题，然后采取一些，反对者认为具有政治色彩的执法行动。这位医疗保险系统管理者无疑率先向媒体发出警告，声称有欺诈行为的人将会受到惩罚。他指责“俄罗斯-亚美尼亚黑帮”在洛杉矶进行了大量的欺诈行为，这导致加州州长加文·纽森提出了关于民权的投诉。（奥兹在 X 平台上回应说，纽森为了避免谈论其州内猖獗的医疗保险欺诈行为，愿意不惜任何手段。）

In April Dr Oz sent letters to all 50 governors instructing them to check providers in "high-risk" areas for fraud, warning "that failure to do so will be considered as we evaluate the likelihood of fraud in each state". This was not an empty threat. CMS has used concerns about fraud to attempt to delay \$1.6bn of Medicaid spending in California and Minnesota, requiring the states to provide additional information before paying out. Tim Walz, Minnesota's Democratic governor, accused the Trump administration of exploiting fraud as part of a "campaign of retribution".

四月份，奥兹博士向所有 50 个州的州长发送了信件，要求他们检查“高风险地区”的医疗服务提供者是否存在欺诈行为。他警告说：“如果不这样做，我们在评估每个州是否存在欺诈行为时就会考虑这一点。”

这并非空穴来风。由于担心存在欺诈行为，CMS 试图推迟加州和明尼苏达州 16 亿美元的医疗补助支出支付时间，要求这些州在支付资金之前提供更多的信息。明尼苏达州民主党籍州长蒂姆·沃尔兹指责特朗普政府利用欺诈行为作为“报复行动”的一部分。

For the president's critics, Dr Oz's efficiency is unsettling. At other agencies, poor execution and a disdain for the workings of government have sometimes frustrated the president's agenda. Dr Oz, though, talks to his predecessors, and has hired and promoted people with relevant experience. "He's probably been the most prepared CMS administrator of any that I know of," says Andy Slavitt, who oversaw CMS under Barack Obama.

对于总统的批评者来说，奥兹博士的治理能力令人不安。在其他机构中，糟糕的执行效率以及对政府运作的漠视，有时会阻碍总统的政策实施。不过，奥兹博士与他的前任们进行了沟通，并招募了具有相关经验的人士来担任重要职位。“他可能是我所知道的最有准备的系统管理员了，”在巴拉克·奥巴马时期负责系统管理的安迪·斯拉维特说道。

Mark McClellan, a CMS administrator under George W. Bush who receives calls from Dr Oz, notes that this is "different than the way leadership at some of the other [health] agencies has played out". Due to a time limit on interim appointments, the Centres for Disease Control is without an acting director. The Food and Drug Administration has lost its commissioner, seemingly in a spat about e-cigarettes. Even the post of surgeon-general, typically a PR job, is on its third nominee. If the churn continues, Dr Oz's unique skills may land him an even larger role. ■

马克·麦克莱伦是乔治·W·布什时期的卫生与公共服务部官员，他接到了奥兹博士的电话。他指出，这种情况与其他一些卫生机构的领导层情况不同。由于临时任命的时间限制，疾病控制与预防中心目前没有代理主任。食品药品监督管理局也失去了局长，似乎是因为与电子烟相关的争议。就连外科总长的职位，通常都是公关性质的职位，已经连续第三个人选了。如果这种情况持续下去，奥兹博士独特的技能或许能让他获得更重要的职位。■

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Lexington on America

《美国中的莱克辛顿》

The left's common-sense problem on crime

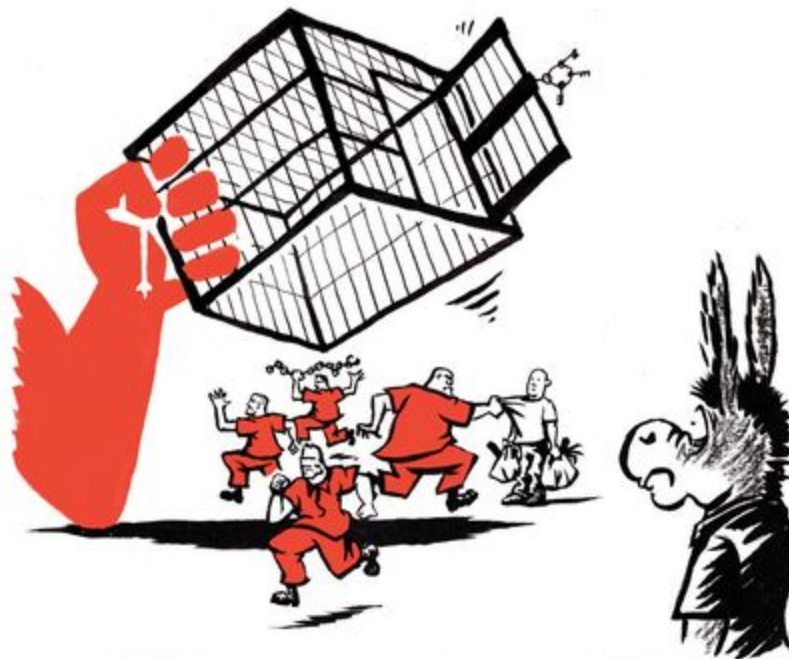
左派在犯罪问题上的现实困境

Radical ideas may seriously harm the Democratic Party

激进的理念可能会严重损害民主党的发展。

Jul 09, 2026 05:23 AM

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IT IS ODD that the Republican Party, whose leader has 34 felony convictions and a knack for turning power into cash, is more trusted

by voters to deal with crime. Yet that is what the polls say: YouGov puts Republicans ahead on this issue by 39% to 31%.

奇怪的是，共和党这位拥有 34 项重罪记录且擅长将权力转化为金钱的领导人，却在选民中更受信任，被认为更能够解决犯罪问题。不过，民意调查的结果确实如此：YouGov 调查显示，在这一点上，共和党人的得分比民主党人高出 39%。

Part of the problem is that people recall the summer of 2020, when riots paralysed American cities after a cop murdered George Floyd. Some on the left then embraced radical slogans, such as “defund the police”, by which a few actually meant “abolish” them. Rates of murder and other violent crimes have fallen sharply since 2021. But memories linger of the Democratic mayor of Seattle, who tolerated a police-free zone in the city centre that inevitably turned violent. And today, though the Democratic Party’s actual platform on crime is boringly mainstream, the chatter among progressive activists can sometimes veer into dottiness.

问题的一部分在于，人们仍然记得 2020 年的那个夏天，当时乔治·弗洛伊德被警察杀害后，骚乱使得美国的城市陷入瘫痪。当时一些左派人士提出了激进的口号，比如“停止资助警察”，但实际上他们想表达的却是“废除警察制度”。自 2021 年以来，谋杀和其他暴力犯罪的发生率已经显著下降。不过，人们仍然记得西雅图那位民主党市长，他允许在市中心设立无警察区，而这一举措最终导致了暴力事件的爆发。如今，尽管民主党关于犯罪的实际政策其实相当保守，但进步主义活动人士的言论有时还是会走向极端。

At Netroots Nation, a progressive conference in Philadelphia in June, *The Economist* met Felix Rosado, one of the speakers. Though a convicted murderer, he seemed a nice fellow. He is truly sorry about the life he took decades ago, when he was a drug-dealing teenager. After serving 27 years behind bars, he now runs “Let’s Circle Up”, a project promoting “restorative justice”—the perfectly sensible idea that criminals should take concrete actions to try to make amends to

those they have wronged.

在 6 月份于费城举行的进步主义会议“Netroots Nation”上，《经济学人》杂志采访了其中一位演讲者费利克斯·罗萨多。尽管他是一名被定罪的杀人犯，但看起来他是个不错的人。他对几十年前自己年轻时贩卖毒品时的行为感到非常后悔。在狱中度过了 27 年后，他现在致力于推动“修复性正义”的理念——即让罪犯通过实际行动来弥补他们曾经伤害过的人所遭受的损失，这是一个非常合理的想法。

However, he also thinks prisons and police should be scrapped. He talks of “creating the kind of world where cages are unnecessary”. If people were not poor, there would be less crime. And if, in this wonderful future, a few still stray, the “people in the community” should “determine what repair needs to look like”.

不过，他也认为应该废除监狱和警察制度。他主张“创建一个不需要牢笼的世界”。如果人们不那么贫穷，犯罪就会减少。而在这个美好的未来中，即使还有少数人犯罪，那么“社区中的人们”就应该决定需要什么样的矫正措施。

Very few Democrats would agree. But the Democratic Socialists of America, a group that endorses candidates in Democratic primaries and is on a roll this year, only recently removed prison abolition from its platform and still has an old page on its website that demands “freedom for all incarcerated people”. Darializa Avila Chevalier, a DSA-backed Democratic House candidate in New York, refused four times in a recent interview to agree that murderers should be locked up.

几乎没有民主党人会同意这种观点。不过，美国民主党社会主义者组织——一个在民主党初选中支持特定候选人的团体——今年势头强劲，他们最近才将废除监狱制度纳入了他们的竞选纲领中。他们的网站上还有一个旧页面，呼吁为所有被监禁的人争取自由。纽约州的民主党议员达里亚拉·阿维拉·谢瓦利埃在最近的一次采访中四次拒绝承认谋杀者应该被关押的观点。

The utopian idea of building a society where predators no longer prey on the weak, even when the state cannot forcibly remove them

from the streets, may win respectful nods in faculty lounges, but voters think it nuts. As for “community” justice, the theory sounds humane but the real-life alternative to a formal justice system has often been mob justice, as your columnist once saw in an underpoliced market in Zambia, where a crowd had caught a suspected thief. He was soaked in blood as they dragged him away.

那种构建一个没有掠夺者再欺负弱者的社会的乌托邦式设想，即使国家无法强制将那些掠夺者从街头驱逐出去，或许会在教职工的会议室里获得一些尊重。但选民们认为这种想法简直荒谬至极。至于所谓的“社区正义”，这个理论听起来很人道，但实际上，比起正式的法律体系，人们往往选择依靠黑帮的司法制度来解决问题。正如我的专栏作家在赞比亚的一个监管不力的市场中观察到的那样，当一群人抓住一个涉嫌盗窃的罪犯时，他浑身是血，被众人拖走的时候，他看起来就像个可怜的受害者。

Because extremism wins clicks, the stars of the progressive chattersphere are often extreme. Bank robberies are “cool”, says Hasan Piker, a lefty streamer with millions of followers. Mr Piker, who headlined a DSA event before New York’s primary, is “pro stealing from big corporations”, he told the *New York Times*, because they “steal” from workers by extracting surplus value from their labour. No politician would go so far, but some sympathise with shoplifters. “They are accessing things that their government will not provide,” suggests Chris Rabb, a DSA-backed House candidate from Pennsylvania. Or perhaps they are doing it “to punish a deceptive, unethical, profit-maximising business”.

因为极端主义能够吸引点击量，所以那些活跃在进步论坛中的人物往往都持有极端观点。左派主播 Hasan Piker 说道：“抢劫银行很酷。”这位拥有数百万粉丝的主播表示，他支持从大型企业中盗窃财物，因为企业从工人身上“窃取”剩余价值。不过，没有政治家会如此行事，不过有些人却同情那些商店扒手的行为。宾夕法尼亚州 DSA 支持的众议院候选人 Chris Rabb 说：“他们获取的是政府无法提供的东西。”或者，他们这么做是为了“惩罚那些不诚实、不道德且只追求利润的企业”。

The most alarming argument that some progressives make is that political violence is often justified. In an Emerson poll, 22% of Democrats thought the murder of a health-insurance boss in 2024 was “acceptable”. A *New Yorker* writer called the killing “an effective act of political consciousness-raising”.

一些进步人士最令人担忧的论点是：政治暴力往往是可以被正当化的。根据艾默森的调查，有 22% 的民主党人认为，在 2024 年杀害一位医疗保险负责人是“可以接受的”。一位《纽约客》的作家甚至将这起谋杀行为称为“一种有效的政治意识提升行为”。

What many of these ideas have in common, besides moral idiocy, is that they ignore incentives and knock-on effects. Yes, America should lock up fewer non-violent offenders. But if criminals can *never* be locked up, what will deter them from mugging you? Yes, some people struggle to afford groceries. But theft is hardly a solution to the affordability crisis. When some people steal, prices rise for everyone else. One can see a parallel with the left’s worst ideas about economics, which also gloss over incentives. Rent controls deter construction; rules making it hard to fire workers discourage firms from hiring them in the first place; and so on. A big difference, politically, is that whereas bad economics is often popular—58% of Americans and 75% of Democrats support rent controls, for example—far-left ideas on crime are not.

这些想法之所以相似，除了道德上的愚蠢之外，还在于它们忽视了激励机制和连锁反应。没错，美国应该关押更少的非暴力犯罪者。但如

果没有人可以被关押，那还能用什么来阻止人们实施抢劫行为呢？当然，有些人确实难以负担日常开支。但盗窃并不能真正解决经济负担问题。当一些人偷窃时，其他人的物价反而会上涨。这一点与左派关于经济学的错误观念颇为相似，因为左派同样忽视了激励机制的作用。租金管制会抑制建筑业的发展；而繁琐的法规会让企业不敢雇佣工人……政治上的区别在于，虽然糟糕的经济政策往往很受欢迎——例如，有 58% 的美国人以及 75% 的民主党人支持租金管制——但关于犯罪的极左派观点却并不受欢迎。

So they will not shape policy much, bar the odd, calamitous experiment in Seattle. No Democratic Congress would dream of legislating for murderers to be given a good talking-to and then released. Yet anti-cop animus can still infuse Democratic politics. Zohran Mamdani, New York's DSA-backed mayor, vowed during his campaign to restrain the police. In office, when actually responsible for public safety, he tried to hire more. But then he backed down, in part due to pressure from his far-left base.

因此，他们并不会对政策产生太大影响，除了在西雅图偶尔会进行一些激进的实验之外。没有任何一个民主党的国会会考虑立法允许杀人犯被好好训斥之后才被释放。然而，对警察的敌意仍然可以在民主党政治中发挥作用。纽约那位由民主社会正义联盟支持的市长佐哈兰·马姆达尼在竞选期间承诺要限制警察的权力。上任后，他实际上负责公共安全事务，试图雇佣更多的警察。但后来由于来自极左翼势力的压力，他不得不放弃这一计划。

Crime and no punishment

犯罪却无人受罚

The big danger of daft ideas about crime is not that they will be enacted. It is that voters will feel the vibes and draw conclusions. Mr Piker's ideas are simpler and more memorable than, say, the successful crime-fighting policies of Baltimore's Democratic mayor. This helps Republicans push a simple, emotive message: Democrats

coddle thugs while President Donald Trump blows up boats full of suspected drug smugglers.

关于犯罪问题的那些愚蠢想法所面临的最大危险，并非这些想法会被实际实施，而是选民能够感知到其中的意味并据此做出判断。皮克先生的想法比巴尔的摩民主党市长那些成功的犯罪防治政策要简单且易于记忆。这帮助共和党人传递了一个简单而富有感染力的信息：民主党人只会迁就那些暴徒，而唐纳德·特朗普总统则会在把涉嫌贩毒者炸毁。

Neera Tanden, the thoughtful head of the Centre for American Progress, a think-tank for Democratic moderates, recently sounded exasperated on X as she pointed out the folly of being associated with prison abolition. “[P]eople who murder people should go to jail. This is not a controversial idea,” she wrote. An “unapologetic leftist” commenter responded: “Hey Neera, can we please just skip to the part where you become a Republican?” ■

美国进步中心的首席执行官尼拉·坦登最近在 X 平台上表达了她的无奈之情。作为民主党温和派人士的智库机构，该中心一直致力于推动政治改革。她指出，与那些主张废除监狱制度的人站在一起是一种愚蠢的行为。“那些杀害他人的人应该被关进监狱。这并不是一个有争议的观点，”她写道。一位“毫不掩饰的左派人士”在评论中回应道：“嘿，尼拉，你能不能直接跳到你成为共和党人的那部分内容呢？”■

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Bombs, bombast and a burial

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Iran's ultra-nationalist new leaders may welcome his bluster

伊朗那些极端民族主义的新领导人可能会欢迎他的狂言妄语。

Jul 09, 2026 06:35 AM | KARBALA

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:35 | 卡尔巴拉



IT WAS LESS a traditional lament for a slain Shia holy man than a victory parade, a display of power and a rallying cry for another confrontation with America. Over six days, Iranians marked the funeral of Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, Iran's former supreme leader, by chanting "Death to America". Red flags of vengeance fluttered above the crowds. Mourners hurled stones at images of Donald Trump and hung effigies of America's president.

这与其说是一场对逝世的什叶派圣人的传统哀悼，不如说是一场胜利游行、权力的展示，同时也是一次号召人们再次与美国对抗的号召。在六天的时间里，伊朗人通过高喊“美国灭亡”来纪念伊朗前最高领袖阿亚图拉·阿里·哈梅内伊的葬礼。人群中飘扬着复仇的红旗。哀悼者们向唐纳德·特朗普的画像投掷石块，并悬挂着美国总统的假象以示抗议。

Then, on the third and fourth days of mourning, the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC), the regime's elite defenders, launched drone attacks on three tankers that they claimed had ignored their designated route through the Strait of Hormuz. If the generals meant to provoke Mr Trump, they seemed to succeed. On July 7th he ordered strikes on Iran and revoked the sanctions waiver

covering Iran's oil exports. "Scum," he called Iran's rulers at a NATO summit in Ankara on July 8th. "It's just a waste of time dealing with them." Perhaps, the president suggested, America could do without a deal and simply hit Iran "hard" again.

在哀悼的第三天和第四天，伊斯兰革命卫队——这个政权的精锐防御部队——对三艘油轮发动了无人机攻击，他们声称这些油轮违反了通过霍尔木兹海峡的指定航线。如果将军们真的想激怒特朗普先生，那么他们的目的似乎达到了。7月7日，特朗普下令对伊朗实施打击，并撤销了针对伊朗石油出口的制裁豁免条款。8日在安卡拉举行的北约峰会上，他称伊朗的统治者是“废物”，并表示“与其与他们打交道，不如浪费时间。”或许，特朗普暗示美国可以不必达成任何协议，直接再次对伊朗进行“打击”。

America carried out dozens of strikes in southern Iran overnight on July 7th, and again on July 8th. Even so, Mr Trump's words may be bluster. American and Iranian negotiators are still expected to resume talks on July 11th in Islamabad, Pakistan's capital, over a final agreement about Iran's nuclear programme. But both sides look belligerent. The leadership that has emerged in Iran since Khamenei's death seems keener to project strength and wear down Mr Trump through military pressure, rather than diplomacy.

7月7日和8日，美国在伊朗南部地区连续发动了数十起袭击。尽管如此，特朗普的言论可能只是空话而已。预计美国和伊朗的谈判人员将在7月11日在巴基斯坦首都伊斯兰堡重新开始会谈，以就伊朗的核计划问题达成最终协议。但双方都显得很激进。自哈梅内伊去世以来，伊朗的领导层似乎更倾向于通过军事压力来对抗特朗普，而不是通过外交手段来解决。

Iran responded to both sets of American strikes with attacks on Bahrain and Kuwait. The oil price reached \$80 a barrel early on July 9th; Iran's rial slipped. Observers again predicted Iran could stomach more economic pain than the global economy. "We don't fold," posted Iran's chief negotiator and parliamentary speaker,

Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf, on July 8th.

伊朗对这两组美国的打击都采取了报复行动，分别对巴林和科威特发动了攻击。7月9日早些时候，石油价格达到了每桶80美元的水平；伊朗里亚尔的价值则有所下降。观察人士再次预测，伊朗能够承受更多的经济痛苦，而不至于影响全球经济的稳定。“我们不会屈服，”7月8日，伊朗首席谈判代表兼议会主席穆罕默德·巴格赫·加利巴夫如此说道。

The funeral offered an early glimpse of the new configuration ruling Iran and what some Iranians now call a second republic. Gone were the traditional rites that marked the burial of Ayatollah Ruhollah Khomeini, the Islamic Republic's founder, in 1989. His body was hurried to its grave, three days after his death, wrapped in a simple white shroud. By contrast, officials spent 126 days preparing for Khamenei's final rites, which they claimed was the largest state funeral in history. His coffin travelled for six days over 2,600km, across five cities and two countries, including Iraq.

这场葬礼让人们提前看到了统治伊朗的新格局，也见证了一些伊朗人所称的“第二共和国”的诞生。1989年，伊朗伊斯兰共和国的创始人阿亚图拉·鲁霍拉·霍梅尼的葬礼时，人们遵循了传统的仪式。他的遗体在去世三天后就被匆忙送往墓地，身上只覆盖着一块简单的白色布单。相比之下，霍梅尼的葬礼则花了126天时间进行准备，官员们声称这是历史上规模最大的国葬。他的棺材在六天的时间里穿越了2600公里的距离，经过五个城市和两个国家，其中包括伊拉克。

The ceremony also revealed a shift in the regime's centre of gravity. The IRGC generals who directed the war occupied pride of place. Iranian flags dominated the stage and draped the coffins. Khamenei's black turban—a symbol of the clerical establishment he led for 37 years—rested almost inconspicuously on top. More than 100 days after assuming power, his son and successor, Mojtaba Khamenei, has still not appeared in public. Even if he eventually does, he may prove little more than a figurehead. His televised statements sound like military communiqués, not sermons. Along the

funeral route, guards units and allied Iraqi militias marshalled the crowds and distributed food and water. Iran's rulers appear to be burying not only their supreme leader but also the clerical order over which he presided.

仪式上还标志着伊朗政权重心发生了一些变化。指挥战争的伊朗革命军指挥官们占据了舞台的重要位置。伊朗国旗覆盖在棺材上，而哈梅内伊的黑色头巾则静静地悬挂在头顶。他的儿子兼继任者莫杰塔巴·哈梅内伊在掌权一百多天后仍没有公开露面。即便他最终出现，也可能只是个空名而已。他在电视上的讲话听起来更像是军事命令，而非布道词。在葬礼沿途，武警部队和伊拉克盟军民兵组织疏导着人群，并分发食物和水。看来，伊朗的统治者不仅正在埋葬他们的最高领袖，同时也正在埋葬由他领导的宗教势力。

Khamenei's killing has accelerated Iran's transition from a theocracy to an ambitious nationalistic state dominated by military men. The IRGC appears to wield power with few constraints. Clerics who challenged its influence—including former Presidents Mohammad Khatami and Hassan Rouhani—were conspicuously absent from the processions.

哈梅内伊的遇害加速了伊朗从神权统治向由军事势力主导的雄心勃勃的民族主义国家的转型。伊朗伊斯兰革命卫队似乎在行使权力时几乎没有受到任何限制。那些挑战其影响力的神职人员——包括前总统穆罕默德·哈塔米和哈桑·鲁哈尼——在这次游行中完全缺席。

The generals, meanwhile, are asserting their regional power. As Iraq's prime minister, Ali al-Zaidi, prepared to curb pro-Iranian militias and for his first official trip to America, they directed Khamenei's funeral procession through Iraq's holy cities and lined its roads with armed groups. Free transport, food and lodgings, together with respect for Iran's success in repelling a foreign attack, drew vast crowds. Many Iraqis who once resented Iranian meddling now curse America and Israel.

与此同时，那些将军们正在强化他们的地区影响力。作为伊拉克的总理，阿里·扎伊迪准备限制亲伊朗民兵组织的活动，并首次对美国进行

正式访问。在哈梅内伊的葬礼游行过程中，他们指挥着武装团体穿过伊拉克的圣城，并在道路上部署了武装力量。免费的交通、食物和住宿，再加上对伊朗成功抵御外国入侵的赞扬，吸引了大量民众前来参加。许多曾经反对伊朗干涉事务的伊拉克人，现在却对美国和以色列表示不满。

Iran's bullying of its neighbours in the Gulf has also resumed. Delegations from Saudi Arabia and other Arab states travelled to Tehran to offer condolences despite enduring thousands of Iranian strikes during the war. Their gestures went unrewarded: more Iranian strikes have since followed. Gulf officials shrink at the determination of Tehran's new leadership to control the Strait of Hormuz. One of them mused that it smacked of a return of imperial Persian ambition.

伊朗对海湾地区邻国的欺凌行为也重新开始了。沙特阿拉伯和其他阿拉伯国家的代表团前往德黑兰表达哀悼之情，尽管在战争期间伊朗遭受了数千次打击。然而他们的努力并未得到回报：此后，伊朗又发动了更多的打击行动。海湾地区的官员们对德黑兰新领导层想要控制霍尔穆特海峡的决心感到担忧。其中一位官员认为，这似乎意味着波斯帝国那种帝国主义的野心正在重新浮现。

Two forces could yet restrain Iran's generals. The first is military reality. America's latest strikes underline the possibility that the war could resume in earnest. Iran's Gulf neighbours, meanwhile, appear more willing to support a tougher American approach. They are pressing partners in Europe and China to increase pressure on Tehran while quietly highlighting both their previous covert operations against Iran and their willingness to act again.

还有两种力量可以制约伊朗的将领们。第一种是军事现实。美国最近的打击行动表明，战争有可能再次爆发。与此同时，伊朗的海湾邻国似乎更愿意支持更强硬的美国政策。他们正在向欧洲和中国的合作伙伴施压，要求他们对德黑兰施加更多压力，同时暗地里展示他们过去对伊朗的暗中行动，以及他们再次采取行动的决心。

The second is economic. Once the funeral crowds disperse, Iran will still face a fragile and isolated economy. Sanctions-busting smuggling networks can sustain the regime, but not the wider population. Perhaps 40% of Iranians live in poverty, probably more. Much of the middle class has disappeared, while the war has pulverised the country's industrial base and left millions jobless. Most Iranians yearn for economic recovery and relief from sanctions rather than the reimposition of America's naval blockade and more war. National renewal will require some accommodation with Iran's enemies, not merely more bombs and bombast. ■

第二个问题是经济问题。一旦葬礼上的人群散去，伊朗仍将面临一个脆弱且孤立的经济体系。尽管有那些破坏制裁的走私网络，但它们只能维持政权的运转，而无法帮助广大民众。或许有 40% 的伊朗人生活在贫困之中，实际情况可能更糟。大部分中产阶级已经消失，而战争已经摧毁了国家的工业基础，导致数百万人失业。大多数伊朗人渴望经济复苏和摆脱制裁，而不是再次面临美国的海上封锁和更多的战争。要实现国家的复兴，就必须与伊朗的敌人进行一些妥协，而不仅仅是制造更多的炸弹和战争。

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If you rebuild it

如果你重新构建它

Rebuilding Syria will cost over \$200bn. Bombs are not helping

重建叙利亚将需要超过 2000 亿美元的资金投入。轰炸根本无济于事。

Emmanuel Macron is greeted by explosions in Damascus

埃马纽埃尔·马克龙在大马士革遭遇爆炸袭击

Jul 09, 2026 05:23 AM | DAMASCUS AND HOMS

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:23 | 大马士革与霍姆斯



Build to-day, then, strong and sure

今天就开始建造吧，这样就能建成坚固且稳固的建筑物了。

ON JULY 6TH Emmanuel Macron, the French president, became the first major Western leader to visit Syria since the toppling of the Assad dictatorship. He brought with him a coterie of French CEOs. Mr Macron's host, Ahmed al-Sharaa, al-Qaeda-militant-turned-statesman, must have been thrilled. He has chased foreign investment and recognition since seizing power 19 months ago. The two bombs that rocked central Damascus the next morning were far less welcome. They are a reminder of the limits of Syria's recovery.

7月6日，法国总统埃马纽尔·马克龙成为自阿萨德独裁政权被推翻以来首位访问叙利亚的西方重要领导人。他带领一群法国企业家一同前往。马克龙的主人公阿赫迈德·阿尔-沙拉，一个从基地组织成员转变为政治家的人，显然非常高兴。自19个月前掌权以来，他一直试图吸引外国投资并获得叙利亚的国际认可。然而，第二天早晨在大马士革市中心发生的两起爆炸事件则让局势变得复杂。这些爆炸事件提醒人们，叙利亚的复兴仍然面临着诸多挑战。

Nowhere is that clearer than in Jobar, a once-thriving suburb in north-east Damascus. Today it is littered with the concrete shells of

looted apartment buildings and the ruins of mosques and shops. There is no mobile-phone signal. Nor is there much evidence of anything being rebuilt.

在达马斯东北部的乔巴尔地区，这种情况表现得尤为明显。曾经繁华的这座郊区如今已变成一片废墟：公寓大楼的混凝土外壳散落一地，清真寺和商店也变成了荒废的废墟。这里没有手机信号，也几乎没有重建的迹象。

Since Bashar al-Assad's regime was overthrown, the much-touted reconstruction of a country devastated by civil war has yet to materialise. A slew of agreements with foreign and domestic firms and a big investor conference in June grabbed headlines. But on the ground frustration is growing. Bureaucracy and old regulations that are "designed for corruption" are choking progress, says a local businessman. Petty graft, political infighting and broken promises are sapping optimism.

自从巴沙尔·阿萨德政权被推翻后，那个因内战而遭受重创的国家如今仍未能实现重建的目标。虽然 6 月份与国内外企业签订了一系列协议，并举办了一场大型投资者会议，但这些努力仍然未能带来实质性的成果。当地一位企业家表示，官僚体系以及那些“旨在滋生腐败”的陈旧法规，正在阻碍着发展进程。小规模贪污行为、政治内斗以及承诺的无法兑现，都在逐渐侵蚀人们的乐观情绪。



Syria needs to rebuild everything, from houses, roads and bridges to energy and water infrastructure and its patchy telecoms network. One-third of its physical assets have been destroyed. The World Bank puts the total reconstruction costs at \$216bn, ten times Syria's GDP in 2024.

叙利亚需要重建一切基础设施，包括房屋、道路、桥梁、能源、供水系统以及尚且还算完整的电信网络。该国三分之一的实物资产已经遭到破坏。据世界银行估计，重建整个叙利亚所需的资金高达 2160 亿美元，这一数字相当于叙利亚 2024 年 GDP 的十倍。

Syria is painfully strapped for cash. Strict withdrawal limits mean few Syrians are willing to deposit their savings in local banks. Bereft of capital, banks are unable to extend loans. The Syrian pound, a managed currency, has continued to fall against the dollar in recent months.

叙利亚的资金状况非常紧张。由于取款限制严格，很少有叙利亚人愿意将积蓄存入当地银行。由于缺乏资金，银行也无法发放贷款。作为管理货币形式的叙利亚镑，最近几个月一直在持续贬值。

Still, if Mr Sharaa has succeeded at anything, it is at diplomacy and drumming up investor interest. His government, he declares, does not want to rebuild Syria “through aid and assistance” but through investment. He has struck up an improbable rapport with Donald Trump, who has eased American sanctions. And he has capitalised on growing interest among Gulf rulers in Syria as a strategic hub, especially after trade through the Strait of Hormuz was choked off.

不过，如果沙拉先生真的取得了一些成果，那也是在于他的外交手段以及吸引投资者兴趣的能力。他声称，他的政府并不希望通过援助来重建叙利亚，而是希望通过投资来实现这一目标。他成功地与唐纳德·特朗普建立了良好的关系，而特朗普也放松了美国的制裁措施。此外，他还利用了海湾地区国家们对叙利亚作为战略要地的兴趣，尤其是在霍尔穆特海峡的贸易通道被切断之后。

Gulf investors zoom into Damascus by private jet. Gulf commercial airliners fly in multiple times a day. Qatar has taken the lead: UCC, a construction firm, already has spades in the ground. It is redeveloping an airport that it hopes to open at the end of summer and is ploughing billions of dollars into Syria’s power plants. The Qataris have also acquired a Syrian bank, which will make it easier for them to move money into the country. And they plan to finance a big affordable-housing project in the coming months.

来自海湾地区的投资者们通过私人飞机迅速抵达大马士革。海湾地区的商业航班每天多次往返于此地。卡塔尔已经走在了前列：一家名为UCC的建筑公司已经着手重新开发机场，希望能在夏季末投入使用。此外，卡塔尔还投入了数十亿美元用于叙利亚的发电厂建设。卡塔尔人还收购了一家叙利亚银行，这将使他们更容易将资金输送进叙利亚。同时，他们计划在接下来的几个月里资助一个大型的经济适用房项目。

The Emiratis have also shaken off their early wariness of Mr Sharaa. In May Mohamed Alabbar of Emaar, a big property firm in the United Arab Emirates (UAE), said he was looking at \$18bn-worth of projects in Syria. Emirati delegations have descended on

Damascus in recent months to discuss transport, trade and a logistics corridor. Saudi companies and its government have pledged more than \$5bn. STC, its biggest telecom firm, is building a 4,500km-long fibre-optic network, data centres and subsea cable-landing stations worth \$800m. On June 30th Syria awarded a \$750m licence to Zain, a Kuwaiti telecoms operator, which wants to roll out 5G.

阿联酋人也已经不再对沙阿拉先生抱有最初的警惕情绪了。5 月，阿联酋大型房地产公司 Emaar 的穆罕默德·阿拉巴尔表示，他正在考虑在叙利亚开展价值 180 亿美元的项目。最近几个月，阿联酋代表团前往大马士革，讨论交通、贸易以及物流通道的问题。沙特阿拉伯的公司和政府已承诺投入超过 50 亿美元的资金。STC 作为其最大的电信公司，正在建设一条长达 4,500 公里的光纤网络，同时还在建设价值 8 亿美元的数据中心和海底电缆登陆站。6 月 30 日，叙利亚授予一家科威特电信公司 Zain 一项价值 7.5 亿美元的许可证，该公司计划推广 5G 服务。

Syrians themselves are also getting in on the action. Hadi Aladdin, a Canadian-Syrian tech entrepreneur, also aims to build a data centre. Samer Chamsi-Pasha, a recently returned exile from a famous merchant family, is lobbying the government to redesignate a disused military airport in Homs for civilian use so he can launch a flight school.

叙利亚人自己也在参与这一行动。加拿大和叙利亚混血种的科技企业家哈迪·阿尔拉丁也计划建造一个数据中心。而来自著名商人家族的萨梅尔·查姆西-帕沙则正在游说政府，希望将霍姆斯地区一个废弃的军事机场重新规划为民用设施，以便他能开办飞行学校。

Even some American firms are tiptoeing in. Visa and Mastercard have said they are returning. American oil companies will not invest directly but are partnering with regional firms to dip into Syrian oilfields. JPMorgan Chase, an American bank, along with two Gulf lenders, hopes to arrange a \$7bn loan, guaranteed by a state-

backed Qatari bank, to fund projects led by UCC.

甚至一些美国公司也在试探性地进入这一领域。Visa 和 Mastercard 已经表示会重新进入叙利亚市场。美国的石油公司不会直接投资，而是与当地企业合作，共同开发叙利亚的油田。美国银行 JPMorgan Chase 以及两家海湾国家的金融机构希望能够促成一项 70 亿美元的贷款项目，该贷款由卡塔尔政府支持的银行提供担保，用于支持由 UCC 主导的项目。

For most Western investors, doing business in Syria is still tough. America has, in theory, declared an end to its sanctions there. In reality, a raft of restrictions still prevent big American firms from entering en masse. European and American investors are also confused by the government's strategy. At a UN confab in June, one minister proclaimed a free-market economy, only for another to declare a desire for a "free, planned" one.

对于大多数西方投资者来说，在叙利亚开展业务仍然很困难。理论上，美国已经宣布终止了对叙利亚的制裁措施。但实际上，各种限制措施仍然阻碍着大型美国企业进入叙利亚市场。欧洲和美国的投资者也对政府的策略感到困惑。在六月的一次会议上，一位部长宣称要实行自由市场经济，而另一位部长则表示希望实现“自由与计划相结合”的经济模式。

Syrians, meanwhile, worry that Mr Sharaa has been so busy with diplomacy and investors that he has ignored other problems. Many are disappointed that he has not done more to pursue Mr Assad's cronies; last month, crowds marched on the homes of officers of the former regime, killing some. Investment conferences and presidential visits are welcome. But one in four Syrians live in extreme poverty. They will judge Mr Sharaa when places such as Jobar are rebuilt. ■

与此同时，叙利亚民众担心沙拉先生因为忙于外交事务和吸引投资者，而忽视其他问题。许多人对此感到失望，因为他没有采取更多措施来拉拢阿萨德的手下。上个月，民众还冲击了前政权官员的住宅，导致一些人死亡。虽然举办投资会议和总统访问是好事，但仍有

四分之一的叙利亚人生活在极端贫困之中。当乔巴尔这样的地区能够重建起来时，人们才会真正评价沙拉先生的表现。■

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It's a bust

这注定会失败。

Ahmed al-Sharaa is quashing Syria's vast captagon trade

艾哈迈德·阿尔-沙拉正在打击叙利亚庞大的奴隶贸易活动。

But pills that cost cents to produce still sell for \$25

不过，那些生产成本仅几美分的药丸，售价却高达 25 美元。

Jul 09, 2026 05:22 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:22



Cleaning up

清理干净

AMONG BASHAR AL-ASSAD'S many crimes as Syria's dictator was turning his country into a narco-state. Captagon, an amphetamine, became Syria's largest export. Mr Assad's neighbours resented his role as drug-pusher-in-chief. To their relief, Ahmed al-Sharaa, Syria's new president, seems eager to stem the flow of captagon in the region. But as a result, the trade is becoming more decentralised.

作为叙利亚的独裁者，巴沙尔·阿萨德犯下了许多罪行，他将自己的国家变成了一个毒品国家。卡普塔根这种安非他明类药物成了叙利亚最大的出口商品。阿萨德的邻国们对他作为主要毒品贩子的角色感到不满。幸运的是，叙利亚的新任总统艾哈迈德·沙拉拉似乎愿意遏制该地区卡普塔根的流通。不过，这样一来，这种贸易活动变得更加分散化。

Captagon, also known as fenethylline, was developed in the 1960s to treat hyperactivity in children and narcolepsy. In 1986 it was banned internationally because it was addictive. Today poor labourers use it to fuel long shifts. Some people take it to suppress hunger.

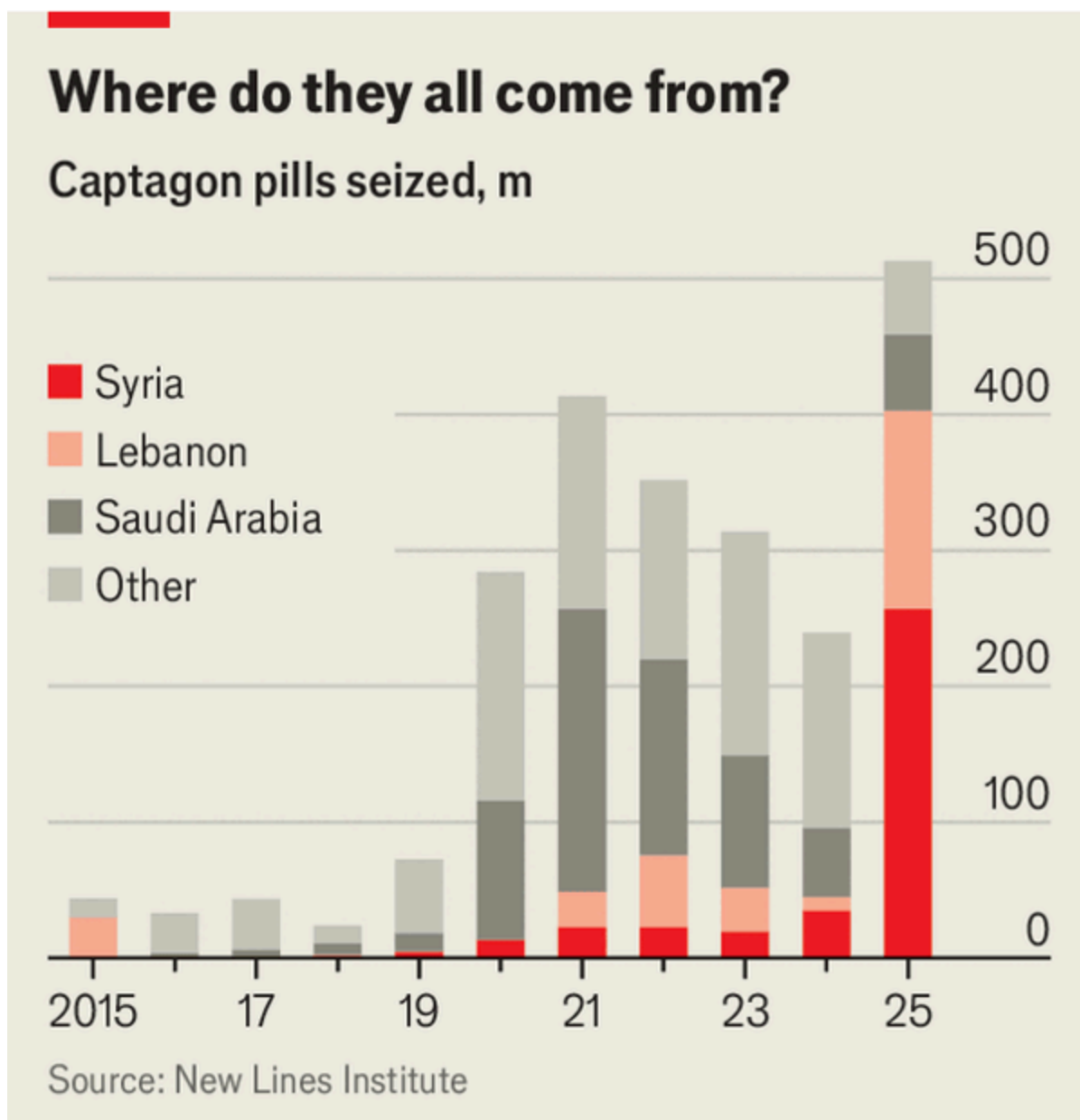
Traumatised soldiers self-medicate with it. The Gulf elite use it as a party drug.

卡普塔贡，又称芬尼西林，是在 20 世纪 60 年代研发出的一种药物，原本用于治疗儿童多动症和嗜睡症。然而由于具有成瘾性，该药物于 1986 年被国际上禁止销售。如今，一些贫困的劳动者利用这种药物来支撑长时间的工作班次；有些人则将其作为抑制饥饿的手段；受过创伤的士兵也会自行使用这种药物来缓解症状；而海湾地区的精英阶层则将其作为派对药物来使用。

It is a lucrative trade. A pill costs cents to produce but may sell for \$25 in Saudi Arabia. The global trade may be worth as much as \$10bn. The UN says between 2019 and 2025 as much as 80% of

global seizures originated in Syria.

这是一项利润丰厚的贸易活动。这种药丸的生产成本只有几分钱，但在沙特阿拉伯的售价可达 25 美元。这项全球贸易的产值可能高达 100 亿美元。据联合国统计，2019 年至 2025 年间，全球查获的毒品中，有 80% 来自叙利亚。



As part of his efforts to win international legitimacy and convince outsiders to unlock reconstruction funds, Mr Sharaa has cracked

down on the trade. In the first year of his rule his forces seized over 500m pills and dismantled 16 industrial laboratories. In June last year Anas Khattab, the interior minister, declared that captagon was no longer being produced in Syria.

为了获得国际社会的认可，并说服外部势力提供重建资金，沙拉先生采取了强硬措施打击非法活动。在他执政的第一年，他的军队就缴获了超过 5 亿片毒品，并捣毁了 16 个工业实验室。去年六月，内政部长阿纳斯·哈特巴特宣布，叙利亚已经不再生产卡坦戈林这种毒品。

He spoke too soon. Over the past year Syrian authorities have seized over 80m pills. Some are Assad-era stockpiles. But new production plants are being built, too. Most are in Sweida, a southern province dominated by Druze militias that have clashed with government forces. Remnants of the Fourth Armoured Division, an elite army unit led by Mr Assad's brother that oversaw the state's labs, have fled there and started making the pills again. "Sweida 24", a local news outlet, reports that 12-15 labs operate in the province.

他发言得太早了。在过去的一年里，叙利亚当局已经没收了超过 8000 万片药丸。其中一些是阿萨德时代留下的库存。不过，新的制药工厂也在建设中。这些工厂大多位于苏韦达省，该省由德鲁兹民兵组织控制，他们与政府军发生过冲突。由阿萨德兄弟领导的第四装甲师的一些残余部队也逃到了那里，重新开始生产药丸。“苏韦达 24”这一当地新闻机构报道称，该省有 12 到 15 个制药厂在运营。

Much of what is produced in Sweida is smuggled into Jordan, the only overland route to markets in the Gulf. Syria and Jordan share over 360km of desert borderlands and a web of tribal trade routes. Interceptions along the border have risen almost four-fold since the Druze-led National Guard took control of the province in July last year. In January Jordan and Syria set up a joint security committee to tackle the trade in drugs and arms. They also deployed more forces to the border. In May Jordan conducted its fifth round of air strikes on production facilities in Sweida. Officials say they were in co-ordination with Syrian authorities. Smugglers are adapting by

using GPS-guided balloons loaded with pills, which Jordanian forces shoot down, with Mr Sharaa's blessing.

在苏韦达生产的大部分商品都被走私到约旦——因为约旦是通往海湾地区市场的唯一陆路通道。叙利亚和约旦之间有着超过 360 公里的沙漠边境地带，还有许多部落间的贸易路线。自去年七月由德鲁兹人领导的国民警卫队控制该省以来，沿边境的走私活动增加了近四倍。今年一月，约旦和叙利亚成立了一个联合安全委员会，以打击毒品和武器贸易。他们还在边境部署了更多军队。五月时，约旦对苏韦达的生产设施进行了第五轮空袭。官员们表示，这些行动是与叙利亚当局协调进行的。走私者们正在调整策略，使用装有药丸的 GPS 导航气球进行走私，而约旦军队则负责击落这些气球，这一切都是在沙拉先生的支持下进行的。

Production is spreading. Hizbullah, the Iran-backed militia in Lebanon, started making captagon in 2006 to replenish its coffers after a war with Israel, which gouged its finances. It has turned to the drugs business once again. In the past six months a quarter of all captagon seized by Syrian authorities has come from Lebanon, says Charles Lister, an analyst. In the past year Lebanese authorities have raided three laboratories in Baalbek, near the Syrian border. They also caught smugglers trying to get production equipment into the Bekaa Valley, a Hizbullah redoubt. A year ago a joint Iraqi-Lebanese operation shut a captagon laboratory in the valley, said to be one of the region's largest.

生产活动正在扩散。黎巴嫩的伊朗支持民兵组织真主党，在 2006 年开始生产卡普阿通，目的是在与以色列的战争后补充资金。如今，他们再次转向毒品生产领域。据分析师查尔斯·利斯特称，在过去六个月中，叙利亚当局查获的所有卡普阿通中，有四分之一来自黎巴嫩。去年，黎巴嫩当局在靠近叙利亚边境的巴尔贝克地区搜查了三个实验室。他们还抓获了试图将生产设备带入贝卡谷地的走私者，该地区是真主党的重要据点。一年前，伊拉克和黎巴嫩的联合行动关闭了一个位于该地区的卡普阿通生产实验室，据说这是该地区最大的此类实验室之一。

Labs have been found in Kuwait and Egypt. In February last year a factory making about 100,000 pills per hour was seized in Sudan in territory previously held by the Rapid Support Forces, a paramilitary group. Last June Yemeni authorities seized 1.5m captagon pills being moved from Sanaa, controlled by the Houthi rebels, to Saudi Arabia. This May Indian authorities raided a production network spanning the country, a first for South Asia.

在科威特和埃及都发现了实验室。去年二月，在苏丹的一个由准军事组织“快速支援部队”控制的地区，一家每小时可生产约 10 万片药片的工厂被捣毁。去年六月，也门当局在从胡塞叛军控制的萨那运往沙特阿拉伯的 150 万片卡普塔贡片剂上截获了这批货物。今年五月，印度当局对全境的一个生产网络进行了搜查，这是南亚地区首次出现此类行动。

Captagon can lead to heart and brain damage. But the Middle East remains a ravenous consumer. The disruptions in supply are driving up street prices, so users are turning to crystal methamphetamine, an even more destructive stimulant. The region's appetite for cheap synthetic highs shows no sign of abating. ■

卡普塔贡可能导致心脏和大脑损伤。然而，中东地区对兴奋剂的需求却依然旺盛。供应中断使得街头毒品的价格不断上涨，因此人们不得不转向更危险的合成兴奋剂——冰毒。该地区的廉价合成兴奋剂需求似乎并没有减弱的迹象。■

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To strive, and not to yield

努力奋斗，绝不放弃

Can Africa take the Asian path to growth?

非洲能否效仿亚洲的道路来实现经济增长呢？

Stalling agricultural productivity makes it look unlikely

农业生产力的停滞使得这种情况看起来不太可能实现。

Jul 09, 2026 06:35 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:35



ECONOMISTS IN AFRICA speak enviously of the “green revolution” that transformed Asia from the 1960s onwards, when new varieties of rice flourished on small family farms. Population density pushed farmers to innovate and use more inputs, like fertiliser. As rural people grew richer, they demanded more manufactured goods. Factories filled with workers who were no longer needed in the fields.

非洲的经济学家们羡慕地谈论着“绿色革命”——这一革命从 20 世纪 60 年代开始改变了亚洲的农业格局。当时，新的水稻品种在小规模家庭农场上茁壮成长。人口密度的增加迫使农民进行创新，使用更多的投入物，比如肥料。随着农村人口变得富裕起来，他们开始需求更多的制造产品。于是，工厂里挤满了那些不再需要在田地里工作的工人。

Taking up space

1

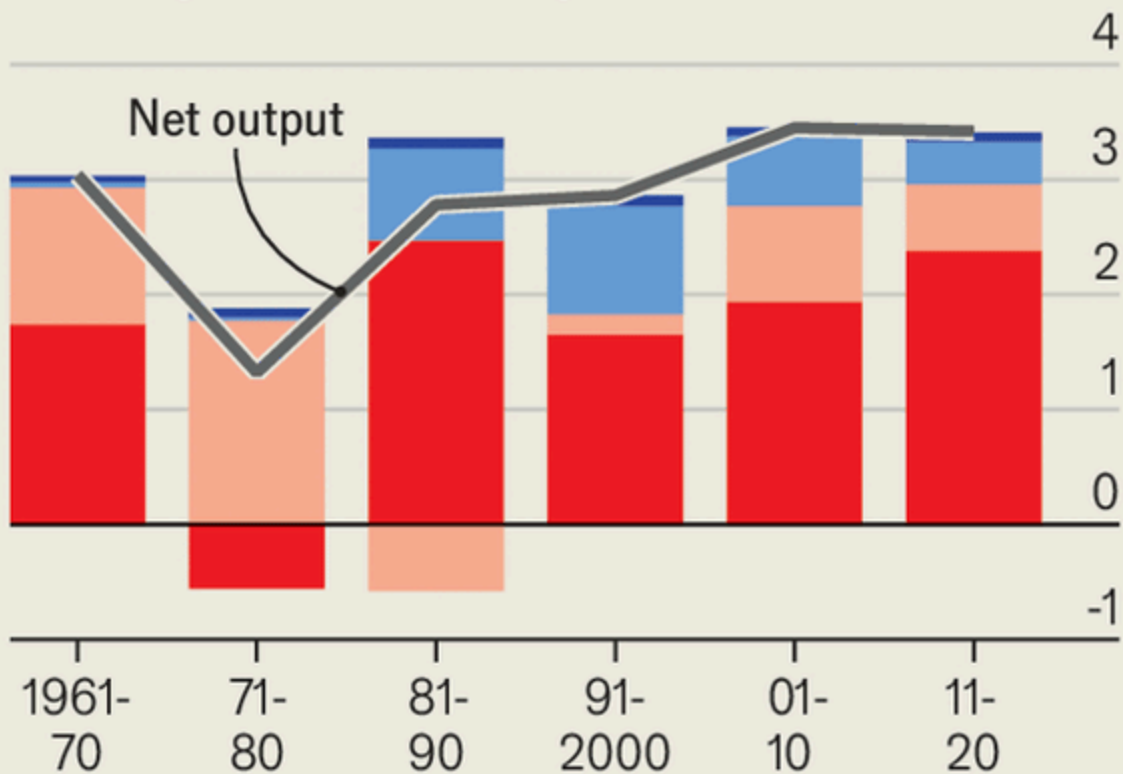
Sub-Saharan Africa, sources of agricultural output growth, % points

Land expansion

Input intensification

TFP* growth

Irrigation



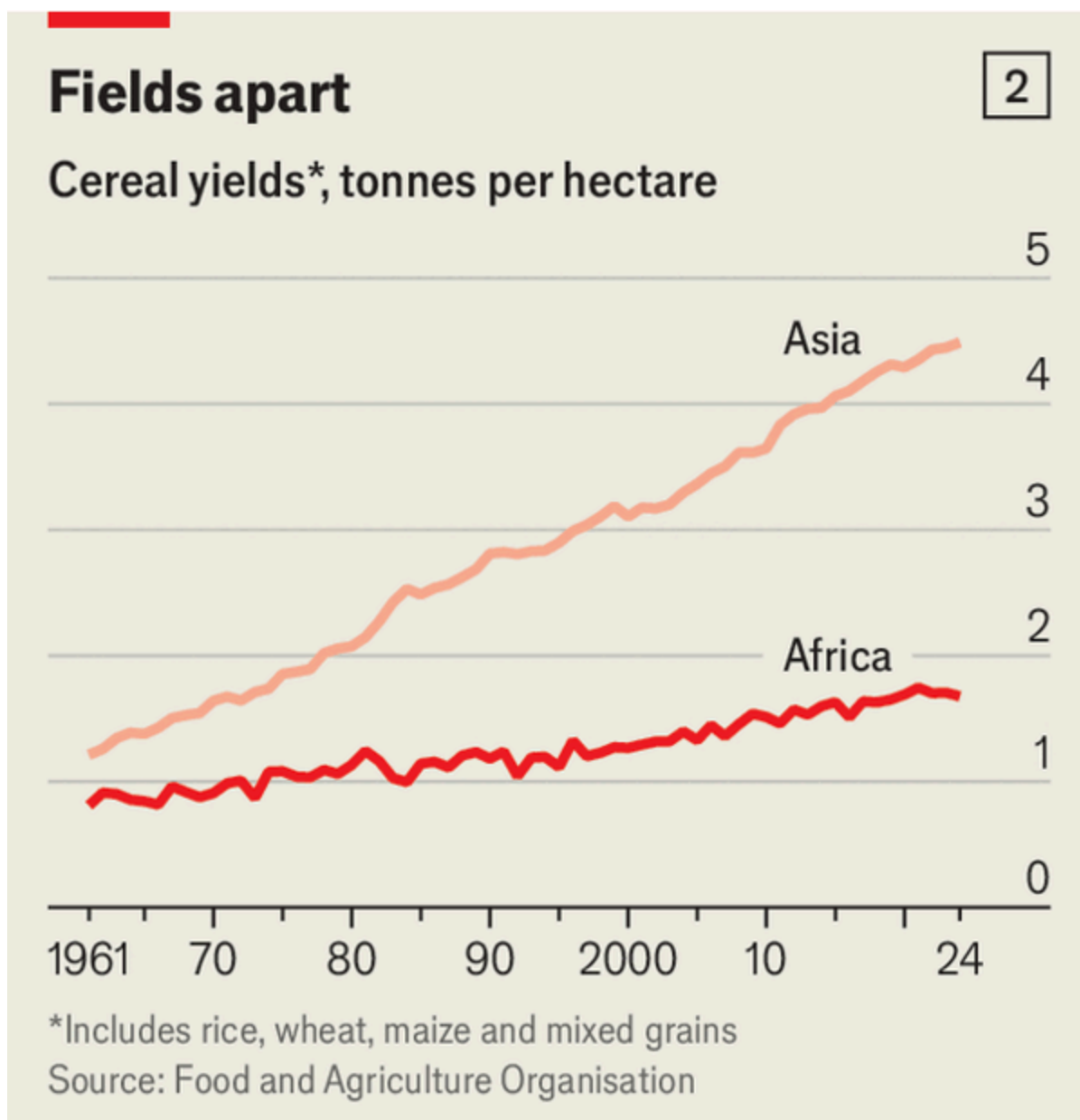
*Total factor productivity

Source: Global Agriculture Productivity Initiative

Could sub-Saharan Africa be on the same path? In aggregate its farmers are growing more cereals, such as maize (corn) and rice, than ever: nearly five times as much as in the 1960s, when many countries achieved independence. But most of those gains came from cultivating more land, which cannot go on for ever (see chart 1). Africa, once sparsely populated, is getting crowded. The amount

of arable land per person has been falling for decades, and now sits at roughly the global average.

撒哈拉以南的非洲地区是否也处于同样的道路呢？总体而言，那里的农民种植的谷物，如玉米和大米，数量比以往任何时候都要多：几乎是 20 世纪 60 年代时的五倍。不过，这些增长的背后实际上是通过耕种更多的土地来实现的，而这种做法不可能永远持续下去（参见图表 1）。曾经人口稀少的非洲，现在却变得越来越拥挤了。人均可耕地数量几十年来一直在下降，目前大约处于全球平均水平。



That might not matter if farmers were also growing more crops per hectare. But recently gentle growth in agricultural productivity has given way to stagnation, perhaps even decline. Consider figures drawn from national statistics in Africa by the Food and Agriculture Organisation (FAO), a UN body. Cereal yields did not grow between 2020 and 2024, the latest data point (see chart 2). Nor did total factor productivity (TFP), a measure of how efficiently inputs of all kinds (such as labour and machinery) are turned into produce. Most African countries had lower agricultural TFP in 2023 than a decade before.

如果农民每公顷种植的作物数量增加的话，那么这种情况可能就不重要了。不过，最近农业生产力虽然有所增长，但已经停滞不前，甚至可能出现下降。根据联合国粮食及农业组织提供的非洲国家统计数据，2020 年至 2024 年间，谷物产量并未增长（参见图表 2）。而全要素生产率——即各种投入（如劳动力和机械设备）转化为产出的效率——也出现了下降。2023 年，大多数非洲国家的农业全要素生产率比十年前还要低。

This seems to be more than a pandemic blip. In a paper published in 2024, Douglas Gollin of Tufts University in Massachusetts and his co-authors analysed data from surveys of 55,000 household farms in six African countries between 2008 and 2019. They estimated that, for smallholdings, yields and TFP were already falling by 3-4% a year then. They found steeper declines than the FAO did, perhaps because their sample did not include large farms, or because official statistics are sketchy.

这似乎不仅仅是一场疫情中的短暂现象。在 2024 年发表的一篇论文中，马萨诸塞州塔夫茨大学的道格拉斯·戈林和他的同事们分析了 2008 年至 2019 年间六个非洲国家 55,000 个家庭农场的调查数据。他们估计，对于小型农场来说，产量和总生产潜力每年都在下降 3-4%。他们的研究表明，这种下降幅度比粮农组织所预测的还要严重，可能是因为他们的样本并未包括大型农场，或者因为官方统计数据不够准确。

Why is this happening? There are plenty of suspects, from conflict to tired soils. As El Niño returns, threatening drought in southern Africa, thoughts turn to climate change. By one estimate, agricultural TFP on the continent is a third lower than it could have been, had the climate remained as it was in 1961. Farmers complain that they no longer know when to sow.

为什么会发生这种情况呢？原因有很多，比如冲突、土壤贫瘠等等。随着“厄尔尼诺现象”的再次出现，南部非洲面临着干旱的威胁，人们开始思考气候变化的问题。据一项估计，该大陆的农业劳动生产率比 1961 年时低了三分之一。农民们抱怨说，他们已经不知道该在什么时候播种了。

Mr Gollin and his colleagues cannot rule out environmental factors, but in checking weather data they have yet to find a smoking gun. Instead, their tentative hypothesis is that workers are spending less time in their fields. Richer, better-educated farmers are especially likely to look for other work. Since factors like workers' skills and working hours are imperfectly measured, this shows up as a fall in TFP.

戈林先生和他的同事们无法排除环境因素的影响，但在检查天气数据后，他们并未发现任何明确的证据。因此，他们暂时认为，可能是工人们在田地里的时间减少了。那些收入更高、教育水平更高的农民更有可能寻找其他工作机会。由于诸如工人技能和工作时间等数据测量并不准确，这就表现为 TFP 指数的下降。

If that proves true, the lessons from Asia would need to be revised. There, farmers responded to rising population density by working their land more intensively. But African farmers are cutting their hours most rapidly in congested places, especially near cities. That might be because African economies are relatively integrated into global markets, so city-dwellers' growing demand for food is partly met by imports. If local food prices do not rise, farmers have less

reason to intensify.

如果这一结论成立，那么从亚洲的经验得出的结论就需要重新评估了。在亚洲，农民通过更集约化的耕作方式来应对人口密度的增加。但在非洲，农民在人口密集的地区工作时间正在缩短，尤其是在城市附近。这可能是因为非洲的经济相对更加融入全球市场，因此城市居民对食物的需求可以通过进口来满足。如果当地食物价格不会上涨，那么农民就没有足够的理由去采用更集约化的耕作方式了。

Another difference is that in Asia it was rising crop yields that helped kick-start economic change. In Africa agricultural productivity is stagnant, but farmers are still being pulled away from their land. That might be because money from sources such as oil revenues is driving urban growth and creating informal service jobs, suggests Mr Gollin.

另一个区别在于，在亚洲，的是随着农作物产量的增加而推动了经济的增长。而在非洲，农业生产力停滞不前，但农民们仍然被迫离开自己的土地。Gollin 先生认为，这可能是因为来自石油收入等来源的资金促进了城市的发展，并创造了非正规服务业的就业机会。

The thorniest question concerns farm size. In Asia, small farms yielded more per hectare than large ones. Some studies find the same relationship in Africa; others explain it away as measurement error. In a paper in 2019 on Kenya, Milu Muyanga and Thomas Jayne, both of Michigan State University, find a u-shaped pattern: yields fall as farms get bigger, but in farms larger than five hectares they start to rise again, perhaps because it becomes easier to mechanise. Often even highly productive small farms are too tiny to be viable.

最棘手的问题是关于农场规模的问题。在亚洲，小型农场的每公顷产量却高于大型农场。一些研究在非洲也发现了类似的情况；而另一些研究则认为这种差异可能是由于测量误差造成的。在 2019 年发表于肯尼亚的相关论文中，密歇根州立大学的 Milu Muyanga 和 Thomas Jayne 发现了一个 U 形曲线：随着农场规模的扩大，产量会下降，但在超过五公顷的农场上，产量又开始上升，这可能是因为此时机械化

生产变得更加可行。不过，即便是非常高效的小型农场，往往仍然因为规模太小而无法维持下去。

Admirers of the Asian model point to rising fertiliser use in the 2010s, suggesting that some farms are starting to intensify. Fast-growing trading firms are shuttling farm produce to towns; demand for meat, eggs and vegetables is met almost entirely by domestic supply. Since 2005 the market value of Africa's agricultural produce has risen at a rate that matches South Asia, and outstrips every other region of the world. Crowded spots, from Africa's Great Lakes to the Ethiopian highlands, could yet follow the path of Taiwan or Punjab.

推崇亚洲发展模式的人士指出，在 2010 年代，非洲的化肥使用量有所增加，这表明一些农场开始采用更集约化的生产方式。那些发展迅速的贸易公司正在将农产品运送到城镇；对肉类、鸡蛋和蔬菜的需求几乎完全由国内供应满足。自 2005 年以来，非洲农产品的市场价值增长速度与南亚地区相当，甚至超过了世界其他地区的增长速度。从非洲的非洲大湖区到埃塞俄比亚的高地，这些人口密集的地区也有潜力效仿台湾或旁遮普邦的发展模式。

Still, the relevance of the Asian example must be proved rather than assumed. "We're in a different world than we were in [Asia] in the 1960s," Mr Gollin says. Africa must find its own way. ■

不过，亚洲的例子是否仍然具有借鉴意义，还是需要通过实际验证来确认。戈林先生说：“我们现在所处的世界与 1960 年代的亚洲已经大不相同了。”非洲必须找到属于自己的发展路径。■

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2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:31



IN “BRAZIL”, TERRY GILLIAM’S film about a dystopian society, eyeball-shaped surveillance bots hover over citizens’ shoulders, watching their every move. In Brazil, the country, something a bit similar is afoot. That is evident in the heart of São Paulo’s historic centre, where a giant electronic counter known as the “prisonometer” records arrests attributed to Smart Sampa: a network of 50,000 cameras enhanced with clever tech.

在特里·吉利亚姆执导的这部关于反乌托邦社会的电影《巴西》中，那些眼球形状的监控机器人悬挂在市民的肩膀上，监视着他们的每一个动作。在巴西，似乎也发生了类似的事情。这一点在圣保罗历史中心可以观察到——那里有一个名为“监狱计数器”的巨大电子监控装置，它记录着由 Smart Sampa 系统所处理的逮捕事件。Smart Sampa 是一个由 5 万台摄像头组成的网络，配备了先进的科技设备。

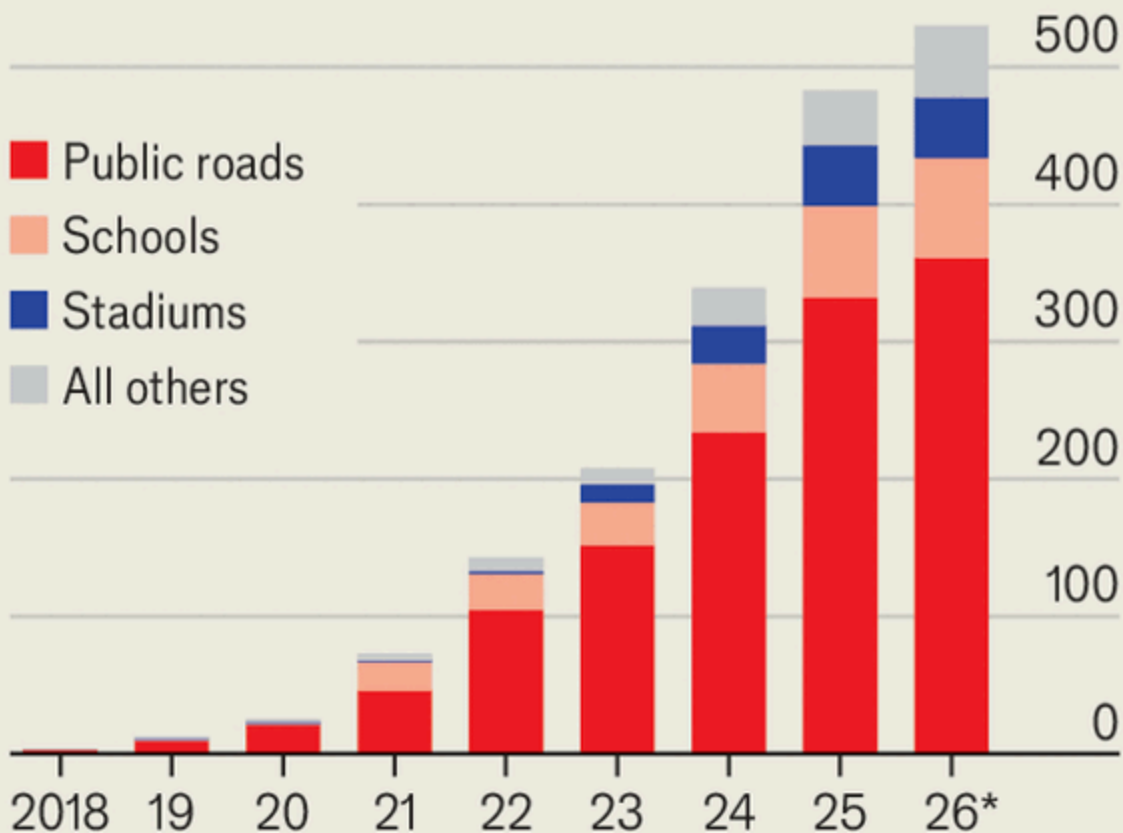
The system, introduced in 2024, uses facial recognition to spot people wanted by police on São Paulo’s streets. It issues alerts and officers are dispatched to pick them up. The system can also locate people who have been reported missing, identify stolen vehicles and provide footage to police investigations. Streamed to its control room in the city centre, information flows not just from lenses on street corners but in health centres, on buses and mounted on police motorbikes. By 2028 the number of cameras in the network is supposed to double, to 100,000.

该系统于 2024 年投入使用，利用面部识别技术来识别圣保罗街头被警方通缉的人员。当有人被识别为可疑人员时，系统会发出警报，警察会立即被派去抓捕这些人。该系统还能帮助找到失踪人员、识别被盗车辆，并为警方调查提供视频资料。这些信息不仅从街角的摄像头中采集，还来自医疗中心、公交车上以及安装在警察摩托车上的摄像头。到 2028 年，该网络中的摄像头数量预计将增加到 10 万台。

Looking you in the eyes

Brazil, active facial-recognition projects

Cumulative, by location



Source: O Panóptico

*To June 13th

São Paulo is one of many Brazilian cities spending big on crime-fighting technology. As in other countries, police are investing in body-worn cameras and networks of microphones that detect the sound of gunshots. What sets Brazil apart from many democracies is its enthusiasm for face-spotting tech. Researchers for O Panóptico, a watchdog, count 560 active facial-recognition projects in more than 20 Brazilian states. These include police-run initiatives but also experiments in schools, for example, where cameras are increasingly being used to take attendance. They gaze upon some 99m people,

more than 47% of Brazil's population.

圣保罗是许多在犯罪防控技术投入巨大的巴西城市之一。与其他国家一样，当地警方也在投资使用随身摄像头和能够捕捉枪声的麦克风网络。不过，让巴西与其他民主国家不同的是，当地人对面部识别技术的热情非常高。据监督机构 O Panóptico 的研究人员统计，在巴西 20 多个州有 560 个基于面部识别的项目正在运行。这些项目既包括由警方主导的举措，也包括在学校中进行的实验，例如，现在越来越多的学校使用摄像头来进行点名。这些摄像头注视着约 9900 万人口，占巴西总人口的 47%以上。

The main impetus for the likes of Smart Sampa is Brazilians' persistent fear of crime. Policing is largely the responsibility of states and municipalities. Their governors and mayors are embracing high-tech kit as a way of showing they are cracking down on insecurity. The spread accelerated during the pandemic, when cities bought cameras to enforce lockdowns and track public-health measures. Many were later repurposed for public security.

推动诸如 Smart Sampa 这样的项目的主要因素，是巴西人对于犯罪行为的持续担忧。实际上，警察力量的部署主要由各州和市政府负责。这些州的州长和市长们采用高科技装备，以此来展示他们正在努力打击不安全问题。在疫情期间，这种情况更加普遍，当时各城市购买了摄像头以执行封锁措施并监测公共卫生状况。许多这些设备后来被重新用于公共安全领域。

It helps that high-resolution, internet-connected cameras are becoming cheaper—and that software capable of wringing insight from their footage is growing more effective. As well as governments, companies and individuals now deploy smart surveillance systems, says Erick Coser of Gabriel, a security-technology firm. Smart Sampa relies heavily on cameras put up by landlords, such as the firms that operate in São Paulo's shopping centres or manage apartment and office buildings, who link their sensors into the system. Ricardo Nunes, the city's mayor, says that already more than half the cameras in the network are privately

owned.

幸运的是，高分辨率、联网的摄像头成本正在降低，而能够从摄像头录像中获取信息的软件也越来越有效。据安全技术公司 Gabriel 的埃里克·科瑟所说，现在不仅是政府、企业和个人在采用智能监控系统。智能 Sampa 系统主要依赖由房东安装的摄像头，比如那些在圣保罗购物中心运营或管理公寓和办公楼的商家，他们会将自己的传感器连接到系统中。圣保罗市长里卡多·努内斯表示，目前网络中超过一半的摄像头都是私人拥有的。

The authorities paint these developments as a success. São Paulo's government says more than 3,000 fugitives have been arrested after being spotted by its system, and that the cameras have let them catch nearly 6,000 people in the act of committing crimes. The use of facial recognition has won broad support across Brazil's political spectrum, says Rafael Ch of Signum Global Advisors, a consultancy.

当局将这些进展描绘成一项成功。圣保罗政府表示，通过其监控系统，已有超过 3000 名逃犯被抓获，而这些摄像头还帮助逮捕了近 6000 名正在实施犯罪活动的人。据 Signum Global Advisors 的拉斐尔·查所说，面部识别技术的使用在巴西各个政治派别中获得了广泛支持。

Yet privacy advocates and some security experts are alarmed. They question the effectiveness of the surveillance systems, and their fairness. São Paulo has been hauling people in on warrants later found to have expired or been withdrawn. A persistent worry is that face-spotting systems are not uniformly accurate when identifying people of different ethnicities. According to Agência Brasil, a state news agency, roughly 80% of wrongful arrests linked to facial-recognition systems in Rio de Janeiro involve black Brazilians. Though the country's privacy and data-protection laws are some of the strongest in Latin America, public security gets big carve-outs. In other places that have invested heavily in surveillance technology,

such as Britain, there are stricter legal safeguards.

然而，隐私倡导者和一些安全专家对此表示担忧。他们质疑这些监控系统的有效性以及其公正性。圣保罗经常发生基于授权进行的逮捕行为，但这些授权后来被证明已经失效或已被撤销。另一个令人担忧的问题是，面部识别系统在识别不同种族的人时并不具有一致性。根据巴西新闻机构 Agência Brasil 的报道，里约热内卢地区大约 80% 的误捕事件涉及黑人巴西人。虽然该国的隐私和数据保护法律在拉丁美洲属于最严格的，但公共安全方面的相关规定却相对宽松。在那些在监控技术方面投入大量资金的其他国家，比如英国，则有更严格的法律保护措施。

Surveillance tech cannot make up for underlying failures in the criminal-justice system, says Pablo Nunes of the Centre for Security and Citizenship Studies (CESEC), a think-tank. Many crimes in Brazil are never properly investigated (only a third of murders are ever solved; in São Paulo state, police solve only around 2% of recorded thefts). Sensors that help pull wanted people off the street are no use in cases where no suspects have been identified.

安全研究中心（CESeC）的帕布罗·努内斯指出，监控技术无法弥补刑事司法体系中的根本缺陷。在巴西，许多犯罪行为始终没有得到妥善调查（只有三分之一的谋杀案能够得到侦破；在圣保罗州，警方只能解决大约 2% 的盗窃案件）。在尚未确定嫌疑人的情况下，那些能够帮助驱散街头流浪者的传感器根本毫无用处。

Capturing more crimes on camera will surely be helpful. But police often lack the skills and resources to sift through reams of footage. The CESEC recently compared crime trends in São Paulo during Smart Sampa's first year with those in other municipalities and found no reduction in thefts, robberies or homicides, nor any increase in police productivity as measured by the number of arrests.

通过摄像头捕捉更多的犯罪行为无疑会有所帮助。不过，警方往往缺乏足够的技能和资源来梳理大量的监控录像。CESeC 在“智能圣保罗”计划实施的第一年期间，对圣保罗的犯罪趋势进行了比较，结果发现

盗窃、抢劫和谋杀案件数量并没有减少，而通过逮捕次数来衡量的警方工作效率也没有提升。

Eyes in the sky

天空中的眼睛

Official claims about effectiveness also tend to ignore the fact that Brazil's streets were growing safer before new crime-fighting technologies became widespread. Murders, robberies and thefts have fallen markedly since 2018. In São Paulo, robberies reached a 25-year low in 2025; its murder rate is now among the lowest of any large city in Latin America. One reason is that crime is changing: large organised crime groups are becoming less like street gangs and more like lawless conglomerates. They infiltrate legal markets, seize control of their supply chains and launder money through legitimate businesses. According to the Brazilian Forum of Public Security, a think-tank, gangs generated 147bn reais (\$29bn) from fuel, gold, cigarettes and drinks in 2022, compared with only 15bn reais from trafficking cocaine. None of this is easy to capture with cameras, no matter how smart they may be.

关于这些新犯罪防治技术有效性的官方声明，往往忽略了这样一个事实：在新的犯罪技术尚未普及之前，巴西的街头就已经变得更加安全了。自 2018 年以来，谋杀、抢劫和盗窃案件的数量显著下降。在圣保罗，2025 年抢劫案件的数量达到了 25 年来的最低水平；该城市的谋杀率也是拉丁美洲所有大城市中最低的。其中一个原因是犯罪形式正在发生变化：大型有组织犯罪团伙不再像传统街头帮派那样行事，而是更像一些无组织的犯罪集团。它们渗透到合法市场之中，掌控着供应链，并通过合法企业来洗钱。根据巴西公共安全论坛的一份报告，2022 年，这些犯罪团伙从燃油、黄金、香烟和饮料中赚取了 147 亿雷亚尔（约 290 亿美元），而贩运可卡因仅赚取了 150 亿雷亚尔。无论摄像头多么先进，都难以捕捉到这些活动。

All this raises questions about costs. Smart Sampa now requires at least 118m reais a year to run. The state of Rio de Janeiro has spent

more than 670m reais on facial-recognition technologies for public security. The opportunity costs are highest in poorer parts of Brazil. In Goiás, a central state, lawmakers have splurged on whizzy security systems for towns where less than half of households have basic sanitation and violent crime is rare.

这一切都引发了关于成本的问题。现在，智能 Sampa 系统的运营成本每年至少为 1.18 亿雷亚尔。里约热内卢州在面部识别技术上的投入已超过 6.7 亿雷亚尔。在巴西较贫困的地区，机会成本最为高昂。在戈亚斯州这样一个中部省份，立法者们为当地社区购买了先进的安全系统，因为该州有一半以上的家庭没有基本卫生设施，而暴力犯罪现象极为罕见。

Courts are beginning to push back. But even if new rules are adopted, enforcing them will be hard, says Caitlin Bishop of Privacy International, a digital-rights group. "Officials often lack the technical expertise needed to verify rules are being respected." Security will be an important issue in general elections in October. As the "prisonometer" shows, Brazilian politicians love eye-catching ways to look like they are tough on crime. ■

法院开始提出反对意见了。不过，即使制定了新的规则，要执行这些规则仍然很困难，数字权利组织 Privacy International 的 Caitlin Bishop 说：“官员们往往缺乏验证这些规则是否得到遵守的技术能力。”在 10 月份的选举中，安全问题将是一个重要议题。正如“监狱指数”所示，巴西的政客们喜欢使用引人注目的方式来展示自己打击犯罪的决心。

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Surging ahead

迅速前进

GIVEN THAT its passengers are mostly heading into work, the mood aboard El Insurgente, a train linking Mexico City with nearby Toluca, is unusually upbeat. Since it began running in February, Mexicans have enjoyed a smooth ride in sleek trains across one of the world's most clogged and sprawling urban areas. It's "wonderful" to avoid traffic, says one customer. On a bad day the journey between Toluca and the Mexican capital, barely 60km (40 miles) apart, can take several hours by road. El Insurgente takes about an hour and costs under \$6.

由于乘客们大多都是前往工作的途中，因此连接墨西哥城与附近的托卢卡之间的列车“El Insurgente”上的人们的情绪异常愉悦。自 2 月份开始运行以来，墨西哥人已经可以乘坐这列舒适的列车穿越世界上交通最拥堵、人口最密集的城市地区了。一位乘客表示，能够避开交通拥堵真是“太好了”。在天气不好的日子里，从托卢卡到墨西哥首都这段仅 60 公里（40 英里）的旅程可能需要几个小时才能到达。而“El Insurgente”列车大约需要一小时就能到达目的地，票价也低于 6 美元。

Claudia Sheinbaum, Mexico's president, wants more of this. She has ambitious plans to build more than 3,000km of new passenger rail before the end of her term in 2030. Many countries, such as China and Turkey, are making big bets on trains. But Mexico's dreams are "dramatic", says Andrew Young, a rail analyst. Mexico is starting more or less from scratch, in a region not known for trains, and building with speed, he says.

墨西哥的总统克劳迪娅·谢因鲍姆希望实现更多这样的目标。她制定了雄心勃勃的计划，希望在 2030 年任期结束前建设超过 3000 公里的新的客运铁路线路。像中国和土耳其这样的许多国家都在大力发展铁路事业。不过，铁路分析师安德鲁·杨表示，墨西哥的梦想是“非常大胆的”。墨西哥几乎是从零开始建设铁路，而他们正在以惊人的速度推进这一项目，他说。

Mexico once had a passable passenger network. By the 1990s, however, the rail system was deteriorating and the government privatised it. The concessions that followed focused mainly on freight. These have been useful: trains play an important part in North America's supply chains, hauling cars, grain, fuel and manufactured goods between ports, factories and the American border. But passenger services all but vanished.

墨西哥曾经拥有相当不错的客运网络。然而，到了 20 世纪 90 年代，铁路系统状况日益恶化，政府于是将其私有化。此后实施的改革主要集中在货运方面。这些改革确实发挥了作用：火车在北美供应链中发挥着重要作用，负责将汽车、粮食、燃料和制造产品从港口、工厂以及美国边境运送到各地。不过，客运服务几乎完全消失了。

Recent efforts to revive passenger trains have been fraught with controversy—in large part because they started with a dud. [Tren Maya](#), a pet project of Ms Sheinbaum's predecessor, Andrés Manuel López Obrador, runs for 1,500km around the Yucatán peninsula in the south-east. It has caused huge environmental damage and its planning was influenced by political considerations. Stations were built in inconvenient locations without good connecting transport. "We have not seen the benefits we were told we would," says a tour guide in Calakmul, one of the stations that bears the name of a nearby archaeological site.

最近试图恢复客运列车运行的努力引发了诸多争议——很大程度上是因为这些计划是从错误的起点开始的。特伦·玛雅列车是由谢恩鲍尔德·安德烈斯·曼努埃尔·洛佩兹·奥夫拉多尔的前任提出的项目。这列列车在东南方向的尤卡坦半岛上行驶了 1500 公里。然而，该项目的实施造成了严重的环境破坏，其规划也受到了政治因素的影响。一些车站建在不太方便的位置，且缺乏良好的交通连接。“我们并没有得到所承诺的好处，”一位位于卡拉克穆尔的导游说，那里有一座以附近考古遗址命名的车站。



Ms Sheinbaum's plans have more rigour. Andrés Lajous, the official in charge, says the idea is to connect contiguous metropolitan areas: from Mexico City to Pachuca and Querétaro, then on towards Irapuato and Guadalajara, and from Saltillo through Monterrey towards Nuevo Laredo (see map). These lines will connect cities that are slow to drive between but too close for flying to be sensible. Planned and built properly, they could save people time, cut pollution

and spur economic growth. They could also stem urban sprawl, since rail makes it easier for people to live in one town while holding down jobs in another.

谢因鲍姆女士的规划更为周密。负责这项计划的安德烈斯·拉霍斯表示，这个想法是将相邻的大都市区域连接起来：从墨西哥城到帕丘卡和克雷塔罗，然后继续延伸到伊拉普阿托和瓜达拉哈拉，再经过萨尔蒂略，经过蒙特雷，最终到达新拉雷多（请参阅地图）。这些线路将连接那些虽然开车前往较为困难，但飞行却不太合理的城市。如果规划得当、建设完善，这些线路不仅可以节省人们的时间、减少污染并促进经济增长，还可以遏制城市扩张现象，因为铁路使得人们可以在一个城镇居住，同时在其他城镇工作。

The idea is for the passenger lines to be built alongside existing freight ones, meaning the right of way is already mostly secured. (They will avoid running them on the same tracks, which can clog up the lines and limit speeds, as tends to happen in the United States.) The government is moving fast: it recently inaugurated a line to Felipe Ángeles airport, north of Mexico City, and has begun work on others to Pachuca and Querétaro.

这个方案是将客运线路与现有的货运线路并行建设，这样便可以最大限度地保障交通通行权。（他们不会将客运线路铺设在同一轨道上，因为那样容易导致轨道堵塞，从而影响运行速度——这种情况在美国很常见。）政府行动迅速：他们最近刚刚开通了一条通往墨西哥城北部菲莱佩·安赫尔斯机场的线路，并且已经开始建设通往帕丘卡和克雷塔罗的线路。

But to reach its destination the government will have to confront several challenges. One is whether there will really be enough cash. Passenger rail almost always requires public money: both to build it, and then to keep fares affordable. (Only a handful of high-density routes worldwide, such as Paris to Lyon and Tokyo to Osaka, are profitable.) Mexico has shallow coffers and many other needs. Oscar Ocampo of IMCO, a think-tank in Mexico City, reckons that only some of Ms Sheinbaum's proposed lines make obvious sense (such as

Mexico City to Querétaro, and Saltillo to Monterrey). The case for others is “not so clear”. Some of the money would be better spent further improving things such as freight rail, ports and industrial-corridor connections, he says.

不过，要达成这一目标，政府必须面对若干挑战。其中一个问题是，是否真的有足够的资金来支持这一计划。客运铁路几乎总是需要政府投入资金：无论是建设铁路本身，还是确保票价保持合理水平，都需要政府拨款。（全球范围内，只有少数几个高密度的铁路线路能够盈利，比如巴黎到里昂、东京到大阪的线路。）墨西哥的财政状况并不乐观，还有许多其他事务需要解决。墨西哥城的一家智库 IMCO 的奥斯卡·奥坎波认为，谢因鲍姆提出的某些铁路线路确实具有合理性，比如墨西哥城到克雷塔罗、萨尔蒂略到蒙特雷的线路。不过，其他线路的合理性则不太明显。他说，这些资金或许应该用于进一步改善货运铁路、港口以及工业走廊的连接等方面。

A second question is whether Mexico’s government intends to do far too much of the work itself. Mr López Obrador’s administration put the state—and the army—at the centre of infrastructure delivery, keeping private firms at arm’s length. Ms Sheinbaum has recognised that she must be less dogmatic. The state will lead the rail roll-out and operate the train services (not uncommon globally for big rail projects). The idea is that private companies will build substantial portions of the infrastructure. Big tenders are going out for stations, bridges, signalling, electrification and more. But keeping a correct balance may be difficult.

第二个问题是，墨西哥政府是否打算过度干预事务。洛佩斯·奥夫拉多罗先生的政府将国家机构和军队置于基础设施建设的核心位置，而把私人企业排除在外。谢因鲍姆女士认识到自己必须减少这种专断行为。国家将主导铁路项目的建设，并负责铁路运营服务（这在大型铁路项目中并不罕见）。原则上，私人公司将负责建设基础设施的绝大部分部分。目前已经有大型项目正在招标，涉及车站、桥梁、信号系统、电气化设施等。不过，保持适当的平衡可能会比较困难。

Last, Ms Sheinbaum will have to resist the temptation to prioritise speed over quality during development. Services along the Interoceanic railway—another of her predecessor's projects, linking the port of Coatzacoalcos on the Gulf of Mexico with Salina Cruz on the Pacific coast—have been suspended since a train derailed in December, killing 14 people. Swift, efficient travel is worth investing in. So is arriving in one piece. ■

最后，Sheinbaum 女士在开发过程中必须克服追求速度而忽视质量的诱惑。Interoceanic 铁路项目也是她的前任所负责的项目之一，该铁路连接着墨西哥湾的 Coatzacoalcos 港口和太平洋沿岸的 Salina Cruz。由于去年 12 月一列火车出轨导致 14 人死亡，该项目的建设已被暂停。虽然追求快速高效的运输很重要，但确保乘客安全抵达同样至关重要。■

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Whose native land?

那是谁的土地呢？

Americans and Canadians are squabbling over mines

美国人和加拿大人正在为矿场问题争吵不休。

The frontier complicates disagreements between indigenous groups
边境问题使得土著群体之间的分歧变得更加复杂。

Jul 09, 2026 05:23 AM | Wrangell

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:23 | 瓦朗格尔



TWELVE YEARS ago members of the indigenous Tahltan Nation blocked roads in British Columbia (BC), in Canada, to stop a copper mine opening on their ancestral land. The mine went ahead—but the Tahltan won big concessions. Today the copper operation, dubbed Red Chris, provides them with hundreds of jobs and millions of dollars in grants and royalties.

十二年前，塔尔坦族成员在加拿大不列颠哥伦比亚省设置了路障，以阻止一家铜矿公司在他们的土地上建设矿山。尽管那家铜矿还是建了起来，但塔尔坦族最终获得了丰厚的补偿。如今，这家名为“红克里斯”的铜矿企业为他们提供了数百个就业机会，并带来了数百万美元的拨款和特许权使用费收入。

Now Newmont, the operator, is preparing a big expansion of the mine. It has agreement from the federal and provincial governments (on July 2nd the government of Canada said it would invest C\$500m, or \$350m, in the project). It also has the Tahltan's approval. All this seems like a success in asserting hard-won indigenous rights. But while that is true for the Tahltan, indigenous groups across the nearby border with the United States fear disaster.

现在，负责运营该矿业的纽蒙特公司正在计划对矿山进行大规模扩建。该公司已经获得了联邦政府和省级政府的支持——7月2日，加拿大政府宣布将投资5亿加元，即3.5亿美元用于该项目。此外，该公司还得到了塔尔坦人的认可。这一切看起来像是维护当地原住民权利取得的重大胜利。不过，对于与美国接壤的塔尔坦人来说，其他原住民群体则担心可能会面临灾难。

Mining is surging in BC's mineral-rich "Golden Triangle", driven by soaring demand for critical metals and Canada's push to build up domestic industries in the face of Donald Trump's tariffs. The boom has effects beyond Canada's frontiers. Red Chris is one of at least eight proposed or operating mines in BC on headwaters of rivers that flow into the lands of indigenous people in Alaska. They do not share in the profits and get no say in how the mines are run. But they

worry toxic mining waste will wash down their rivers.

在加拿大矿产资源丰富的“金三角地区”，采矿活动正在蓬勃发展。这一趋势是由对关键金属需求的激增所推动的，同时也是加拿大在 Donald Trump 的关税政策背景下努力发展国内产业的体现。这一繁荣现象的影响已经超出了加拿大的边界。在 BC 省，至少有八座矿山正在建设或运营中，这些矿山的源头位于流入阿拉斯加原住民土地的河流上。原住民并没有参与到这些矿山的利润分配中，也无法对矿山的运营方式发表意见。不过，他们担心有毒的采矿废料会流入他们的河流中。



Red Chris is on a tributary of the Stikine River, which flows into the Pacific Ocean near the Alaskan town of Wrangell (see map). The river runs between snow-crowned mountains, their flanks thickly

furred with spruce and pine trees. Bald eagles fly overhead. A strip of cut-down forest on either side of the river is the only marker of the border.

红克里斯河是斯蒂金河的一条支流，这条河流入太平洋，位于阿拉斯加州的兰格尔镇附近（详见地图）。河流穿过被雪覆盖的山脉，两侧树木繁茂，有云杉和松树。秃鹰在头顶飞翔。河流两岸被砍伐后的森林地带，是这条河作为边界的唯一标志。

The Wrangell area is home to the Tlingit people. Most houses in town have a freezer packed with salmon from the Stikine, as well as meat from deer and moose that are hunted along its banks. The river also sustains old practices such as harvesting oil from small eulachon fish. The mines jeopardise this, says Coven Petticrew, a Wrangell Tlingit. "It could destroy what little is left of our way of life."

瓦朗格尔地区是特林吉特人的聚居地。镇上大多数家庭的家里都放着用斯蒂金河捕获的鲑鱼制成的冷冻食品，此外还有从河岸上捕获的鹿肉和驼鹿肉。这条河流还承载着一些古老的传统，比如从小型鳕鱼中提取油脂。不过，瓦朗格尔的特林吉特人科文·佩蒂克鲁表示，这些矿山的开发正在破坏这些传统。“这可能会毁掉我们仅存的生活方式。”

The miners say they are "committed to environmental stewardship". The Tlingit and neighbouring groups such as the Haida and Tsimshian do not trust them. Several watersheds feeding rivers flowing from Canada into Alaska have in the past been contaminated by industry, to varying degrees. Wrangell residents are quick to mention a 2014 tailings-dam rupture at another BC copper mine, which spilled waste into creeks and lakes.

矿工们声称自己“致力于环境保护”。然而，特林吉特人以及海达族、茨姆希安族等邻近部落却并不信任他们。过去，许多将河水从加拿大输送至阿拉斯加的流域都受到了工业污染的困扰，污染程度不一。瓦朗格尔的居民立刻提到了 2014 年不列颠哥伦比亚省另一家铜矿的尾矿坝溃坝事件，那次事件导致废物泄漏到溪流和湖泊中。

The Tlingit, Haida and Tsimshian's historic territories include areas that straddle the border. Those living in what is now Alaska believe this should grant them a say in what happens upriver. They have petitioned the Inter-American Commission on Human Rights to investigate the mines. They have filed a suit in BC's Supreme Court claiming they have the right to be included in decision-making.

特林吉特人、海达人和茨姆希安人拥有历史悠久的领地，这些领地的一部分位于边界沿线。现在居住在阿拉斯加地区的这些人认为，他们应该有权参与决定河流上游地区的事务。他们已向美洲人权委员会提出请求，要求调查这些矿场的问题。此外，他们还在不列颠哥伦比亚省最高法院提起了诉讼，声称他们有权参与相关决策的制定过程。

The Alaskans are not mad to think some over the border might be sympathetic. Canada, and BC in particular, volubly promote indigenous rights. Many public gatherings begin with a land acknowledgment recognising First Nations. In 2019 BC passed a landmark law giving indigenous nations broad rights to be consulted on legislation and other issues. And some relevant legal precedent exists: a 2021 Canadian Supreme Court decision on a hunting-rights case ruled that American members of an indigenous tribe with members on both sides of the border could be considered indigenous Canadians.

阿拉斯加人之所以会这么想，是因为他们相信有些位于边境另一边的人可能会同情他们。加拿大，尤其是不列颠哥伦比亚省，非常重视原住民的权益。许多公共活动都会以承认原住民土地为开端。2019年，不列颠哥伦比亚省通过了一项具有里程碑意义的法律，赋予原住民在立法和其他事务上发表意见的广泛权利。此外，还有一些相关的法律判例：2021年加拿大最高法院在一起关于狩猎权的案件中裁定，位于边境两侧的美国原住民部落成员可以被视为加拿大原住民。

The Tahltan are unmoved. They do "not recognise the claims of Alaskan Tribes in Tahltan Territory and view them as an encroachment on our title and rights," says Tahltan Central Government's president, Kerry Carlick. The provincial government is

taking a similar line. In April it passed a law explicitly locking Alaskan tribes out of the most important environmental decision-making processes.

塔赫坦人毫不动容。塔赫坦政府的总统克里·卡利克表示：“我们不承认阿拉斯加部落对塔赫坦领土的主张，认为这些主张是对我们权利和所有权的侵犯。”该省政府也采取了类似的立场。今年 4 月，该省通过了一项法律，明确将阿拉斯加部落排除在最重要的环境决策过程之外。

The Alaskans are continuing the battle in court. They see the stakes going up. In December the Tahltan gave their consent to another new mine on an Alaska-bound river—in exchange for \$10,000 per member and the promise of more to come. ■

阿拉斯加人继续在法庭上抗争。他们意识到形势越来越严峻。12 月，塔赫坦人同意在通往阿拉斯加的河流上建设新的矿场——作为交换，他们获得了每成员 10,000 美元的报酬，并且还承诺未来会有更多的收益。■

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Hokkaido Dreamin'

北海道梦想

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北海道一个高科技产业园区的构想，依赖于一家由政府支持的公司来实施。

Jul 09, 2026 06:32 AM | CHITOSE AND SAPPORO

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:32 | 千叶与札幌



HOKKAIDO HAS long been known for dramatic volcanic peaks, creamy dairy products and powdery snow. These days, Japan's northernmost major island is being touted by enthusiasts as the country's next high-tech hub. "Hokkaido is the new Taiwan," writes James Riney of Coral Capital, a Tokyo-based venture-capital firm. Japanese officials speak, somewhat breathlessly, of "Hokkaido Valley".

北海道以壮丽的火山峰景、优质的乳制品以及洁白的雪景而闻名已久。如今，这个日本最北端的岛屿被一些人士誉为日本的下一个高科技中心。“北海道就是新的台湾，”东京的风险投资公司 Coral Capital 的詹姆斯·雷尼如此评价道。日本的官员们则略带激动地称北海道为“北海道之谷”。

The vision hinges on Rapidus, a bold if risky chipmaking effort. Launched in 2022, the company aims to bring Japan back to the frontier of advanced semiconductor manufacturing. Supported by the Japanese government and a consortium of big Japanese companies, Rapidus broke ground on its first fab in September 2023, in a field near the international airport in Chitose, a suburb south of Sapporo, Hokkaido's capital. Pilot production of 2-nanometre chips, the cutting

edge for chipmaking technology, is under way. The ambitious effort is seen as a model for the sort of new-age industrial policy favoured by Japan's prime minister, Takaichi Sanae.

这一计划的实现依赖于 Rapidus 项目——一项大胆但具有风险性的芯片制造计划。该计划于 2022 年启动，公司的目标是将日本重新引向先进半导体制造的前沿领域。在日本政府以及一批日本大型企业的支持下，Rapidus 于 2023 年 9 月在北海道札幌市南部的千叶县国际机场附近地区建造了首个工厂。目前，2 纳米芯片的试生产正在进行中，这代表了芯片制造技术的最新水平。这一雄心勃勃的计划被视为日本首相田中正明所推崇的新时代工业政策的典范。



Rapidus could have set up in Kyushu, the southernmost main island. TSMC, a Taiwanese semiconductor giant, has two fabs there, tapping into a strong local supplier network. (Officials there call Kyushu a “Silicon Island”.) But the Rapidus bosses settled on Hokkaido. The island, home to the indigenous Ainu people, was once Japan’s frontier, annexed formally only in the late 19th century. The new frontier spirit is focused on pioneering semiconductors, says Ota

Yasuhiko of Hokkaido University.

Rapidus 本可以在九州这个最南端的主岛上建立工厂。台湾的半导体巨头 TSMC 在九州有两个制造工厂，拥有强大的本地供应商网络。不过，Rapidus 的负责人选择了北海道作为生产基地。北海道是原住民族阿伊努人的聚居地，曾经是日本的边境地区，直到 19 世纪末才被正式纳入日本版图。北海道大学的太田康彦表示，新边疆地区的企业们专注于半导体产业的创新发展。

Rapidus cites an “abundance of water” in Hokkaido, crucial for semiconductor manufacturing, as a key reason for choosing the region. Besides that, no other prefecture in Japan has as much potential for offshore wind energy: Hokkaido is projected to produce a third of the country’s wind power by 2040. The local governor also agreed late last year to restart the island’s sole nuclear power plant, which will provide a carbon-free, stable baseload for Hokkaido’s electricity grid.

Rapidus 认为，北海道拥有“丰富的水资源”，这对半导体制造来说非常重要，这也是选择该地区的关键原因。此外，日本没有其他省份拥有如此大的海上风能潜力：预计到 2040 年，北海道将提供全国三分之一的风能电力。去年年底，当地州长也同意重新启用该岛唯一的核电站，这将为北海道的电力网络提供无碳、稳定的基础电力。

Hokkaido’s geography also brings a number of other advantages. Large and sparsely populated by Japanese standards, the island offers ample space for new production facilities; Rapidus hopes to build several more fabs next to its first. Cooler temperatures make it a desirable location for data centres, which run hot; SoftBank, a Japanese tech giant, recently began building a ¥65bn (\$400m) data centre in Tomakomai, south of Chitose. Another largely unspoken benefit is geographic diversification: if a conflict ever broke out around Taiwan, Japan’s south-west islands, including Kyushu, could be at risk; production facilities in Hokkaido, by contrast, would be

much farther from any fighting.

北海道的地理位置还带来了许多其他优势。按照日本的标准来看，该岛面积广阔且人口稀少，为新建生产设施提供了充足的空间。Rapidus 计划在其首个工厂附近再建设几座生产设施。较低的温度条件使得该地成为建设数据中心的理想地点，因为数据中心通常需要保持低温环境。日本科技巨头软银最近在千叶县南部的 Tomakomai 地区，投资了 65 亿日元（约 4 亿美元）建设了一个数据中心。另一个未被充分提及的优势是地理上的多元化：如果台湾附近爆发冲突，包括九州在内的日本西南岛屿可能会面临风险；而北海道的生产设施则远离任何冲突区域。

Hokkaido would gain if there were a chipmaking boom. The semiconductor cluster could add as much as ¥11.2trn to its GDP between 2023 and 2036, according to a study by a regional-development agency. While Hokkaido will not reproduce the dynamism of Silicon Valley's startup ecosystem or the scale of Taiwan's chip-manufacturing base any time soon, it has a decent shot at becoming an important node in global semiconductor development and a key part of Japan's nascent AI ecosystem. A more realistic guide may be Albany, New York, where Rapidus's main technology partner, IBM, sits at the centre of a thriving tech research-and-development hub. Hokkaido's governor visited Albany in 2024 to study its model.

如果芯片制造行业能够蓬勃发展，北海道将会获得巨大收益。根据一家地区发展机构的研究报告，从 2023 年到 2036 年，半导体产业可能会为北海道的 GDP 贡献多达 11.2 万亿日元。虽然北海道短期内无法复制硅谷创业生态系统的活力或台湾在芯片制造方面的规模，但它有潜力成为全球半导体产业发展的重要节点，以及日本新兴人工智能生态系统中的关键组成部分。一个更现实的参考对象可能是纽约州的奥尔巴尼，Rapidus 的主要技术合作伙伴 IBM 就位于这个充满活力的科技研发中心。2024 年，北海道州长访问了奥尔巴尼，以研究其发展模式。

Yet despite all the enthusiasm, the Hokkaido Valley plan faces several big obstacles. First is cultivating the third necessary resource for chip manufacturing: human talent. Hokkaido hopes to sell itself as a place where skilled engineers might want to live. True, it is bitterly cold in winter. But the island is home to world-famous ski spots. And local culinary delights, culled from the icy surrounding seas, include tasty scallops and sea urchins as well as enormous crabs.

然而，尽管人们充满热情，但北海谷计划仍面临诸多障碍。首先就是如何培养芯片制造所需的第三种关键资源——人才。北海岛希望将自己打造成一个适合技术精湛的工程师们生活的理想之地。诚然，这里的冬天非常寒冷。不过，这座岛屿拥有世界著名的滑雪胜地。此外，当地还拥有来自冰冷海域的丰富美食，比如美味的扇贝、海胆，以及巨大的螃蟹。

Nonetheless, Hokkaido has few international schools for foreign recruits' children and salaries in Japan lag behind global standards. While the region has plenty of universities and colleges, they have tended to focus on agriculture, fisheries, forestry and service industries. Hokkaido University, the biggest and oldest university, was founded as an agriculture school; it is only now gearing up to train semiconductor engineers. Rapidus has relied heavily on veteran Japanese engineers.

不过，北海道对于外国学生子女来说，国际学校相对较少。日本的薪资水平也低于全球标准。虽然该地区有许多大学和学院，但这些机构和学校往往专注于农业、渔业、林业以及服务业领域。北海道大学是规模最大、历史最悠久的大学，最初是以农业教育为主的学校；现在它才开始培养半导体工程师。Rapidus 公司主要依赖日本的资深工程师来开展工作。

The second obstacle is the supplier ecosystem. Manufacturing accounts for less than 10% of Hokkaido's output, compared with 20% nationally. While dozens of semiconductor-related firms do operate there, the industry is still small. Some of Rapidus's partners

have set up support offices nearby, but so far not big manufacturing bases of their own. Hokkaido Valley insiders acknowledge that it will take at least a decade to cultivate a thriving cluster.

第二个障碍是供应商生态系统的问题。在北海道的制造业中，半导体相关产品的产值占比不到 10%，而全国范围内这一比例高达 20%。虽然那里有一些半导体相关企业，但整个产业规模仍然很小。Rapidus 的一些合作伙伴在附近设立了支持办事处，但至今还没有建立起大型的制造基地。业内人士认识到，要培育出一个繁荣的半导体产业集群，至少需要十年时间。

Most important is the success of Rapidus itself. While the firm has made impressive technological advances, its commercial success is far from guaranteed. The true test will come when it begins mass production, which it aims to do next year. TSMC produces standardised chips at large scale; Rapidus, by contrast, plans to offer rapidly made, small batches of bespoke AI chips. Given the dearth of firms able to make cutting-edge semiconductors, and the growing demand for them, the strategy is plausible. But even in the best case, Rapidus will need to rely heavily on public subsidies. The government has already promised more than \$15bn in support for the project. It is a big bet on a single firm. The Hokkaido Valley concept depends on it paying off. ■

最重要的是 Rapidus 自身的成功。虽然该公司取得了令人瞩目的技术突破，但其商业成功仍难以保证。真正的考验将在大规模生产开始时到来，而该公司计划在明年实现这一目标。台积电能够大规模生产标准化芯片；而 Rapidus 则打算生产少量定制化的 AI 芯片。鉴于目前缺乏能够制造先进半导体的企业，且对这类产品的需求不断增长，这一策略是可行的。但即便在最好的情况下，Rapidus 仍需要依赖政府补贴。政府已经承诺为该项目提供超过 150 亿美元的支持。这确实是一个对单一企业的重大投资。Hokkaido Valley 项目的成功与否，就取决于此。

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Power down

断电

Laos has big dreams of exporting energy

老挝有着巨大的能源出口梦想

But its dams have flooded it with debt and other problems

但是，其水坝建设带来了债务和其他问题，使该地区陷入困境。

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WITH ITS large ambitions for data centres and factories, South-East Asia needs energy. Last month the International Energy Agency

estimated that the region would account for a fifth of the increase in global power demand between now and 2035; only India is expected to contribute more. Yet as the war in Iran has painfully illustrated, secure supplies cannot be taken for granted. Where could the juice come from?

由于东南亚地区对数据中心和工厂的巨额投资需求，该地区迫切需要能源。上个月，国际能源署估计，从当前到 2035 年之间，该地区的电力需求将占全球总需求的五分之一；而印度预计将贡献更多的电力需求。然而，正如伊朗战争所显示的那样，确保能源供应并非易事。那么，这些能源从何而来呢？



Laos believes that it could be part of the answer. Coming from officials belonging to a landlocked country of around 8m people and an income per person of only \$2,400, that sounds audacious. But Laos is rich in one respect: water. The Mekong, South-East Asia's longest river, and its tributaries tumble through the country's mountains. Harnessing all that falling water offers an abundant source of clean energy. Laos wants to use it to become the "battery of South-East Asia", as enthusiasts term it, and the core of a regional grid.

老挝认为，这或许可以成为解决问题的一部分。对于一个拥有约 800 万人口、人均收入仅为 2400 美元的内陆国家来说，这一想法听起来相当大胆。但老挝在水资源方面却非常丰富。湄公河是东南亚最长的河流，其支流流经该国的山脉。利用这些水资源可以创造出丰富的清洁能源来源。老挝希望利用这些资源成为“东南亚的能源基地”，正如专家们所愿的那样，成为区域电网的核心组成部分。

The idea of such a South-East Asian network was first dreamt up as long ago as the late 1990s, though Laos had been exporting power long before that. It first sold hydro-generated electricity to Thailand, with which it shares a long border, in 1971. Since then it has built more than 80 hydro plants, with a total capacity of more than 12gw, enough to meet Singapore's peak demand, and accounting for around 70% of Laos's own supply. By 2030 it hopes to be operating 100 dams and to have lifted capacity above 15gw. Electricity is already the country's biggest export. In 2024 Laos sold power to six countries, including Singapore (some 2,000km away), raking in \$2.4bn, which was nearly a quarter of its total exports.

这个东南亚地区的电力网络构想最早出现在 20 世纪 90 年代末。不过，老挝在那个时候就已经开始出口电力了。1971 年，老挝首次向泰国出售了水电电力，因为泰国有与老挝漫长的边界。从那时起，老挝建造了超过 80 座水电站，总装机容量达到 12 吉瓦以上，足以满足新加坡的高峰需求。到 2030 年，老挝希望拥有 100 座水电站，总装机容量超过 15 吉瓦。电力已经成为老挝最大的出口产品。2024 年，老

挝向包括新加坡在内的六个国家出售电力，收入达到了 24 亿美元，这几乎占到了老挝总出口额的四分之一。

Much of this growth is due to China, which borders Laos to its north. This year a new transmission line linking the two countries opened up, allowing far bigger sales northwards. But Chinese influence extends well beyond electricity generation. The two countries, both nominally communist one-party states, have long shared an affinity. That has deepened thanks to a flood of Chinese investment in railways, rare-earth mines and dams. Around half of Laos's hydropower projects are believed to involve Chinese financing. In 2021 Électricité du Laos (EDL), the state utility, handed a 90% stake in a transmission grid to a subsidiary of China Southern Power Grid, a state-owned firm, under a 25-year concession.

这种增长的背后很大程度上归功于中国，因为老挝的北部与中国接壤。今年，一条连接两国的输电线路正式开通，从而使得向北的贸易往来更加便捷。不过，中国的影响力远不止于电力领域。这两个国家都是名义上的共产主义一党制国家，长期以来一直有着密切的联系。这种联系因中国对老挝铁路、稀土矿和水电站的大量投资而进一步加深。据估计，老挝约有一半的水电项目得到了中国的资金支持。2021 年，老挝国家电力公司将输电网络的 90% 股权授予了南方电网旗下的子公司，该国有企业获得了为期 25 年的特许权。

But the China-fuelled dam-building frenzy has come at a cost. Public debt is estimated to have ballooned to roughly 81% of GDP in 2025, up from about 53% a decade ago. Around half of the country's borrowing is owed to China, which has repeatedly staved off crises by deferring repayments. Many dams have been financed under build-operate-transfer deals, in which ownership will eventually revert to the Lao government. But such transfers will take time. According to the Lowy Institute, an Australian think-tank, the earliest Laos can expect to take over a big hydropower project is 2035. Environmentalists, meanwhile, blame the dams for collapsing fish

stocks in the Mekong and the erosion of river banks along it.

然而，由中国推动的大坝建设热潮也带来了代价。据估计，到 2025 年，老挝的公共债务将上升至 GDP 的约 81%，而十年前这一比例仅为 53%。该国约一半的债务是欠中国的，中国通过推迟还款来避免危机的发生。许多大坝的建设是通过建设-运营-转让模式来融资的，这种模式下，大坝的所有权最终将归老挝政府所有。不过，这样的转让过程需要时间。根据澳大利亚智库洛维研究所的数据，老挝最早要到 2035 年才能接管大型水电项目的建设权。与此同时，环保人士认为，这些大坝导致了湄公河鱼类资源的减少，以及河岸的侵蚀问题。

The quest for exports has also meant neglect at home. EDL is in the red because of transmission losses and other infrastructure problems. Power cuts remain common, especially in the dry season, when the Mekong runs low. This means that Laos has to often import electricity from Thailand at a higher price than it sells it for, according to Len George of the Asian Development Bank. To tackle this, the country is now investing more in solar power, which it also hopes to export. In April South-East Asia's largest solar plant, of 1GW, opened in the country's north. This too was built by a Chinese state firm to serve the Chinese market.

为了增加出口，老挝在国内方面的投入却有所忽视。由于电力传输损耗以及其他基础设施问题，老挝电力部门一直处于亏损状态。停电现象仍然频繁发生，尤其是在旱季，而湄公河的水流也会减少。据亚洲开发银行的 Len George 称，这意味着老挝不得不以较高的价格从泰国进口电力。为了解决这个问题，老挝现在正在加大对太阳能发电的投资，并希望将太阳能发电产品出口到其他国家。今年 4 月，东南亚最大的太阳能发电厂——装机容量达 1 吉瓦的发电厂在老挝北部建成投产。这座发电厂也是由中国的一家国有企业建造的，目的是为中国市场服务。

Exporting energy may help Laos's neighbours, but its economy has its own needs. Investment in power has crowded out spending on schools and clinics. Laotians stream across to Thailand in search of better-paid work. In November the country is due to graduate from

the UN's list of least-developed countries. To keep climbing, however, Laos will need more than the Mekong to charge its economy. ■

出口能源或许能帮助老挝的邻国，但老挝的经济也有其自身的需求。对电力行业的投资已经挤占了用于学校和教育设施的资金投入。老挝人纷纷前往泰国寻找更高收入的工作。今年 11 月，老挝预计将从联合国最不发达国家名单中毕业。然而，要继续保持发展，老挝不仅需要湄公河带来的资源，还需要更多的发展机会。

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Forbidden fruit

禁果

Indian mangoes have been banned from Japan 印度的芒果被禁止进口到日本了。

It's the latest sign of a widespread food-safety problem

这是食品安全问题普遍存在的又一迹象。

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Do I dare to eat a mango?

我敢吃芒果吗？

HUNDREDS OF PEOPLE had gathered to honour India's favourite fruit. Braving the heat in Delhi's Lodhi Gardens, a rapper riffed on the double meaning of *aam*, the Hindi word for both mango and common, as in common man. People dressed in mango-themed outfits were lectured by a mango farmer. Finally, the party, the fifth to be organised by an enthusiast named Ravinder Singh, descended into the mass munching of 120kg of the stuff.

数百人聚集在一起，庆祝印度最喜爱的水果。在德里洛迪花园里，尽管天气炎热，一位说唱歌手还是唱出了“am”这个词的双关含义——它在印地语中既指芒果，也指普通民众。穿着与芒果相关的服装的人们在芒果种植者的讲解下，共同品尝了这 120 公斤的芒果。这已经是这位名叫拉宾德·辛格的爱好者组织的第五场庆祝活动了。

Japan won't be having any, though. It has banned fresh mango imports from India, after the world's biggest producer failed its pest-control checks. India flunks a lot of such tests. Its spices, seafood and rice all face restrictions, bans and extra inspections in America, Europe and Asia. The EU has issued 365 alerts against various Indian food products in the past two years. The problem begins on farms, where runaway pesticide use and banned chemicals are common and good pest control is not. Corruption and lax monitoring mean that pesticides, drug residues and microbial bugs like salmonella then travel smoothly up the supply chain.

不过，日本并没有采取任何措施。由于印度最大的芒果生产国未能通过害虫控制的检测，日本禁止了从印度进口新鲜芒果。印度在许多此类检测中都不合格。在美洲、欧洲和亚洲，印度的香料、海鲜和大米都面临着各种限制、禁令和额外的检查。过去两年中，欧盟共对印度的各种食品发布了 365 项警告。问题始于农场，那里普遍存在过度使用农药和滥用禁用化学品的情况，而良好的害虫控制却难以实现。再加上腐败和监管不力，导致农药残留、药物残留以及沙门氏菌等微生物得以顺利传播到供应链的各个环节。

Bad food is bad for business. A single cargo container of spices can be worth over \$100,000, so rejection by inspectors hurts. Harder to

measure are reputational hits and extra inspection costs in the future. The EU already lab-tests 20-50% of all Indian chilli and curry-leaf shipments—at the producers' expense.

劣质商品对生意来说是有害的。一集装箱的香料价值可能超过 10 万美元，因此如果遭到检查人员的拒绝，将会造成巨大的损失。更难以衡量的是，这种劣质产品所带来的声誉损失以及未来需要支付的额外检查费用。欧盟已经对所有来自印度的辣椒和咖喱叶货物进行了 20-50% 的实验室检测——而这些检测是由生产商自己承担的。

The biggest victims are unsuspecting Indians. Almost one in five samples that the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India tested in 2024-25 failed. One recent raid in Gujarat unearthed a stockpile of worm-eaten and fungus-infected mangoes destined for juice. Artificial ripening—a banned but common chemical trick—can cause organ failure. Other things can kill over decades: the bigger the amount of certain pesticides you consume, the greater the risk of cancer.

最大的受害者是那些毫无戒备的印度人。在 2024-25 年间，印度食品安全标准局检测的样本中，几乎每五个样本就有一个存在质量问题。最近在古吉拉特邦的一次突击检查中，发现了大量被虫蛀和真菌感染的芒果，这些芒果原本是用来制作果汁的。人工催熟——这是一种被禁止但非常常见的化学手段——可能导致器官功能衰竭。此外，某些农药的过量使用也会在数十年内引发健康问题：摄入的农药剂量越大，患癌症的风险就越高。

Some fixes are for policy wonks. There could be a national farm-to-port tracing system for agricultural exports, and more testing labs along the supply chain. Other solutions may require high-level input. Over the past decade Bangladesh has virtually eliminated poisoning from lead chromate, a chemical that was frequently added to the spice turmeric to enhance its colour. Lead is toxic to humans, increasing the risk of brain and heart disease, and particularly dangerous to children because it can stunt their cognitive

development.

一些解决方案是为政策专家设计的。可以建立一个全国性的农业产品从农场到港口的追踪系统，并在供应链的各个环节增加检测实验室。其他解决方案则可能需要高层级的支持。在过去十年中，孟加拉国几乎彻底消除了使用铬酸钾作为添加剂的情况——这种化学物质常被添加到姜黄中以增强其颜色。铬酸钾对人类有毒害作用，会增加患脑部和心脏疾病的风险，而对孩子来说则更为危险，因为它会阻碍他们的认知发展。

Bangladesh's action against the additive involved public intervention from the prime minister, as well as a graphic tv campaign and the plastering of 50,000 notices in markets and other public areas. Adulteration of turmeric with the chemical was made a crime; India had done that earlier, but failed to implement its rules. It could do a lot worse than learn from its often looked-down-upon neighbour. ■

孟加拉国对这种添加剂采取的行动涉及总理的亲自干预，同时还开展了大规模的电视宣传活动，并在市场和其他公共区域张贴了 50,000 张告示。将姜黄与化学物质混合的行为被定为犯罪；印度之前也曾经有过类似的举措，但未能有效执行相关法规。孟加拉国现在只能向这个经常让人感到失望的邻国学习经验了。■

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The middle way to Gen Z

通往 Z 世代的中间道路

How South Korean Buddhists are trying to stay relevant

韩国佛教徒们是如何努力保持自身影响力的呢？

Life is suffering; the Buddha can help

生活充满了苦难；佛陀能够提供帮助。

Jul 09, 2026 05:22 AM | DAEGU

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A ROBOT MONK trundles across the exhibition hall of the Korean Buddhism Culture Expo in the city of Daegu. The humanoid, called Gabi, was unveiled in May and has since generated a new buzz about an ancient religion. Buddhists in South Korea have recently been trying to appear less old-fashioned, says Bae Ji-yun, a 26-year-old attending the expo and sifting through T-shirts bearing slogans such as "Shut up and meditate". Their efforts seem to be paying off. The event used to draw mainly Buddhists, but it increasingly attracts casual shoppers too. A similar expo this year in Seoul, the capital, drew a quarter of a million visitors, mostly youngsters.

一只名为 Gabi 的机器人正在大邱市举行的韩国佛教文化展览会的展厅内穿梭。这只名为 Gabi 的机器人于 5 月份亮相，自那以后，它为这一古老宗教带来了新的活力。参加此次展览的 26 岁年轻人 Bae Ji-yun 表示，韩国的佛教信徒们最近试图避免显得过于保守。他们的努力似乎正在取得成效。过去，这个展览主要吸引的是佛教信徒，但现在越来越多地吸引了普通消费者。今年在首尔举行的类似展览吸引了 25 万名游客，其中大多数是年轻人。

Gloomy young Koreans are drawn to Buddhism. Young adults report that life is increasingly stressful and competitive. The number of young who are economically inactive is said to have nearly tripled since 2004. Buddhism, which views suffering as an unavoidable feature of life and strives to rise above it, offers them some comfort. The religion generates faith in oneself rather than in a deity, says Kim Su-jin, a 25-year-old who recently trekked to a temple in search of inner peace. Buddhism remains the religion viewed most favourably by secular Koreans, a recent poll shows. Books about mindfulness such as "Life Hacks from the Buddha" are bestsellers. Last year temples hosted a record number of overnight guests.

那些情绪忧郁的年轻韩国人逐渐倾向于佛教。年轻人表示，生活中的压力与竞争日益加剧。自 2004 年以来，经济上不活跃的年轻人数量几乎增加了三倍。佛教认为苦难是生活中不可避免的一部分，但努力寻求超越苦难的方法，这为年轻人提供了一些安慰。25 岁的金秀珍说，佛教让人们相信的是自我，而不是神灵。最近一项调查显示，佛

教仍然是韩国世俗民众最喜爱的宗教。诸如《佛陀的生活秘籍》之类的关于正念的书籍非常畅销。去年，寺庙接待的过夜游客数量创下了历史新高。

Buddhist leaders hope the interest will revitalise their fading religion. South Koreans, especially young ones, are becoming less religious overall. The number of practising Buddhists is shrinking. Fewer new monks join monasteries: ordinations within the Jogye order, the largest in South Korea, have dropped to less than a third of their level two decades ago.

佛教领袖们希望，这种兴趣能够重新激发他们日益衰落的宗教事业。韩国人，尤其是年轻人，整体的宗教参与度正在下降。从事佛教修行的人数也在减少。加入寺庙的新僧侣数量也在减少：在韩国最大的佛教宗派——佛宗中，新修行的僧侣数量已经减少到二十年前的一半以下。

Last year, the Association of Buddhist Orders in Korea convened to discuss Buddhism's survival in the country. The latest challenge is to arouse lasting engagement while remaining uncoercive—one of Buddhism's key selling points.

去年，韩国佛教宗派协会召开会议，讨论佛教在该国的传承与发展问题。当前面临的最大挑战在于如何在不采用强制手段的情况下，激发信徒的持久参与意愿——这恰恰是佛教的核心优势之一。

To appeal to younger people, Buddhist orders are these days throwing dance parties and meditation festivals. Some temples even host matchmaking events for singles. These aren't gimmicks, says the Venerable Seo One of the Jikjisa Temple, one of the Koreas' oldest, dating back to the fifth century. Buddhism, she says, has always embraced "an unorthodox culture that transcends class and age". Others fear the religion is being cherry-picked. "The core beliefs may get lost," worries the Venerable Il Hwa of the Cultural

Corps of Korean Buddhism.

为了吸引年轻人群体，一些佛教团体现在会举办舞蹈派对和冥想节。有些寺庙甚至为单身人士提供配对活动。这些并不是做作的行为，韩国最古老的佛教寺庙之一——吉智寺的住持 Seo 说。她指出，佛教一直推崇“超越阶级和年龄的非正统文化”。不过，也有人担心这种宗教形式可能被滥用。“核心信仰可能会因此而丢失，”韩国佛教文化团体的住持 Il Hwa 担忧道。

It may be so. Hipster brands sell merch and preach the importance of inner wellbeing. One brand, Haetal Company, prints Buddhism-inspired memes on mugs and plastic key-chains. “I have always found Buddhism incredibly fun and cool,” says Ju Yeo-jin, its founder. The knick-knacks may not be a path to true enlightenment, but at least they are lifting spirits. ■

也许是这样吧。那些所谓的“潮人品牌”虽然销售各种商品，但却宣扬内心健康的重要性。其中一家名为 Haetal Company 的品牌，会在马克杯和塑料钥匙链上印有佛教相关的图案。“我一直觉得佛教非常有趣且酷，”该品牌的创始人 Ju Yeo-jin 说道。这些小物件或许无法带来真正的觉悟，但至少能让人心情愉悦一些。■

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Ashoka

阿育王

What Indians are reading, and what that reveals about the self

印度人正在阅读哪些书籍？这些书籍揭示了关于自我的一些什么信息？

English-language books offer a glimpse of India's hopes and dreams
用英语写成的书籍让我们得以一窥印度的希望与梦想。

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INDIA IS A rare country where hawkers still peddle pirated books at traffic lights. Congestion is often terrible, it is true, but it is not novel-length bad. The black-market trade says several things about the place: that there are not enough bookshops; that Indians are keen readers; and that copyright enforcement is somewhat lax. No matter. For many authors—if not their publishers—seeing knock-off versions of their books from car windows is the ultimate sign of success.

印度是一个相当罕见的国度，在那里，小贩仍然会在交通信号灯处兜售盗版书籍。虽然交通拥堵的情况相当糟糕，但这并不算什么大问题。黑市上的交易情况表明，这个国家的书店数量不足；印度人非常喜欢阅读；而版权保护的执行力度则相当宽松。不过，对许多作者来说，即使不是他们的出版商，也能从车窗上看到自己作品的仿制品，这倒不失为一种成功的表现。

The observant commuter will spot something else. In a country where only a small minority has any facility with the language, and an infinitesimally tiny one speaks it natively, all the books sold at red lights are in English. So are most of those at roadside second-hand-book dealers, in bookshops and in the top 100 on Amazon India.

English-language books make up about half of (non-educational) official sales. For a country as linguistically and culturally kaleidoscopic as India, that makes English books a rare example of common ground. What Indians read offers a glimpse of their hopes and dreams.

那些善于观察的乘客还会注意到另一件事。在一个只有极少数人掌握这种语言、而几乎没有人能说这种语言的国家里，所有在街边书店出售的书都是英文书籍。在路边二手书店、书店里，以及亚马逊印度站的排名前 100 的书籍中，也几乎全是英文书籍。在（非教育类）官方销售中，英文书籍约占一半。对于一个在语言和文化上如此多样化的国家来说，英文书籍确实是一种罕见的共同语言载体。印度人阅读的书籍反映了他们的希望与梦想。

Bookshop displays and bestseller lists reveal the chief concern of the Indian reader to be **self-improvement**. English is itself the biggest giveaway: it is the language of aspiration, not of pleasure. The split within English is illuminating, too. Half of all books sold are non-fiction, with fiction and children's books roughly equal. That is in contrast to other big English-language markets, where fiction has a clear lead.

书店的陈列和畅销书列表表明，印度读者最关心的是自我提升。英语本身就是一个显著的体现：它是表达追求之情的工具，而非享受之情的工具。英语内部的这种分化也很有意义。在所有销售的书籍中，有一半是非虚构类作品，而小说和儿童书籍的数量大致相当。这与其他英语国家的情况不同，在那里，小说占据着明显的优势。

That is why "Atomic Habits" and "The Psychology of Money" are reliable bestsellers. "Word Power Made Easy", which combines linguistic aspiration with the more general kind, is a perennial favourite. The [desire for personal growth](#) is not new. "How to Win Friends and Influence People" has been a regular on Indian bookshelves for decades. But it has recently been Indianised. "Do Epic Shit" by Ankur Warikoo, an entrepreneur and content creator (what else?), has sold over 300,000 copies since it came out in

2021. Its secret is to locate its epigrams in modern Indian society. The shops are full of similar books offering advice on life, work, health and relationships written by everyone from celebrities to doctors.

这就是为什么《原子习惯》和《金钱心理学》仍然是畅销书。而《简化语言的力量》则结合了语言技巧与更普遍的实用建议，一直都是读者的最爱。对个人成长的渴望并非新鲜事。《如何赢得朋友并影响他人》几十年来一直都是印度书架上的常销书籍。不过，最近这本书被赋予了印度特色。企业家兼内容创作者安库尔·瓦里库所著的《做伟大的事》自 2021 年出版以来，销量已超过 30 万册。这本书的成功秘诀在于将其格言融入了现代印度社会背景中。书店里到处都是类似的书籍，内容涉及生活、工作、健康以及人际关系等方面，作者从名人到医生都有。

Books reveal, too, that Indians are on a journey of **self-discovery**. Histories of India, often written by foreigners, have always sold well. But now Indians are not just writing their own stories, as Manu Pillai does in his mammoth "Gods, Guns and Missionaries". They are also interrogating who actually tells these stories, as Sowmiya Ashok does in "The Dig", a book about "the politics of the past". Contemporary histories are thickening the genre. Publishers rush out quick-response editions about still-fresh events; a book about last year's war with Pakistan was out within months of the fighting. Even memoirs by retired bureaucrats and politicians find a market (though mostly among their own friends and contacts).

这些书籍也揭示了印度人正在进行的自我探索之旅。关于印度的历史书籍，通常由外国人撰写，这些书籍一直都很受欢迎。但现在，印度人不仅自己在讲述自己的故事——比如马努·皮莱所写的《神、枪炮与传教士》一书。他们还在思考究竟是谁在讲述这些故事。比如索米亚·阿肖克所写的《挖掘》，这本书讲述了“过去的政治斗争”。当代的历史作品进一步丰富了这一文学类型。出版商们迅速推出关于最新事件的版本；关于去年与巴基斯坦战争的书在战斗发生后的几个月内就出版了。甚至退休的官僚和政客的回忆录也能找到市场（不过，这些回忆录大多只在他们自己的朋友和联系人中间流传）。

Books related to religion, mythology and spirituality are a growing force. One of last year's bestsellers was a small, inexpensive edition of the "Hanuman Chalisa", a five-century-old Hindu devotional poem. Gaur Gopal Das, who calls himself an "urban online monk", writes blockbuster hits that combine self-help with spirituality. India's foreign minister wrote one about geopolitics based on the lessons of the Ramayana. Other books tell CEOs what they can learn from the Mahabharata.

涉及宗教、神话与灵性主题的书籍越来越受到欢迎。去年最畅销的书之一，就是一本小巧且价格低廉的《哈努曼颂歌》版本——这是一首有着五百年历史的印度教虔诚诗歌。作者高乌·戈帕尔·达斯自称是一位“都市在线僧侣”，他创作的书籍将自我提升与灵性修炼相结合，取得了巨大成功。印度外交部长还写了一本基于《罗摩衍那》故事的地缘政治类书籍。还有其他一些书籍则向企业高管们传授从《摩诃婆罗多》中可以学到的道理。

Back at the traffic lights, an idling driver might notice that many bored commuters are whiling away their time [on their phones](#). Indeed. Social media and books share a symbiotic relationship. YouTube videos from literary festivals, Instagram poses from bookshops, photos of annotated pages of Dostoevsky—books feed the feed. And vice versa. Mr Warikoo's guide was essentially a collection of his social-media posts. Last year's biggest fiction hit was "Too Good to Be True", a romance novel whose author, Prajakta Koli,

is a YouTuber with millions of subscribers. Books reveal the Indian reader—both creator and consumer—to be versed in the art of **self-promotion**.

在交通信号灯处，那些怠速行驶的司机可能会注意到，许多无聊的乘客都在玩手机。事实上，社交媒体和书籍之间存在着一种共生关系。文学节上的 YouTube 视频、书店里的 Instagram 照片，以及多斯托耶夫斯基书籍上的注释页面——这些书籍相互滋养着对方。瓦里库先生的导览内容基本上就是他自己社交媒体上发布的内容的汇总。去年最畅销的小说是《Too Good to Be True》，这部浪漫小说的小说作者普拉克塔·科利是一名 YouTube 博主，拥有数百万订阅者。看来，印度读者——无论是创作者还是消费者——都非常擅长自我推广的技巧。

Yet social media does not transform the act of reading. It is at heart a solo endeavour. In India it is also a socially acceptable way of cultivating an individual identity in what remains a deeply collectivist society. Whether undertaken in pursuit of self-improvement, self-discovery or self-promotion, its appeal points to a deeper aspiration of modern Indians: the desire for self-expression. ■

然而，社交媒体并不能真正改变阅读的行为方式。本质上，阅读仍然是一种个人行为。在印度，社交媒体也是一种被社会所接受的方式来塑造个人身份认同——尽管印度仍然是一个高度集体主义的社会。无论是为了自我提升、自我发现还是自我推广，阅读都拥有着深刻的现代印度人的愿望：对自我表达的渴望。

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[reveals-about-the-self](#)

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The other mandarins :: But Chinese viewers also love British comedy that laughs at politics

其他官员们.....不过，中国的观众同样喜欢英国喜剧那种以政治为笑料的风格。

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Dutch masters

荷兰大师

Has China obtained the world's most important machine?

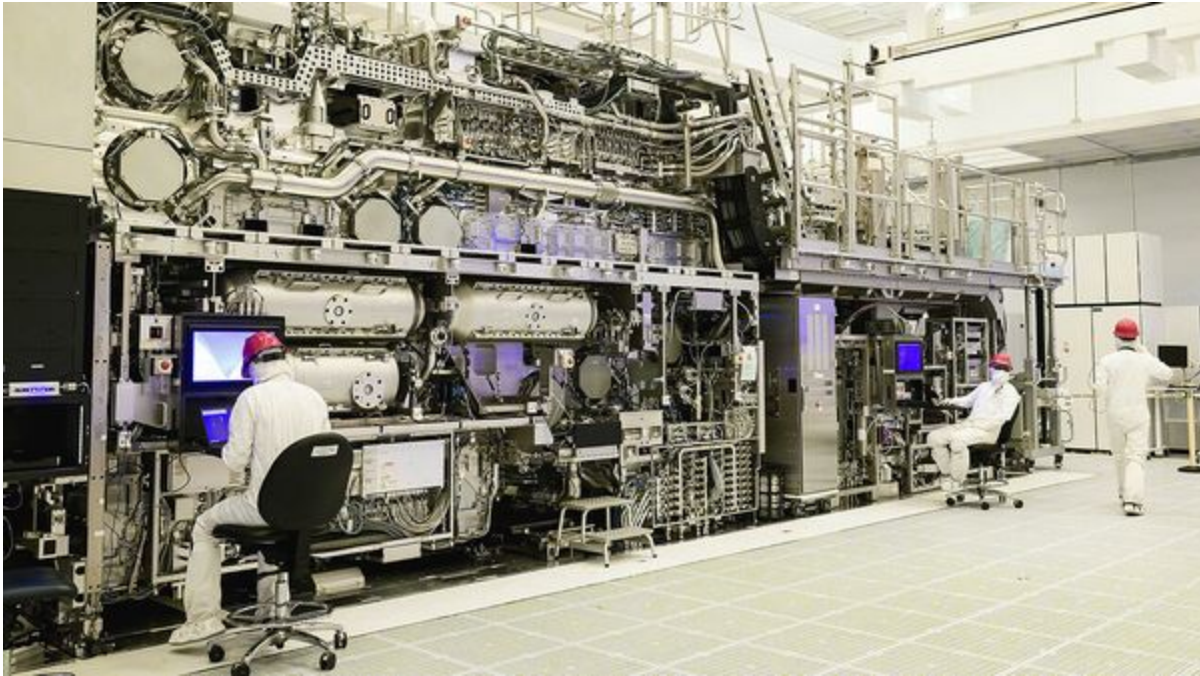
中国是否已经获得了世界上最重要的机器？

Its Dutch manufacturer is fighting to rebut American claims

该产品的荷兰制造商正在努力反驳美国的指控。

Jul 09, 2026 06:35 AM | Taipei

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:35 | 台北



THE DUTCH punch above their weight in technology transfers that shaped the modern world. In the 17th century their financial and farming innovations spread to Britain, spurring the Industrial Revolution and the British empire's expansion. Peter the Great, a Russian tsar, studied Dutch shipbuilding techniques to build the navy that made Russia a maritime power in the 18th century. And in the 1970s a Pakistani scientist, A.Q. Khan, stole blueprints from a Dutch lab to launch his country's nuclear-weapons programme and seed similar efforts in North Korea, Iran and Libya.

荷兰在科技领域的贡献对现代世界的形成起到了至关重要的作用。在 17 世纪，荷兰的金融和农业创新传到了英国，从而推动了工业革命的开展以及英国帝国的扩张。俄罗斯的沙皇彼得大帝学习了荷兰的造船技术，从而建立了强大的海军力量，使俄罗斯在 18 世纪成为海上强国。而在 20 世纪 70 年代，巴基斯坦科学家 A.Q. Khan 从荷兰实验室窃取了核设计图纸，进而推动了自己国家的核武器计划，同时也在朝鲜、伊朗和利比亚引发了类似的核计划。

Could Dutch know-how have just tilted the global balance of power again? So the Trump administration alleges. Since 2019 America has blocked the export to China of the extreme-ultraviolet, or EUV,

lithography machines (pictured) that make the world's most advanced semiconductors. These machines, whose creations power the most capable artificial-intelligence models, are made only by ASML, a Dutch firm. In recent weeks, however, America's commerce secretary, Howard Lutnick, has thrown the company into crisis by sharing with it his concerns that one of these machines may have found its way to China.

难道荷兰的技术能够再次改变全球的权力平衡吗？特朗普政府如此声称。自 2019 年以来，美国一直禁止将极紫外光刻机出口到中国——这些机器制造出世界上最先进的半导体产品。这些机器的核心部件由荷兰公司 ASML 生产，而 ASML 正是世界上最先进的智能模型的基础技术供应商。然而，最近几周，美国商务部长霍华德·卢特尼克透露，他担心其中一台机器可能已经流入了中国。

Impossible, says ASML. Europe's most valuable company has told American officials that it knows the exact location of all 340 EUV machines it has produced, including 26 decommissioned ones. None is in China, it says. What is more, only ASML can transport the highly sensitive machines, which it monitors online, and components that it ships are handled by ASML engineers in customers' fabs. "ASML has never shipped an EUV machine to China, nor have we shipped to China any component, module or equipment specially designed to be used in an EUV machine," the company says. Despite repeated requests, ASML has yet to be provided with any evidence to support Mr Lutnick's allegation.

ASML 表示，这是不可能的事情。这家欧洲最有价值的公司已经向美国官员表明，他们清楚自己生产的所有 340 台 EUV 设备的确切位置，其中包括 26 台已经退役的设备。这些设备都不在中国境内。此外，只有 ASML 能够运输这些高度敏感的设备，而这些设备的监控工作也由 ASML 的工程师在客户的工厂中进行。ASML 表示：“我们从未将任何 EUV 设备运往中国，也没有向中国输送过任何专为 EUV 设备设计的组件、模块或设备。”尽管多次请求，ASML 仍然没有得到任何能够证明 Lutnick 所诉事情真实有效的证据。

The Dutch government, while taking the American claim seriously, is pushing back, too. On a visit to Washington in late June, its trade minister, Sjoerd Sjoerdsma, tried to convince Mr Lutnick, other officials and members of Congress that the Dutch government strictly enforced its export controls, including on EUV technology. Speaking to *The Economist* on July 2nd, Mr Sjoerdsma declined to provide details of conversations about Mr Lutnick's claim. But he says the Dutch government is not, at present, investigating the American allegation. "If there were things to be investigated or perhaps even to be prosecuted, then obviously we would do so," he says.

荷兰政府虽然认真对待美国的指控，但也予以反驳。在 6 月底访问华盛顿期间，其贸易部长斯约尔德·斯约尔兹马试图说服卢特尼克先生以及其他官员和国会议员，表明荷兰政府严格执行了出口管制措施，包括对 EUV 技术的管控。在 7 月 2 日接受《经济学人》采访时，斯约尔兹马拒绝透露关于卢特尼克指控的详细对话内容。但他表示，目前荷兰政府并未调查美国的指控。“如果确实有需要调查或甚至起诉的事情，那当然我们会这么做，”他说。

The dispute hinges on whether there is any basis for Mr Lutnick's allegation. Although no information supporting it has been made public, some people briefed on it describe it as "unverified" yet "not unfounded". Many industry experts consider it highly unlikely that an entire EUV machine from ASML was shipped to China. But some believe that related components could have been, perhaps via ASML's own suppliers or other third parties. Others think the issue is more likely to be ASML's export to China of its older deep-ultraviolet, or DUV, lithography tools and related parts and services, most of which are not covered by export controls. ASML's DUV-related exports to China accounted for about a third of its revenues in 2025.

这一争议的核心在于，卢特尼克先生的指控是否有依据。虽然没有任何信息能够支持他的说法，但一些了解此事的人士认为，这一指控“尚未得到证实”，但“并非毫无根据”。许多行业专家认为，ASML 的整个 EUV 光刻机被运往中国这种可能性极低。不过，也有人认为，相关零

部件可能是通过 ASML 自己的供应商或其他第三方被输送到的中国。还有人认为，这个问题更可能是 ASML 将其旧的深紫外光刻工具及相关零部件和服务出口到中国，而这些产品大多并不受出口管制制度的约束。在 2025 年，ASML 对中国的深紫外光刻相关产品的出口占其总收入的约三分之一。

Build your dream

打造你的梦想家园吧。

Behind this controversy, however, lie much deeper differences over China's technological progress and how Western governments should respond. It also highlights the recent friction between the Trump administration and many American allies. Some American officials see Europe as weak on China. Many European governments fear the Trump administration is undermining their economic and security interests while trying to strike its own preferential deals with China. Some European officials and executives also worry that the Trump administration is trying to strong-arm ASML and related companies into shifting more of their business to America to help develop the chip industry there.

然而，在这场争议背后，其实存在着更为深刻的分歧，涉及中国的技术进步问题，以及西方政府应该如何应对这些问题。这一争议也凸显了特朗普政府与许多美国盟友之间最近的矛盾。一些美国官员认为欧洲在应对中国问题上表现得不够有力。许多欧洲政府担心，特朗普政府试图破坏他们的经济和安全利益，同时试图与中国达成自己的优惠协议。一些欧洲官员和高层人士还担心，特朗普政府正试图迫使 ASML 及相关公司将其业务更多地转移到美国，以推动美国芯片产业的发展。

One pivotal question is how far China has progressed in building its own EUV machine. Reuters, a news agency, reported in December that a team of former ASML engineers in China had completed a prototype EUV machine in 2025 and were testing it at a high-security lab in Shenzhen. ASML said it cannot control where former employees

work, but they are bound by confidentiality agreements and in some cases the company has successfully taken legal action in response to theft of trade secrets.

一个关键问题是，中国在制造自己的 EUV 光刻机方面取得了怎样的进展。据路透社报道，2025 年，一群曾在 ASML 工作的工程师在中国完成了 EUV 光刻机的原型机，目前该设备正在深圳的一个高安全实验室中进行测试。ASML 表示，他们无法控制这些前员工的就业地点，但他们必须遵守保密协议。在某些情况下，ASML 甚至因前员工泄露商业机密而采取法律行动。

The prototype had not yet created any working chips but the Chinese government had set a goal for it to produce functional ones by 2028, Reuters reported. Most experts think that unrealistic, and that it could be a decade before China has a [working 'EUV machine'](#). Still, they concede China is [making faster progress](#) than expected on EUVs, and some alternative technology.

据路透社报道，该原型机尚未制造出任何可用的芯片，但中国政府设定了在 2028 年前生产出功能性芯片的目标。大多数专家认为这一目标并不现实，可能需要十年时间才能看到中国拥有实用的 EUV 光刻机。不过，专家们也承认，中国在 EUV 光刻技术及其他替代技术方面的发展速度确实比预期要快。

The other big American concern is China's innovative use of DUV technology. Chinese chip firms such as SMIC and Huawei have pushed the limits of a technique known as "multi-patterning", allowing them to use DUV technology to make logic chips of less than seven nanometres, near the industry's cutting edge. Those were previously only made by EUV machines. While that technique brings higher costs and more errors than EUV tools, some American experts believe it could allow China to produce millions of the advanced chips it needs to catch up with America in the race for AI supremacy. Many in Europe believe such risks must be balanced with the need to protect and expand the revenues of ASML and the ecosystem

around it, while avoiding retaliation from China.

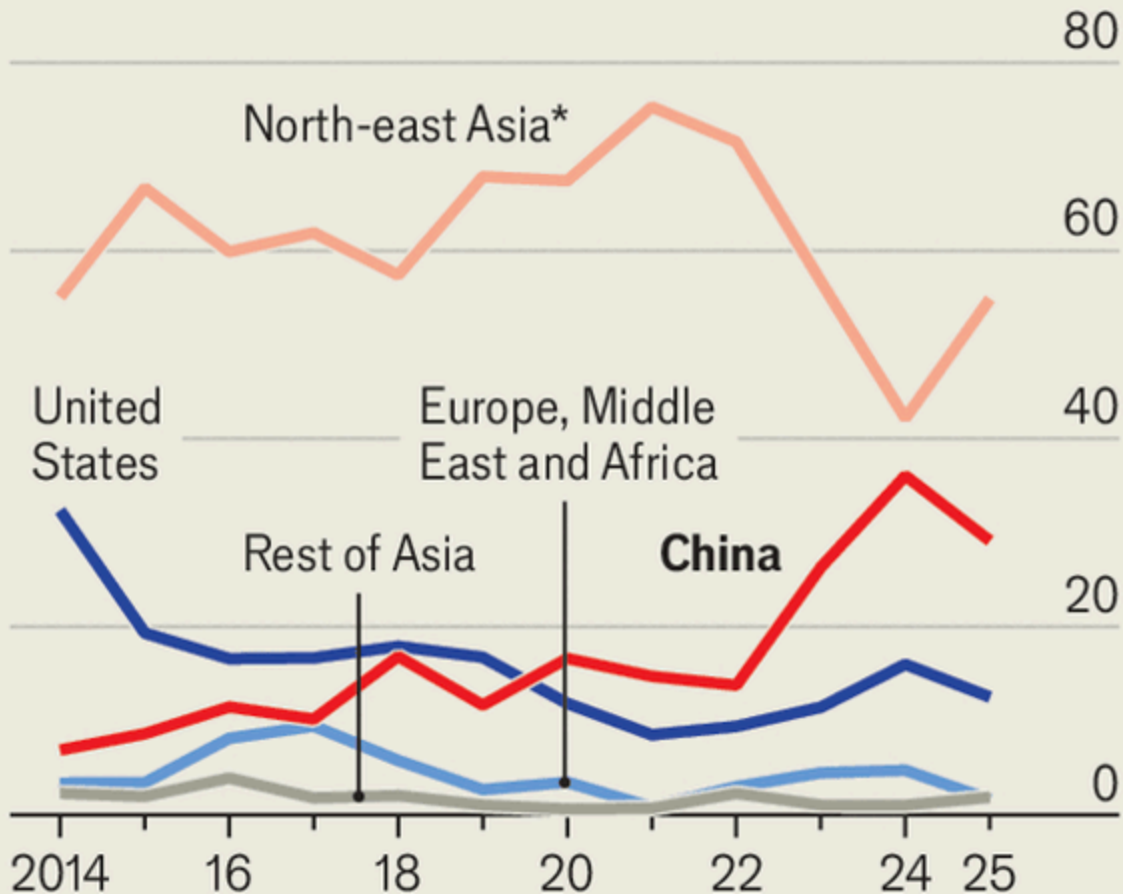
另一个令美国担忧的问题是，中国在极紫外光技术方面的创新应用。像 SMIC 和 华为 这样的中国芯片企业已经突破了“多栅格技术”的限制，他们能够利用极紫外光技术制造出厚度小于 7 纳米的逻辑芯片，这几乎达到了行业的最先进水平。此前，这种芯片只能由 EUV 设备来制造。虽然这种技术成本更高，出错率也更高，但一些美国专家认为，这或许能让中国生产出数百万种先进的芯片，从而在人工智能领域的竞争中赶上美国。许多欧洲人认为，在考虑这些风险的同时，必须权衡保护 ASML 及其相关产业利益的需求，同时避免遭到中国的报复。

One pillar of America's response is a new alliance of countries involved in Western AI supply chains. Known as Pax Silica, it aims to encourage partnership and common regulations in areas ranging from energy and critical minerals to advanced manufacturing and AI models. It has so far won support from 24 signatories, including the European Union and the Netherlands, which signed up in June during its trade minister's visit. That could make it easier to share cutting-edge technology among like-minded countries and to unify export controls relating to EUV systems.

美国应对措施的一个重要支柱是建立一个新的国家联盟，这些国家共同参与西方的人工智能供应链建设。这个联盟被称为“硅石同盟”，旨在促进在能源、关键矿物、先进制造以及人工智能模型等领域的合作与共同规范制定。目前，该联盟已经获得了 24 个国家的支持，其中包括欧盟和荷兰。荷兰在 6 月份贸易部长访问期间加入了该联盟。这一举措将有助于在志同道合的国家之间更便捷地分享尖端技术，并统一有关先进系统出口控制的规则。

Nether regions

ASML, net revenues, by region, % of total



Source: Company reports

*Japan, South Korea and Taiwan

The more divisive American initiative is the MATCH Act, legislation that was introduced in April with bipartisan support. It would not just block sales of DUV machines to China, but also restrict ASML's provision of servicing, spare parts and software support for the hundreds of DUV machines already there. And it would give the Dutch and others 150 days to align their controls with America's or face action under the Foreign Direct Product Rule. That applies American export controls to foreign products whose manufacture involves technology that originated in America and, in ASML's case,

would oblige it to comply or face hefty fines and other penalties. Backers say such measures are necessary, given the national-security stakes. "I don't support asking the companies nicely not to do this. I support making it illegal to do this," says Gregory Allen, a former director of strategy at the Pentagon's Joint AI Centre who now runs an advisory firm.

更具争议性的美国举措是《MATCH 法案》。该法案在四月由两党共同提出，旨在实施相关法规。该法案不仅会禁止向中国出售光刻机，还会限制 ASML 为那些已在中国境内的光刻机提供维修、备件和软件支持。此外，该法案还规定荷兰等国有 150 天的时间来调整其监管机制，以符合美国的法规要求；否则将依据《外国直接产品规则》采取相应措施。这项法规将把美国的出口管制措施扩展到那些制造过程中使用了美国技术的外国产品。在 ASML 的情况下，如果不遵守该法规，它将不得不遵守相关规定，否则将面临高额罚款和其他处罚。支持者认为，鉴于国家安全方面的考虑，采取这样的措施是必要的。“我不支持用温和的方式要求这些公司不要这么做。”“我支持将这种行为定为非法行为，”格雷戈里·艾伦说道。他曾担任五角大楼联合人工智能中心的策略总监，现在一家咨询公司的负责人。

The Dutch, and some others, disagree. The MATCH Act is "really unfortunate from our perspective," says Mr Sjoerdsma. He expresses particular concern about the threat to apply American law extraterritorially to Dutch and allied firms. "We believe that every country can best decide for itself what technology should be developed by its companies and what security risks this might or might not entail," he says. Further grounds for his government's scepticism is the contradiction between the demand to restrict exports of older DUV tools and the Trump administration's agreement to allow the export to China of Nvidia's H200 AI chips. They can only be made by some of the latest EUV machines.

荷兰人以及其他一些国家则持不同意见。Sjoerdsma 先生表示，从我们的角度来看，MATCH 法案确实很不幸。他特别担心将美国法律适用范围扩大到荷兰及盟国企业所带来的问题。“我们认为，每个国家都应该自行决定其企业应该开发哪些技术，以及这些技术可能带来的安全

风险是什么。”他说。此外，他的政府还对以下矛盾感到怀疑：一方面要求限制旧式 DUV 设备的出口，另一方面特朗普政府却同意将 Nvidia 的 h200 AI 芯片出口到中国。而这些芯片只能由最新的 EUV 设备制造出来。

Mr Sjoerdsma faced similarly tricky negotiations on a visit to China this week. It has denounced the MATCH Act and introduced regulations authorising it to penalise foreign companies that comply with American sanctions or export controls. The Netherlands is already reeling from the backlash to its decision in September to take control of Nexperia, a Chinese-owned Dutch chipmaker, to stop it from moving operations to China. The Chinese government responded by blocking Nexperia's exports from China, severely disrupting European and Japanese carmakers.

本周，索尔兹马先生在访问中国时也面临着类似的棘手谈判。荷兰已经废除了 MATCH 法案，并制定了相关法规，规定对那些遵守美国制裁或出口控制规定的外国公司进行处罚。然而，荷兰由于今年 9 月决定接管由中国企业控制的 Nexperia 公司而引发了强烈反对意见。中国政府因此阻止了 Nexperia 公司的出口业务，这严重影响了欧洲和日本的汽车制造商。

The fracas over Mr Lutnick's claim may die down, especially if America shares no evidence. But this is just an early salvo in the bigger battle over AI chokeholds. It will not be the last time that ASML and its technology are caught in the crossfire. ■

关于卢特尼克先生的索赔事件的喧嚣可能会逐渐平息，尤其是当美国无法提供任何证据的情况下。但这只是关于人工智能技术争议中初期的一些举措而已。这不会是 ASML 及其技术最后一次成为争议焦点。

■

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Set free

获得自由

China releases a prominent Christian pastor

中国释放了一位著名的基督教牧师

Jin Mingri formerly ran a large house church in Beijing

金明日曾经在北京经营一家大型的教会机构。

Jul 09, 2026 05:22 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:22



ONE OF CHINA'S most influential Christians has been released from detention and has flown to America. Jin Mingri, known as Ezra Jin,

was detained in October in a crackdown on religious activity. He was the pastor of Zion church in Beijing, one of China's biggest house churches. When authorities shut it down in 2018, he moved services online, broadening its reach. Donald Trump raised his case with Xi Jinping in May. He also spoke about Jimmy Lai, a pro-democracy tycoon serving 20 years in a Hong Kong jail for "conspiracy to collude with foreign forces". Mr Xi reportedly told him that Mr Lai's case was "a tough one". Other pastors from Zion church remain locked up. ■

中国最具影响力的基督徒之一已经从拘留所中被释放，并前往美国。名叫埃兹拉·金的金明瑞，在 10 月份因参与宗教活动而被拘留。他是北京锡安教会的牧师，该教会是中国最大的家庭式教会之一。当局在 2018 年关闭该教会时，他转而通过在线方式继续举行礼拜活动，从而扩大了教会的影响力。5 月份，唐纳德·特朗普向习近平提到了他的案件。他还提到了吉米·赖，这位支持民主的富豪因“与外国势力勾结”而在香港监狱中服刑 20 年。据报道，习近平表示赖先生的案件“非常棘手”。而锡安教会的其他牧师们仍然被关押着。■

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OK, boomer

好了，婴儿潮一代的时代已经过去了。

A rare Chinese missile test unnerves Asian neighbours

一次罕见的中国导弹测试让亚洲邻国感到不安

China moves a step closer to having an operational "nuclear triad"
中国距离拥有具备实战能力的“核三位一体”军事力量又近了一步。

Jul 09, 2026 05:22 AM | Taipei

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:22 | 台北



SECURITY IS ESSENTIAL to the operation of submarines that bear nuclear missiles. The vessels, known as boomers, are designed to stay hidden at sea for long periods, poised to fire nuclear-armed ballistic missiles at potential foes. China, however, is especially opaque about its boomers. Although the Pentagon estimates that they have patrolled at sea for a decade, China's government has never confirmed that. So its announcement on July 6th that one of them had carried out a rare test of an intercontinental ballistic missile in the Pacific Ocean surprised and unnerved the region.

携带核导弹的潜艇的运作离不开保密性。这些被称为“轰炸机”的潜艇被设计成能够在海上长期隐藏自身，随时准备向潜在敌人发射核武装弹道导弹。然而，中国对其潜艇的部署情况却表现得极为隐秘。尽管五角大楼估计这些潜艇已经在海上巡逻了十年之久，但中国政府从未对此作出过确认。因此，中国在 7 月 6 日宣布其中一艘潜艇在太平洋进行了洲际弹道导弹的罕见试射，这一消息令该地区感到震惊。

The missile carrying a dummy warhead was fired towards international waters, said Xinhua, an official news agency, without saying where it came down. China has test-fired missiles from submarines before but usually closer to its own shores. It has [tested long-range ballistic missiles](#) over the Pacific twice before, in 1980 and 2024. Both were launched from land.

据官方新闻机构新华社报道，那枚携带模拟弹头的导弹被发射到国际水域，但并未说明导弹的落点。中国之前曾从潜艇上发射过导弹，但通常都是发射到靠近自己海岸线的位置。此外，中国还在 1980 年和 2024 年两次从陆地上发射远程弹道导弹。

The test shows that China is “moving closer to a credible triad”, the capacity to launch long-range ballistic missiles from land, sea and air, wrote Frank Rose, a former senior official at the us National Nuclear Security Administration. Wang Qiang, a former professor at China's National Defence University, predicted on his Weibo social-media account that by next year China would demonstrate the triad's

completion by test-firing an air-launched ballistic missile.

据美国国家核安全局的前高级官员弗兰克·罗斯称，测试结果表明，中国正“逐渐朝着拥有可信的三元体系迈进”。此外，中国从陆地、海洋和空中发射远程弹道导弹的能力也得到了提升。中国国防大学的前教授王强在他的微博账号上预测，到明年，中国将通过发射空射弹道导弹来展示其三元体系的完整运作能力。

Foreign analysts say China is likely to carry out such tests regularly in the coming years as a way to validate the equipment involved and demonstrate resolve to America. "The United States and its allies must modernise their own deterrent capabilities and...find ways to bring arms control back into play as a tool for constraining China's build-up," wrote Mr Rose. China suspended nuclear-arms talks with America in 2024 in protest over arms sales to Taiwan.

外国分析人士表示，中国可能在未来几年内定期进行此类测试，以此来验证相关设备的性能，并展示其遏制美国的决心。“美国和其盟友必须现代化自身的威慑能力，并找到办法让军备控制重新成为制约中国扩张的手段。”罗斯先生写道。2024 年，中国因反对向台湾出售武器而暂停了与美国的核军备谈判。

The Pentagon has warned that China is expanding its nuclear arsenal and could have more than 1,000 operational warheads by 2030, compared with "the low 600s" in 2024. It is also building quieter submarines. American officials fear this is in preparation for a potential war over Taiwan that could escalate into nuclear confrontation between China and America.

五角大楼警告称，中国正在扩大其核武库的规模，到 2030 年时，中国的作战核弹数量可能达到 1000 枚以上，而 2024 年时这一数字仅为 600 余枚。此外，中国还在研发更安静的潜艇。美国官员担心，中国的这些行动可能是为应对潜在的台湾战争做准备，而这场战争有可能升级为中美之间的核对抗。

The missile, which appeared to have been launched from the South China Sea and to have splashed down in the South Pacific, was likely

to be a JL-2 or JL-3 (pictured), said several experts. The former has a range of about 7,200km, meaning it would have to be fired from the mid-Pacific Ocean to hit the western half of the continental United States. The JL-3 has a range of about 10,000km, allowing it to hit parts of the American mainland from Chinese coastal waters. It was on display for the first time at a military parade in Beijing last year.

据几位专家称，这枚导弹似乎是从南海发射的，然后坠落在南太平洋地区。该导弹很可能是 JL-2 或 JL-3 型导弹（如图所示）。JL-2 的射程约为 7,200 公里，因此必须从太平洋中部地区发射才能击中美国西部的陆地。而 JL-3 的射程约为 10,000 公里，因此可以从中国沿海水域发射，击中美国大陆的部分地区。去年在北京的一次军事阅兵仪式上，这枚导弹首次被展示出来。

China did notify some governments in the region before the latest test. Still, several voiced concern about the operation, which came on the eve of a NATO summit in Ankara and in the midst of American-led joint naval exercises around Hawaii. America's State Department said China's "rapid and opaque nuclear-weapons build-up is of great concern". It urged China to commit to routine notification of such launches, as other nuclear powers have. Australia's foreign minister, Penny Wong, described the test as "destabilising".

在最新一次核试验之前，中国确实已经通知了该地区的部分政府。不过，仍有几个国家对这次行动表示担忧，因为这次试验发生在安卡拉举行的北约峰会前夕，同时正值美国主导的联合海军演习期间。美国国务院表示，中国“快速且隐蔽的核武器建设行为令人担忧”，并敦促中国像其他核大国一样，定期通报此类核试验的信息。澳大利亚外交部长彭尼·王将这次试验称为“破坏稳定的行为”。

China is not alone in test-firing missiles from its boomers. The four other permanent members of the UN Security Council—America, Britain, France and Russia—do so regularly. But, given China's expanding nuclear arsenal and military pressure on Taiwan, this test will heighten regional fears about Chinese intentions and America's

capacity to protect its allies. ■

中国并非唯一一个进行导弹试射的国家。联合国安理会的其他四个常任理事国——美国、英国、法国和俄罗斯——也经常进行此类行动。不过，鉴于中国不断扩充的核武库以及对其台湾地区的军事压力，这次试射会加剧地区国家对中国意图的担忧，也会让美国更加意识到自己需要保护盟友的能力。

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The other mandarins

其他官员们

China's media gloat at Britain's chaotic democracy

中国的媒体嘲笑英国混乱的民主制度

But Chinese viewers also love British comedy that laughs at politics
不过，中国的观众同样喜欢英国喜剧中的政治讽刺元素。

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2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:22



“Hello? Is that Chairman Xi?”

“喂？是习主席吗？”

IT WAS NOT hard to guess how China's state-run media would react to the resignation of Sir Keir Starmer last month and the ongoing process of replacing him. The fall of the sixth British prime minister in a decade is yet more evidence, they suggested, that liberal democracies are unstable. “Could there be a problem with this type of government?” coyly asked the *People's Daily* in an interview with Cui Hongjian, a Chinese diplomat-turned-professor.

不难猜测，中国的国有媒体会对上个月凯尔·斯塔默爵士的辞职以及接替他的进程有何反应。《人民日报》在采访中国外交官出身的教授崔洪建时，也暗示了这一点。这位英国首相是十年来第六位辞职的首相，他的下台进一步证明了自由民主制度的不稳定性。“这样的政府会不会存在问题？”《人民日报》在采访中小心翼翼地提出了这个问题。

The chaotic turn in British politics since Brexit has been a gift to critics of Western democracies. It makes China's system look more stable. “Foreigners doing politics are like children playing with mud,” said a commenter on a video of one ugly House of Commons debate circulating on social media. The problem is that British parties only care about winning elections, rather than improving things, said Mr Cui. So they “quickly swap through prime ministers to win back votes rather than address deep-seated problems”. The Communist Party, of course, does not have to worry about winning elections.

自英国脱欧以来，英国政治出现了混乱的局面，这对西方民主制度的批评者来说是个好机会。这一情况让中国的体制看起来更加稳定。“参与政治的外国人就像玩泥巴的孩子一样，”在社交媒体上流传的一个关于下议院辩论的视频评论中如此说道。库伊先生指出，问题在于英国各政党只关心赢得选举，而不是改善现状。因此，他们只是频繁更换首相，以赢得选票，而不是解决深层次的问题。当然，中国共产党不必担心赢得选举的问题。

Interest in Britain's politics extends to satire. "Yes Minister", a BBC sitcom from the 1980s, has an unlikely but devoted online following, in part thanks to its cynical view of politics. Cheng Hong, wife of the late Li Keqiang, a former prime minister, translated a BBC book on the series into Chinese. One video analysing "Yes Minister" on Bilibili, a video platform, has 9m views.

对英国政治的兴趣也延伸到了讽刺作品领域。《Yes Minister》这部 20 世纪 80 年代的英国 BBC 情景喜剧拥有不少忠实的在线观众，这部分得益于其对政治的冷嘲热讽的态度。已故前总理李克强的妻子程虹将这部 BBC 剧的书籍翻译成了中文。在哔哩哔哩上有一篇分析《Yes Minister》的视频，获得了 900 万次观看次数。

Quotes are shared online. In one popular clip, Bernard, a naive civil servant, pushes for more transparency. "Surely the citizens of a democracy have a right to know!" he exclaims. "No," responds Sir Humphrey, his boss. "They have a right to be ignorant."

这些言论被分享在网上。在一个流行的视频片段中，一个天真的公务员伯纳德主张增加透明度。“民主国家的公民当然有权利了解真相！”他大声说道。“不，”他的上司汉弗莱爵士回答道，“他们有权保持无知。”

"Yes Minister" is also loved because some Chinese viewers recognise their own elitist, unaccountable bureaucracy. And the turnover of British leaders contrasts with the unending rule of Xi Jinping. In power since 2012, he removed presidential term limits in 2018. Commenting on Sir Keir's resignation, one social-media user wrote, "I envy this kind of replacement." "Wow," replied another. "You dared to say it." ■

“是的，部长。”这种说法也很受欢迎，因为一些中国观众能够认出自己所处的官僚体系其实也是精英主义且不负责任的。而英国领导人的轮换现象，则与习近平的无休止统治形成对比。自 2012 年以来，习近平一直掌权，他在 2018 年取消了总统任期限制。在评论基尔爵士的辞职时，一位社交媒体用户写道：“我羡慕这种替代方式。”另一位用户则回复道：“哇，你竟敢这么说。”

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Not so minor offences

并非轻微的违法行为

Child suspects are being prosecuted at younger ages

那些年幼的嫌疑人也在相对较年轻的时候就被起诉了。

Some governments are lowering the age of criminal responsibility. That may backfire

一些政府正在降低刑事责任年龄。这可能会带来不良后果。

Jul 09, 2026 05:23 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:23



"I'LL GUIDE YOU," wrote a user called Akon on Signal, an encrypted messaging app. "Pick up the guns and then take a taxi and go straight there. Like a soldier." In October 2024, court records show, a 13-year-old boy in Gothenburg, Sweden had agreed to do a job in exchange for SKr200,000 (about \$19,000 at the time). At around 7am on October 10th the boy received a YouTube tutorial on how to load a gun. Shortly after that he strode past a police car and shot at the entrance of Elbit Systems, Israel's largest defence contractor, in broad daylight. News reports suggest the attack had been orchestrated by a Swedish drug gang with links to Iran, a year into Israel's war in Gaza.

“我会引导你，”一位用户在加密消息应用 Signal 上写道。“拿起枪，然后打车前往那里。就像一名士兵一样。”2024 年 10 月，法庭记录显示，在瑞典哥德堡，有一个 13 岁的男孩同意接受这份工作，作为交换，他获得了 200,000 瑞典克朗的报酬（当时约合 19,000 美元）。10 月 10 日早上 7 点左右，这个男孩收到了一个关于如何装弹枪支的 YouTube 教程。之后，他径直穿过一辆警车，在光天化日之下向以色列最大的国防承包商 Elbit Systems 的门口开枪。新闻报道称，这次袭击是由一个与伊朗有联系的瑞典贩毒团伙策划的，而以色列在加沙的战争已经持续了一年之久。

The boy was arrested almost instantly. But he was never charged, probably for the same reason he was recruited in the first place: he was below Sweden's minimum age of criminal responsibility (MACR) of 15—the threshold at which people are deemed able to grasp the consequences of their actions, and thus punishable for them. Swedish officials are pushing to lower the MACR to 14 for serious crimes ahead of parliamentary elections in September, as voters demand a response to a spate of gang violence in recent years. In 2022 the country had one of the highest rates of gun homicides in Europe. Last year there was a wave of bomb explosions and shootings, a number of which involved children.

那个男孩几乎立刻就被逮捕了。不过他并没有被起诉，这可能是因为他最初被招募时的年龄就不符合瑞典的最低刑事责任年龄标准——15

岁。通常，15 岁的人被认为已经能够理解自己的行为后果，因此无需承担法律责任。在 9 月举行的议会选举之前，瑞典官员试图将严重犯罪的刑事责任年龄降低到 14 岁，因为选民们要求对近年来不断增长的帮派暴力事件作出回应。2022 年，瑞典的枪杀案件发生率位居欧洲首位。去年发生了多起爆炸和枪击事件，其中一些事件涉及儿童。

How low can you know?

Minimum age of criminal responsibility

Selected countries



*12 in Scotland

Sources: "The minimum age of criminal responsibility internationally—history, systems and the future", by E. Delmage et al., *Criminal behaviour and mental health*, 2026; CRIN; CLT; government statistics; press reports; *The Economist*

Politicians in other countries from Brazil to the Philippines and South Korea are trying to lower their MACR, often for similar reasons (see chart). The Maldives may soon lower it from 15 to 12. Argentina this year has lowered its MACR from 16 to 14 at the behest of Javier Milei, the president. Last month Northern Ireland blocked a proposal to raise the MACR from ten, the lowest in Europe (along with England, Wales and Switzerland), to 14.

从巴西到菲律宾、韩国等国的政客们都在努力降低自己的边际税率，其原因往往相似（参见图表）。马尔代夫可能很快会将边际税率从 15% 降至 12%。今年，阿根廷根据总统哈维尔·米莱的建议，也将边际税率从 16% 降至 14%。上个月，北爱尔兰否决了一项将边际税率从 10% 提高到 14% 的提议；10% 是欧洲最低税率水平，北爱尔兰与英格兰、威尔士和瑞士一样处于这一水平。

Governments are also moving to impose tougher punishments on the children they do prosecute. Mr Milei has championed his changes with the slogan “adult crime, adult punishment”. In 2024 Queensland, Australia, passed its own “Adult Crime, Adult Time” law (then expanded it twice). Children there as young as ten can be sentenced to life in prison for murder. And starting this month in Sweden convicts as young as 15 will be imprisoned, ending a long-standing policy of detaining them in youth homes. If Sweden’s change in MACR goes through, 14-year-old criminals will go to prison, too.

各国政府也在努力对那些被起诉的未成年人实施更严厉的惩罚。米莱先生倡导这一改革理念，其口号是“成人犯罪，应由成人来惩罚”。2024 年，澳大利亚昆士兰州通过了名为“成人犯罪，成人服刑”的法律，并随后两次对其进行了修订。在那里，年仅 10 岁的儿童犯谋杀罪也可能被判处终身监禁。而从本月开始，在瑞典，甚至 15 岁的罪犯也将被监禁，这一政策是瑞典长期以来的做法。如果瑞典的“成人犯罪，成人服刑”改革得以实施，那么 14 岁的罪犯也将面临监禁。

Officials in many of these countries are responding to rising public pressure over high-profile incidents of youth violence. In the

Philippines, a 14-year-old boy was one of two teenagers accused of carrying out a school shooting in June that left three dead, prompting some politicians (though not yet Ferdinand Marcos, the president) to call for lowering the country's MACR from 15. One of the killers was a player of GoreBox, a first-person shooter game, which the government has now banned.

许多国家的官员正在应对公众对于青少年暴力事件的日益增加的压力。在菲律宾，一名 14 岁的男孩是两名被指控在 6 月实施校园枪击事件的青少年之一。那起事件导致 3 人死亡，这促使一些政治家呼吁将该国的最低刑事责任年龄从 15 岁降低。其中一名凶手喜欢玩《GoreBox》这款第一人称射击游戏，而政府现已禁止了这款游戏的销售。

In Argentina in 2024, prosecutors say, someone inside a prison hired a 15-year-old gunman for 200,000 pesos (\$200 at the time) to murder a petrol-station attendant—a crime that was captured on CCTV footage and shocked the country. The teen was too young to be prosecuted, provoking an outcry. Julio Burdman of Isasi/Burdman, a pollster, found 68% of people favoured lowering the MACR. "Public opinion is quite convinced that young people are the drivers of crime," Mr Burdman says. "And that's why politicians go after it."

据 2024 年在阿根廷的检察官称，有一名监狱内部的人员以 20 万比索（当时相当于 200 美元）的报酬雇用了一名 15 岁的枪手，意图杀害一名加油站工作人员。这一犯罪行为被监控摄像头拍下，震惊了整个国家。由于涉事少年年龄太小，无法受到起诉，这一事件引发了广泛的抗议。民意调查机构 Isasi/Burdman 的朱利奥·伯德曼发现，有 68% 的人支持降低枪械的制造年龄限制。“公众普遍认为，年轻人是犯罪行为的推动者，”伯德曼先生说：“这就是为什么政客们一直试图解决这个问题。”

The actual data on youth crimes across countries are more murky than the perception. In some countries, including Germany and Sweden, there have been reported spikes in serious crime among

young people. And in South Korea the number of crimes among children under 14 nearly doubled in four years, to 21,000 last year.

各国关于青少年犯罪的实际数据情况比人们的认知要复杂得多。在一些国家，比如德国和瑞典，青少年的严重犯罪事件数量出现了上升。而在韩国，14岁以下的儿童犯罪案件数量在四年内几乎翻了一番，去年达到了 21,000 起。

But such rises have generally been from a relatively tiny base; in many rich countries rates of juvenile crime declined from the 1990s (when there was a previous round of get-tough-on-crime changes in law) to the 2010s. The Swedish National Council for Crime Prevention reported that in 2023 some 3,500 offences by children under 15 had been serious enough to be investigated formally, up from 1,500 in 2015. Assault was the most common offence, followed (in the case of boys) by robbery and rape. In 2025, 52 Swedish children under 15 were linked to a murder or a murder-related plot—around a third of them under 14.

不过，这种犯罪率的上升通常是从相对较小的基数开始的；在许多富裕国家，青少年犯罪的比率从 20 世纪 90 年代开始下降（当时曾有过一系列旨在加强打击犯罪的法律改革），到了 21 世纪 10 年代更是有所降低。瑞典国家犯罪预防委员会报告称，到 2023 年，有大约 3,500 起 15 岁以下儿童的犯罪行为需要被正式调查，而这一数字在 2015 年时仅为 1,500 起。攻击行为是最常见的犯罪行为，而在男孩中，抢劫和强奸也是常见的犯罪行为。到 2025 年，有 52 名 15 岁以下的瑞典儿童与谋杀案或类似谋杀案有关——其中约三分之一的年龄在 14 岁以下。

How young is too young to hold a child responsible? The UN Committee on the Rights of the Child recommends a MACR of at least 14, and urges against lowering a MACR once established. Critics of lowering the age say children may not fully understand the consequences of their actions. Studies show children aged 12-14 are more impressionable, impulsive and prone to risk-taking. The brain's

pre-frontal cortex is still developing during adolescence.

那么，多小的孩子才能被认定为不负责任呢？联合国儿童权利委员会建议最低年龄限制为 14 岁，并强调不应降低已经确定的年龄标准。那些主张降低年龄限制的人认为，孩子们可能还无法完全理解自己的行为所带来的后果。研究表明，12 到 14 岁的孩子更容易受到外界影响，情绪冲动，且倾向于冒险行为。在青春期，大脑的前额叶仍在发育中。

But politics shapes criminal-justice systems—and often that means tough-on-crime politics. England's MACR of ten has been on the books for more than 60 years. But in 1993 the torture and murder of a two-year-old by two ten-year-old boys prompted calls to tighten the screws further on young offenders. In 1998 Tony Blair's Labour government abolished a common-law presumption—which prosecutors had to rebut—that children aged 10-13 are *doli incapax*, or incapable of wrongdoing. Australia still adheres to the same prosecutorial hurdle for suspects aged 10-13 (even while Queensland seeks to punish such children like adults). In other countries high-profile crimes similarly produce constituencies for lowering the MACR; rarely does pressure go the other way.

不过，政治因素确实会影响刑事司法体系的设计——而这通常意味着需要采取更为严厉的政策来打击犯罪。英国的 10 岁刑事责任年龄规定已经实施超过 60 年。但在 1993 年，两名 10 岁男孩杀害了一名 2 岁儿童的事件引发了要求进一步加强对青少年犯罪行为的惩罚的呼声。1998 年，托尼·布莱尔的工党政府废除了一种常见的法律推定规则，即认为 10 至 13 岁的儿童不具备实施违法行为的能力。澳大利亚仍然坚持对 10 至 13 岁的嫌疑人采取同样的起诉标准（尽管昆士兰州试图像对待成年人一样对这类儿童进行惩罚）。在其他国家，一些严重的犯罪行为同样会引发降低 10 岁刑事责任年龄的呼声；但很少有情况下，这种压力会朝着相反的方向发展。

Politicians pushing to lower the MACR say they are motivated in part by the recruitment of youths into gang violence. In the Maldives, the government says that gangs in Malé, the capital, use children as

young as 11 to carry out serious crimes. In Colombia authorities reported that 409 children were recruited by armed groups in 2024, up from 342 in 2023 (and probably a severe undercount, experts say).

那些试图降低未成年人犯罪率的政客们表示，他们的行动部分是由于希望将年轻人吸引到帮派暴力活动中。在马尔代夫，政府称首都马累的帮派会利用年仅 11 岁的儿童实施严重犯罪。在哥伦比亚，当局报告称，2024 年有 409 名儿童被武装组织招募，而 2023 年这一数字为 342 人（不过专家认为实际数字可能远低于此数值）。

In June last year, a 15-year-old Colombian boy shot a senator and presidential hopeful who died from his injuries two months later. Prosecutors said he was probably recruited by a criminal network. He was sentenced to just seven years in juvenile detention, provoking criticism that such lax punishments encourage the exploitation of minors by gangs. The UN says the longstanding problem in the country of drug-traffickers using *soldaditos*, or little soldiers, has been getting worse.

去年六月，一名 15 岁的哥伦比亚男孩枪杀了某位参议员和总统候选人。两个月后，该参议员去世。检察官称，该男孩很可能是某个犯罪网络招募来的成员。他仅被判处七年的少年拘留刑罚，这一判决引发了批评，人们认为如此宽松的刑罚助长了犯罪团伙对未成年人的剥削行为。联合国指出，该国长期存在的毒品贩子利用“小士兵”进行非法活动的现象正在加剧。

A report in 2025 by the European Parliament says gang recruitment is getting worse in a number of European countries as well (while noting that hard data are scarce due to shortcomings and inconsistencies in record-keeping on youth crime). The report attributes much of the rise to growing demand for recreational drugs, and finds that youths are taking part in more types of organised crime in more geographic areas than before in places like

France and the Netherlands.

2025 年，欧洲议会的一份报告指出，在多个欧洲国家，帮派招募现象正在加剧。报告指出，由于青少年犯罪记录的保存存在缺陷和不一致性问题，因此很难获得确切的数据。该报告认为，这种现象的增加主要源于对娱乐性毒品需求的增长，同时指出，在法国和荷兰等国家和地区，青少年参与的各种有组织犯罪活动种类越来越多，涉及的地理范围也不断扩大。

Inevitably this has meant more violence, too. In Marseille, where gangs are hiring adolescents as police-spotters, the report says, there have been cases of children “harming innocent bystanders or killing each other with Kalashnikovs”.

显然，这也意味着更多的暴力行为。报告指出，在马赛，一些帮派雇佣青少年担任监视员，结果出现了一些案例：孩子们“伤害了无辜的旁观者，或者用卡拉什 nikov 步枪互相残杀”。

In Sweden, like in Argentina, the Maldives and elsewhere, government officials argue that lowering the MACR will let police not only improve public safety, but also help children who have gone astray by intervening earlier in their lives. To the extent that their age made them targets for recruitment, the argument goes, it may also spare some children from organised-crime recruitment.

在瑞典，就像在阿根廷、马尔代夫等地一样，政府官员认为降低招募年龄限制不仅有助于警方提升公共安全，还能帮助那些迷路的孩子，在他们成长过程中更早得到干预。他们认为，由于这些孩子年龄较小，更容易成为犯罪组织的招募对象，因此降低招募年龄限制或许也能让一些孩子免于被有组织犯罪团伙招募。

But those who oppose lowering the MACR—including, in Sweden, the prison service, the bar association and an independent body of senior judges—fear the opposite will happen instead. In England and Wales, where the MACR is just ten, gangs recruit children as young as seven. “Gangs are going lower and lower,” says Gabriel Wessman,

director of Rosersberg prison north of Stockholm.

但是那些反对降低最低刑事责任年龄的人——在瑞典，这些反对者包括监狱管理部门、律师协会以及一些独立的资深法官团体——却担心相反的情况会发生。在英格兰和威尔士，最低刑事责任年龄仅为 10 岁，而帮派甚至从 7 岁就开始招募儿童成员。“帮派的年龄越来越小了，”斯德哥尔摩北部罗瑟斯伯格监狱的负责人加布里埃尔·韦斯曼说道。

Lowering the MACR can also do lasting harm to the children who get locked up. In 2010 Denmark, which was then enduring a wave of gang-related violence similar to Sweden's, experimented with lowering the age from 15 to 14. Two years later the change was reversed under a new government. Authorities determined that lowering the MACR had actually led to an increase in crime: criminalising younger children increased the likelihood of their reoffending within 18 months of release. (Similarly, in England and Wales two-thirds of children aged 10-17 who served custodial sentences of under a year end up reoffending within a year of their release.)

降低最低刑事责任年龄也会对那些被关进监狱的儿童造成长期的影响。2010 年，丹麦当时正面临与瑞典类似的帮派暴力问题，当时尝试将最低刑事责任年龄从 15 岁降至 14 岁。两年后，在新政府上台后，这一政策被撤销了。当局发现，降低最低刑事责任年龄实际上导致了犯罪率的上升：将年龄较小的儿童纳入刑事责任范围，会让他们在出狱后 18 个月内再次犯罪的可能性增加。（同样，在英格兰和威尔士，那些在 10 至 17 岁之间、曾因违法行为被监禁一年以下的儿童中，有三分之二在出狱后一年内再次犯罪。）

Insta-gangs

Insta 帮派

However governments tweak their laws, gangs will find a way to hire young shooters like the 13-year-old in Gothenburg. Narcos in Latin

America and gangs in Britain alike target children on Instagram and TikTok, massively widening their pool of recruits. “They can take the children that we recruit, but in one second I will put something new on Instagram, and I will recruit hundreds of children again,” one recruiter told Evin Cetin, a co-author of “Child Soldiers: How Gangs Kidnap Our Future”.

不过，无论政府如何修改相关法律，那些帮派总能找到办法来招募像哥德堡那名 13 岁少年这样的年轻枪手。在拉丁美洲，那些贩毒组织以及英国的帮派都在 Instagram 和 TikTok 上寻找目标，专门招募儿童成员。一位招募者告诉《儿童士兵：帮派如何绑架我们的未来》一书的合著者 Evin Cetin：“他们可以夺走我们招募来的孩子，但再过一秒钟，我就会在 Instagram 上发布新的内容，然后再次招募数百名儿童。”

Sweden is an example of how shrewdly—and quickly—criminals can adapt to changes in the law and inflict the consequences on the young. In 2022, as gang crimes hit their peak, the government toughened a measure that gave anyone under 20 years old a “discount” on their prison sentence, lowering that threshold to under 18. Gangs quickly accelerated the recruitment of younger people online, asking them to send a photo of their passports or of their relatives’ passports before they carried out a crime. That locked them in for fear of reprisals if they got cold feet.

瑞典就是一个很好的例子，说明犯罪分子如何巧妙且迅速地适应法律的变化，从而将后果归咎于年轻人。在 2022 年，随着帮派犯罪活动达到顶峰，政府加强了一项政策：对于年龄小于 20 岁的罪犯，其刑期可以予以减免，甚至降低到 18 岁以下即可。帮派迅速通过线上方式招募更年轻的成员，要求他们在实施犯罪之前上传护照照片或亲属的护照照片。这样做是为了避免那些犹豫不决的罪犯遭到报复。

The case of the Elbit Systems shooting remains a telltale example of who gets punished and who often does not in organised crime. Four other teenagers, ranging in age from 15 to 19, were eventually sentenced to prison for their roles in the crime, including the

recruitment of the 13-year-old boy. But not “Akon”, the person who appears to have been the mastermind. He was never identified. ■

Elbit Systems 公司案仍然是一个典型的例子，足以说明在有组织犯罪中，哪些人会受到惩罚，而哪些人却能逍遥法外。另外四名青少年，年龄在 15 到 19 岁之间，最终因参与该犯罪活动而被判入狱。其中包括那个被招募来的 13 岁男孩。不过，那个看似是犯罪主谋的人却一直未被识别出来。 ■

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The Telegram

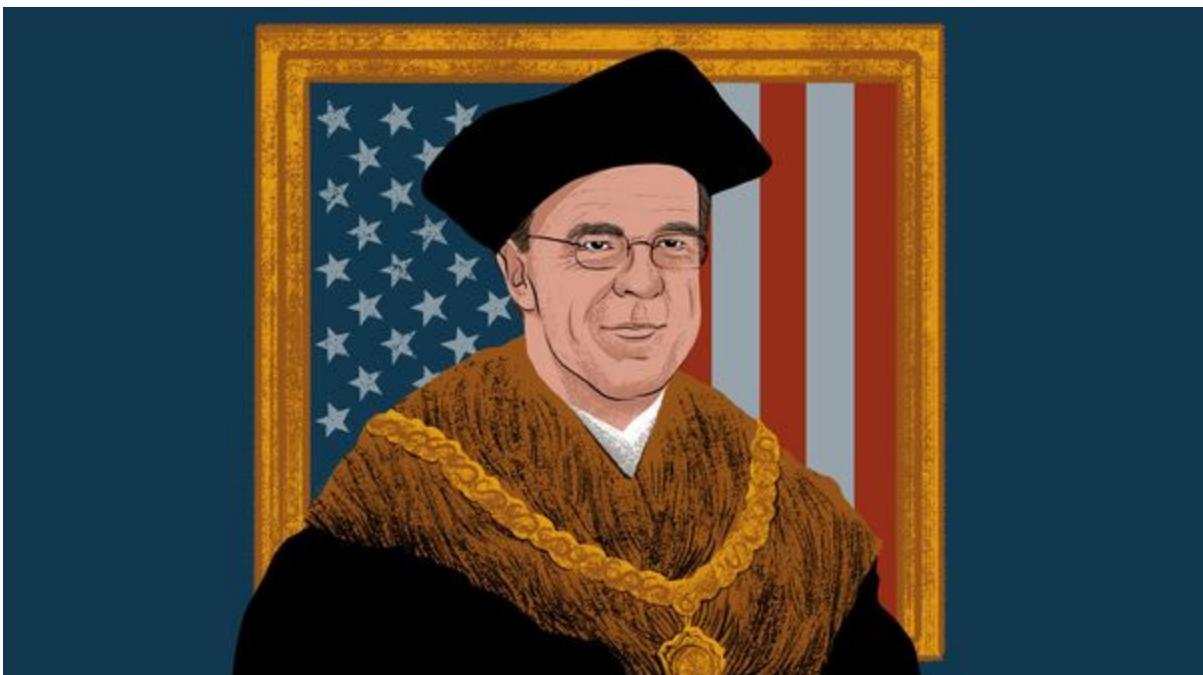
电报

If ludicrous Trump flattery can save NATO, bring it on 如果可笑的特朗普恭维能够拯救北 约，那就来吧。

The NATO chief Mark Rutte is quite annoying. It is in a worthy cause
北约首领马克·罗特确实很烦人。不过，他所追求的目标还是值得支持的。

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2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:23



TAKING HIS seat at a NATO summit must be a bittersweet moment for Mark Rutte, the alliance's secretary-general. For among the 32 national leaders at the top table, several find the Dutchman insufferable.

对于北约秘书长马克·罗特来说，在北约峰会上就座无疑是一个苦乐参半的时刻。在 32 位与会国家领导人中，有不少人认为这位荷兰人难以相处。

It grates on some governments when Mr Rutte praises President Donald Trump and—far from rebuking him for calling NATO a “paper tiger” and demanding that members show him “loyalty”—thanks him for strengthening the alliance. Worse, Mr Rutte seems to enjoy playing Mr Trump's enforcer a little too much. A former Dutch prime minister, he reminds some of a finger-wagging preacher when he scolds Europeans to spend more on their defence. Or while chiding them to avoid “empty” talk about deterring Russia without American help. Southern Europeans, in particular, remember lectures from Prime Minister Rutte to spend less. Now, as NATO boss, he wants them to borrow and rearm. Mr Trump calls Mr Rutte his friend and a man “respected all over the world”, setting colleagues' teeth a-grinding once more.

当罗特先生赞扬唐纳德·特朗普总统时，一些政府非常不满。罗特先生不仅没有批评特朗普将北约称为“纸老虎”，并要求成员国表达忠诚，反而对特朗普的举措表示赞赏。更糟糕的是，罗特先生似乎过于热衷于扮演特朗普的代言人角色。作为前荷兰首相，他在指责欧洲人在国防上投入更多资金时，让人联想到一个爱发号施令的传教士。他还告诫欧洲人不要空谈在没有美国帮助的情况下威慑俄罗斯。尤其是南欧国家，他们记得罗特首相曾经提出的减少开支的建议。现在，作为北约的领导人，他却要求欧洲国家增加开支和武装力量。特朗普称罗特先生为朋友，称他为“全世界都尊敬的人”，这再次让他的同事们感到愤怒。

Against that, Mr Rutte can be confident that many allies want him in the room. He soothes Mr Trump's rages as few other Europeans can.

Mr Rutte is willing to call Mr Trump “Daddy” and hail him as leader of the free world, if that stops America’s president storming out of summits like an angry old king.

相比之下，鲁特先生可以放心，许多盟友都希望他能够参与讨论。他能够安抚特朗普的怒火，因为其他欧洲人几乎无法做到这一点。鲁特先生愿意称特朗普为“爸爸”，并把他视为自由世界的领袖，只要这样能阻止美国总统像愤怒的老国王一样突然离开峰会。

Mr Rutte was at it again on July 6th at a press conference in Ankara on the eve of a potentially fraught NATO summit in the Turkish capital on July 7th and 8th. A reporter noted Mr Trump’s claims that European allies failed to support his war in Iran, and asked whether that might dampen the mood. Mr Rutte went big. With a straight face, he compared Mr Trump to Dwight Eisenhower, the former Supreme Allied Commander who defeated Hitler and was later elected president. In the secretary-general’s telling, after 60 years of trying, at last an American leader had matched Eisenhower’s powers of persuasion.

7月6日，鲁特先生在土耳其首都安卡拉举行的新闻发布会上再次发表演讲。这一会议正值7月7日和8日举行的、可能充满挑战的北约峰会之前。一位记者提到了特朗普声称欧洲盟友没有支持他发动的伊朗战争的说法，并询问这是否会打击与会人员的情绪。鲁特先生则大发雷霆。他面无表情地将特朗普与德怀特·艾森森进行比较——艾森森是曾击败希特勒的盟军最高指挥官，后来还当选为美国总统。在秘书长看来，经过60年的努力，终于有一位美国领导人具备了与艾森森相当的影响力。

Now, due to a combination of Mr Trump’s “extremely forceful” leadership and the threat posed by Russia, NATO members are spending their fair share on defence. Mr Rutte added a tribute to Ukraine for taking the fight to Russia, leaving Vladimir Putin “desperate”. Yes, Mr Trump had shared his “disappointment” about the role played by some partners in the Gulf, he conceded. But actually almost 5,000 American planes flew sorties from Europe to

support Operation Epic Fury. What is more, he enthused, Britain, France and other allies had announced their willingness to help defend shipping lanes in the Strait of Hormuz.

现在，由于特朗普“极其强势”的领导风格以及俄罗斯所构成的威胁，北约成员国都在投入相应的资金用于国防建设。鲁特先生还赞扬了乌克兰对抗俄罗斯的行动，让弗拉基米尔·普京感到“束手无策”。是的，特朗普确实表达了他对一些海湾国家行为的失望之情。但实际上，大约有 5000 架美国飞机从欧洲出发，参与支持“史诗般的愤怒行动”。此外，他补充说，英国、法国以及其他盟友也宣布愿意协助保护霍尔穆特海峡的航道安全。

The performance helps explain why Mr Rutte inspires complex emotions among his peers. Alongside outlandish flattery for Mr Trump and a soothing acknowledgment of his impatience with allies, the Dutchman can be heard pushing back on current Trumpian obsessions, with the help of actual facts. Such praise-and-reality sandwiches are required. Diplomats relate that as recently as the G7 summit in June, Mr Trump greeted fellow leaders with a growling assertion that Ukraine was losing and that its war with Russia needed to stop, though he was talked down from this position by the end of the meeting. Lately, Mr Trump has been fulminating to all who will listen that Europeans tried to thwart his war with Iran. In search of scapegoats for his debacle in the Gulf, he exaggerates the extent to which allies imposed legal restrictions on bombing runs and missions over Iran.

这一表现有助于解释为何罗特先生能在同僚中引发复杂的情感反应。除了对特朗普的夸张赞美，以及对其对盟友的急躁情绪的安抚性认可之外，人们还能听到这位荷兰人试图用事实来反驳特朗普当前的那些错误想法。这种既赞美又实事求是的做法是必要的。外交官们回忆说，就在六月的 G7 峰会上，特朗普还向其他领导人宣称乌克兰正在败北，其与俄罗斯战争必须停止。不过，到会议结束时，他的这一观点就被大家否定了。最近，特朗普还向所有愿意听他说话的人宣称，欧洲试图阻挠他与伊朗的战争。为了为自己的在海湾地区的失败

找替罪羊，他夸大了盟友对针对伊朗的轰炸行动所施加的法律限制的程度。

Actually, Ukraine is doing well, Mr Rutte has told Mr Trump repeatedly, in both public and private. What is more, Europe provided lots of help in Iran, and is generally an indispensable platform for American power projection in the Middle East and beyond.

实际上，乌克兰的情况相当不错。罗特先生在公开和私下的场合多次向特朗普先生强调这一点。此外，欧洲在伊朗问题上提供了大量帮助，总体而言，欧洲是美国在中东及更远地区进行势力扩张的重要平台。

Other Western leaders and officials are aware that Mr Trump calls the Dutchman often, sometimes several times a day, to vent or consult him about his European peers. They are shocked, though, when Mr Rutte privately admits to rather liking Mr Trump, whose company he finds fun. Many allies are quietly livid with Mr Trump. Exhaustion is setting in among many governments, especially after America's adventure in the Gulf wreaked havoc with their public finances. When European officials mutter about Mr Rutte's obsequiousness, this is, in part, transferred resentment of America's president, a man few dare to cross.

其他西方领导人和官员也意识到，特朗普经常联系这位荷兰人，有时甚至一天多次，以寻求建议或咨询关于欧洲同行的问题。不过，当拉特私下承认自己喜欢特朗普时，他们感到非常震惊——他觉得特朗普很有趣。许多盟友对特朗普感到愤怒不已。许多政府也开始感到疲惫不堪，尤其是在美国在中东地区的冒险行动给他们的公共财政带来了巨大冲击之后。当欧洲官员们抱怨拉特的谄媚态度时，这其实也反映出他们对美国总统的怨恨，因为很少有人敢与这位总统作对。

Taking one for the team

为了团队着想，就牺牲自己吧。

Mr Rutte's sense of fun runs counter to lessons from history. Sir Thomas More, counsellor to King Henry VIII, an extravagantly vengeful English monarch, wrote that having the king's ear is like playing with a tamed lion: a thrill until "he roars in rage for no known reason", when "suddenly the fun becomes fatal". More was eventually beheaded by his king. Though NATO bosses need not fear that fate, defenders of Mr Rutte say that he knows Mr Trump may turn on him one day, just as he has savaged such allies as Georgia Meloni of Italy and Britain's Sir Keir Starmer. Until that day, he is convinced that it is objectively in America's interest to preserve the alliance, and that Europe is not ready to defend itself. So he will do what it takes to keep Mr Trump onside.

罗特先生的这种玩乐心态与历史教训背道而驰。亨利八世国王的顾问托马斯·莫尔写道，得到国王的青睐就像与一头被驯服的狮子玩耍一样：起初令人兴奋不已，直到“狮子因毫无缘由而发怒”，此时“玩乐就变成了致命的危险”。莫尔最终被国王处决。虽然北约的领导人不必担心会遭遇同样的命运，但罗特先生的支持者认为，特朗普有朝一日可能会反叛，就像他曾经轻视过意大利的乔治亚·梅洛尼和英国的基尔·斯塔默一样。在那一天到来之前，他坚信维持这一联盟符合美国的利益，而欧洲目前还无法独立防御。因此，他会不惜一切手段让特朗普继续支持自己。

Critics accuse Mr Rutte of blocking European efforts to plan for a post-American order. Supporters say that Mr Rutte opposes Europe openly working on its own defence structures because he fears they would hollow out NATO and make America's departure a self-fulfilling prophecy. His is a big bet on America staying in the alliance. Without any planning, Europe would be vulnerable if America leaves. That said, his lion-taming buys Europe time to rearm. His readiness to defend reality also shows up the cowardice of Trump courtiers, many of whom slavishly endorse the president's most absurd beliefs. If a mix of flattery and candour can stop Mr Trump from turning on Ukraine, or roaring out of the alliance, the shredding of Mr Rutte's

dignity is a small price to pay. ■

批评者指责罗特先生阻碍了欧洲为应对美国时代之后的局势而进行的规划工作。而支持者则认为，罗特先生反对欧洲独立建立防御体系，因为他担心这会削弱北约的作用，让美国的退出成为必然。他其实是在冒险让美国继续留在北约组织中。如果没有适当的规划，当美国退出时，欧洲将会变得非常脆弱。不过，罗特先生愿意维护现实的态度，也显示出特朗普的支持者们是多么的懦弱，他们大多盲目地支持总统那些荒谬的观点。如果通过奉承与坦诚相结合的方式，能够阻止特朗普对乌克兰采取敌对行动，或者让美国退出北约，那么破坏罗特先生的尊严也算是值得的代价了。

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对安德烈·梅尔尼琴科关于他的国家未来的采访

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The clock on the Kremlin tower had already struck midnight on May 28th 2025 when Andrey Melnichenko was finally summoned. The building was largely empty but its most important occupant was still awake. [Vladimir Putin](#) greeted his guest and invited Melnichenko to sit beside him, offering him tea. "Move closer, Andrey," Putin said kindly. Melnichenko's gaze landed on a red folder which lay in front

of Russia's president—he guessed it was a dossier about him supplied by the security services.

2025 年 5 月 28 日午夜时分，克里姆林宫塔上的时钟已经敲响了午夜的钟声。安德烈·梅尔尼琴科终于被召见了。大楼里几乎空无一人，但最重要的人物却依然在房间里。弗拉基米尔·普京向他的客人致意，并邀请梅尔尼琴科坐在他旁边，同时递给他茶。“坐得更近些，安德烈，”普京亲切地说道。梅尔尼琴科的目光落在放在俄罗斯总统面前的红色文件夹上——他猜想那应该是安全部门为他准备的关于他的档案。

Melnichenko, a slim, tall man with a gawky bearing, is one of Russia's richest men. He had met Putin before in the company of other Russian businessmen. But this was the first time he had asked to see *nachalstvo* ("the leadership") one on one. He began by introducing himself. Over the past 35 years he has built up an industrial empire with vast holdings in [fertilisers](#), mining, energy and logistics. Yet he had always kept a low profile. Even Putin seemed surprised to hear about the scale of Melnichenko's operations, which account for nearly 1% of Russia's GDP.

梅尔尼琴科是一位身材瘦高、面容憔悴的男子，同时也是俄罗斯最富有的企业家之一。此前，他曾与其他俄罗斯商人一起见过普京。但这是他第一次请求与“高层”进行面谈。他首先介绍了自己：在过去的 35 年里，他建立了一个庞大的工业帝国，旗下拥有广泛的肥料、矿业、能源和物流业务。不过，他一直保持低调的作风。就连普京听到梅尔尼琴科的业务规模后也感到惊讶，因为他的业务规模几乎占到了俄罗斯 GDP 的 1%。

Melnichenko began to talk about his public role, including the brief on climate policy he held with the [Russian Union of Industrialists and Entrepreneurs](#), a club of businessmen. Putin began to lose interest. Melnichenko thought he could read a question in Putin's eyes: "Why are you here? What do you want from me?"

梅尔尼琴科开始谈论他的公共角色，包括他与俄罗斯实业家企业家协会合作的气候政策项目。普京的兴趣逐渐减退。梅尔尼琴科似乎

从普京的眼神中读出了一个问题：“你为什么在这里？你想要从我这里得到什么？”

“Is someone bothering you?” Putin asked.

“有没有人打扰你？”普京问道。

“Vladimir Vladimirovich, honestly, I understand that people usually come to you for one of two reasons. Either they’re afraid, there’s some problem. Or they want something—a position, a favour...As for fear, of course I’m afraid, 100%, like everyone else. Why deny it? I’m not afraid of anything specific, unless there’s something in your folder. But if there is, please tell me so at least I know what to fear.”

“弗拉基米尔·弗拉基米罗维奇，说实话，我明白人们来找你的原因通常只有两种。要么是因为他们感到害怕，要么是因为他们遇到了一些问题。或者，他们想要得到某些东西——职位、好处之类的……至于害怕，当然，我和其他人一样，完全害怕啊。为什么要否认呢？我并不害怕任何特定的事物，除非你的文件夹里有什么东西。但如果有东西的话，请告诉我，这样我就知道该害怕什么了。”

Putin smiled. Melnichenko’s directness had grabbed his attention.

普京笑了。梅尔尼琴科的直接性吸引了他的注意。

“As for ambition,” Melnichenko continued, “my ambition was to build a global fertiliser company, one of the largest in the world, operating in every market, independent of any one country...I wanted to build a global company simply because it was interesting.”

“至于野心嘛，”梅尔尼琴科继续说道，“我的野心是打造一家全球性的肥料公司——一家在世界上规模最大的公司之一。这家公司要在每个市场都有业务，并且独立于任何单一国家而运营……我想要打造一家全球性公司，因为那样很有趣。”

Melnichenko thought he could read a question in Putin’s eyes:

“Why are you here? What do you want from me?”

梅尔尼琴科以为自己能读懂普京眼中的问题：“你为什么在这里？你想要从我这里得到什么？”

But then “all this happened”—by which he meant the war with Ukraine, the sanctions, the unpredictability of geopolitics. “The world turned out not to be what I thought. There is no global world. There are no global rules...You understood it before we did.”

但是，所有这些事情都发生了——他指的是与乌克兰的战争、制裁措施，以及地缘政治的不可预测性。“世界并非我想象的那样。并不存在所谓的全球秩序，也没有全球性的规则.....你们在我们之前就明白了这一点。”

Melnichenko, who was placed under sanctions in the first days of the war, told Putin how he was forced to hand his wife ownership of EuroChem, then the world’s second-largest fertiliser firm.

梅尔尼琴科在战争开始后的几天就被实施了制裁。他向普京透露，自己被迫将 EuroChem 公司的所有权交给了妻子——当时 EuroChem 是全球第二大化肥公司。

“Who is your wife?” Putin enquired.

“你的妻子是谁？”普京问道。

“She is a Serb,” Melnichenko told him.

“她是塞尔维亚人，”梅尔尼琴科告诉他。”

“Well, Serbs are decent, honest people,” Putin said. “They won’t steal it.”

“嗯，塞尔维亚人都是诚实、正直的人，”普京说。“他们不会偷东西的。”

Melnichenko then turned to the purpose of the visit. He wanted to become more involved in public life and to work for the good of his country. The mistake of the elite, Melnichenko told Putin, had been to separate their own fate from the fate of Russia. The supposed

guarantee by the West of their property rights had nearly cost them their fortunes. "You cannot have one country for making money and another for security, your family's future and real life," said Melnichenko, and thanked the Russian leader for helping him see the light.

梅尔尼琴科接着谈到了这次访问的目的。他希望更多地参与公共生活，为国家的利益而努力工作。梅尔尼琴科对普京说，精英阶层的错误在于将自身的命运与俄罗斯的命运分离开来。西方所谓的“保障”他们的财产权，实际上差点让他们失去一切。“你不能有一个国家为了赚钱，另一个国家却为了安全、为了家人的未来和现实生活而存在，”梅尔尼琴科说道，并感谢俄罗斯领导人让他看到了现实。

Putin was pleased. For years he had warned Russian oligarchs that they were not truly welcome in the West. Now, one of the foremost among them had admitted that he was right. The meeting lasted over an hour, far longer than Melnichenko had expected.

普京很满意。多年来，他一直警告俄罗斯的寡头们，他们并不真正受到西方的欢迎。现在，其中一位最重要的寡头承认自己是对的。这次会议持续了一个多小时，比梅尔尼琴科预想的要长得多。

Melnichenko spent just five minutes telling me about his visit to the Kremlin during nearly 60 hours' worth of conversations we have had over the past three months. He wouldn't give any more details of the meeting with Putin, but he did share, with startling frankness, the story of his own rise, his diagnosis of the existential challenge that [Russia](#) faces and his vision for the country's future which could change Russian history if he manages to realise it.

梅尔尼琴科用仅仅五分钟的时间向我介绍了他访问克里姆林宫的经历。在过去的三个月里，我们进行了长达 60 小时的对话。他并没有透露与普京会面的更多细节，但他非常坦率地讲述了自己崛起的故事，分析了俄罗斯所面临的生存挑战，并提出了自己对国家未来的设想——如果他能够成功实现这一设想，那么俄罗斯的历史可能会发生翻天覆地的变化。

He is nothing like most businessmen whose ambition leads them to believe they can run for office. He arrived at our first meeting in Istanbul after a 28-day fast to purify his body and mind. He does not pontificate. Rather, I could see the effort he put into wrestling his thoughts into words, using his entire body to draw them out. He seemed interested in using dialogue to test and shape his ideas.

他完全不像大多数那些因野心而想要担任公职的商人。在进行了 28 天的斋戒以净化身心之后，他来到了我们在伊斯坦布尔的第一次会面。他并不喜欢长篇大论地发表意见，而是努力将自己的想法用语言表达出来，用整个身体来传达这些想法。他似乎很乐意通过对话来检验和塑造自己的想法。

Melnichenko studied quantum physics at university, and he carries with him the discipline's seemingly contradictory impulses. He thinks in systems like a physicist. But he thrives on the fundamental uncertainty of the world around him. Each of those traits is useful and together they have propelled him to the top of global business. They may yet equip him to play a role in restructuring Russia and its place in the world.

梅尔尼琴科在大学期间学习量子物理学，他身上兼具了这门学科中看似矛盾的特性。他以物理学家的思维方式来思考问题。但同时，他又非常享受周围世界所蕴含的不确定性带来的乐趣。这些特质共同使他成为了全球商业领域的佼佼者。它们或许还能帮助他重新塑造俄罗斯的地位，使其在全球舞台上发挥更大的作用。

As we talked, Melnichenko's ideas took shape. Our conversations inspired him to [write an essay](#) laying out his vision of Russia's future, which *The Economist* is [publishing online this week](#). At the heart of that vision is the idea of sovereignty—not just of the state but also of the elites and citizens who, under Putin, have been excluded from participation in their country's politics.

在交谈过程中，梅尔尼琴科的想法逐渐清晰起来。我们的对话激励他撰写了一篇论文，阐述了自己对俄罗斯未来的设想。这篇论文将于本周发表在《经济学人》网站上。这一设想的核心就是主权概念——不

仅仅是国家的主权，还包括那些在普京统治下被排除在政治生活之外的精英和公民的主权。



The security establishment sees any independence as a threat. An outsider taking the initiative—a rich businessman no less—may be perceived as a direct challenge. Melnichenko is well aware of the dangers. “Any move beyond silent compliance poses risk,” he told me. “It would be natural to keep one’s head down. But the stakes are too high and if you don’t participate, you exclude yourself from your own future.”

那些掌权者将任何形式的独立行为视为一种威胁。任何试图主动行动的人——哪怕是个富商——都可能被视作对他们的直接挑战。梅尔尼琴科非常清楚这些危险。“任何超出默默顺从的行为都会带来风险，”他告诉我，“保持沉默当然也是自然的选择。但风险太大了，如果你不参与，就等于断绝了自己未来的机会。”

Melnichenko is a latecomer to Russian statecraft. Despite being the richest man in Russia when Putin invaded Ukraine in 2022, he is not a household name inside or outside the country. For the past 20 years, he has treated Russia as a foreign investor would, flying in for a few weeks a year to inspect his businesses. The rest of the time he either lived in Switzerland or cruised round the world on his yacht. This was partly because he wanted to live like other international billionaires. He has cultivated relationships with tech titans such as Larry Ellison, the leaders of the UAE and the court of Muhammad bin Salman, the crown prince of Saudi Arabia.

梅尔尼琴科是俄罗斯政坛上一位晚来者。尽管在 2022 年普京入侵乌克兰时，他还是俄罗斯最富有的人，但在俄罗斯国内乃至国外，他并不知名。在过去的 20 年里，他像外国投资者一样对待俄罗斯，每年会飞到俄罗斯几周时间去考察自己的企业。其余时间，他要么住在瑞士，要么在游艇上环游世界。这在一定程度上是因为他希望像其他国际亿万富翁一样生活。他与其他科技巨头如拉里·埃利森、阿联酋的领导人以及沙特阿拉伯王储穆罕默德·本·萨勒曼都保持着良好的关系。

But it’s also because of the agreement Putin struck with the oligarchs when he came to power: stay out of politics and you can keep your fortunes and enjoy your life abroad. The country was

instead dominated by the *siloviki*, alumni of the security services.

不过，这也是因为普京上台后与那些寡头们达成的协议：只要不参与政治事务，他们就可以保住自己的财富，在海外享受生活。实际上，该国由那些来自安全部门的家伙们掌控着。

When Putin invaded Ukraine, the world waited for Russia's rich and powerful to speak against the war. But they stayed quiet. The West imposed sanctions on them, partly to make them apply pressure on Putin. But this betrayed a lack of understanding of how power worked in Russia—the business elite had long given up trying to influence politics.

当普京入侵乌克兰时，全世界都在期待那些俄罗斯富有且有权势的人能够站出来反对这场战争。但实际上，他们选择保持沉默。西方对他们实施了制裁，部分是为了让他们对普京施加压力。但这一做法恰恰表明，西方根本不了解俄罗斯的权力运作机制——那些商业精英早已放弃试图影响政治进程的努力了。

Putin himself was worried the oligarchs would betray him. Instead sanctions pushed them back into his embrace. Yet when they returned, they repatriated their interests and ambitions along with their money. Melnichenko's opening gambit when our conversations began three months ago was: "For the first time I feel I have no other country but Russia." Given the reticence of his peers, it is astonishing that Russia's most enigmatic oligarch, while living in Moscow, is willing to put his head above the parapet and lay his views on the record.

普京本人也担心那些寡头会背叛他。然而，制裁措施却让他们重新回到了他的怀抱。不过，当他们再次回来时，他们把他们的利益和野心以及资金都带回到了俄罗斯。三个月前我们开始交谈时，梅尔尼琴科的第一句话就是：“我第一次觉得，除了俄罗斯，我没有其他的国家了。”考虑到他的同龄人的犹豫不决，令人惊讶的是，这位俄罗斯最神秘的寡头，尽管居住在莫斯科，却愿意站出来表达自己的观点。

Melnichenko is not a dissident. He is neither an anti-war hero nor a pro-war zealot. The businesses he runs help sustain the war economy. Ammonia produced by his plants is used in munitions. He works with the armed forces to defend his factories from drone attacks and co-operates with the security services to avert sabotage. He avoids ideological and moral judgments, because he thinks they are a distraction from the task of designing a system that works.

梅尔尼琴科并非异见人士。他既不是反战英雄，也不是支持战争狂热者。他经营的企业实际上在为战争经济提供支撑。他的工厂生产的氨气被用于制造弹药。他与军队合作，保护工厂免受无人机攻击；同时与安全部门合作，以防止破坏行为的发生。他避免进行意识形态和道德上的评判，因为他认为这些评判只会分散人们专注于设计有效系统的注意力。

The security establishment sees any independence as a threat. An outsider taking the initiative—a rich businessman no less—may be perceived as a direct challenge

那些负责安全事务的人将任何形式的独立视为一种威胁。任何试图主动采取行动的人——即便是个富商——都可能被视作对现有秩序的直接挑战。

He is not seeking to challenge the existing power structure. Rather, he is offering his services to the government and hopes to become an architect of change. The course of his career suggests that he is not interested in wielding direct control. He served as a non-executive director on the boards of his companies, at times allowing his chief executives to overrule him. His skill has been in bringing together disparate interests to construct systems that transform natural resources: building ports and railways, synthesising fertiliser, generating electricity. Hard-won mastery over the physical world, he believes, gives him a clear-eyed perspective that ideologues lack.

他并不试图挑战现有的权力结构。相反，他愿意为政府提供服务，并希望成为变革的推动者。从他的职业生涯来看，他并不热衷于直接行使权力。他曾担任多家公司的非执行董事，有时会让公司的首席执行官

官来决定他的意见。他的专长在于将不同的利益结合起来，从而创造出能够改变自然资源的系统——比如建设港口和铁路、合成肥料、发电等。他认为，对物质世界的深刻了解让他能够拥有一种清晰的视角，而这是那些意识形态家所缺乏的。

The war with Ukraine has now gone on longer than Russia's involvement in the second world war. Melnichenko is stepping up as Moscow finds itself under military assault for the first time since 1942. Ukraine's attacks on Russia's refineries have caused a massive fuel shortage. Drones are striking industrial and military facilities deep inside Russia, stripping the Kremlin of its aura of invincibility. The economy is under strain. For some time, elites have felt that the country has reached a *tupik*—a dead end. Now, [the arrival of war on the home front](#) has added a fresh layer of discontent.

与乌克兰的战争持续时间已经超过了俄罗斯参与第二次世界大战的时间。随着莫斯科自 1942 年以来首次面临军事打击，梅尔尼琴科的地位日益重要。乌克兰对俄罗斯炼油厂的攻击导致了严重的燃料短缺。无人机正在袭击俄罗斯境内的工业和军事设施，使克里姆林宫失去了那种不可战胜的威严。经济也面临着压力。一段时间以来，精英们认为国家已经陷入了僵局。现在，内战的爆发又增加了民众的不满情绪。

This means the conflict may escalate dangerously. "The war in Ukraine is unequivocally seen as a war between Russia and the West," said Melnichenko. He thinks there is a worryingly high chance that it will spill over into other countries. He does not rule out the use of nuclear weapons. That is an outcome he is desperate to avoid. "Whatever the reasons that brought us here—whether these people were right or those people were wrong—we have to recognise the reality: we're now in uncharted territory."

这意味着冲突可能会危险地升级。“乌克兰战争显然可以被视为俄罗斯与西方之间的战争，”梅尔尼琴科说。他认为，战争蔓延到其他国家的可能性非常高。他并不排除使用核武器的情况。这是他绝对不想看到的结局。“无论是什么原因让我们陷入这个局面——无论是那些人是对

的还是错的——我们都必须承认一个事实：我们现在正处在一个未知的领域。”

Melnichenko is not scared of chaos—he sees it as a laboratory to test himself as a builder of systems. His fortune was created as modern Russia emerged from the carcass of the Soviet Union. He has always been a step ahead of change, identifying value which is underpriced. Today there is a heightened demand for order, predictability and an idea of a future. “People are not afraid of freedom. People are afraid of chaos,” Melnichenko said. From the outside, the regime seems impregnable. Yet that had also seemed the case in 1913 and in 1986. Those governments fell a few years later.

梅尔尼琴科并不害怕混乱——他将混乱视为检验自己作为系统构建者能力的实验室。他的财富是在现代俄罗斯从苏联的废墟中崛起时创造的。他总是能够预见变革的趋势，并识别出被低估的价值。如今，人们更加渴望秩序、可预测性以及对未来有清晰的认识。“人们并不害怕自由。人们害怕的是混乱，”梅尔尼琴科说道。从表面上看，这个政权似乎坚不可摧。但实际上，1913年和1986年的情况也是如此。那些政府在几年后都倒下了。

It is important to understand Melnichenko’s story for two reasons: first, because he is likely to become a force who cannot be ignored; second, it shows him to be a meticulous strategist, who plans patiently and acts decisively. So far, he has always got what he wants.

了解梅尔尼琴科的故事有两大重要原因：首先，因为他很可能会成为一个不可忽视的力量；其次，这表明他是一个极其出色的战略家，能够耐心规划，同时又能果断行动。到目前为止，他总是能够达成自己的目标。

Melnichenko was born in 1972 in Gomel, the second-largest city in Belarus, into a family of Soviet intelligentsia. His father was a physicist and a semi-professional basketball player; his mother, an

ethnic Ukrainian, taught Russian language and literature in a local music school.

梅尔尼琴科出生于 1972 年，出生地是白俄罗斯第二大城市戈梅利。他出身于一个苏联知识阶层家庭：他的父亲是物理学家，同时还是一名半职业篮球运动员；他的母亲是乌克兰裔，在当地的音乐学校教授俄语和文学课程。



In the spring of 1986, when Melnichenko was 14, the nuclear plant blew up in Chernobyl, 160km from Gomel. He experienced Chernobyl as both a catastrophe and a liberation. He and his

classmates were evacuated to an empty military base in Lithuania that had recently stored short-range nuclear missiles. "It was the freest and most interesting summer of my childhood: no parents, no school supervision, total freedom. You could crawl through missile silos, many of them not sealed up yet, wander through underground passages: it was risky, exciting and girls liked it."

1986 年春天，当梅尔尼琴科 14 岁的时候，距离戈梅利大约 160 公里处的切尔诺贝利核电站发生了爆炸。他经历了这场灾难，但同时也感受到了一种解放的感觉。他和同学们被疏散到立陶宛的一个空军事基地，那里曾经存放着短程核导弹。“那是我童年中最自由、最有趣的夏天：没有父母，没有学校的监管，完全的自由自在。你可以随意穿梭在导弹发射塔之间，许多发射塔甚至还没有被密封起来。在地下通道中漫步，既危险又刺激，而且女生们特别喜欢这种感觉。”

Chernobyl was also a catalyst of *glasnost* (openness) in the Soviet Union. As attempts to conceal the scale of the disaster failed, the pervasive culture of secrecy and fear began to melt away. Magazines started to publish previously banned writing about Stalin's repressions, "I watched teachers quite literally rewrite their interpretation of history on the fly." Foreigners and goods were starting to trickle over the Soviet border. As a teenager, Melnichenko would buy Western clothes and electronics from Poles and Hungarians and sell them in street markets in Gomel.

切尔诺贝利事件也是苏联实行“开放政策”的催化剂。随着人们试图掩盖灾难规模的努力失败，那种普遍存在的保密和恐惧氛围开始逐渐消失。杂志开始刊登那些此前被禁止的关于斯大林镇压行为的文章。外国人以及商品也开始少量地流入苏联边境。作为青少年时，梅尔尼琴科会从波兰人和匈牙利人那里购买西方的服装和电子产品，然后在戈梅利的市场上出售它们。

Melnichenko was clever and placed in a stream for advanced maths and physics. At 15 he went to the leading Soviet school for mathematics, which was attached to Moscow State University (MSU). Unlike most other parts of the Soviet education system, it was

genuinely meritocratic. Students who did well, like Melnichenko, studied physics at MSU. Others trained as cryptographers at the KGB academy.

梅尔尼琴科很聪明，被安排去学习高等数学和物理。15 岁时，他进入莫斯科国立大学附属的顶尖苏联学校学习数学。与苏联教育体系的其他部分不同，这里的选拔真正基于才能。像梅尔尼琴科这样的优秀学生可以在莫斯科国立大学学习物理。而另一些学生则会在克格纳党学院接受密码学培训。

His studies at MSU shaped Melnichenko's perception of the world. He specialised in quantum statistics and field theory, which deals with sub-atomic particles and their behaviour. "In the quantum world, nothing is certain and everything is probable. Reality is fluid," he explained. "If something disproves your view of life—some event, phenomenon, whatever—it is not a tragedy, it is an opportunity. I'm not rigid. Tomorrow I may believe something different from what I believed the day before yesterday." This mentality was perfect for a country in upheaval.

他在莫斯科大学的学习经历塑造了梅尔尼琴科对世界的看法。他专攻量子统计和场论，这些领域涉及亚原子粒子及其行为。“在量子世界中，没有什么确定的，一切都是可能的。现实是流动的，”他解释道。“如果某件事与你的世界观相悖——无论是什么事件、现象或情况——那并不是悲剧，而是一个机会。我不会固执己见。明天我可能会持有与前天不同的观点。”这种心态非常适合一个处于变革中的国家。

In the spring of 1989 he attended political rallies and rock concerts by Western bands such as the Scorpions, whose song "Winds of Change" became an anthem of freedom. He and a friend bought tickets for Pink Floyd's gigs via employees at theatre box offices—prices were still set by the state—and resold them through a network of students at a huge mark-up.

1989 年春天，他参加了许多政治集会，还观看了西方乐队如蝎子乐队的摇滚音乐会。蝎子乐队的歌曲《Winds of Change》后来成为了自由

的象征。他和一位朋友通过剧院售票处的员工购买平价门票，然后以更高的价格将门票转售给其他人。

Given the silence of his peers, it is astonishing that Russia's most enigmatic oligarch is willing to put his head above the parapet

鉴于他的同龄人都不发言，俄罗斯这位最神秘的寡头愿意冒险做出这样的决定，真是令人惊讶。

At MSU, Melnichenko met a woman called Larisa, his first love. "She was beautiful, intelligent and she was five years older." Larisa had studied music and sang jazz. Though he was certain she loved him back, Larisa suddenly disappeared in the spring of 1990. Later, one of her friends told Melnichenko that she had married a rich Muscovite and was expecting a child.

在莫斯科国立大学，梅尔尼琴科遇到了一位名叫拉里萨的女孩，她就是他的初恋对象。“她很漂亮、聪明，而且年龄比他大五岁。”拉里萨曾经学习过音乐，喜欢演唱爵士乐。虽然他确信她也爱着他，但到了1990年春天，拉里萨突然消失了。后来，拉里萨的一个朋友告诉梅尔尼琴科，她嫁给了一个富有的莫斯科人，并且怀孕了。

He was devastated but there was a twist in the tale. "Two years after her wedding, I met Larisa again. By then I was a different person. I had money, status, confidence." He resumed the relationship—but only because he wanted to hurt her. Melnichenko got his revenge. "It was probably the most shameful thing I did in those years, and I can find no justification for it."

他非常痛苦，但故事中有个转折：“在她结婚两年后，我又遇到了拉里萨。那时我已经变成了一个完全不同的人。我有钱、有地位，也充满自信。”他重新与她交往——但只是因为想伤害她。梅尔尼琴科实现了他的复仇。“那可能是我那些年做过的最可耻的事情，我找不到任何理由来为这种行为辩解。”

The story of Larisa taught him two lessons: revenge, however tempting it may be, humiliates the perpetrator more than the target. The second was that Moscow was obsessed with money.

拉里萨的故事让他明白了两件事：尽管复仇可能很诱人，但报复行为只会让施害者更加难堪，而受害者则不会因此受到什么影响。第二点是，莫斯科人对金钱有着近乎痴迷的欲望。

The collapse of the command economy and rapid impoverishment of the population created an enormous appetite for magic shows and gambling as people sought a miracle. Card games, shell games and lotteries, run by con artists, sprung up everywhere. Melnichenko and a friend sensed an opportunity. "We observed it, rationalised parts of it, simplified it rather cynically, and basically made it efficient." Melnichenko's game favoured the house, but it did allow people to win—he realised that for the business to endure he needed his customers to share in the benefits.

命令经济的崩溃以及民众财富的迅速减少，使得人们迫切需要一些可以带来奇迹的娱乐活动。于是，由骗子经营的纸牌游戏、有奖游戏和彩票便在各地兴起。梅尔尼琴科和他的朋友察觉到了这个机会。“我们观察了这一现象，对其中一些元素进行了合理化处理，然后以一种相当讽刺的方式将其简化，最终使其变得更加高效。”梅尔尼琴科的游戏虽然偏向让庄家获利，但确实也允许人们赢钱——他意识到，为了让这项生意持续下去，他需要让顾客也能分享到好处。

The game was simple. The player drew ten sticks from a set of 60. Each stick was marked with a number from one to ten, and the total was then checked against a payout table to determine whether they had won. "We made sure our operators stuck to the rules. The hope we were selling was genuine." This increased the game's popularity, even though "I understood who was profiting from whom."

这个游戏很简单。玩家从 60 根棍子中抽取 10 根。每根棍子上都有一个从 1 到 10 的数字标记，最后将抽取到的棍子数量与奖励表进行比对，以确定是否中奖。“我们确保玩家遵守规则。我们出售的产品是纯

正的。“这一点增加了游戏的受欢迎程度，尽管“我知道谁在从中获利，谁在亏本。”

To avoid getting shut down, Melnichenko needed to square the authorities. He acquired permits to operate the lottery by pretending it was a charitable foundation. (Later it was registered as a charity—the cause supported was named as “strengthening relationships with those who issued permits”.)

为了避免被关闭，梅尔尼琴科需要与当局达成协议。他通过伪装自己是一家慈善机构来取得经营彩票的许可。（后来，这家慈善机构真的注册了——其宗旨被定为“加强与那些发放许可的机构的关系”。）

A far bigger problem was thugs shaking down businesses. To prevent this “injustice”, Melnichenko relied on a friend whose father headed a police academy in Volgograd. “Why negotiate with gangsters when there are plenty of half-trained policemen around?” Hiring them made paying off a protection racket unnecessary and the cops also helped to manage the crowd “which may become disappointed with its financial result and punch you in the face”.

一个更为严重的问题是，那些暴徒们经常抢劫商家。为了应对这种“不公正行为”，梅尔尼琴科依靠了一位朋友的帮助——这位朋友的父亲在伏尔加格勒拥有一所警察学院。“既然有那么多训练不足的警察，为什么还要和那些暴徒谈判呢？”通过雇佣他们，就无需支付保护费了，而且警察们还能协助管理人群，避免他们因经济收益不佳而动手打人。

Through his business, Melnichenko acquired a network that has risen along with him. Many of the MSU students who operated the lottery became government officials and businessmen who are still in his orbit. The police cadets now occupy senior positions in the security services.

通过他的商业活动，梅尔尼琴科建立了一个与他共同发展的网络。许多曾经参与彩票业务的莫斯科大学学生后来成为了政府官员或商界人

士，他们至今仍然在他的影响范围内。而那些曾经是警察学员的人，现在则在安全部门担任高级职位。





Russian billionaire and industrialist Andrey Melnichenko, pictured in 2008. He is the owner of Sailing Yacht A, made by the same company that built the second world war battleship *Bismarck*. At 469 feet, it is one of the world's largest sail-powered yachts

俄罗斯亿万富翁兼实业家安德烈·梅尔尼琴科，照片拍摄于 2008 年。他是“Sailing Yacht A”游艇的拥有者，这款游艇由与制造二战战舰“俾斯麦号”同一家公司打造。该游艇长 469 英尺，是世界上最大的帆动力游艇之一。

Melnichenko got another student to manage day-to-day operations while he went to lectures and “thought about things”. This was the role he has always preferred. “I was always a leader but almost never in the foreground.” His low-key style was honed at the summer camps he had attended as a child, where the strongest boys were the most popular. “The moment you try to advance your own agenda, however admirable it may be, you inevitably provoke the desire of some less reflective but physically stronger boy...to

punch you in the eye.”

梅尔尼琴科又找了一个学生来负责日常事务，而他自己则去听讲座，同时“思考一些事情”。这正是他一直喜欢的角色。“我一直都是个领导者，但几乎从未处于主导地位。”他的低调作风是从他小时候参加夏令营时养成的。在那些夏令营里，最强壮的男孩往往最受欢迎。“当你试图推进自己的计划时，无论这个计划多么值得赞赏，你都会不可避免地激怒那些比较强壮但缺乏思考能力的男孩……他们可能会打你的眼睛。”

He learned how to be diplomatic. “I have never liked violence as a way of achieving an objective. The best option is to attract people by proposing objectives they either had not seen themselves or did not believe were attainable.”

他学会了如何保持外交手段。“我从来都不喜欢用暴力来实现目标。最好的办法是提出一些人们未曾见过或认为难以实现的目标，以此来吸引人们。”

By the end of his first year of university, Melnichenko was driving a Lada. By the end of his second year, he had upgraded to a Mercedes. He had 40 lottery stands operating across Moscow. The lottery generated a steady flow of roubles, but these were losing value by the day as inflation shot up. He converted his earnings into dollars—then an activity that was still illegal outside official channels. He obtained these through Chinese and American students who had access to greenbacks through expat connections. These contacts turned into friendships—one became a senior official in the Chinese government and his son heads Melnichenko’s Shanghai office. The American became a congressman. Any excess dollars he had were sold to other aspiring entrepreneurs. He opened his first informal currency exchange in a dorm room at MSU.

在大学第一年结束时，梅尔尼琴科已经能驾驶拉达汽车了。到了第二年，他甚至换了一辆奔驰车。他在莫斯科有 40 家彩票销售点。虽然彩票能带来稳定的收入，但随着通货膨胀的加剧，这些收入的价值每天都在下降。他将赚到的钱兑换成美元——在当时，这种交易在官方

渠道之外仍然是非法的。他通过那些通过人脉关系获得美元的中国和美国学生来筹集资金。这些关系最终发展成友谊——其中一位朋友后来成为中国政府的高级官员，而梅尔尼琴科的儿子则掌管着他在上海的办公室。那位美国人后来成为了一名国会议员。他多余的美元则出售给其他有创业梦想的人。他在莫斯科国立大学的宿舍里开设了第一家非正式的货币兑换店。

Melnichenko spent the summer of 1991 in Crimea. Not far away, Mikhail Gorbachev was being detained by the KGB in a last-ditch attempt to preserve the Soviet Union. Melnichenko sensed that these were the death throes. He felt "neither fear nor euphoria—just a sense of an inevitable process accelerating".

梅尔尼琴科在 1991 年的夏天待在克里米亚半岛。就在不远处，米哈伊尔·戈尔巴乔夫被克格勃逮捕，这是他们试图维持苏联统治的最后尝试。梅尔尼琴科感觉到，苏联正处于崩溃的边缘。他没有任何恐惧或狂热的情绪——只有一种对不可避免进程加速的预感。

When he returned to Moscow, he did something unthinkable a few weeks earlier. Betting that the old system was hollow, he advertised his illegal foreign-currency exchange in a newspaper. The risk paid off and the business grew rapidly. He finally dropped out of university and folded the lottery.

当他回到莫斯科时，他做了一件几周前根本无法想象的事情。他相信旧有的体系是空洞无物的，于是他在一家报纸上刊登了关于自己非法兑换外币的广告。这一尝试成功了，他的生意迅速发展起来。最终，他退学了，也放弃了彩票事业。

What he wanted now was to make his operations official—not easy if you're a 20-year-old without government connections. What he did have, though, was chutzpah and a knack for winning the trust of older men of his grandfather's generation. He had two guardian angels. One was David Kruk, a 70-year-old war veteran who ran Premier, a co-operative bank. Melnichenko found him through the yellow pages and made Kruk an offer. Premier would receive a fixed

fee for bringing his exchanges under its roof; any additional profits would be kept off the books.

他现在想要的是让自己的经营活动正式化——不过，对于一个没有政府关系背景、只有 20 岁年纪的人来说，这并不容易。不过，他拥有的是胆识以及赢得老一辈人信任的天赋。他有两个“守护天使”：一个是 70 岁的战争老兵大卫·克鲁克，他经营着一家名为“Premier”的合作社银行。梅尔尼琴科通过黄页找到了他，并向克鲁克提出了合作建议。Premier 公司会支付一定的固定费用来协助他开展业务；而所有的额外利润则会被记录在账外。

Melnichenko is not scared of chaos—he sees it as a laboratory to test himself as a builder of systems

梅尔尼琴科并不害怕混乱——他将混乱视为考验自己作为系统构建者能力的实验室。

After six months Melnichenko poached Kruk's staff and set up on his own, but he managed to stay friends with his mentor until Kruk's death at the age of 96. He called the new bank Moskovsky Delovoy Mir (Moscow Business World, or MDM for short).

六个月后，梅尔尼切恩科挖走了克鲁克的手下，独自经营起了这家银行。不过，他一直保持与导师的友谊，直到克鲁克在 96 岁时去世。他将新成立的银行命名为“莫斯科商业世界”（简称 MDM）。

Meanwhile, Russian politics was breaking down. In 1993 the country suffered a constitutional crisis when communists and ultra-nationalists led an insurgency against Boris Yeltsin, the president. There was shooting on the streets. Melnichenko picked up a gun and headed out—not to get involved but to observe.

与此同时，俄罗斯的政治局势正在崩溃。1993 年，当共产主义者和极端民族主义者联合起来反对总统鲍里斯·叶利钦时，该国陷入了宪法危机。街头发生了枪战。梅尔尼琴科拿起武器出征——并非是为了参与冲突，而是为了观察局势。

To consolidate his position in foreign-currency dealing, Melnichenko needed to find a regular supplier of dollars. His other guardian angel was an American banker called Richard Spikerman, the head of international relationships at the Republic National Bank of New York, the main importer of American bank notes into Russia.

为了巩固自己在外汇交易中的地位，梅尔尼琴科需要找到一个稳定的美元供应来源。他的另一位“守护天使”是一位名叫理查德·斯皮克曼的美国银行家，他是纽约共和国国民银行国际关系部门的负责人，该银行是俄罗斯境内主要的美国银行纸币进口商。

Melnichenko won him over. “We stood outside in the snow and grilled steaks. I was 60. He was 22. He reminded me of my son,” said Spikerman, who worked with him up until last year. Now Melnichenko had a direct line that bypassed the official Russian exchanges.

梅尔尼琴科赢得了他的心。“我们站在雪地里，烤着牛排。当时我 60 岁，而他是 22 岁。他让我想起了我的儿子，”斯皮克曼说。斯皮克曼一直和他一起工作到去年。现在，梅尔尼琴科有了自己的直接联系渠道，不再需要通过官方的俄罗斯渠道进行交流了。

Republic National would fly up to \$300m-worth of notes a day from vaults in Europe to Moscow. Melnichenko arranged the transport and security for his share. He rented a disused nuclear shelter near Moscow for storage. Trucks drove two storeys underground, where dozens of people sat counting cash.

共和国家公司每天会从欧洲的仓库向莫斯科运送价值高达 3 亿美元的纸币。梅尔尼琴科负责安排这些纸币的运输和安保事宜。他还租了一处位于莫斯科附近的废弃核掩体用于存放这些纸币。卡车将纸币运送到地下两层楼处，在那里，数十人坐在一起清点现金。

“Russia in the 1990s was an engine of acceleration: it destroyed people and created them at the same pace,” Melnichenko said. Rules were flexible and success or failure depended on one’s agility. “If you could think a little faster than others and formulate things a little

better, things worked out for you.”

“在 20 世纪 90 年代的俄罗斯，人们被视为推动进步的动力源——国家会摧毁一些人，同时也会创造新的人。规则非常灵活，成功或失败取决于个人的应变能力。如果你能比他人更快地思考，能更出色地解决问题，那么你就会取得成功。”梅尔尼琴科说道。

In 1992 the government began the biggest privatisation in history. Many of Melnichenko's friends became owners of companies that were previously state-owned; he served as their banker. His big clients included the Chernoy brothers, who assembled a metals empire with the help of political connections and underworld muscle. The turf war they fought over Russia's aluminium left hundreds dead in the smelter cities of Siberia.

在 1992 年，政府开始了历史上最大规模的私有化改革。梅尔尼琴科许多朋友成为了那些原本属于国家所有的公司的所有者；他则担任了这些公司的银行家角色。他的主要客户包括切尔诺伊兄弟，他们在政治关系及黑帮势力的帮助下建立了一个金属帝国。他们为争夺俄罗斯铝矿资源而发生的冲突，导致西伯利亚的冶炼厂中数百人丧生。

In 1996 the Chernoy brothers' empire fell. They were succeeded by a select group of tycoons, who were handed control of Russia's natural resources by Yeltsin's government in return for political support. After Yeltsin's re-election in 1996, Boris Berezovsky, one of the most prominent of these oligarchs, declared, "now we have the right to occupy government posts and enjoy the fruits of our victory." Melnichenko was not of their number. He observed from the side, as they scrapped with each other to expand their personal fiefs instead of investing their wealth and energies in improving the public realm.

1996 年，切尔诺伊兄弟的帝国崩溃了。他们被一群精英寡头所取代，这些寡头由叶利钦政府授意掌管俄罗斯的自然资源，以换取政治支持。1996 年叶利钦再次当选后，其中一位著名的寡头鲍里斯·贝雷佐夫斯基宣称：“现在，我们有权担任政府职务，并享受我们取得的胜利带来的好处。”而梅尔尼琴科并不属于这些人之一。他只是旁观着他们

为了扩张自己的势力而互相争斗，却不愿将自己的财富和精力投入到改善社会状况上。



In 1998 Russia defaulted on its debt and devalued the rouble. Many of the oligarchs were exposed and lost vast sums of money. Melnichenko, who had converted his earnings into foreign currency, came away not just unscathed but stronger. As other Russian banks went under, he scooped up some of the country's biggest firms as clients. One of these was owned by Roman Abramovich, who had worked his way into Yeltsin's inner circle. "He made a big impression on me. For the first time, I saw a strategist—disciplined, patient and systematic."

1998 年，俄罗斯拖欠了债务，卢布也贬值了。许多寡头因此遭受了巨大损失。而梅尔尼琴科则不然，他将自己的收入兑换成了外币，不仅没有遭受损失，反而变得更加富有。当其他俄罗斯银行倒闭时，他收购了一些该国最大的企业作为客户。其中一家企业的所有者就是罗曼·阿布拉莫维奇，他通过努力进入了叶利钦的亲信圈子。“他给我留下了深刻的印象。我第一次见到一位能够冷静、耐心且有条不紊地制定策略的人。”

Melnichenko "came to understand how power in Russia really worked". It did not derive from official positions of authority, he realised, but ran through informal networks, where only trust and loyalty mattered. Melnichenko saw how Abramovich had built up contacts everywhere—from regional governors to Yeltsin's family—and wielded influence without displays of dominance. "People who made up his 'collective' did not realise they were part of a single plan...that existed in his head. Abramovich seemed to be nowhere, yet soon he was everywhere. From a certain moment", around spring 1999, "there were no oligarchs in Russia. There was just Abramovich."

梅尔尼琴科“逐渐明白了俄罗斯的权力究竟是如何运作的”。他意识到，这种权力并非源自官方的权威地位，而是存在于各种非正式的网络中，在那里，唯有信任和忠诚才是最重要的。梅尔尼琴科看到阿布拉莫维奇如何建立了广泛的联系——从地方官员到叶利钦的家族成员，他都能施加影响，但却从不表现出强势的态度。“那些组成他‘集体’的人并没有意识到，他们其实都是他心中那个计划的一部分……阿

布拉莫维奇似乎无处不在，但实际上他却无处不在。从某个时刻开始，“大约在 1999 年春季，“俄罗斯已经没有寡头了。只有阿布拉莫维奇一个人而已。”

Melnichenko did not want to be part of someone else's system, nor was he interested in politics. Instead, he wanted to create an industrial empire. In 1999 he hired Alexander Mamut, a plugged-in figure, as chairman of his bank. "Within a year I got to know absolutely everyone who one needed to know."

梅尔尼琴科并不想加入别人的体系，也不热衷于政治事务。相反，他希望建立自己的工业帝国。1999 年，他聘请了那位颇有名气的亚历山大·马穆特担任自己银行的董事长。“在短短一年内，我就认识了所有需要认识的人。”

Abramovich was instrumental in managing the transition from Yeltsin to Putin. Melnichenko also recognised this marked the end of an era. He offered hundreds of thousands of dollars to lure opposition candidates to Putin's party and received a letter of gratitude from Putin himself after he was elected president in 2000.

阿布拉莫维奇在从叶利钦到普京的过渡期间发挥了重要作用。梅尔尼琴科也认为这一转变标志着一个时代的终结。他出资数十万美元试图拉拢反对党候选人加入普京的政党，并在 2000 年当选总统后收到了普京的感谢信。

Early that year Melnichenko went to the Himalayas. "I wanted to think everything through, calmly." He had money, political connections and a clear goal: to consolidate some of the largest industrial resources in the country. He had his eye on three sectors: making metal pipes, making fertiliser and mining coal. "Everything was part of a unified strategy."

那一年初，梅尔尼琴科前往了喜马拉雅山脉。“我希望能够冷静地思考一切。”他拥有资金、政治关系，并且有一个明确的目标：整合该国一些规模最大的工业资源。他重点关注三个领域：金属管道制造、肥料生产以及煤炭开采。“所有这些都是一个统一战略的一部分。”

Each target was, on the face of it, unpromising. Export prices for Russia's commodities were in the basement, agriculture was in a dire state and domestic tariffs for electricity and gas were set artificially low. Many domestic consumers simply did not pay at all, safe in the knowledge that they would not be cut off.

从表面上看，每一个目标都并不具有吸引力。俄罗斯商品的出口价格极低，农业状况也很糟糕，而电力和天然气方面的国内关税则被人为地定得过低。许多国内消费者根本不愿意支付费用，因为他们知道他们的服务不会被中断。

“In the quantum world, nothing is certain and everything is probable. If something disproves your view of life, it is not a tragedy, it is an opportunity”

在量子世界中，没有什么是一定的，一切都是可能的。如果某件事与你对生活的看法相悖，那并非悲剧，而是一个机会。

But Melnichenko had a hypothesis: that China's economic growth would create new demand for coal, and require food from North and South America, which would therefore need fertilisers. Internal reforms would establish fair energy tariffs, and consumers would begin paying in full. Rising oil and gas prices would create domestic demand for pipes. And scrap metal, the raw material for making them, was cheap and plentiful.

不过，梅尔尼切恩科有一个假设：中国的经济增长将会创造出对煤炭的新需求，从而需要从北美和南美进口粮食，而这就需要化肥。通过内部改革，可以制定公平的能源价格体系，消费者将开始全额支付能源费用。石油和天然气价格的上涨将促进对管道产品的国内需求。而制造管道所需的原材料——废金属，则价格低廉且供应充足。

Melnichenko started with coal: sweeping up undervalued mines, and connecting them to railway hubs, ports and power generators. In the east of the country, he built an export terminal at the end of an underutilised railway line—a 2,700-mile-long (4,345km) Soviet mega-project that ran from Siberia to the Pacific.

梅尔尼琴科从煤炭业务开始他的事业：他收购了那些价值被低估的煤矿，并将这些煤矿与铁路枢纽、港口和发电厂连接起来。在该国的东部，他在一条使用不足的铁路线末端建造了一个出口终端——这是一个长达 2700 英里（4345 公里）的苏联大型工程，这条铁路线从西伯利亚一直延伸到太平洋沿岸。

The main consumers of coal inside the country were electricity producers. Anatoly Chubais, the architect of privatisation, had been appointed in 1998 as head of RAO UES, the electricity monopoly, with a mission to break up one of the last remaining pillars of the centralised economy and promote competition. Melnichenko paid a call to introduce himself. "I believe that your reform will work out," he told him.

国内煤炭的主要消费者是电力生产商。私有化的实施者阿纳托利·丘巴伊斯于 1998 年被任命为电力垄断企业 RAO UES 的负责人，他的任务就是打破中央集权经济体系中最后的支柱，促进竞争。梅尔尼琴科前来拜访他，向他表示：“我相信你们的改革一定会取得成功。”

Chubais was used to dealing with bolshy minority shareholders or oligarchs demanding favours. The man visiting him was so polite that "he looked like a schoolboy walking into the staff room during break," Chubais recalled. There was one more thing, Melnichenko added. "We raised \$2.5bn and we bought 15% of your shares."

丘拜斯习惯于与那些要求特殊待遇的大股东或寡头们打交道。他提到的那位来访者非常客气，丘拜斯回忆说：“他看起来就像是一个小学生，走进教室的瞬间。”梅尔尼琴科补充说：“我们还筹集了 25 亿美元的资金，并购买了你们公司 15% 的股份。”

Chubais was so stunned he thought he had misheard. This would make Melnichenko the largest individual investor in RAO UES. Chubais waited for the new owner's demands. None came. As Melnichenko prepared to leave, Chubais could not help asking: "Why did you come, Andrey? Do you have any wishes?" "No, I just came to inform you," Melnichenko replied. Then he left. For the next seven years, he did not make a single request. "It was my dream come true," Chubais said. "He was a new kind of industrialist."

丘拜斯惊讶得几乎不敢相信自己的耳朵。这意味着梅尔尼琴科将成为 RAO UES 中最大的个人投资者。丘拜斯等待着新主人的要求。然而，并没有什么要求被提出来。当梅尔尼琴科准备离开时，丘拜斯忍不住问道：“你为什么来这里，安德烈？你有什么愿望吗？”“没有，我只是来通知你一声而已，”梅尔尼琴科回答道。然后他就离开了。在接下来的七年里，他再也没有提出过任何要求。“这真是我的梦想成真，”丘拜斯说。“他真是个新型式的实业家。”

It took just two years for Melnichenko, whose name had previously been barely known outside business circles, to emerge as one of Russia's top industrialists. "Everything was done very quickly. And nobody could understand what we were doing. Only once everything was finished did it become clear." In 2002 *Nezavisimaya Gazeta*, a Russian newspaper, quoted one Western businessman who said of Melnichenko, "He's 30 years old, and he wants to rule the world."

仅仅两年时间，梅尔尼切金就从一个在商业圈之外几乎无人知晓的人物，成为了俄罗斯顶尖的实业家之一。“一切都在很短的时间内完成了。当时没有人能理解我们在做什么。直到一切完成后，才明白其中的道理。”2002 年，《自由报》引用了一位西方商人的话来形容梅尔尼切金：“他只有 30 岁，却想要统治世界。”

By 2004 his plan was complete. MDM Group had merged 50 enterprises into three companies: the Pipe Metallurgical Company (ТМК), EuroChem, a mineral and chemical company, and the Siberian Coal Energy Company (SUEK). The power plants served Russia, his coal exports were sent to Asia and EuroChem looked West. He had,

as his old friend Spikerman said, become “a globalist by design”.

到 2004 年，他的计划已经完成了。MDM 集团将 50 家企业合并为三家子公司：Pipe 冶金公司、EuroChem——一家从事矿物和化工业务的公司，以及西伯利亚煤炭能源公司。这些发电厂为俄罗斯提供服务，他的煤炭出口则销往亚洲，而 EuroChem 则面向西方市场。正如他的老朋友 Spikerman 所说，他确实成为了一名“具有全球视野的人”。





Aleksandra Melnichenko, Melnichenko's wife and a Serbian former-model. She and her husband are the owners of Motor Yacht A. Designed as a "stealth" yacht, it successfully evaded impoundment in 2022 following Russia's invasion of Ukraine, though its sister ship was seized by the Italian government

亚历山德拉·梅尔尼切恩科，梅尔尼切恩科的妻子，同时也是一位塞尔维亚前模特。她和丈夫共同拥有名为“A”的摩托艇。这艘游艇被设计成一种“隐形”游艇，在 2022 年俄罗斯入侵乌克兰后成功避开了被扣押的命运。不过，它的姊妹船却被意大利政府没收了。

While Melnichenko was consolidating his industrial assets, Putin and the security services were establishing control over the elites and eliminating independent power bases. The new leader sidelined most of the oligarchs. In 2003 he arrested Mikhail Khodorkovsky, the politically ambitious owner of Yukos, Russia's largest oil firm, and seized his company.

当梅尔尼琴科在巩固其工业资产时，普京和安全部门则开始控制那些精英阶层，并消灭了所有的独立势力。这位新领导人将大多数寡头排除在外。2003 年，他逮捕了米哈伊尔·霍多罗科夫——这位野心勃勃的政治人物，他是俄罗斯最大的石油公司“尤科斯”的老板，同时没收了这家公司的资产。

Moguls were told that “you don’t need to be involved in anything other than your business,” Melnichenko recalled. “In fact, you are explicitly expected not to be involved.” He did not mind this arrangement and neither did his peers. By the early 2000s they were looking outwards. “The same impulse that had once led me from Gomel to Moscow was now pushing me to New York, London and Paris,” said Melnichenko.

梅尔尼切恩科回忆说，那些大亨们被要求“只专注于自己的生意，不要涉足其他事务”。事实上，他们被明确要求不要参与其他事情。他和他的同伴们都不介意这种安排。到了 21 世纪初，他们开始向外发展。“曾经让我从戈梅利来到莫斯科的同样冲动，现在又推动我前往纽约、伦敦和巴黎，”梅尔尼切恩科说道。

Part of this shift was his decision to get married. He approached his personal life as systematically and deliberately as his business affairs—like “Chinese dynasties. There was no randomness in it, absolutely none.” He chose his future wife before he actually met her.

这一转变的一部分在于他决定结婚的决定。他对个人生活的处理方式与对待商业事务时一样，都遵循着系统性和计划性。就像“中国的王朝一样，没有任何偶然性，完全没有任何随机因素。”他在真正认识未来的妻子之前就已经选好了她。

Aleksandra Nikolić, known as Sandra, was five years younger than him. She had been raised in the former Yugoslavia. Her father was a Serbian architect, her mother a Croatian artist. As the most popular singer in the Balkans and a model with a degree in international management, she was beautiful, famous and clever. She was also his entrée into European society.

亚历山德拉·尼科利奇，简称桑德拉，比他年轻五岁。她在前南斯拉夫地区长大。她的父亲是塞尔维亚建筑师，母亲则是克罗地亚艺术家。作为巴尔干地区最受欢迎的歌手，同时拥有国际管理学位的模特，她既美丽又富有才华。她还是他进入欧洲社会的重要桥梁。

At their first meeting in Antibes, Melnichenko told her straight away he was planning to marry her. She was taken aback, but he was confident. "The moment I saw her, I knew that everything I'd heard about her before was true—and much more besides. I fell in love with her immediately."

在安蒂贝的第一次见面时，梅尔尼琴科直接告诉她，他打算娶她。她感到很惊讶，但他却非常自信。“当我见到她的那一刻，我就知道之前关于她的所有传闻都是真实的——而且还有更多的事情。我立刻就爱上了她。”

Six months later they moved in together and, two years after that, they got married. The wedding cost \$30m. The 300 guests were fed by Alain Ducasse, a Michelin-starred chef, and entertained by Whitney Houston, Christina Aguilera and Enrique Iglesias.

六个月后，他们开始同居，两年后便结婚了。这场婚礼的花费达到了3000 万美元。300 位宾客由米其林星级厨师阿尔兰·杜卡萨料理饮食，而表演嘉宾则包括惠特妮·休斯顿、克里斯蒂娜·阿奎莱拉和恩里克·伊格莱西亚斯。

By the time of their wedding, Melnichenko was no longer a Russian tax resident. In 2004 he moved to France, and later to Switzerland, and stepped back from the day-to-day operations of his companies. A life apart suited him. "I had worked very hard, essentially, since childhood. I just wanted to live...I had no interest in improving the world, let's put it that way."

在他们结婚的时候，梅尔尼琴科已经不再拥有俄罗斯税务居民身份了。2004 年，他移居法国，随后又去了瑞士。他暂时退出了自己公司的日常管理工作。这种远离尘嚣的生活方式很适合他。“从童年时期开始，我就一直非常努力地工作。我只是想好好生活……说实话，我对改善世界并没有什么兴趣。”

Melnichenko did not want to be part of someone else's system, nor was he interested in politics. Instead, he wanted to create

an industrial empire

梅尔尼琴科不想成为别人体系的一部分，也不关心政治事务。相反，他希望建立一个工业帝国。

Until then his knowledge of Western business was mostly theoretical. There was only one way to turn it into practice: "start living the way the people you aspire to become actually live, spend time how they spend it, see how decisions are really made."

直到那时，他对西方商业方面的了解还大多是理论上的。要实现理论到实践的转变，只有一种方法：“模仿你渴望成为的那种人来生活，体验他们的生活方式，了解他们是如何做出决策的。”

Melnichenko commissioned a yacht from the designer Philippe Starck, whom he gave complete freedom. It was 119 metres long and weighed 6,000 tonnes. The prow was shaped like the beak of an eagle and it glided stealthily through the sea with barely a ripple, "like a whale". The boat, called *A* after his and his wife's shared initial, set sail in 2008. It served as his calling card and an expression of life unconstrained by borders or nationality. He surveyed the globe, spending eight months a year on board. "We were building a global Russia integrated into the world economy and Western institutions."

梅尔尼琴科委托设计师菲利普·斯塔克设计了一艘游艇，并给予了他完全的创作自由。这艘游艇长 119 米，重达 6000 吨。它的船首形状像鹰的喙，在海上滑行时几乎不产生任何涟漪，就像一只鲸鱼一样悄无声息地前进。这艘游艇以他和妻子共同的名字“A”命名，于 2008 年启航。它成为了他的象征，也是他对无边界、无国籍生活的追求的体现。他每年有八个月都在驾驶这艘游艇环游世界。“我们是在打造一个融入世界经济的全球俄罗斯，让俄罗斯与西方机构更加紧密地联系在一起。”

From the deck of his yacht he began devising a global investment strategy. In 2011 he conceived a plan to spend \$35bn over 15 years, picking up assets across the world, and building new plants in

Russia. "I did not receive much in the way of dividends, I was investing in the long term." The plan succeeded—but the world for which it was made would fall apart.

在他的游艇上，他开始制定一项全球性的投资策略。2011 年，他提出了一个计划：在 15 年内投资 350 亿美元，在全球范围内收购资产，并在俄罗斯建设新的工厂。“我没有获得太多红利，我是在进行长期投资。”这个计划成功了——但为这个计划而设计的世界却走向了崩溃。

Two conflicting tendencies began to emerge inside Russia in 2008, the year that Putin took a four-year hiatus as president. Following years of growth and high oil prices, the country was modernising socially and economically. The first post-Soviet generation was coming of age. They wished to be citizens rather than subjects and were receptive to international influences.

在 2008 年，也就是普京暂停总统职务的四年期间，俄罗斯国内出现了两种相互矛盾的趋势。经过多年的经济增长和石油价格高涨之后，该国在社会和经济方面开始进行现代化改革。这一代后苏联时代出生的人正在成长起来。他们希望成为公民而不是臣民，并且乐于接受国际影响。

But Putin, who continued to wield power as prime minister, realised integration with the West would upend Russia's political system. This would undermine his power and that of the *siloviki*, and his desire to recreate the Soviet empire by asserting a Russian sphere of influence. His return to the Kremlin in 2012 was greeted with mass protests by Russia's middle class. At that point he made a deliberate choice to set the country on a path of confrontation.

但普京仍然继续担任总理一职，他意识到与西方一体化会破坏俄罗斯的政治体系。这将会削弱他以及那些亲政府派人物的权力，而他也渴望通过确立俄罗斯的影响力范围来重新建立苏联式的帝国。2012 年他重返克里姆林宫时，遭到了俄罗斯中产阶级的大规模抗议。从那时起，他便故意选择让国家走上对抗的道路。

While Melnichenko was expanding his horizons, Putin began to isolate Russia and restore the symbols of empire. None was more potent than Crimea, which he annexed in 2014. Sanctions followed as Putin began to turn Russia into a fortress—self-reliant, hardened against pressure, its population on a leash.

当梅尔尼琴科在拓宽视野时，普京开始孤立俄罗斯，并试图恢复帝国的象征意义。而克里米亚则是一个极具影响力的象征，他在 2014 年吞并了它。随后，各种制裁措施随之出台，普京将俄罗斯变成了一个自给自足的堡垒，对外部压力毫无抵抗力，民众也被束缚在一种被动的状态之下。

That year Melnichenko moved the headquarters of EuroChem to Switzerland, where he lived. He did not recognise the magnitude of the tensions between Russia and the West. He saw crises in business terms, where matters are resolved when the costs grow too high. "I didn't think it would go as far as it did. It shouldn't have gone that far." Melnichenko now sees his error. "While I was continuing to build an international company, the world in which such companies could exist was already coming to an end."

那一年，梅尔尼切恩科将 EuroChem 的总部迁到了瑞士，他本人也住在了那里。他并未意识到俄罗斯与西方之间紧张关系的严重性。他只是从商业的角度看待这些危机，认为当成本过高时，问题自然会得到解决。“我没想到情况会发展到这种地步。事情本不该如此。”现在，梅尔尼切恩科意识到了自己的错误。“当我还努力打造一家国际性公司的时候，能够存在这样的公司的世界已经走向了终结。”



Then in 2022 his world imploded. On the day that war broke out, Melnichenko was in Moscow to attend a long-scheduled engagement with Putin, alongside other Russian business leaders. Putin projected

confidence. “Unfortunately, our meeting is taking place in unusual conditions, to put it mildly, but we planned it in advance,” he told the stunned gathering. None of those present had expected the Russian president to pull the trigger. They had persuaded themselves that war couldn’t happen because it would be a disaster. Nonetheless, none of them spoke against it.

然后，在 2022 年，他的世界崩塌了。就在战争爆发的那天，梅尔尼琴科正在莫斯科，与其他俄罗斯商业领袖一起参加一个早已安排好的会议。普京表现得非常自信：“不幸的是，我们的会议是在非常不寻常的情况下进行的，不过我们还是提前安排好了这一切。”在场的人都没有预料到俄罗斯总统会发动战争。他们一直认为战争是不可能发生的，因为那将是一场灾难。然而，没有人敢反对这一决定。

Melnichenko was put under sanctions on March 9th. The EU claimed that this was because he was part of “the closest circle of Vladimir Putin”. EuroChem itself was exempted from sanctions, so as not to endanger the world’s food supply. Melnichenko later challenged the sanctions in the European Court of Justice, but his arguments were dismissed.

梅尔尼琴科于 3 月 9 日被实施制裁。欧盟声称这是因为他属于“弗拉基米尔·普京最亲密的亲信圈子”。而 EuroChem 公司则被免于制裁，以免危及全球粮食供应。后来，梅尔尼琴科向欧洲法院提出了挑战，但他的主张被驳回。

He had already taken countermeasures. On March 8th, his 50th birthday, he resigned as the beneficiary of the trusts that held assets used by the family—houses, planes, yachts—and transferred them to Sandra, an EU citizen who had never lived in Russia and had no Russian passport. A few days later the Italian government seized his newest yacht. The EU bureaucracy was not his only source of trouble. Business partners in Europe tried to exploit his predicament, he says.

他已经采取了应对措施。3 月 8 日，也就是他的 50 岁生日那天，他辞去了信托受益人职位，将那些用于家庭的资产——包括房屋、飞

机、游艇等——转移给了桑德拉，她是一名欧盟公民，从未在俄罗斯居住过，也没有俄罗斯护照。几天后，意大利政府没收了他的新游艇。据他说，欧盟的官僚机构并不是他唯一的麻烦来源。在欧洲的商业伙伴也试图利用他的困境来谋取利益。

Melnichenko's initial strategy was to sit out the war and wait for things to return to normal. "There was a period in 2022-23 when I tried to play by the old rules because it seemed to me that this whole story was temporary." He based himself in Dubai and made friends with the Emirati elite. The tipping point came in a conversation with Tucker Carlson, then a MAGA tribune, in a hotel in Dubai in the build-up to the 2024 American election. "It left me with a clear impression that if Trump wins, he would embrace fragmentation."

梅尔尼琴科最初的策略是远离战争，等待局势恢复正常。“在 2022-23 年期间，我试图按照旧的规则来行事，因为我觉得整个局势都是暂时的。”他定居在迪拜，并结识了当地的精英人士。转折点出现在一次对话中——当时，塔克·卡尔森还是一位支持“让美国再次伟大”政策的政治人物，他们在迪拜的一家酒店里进行了交谈。这次对话让我意识到，如果特朗普获胜，美国将会陷入分裂状态。

At around that time he and other businessmen realised that the war would not end soon. With no reprieve from sanctions in sight, they started to repatriate themselves back to Russia, where they faced a different kind of threat to their assets.

大约在那个时候，他和其他商人意识到战争不会很快结束。由于制裁措施短期内无法解除，他们开始返回俄罗斯，因为在那里，他们的资产面临着另一种威胁。

Property rights in Russia had always been conditional. But the war unleashed a rapacity that hadn't been seen for decades. Since 2023, assets worth \$60bn have been nationalised or handed over to loyalists. It was the biggest redistribution of property since the mass

privatisations of the 1990s.

在俄罗斯，财产权一直都是有条件的。然而，战争引发了数十年来从未见过的贪婪行为。自 2023 年以来，价值 600 亿美元的资产被国有化或交给了忠诚于政府的人。这是自 20 世纪 90 年代大规模私有化改革以来最大规模的财产重新分配。

“While I was continuing to build an international company, the world in which such companies could exist was already coming to an end”

“在我努力打造一家国际性公司的过程中，那些这样的公司能够存在的世界，其实已经走向了终结。”

In August 2023 prosecutors sought to confiscate Sibeco, a Siberian power plant, from Melnichenko, arguing that his purchase of it had involved fraudulent collusion with the previous owner. Two weeks later, the prosecutor-general's office backed down in return for Melnichenko making a donation to a “charitable organisation”. According to people familiar with the settlement, the sum was 32bn roubles (\$335m)—the same amount that Melnichenko had originally paid for Sibeco. The charitable organisation was Sirius, a school for gifted children favoured by Putin.

2023 年 8 月，检察官试图将西伯利亚的 Sibeco 发电厂从 Melnichenko 手中夺回，理由是他购买该发电厂时与前所有者存在欺诈行为。两周后，总检察院为了换取 Melnichenko 向一家“慈善组织”捐款的承诺而放弃了这一要求。据熟悉该协议的人士透露，捐款金额为 320 亿卢布（相当于 3.35 亿美元）——这与 Melnichenko 最初购买 Sibeco 发电厂时所支付的金额相同。这家慈善组织是 Sirius，一家受普京青睐的英才教育机构。

Melnichenko now knew that he needed to establish property rights in Russia. The only way to do this was to work his way into the system, understand the competing interests and help shape its objectives. “If

you want a seat at the table, you have to do something.”

梅尔尼琴科现在明白，他需要在俄罗斯建立财产权。实现这一目标的唯一途径就是融入这个体系，了解各种相互竞争的利益关系，并帮助塑造该体系的目标。“如果你想获得发言权，就必须采取行动。”

As always he began by observation. “In 2023 I started to spend more time in Russia and was getting to know it in a much deeper way.” He talked to anyone who had a stake and a viewpoint: “politicians, journalists, thinkers, liberals, nationalists, communists”. He could be found having breakfast with Dmitry Muratov, the Nobel prizewinner and founding editor of *Novaya Gazeta*, a liberal newspaper, who was ostracised by the government and branded a “foreign agent”. In the evening he might have tea with Alexander Dugin, a nationalist philosopher who glorifies the war.

像往常一样，他首先通过观察来开始他的研究。“到了 2023 年，我开始在俄罗斯度过更多的时间，对这座城市有了更深入的了解。”他向那些有相关利益或观点的人寻求建议：“政治家、记者、思想家、自由主义者、民族主义者、共产主义者……”人们经常可以在他那里看到与德米特里·穆拉托夫一起吃早餐的情景。德米特里是诺贝尔获奖者，也是《新报》的创始人之一，那是一份自由派报纸。不过，德米特里被政府排挤，被称为“外国代理人”。到了晚上，他可能会和民族主义哲学家亚历山大·杜金一起喝茶，而亚历山大则热衷于宣扬战争的好处。

Conversation by conversation, he found a way to imagine what Russia ought to become. “Everybody has different interests, but there is a consensus that a clear idea of the future has been lost.” To much of the world, no serious discussion of Russia’s future is possible until after the war. To Melnichenko, the end of the war in Ukraine is contingent on imagining that future—which hardly anyone in either Russia or the West is prepared to do.

他——地讨论着各种可能性，试图想象出俄罗斯未来的样子。“每个人都有自己的利益诉求，但大家都认为，关于未来发展的明确构想已经缺失了。”对于世界上大多数国家来说，在战争结束之前，根本无法进行关于俄罗斯未来的严肃讨论。对梅尔尼琴科来说，乌克兰战争的结

束取决于人们能否想象出那样的未来——而无论是俄罗斯还是西方，几乎没有人愿意去想象这样的未来。

Melnichenko's vision is set out in [his online essay](#). It is not ideological. He does not think in terms of democracy and autocracy, good and evil, friend and enemy, defeat and victory. His most important goals are building consensus, restoring stability and working for Russia's long-term interests.

梅尔尼琴科的愿景在他的在线文章中得到了阐述。这种愿景并非基于意识形态的考量。他并不以民主与专制、善与恶、朋友与敌人、失败与胜利来划分事物。他最重要的目标在于建立共识、恢复稳定，并维护俄罗斯的长远利益。

He explained to me four scenarios, all of which he thinks are grim. In the first, Russia is brought in from the cold and reintegrated into the Western order while being confined to its periphery. To Melnichenko that sounds like vassalage; he thinks a humiliated and defeated Russia would almost certainly generate aggressive revanchism.

他向我介绍了四种情况，他认为这些情况都非常严峻。第一种情况是，俄罗斯被从寒冷之地召回，重新融入西方秩序，但只能处于边缘地位。对梅尔尼琴科来说，这听起来像是屈辱的附庸地位；他认为，一个被击败且蒙羞的俄罗斯肯定会引发强烈的复仇情绪。

A second is for Russia to be permanently drawn into China's orbit as a buffer zone and supplier of natural resources. China may have little interest in this scenario: it would be responsible for Russia's problems and face a backlash from humiliated Russians. "China is happy to benefit from asymmetry in the relationship but is in no hurry to formalise it," he argues. To him, the only difference between these two scenarios is the identity of the feudal overlord.

第二个方案是让俄罗斯永远成为中国关系中的缓冲地带，同时担任中国自然资源的供应者。不过，中国可能对这种安排并无兴趣：这样做只会让俄罗斯陷入麻烦，而且还会遭到羞辱的俄罗斯人的反对。他认

为，这两种方案之间的唯一区别在于谁是这种关系中的“封建统治者”。



The two other scenarios are more alarming for being entirely plausible. Russia could descend into civil conflict with different warlords vying for scarce resources. A fragmenting country with a nuclear arsenal was America's worst nightmare when the Soviet Union collapsed and it remains so today. "A broken Russia may be an attractive image in political speeches," Melnichenko says. "It is far less attractive from the standpoint of risk management."

另外两种情况更为令人担忧，因为它们完全具有可能性。俄罗斯可能会陷入内战，各种军阀争夺有限的资源。而一个分裂且拥有核武器的国家，对于美国来说无疑是最糟糕的噩梦——这种情况在苏联解体后一直存在至今。“一个分裂的俄罗斯可能在政治演讲中看起来是个吸引人的形象，”梅尔尼琴科说。“但从风险管理的角度来看，这种形象要少得多。”

The fourth scenario, promoted by the security services and subject to serious discussion in the Kremlin, poses a direct threat to Melnichenko and the Russian elite: a North Korea-style lockdown sustained by militarism, repression, isolation, rationing and the export of instability. "A Russia trapped in the mentality of a permanent fortress would transform external confrontation into a permanent instrument of domestic politics," he says.

第四个方案由安全部门推动，并在克里姆林宫引发了广泛讨论。这一方案对梅尔尼琴科和俄罗斯精英阶层构成了直接威胁：即采用朝鲜式的封锁政策，通过军事压迫、镇压、隔离、配给制以及制造不稳定局势来维持统治。他说：“一个陷入永久防御心态的俄罗斯，会将外部对抗转化为国内政治的工具。”

The only alternative to these scenarios, as Melnichenko sees it, is for Russia to become what he calls a "sovereign" country, one that places the comfort of its people first and whose behaviour is predictable to the outside world. The word "sovereignty" has had varying meanings in Russian politics over the past three decades. Yeltsin invoked sovereignty to show that the new democratic country was distinct from the Soviet Union. One astute Russian philologist

thought the idea was absurd. "Who is Russia seeking sovereignty from, the polar bears?" she wrote in her diary.

在梅尔尼琴科看来，这些情况的唯一替代方案是让俄罗斯成为一个他所称的“主权国家”——一个将人民福祉置于首位、其行为对外界来说是可以预测的国家。在过去三十年中，“主权”这个词在俄罗斯政治中有着不同的含义。叶利钦利用“主权”这一概念来表明这个新的民主国家与苏联是不同的。不过，有一位精明的俄罗斯语言学家认为这一想法很荒谬。“俄罗斯到底在寻求谁的主权呢？难道是北极熊吗？”她在日记中写道。

Putin, who argued that modern Russia shared characteristics with the Soviet Union and the Russian empire before it, invoked sovereignty to justify the domination of the state over its people. Sovereignty became a synonym for Russia's resurgence as a great power—one opposed to the Western liberal order. It was also a byword for Putin's personal rule and his right to impose his will on former Soviet republics.

普京认为，现代俄罗斯与苏联及沙俄时期有着相似之处，因此他以主权概念为理由，来论证国家有权统治其人民。主权成了俄罗斯作为超级大国的复兴的象征——一个与西方自由主义秩序相对立的强国。同时，主权也代表了普京个人统治的方式，以及他有权对前苏联共和国施加自己的意志。

To much of the world, no serious discussion of Russia's future is possible until after the war. To Melnichenko, the end of the war is contingent on imagining that future

在世界上大多数地方，直到战争结束之前，都无法进行关于俄罗斯未来的严肃讨论。对梅尔尼琴科来说，战争的结束取决于是否能够想象出那样的未来。

Melnichenko uses the word "sovereignty" differently: to refer to the agency of the elites with a stake in the country. Citizens too "may come to understand the importance of agency as well—provided they are offered not a simulation of participation but an opportunity

to discuss real alternatives honestly". A country's greatness, Melnichenko argues, has nothing to do with sloganeering. It depends on whether it protects citizens' freedom and property "not as an act of good will but as an obligation".

梅尔尼琴科对“主权”这个词有不同的理解：他指的是那些在国家事务中有利益关系的精英们的权力。公民们同样可以认识到这种权力的重要性——只要他们不是被给予一种虚假的参与机会，而是有机会诚实地讨论真正的选择。梅尔尼琴科认为，一个国家的伟大与否与口号无关，而在于它是否能够保护公民的自由和财产，而不是出于善意，而是作为一种义务来履行。

Melnichenko is convinced that the challenges that Russia faces are so severe that wider participation is needed. Businessmen, leaders of civil society, nationalists, technocrats ought to get involved. These people have different, sometimes opposing interests but would agree on a compromise not because they like each other, but because alternatives would be worse. Such a polity would be an oligarchy in the classical sense of the word—rule by elites. The “internal debate about what Russia should become is unavoidable—and it will be intense.”

梅尔尼琴科坚信，俄罗斯面临的挑战非常严峻，因此需要更广泛的参与。企业家、民间社会的领袖、民族主义者以及技术官僚都应该参与其中。这些人虽然有着不同的、有时甚至对立的利益诉求，但他们能够达成妥协，并不是因为他们彼此喜欢，而是因为其他方案会更糟糕。这样的政府结构实际上是一种典型的精英统治——由少数精英掌控权力。关于俄罗斯应该成为什么样的国家，内部的争论是不可避免的，而且将会非常激烈。

The main aim is to make the country “a place where people are drawn to because they genuinely like it, because life there is better: safer, more secure, more predictable, more prosperous—and because they feel they can realise themselves.” For Melnichenko, attracting people from former Soviet republics and tempting back those who fled the country is the only way of making Russia

economically viable.

其主要目标是将这个国家打造成“一个人们愿意居住的地方——因为他们真心喜欢这里的生活，这里的生活更加美好：更安全、更稳定、更可预测、更繁荣——而且他们觉得在这里能够实现自己的梦想。”对于梅尔尼琴科来说，吸引来自前苏联共和国的人们，并重新吸引那些离开该国的人，是让俄罗斯在经济上保持活力的唯一途径。

This vision is strikingly close to the one advocated by Tsar Fedor Ioannovich—the son of Ivan the Terrible and the titular hero in one of Russia’s most popular history plays: “We should make Russia so pleasant that people would not prefer living abroad. Then there will be no reason for them running away from us.”

这一愿景与沙皇费奥多尔·伊万诺维奇所倡导的理念极为相似——费奥多尔是伊凡雷帝的儿子，也是俄罗斯最受欢迎的历史剧中的主角。费奥多尔认为：“我们应该让俄罗斯变得如此美好，以至于人们不会愿意生活在海外。那样一来，他们就没有理由离开我们的国家了。”

“This Russia does not have to be convenient to the West or to China,” Melnichenko argues. “It has to care primarily about its own citizens and be predictable and rational to the outside world. It might be a difficult partner to the West, but it is not a black hole. It might be less amenable to China than a client state, but it is safer than a large and volatile vassal.”

梅尔尼琴科认为：“俄罗斯不必总是对西方或中国有利。它首先应该关心自己的公民，对外来世界要表现出可预测性和理性性。虽然俄罗斯可能对西方来说是一个难以合作的伙伴，但它并非一个黑洞。与中国的关系方面，它可能不如一个附庸国那么友好，但至少比一个庞大且不稳定的附庸国要安全一些。”

His proposals are self-serving, obviously. He clearly wants Russia to become a place where there is a role for him. If the country turns into North Korea, his children will not have a future there. If it

descends into civil war, his fortune will not survive.

他的提议显然是为了自己谋利。他显然希望俄罗斯能成为一个适合他发挥作用的场所。如果俄罗斯变成像朝鲜那样的国家，他的孩子们将没有未来。而如果俄罗斯陷入内战，他的财富也将会化为乌有。

It is far too early to say if Melnichenko's idea of Russia's sovereignty can become reality. The odds against it are high: veterans returning from the front will increase social tensions; the frustrations of a population that feels it has been put under a state of emergency for no benefit are already blatant. The security services will not give up power easily and they are so universally despised that collaboration with them may not be possible.

现在还太早，无法判断梅尔尼琴科关于俄罗斯主权的设想能否成为现实。这种可能性很低：从前线归来的老兵们会加剧社会紧张局势；那些认为自己被置于紧急状态而毫无收获的民众的不满情绪已经非常明显了。安全部门不会轻易放弃权力，而他们又是备受憎恶的群体，因此与他们合作可能并不现实。

He aims to make Russia "a place where people are drawn to because they genuinely like it, because life there is better: safer, more secure, more predictable, more prosperous"

他致力于将俄罗斯打造成“一个人们愿意前往的地方，因为他们真心喜欢这里，因为这里的生活更美好：更安全、更稳定、更可预测、更繁荣。”

Yet Russian history rarely follows a script. There is certainly a yearning among the elite for someone to say what everybody already thinks. It might only take one man to break the silence for the floodgates to open. And the lesson of the past is that epochal shifts begin at the top. As Yegor Gaidar, Russia's former prime minister said, big changes in Russia happen later than we think, but earlier than we expect.

然而，俄罗斯的历史很少遵循某种固定的模式。当然，精英阶层确实渴望有人能够说出大家已经想到的那些话。也许只需要一个人打破沉

默，就能开启新的变革。过去的经验告诉我们，重大的变革往往从顶层开始。正如俄罗斯前总理叶戈里·盖达尔所说，俄罗斯的重大变化发生的时间比我们想象的要晚，但比我们预期的要早。

Melnichenko knows this, too. He told me that “the moment of change cannot be predicted. There are moments in history that just happen. Trying to accelerate is usually a mistake. All you can do is observe and be ready for it.” He cannot foretell which way the country will turn. All he can do now is increase his standing and clout. Melnichenko’s mind still thinks in terms of quantum physics, where the mere act of looking alters the nature of things. “It is only the appearance of an observer that brings sense to the world.” ■

梅尔尼琴科也明白这一点。他告诉我：“变革的时刻是无法预测的。历史中有一些时刻是自然而然发生的。试图加速变革通常是一个错误。你所能做的只是观察并做好准备。”他无法预知国家会走向何方。现在，他所能做的就是提升自己的地位和影响力。梅尔尼琴科的思维仍然遵循量子物理的思维方式——在量子物理学中，仅仅是观察的行为就能改变事物的本质。“只有观察者的存在，才能赋予世界意义。”

Arkady Ostrovsky is *The Economist's* Russia editor

阿尔卡迪·奥斯特罗夫斯基是《经济学人》杂志的俄罗斯事务编辑。

Photographs **Nanna Heitmann**

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Corporate concentration

企业集中度

Beware the top-heavy economy

小心这种重量分布不均衡的经济状况吧

Supersize capital flows are reshaping business—and building risk
超大规模的资本流动正在重塑商业模式，并带来新的风险。

Jul 09, 2026 06:35 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:35



NOWADAYS IT IS easy to get desensitised to big numbers. Every week stonking deals are announced. Only four days after SpaceX, Elon Musk's rocket-maker, raised \$86bn in the [largest ever public listing](#) on June 12th, it said it would buy Cursor, an artificial-intelligence coding startup, for \$60bn. The same day DeepSeek, a Chinese AI lab, said it had raised \$7bn in the fourth-biggest venture-capital (vc) round ever in the country.

如今，人们很容易对巨额数字产生麻木感。每周都有一些惊人的交易被公布出来。就在 6 月 12 日，埃隆·马斯克的火箭制造商 SpaceX 以 860 亿美元的价格完成了史上最大规模的公开募股，仅仅四天后，它便宣布以 600 亿美元收购了人工智能编程初创公司 Cursor。同一天，中国的人工智能实验室 DeepSeek 也宣布获得了 70 亿美元的投资，这创下了该国有史以来第四大规模的风险投资纪录。

So far this year mega-mergers worth over \$10bn have accounted for 48% of total deal value, the highest level on record, according to Dealogic, a data provider (see chart 1). Bets on startups are also concentrating: investment rounds larger than \$1bn have accounted for 61% of total vc funding this year, with four-fifths of those rounds involving a corporate investor, according to PitchBook, another data provider (see chart 2).

今年到目前为止，价值超过 100 亿美元的大型合并交易占整个交易总额的 48%，这一比例创下了历史新高。根据数据提供商 Dealogic 的数据（见图表 1），投资初创公司的资金也显著增加：今年，规模超过 10 亿美元的融资轮次占总融资额的 61%，其中五分之四的融资轮次涉及企业投资者。同样来自 PitchBook 的数据提供商的数据也显示（见图表 2），投资初创公司的资金占比同样很高。

The trend towards supersize capital flows is visible everywhere you look. Greenfield foreign direct investment (FDI) projects worth over \$1bn have made up 42% of the total since the start of 2024, up from 28% from 2016-18, reckons fdi Markets, which tracks projects

(see chart 3).

超大规模的资金流动趋势随处可见。根据 fDi Markets 的数据，自 2024 年初以来，价值超过 10 亿美元的绿地海外直接投资项目占总项目的 42%，而这一比例在 2016 年至 2018 年期间为 28%。

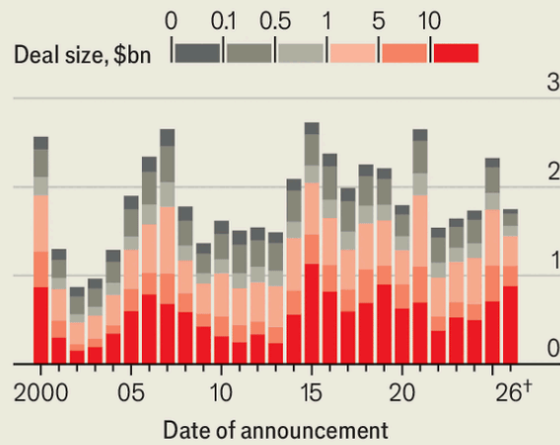
Much of this activity centres on America. Last year the country was the largest destination and source of greenfield FDI projects worth over \$1bn. It is also home to 14 of the 15 startups that have received the biggest cheques since the start of 2024. For the 71 mega-mergers since the start of 2025, 44 of the buyers come from America.

这些活动大多集中在美国。去年，美国是价值超过 10 亿美元的新建外国直接投资项目的最大目的地和来源地。此外，自 2024 年开始以来，有 15 家初创企业获得了巨额投资，其中 14 家都来自美国。自 2025 年以来，在 71 起大型合并案例中，有 44 家的收购方来自美国。

Concentrated firepower

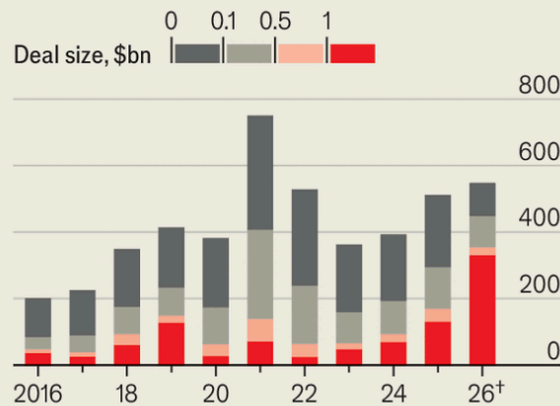
Global strategic-M&A deal value*, \$trn

1



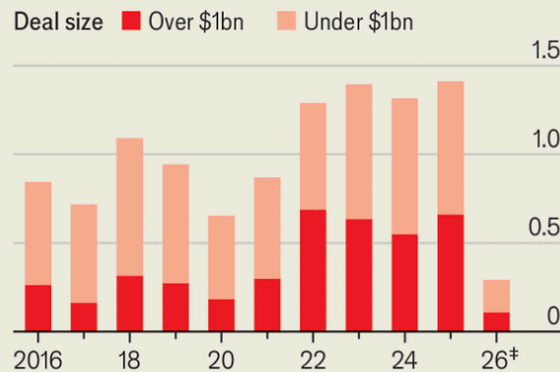
Global venture-capital investment, \$bn

2



Global greenfield foreign-direct-investment deals, \$trn

3



*Excludes deals where the stake in the target firm is less than 50% [†]To June [‡]To April

Sources: Dealogic; PitchBook; fDi Markets

But the pattern has also spread to other regions. Last year Taiwan was the second-biggest source of jumbo FDI deals, followed by the UAE and China. Large VC deals are being struck outside America too. DayOne, a Singapore-based data-centre operator, raised \$4.5bn in June; Nscale, a British rival, received \$2bn in March.

不过，这种趋势也扩散到了其他地区。去年，台湾是第二大吸引大型外国直接投资的市场，紧随其后的是阿联酋和中国。在美洲以外地区，也出现了许多大型风险投资交易。例如，一家位于新加坡的数据中心运营商 DayOne 在六月筹集了 45 亿美元资金；而另一家英国公司 Nscale 则在三月获得了 20 亿美元的投资。

Big transactions come and go in waves. Yet it is rare for these cycles to be so synchronised, and so dependent on a small number of giant firms. That brings dangers.

大型交易以周期性的方式出现和消失。然而，这些周期能够如此同步运行，并且依赖于少数几家大型公司，这种情况是非常罕见的。这带来了风险。

The trend towards supersize investments is the result of a combination of various undercurrents in global business. First is the availability of capital, despite interest rates having risen from unusually low levels. The cash holdings of companies in America's S&P 500 index have reached \$2.2trn. These firms are also earning more than ever. In America corporate profits are near an all-time high when compared with GDP. That, in turn, has helped push market values to record levels, which gives firms yet more scope to perform takeovers and raise additional debt or equity. On June 1st Alphabet said it would sell \$80bn-worth of stock—a rounding error for a company whose market value has soared to \$4.4trn.

追求超大规模投资的趋势，是全球商业环境中多种因素共同作用的结果。首先，尽管利率已从异常低的水平上升，但资本的可获得性依然充足。美国标准普尔 500 指数中的公司现金储备已达到 2.2 万亿美元。这些公司获得的收益也超过了以往任何时候。与 GDP 相比，美国的企业利润已接近历史最高水平。这一情况进一步推动了市场价值的

攀升，为企业的收购行为提供了更多机会，同时也使得企业有更大的空间来筹集更多的债务或股权。6月1日，Alphabet 宣布将出售价值 800 亿美元的股票——对于一家市值已飙升至 4.4 万亿美元的公司来说，这只是一个微不足道的数值而已。

Much of this cash is being used to fund the AI boom—the second factor behind the trend. Five hyperscalers—Alphabet, Amazon, Meta, Microsoft and Oracle—are expected to shell out perhaps \$800bn in capital expenditure this year as they race to erect data centres around the world. At the same time, they are among the biggest financial backers of AI startups. The AI boom has also encouraged a number of big corporate tie-ups, including the merger of [Dominion and NextEra](#), a pair of American power utilities, and the acquisition of CyberArk, a cyber-security company, by Palo Alto Networks, the market leader.

这些资金中的大部分被用于支持人工智能领域的发展——这是推动这一趋势的第二大因素。预计有五家大型科技公司——Alphabet、Amazon、Meta、Microsoft 和 Oracle——今年将投入约 8000 亿美元用于基础设施建设，以在全球范围内建立数据中心。同时，它们也是许多人工智能初创企业的最大融资支持者。人工智能领域的快速发展还促成了一些大型企业的合作，例如美国两家电力公用事业公司 Dominion 和 NextEra 的合并，以及市场领导者 Palo Alto Networks 收购网络安全公司 CyberArk 的事件。

The third factor behind the wave of giant capital flows is politics. In America, the current administration has proved far more relaxed than its predecessor about big mergers. The European Union, fearing that its corporate champions will be left behind, has also recently revised its merger guidelines to make tie-ups easier.

导致这一系列巨额资本流动出现的第三个因素是政治因素。在美国，现任政府在大型企业合并问题上表现得比前任政府要宽松得多。而欧盟则担心自己的企业巨头会被淘汰，因此最近也修改了合并指南，以简化企业间的合并流程。

Meanwhile, protectionist governments are pressing companies to reshore manufacturing with tariffs and subsidies. As a result, many big firms are spending huge sums on additional facilities overseas, such as the chip plants in Arizona constructed by TSMC, a Taiwanese semiconductor giant, or the new car factory in Hungary for BYD, a Chinese electric-vehicle colossus.

与此同时，保护主义政府通过征收关税和提供补贴来迫使企业将生产设施迁往海外。因此，许多大型企业在海外建设新的生产设施上投入了大量资金。例如，台湾半导体巨头 TSMC 在亚利桑那州建造了芯片工厂；而中国的电动汽车巨头比亚迪则在匈牙利新建了一家汽车工厂。

Technological change and political meddling have resulted in a more uncertain business environment, and bosses are increasingly concluding that [greater scale will offer greater safety](#)—a fourth factor behind the investment frenzy. “In a lot of boardrooms I have heard that it is better to be bigger,” says Jake Henry of McKinsey, a consultancy. Investors appear to agree. *The Economist* looked at non-financial American firms in the Russell 3000 index and split them into quintiles by market value. In 2019 the median price-to-earnings ratio (a measure of how highly investors value a company’s profits) for the largest quintile was 18, compared with 14 for the lowest. Today those figures are 26 and 15, suggesting that the market is valuing the profits of big firms more richly than in the past (see chart 4). The overall result is unchanged when technology firms are excluded.

技术变革和政治干预使得商业环境变得更加不确定。因此，企业领导者越来越认为，规模越大，安全性就越高——这便是推动投资热潮的第四个因素。麦肯锡公司的杰克·亨利表示：“在许多董事会中，人们都认为规模越大越好。”投资者似乎也持相同观点。《经济学人》对罗素 3000 指数中的非金融类美国公司进行了分析，并根据市值将它们分为五组。2019 年，最顶尖一组公司的市盈率（衡量投资者对公司利润价值的评估）为 18，而最底层一组则为 14。如今，这一数字分别

上升为 26 和 15，表明市场现在更重视大型公司的利润价值（参见图表 4）。如果排除科技行业的企业，整体情况则保持不变。

Companies' race to scale also poses risks, however. Academics reckon that the chance of a big merger paying off is no different from that of a smaller one (that is, roughly 50-50). Yet the consequences can be catastrophic when things go wrong. Bain, another consultancy, calculates that in almost half of mega-mergers last year the target's value was over 50% of the buyer's market capitalisation. Vast amounts of debt are often required.

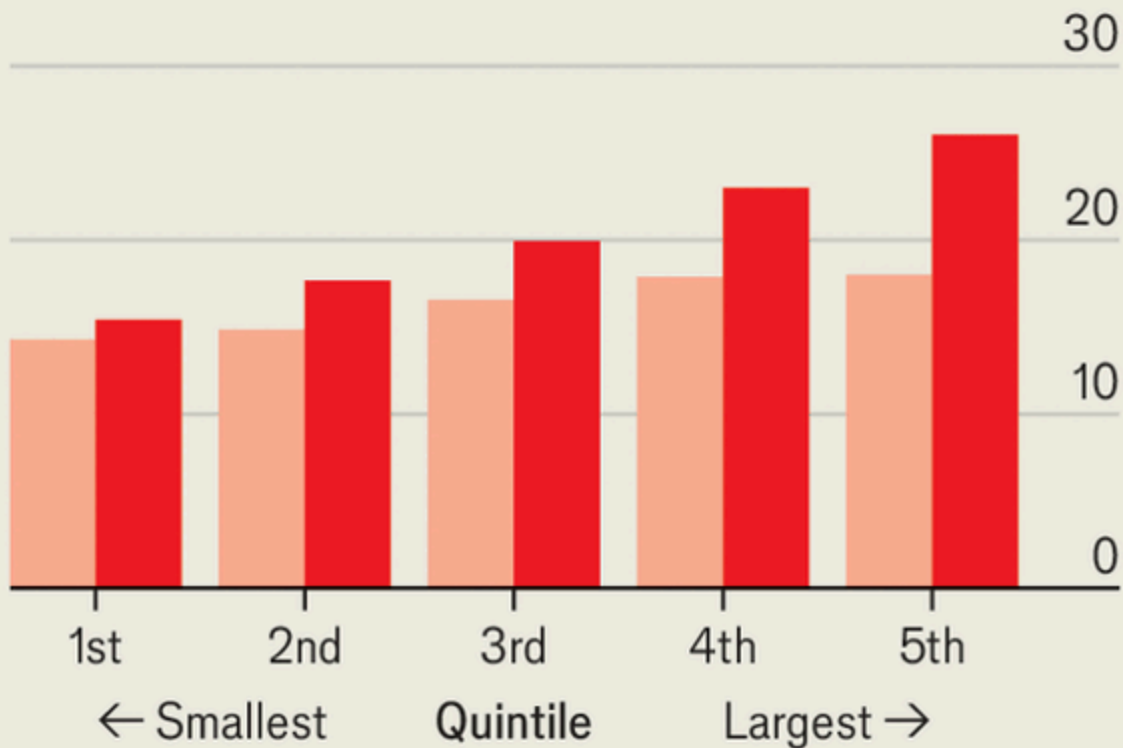
不过，企业追求规模扩张的同时也带来了风险。学者们认为，大型合并的成功几率与小型合并并无差异（大约各占 50%）。然而，当情况出现问题时，后果可能会非常严重。另一家咨询公司贝恩的计算显示，去年几乎有一半的大型合并案例中，被合并企业的价值超过了收购方的市值 50% 以上。在这种情况下，往往需要大量债务来支撑。

Winners take more

4

Russell 3000 non-financial companies,
price-earnings ratio by market value quintile

January 2019 July 2026



Sources: Bloomberg; *The Economist*

It is not only mega-mergers that are a cause for concern. Until recently the huge data-centre outlays by America's hyperscalers were mostly paid for with cash generated by their other businesses. Now they are borrowing heavily, causing a surge in the ratio of their debt to their annual free cashflow. Amazon's ratio has fallen from below that of the S&P 500 average in 2019 to more than four times

the average today.

不仅仅是大型合并行为令人担忧。直到最近，美国的几家大型科技公司仍然主要通过其其他业务的现金流来支付数据中心的建设成本。但现在，这些公司不得不大量借款，导致其债务与年度自由现金流的比例上升。亚马逊的该比例已经从 2019 年的低于标准普尔 500 指数的平均水平，上升到了现在的四倍多。

All this has ramifications for the wider economy. The top decile of listed firms by value now account for over three-quarters of total market capitalisation in America, the highest share in a century, according to Deutsche Bank. An increasingly top-heavy structure means that the failure of just one debt-laden corporate giant could cause significant disruption to financial markets.

这一切都影响着整个经济。根据德意志银行的数据，目前，市值最高的 10% 上市企业占据了美国总市值的四分之三以上，这一比例是有史以来最高的。这种高度集中于顶尖企业的结构意味着，只要有一家负债累累的大型企业倒闭，就可能对金融市场造成严重的冲击。

Growing corporate concentration may also prove malign in other ways. Consumers, employees and small suppliers could be squeezed and governments unduly swayed by the many lobbyists employed by corporate colossi. That could further fuel the rise of populists on both sides of the political spectrum. According to Gallup, a pollster, the share of Americans who say they trust big business has fallen roughly by half since 2000, to 15%. Scale may confer many advantages, but public adoration will not be one of them. ■

企业集中度越来越高，这可能会带来一些负面影响。消费者、员工和小供应商可能会受到挤压，而政府则可能会受到企业巨头们所雇佣的游说者的不当影响。这可能会进一步促进政治光谱两侧民粹主义者的崛起。根据民意调查机构盖洛普的数据，自 2000 年以来，认为信任大企业的美国人比例下降了一半，降至 15%。规模确实可以带来许多优势，但公众的崇拜并非其中之一。■

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Pac-Woman

太平洋女子队队员

Microsoft's gaming strategy has misfired badly

微软的游戏战略效果非常糟糕

A supply-chain crisis for Xbox couldn't have come at a worse time
对于 Xbox 来说，供应链危机的出现时机实在太糟糕了。

Jul 09, 2026 07:01 PM | LOS ANGELES

2026 年 7 月 9 日 下午 07:01 | 洛杉矶



Editor's note (July 10th): Fidji Simo has stepped down from her full-time role at OpenAI for health reasons.

编辑注（7 月 10 日）：由于个人原因，Fidji Simo 已辞去她在 OpenAI 的全职职位。

IT IS NOT yet the PayPal mafia, but the Instacart matriarchy is making its mark. Not long after Fidji Simo, ex-head of the online grocery store, became Sam Altman's product-focused sidekick at OpenAI, Asha Sharma, Instacart's former chief operating officer, became Satya Nadella's Ms Fix-it at Microsoft Gaming. Groceries are a tricky, low-margin business. So is Xbox—and Ms Sharma has wasted no time in getting to work. On July 6th, less than five months after becoming the division's boss, she launched what she called the biggest reset in its 25-year history.

虽然还称不上是 PayPal 黑帮，但 Instacart 的“女权主义统治”模式已经开始显现其影响。不久之后，前在线杂货店负责人 Fidji Simo 成为了 OpenAI 中专注于产品的副手 Sam Altman 的得力助手。而 Instacart 的前首席运营官 Asha Sharma 则被派往微软游戏部门，担任 Satya Nadella 的得力助手。杂货业务是一项复杂且利润率较低的业务。Xbox 也是如此——Asha Sharma 没有浪费时间，立即开始工作。在 7 月 6 日，也就是她成为该部门负责人不到五个月后，她宣布了该公司 25 年来最大的一次改革。

Ms Sharma has gone about her overhaul with a candour that is rare in the mealy-mouthed world of big tech. Declaring that Microsoft's gaming arm is “not healthy”, she announced that 3,200 employees would be axed over the next 12 months, and that up to five loss-making studios would be shed. Her diagnosis makes two things clear: first, Mr Nadella's gaming strategy has misfired badly; second, the entire console industry is in a supply-chain crisis. No hard-core gamer herself, the battles ahead will test Ms Sharma's mettle.

莎玛女士以一种在大型科技公司的保守世界里极为罕见的坦诚态度来推进她的改革工作。她指出，微软的游戏部门“并不健康”，并宣布在接下来的 12 个月内将裁掉 3,200 名员工，还有多达 5 个盈利状况不佳的游戏工作室将被关闭。她的分析表明两点：首先，纳德拉先生的游戏战略完全失败了；其次，整个游戏机行业都面临着供应链危机。

作为一名并非极端的游戏玩家，莎玛女士将不得不面对这些挑战，看看她的勇气能否经受住考验。

With Mr Nadella's attention focused on the artificial-intelligence boom in recent years, Xbox has suffered from neglect. Under previous management, it sought to reduce its reliance on the Xbox console and focus on its multi-platform subscription service, called Game Pass, intending to become the "Netflix of gaming". To fuel demand, Microsoft invested what insiders say was upwards of \$20bn on games and studios, in addition to the \$70bn-plus it spent buying Activision Blizzard, maker of "Call of Duty", in 2023.

由于纳德拉先生将注意力集中在近年来人工智能领域的快速发展上，Xbox 则受到了忽视。在之前的管理层领导下，Xbox 试图减少对 Xbox 主机的依赖，转而专注于其多平台订阅服务——游戏通行证，目标是成为“游戏界的 Netflix”。为了刺激需求，微软在游戏和工作室方面投入了约 200 亿美元，据内部人士透露，此外，微软还在 2023 年以超过 700 亿美元的价格收购了《使命召唤》的开发商动视暴雪。

Alas, Game Pass, which was meant to have 77m members this year, has fewer than 30m. Meanwhile, the multi-platform approach has undermined Microsoft's own console business by making content available on other platforms, such as Sony's PlayStation, which kept its own games off Xbox. Microsoft's quarterly gaming revenue has been in decline since last autumn. Xbox's operating margins are a meagre 3%. It has been losing market share to Nintendo, another console-maker. Bureaucracy has ballooned; in parts of the company, Ms Sharma says, work passes through 14 layers of management. Just like a real-life Pac-Woman, she intends to chomp those down to as few as three.

唉，原本预计今年《游戏通行证》的会员数量能达到 7700 万，但实际上现在的会员数量还不到 3000 万。与此同时，这种跨平台的发展模式反而削弱了微软自己的游戏机业务，因为内容可以在其他平台上获得，比如索尼的 PlayStation，它们自己的游戏并没有在 Xbox 上发布。自去年秋季以来，微软的游戏收入一直在下降。Xbox 的运营利润

率仅为 3%。它正在失去市场份额，因为竞争对手任天堂也是一家游戏机制造商。公司的官僚体系也变得过于复杂；据 Sharma 女士说，在公司的某些部门，决策要经过 14 层管理层才能最终确定。她希望能把这些层级减少到最少，就像现实生活中的“Pac-Woman”一样。

Her strategy is bold. The year of lay-offs will be the biggest in Xbox's history. Her disposal of studios will end Microsoft's attempt to Hoover up indie game-developers. Yet it is not all cost-cutting. Insiders say Ms Sharma intends to invest in "Minecraft", a hit game that was used as a cash cow rather than a growth engine and has lost significant ground to Roblox, a stable of games that competes for youngsters' attention. She also plans to double down on mobile gaming using untapped expertise in King, creator of "Candy Crush", which was bought with Activision.

她的策略非常大胆。裁员潮将成为 Xbox 历史上最严重的一次。她对这些工作室的整合，将终结微软试图收购独立游戏开发者的努力。不过，这并非完全是削减成本的做法。业内人士表示，莎尔玛女士打算投资《我的世界》这款热门游戏。这款游戏过去被当作摇钱树，而非推动公司发展的引擎，现在已远远落后于 Roblox 这类能够吸引年轻玩家的游戏。她还计划利用收购了 Activision 的 King 公司尚未开发的专长，在移动游戏领域加大投入。

The trickiest part will be rescuing the console. When Ms Sharma took over in February she promised "the return of Xbox". Sales of gaming hardware have long been in decline, but insiders say Ms Sharma considers Xbox users to be her core customers, spending far more on games and services than PC players.

最棘手的部分就是如何拯救这台游戏机。在 2 月份接任职位时，莎尔玛女士承诺会“让 Xbox 重新焕发生机”。虽然游戏硬件的销量一直处于下降趋势，但业内人士表示，莎尔玛女士认为 Xbox 的用户是她的核心客户，这些用户在购买游戏和服务方面的支出远高于 PC 玩家。

Yet as Ms Sharma tries to win them back, the ground is moving under her feet. When she took control of the business, AI-related

demand for memory chips and other components had already caused costs to surge across the consumer-electronics industry. Within her first 50 days, input costs rose by 50%, a source at the company says. All three console-makers have been forced to announce price increases at a time when growth in the industry (excluding China) is sluggish.

然而，当夏尔玛女士试图重新赢得他们的支持时，实际情况却正在发生变化。当她接管这家公司时，人工智能相关领域对内存芯片及其他组件的需求已经导致整个消费电子行业的成本飙升。据该公司内部消息，在她的 50 天任期内，原材料成本上升了 50%。在这段时间里，三家游戏机制造商都不得不宣布提价，而此时整个行业（不包括中国）的增长情况并不乐观。

The component crunch will have long-term consequences. Microsoft had hoped to increase production of consoles to support the eagerly awaited release of the latest version of "Grand Theft Auto", made by Take-Two, a listed studio, which is rumoured to have cost a staggering \$2bn to develop. The supply constraints will make it harder to increase production of consoles to meet the expected demand.

这种短缺现象将产生长期的影响。微软希望增加游戏机的产量，以支撑由 Take-Two 公司开发的《侠盗猎车手》最新版本的发布——据传这款游戏的开发成本高达 20 亿美元。但生产能力的限制会使得增加游戏机产量以满足预期需求变得更加困难。

In 2028 both Microsoft and Sony are expected to launch the next generation of devices, which could also be hampered by the supply-chain chaos. Piers Harding-Rolls of Ampere Analysis, a consultancy, says Microsoft may be hit harder, because Sony, as a consumer-electronics company, has stronger relationships with suppliers. On July 1st Sony said it would stop selling physical discs in 2028, a decision that Mr Harding-Rolls says was long in gestation but might

help offset rising costs.

在 2028 年，微软和索尼都预计会推出下一代设备。不过，这一进程可能会受到供应链混乱的影响。咨询公司 Ampere Analysis 的 Piers Harding-Rolls 指出，微软可能会受到更大的影响，因为作为消费电子公司的索尼，与供应商的关系更为紧密。7 月 1 日，索尼宣布将在 2028 年停止销售物理光盘。Harding-Rolls 认为，这一决定虽然酝酿已久，但或许有助于缓解成本上升的问题。

Some think Microsoft's best response to both the strategic blunders and the hardware crisis would be to spin off the gaming business. Gil Luria of D.A. Davidson, an investment firm, reckons that the lumpiness of revenue as a result of seven-year console cycles is better suited to private-equity investors than to public ones.

有些人认为，微软应对战略失误和硬件危机的最佳方式是将游戏业务分离出来独立运营。投资公司 D.A. Davidson 的 Gil Luria 认为，由于七年一次的游戏机更新周期导致的收入波动，更适合由私人资本投资者来掌控，而不是由公众投资者来操作。

There are still rich seams of potential growth within Xbox that Ms Sharma will hope to mine before a final decision about its future is made. But as Ben Thompson of Stratechery, a popular newsletter, puts it, "Sometimes it's Game Over." ■

Xbox 仍然蕴含着巨大的增长潜力，莎尔玛女士希望能在最终决定其未来发展方向之前，发掘出这些潜力。不过，正如《Stratechery》这份热门新闻通讯的作者本·汤普森所说：“有时候，一切都结束了。” ■

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Breaking the cycle

打破循环

Could a Chinese bike win the Tour de France?

一位中国骑手能赢得环法自行车赛吗？

The country's manufacturers hope that high-performance models will improve their image

该国的制造商们希望，高性能的型号能够提升他们的形象。

Jul 09, 2026 05:22 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:22



CHINESE CYCLING enthusiasts casting their eyes over the start-line of the Tour de France in Barcelona on July 4th would surely have felt disappointed. In 2014, Ji Cheng, the first from China to compete in the race, collected the questionable distinction of the *lanterne rouge*, awarded for last place. China has not returned to the Tour since. Even so, the country is playing an increasingly important role in the sport.

在 7 月 4 日于巴塞罗那举行的环法自行车赛起跑线上，那些对中国自行车运动充满热情的人们肯定会感到失望。2014 年，首位参加这项赛事的中国选手季成获得了“最后一名荣誉奖”，这一荣誉其实相当可疑。自那以后，中国就再也没有参加过环法自行车赛。不过，中国在这项运动中的影响力正在逐渐增强。

Roughly 60% of the world's bikes are made in China. Yet although it supplies parts for many Western brands, including premium ones such as Pinarello, its own models have frequently been dismissed as low quality. That may soon change. In recent years Chinese companies have been launching their own high-performance bikes, which cost around 40% less than models with similar specifications from the incumbents.

全球大约 60% 的自行车产自中国。尽管中国为许多西方品牌提供零部件供应，包括一些高端品牌如 Pinarello，但中国的自行车产品往往被认定为低品质产品。不过这种情况可能很快就会改变。近年来，中国公司开始推出自己的高性能自行车，这些产品的价格比国外品牌同类产品低约 40%。

Chinese bikes appeared in last year's Tour de France for the first time, with Kazakhstan's team riding models from x-Lab, a division of XDS, a Chinese carbon-fibre manufacturing giant (and the team's new title sponsor). "A Chinese bike has won the Tour de France many times," argues Patrick Pan of x-Lab, just not under a Chinese brand. Quick Pro, a competitor, made its World Tour debut in March this year. Pardus, ridden by the Chinese team at the Paris Olympics,

announced in May that it was expanding into Europe.

去年，中国制造的自行车首次出现在环法自行车赛中。参赛的队伍使用的是 X-Lab 品牌的自行车，而 X-Lab 是 XDS 公司的子公司，XDS 是一家中国碳纤维制造巨头（同时也是该队伍的新冠名赞助商）。X-Lab 的帕特里克·潘表示：“有多次中国制造的自行车赢得了环法自行车赛，只不过这次是采用中国品牌的产品。竞争对手 Quick Pro 在今年三月首次亮相环法自行车赛。而参加巴黎奥运会的中国队所骑的 Pardus 自行车品牌也在 5 月份宣布将扩展到欧洲市场。”

The ultimate prize is the consumer market. Accordingly, these brands are establishing a retail presence abroad. x-Lab has signed with around 300 dealers in America since its launch there in April. The growth of Panda Podium, an e-commerce site for Chinese bikes and parts, also helps. And many brands are building direct-to-consumer channels.

最终的胜利在于消费者市场。因此，这些品牌正在海外建立零售业务。自 4 月份在北美推出以来，X-Lab 已经与大约 300 家经销商建立了合作关系。而 Panda Podium 这一中国自行车及零部件的电子商务平台的快速发展也起到了推动作用。此外，许多品牌正在建立直接面向消费者的销售渠道。

Out-performing Western brands will not be easy. China is unlikely to collect many gongs from the Tour this year; Kazakhstan's team has already had a crash in the first stage. But as Chinese bikes become a more common sight in such tournaments, their credibility will grow. The wheels are in motion. ■

要超越西方的品牌并不容易。今年在环法自行车赛中，中国队不太可能取得好成绩；哈萨克斯坦队在第一阶段就已经遭遇了失败。不过，随着中国自行车队在类似比赛中越来越常见，他们的信誉也会逐渐提升。一切都在进行中。■

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Node by node

逐节点地

China's semiconductor industry is racing to catch the West's

中国的半导体产业正在努力追赶西方的先进水平。

But it is proving easier to design chips than to make them

不过，设计芯片似乎比制造它们要容易一些。

Jul 09, 2026 05:22 AM | TAIPEI

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:22 | 台北



WHEN LAST MONTH the chip industry's elite descended on Taipei for Computex, an annual trade show, two topics dominated discussions. The first was artificial intelligence, which has turned semiconductors into one of the world's most profitable industries. The second was China. Its chipmakers were absent from the event, but their shadow was long.

上个月，芯片行业的精英们齐聚台北参加一年一度的贸易展 Computex。在会议中，有两个话题占据了主要讨论焦点。第一个话题是人工智能，它已经使半导体行业成为全球最盈利的行业之一。第二个话题则是中国。虽然中国的芯片制造商并未参加此次活动，但他们的影响力却一直存在。

The fascination with China is easy to explain. A week before Computex, Huawei, the country's tech-hardware champion, unveiled a [technique that stacks layers of circuits onto a chip](#) to get better performance without relying on the latest Western manufacturing tools. Investors are also signalling confidence. The share prices of semiconductor firms on Hong Kong's stock market has risen by 140% over the past year, beating a comparable American index. Alibaba and Baidu, two Chinese internet giants, intend to spin off

their chip-design businesses. CXMT, a maker of memory chips, is preparing a public listing.

对中国的迷恋很容易解释。在 Computex 展会之前的一周，中国的科技硬件领先企业华为推出了一种技术，该技术通过将多层电路堆叠在芯片上，从而在无需依赖最新西方制造工具的情况下获得更好的性能。投资者的信心也有所体现。过去一年中，香港股市上的半导体公司股价上涨了 140%，这一涨幅超过了类似的美国指数。中国的两大互联网企业阿里巴巴和百度计划将他们的芯片设计业务分离出去。而一家内存芯片制造商 CXMT 则正在准备上市。

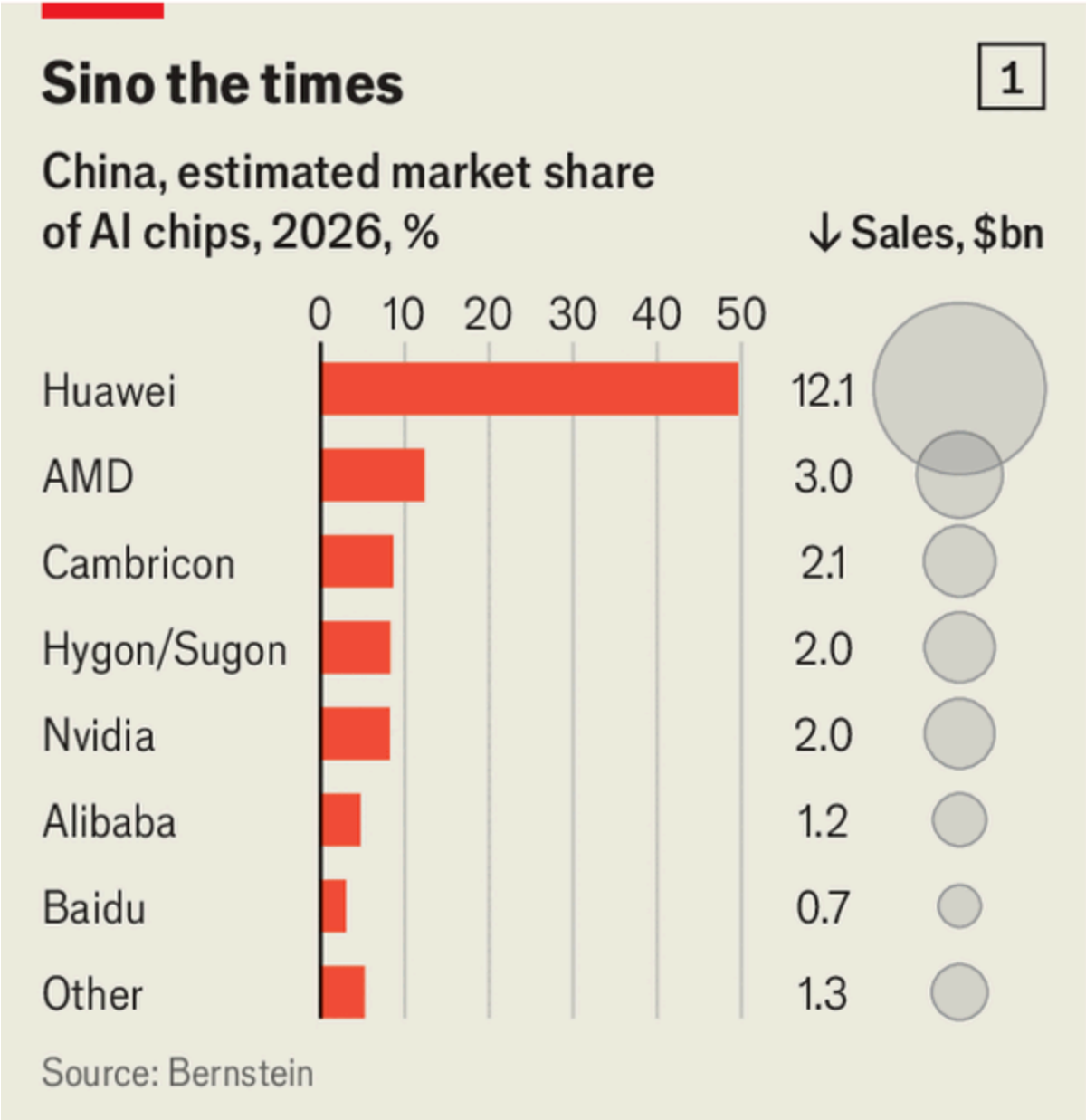
China's potential for self-sufficiency in chipmaking is one of the industry's biggest questions. The answer matters because "compute"—the processors and memory that train and run AI models—has become the [currency of technological power](#). At the end of 2025 China had only around one-seventh of the compute capacity of America. Closing the gap requires mastering two very different activities: designing chips and manufacturing them. China has made remarkable progress in the first. In the second, it has much further to go.

中国在芯片制造方面的自给能力是该行业最值得关注的问题之一。这个问题的答案非常重要，因为“计算能力”——即用于训练和运行人工智能模型的处理器和内存——已经成为了衡量技术实力的关键指标。到 2025 年底，中国的计算能力仅相当于美国的七分之一。要缩小这一差距，中国需要在设计和制造芯片这两方面取得显著进展。中国在设计芯片方面已经取得了显著成果，但在制造方面仍有很长的路要走。

China used to be miles behind in chip design. Until 2023 Nvidia, which dominates the market for AI chips, met around 90% of China's demand. Export controls changed that. Since America restricted sales of advanced chips to China in October 2022, Uncle Sam's policy has oscillated. But China's response has been steady: regulators have consistently steered domestic firms away from foreign chips,

even when they are legally obtainable.

中国在芯片设计领域曾经远远落后于其他国家。直到 2023 年，占据人工智能芯片市场主导地位的英伟达能够满足中国约 90% 的芯片需求。然而，随着 2022 年 10 月美国对先进芯片的出口限制政策的实施，美国的政策发生了变化。不过，中国的反应一直很稳定：监管机构一直引导国内企业避免使用外国芯片，即使这些芯片在法律上是可以获得的。



The result has been a protected home market. Alibaba and Baidu are designing processors in-house, while upstarts such as Cambricon have flourished with limited competition. Domestic designers are projected to capture around four-fifths of spending in China on AI chips this year (see chart 1). Qingyuan Lin of Bernstein, a broker, jokes that America has done more to strengthen China's semiconductor industry than the country's own government.

结果就是形成了一个受保护的国内市场。阿里巴巴和百度在内部设计处理器，而那些新兴企业如 Cambricon 则因为在竞争较少的情况下而得以蓬勃发展。预计今年，国内设计师将在中国 AI 芯片市场的投资中占据大约五分之四的份额（参见图表 1）。Bernstein 证券公司的 Qingyuan Lin 开玩笑说，美国的努力比中国政府本身对加强中国的半导体产业所做的贡献还要多。

China's market is big enough to sustain an industry. Local cloud giants are expected to spend more than \$400bn on AI infrastructure over the next three years, much of it on compute. The government is said to be planning another \$295bn of spending on data centres over five years.

中国的市场规模足够大，足以支撑一个完整的 AI 产业。预计在未来三年里，当地的云服务提供商将在 AI 基础设施上投入超过 4000 亿美元，其中大部分资金将用于计算方面的投入。此外，政府还计划在五年内再投入 295 亿美元用于数据中心的建设。

China has plenty of people with the right skills too. Many Chinese chip designers cut their teeth working for American firms like Nvidia and AMD. Kyle Chan of the Brookings Institution, a think-tank in Washington, argues that the pool is now deep enough for even small startups to recruit entire design teams.

中国同样拥有大量具备相关技能的人才。许多中国的芯片设计师是在为 Nvidia 和 AMD 等美国公司工作期间积累了经验。华盛顿的布鲁金斯学会研究员 Kyle Chan 认为，目前中国的相关人才储备已经足够丰富，即使是小型初创公司也能招聘到完整的设计团队。

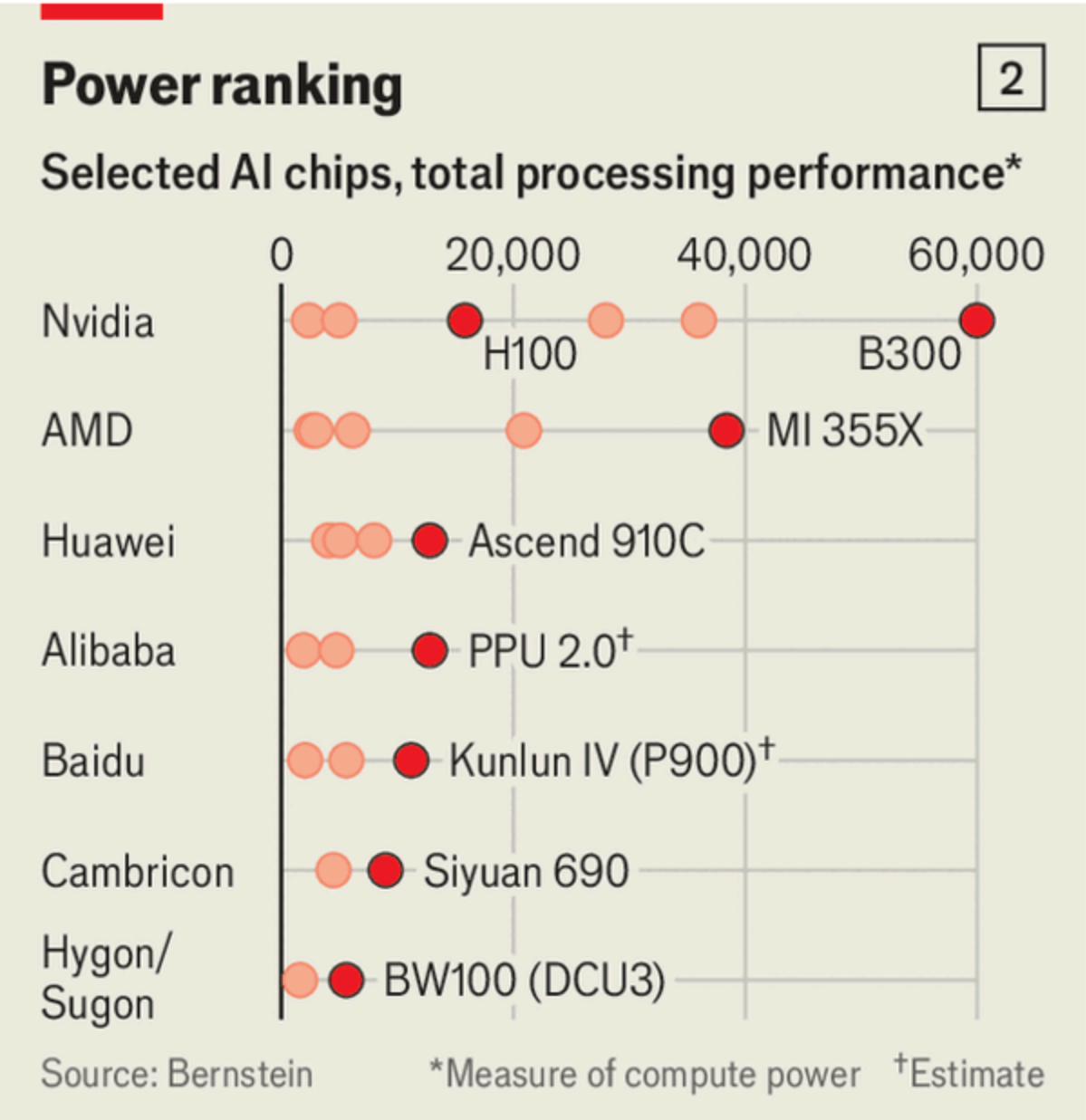
Talented designers are finding ways round sanctions. One approach is to use brute force. Huawei's CloudMatrix system links 384 of the company's Ascend processors to challenge Nvidia's latest AI systems (though it consumes four times as much power). Another is tighter integration of hardware and software. In April DeepSeek, a Chinese AI lab, released a large language model tuned to Huawei's silicon. Chinese designers are also embracing FP8, a lower-precision data format that helps models run efficiently on less powerful chips. Huawei is also working to undermine the advantage Nvidia enjoys from its widely used CUDA software. Its own platform, CANN, is designed to make switching from Nvidia's chips easier. The founder of one Chinese AI startup says that the software gap, once enormous, is starting to close.

有才华的设计者们正在寻找突破制裁限制的方法。其中一种方法是使用暴力计算技术。华为的 CloudMatrix 系统将 384 个 Ascend 处理器连接起来，以此来挑战 Nvidia 最新的 AI 系统（不过这种方法的能耗是后者的四倍）。另一种方法是实现硬件与软件的更紧密集成。今年 4 月，中国的 AI 实验室 DeepSeek 发布了一种针对华为芯片优化的语言模型。中国的设计师们还采用了 FP8 这种低精度数据格式，这有助于模型在性能较低的芯片上也能高效运行。华为也在努力打破 Nvidia 凭借其广受欢迎的 CUDA 软件所享有的优势。华为自家的 CANN 平台旨在简化从 Nvidia 芯片转向其他芯片的过程。一位中国 AI 初创公司的创始人表示，曾经巨大的软件差距现在正在逐渐缩小。

But such resourcefulness can take China only so far. Bernstein notes that Huawei's top chip, the Ascend 910c, delivers just four-fifths of the performance of Nvidia's H100, released almost four years ago. Homegrown chips compete mainly with the degraded processors Nvidia is allowed to sell in China (see chart 2). They are also mostly confined to "inference"—running existing models—rather than the far more demanding task of training frontier AI from scratch.

不过，这种巧妙的创新能力在中国所能发挥的作用还是有限的。伯恩斯坦指出，华为的顶级芯片 Ascend 910C 的性能仅为 Nvidia 的 H100 芯片的四分之五。Nvidia 的 H100 芯片是在近四年前推出的，其性能

远优于华为的 Ascend 910C。国产芯片主要与 Nvidia 在中国市场上销售的那些性能较差的处理器竞争（参见图表 2）。此外，国产芯片大多只能用于“推理”任务，即运行现有的模型，而要想从零开始训练先进的 AI 系统，则需要更复杂的处理能力。



The remaining gap is less in designing chips than in making them. The fastest processors require the most advanced production lines. Chinese designers are barred from using the latest processes from foundries such as TSMC, a Taiwanese contract manufacturer.

Domestic foundries, cut off from purchasing extreme-ultraviolet (EUV) lithography gear from ASML, a Dutch toolmaker, cannot reliably mass-produce chips with transistors less than seven nanometres across (the cutting edge is 3nm and below). Even for less advanced chips, capacity is constrained.

在芯片设计方面，与制造过程相比，剩余的差距要小得多。最快的处理器需要最先进的生产线来生产。中国的设计师无法使用像台积电这样的晶圆厂所提供的先进工艺，因为台积电是一家台湾的合约制造商。而国内的晶圆厂则无法从荷兰的 ASML 公司购买极紫外光刻设备，因此无法可靠地大规模生产晶体管直径小于 7 纳米的芯片（目前的最小要求是 3 纳米及以下）。即使是对于技术较为简单的芯片来说，产能也受到了限制。

Consequently, China's demand for AI processors far outstrips what it can procure. Zephyr, a pseudonymous analyst at Citrini, a research firm, notes that Chinese companies make up for the shortfall by renting cloud capacity abroad or by smuggling chips into the country. Advanced memory is another bottleneck. Almost all the high-bandwidth memory (HBM) needed for AI is made by three firms: Micron of America, and Samsung and SK Hynix of South Korea.

因此，中国对人工智能处理器的需求远远超过了其能够获得的供应量。Citrini 研究公司的匿名分析师 Zephyr 指出，中国公司通过向国外租赁云存储资源，或者走私芯片进入国内来弥补这一缺口。高级内存也是另一个瓶颈问题。几乎所有用于人工智能的高带宽内存，都是由三家公司生产的：美国的 Micron，以及韩国的 Samsung 和 SK Hynix。

China is spending heavily to catch up. Since 2019 annual imports of chipmaking kit have tripled, to \$39bn, accounting for some 40% of global demand. Much of this is to produce older chips, but some is being used for advanced fabrication. At the same time, local firms like Naura and AMEC now offer competitive alternatives for tools in critical steps like chemical deposition, etching and wafer cleaning. China is even making headway in HBMs. SemiAnalysis, a research

firm, expects CXMT's share of global HBM production to rise from almost nothing today to around 12% by 2028.

中国正在投入大量资金以追赶国际先进水平。自 2019 年以来，用于芯片制造的相关设备年进口额已增至 390 亿美元，占全球需求的约 40%。其中，大部分设备用于生产较旧的芯片，但也有一些设备被用于先进的制造工艺。与此同时，像 Naura 和 AMEC 这样的本土企业，正在为化学沉积、蚀刻和晶圆清洗等关键工序提供具有竞争力的解决方案。此外，中国在高性能内存市场方面也取得了进展。研究公司 SemiAnalysis 预计，到 2028 年，中国在高性能内存生产中的份额将从目前的几乎为零上升到约 12%。

For all the progress, however, China's self-sufficiency drive hits a wall with EUV lithography, essential for printing tiny circuits. Despite years of access to ASML's older deep-ultraviolet (DUV) machines, China has yet to produce a domestic equivalent. Most industry estimates put a Chinese-made EUV at around a decade away, though America's commerce department believes the country may have [obtained one machine illicitly](#).

尽管中国在技术进步方面取得了显著成果，但中国的自给自足战略在欧盟超紫外线光刻技术方面遇到了障碍。这项技术对于制造微型电路至关重要。尽管中国多年来一直能够使用 ASML 公司生产的较旧的深紫外线光刻设备，但至今仍未能够制造出与之相当的中国国产设备。大多数行业估计认为，中国要开发出属于自己的欧盟超紫外线光刻技术还需要大约十年时间。不过，美国商务部认为，中国可能已经非法获得了相关设备。

Without these advanced printers, Chinese chipmakers are pursuing workarounds to extract more performance from DUV machines. One is "multi-patterning", which repeatedly exposes a single silicon wafer to multiple passes of a lithography tool. This etches smaller features, but adds cost, slows production and increases the chance of defects. Another is advanced packaging, which links multiple chips made using older technology into a single system. Huawei's announcement before Computex signalled that the company was seeking to get

closer to leading-edge performance using older DUV tools.

如果没有这些先进的打印机，中国的芯片制造商们不得不寻找其他方法来提高超薄封装设备的性能。其中一种方法是“多图案刻蚀”，即让同一硅片反复经过多次光刻工具的加工。这种方法可以刻出更小的特征，但会增加成本、降低生产效率，还会增加缺陷产生的可能性。另一种方法是先进的封装技术，它将使用旧技术制造的多个芯片集成在一起，形成一个完整的系统。在 Computex 展前，华为的宣布表明，该公司正试图利用旧的超薄封装技术来实现更先进的性能。

Although China is still some distance from chipmaking's technological frontier, its progress should not be ignored. Consider Apple. Amid a worsening shortage of memory chips, the iPhone-maker is seeking permission from the American government to buy older-generation memory from CXMT. If it wins approval, an American business will be helping to bankroll the very industry its government has spent years trying to contain. ■

虽然中国在芯片制造技术方面距离前沿水平还有一定差距，但中国的进步不应被忽视。以苹果为例，由于内存芯片的短缺问题日益严重，苹果公司正在寻求美国政府许可，从 CXMT 公司购买更老一代的内存产品。如果获得批准，这家美国企业将能够资助这个政府多年来试图控制却始终无法成功的行业。

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Bartleby

巴特利比

The secret to good questions

提出好问题的秘诀

Consideration, consistency and curveballs

考虑因素、一致性以及那些出人意料的状况

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SOME PROFESSIONS are defined by questions. Detectives ask them, and suspects have the right not to answer them. A phrase like “I’m the one asking the questions” sounds appropriate when coming from

a journalist, and pretty weird from the lips of a plumber.

有些职业是由问题来定义的。侦探会提出这些问题，而嫌疑人则有权选择不回答这些问题。比如“我就是那个提问的人”这句话，如果是记者说出来听起来很合适，但如果是水管工说出这句话，那就显得很奇怪了。

But questions are crucial in every organisation. They sharpen thinking and extract information when things go wrong. They are central to forging relationships: according to research by Karen Huang of Georgetown University and her co-authors, people who ask more questions tend to be better liked. Questions are a crude way to measure career progression. As you get more senior, you spend less time doing the work and more time asking about it. By the time you reach the boardroom, your principal output is questions.

但在每个组织中，提问都是非常重要的环节。它有助于激发思考，并在出现问题时提取相关信息。提问也是建立人际关系的关键：根据乔治城大学凯伦·黄及其合作者的研究，喜欢提问的人往往更受他人喜爱。提问也是一种衡量职业发展的方式。随着职位升职，你用于执行工作的时间会减少，而用于提问的时间则会增加。当你们进入决策层时，你的主要工作就变成了提问了。

An absence of questions may indicate a culture that does not brook them. Even easy questions can be a warning sign. A paper by Elliott Ash of ETH Zurich and his co-authors trawls through interview reports posted to Glassdoor, a workplace-review site, and finds that candidates are more likely to turn down high-wage job offers when they rate the interview process undemanding. By analysing free-text posts about interviews, the researchers find that candidates view softball questions as a signal about the quality of future colleagues. Tough questions are not just a way for employers to screen for able candidates; the reverse also applies.

没有问题这一情况可能表明企业缺乏问题式沟通的文化。甚至简单的问题也可能是一个警示信号。苏黎世联邦理工学院的埃利奥特·阿什和他的同事们通过梳理 Glassdoor 上发布的招聘信息，发现当候选人认

为面试过程过于简单时，他们更有可能拒绝高薪工作机会。通过分析关于面试的匿名帖子，研究人员发现，候选人将简单的问题视为衡量未来同事素质的一个指标。严格的问题不仅被雇主用来筛选合适的候选人，反之亦然。

What makes a good question obviously depends on the context. The “five whys”, a succession of “why” questions that are meant to lead to the root cause of a problem, originated in Toyota and has spread from there. But what works well as an investigative technique in a specific environment is not going to help with forging relationships. (“Why were you absent yesterday?” “I was at a funeral.” “Why?” “What do you mean, why?”)

显然，一个好问题的关键在于其适用的情境。所谓的“五问法”，即一系列旨在探明问题根源的“为什么”问题，起源于丰田公司，并由此传播开来。不过，这种在特定环境中有效的调查方法，在建立人际关系方面却未必有效。（例如：“昨天你为什么没来？”“我参加了一场葬礼。”“为什么？”“你所说的‘为什么’是什么意思？”）

Still, some rules of thumb work across different settings. Paying attention to the answer is always a good idea. Lots of people ask questions in order to supply their own piece of information, a phenomenon christened “boomerasking” in a recent paper by Alison Wood Brooks of Harvard Business School and Michael Yeomans of Imperial College London.

不过，一些通用的规则在不同情况下仍然适用。注意回答的内容总是个好主意。很多人提问只是为了获取自己的信息，这种现象在哈佛商学院的艾莉森·伍德·布鲁克斯和伦敦帝国学院的迈克尔·耶奥曼撰写的一篇论文中被称为“信息轰炸”。

If you ask someone where they are going on holiday in order to tell them that you are heading to Bhutan for the trip of a lifetime, you are boomerasking. Unsurprisingly, it doesn't land well: the researchers find that questioners are seen as insincere if they are not interested in the other person's answer. (Some people don't even

bother with an interlocutor, conducting a Q&A session with themselves while others watch in puzzlement: “What kind of questions do I like? Rhetorical ones. Do I want anyone else to answer them? No. Do I struggle to make friends? Yes.”)

如果你问别人打算去哪里度假，然后告诉他们你要去不丹度过一次难忘的假期，这就是在故意为难对方。不出所料，这种问题并不受欢迎：研究人员发现，如果提问者并不关心对方的回答，那么就会让人觉得他们不真诚。（有些人甚至根本不找对象提问，而是自问自答；而其他人则一脸困惑地望着对方：“我喜欢什么样的问题呢？修辞性问题吧。我希望别人来回答这些问题吗？不。我在交朋友方面有困难吗？是的。”）

If you are making comparisons, the consistency of questions matters. Unstructured interviews make it harder to judge between candidates and easier for bias to creep in. Take, for example, the funding gap between male and female founders. Investors tend to ask different questions of entrepreneurs depending on their gender: men are more likely to be asked about their startups’ growth potential and women are more likely to be quizzed about risks. By systematising the evaluation framework used by an early-stage investment platform, Amisha Miller of New York University and her co-authors eliminated, and even reversed, investors’ preference for all-male teams over female-founded ones.

如果你要进行比较的话，那么问题设计的一致性就非常重要。非结构化的面试使得难以区分不同的候选人，同时也更容易出现偏见。例如，关于男性与女性创始人之间的资金差距问题，投资者通常会根据性别来提出不同的问题：男性更可能被问及他们的创业公司的增长潜力，而女性则更可能被问及风险方面的问题。通过系统化一个早期投资平台所使用的评估框架，纽约大学的阿米莎·米勒及其合作者们成功地消除了投资者对仅由男性组成的团队而非由女性组成的团队的偏好。

Yet asking the same bad question of everyone is not particularly useful. Another paper, by Nandil Bhatia and Wei Cai of Columbia

University and Sameer Srivastava of the University of California, Berkeley, identifies the ingredients of a good question. The authors trained a large language model to identify what they call “curveball” questions, which they define as questions that are difficult to predict, and therefore hard to prepare for, but also relevant to what has come before, and therefore tough to dodge.

然而，对每个人都提出同样的问题其实并没有什么用处。哥伦比亚大学的 Nandil Bhatia 和 Wei Cai，以及加州大学伯克利分校的 Sameer Srivastava 发表的一篇论文，提出了如何提出好问题的关键。作者们训练了一个大型语言模型来识别他们所说的“曲线球”问题——这类问题难以预测，因此很难做好准备应对；但同时，这类问题又与之前发生的事有关，因此也很难回避。

They then analysed earnings-call transcripts at listed American firms, and found that curveball questions from analysts were associated with larger share-price movements and rating changes, presumably because they were likelier to elicit new information than other questions. The researchers also found that star analysts and analysts who were new to covering the firm were more likely to ask curveballs. The stars can draw on expertise. The newbies are not yet immersed in conventional wisdom. Both lead to better questions. ■

随后，他们分析了美国上市公司的财报电话会议记录，发现分析师提出的意外问题与股价的较大波动以及评级的变动密切相关。这可能是因为这类问题更容易引发新的信息，而非其他类型的问题。研究人员还发现，那些经验丰富的分析师以及刚开始从事该公司分析工作的分析师，更有可能提出这类意外问题。经验丰富的分析师可以借助自己的专业知识，而新手则尚未完全掌握常规的分析方法。这两种情况都使得分析师能够提出更有效的提问方式。■

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Schumpeter

熊彼特

Elon Musk and the age of the corporate leviathan

埃隆·马斯克与企业的巨兽时代

For the world's largest companies, the normal rules of corporate governance no longer apply

对于全球最大的企业来说，传统的公司治理规则已不再适用了。

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IN 1989 Francis Fukuyama famously and prematurely wrote that the world was seeing “the total exhaustion of viable systematic alternatives to Western liberalism”. A decade later Henry Hansmann and Reinier Kraakman, two American law professors, made a similar argument about the way companies are run. The world was converging on a superior model of shareholder capitalism, they argued: firms subordinating the interests of capital to managers, workers and states would soon crumble like the Berlin Wall.

1989 年，弗朗西斯·福山预言性地指出，世界正在经历“所有可行的系统性替代方案都走向衰竭”，而这些替代方案原本可以取代西方自由主义。十年后，两位美国法学教授亨利·汉斯曼和雷尼尔·克拉科曼也提出了类似的观点，他们认为世界正朝着一种更先进的股东资本主义模式发展：那些将资本利益置于管理者、工人和国家的利益之上的企业，很快就会像柏林墙一样倒塌。

Like Mr Fukuyama’s work, “The End of History for Corporate Law” takes a beating every time liberal capitalism fails, as it did in 2008, or its elites announce that firms should serve all of society rather than just their shareholders, as they did most energetically around 2020. Yet the essay’s thesis has by and large proved correct. Governments in Europe and Asia have been endeavouring to make their corporate rules more “shareholder friendly” in the image of America. The ascent of private equity is but a vast exercise in imposing shareholder supremacy.

就像福山先生的文章《企业法的历史终结》一样，每当自由资本主义遭遇失败时，这篇文章也会受到冲击——比如在 2008 年，或者当企业的精英们宣布企业应该服务于整个社会而非仅仅股东利益时，这种情况在 2020 年左右尤为明显。不过，这篇文章的论点总体上是正确的。欧洲和亚洲的政府一直在努力使企业的规则更加“符合股东的利益”，这种努力其实是在模仿美国的做法。私募股权行业的崛起，本质上就是一种强制推行股东至上主义的行为。

Look to the giants of the corporate world, however, and the picture is very different. Above a certain size the ordinary rules of

governance apparently cease to apply. Some firms reach a kind of escape velocity where the disciplining force of finance becomes too weak and the stakes for governments too high for ordinary rules. Among their ranks can be spotted not one stable vision of what companies are for, but four warring ones.

然而，当目光转向企业界的巨头们时，情况就大不相同了。当企业规模达到一定规模之后，传统的治理规则显然不再适用。有些企业达到了一种“逃逸速度”，此时金融市场的约束力量变得过于微弱，而政府面临的挑战则过于严峻，以至于普通规则已经无法发挥作用。在这些企业中，我们看不到对企业本质的明确认识，反而能看到四种截然不同的观念在相互争斗。

Of the 16 listed firms worth more than \$1trn, seven are shareholder fundamentalists. None of Nvidia, Apple, Microsoft, Amazon, Broadcom, Eli Lilly or Micron is beholden to a government owner, though they put plenty of effort into staying in Uncle Sam's good books. With a median age of 50, none bar Nvidia is run by its founder, and Jensen Huang owns only a small stake in the chipmaker. None has an elaborate statement of corporate purpose, since they are mostly content making heaps of money. All are American. Their adventures abroad are often held up as examples of the profit motive pushed too far. Eli Lilly pays much of its tax in Ireland. Apple has helped cement China's dominance in manufacturing, while Nvidia has helped it remain in the artificial-intelligence race.

在 16 家市值超过 1 万亿美元的公司中，有 7 家是纯粹的股东主义企业。除了英伟达、苹果、微软、亚马逊、博通、埃利利公司以及美光科技之外，没有其他公司的所有者是政府官员。不过，这些公司都努力让自己的业绩看起来对美国政府有利。这些公司的平均年龄都在 50 岁左右，除了英伟达外，其他公司的所有者都只是公司的创始人而已。Jensen Huang 在这家芯片制造公司的股份也非常少。这些公司都没有详细阐述自己的企业使命，因为它们主要专注于赚取巨额利润。所有这些公司都是美国的公司。它们在海外的的发展往往被视作利润驱动过度行为的例子。埃利利公司在爱尔兰缴纳了大部分税款。苹果帮

助中国巩固了在制造业领域的优势地位，而英伟达则帮助中国保持在人工智能领域的领先地位。

Next are the corporate paternalists, who believe that the problem with shareholder democracy is that its voters do not know what is best for them. Berkshire Hathaway's shareholders submit to Warren Buffett, the conglomerate's super-voting patriarch, because they believe he is a better judge of how to use (or, more recently, not use) their cash. Google, too, is controlled by largely benign founders. Shareholders of Meta suffer rather than celebrate Mark Zuckerberg's iron grip on the firm. Little else could explain the vast amounts of cash it wasted on the metaverse, or its creepy camera glasses. (Snap, a much smaller social-media firm, also makes specs, and is controlled by its founders too.)

接下来是那些企业家长父式的领导者，他们认为 shareholder democracy 的问题在于，公司的股东们并不清楚什么才是对他们最有利的东西。伯克希尔·哈撒韦的股东们服从于沃伦·巴菲特这位集团的“超级统治者”，因为他们相信他更懂得如何运用（或者，更确切地说，如何不使用）他们的资金。谷歌也是如此，它同样由一些较为温和的创始人掌控着。Meta 的股东们似乎更愿意忍受马克·扎克伯格对公司的严格控制，而不是为此感到高兴。除此之外，很难找到其他理由来解释为什么谷歌会花费大量资金在“元宇宙”上，或者购买那些奇怪的摄像头设备。（Snap 是一家规模较小的社交媒体公司，它也由创始人掌控着。）

Meta and Google, which are constrained only by solvency, are competing to out-spend Microsoft and Amazon, which must ultimately appease all shareholders. Much of the capital is flowing to SK Hynix and Samsung, two South Korean chipmakers which recently joined the trillion-dollar club and make up the remaining paternalists. Their sudden and enormous success has led to a sudden and frantic debate about who is owed what. (In America this debate remains theoretical, because the profits mostly are.) Workers have extracted massive concessions, in the form of bonuses, by threatening to go on strike. Politicians have dreamed about what handouts could be

funded by the firms' profits. The domestic scramble to buy shares in the firms, often with borrowed money, has caused something like a moral panic.

Meta 和 Google 这些公司仅受财务能力的限制，正在竞相超越微软和亚马逊。这两家公司最终必须安抚所有股东的情绪。大量资金流向了 SK 海力士和三星这两家韩国芯片制造商，它们最近加入了万亿美元俱乐部，成为了剩下的“家长式统治”力量。它们突如其来的巨大成功引发了一场关于谁应获得多少回报的激烈争论。（在美国，这种争论仍然停留在理论层面，因为大部分利润都归企业所有。）工人们通过威胁罢工来迫使企业给予丰厚的奖金。政客们则梦想着这些公司利润能用来资助哪些项目。国内民众为了购买这些公司的股票而争先恐后，常常需要借贷资金，这引发了一种道德恐慌。

The South Korean chipmakers also have much in common with TSMC and Saudi Aramco, the national champions that constitute the third corporate tribe. Any firm worth more than \$1trn is strategically important. But this pair represent the totality of their home nations' geopolitical significance. To most world leaders, Taiwan is a chip factory and Saudi Arabia an oilfield.

韩国的芯片制造商与台积电以及沙特阿美公司有着许多共同点。这两家公司都是各自国家的企业巨头，构成了第三大企业群体。任何市值超过 1 万亿美元的公司都具有战略上的重要性。而这两家公司则代表了其所在国家在地缘政治上的重要地位。对大多数世界领导人来说，台湾就像一家芯片工厂，而沙特阿拉伯则像一座石油矿场。

The final pair presents the strongest argument against the end of corporate history. SpaceX and Tesla, the rocket and car businesses run by Elon Musk, are governance inventions of a Hobbesian design: individual shareholders consent to hand over all of their rights to the world's richest man, who then governs as he sees fit. Its boss sees profit as a means to visiting Mars, instead of a worthy end in itself. SpaceX shareholders' votes count for nothing. The firm makes it hard for them to sue. And for many it is hard to sell: the early inclusion of SpaceX's shares in major indices means most investors

are passive supporters of Mr Musk's enterprise, whether they want to be or not.

最后这一对企业代表了最有力的反对企业历史终结的论据。由埃隆·马斯克经营的 SpaceX 和 Tesla，这两家以火箭和汽车为主的公司，其实都是遵循霍布斯式治理模式而创立的企业。股东们同意将所有的权利交给世界上最富有的人，然后由他按照自己的意愿来管理公司。在这些公司的领导下，利润被当作实现目标的手段，而并非一种值得追求的目标。SpaceX 的股东投票毫无意义，这家公司甚至让股东们难以提起诉讼。对于许多投资者来说，出售股票也变得困难：由于 SpaceX 的股票被纳入了主要指数，因此大多数投资者都成了马斯克企业的被动支持者，无论他们是否愿意如此。

Almost nothing about Mr Musk's corporate empire can be understood in the language of shareholder capitalism. That leads to discordant results when the analysts who speak it are required to express a view. This week Wall Street banks released their initial reports on SpaceX. "Not [free cashflow] positive on our forecasts before 2035, requiring, on average, \$84bn of external capital needs per year from 2027-2034," wrote Morgan Stanley, before saying the firm should be worth twice as much as it already is.

关于马斯克的企业帝国，几乎没有任何事情可以用股东资本主义的视角来理解。当那些使用这种分析方法的分析师需要表达他们的观点时，结果往往并不一致。本周，华尔街的银行发布了关于 SpaceX 的初步报告。摩根士丹利指出，在 2035 年之前，公司的自由现金流并不乐观，因此从 2027 年到 2034 年，公司每年需要约 840 亿美元的外部资本支持。摩根士丹利还认为，公司的价值应该达到目前的两倍。

This is the end. My only friend, the end

这就是终点了。我唯一的朋友，终点了。

Soon the ranks of giant public companies will grow. With which tribe are OpenAI and Anthropic likely to identify? Certainly not the

fundamentalists. Both have a paternalistic strain and have supported redistribution, which makes the South Korean firms potential models. Yet they have none of their profits. Maybe the pair will become national champions, giving away a stake to the government, as OpenAI has reportedly floated. Or maybe the allure of absolute Hobbesian power will prove too great. ■

很快，那些大型公共公司的行列就会越来越长。那么，OpenAI 和 Anthropic 可能会归属于哪个阵营呢？显然不会是那些极端保守派。这两家公司都带有家长式的作风，并且支持再分配政策，这使得它们成为韩国公司的潜在榜样。不过，这两家公司都没有自己的利润。也许，它们会成为国家冠军，把股份分给政府，正如 OpenAI 所宣称的那样。或者，极权的权力诱惑可能会让它们难以抗拒。■

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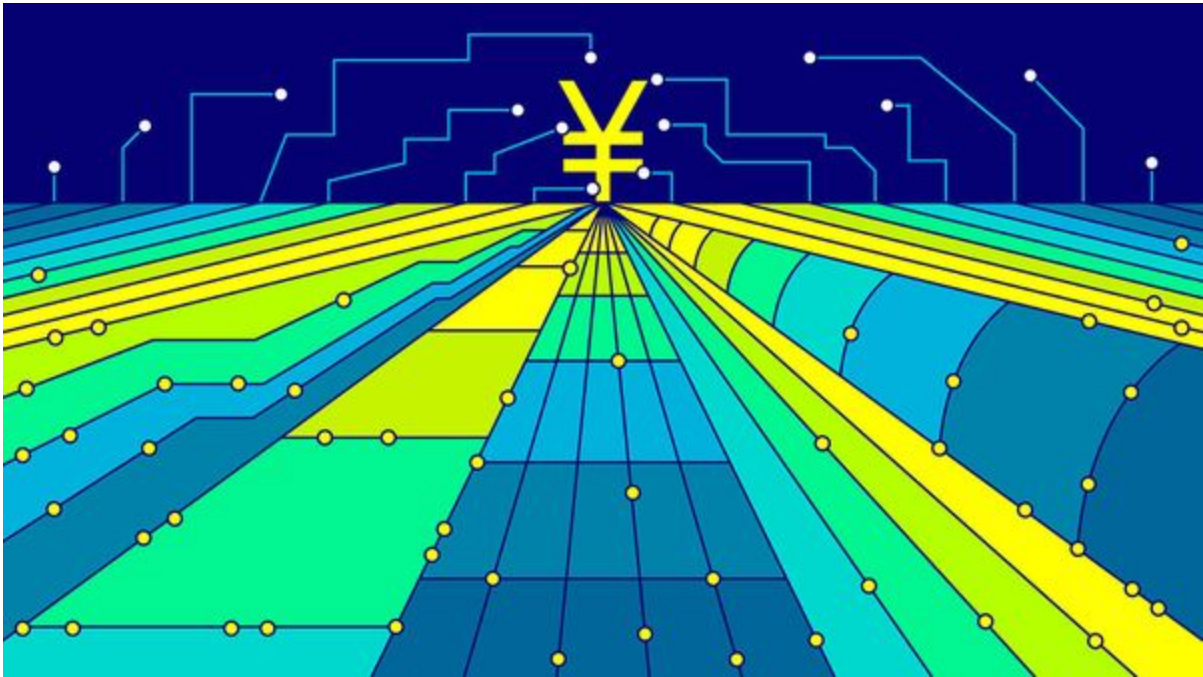
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Even though capital markets are staging a comeback

尽管资本市场正在复苏。

Jul 09, 2026 08:40 AM | Shanghai

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 08:40 | 上海



CHINA'S LEADERS rarely namecheck individual companies. It is rarer still for them to talk up a group's valuation while it prepares a highly anticipated initial public offering (IPO). That did not stop Li Qiang, the country's premier, from recently mentioning Unitree, a robotics firm, and the explosion in its valuation from 10m yuan to 42bn yuan (\$6bn) in a decade.

中国的领导人很少提及具体的公司。在一家公司准备进行备受期待的首次公开募股时，他们更不会夸赞该公司的估值。不过，这种情况并没有阻止中国总理李强最近提到 Unitree 这家机器人公司。在十年时间里，Unitree 的估值从 1000 万人民币增长到了 420 亿元人民币（约 60 亿美元）。

Unitree, which on July 2nd received approval to list, is just one of thousands of companies behind the Communist Party's plan to take the lead in a long list of frontier technologies over the next decade, from artificial intelligence and humanoid robots to fusion power and digital brain implants. The businesses behind these technologies now need copious amounts of capital to make them work at scale.

China's AI data centres alone will cost 2trn yuan over the next five years. Robotics and high-end manufacturing could require a similar amount over the next ten. As America's stock market welcomes one mega-IPO after another and its bond market [catches 'AI fever'](#), can China's punier capital markets keep pace—and live up to the party's ambitions?

Unitree 在 7 月 2 日获得了上市批准，这只是成千上万致力于实现共产党在未来十年内在前沿技术领域的领先计划的公司之一。这些技术的范围包括人工智能、类人机器人、聚变能源以及数字脑植入物等。这些技术背后的企业现在需要大量的资金来大规模实施这些项目。仅中国的 AI 数据中心在未来五年内就将耗资 2 万亿元人民币。而机器人技术和高端制造领域在未来十年内所需的资金数额也可能相当可观。当美国的股市不断迎来新的大型 IPO 项目，而其债券市场也陷入对 AI 技术的狂热追捧之际，中国的资本市场能否跟上步伐，实现党的宏伟目标呢？

Part of China's technology bill will be footed by established companies' reinvested profits and by China's state-directed banking system. But public and private equity investors will need to pick up a chunk of the tab. To nudge them along, in the past two years Xi Jinping, Mr Li's paramount boss, has eased an earlier crackdown on tech and "disorderly" investing. He has also made it clearer where he wants capital to flow.

中国的科技投资资金将主要由一些知名企业的再投资利润以及中国的国有银行系统提供。不过，公共和私人投资者也需要承担一部分费用。为了鼓励他们参与投资，习近平在过去两年里放松了对科技领域以及“无序”投资的限制。他还明确了资本应该流向哪些领域。

As a result, the first five months of 2026 saw the launch of over 9,500 new equity funds, half as many again as in the same period last year. Much of this activity has been driven by venture-capital funds set up by large corporations, both private and state-owned. At the end of 2025 state-directed funds raised 230bn yuan in new capital to invest in tech, up from 11bn yuan a year earlier. Slow credit growth in a slowing economy has freed up banks to lend more to private investors.

因此，在 2026 年的前五个月，共有超过 9,500 只新的股权基金被推出。这一数字是去年同期的两倍。这些基金的设立主要是由大型私营企业和国有企业所成立的风险投资基金推动的。到 2025 年底，国有基金为科技领域的投资筹集了 2300 亿元人民币的新资本，而去年同期这一数字仅为 110 亿元人民币。在经济增长放缓的情况下，缓慢的信贷增长使得银行能够向私人投资者提供更多的贷款。

DeepSeek, China's hottest AI startup, is said to be raising capital at a valuation of nearly \$60bn from Tencent, a digital titan, and CATL, the world's largest battery-maker. Unitree owes its soaring valuation to similar investments. Hurun, a consultancy, counted at least 80 startups surpassing \$1bn in value in the first half of the year, up

from 22 in the whole of 2025.

中国最热门的人工智能初创公司 DeepSeek 据说正在以近 600 亿美元的价值从数字巨头腾讯和全球最大的电池制造商 CATL 那里筹集资金。小鹏汽车的飙升市值也是得益于类似的投资。咨询公司 Hurun 统计显示，今年上半年至少有 80 家初创公司的估值超过了 10 亿美元，而 2025 年全年这一数字仅为 22 家。



Public markets are astir, too, after a period when officials hit the brakes, fearful that IPOs sucked capital away from other stocks in a sagging market. Chinese firms have raised around \$32bn this year, double the comparable figure for 2025 and triple that for 2024 (see chart). Big deals are back. CXMT, a maker of memory chips, is eyeing a \$4.3bn listing, one of the biggest in recent years. Another ten tech firms are planning multibillion-yuan flotations. Shanghai's tech-heavy STAR market, which had barred profitless startups from listing in 2024 and 2025, has let them back in. Unitree got its IPO approved in 100 days, not the year or more it used to take.

在官员们出于对 IPO 在低迷市场中会消耗资本风险的担忧而采取保守态度的时期之后，公开市场也重新活跃起来。今年，中国公司共筹集了约 320 亿美元的资金，是 2025 年的两倍，是 2024 年的三倍（参见图表）。大型融资活动再次兴起。例如，生产内存芯片的 CXMT 公司计划进行 43 亿美元的上市交易，这将是近年来规模最大的上市之一。还有十家科技公司计划进行数十亿人民币级别的融资。上海科技板块的 STAR 市场曾在 2024 年和 2025 年禁止无盈利初创企业上市，但现在允许这些企业再次上市。宇龙智通的 IPO 在 100 天内就获得了批准，而传统做法通常需要一年甚至更长时间。

Insiders welcome the revival of Chinese capital markets. But some also remember the early days of Chinese capitalism in the 1990s, when these served chiefly to funnel money to state firms rather than seek rich returns. Now it is often state firms funnelling capital to startups. SMIC, a state-owned chipmaker, has launched a fund that now owns stakes in more than 400 semiconductor firms. When private companies get involved, they often team up with the state. Xiaomi, which now makes electric cars as well as smartphones, has created a fund with the local government of Hubei province that has made more than 100 investments.

业内人士对中国资本市场的复兴表示欢迎。不过，也有人回忆起 20 世纪 90 年代中国资本主义的初期情景——当时资本市场主要被用于向国有企业输送资金，而非追求高回报。如今，往往是国有企业向初创企业提供资本支持。国有芯片制造商 SMIC 就成立了一个基金，目前

该基金已持有 400 多家半导体企业的股份。当私人企业参与进来时，它们通常会与国有企业合作。比如小米公司，如今不仅生产智能手机，还生产电动汽车。小米与湖北省政府合作，成立了一个基金，已进行了 100 多次投资。

For the asset managers who receive the state's capital, and its private co-investors, government involvement comes with strings. The money must go to companies that fit in with the party's tech plans. Many are not particularly innovative; some may be working on problems solved years ago in other countries. Bank-backed investment firms, for example, rarely invest in startups younger than five years, preferring companies that had already received some sort of government recognition, according to a review of such deals by Gavekal, a consultancy. That could mean limited upside.

对于那些获得政府资本支持的资产管理公司以及私人投资者来说，政府的干预附带了某些条件。这些资金必须投入到符合该政党科技规划的企业中。不过，这些企业往往并不具有创新性；有些企业可能正在解决的是其他国家多年前就已经解决过的问题。根据咨询公司 Gavekal 对这类投资项目的分析，由银行支持的投资公司很少投资于成立时间不足五年的初创企业，而是更倾向于那些已经获得政府认可的企业。这意味着这些投资的机会可能有限。

At the same time, straying from favoured sectors has big downsides. Less state capital dampens valuations. A lack of state backers may also make it harder to get IPOs approved, even as SMIC's fund, for example, has listed at least 48 portfolio companies and is preparing to float another 50. Regulators are reserving listing privileges almost exclusively for top hardware makers, such as Unitree, and for those that, like CXMT, are helping the country break away from reliance on foreign tech.

同时，远离那些受青睐的行业也有很大的弊端。较少的国家资本投入会削弱企业的估值。缺乏国家支持也可能使得 IPO 审批变得更加困难。例如，SMIC 已经帮助至少 48 家子公司上市，并且还计划再推出 50 家上市公司。监管机构几乎只将上市资格保留给那些顶尖的硬件制

造商，比如 Unitree，以及那些像 CXMT 这样的企业，它们正在帮助国家摆脱对国外技术的依赖。

The job of the China Securities Regulatory Commission (CSRC), the main markets watchdog, is now not just to vet companies, prevent bubbles and manage liquidity, but also to ensure that capital flows towards Mr Xi's policy goals. However, striking a balance between industrial policy and market stability is tough. The CSRC's aim of maintaining a "slow bull" market that rises gradually rather than a Pamplona-like run is hard to accomplish when top leaders talk up individual tech firms. Listening to such pronouncements, hundreds of millions of Chinese retail investors are pulling money out of boring but important industries like consumer staples (down by 15% this year) and into tech (up by 20% going by Shenzhen's technology-heavy ChiNex index).

中国证券监督管理委员会（CSRC）作为主要的市场监管机构，其职责如今不仅限于审核企业、防止泡沫形成以及管理流动性，还在于确保资金流向习近平所倡导的政策目标方向。然而，要在产业政策与市场稳定之间找到平衡却相当困难。当高层领导人不断推崇个别科技企业时，CSRC 想要维持一种缓慢增长的“慢牛”市场是难以实现的。听到这样的言论后，数以亿计的中国散户投资者纷纷将资金从那些乏味但重要的行业转移出去，比如消费品行业（今年跌幅达 15%），转而投入科技行业（以深圳以科技为主的 ChiNex 指数为例，涨幅达到了 20%）。

Such considerations make professional investors with the real money more nervous than they might be in a freer market. That in turn makes them stingier with capital. Instead, state banks with a record for inefficient capital allocation will end up investing more than they should. This is what happens when the central government's policy goals come first and greed is secondary, observes one veteran of the Chinese market. Far from helping China fulfil its techno-designs, a

hands-on state may make them harder to attain.■

这样的考虑使得拥有实际资金的专业投资者在更自由的市场中反而会更加紧张不安。这反过来又使他们更加吝啬自己的资金。相反，那些在资本分配上效率低下的国家银行最终会投入比实际应该更多的资金。正如一位中国市场资深人士所说，当中央政府的政策目标优先于贪婪时，这种情况就会发生。对中国来说，由国家直接管理不仅无法帮助实现其技术目标，反而可能会让这些目标更难达成。

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Tokens and coupons

代币和优惠券

AI has taken over the stock market. The bond market is next

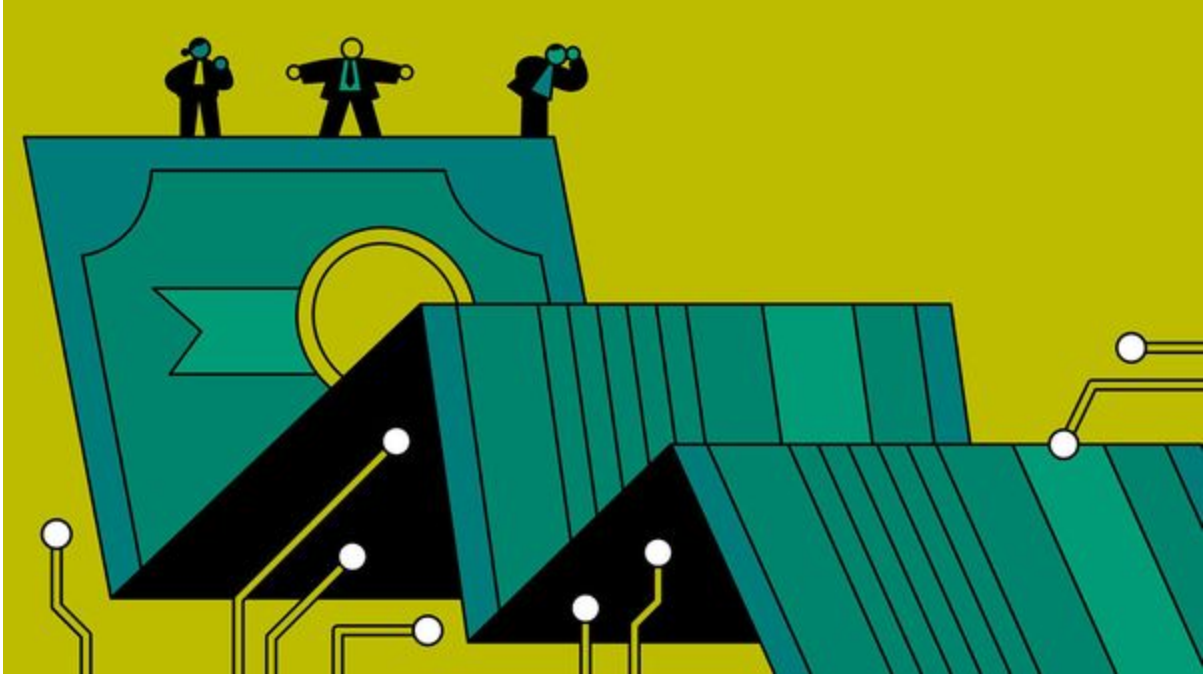
人工智能已经掌控了股市。接下来就是债券市场了。

Judging credit risk of the AI boom is difficult

要判断人工智能发展的信用风险是相当困难的。

Jul 09, 2026 06:44 AM | New York

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:44 | 纽约



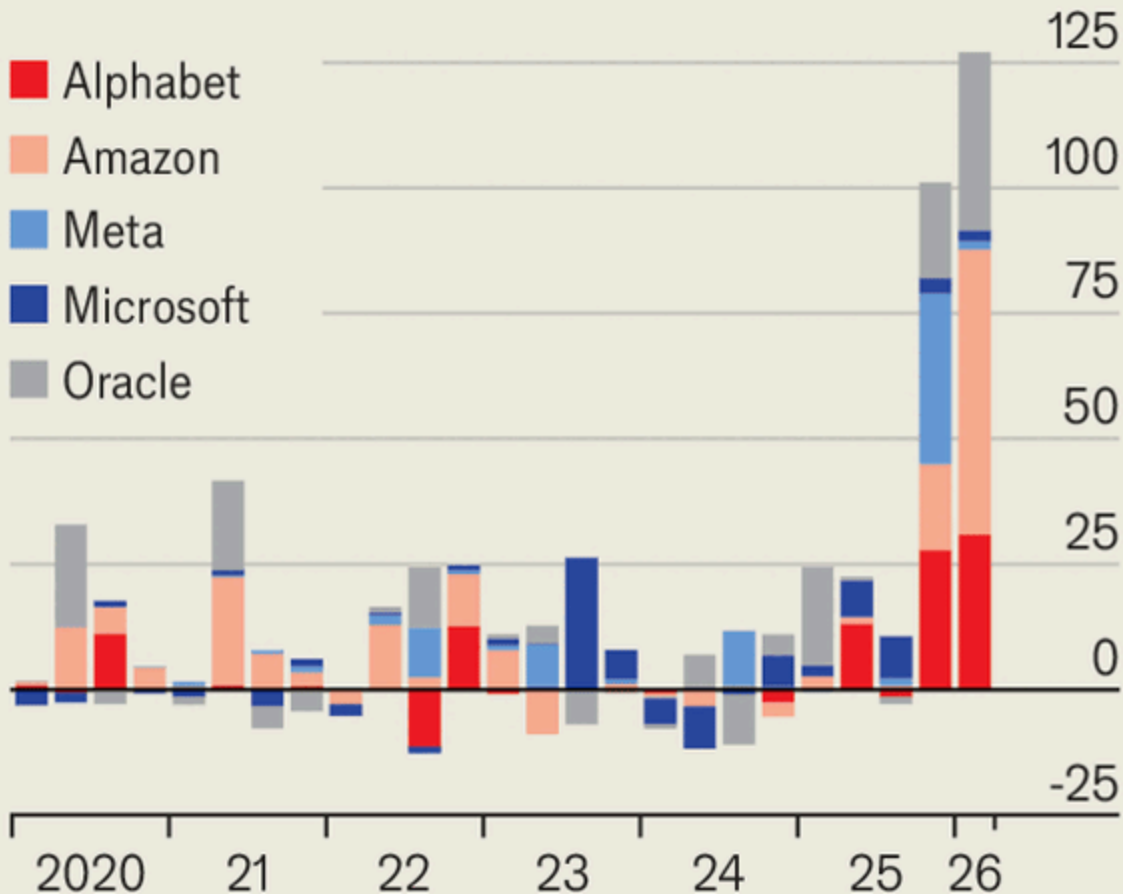
THE RAPID spread of new technological infrastructure is usually accompanied by booms in bond markets. The emergence of a liquid market for corporate credit on both sides of the Atlantic in the 19th century reflected the express growth of the railway industry. Before the arrival of railway operators with their vast investment needs—to buy land, lay tracks and ship goods—corporate finance was the province of small banks. Afterwards it became coupled with bond markets, at first nationally, then internationally.

新型技术基础设施的迅速普及通常伴随着债券市场的繁荣。19 世纪时，大西洋两岸出现了企业信贷的流动性市场，这反映了铁路业的快速发展。在铁路运营商出现之前，他们需要大量的投资来购买土地、铺设轨道以及运输货物，因此企业融资主要由小型银行负责。而在铁路运营商出现之后，企业融资便与债券市场紧密结合起来，最初是在国内，后来则扩展到了国际范围。

Technological debt

1

Change in total debt by quarter, \$bn



Source: Bloomberg

The latest techno-infrastructure frenzy, this time over artificial intelligence, is likewise stoking a bond-market boom (see chart 1). Since January Meta, Nvidia and Oracle have launched individual bond offerings worth \$25bn apiece to fund their AI ambitions—more than any of them has ever raised in equity. So has SpaceX, which added the same sum to the \$86bn that Elon Musk's rockets-to-robots business raised from stock-market investors last month. In March Amazon, whose computing cloud hosts lots of AI workloads, sold \$37bn in bonds. Alphabet issued a rare 100-year bond worth

£1bn (\$1.4bn) in Britain in February as part of a £5.5bn debt sale, plus more paper in Swiss francs, days after it raised \$20bn at home.

最新的技术基础设施热潮，这次是围绕人工智能领域，同样在推动债券市场的繁荣（参见图表 1）。自 1 月份以来，Meta、Nvidia 和 Oracle 分别发行了价值 250 亿美元的债券，用于资助他们的 AI 项目——这相当于它们以往在股权融资方面所筹集资金的总和。同样的情况也发生在 SpaceX 身上，该公司从上个月从股票投资者那里筹集到了 860 亿美元的资金，其中增加了同样数额的资金。3 月份，亚马逊的云计算平台承载了大量的 AI 工作负载，该公司出售了 370 亿美元的债券。2 月份，Alphabet 在英国发行了价值 10 亿英镑（约合 14 亿美元）的 100 年期债券，作为 55 亿英镑债务融资的一部分，此外还发行了更多以瑞士法郎计价的债券。就在几天前，该公司在美国筹集了 200 亿美元的资金。

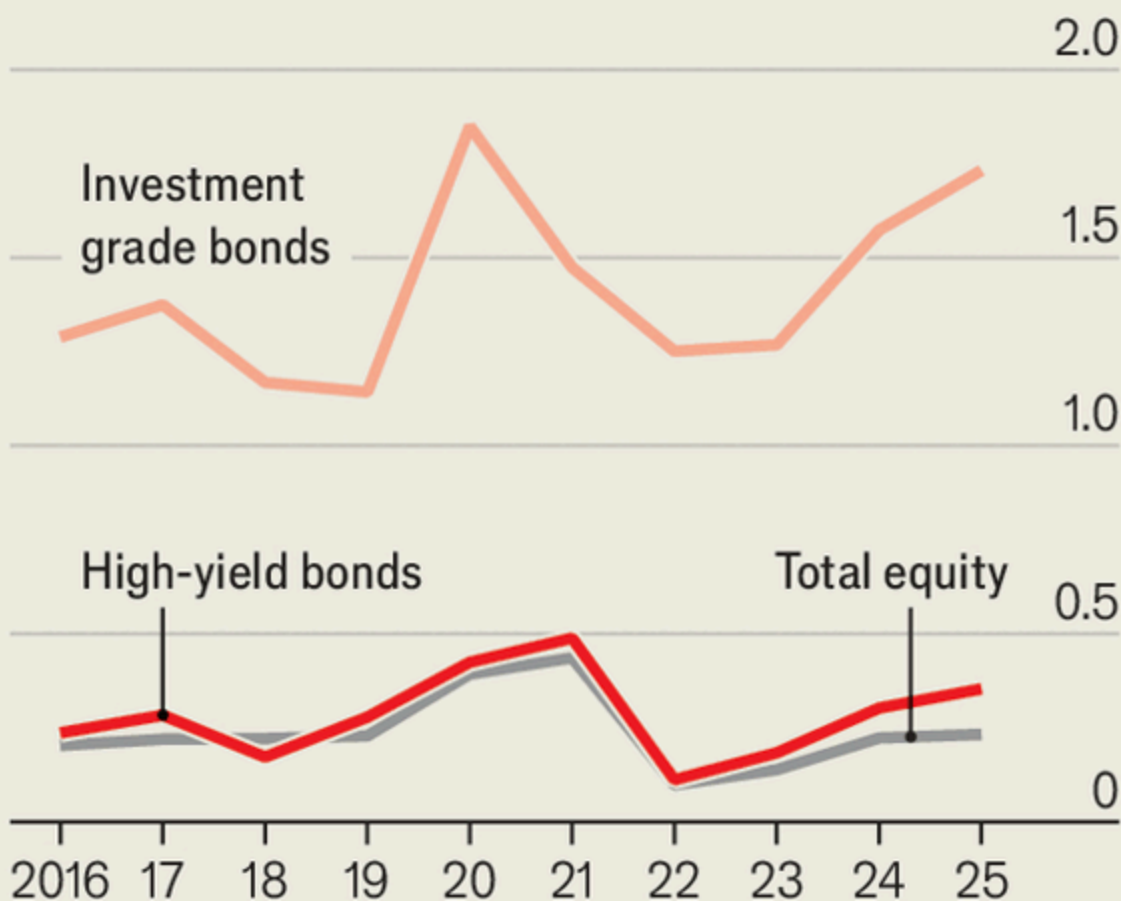
Last year issuance of corporate bonds in America was not far off the all-time high set in 2020 (see chart 2). This year that record will almost certainly be broken, thanks in large part to AI. Morgan Stanley, an investment bank, expects \$350bn-400bn in AI-related investment-grade issuance this year in American bond markets. That would be nearly a fifth of the \$2.3trn in high-quality dollar-denominated bonds which companies are forecast to sell there in 2026. Another \$50bn may come from junk bonds linked to AI projects (out of total high-yield issuance of \$440bn).

去年，美国的企业债券发行量接近 2020 年创下的历史最高水平（参见图表 2）。今年，这一纪录几乎肯定会被打破，这主要得益于人工智能技术的发展。投资银行摩根士丹利预计，今年美国债券市场将有 3500 亿至 4000 亿美元与人工智能相关的投资级债券发行。这几乎占到了 2026 年企业将在美国市场出售的 2.3 万亿美元高质量美元计价债券总量的五分之一。另外，可能还有 500 亿美元来自与人工智能项目相关的垃圾债券发行（在总计 4400 亿美元的高收益债券发行中）。

The big issue

2

United States, corporate issuance by type, \$trn



Source: SIFMA

Such sums explain why the Bank for International Settlements, central banks' central bank, recently warned that AI projects may not make enough money to repay the debt that financed them. If bond investing is the "negative art" of choosing what to avoid rather than what to buy, as it is sometimes described, how much avoiding must bond investors do?

这样的数字解释了为什么国际清算银行——作为各国中央银行的核心机构——最近发出警告，认为人工智能项目可能无法获得足够的收益

来偿还资助这些项目的债务。如果像有时所描述的那样，投资债券实际上是一种“消极的艺术”，即选择避免什么而不是选择购买什么，那么债券投资者究竟需要避免多少投资呢？

In some ways, the AI-issuance bonanza makes the corporate-bond market appear a little safer than it was. The total debts of America's five "hyperscale" cloud giants—Alphabet, Amazon, Meta, Microsoft and Oracle—climbed by \$228bn in the six months to March. That is nearly five times more than any such two-quarter increase in the past.

在某些方面，人工智能带来的收益使得企业债券市场看起来比实际情况要安全一些。在截至 3 月的六个月中，美国五大“超大型”科技公司的总债务增加了 2280 亿美元。这一数字几乎是过去两个季度增长量的五倍。

The first four of the hyperscalers have for years churned out more profits than they know what to do with, and so enjoy strong credit ratings. Microsoft's debt is considered safer than Uncle Sam's. Only Oracle, the smallest and least profitable of the five, receives a middling "B" grade from big credit-rating agencies (though so do the issuers of about half of American corporate bonds these days).

前四家大型电信企业多年来一直赚取着数不胜数的利润，因此它们拥有极高的信用评级。微软的债务被认为比美国政府的债务更可靠。而在五家企业中，规模最小且盈利能力最差的甲骨文公司，也只是获得了大型信用评级机构给出的中等评级“B”。不过，如今大约有半数的美国企业债券发行方都获得了类似的评级。

You might expect a debt-raising boom to raise the spreads on corporate bonds, a measure of their riskiness relative to safe Treasuries. But thanks to the creditworthiness of the largest big-tech issuers, average spreads remain at around 0.8 percentage points, close to the narrowest they have been in a quarter of a century.

人们可能会认为，债务激增会提高企业债券的利差，因为这可以反映这些债券相对于安全国债的风险程度。然而，由于大型科技企业的信

用状况良好，平均利差仍然保持在 0.8 个百分点左右，这一水平是过去四分之一世纪以来最窄的。



Investors are also beginning to be more discerning between the safe debt of the hyperscalers and bonds funding some of the riskier projects with which the tech giants are associated. In April QTS Data Centers, a firm owned by Blackstone, a giant manager of private assets, issued \$4.6bn in bonds to fund an immense server farm in Georgia, of which Microsoft will be a client. Initially the bonds' yield

was 1.1 percentage points higher than for the equivalent Microsoft debt. Since then the spread has widened to 1.6 points (see chart 3).

投资者也开始更加明辨优劣，区分那些由大型科技公司发行的低风险债务，与那些与高风险项目相关的债券之间的区别。4 月，由黑石集团拥有的 QTS 数据中心公司发行了 46 亿美元的债券，用于投资在乔治亚州的一个大型服务器基地的项目，微软将是该项目的客户。最初，这些债券的收益率比微软同类债务高出 1.1 个百分点。从那以后，两者之间的收益率差距进一步扩大到 1.6 个百分点（参见图表 3）。

On the surface, the ballooning issuance of riskier debt looks like a bigger cause for concern. The wave of junk bonds, set off last May by a \$2bn bond offering from CoreWeave, which rents out top-tier chip capacity, is swelling. In addition, CoreWeave and fellow “neoclouds” like Nebius and Iren have all issued billions of dollars in convertible bonds this year, which investors can swap for a certain number of the issuer’s shares. The division between safer and riskier debt may be misleading, however. Historically, financial instability has tended to build up around assets that investors believe to be safe, not those they already see as sketchy. In this light, the junk bonds are a sign of market adaptation.

从表面上看，大量发行风险较高的债务似乎更值得关注。去年五月，CoreWeave 公司发行了 20 亿美元的债券，这些债券用于出租高端芯片产能，由此引发了一波垃圾债券热潮。此外，CoreWeave 以及 Nebius 和 Iren 等公司今年也发行了数十亿美元的可转换债券，投资者可以用这些债券换取发行公司一定数量的股份。不过，将债务分为安全型和高风险型可能并不准确。历史上，金融不稳定往往发生在那些投资者认为较为安全的资产上，而不是那些他们已经认为存在风险的资产上。因此，垃圾债券实际上是市场适应变化的一个迹象。

When railway defaults surged in the wake of the financial panic of 1873, this eventually led to a worldwide depression. No such cataclysm looks imminent today. It is clear, though, that avoiding duds will be harder than ever. The AI revolution is proceeding at

such a blistering pace that some early winners have already turned into losers, then, occasionally, back into winners—and vice versa. Divining which companies will come out on top, and be able to redeem their bonds when they mature in ten, 30 or, in Alphabet's case, 100 years' time, will require bond investors to be at their most negatively artful. ■

在 1873 年的金融恐慌之后，铁路公司的违约现象激增，这最终导致了全球性的经济衰退。不过，如今似乎已经没有这种灾难性的情况了。不过，显然，避免出现糟糕的企业仍然比以往更加困难。人工智能革命的推进速度非常快，以至于一些早期的成功者已经变成了失败者，而偶尔又重新成为成功者——反之亦然。因此，要判断哪些公司能够脱颖而出，并在十年、三十年，或者像 Alphabet 那样，在 100 年后还能兑现其债券，就需要债券投资者展现出最精明的策略。

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Fallen leaves

飘落的叶子

The World Bank has ditched its climate targets

世界银行已经放弃了其气候目标。

The rise and fall of the institution's love for green growth

该机构对绿色增长的重视程度的高涨与下降

Jul 09, 2026 05:23 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:23



Browner pastures on the other side

而布罗纳则在另一边广阔的牧场中放牧着

IN JUNE 2023 the world's biggest development bank seemed to be undergoing a transformation. At a summit in Paris, the president of the World Bank, which for 70 years had focused only on tackling global poverty, announced plans to reserve a large portion of lending for projects to alleviate climate change and its effects.

在 2023 年 6 月，世界最大的开发银行似乎正在经历一场变革。在巴黎举行的一次会议上，世界银行行长宣布，在过去的 70 年里，该银行一直专注于解决全球贫困问题，但现在计划将大量贷款用于应对气候变化及其影响的项目。

The bank's then newish boss, Ajay Banga, had been hired in part for his green credentials, having pledged to plant 100m trees in his previous job as the chief executive of Mastercard, and he was proving popular. The crowd, which included Emmanuel Macron, the French president, and Abiy Ahmed, the prime minister of Ethiopia, celebrated with a standing ovation. As Mr Banga left the stage, he was diverted by Mr Abiy's aide for a selfie. A year later the World Bank ponied up \$43bn, or 44% of the year's lending, nearly hitting its formal target of channelling 45% of its loans to such causes.

这家银行的新任老板阿杰·班加的聘用部分基于他的环保理念。在担任万事达卡首席执行官期间，他曾承诺在地球上种植 1 亿棵树，而他的这一承诺确实得到了兑现，因此他很受青睐。出席活动的还有法国总统埃马纽埃尔·马克龙和埃塞俄比亚总理阿比·艾哈迈德。当班加先生离开舞台时，埃塞俄比亚总理的助手请他拍了一张自拍照。一年后，世界银行提供了 430 亿美元的资金，占当年贷款总额的 44%，这一比例几乎达到了世界银行将 45% 的贷款用于此类环保项目的目标。

Now the party is over. Last month, under American pressure, the 45% target was formally ditched. Bank officials have barely mentioned climate since Donald Trump returned to office in early 2025 (Mr Trump thinks climate change is a hoax and wants more fossil-fuel use, not less). European countries, with more environmentally minded electorates, fought hard for the target to

stay.

现在，该会议已经结束了。上个月，在美国的压力下，那 45% 的目标被正式放弃了。自唐纳德·特朗普在 2025 年初重新上任以来，银行官员几乎不再提及气候变化问题（特朗普认为气候变化是个骗局，希望增加化石燃料的使用，而不是减少其使用）。而那些具有更环保意识的欧洲国家则努力争取让该目标得以保留。

The sudden drought in climate finance could, it is true, slow the developing world's decarbonisation efforts. However, for the world's poorest countries, the World Bank's climate reversal could yet turn out to be good news.

气候融资领域的突然短缺确实可能会减缓发展中国家实现脱碳的努力。然而，对于世界上最贫困的国家来说，世界银行的气候政策逆转或许反而能带来好消息。

The green shift was always controversial. A split soon emerged between development types, inside and outside the bank. One group believed that spending on things like wind turbines (for renewable power), electric vehicles (to reduce pollution) and mangrove forests (to stop flooding) were vital to prepare developing countries for rising temperatures. Another lot believed that this diverted money from clinics, schools and roads that immediately helped the poorest places.

“绿色转型”一直存在争议。很快，银行内部和外部的各方意见出现了分歧。一部分人认为，投资风力发电设施、电动汽车、红树林保护等项目对于帮助发展中国家应对气候变化至关重要。另一部分人则认为，将这些资金用于医疗、教育和社会基础设施的建设，能够更直接地帮助最贫困的地区。

To sharpen the division, Mr Banga's big climate push happened just when rich countries were falling out of love with development assistance. As aid budgets and contributions to the World Bank froze in real terms, climate commitments would require budget cuts elsewhere. Bank officials demurred, saying that projects that

alleviated poverty also protected the planet. Mr Banga argued that there was little difference between spending on one or the other. If that were true, many officials in the poorest countries wondered, why ring-fence climate spending at all?

为了加强这种分化，班加先生的气候政策主张出现在富裕国家开始对发展援助失去兴趣的时候。随着各国的援助预算以及对世界银行的捐款实际金额都陷入了停滞，气候相关的承诺就需要在其他领域进行削减。银行官员们对此表示反对，他们认为，那些能够缓解贫困的项目同样也有助于保护地球。班加先生则认为，在这两个方面之间并没有太大的区别。如果真是这样，那么最贫穷国家的许多官员就会问：为什么要把气候相关的支出单独分离出来呢？

At the end of 2024 the bank increased its climate pledges again, promising to provide \$120bn annually by 2030, along with other international institutions. However, Mr Trump's return to the White House stopped the momentum. America's concerns ran deeper than the president's reflexive dislike for green do-goodery. In October 2025 Scott Bessent, the treasury secretary, proclaimed that focusing on climate was distracting from helping poor countries grow. He hinted that the bank needed to pull back or lose American support—a stark choice, since America is its biggest shareholder.

在 2024 年底，该银行再次增加了其气候承诺，承诺到 2030 年每年提供 1200 亿美元的资金，与其他国际机构一起努力。然而，特朗普先生重返白宫后，这一进展便戛然而止。美国的担忧不仅仅源于总统对环保政策的本能反感。2025 年 10 月，财政部长斯科特·贝森特声称，关注气候问题会分散人们对帮助贫困国家发展的注意力。他暗示，该银行需要减少投入或失去美国的支持——这是一个艰难的选择，因为美国是该银行最大的股东。

By April Mr Bessent's officials had begun a quiet campaign to scrap the targets. Little that Mr Banga did to appease Mr Trump helped, including joining the Board of Peace, the committee supposed to oversee the reconstruction of Gaza. The protests of many European countries were weakened when war in Iran was making net-zero

commitments that raise the price of petrol less popular at home.

到了四月，贝森特的官员们开始悄悄推动取消这些目标。班加先生所做的任何努力都没有起到安抚特朗普的作用，包括他加入和平委员会——这个本应负责监督加沙重建工作的委员会。当伊朗的战争导致净零排放承诺的履行变得困难时，许多欧洲国家的抗议活动也减弱了。

Less greenery, more greenbacks

更多的绿地，更少的绿票币

The question now is what happens to the balance of the bank's lending. The climate push meant more aid ended up with middle-income countries, which pollute more than the poorest and therefore find decarbonising costlier. So policymakers in the world's poorest countries are relieved at the prospect that the needle swings back.

现在的问题是，银行的贷款分配平衡将会如何变化。由于气候问题的影响，更多的援助被分配给了中等收入国家，这些国家的污染程度比最贫穷的国家要高，因此实现脱碳的成本也更高。因此，世界最贫穷国家的政策制定者对于情况可能会有所改善感到欣慰。

Yet some at the World Bank think that ditching climate targets will make no difference to the institution's portfolio. New climate projects could simply be repackaged and approved as development loans. If so, many staff will consider that to be a victory stolen from a meddling America. At the same time, however, it may also show that the sceptical development types were right—and there was little need for targets to start with. ■

不过，世界银行中的一些人士认为，放弃气候目标对该机构的项目规划来说并无实质影响。新的气候项目可以重新包装，然后被批准为发展贷款。这样一来，许多工作人员就会认为这是从那些爱管闲事的美国那里夺来的胜利。不过，同时这也可能表明，那些持怀疑态度的发展型思维是正确的——其实一开始就没有必要设定这些目标。■

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Lean years

艰难的岁月

Women's progress at work is stalling

女性在工作上的进步停滞不前

Is the "Lean In" generation leaning out?

“精益一代”是否正在选择离开呢？

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WOMEN HAVE made extraordinary gains in the past few decades across the rich world. They now outnumber men on university

campuses in virtually every wealthy country. At work, many have been enthusiastically “leaning in”, as Sheryl Sandberg, then Facebook’s second-in-command, urged them to do in a book in 2013. Their representation among the highest-paying professions, including medicine and the law, has nearly tripled in America since 1980. At the turn of the century a British patient was twice as likely to see a man. Last year the number of female physicians exceeded those of men for the first time, according to Britain’s General Medical Council, a public body.

在过去的几十年里，在富裕国家，女性的地位取得了显著的进步。现在，在几乎所有富裕国家的大学里，女性的数量几乎超过了男性。在工作领域，许多女性也积极选择从事高薪职业，正如 Facebook 的副主管谢丽尔·桑德伯格在 2013 年的一本书中所建议的那样。自 1980 年以来，包括医学和法律领域在内的高薪职业中，女性的比例在美国几乎增加了两倍。进入新世纪时，在英国，女性患者看医生的几率是男性的两倍。根据英国医学委员会的统计，去年，英国的女医生数量首次超过了男医生的数量。

Recently, however, the most highly qualified cohort of women in human history has often appeared to be leaning out. In 2024 a study by S&P Global, a compiler of indices, found that women’s share of executive positions in listed American companies fell for the first time in 2023 after nearly 20 years of uninterrupted growth. In 2025 women secured 38% of new board seats at companies in the S&P 500 index of large American firms, down from 42% the previous year and prolonging a retreat from their peak in 2020.

然而，最近，历史上最有能力的女性群体似乎开始逐渐退出这一领域。2024 年，指数编制公司 S&P Global 的一项研究发现，自近 20 年来持续增长的背景下，2023 年美国上市公司中女性担任高管职位的比例首次出现下降。在 2025 年，S&P 500 指数中的大型美国公司中，女性占据了 38% 的新董事会席位，而去年这一比例为 42%。这一数据表明，女性在高管职位中的比例正在从 2020 年的峰值下滑。

In its last round of partner promotions, in 2024, Goldman Sachs named a smaller share of female partners than in the previous round, for the first time in more than a decade. A year later the share of new female managing directors at the Wall Street bank fell, too. Last month Marianne Lake, a female frontrunner to succeed Jamie Dimon at JPMorgan Chase, was relegated and another, Jennifer Piepszak, bowed out last year, leaving an unusually pale and male lineup for the top job.

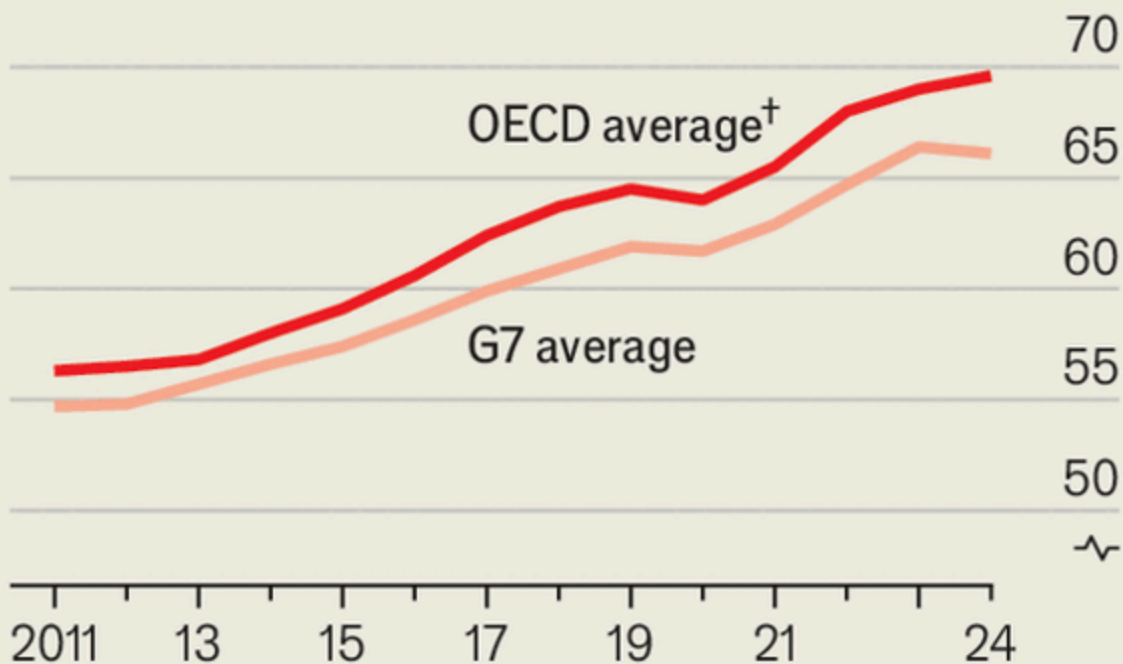
在 2024 年的最新一轮合作伙伴晋升中，高盛公司任命的女性合作伙伴数量比上一轮少了。这是十多年来首次出现这种情况。一年后，这家华尔街银行中新任命的女性董事比例也有所下降。上个月，玛丽安·莱克被排挤出了摩根大通的领导岗位，而另一位候选人詹妮弗·皮普兹扎克也在去年辞职。因此，高盛高层团队中的女性成员数量显得异常稀少。

Glass divide

1

Women-in-work index*

100=highest level of gender equality



*Based on gender pay gap, female labour-force participation, participation-rate gap, female unemployment rate, female full-time employment rate[†]33 countries

Source: PwC

It is not just at the top that the progress of women in work is stalling or even going into reverse (see chart 1). Across 33 members of the OECD, a club of mostly rich countries, the share of employed women in full-time work declined from 78.1% in 2023 to 76.8% a year later—a small dip but also the first one since PwC, a consultancy, started tracking the data 15 years ago. In March 78.5% of American women aged 25-54 were in the labour force, an all-time high. Since then their participation has fallen by almost a percentage

point, a much sharper fall than seen among men.

不仅仅是高层职位，女性在工作领域的进展也陷入了停滞甚至倒退状态（参见图表 1）。在 OECD 的 33 个成员国中，从事全职工作的女性比例从 2023 年的 78.1% 下降到了一年后的 76.8%——虽然降幅不大，但这是自 PwC 咨询公司开始跟踪这一数据以来的首次下降。3 月份，25-54 岁美国的女性劳动力人口比例为 78.5%，创下了历史新高。自那以后，女性的参与率又下降了近一个百分点，这一降幅比男性更为明显。

University-educated American women with young families appear to be leading the retreat. Their labour-force participation rate took a turn in 2023 after decades of improvement, and has fallen every year since. Last year marked the sharpest drop in participation by mothers with young children in four decades.

受过大学教育的美国女性，尤其是那些拥有年幼孩子的家庭中的女性，似乎正在引领这一趋势。在经历了数十年的参与率上升之后，2023 年她们的劳动力参与率出现了下降，并且从那以后每年都在减少。去年，有年幼孩子的母亲们的劳动力参与率下降幅度是过去四十年中最高的。

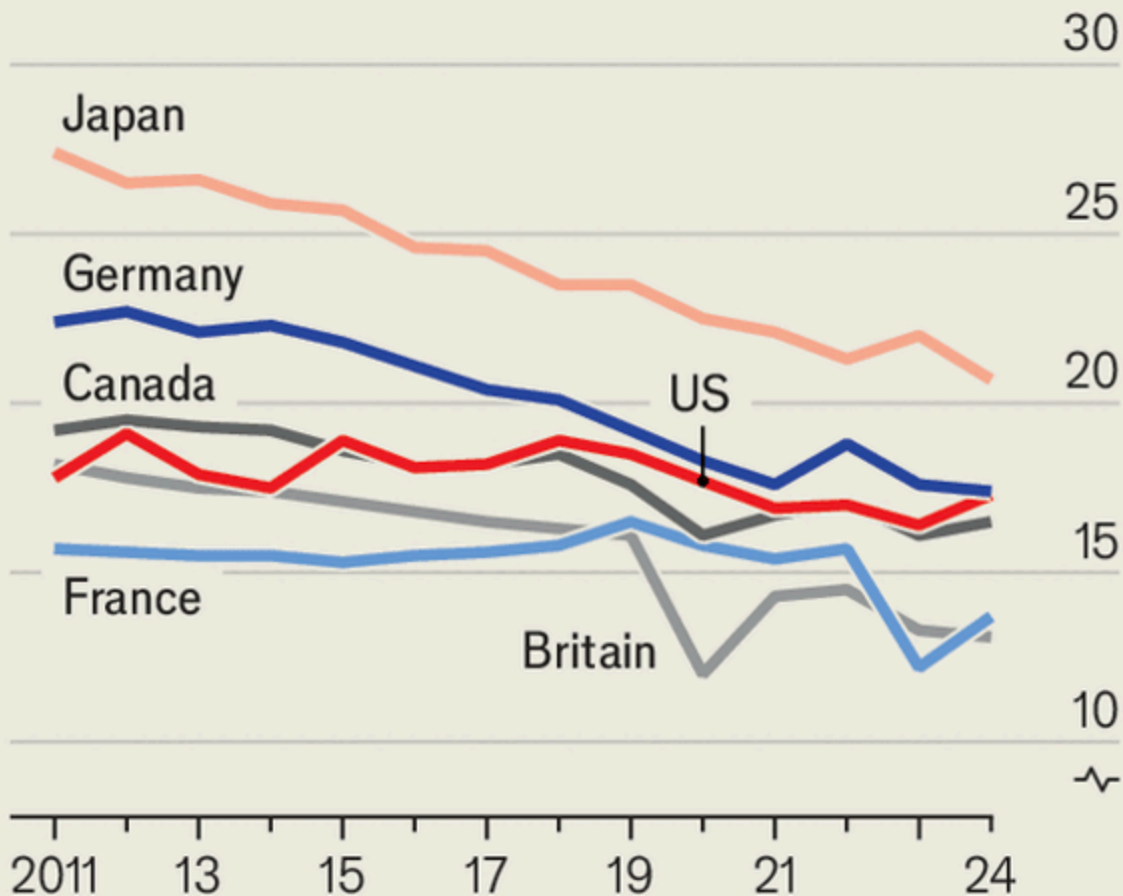
After consistently closing for years, the gender pay gap is opening up again, too. In America it widened in both 2023 and 2024, the first consecutive two-year decline in 60 years. In 2024 it also widened (on PwC's slightly different measure) in other rich countries, including Canada and France (see chart 2). For British women in their 40s, who were starting their careers when Ms Sandberg was telling them to lean in, the gap likewise increased.

多年来，性别薪酬差距一直存在，但近年来这一差距又重新显现了。在美国，2023 年和 2024 年性别薪酬差距都有所扩大，这是 60 年来连续两年缩小的现象。2024 年，其他富裕国家也出现了类似的趋势（根据 PwC 的衡量标准），包括加拿大和法国（见图表 2）。对于 40 多岁的英国女性来说，当桑德伯格女士还建议她们积极争取权益时，性别薪酬差距同样有所扩大。

Waging war of the sexes

2

Gender pay gap*, %



Source: PwC *Male minus female wages, divided by male wages

It also seems that women's professional aspirations no longer match men's. An annual survey published in December 2025 by McKinsey, a consultancy, and Lean In, a non-profit founded by Ms Sandberg and named after her book, asks respondents to indicate their interest in climbing up the corporate ladder. Between 2019 and 2023 the share of both men and women keen on a promotion rose from seven in ten to eight in ten. By 2025 it had risen to nearly nine in ten for men but remained flat for women. For female entry-level workers it was just 69%. PwC also finds a persistent gap in men's and women's

intentions to ask for a bigger job.

看起来，女性的职业抱负已不再与男性相匹配。2025 年 12 月，咨询公司麦肯锡和由桑德伯格女士创立并以她的著作命名的非营利组织 Lean In 共同发布了一项年度调查。该调查询问受访者对于晋升到更高职位的兴趣程度。在 2019 年至 2023 年期间，无论是男性还是女性，有晋升意愿的比例从七成上升到了八成。到了 2025 年，男性的这一比例上升至近九成，而女性则保持不变，仍为 69%。对于女性基层员工来说，有寻求晋升意愿的比例仅为 69%。普华永道也发现，男性与女性在争取更大职位方面的意愿之间存在持续差距。

One reason for some of these reversals may have to do with the arithmetical aftermath of the covid-19 pandemic. Labour economists caution that disproportionate numbers of low-wage female workers lost their jobs during the lockdowns, artificially narrowing the gender pay gap. Some of the recent widening may reflect those women returning to the labour market. Still, the gap's expansion half a decade after lockdowns ended suggests something else could be at play.

这些薪资差距出现逆转的原因之一可能与新冠疫情后的算术效应有关。劳动经济学家警告称，在封锁期间，大量低薪女性工人失去了工作，这人为地缩小了性别薪资差距。最近薪资差距的扩大或许反映了这些女性重新进入劳动力市场的情况。不过，在封锁结束五年后，薪资差距仍然扩大，这表明可能存在其他原因。

Difficulty finding child care is another potential culprit. Although nurseries have [become more affordable in some rich countries](#) lately thanks to subsidies, supply is often constrained. That means frequent long waiting lists and staff shortages. Germany, considered to have affordable child care, still lacks more than 300,000 nursery places for children under three.

难以找到儿童看护服务也是个潜在的问题。虽然由于政府补贴，一些富裕国家的托儿服务现在变得更加负担得起，但托儿服务的供应往往仍然不足。这就导致了频繁的等待排队现象以及人员短缺的问题。尽

管德国被认为在提供儿童看护服务方面比较有优势，但该国仍然缺少超过 30 万个托儿名额，用于照顾三岁以下的儿童。

At the same time, especially across swathes of Donald Trump's America, diversity, equity and inclusion have become dirty words. The federal government is proudly dismantling DEI policies. So, more subtly, are many companies that do not want to cross the alpha-male-in-chief. A few years ago Mr Dimon, then a champion of progressive causes, would probably not have dreamed of an all-male shortlist of names to succeed him. ■

与此同时，尤其是在唐纳德·特朗普所统治的这片土地上，多样性、公平性和包容性这些概念已经变成了禁忌词汇。联邦政府正自豪地废除那些与多元性、公平性和包容性相关的政策。同样，许多公司也为了避免触及这一敏感话题，选择回避与这些概念相关的讨论。几年前，当丹蒙还是那些进步主义事业的拥护者时，他肯定不会想到会有全由男性组成的继任者名单出现。

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Boiling over

过于夸张了

Three ways the LNG market could crack before winter

在冬季到来之前，液化天然气市场可能会面临三种挑战。

War, weather and outages may still send gas prices soaring

战争、恶劣天气以及电力中断等因素仍可能导致汽油价格飙升。

Jul 09, 2026 05:52 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:52



ON JUNE 28TH the *Hlaitan*, a tanker laden with liquefied natural gas, set off for France from Freeport, Texas. Almost immediately it changed course. TotalEnergies, its charterer, had received a better offer from Asia. According to Kpler, a data firm, the *Hlaitan* is due at its new destination on August 1st.

6 月 28 日，一艘载有液化天然气的油轮“Hlaitan”从德克萨斯州的自由港出发，前往法国。几乎立刻，它改变了航向。其租船公司 TotalEnergies 从亚洲获得了更好的报价。根据数据公司 Kpler 的消息，该油轮预计将在 8 月 1 日抵达新的目的地。

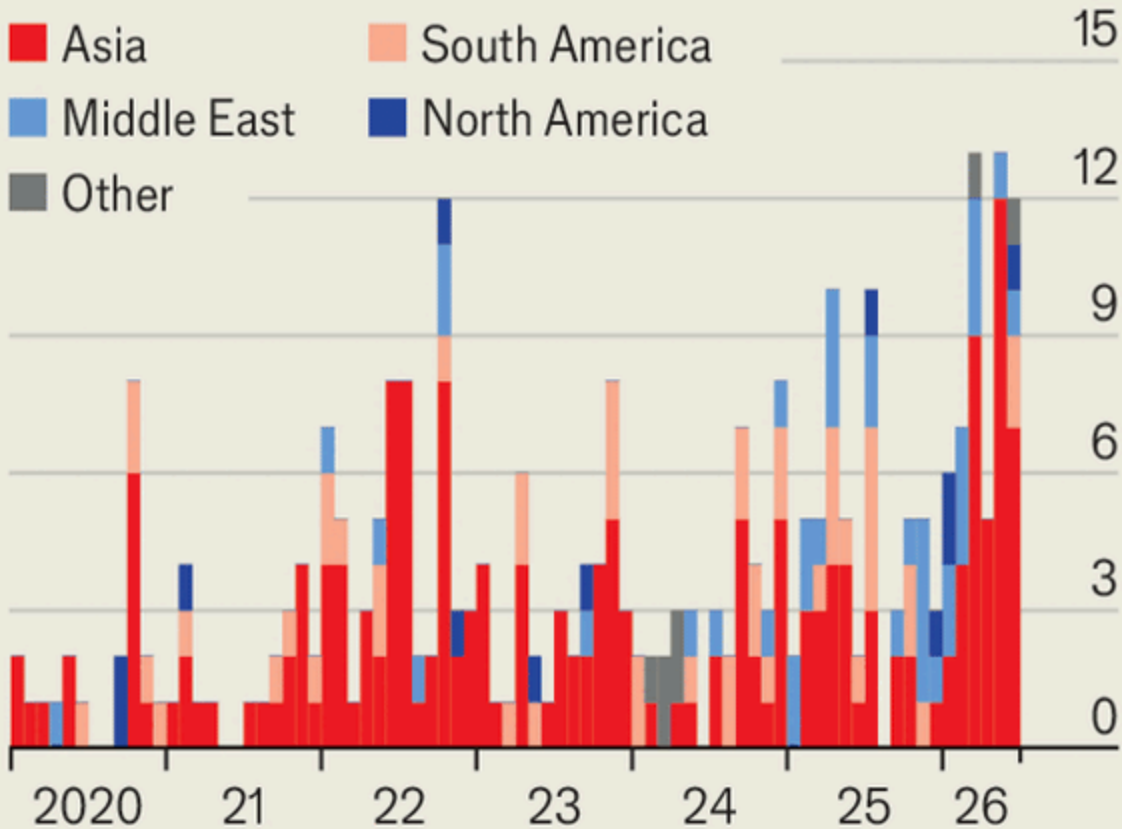
Such stories have become common. Buyers in Asia, where a scorching summer is turbocharging demand, are outbidding Europeans for American cargoes at every turn. LNG tankers are being diverted in record numbers (see chart 1). In sidelined Europe, gas storage, drained by a cold winter, is only 47% full—the lowest in 15 years at this point of the summer (see chart 2).

这样的故事已经变得很常见了。在亚洲，炎热的夏季极大地刺激了需求，那里的买家总是以更高的价格购买美国的货物，远远超过了欧洲人。液化天然气运输船的数量也在创纪录地增加（参见图表 1）。而在被冷落了欧洲，由于寒冷的冬季，天然气储存量仅为 47%，这一比例是该夏季以来最低的，已经达到了 15 年来的最低水平（参见图表 2）。

Hard to starboard

1

Number of liquefied-natural-gas cargoes diverted from Europe, by new destination



Source: Kpler

Behind this is a [lack of supply](#) from Qatar, usually Asia's main provider. Since America and Iran agreed in mid-June to reopen the [Strait of Hormuz](#), 11 LNG tankers have traversed the waterway—better than none, but just three days' normal traffic. On July 7th America began striking Iran, in retaliation for Iranian attacks on tankers (including a Qatari LNG one a day earlier). President Donald Trump also revoked a waiver which allowed Iran to sell its oil and

declared the ceasefire with the Islamic Republic to be “over”.

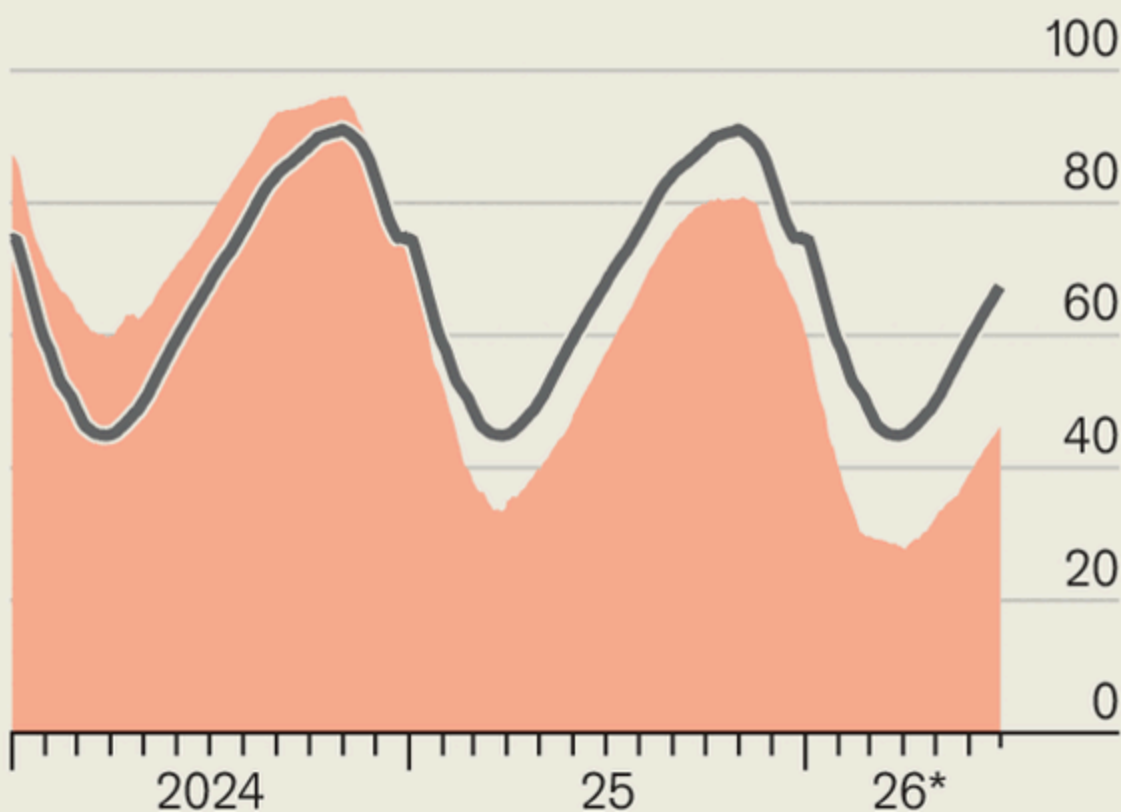
这背后是由于卡塔尔的供应中断造成的。卡塔尔通常是亚洲最大的液化天然气供应国。自从美国和伊朗在六月中期同意重新开放霍姆兹海峡后，共有 11 艘液化天然气运输船通过了这一海域——虽然这已经算是不错的成绩了，但依然比正常的运输量少三倍。7 月 7 日，美国开始对伊朗进行打击，以报复伊朗对液化天然气运输船的攻击（包括一天前被卡塔尔液化天然气运输船遭遇的攻击）。唐纳德·特朗普总统还撤销了允许伊朗销售石油的豁免条款，并宣布与伊朗伊斯兰共和国的停火协议已经结束。

Under pressure

2

Europe, gas-storage levels, billion cubic metres

Actual 2020-24 average



Source: S&P Global Platts

*To June 29th

Unlike oil prices, which despite an uptick amid the latest hostilities are [well below their war-time highs](#), gas prices remain 55% higher in Europe, and 73% higher in Asia, than in February (see chart 3). Analysts expect Qatari flows to be back to normal by September, just in time for Europe to restock before winter. But a more malign scenario is still uncomfortably plausible.

与油价不同，尽管在最近的冲突期间油价有所上涨，但依然远低于战争时期的高峰水平。欧洲的天然气价格比 2 月份高出 55%，而亚洲

则高出 73%（参见图表 3）。分析师预计，卡塔尔的天然气供应将在 9 月前恢复正常，这样欧洲就能在冬季来临之前补充库存。不过，更糟糕的情况仍然有可能发生。

The war in Iran has deprived the world of a fifth of its LNG flows. It has also knocked out 17% of Qatar's export capacity, which will take years to rebuild. Restarting surviving plants takes time. Despite extra supplies from Africa and Australia, lured by rising prices, and lower demand owing to Asian countries' power-saving measures, industrial users' deferred purchases and the restarting of coal-fired plants, the world will be short of a cumulative 40m tonnes of Qatari LNG this year. That is almost a tenth of last year's supply.

在伊朗发生的战争导致全球失去了五分之一的液化天然气供应。此外，这还使卡塔尔的出口能力减少了 17%，需要数年时间才能恢复。重新启动那些仍在运行的工厂也需要时间。尽管来自非洲和澳大利亚的额外供应，但由于价格上涨以及亚洲国家为节省能源而采取的节能措施导致需求下降，工业用户推迟了采购计划，再加上燃煤电厂的重新启动，今年全球将出现累计 4000 万吨的卡塔尔液化天然气短缺。这几乎相当于去年供应量的十分之一。

Hormuz hangover

3

Natural-gas spot prices, \$ per MWh



Source: S&P Global Platts

And that is before Asian and European importers start replenishing their winter stocks. Most are waiting as long as they can. One reason is that prices remain high; another is that prices for winter deliveries are no higher than today's. If Qatari supplies return by September, Asian demand for American cargoes should ease, spot prices fall and European buyers restock. By November EU stores would be some three-quarters full—low, but enough for a normal winter. Prices

ought to stay under control.

而在亚洲和欧洲的进口商开始补充他们的冬季库存之前，情况还是这样。大多数进口商都在尽可能延长等待时间。其中一个原因是价格仍然很高；另一个原因是冬季的供应价格与今天的价格差不多。如果卡塔尔的供应能在 9 月之前恢复，那么亚洲对美国商品的需求就会减少，现货价格也会下降，而欧洲的买家则会继续补充库存。到 11 月时，欧洲的商店里商品的数量应该会达到四分之三的满额——虽然这个数量较少，但足以满足正常的冬季需求。价格应该能够保持在可控范围内。

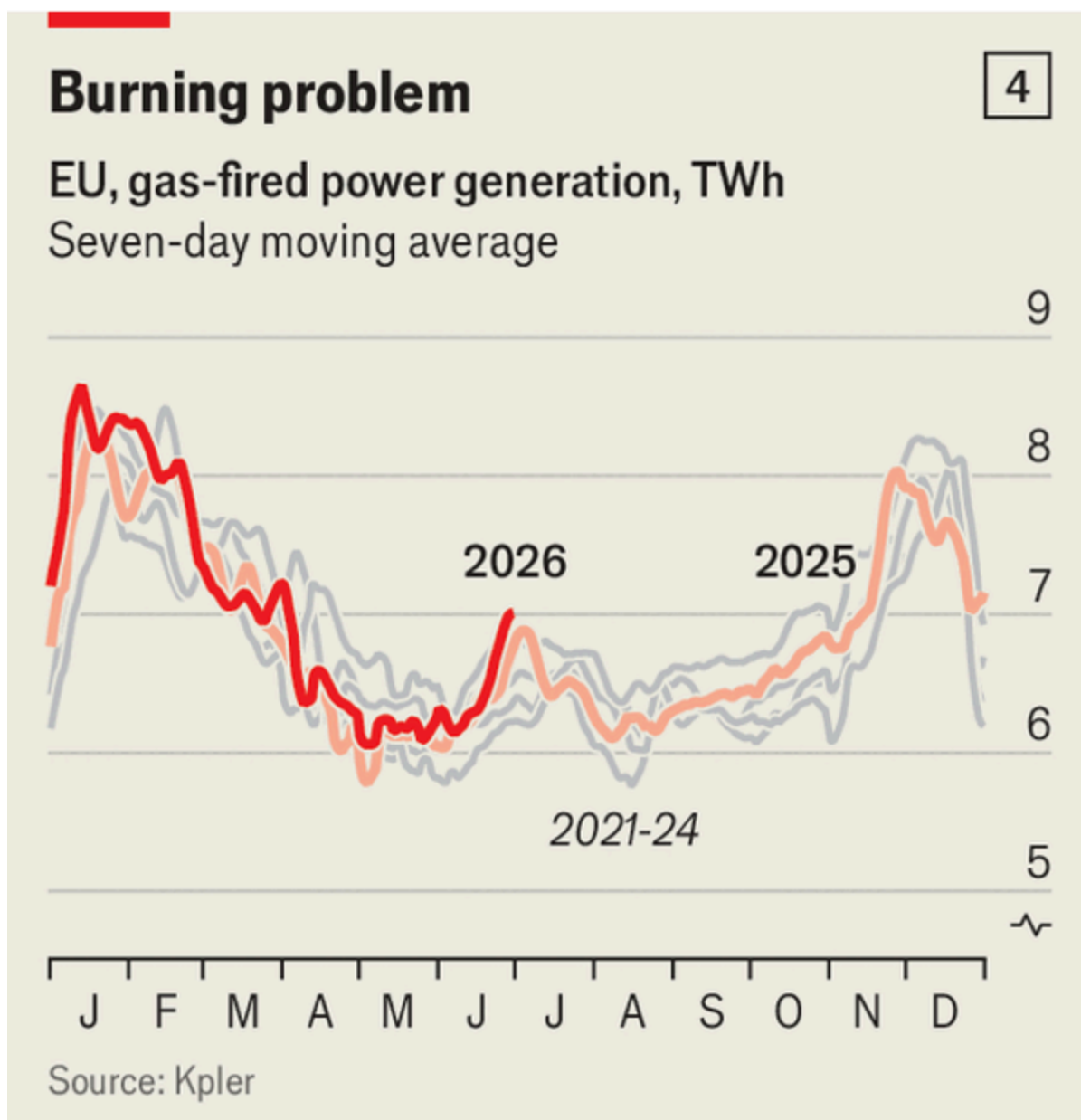
But the market is so tight that a succession of small shocks could precipitate a crunch. Three risks stand out. First, Gulf supplies may not return on time. Hours after the Qatari gas tanker was hit near the entrance of the strait on July 6th, another heading for Hormuz turned around. A dozen ballast tankers are waiting near Ras Laffan to load. But repeated skirmishes, let alone a collapse of the ceasefire, could rattle buyers and push Asia to bid even harder for American cargoes.

但市场目前非常紧张，稍许的波动就可能导致严重的短缺。有三个风险值得关注。首先，海湾地区的供应可能无法按时恢复。7 月 6 日，一艘卡塔尔籍天然气运输船在海峡入口附近遭到袭击后几小时，另一艘前往霍姆兹的船只也改变了航线。目前有十几艘天然气运输船在拉夫安附近等待装载货物。不过，反复的冲突事件，甚至停火协议的破裂，都可能让买家感到不安，从而促使亚洲地区为获取美国货物而展开更加激烈的竞争。

A second risk is extreme weather. In June Europe suffered [record temperatures](#), which pushed up demand for cooling and so power (see chart 4). In Asia El Niño—a climatic phenomenon that brings hot, dry weather to the region—is also pushing the mercury abnormally high, forcing countries such as Bangladesh and Pakistan back onto the spot market. More sizzling weather in either continent

will mean more buying.

第二个风险是极端天气。6 月，欧洲经历了创纪录的高温，这导致了对制冷设备的需求增加，从而推高了电力需求（参见图表 4）。在亚洲，厄尔尼诺现象——一种导致该地区天气炎热干燥的气候现象——也使得气温异常升高，迫使像孟加拉国和巴基斯坦这样的国家重新转向现货市场进行交易。无论哪个大陆的天气变得更加炎热，都会引发更多的购买行为。



China's unpredictable purchases add uncertainty. The world's largest LNG importer mostly buys under long-term contracts. It does not stockpile gas as it does oil. What it does not need it resells, as it did in March and April. But when heatwaves struck in May and June, it resumed large imports; when welcome rain fell in late June, it retreated. Scorching temperatures might again cause it to buy in a hurry.

中国不可预测的采购行为带来了不确定性。作为世界上最大的液化天然气进口国，中国主要通过长期合同进行采购。与石油不同，中国并不储存天然气。那些不需要的天然气会被重新出售，就像在 3 月和 4 月所做的那样。然而，当 5 月和 6 月出现高温天气时，中国又恢复了大量进口天然气的行为；而当 6 月底出现降雨时，中国的采购行为又有所减少。高温天气可能会再次促使中国加快采购速度。

The third danger is that infrastructure fails. Prolonged dry spells drain hydropower reservoirs. Power prices in Switzerland have already jumped as it imports electricity from neighbours that use fossil fuels, notes Gillian Boccara of Kpler. If rivers are abnormally warm, nuclear reactors, which need cold water, may throttle back.

第三个危险是基础设施的故障。长期干旱会导致水电水库的水位下降。据 Kpler 公司的 Gillian Boccara 指出，由于瑞士需要从使用化石燃料的邻国进口电力，其电力价格已经上涨。如果河流温度异常升高，那些需要冷水运行的核电站也可能因此受到影响，从而被迫停止运行。

Then there are unknown unknowns. A big LNG terminal could break down, as when the Freeport plant, then accounting for 4% of global supply, caught fire in 2022. Strikes, like those in Australia in 2023, can disable facilities for weeks. Russia—which supplied record volumes to Europe this spring—could turn off the taps.

还有那些所谓的“更不为人知的未知情况”。比如，一个大型液化天然气终端可能会发生故障——就像 2022 年那座占全球供应总量 4% 的自由港工厂发生火灾时一样。而像 2023 年在澳大利亚发生的罢工事

件，也可能导致设施数周无法运行。今年春天，俄罗斯向欧洲输送的天然气量创下了历史新高，但俄罗斯也有可能突然停止供应。

Several of these shocks at once could turn the manageable into a nightmare. "When bad news accumulates," says Anne-Sophie Corbeau of Columbia University, "the effect on prices can turn exponential." There is little scope left for switching fuels. South Asian countries will surely have to cut back. China, Japan and South Korea are rich enough to keep bidding. Europe will not freeze this winter. But it could face an enormous heating bill.■

如果这种糟糕的消息接连发生，那么一切可控的情况也会变成噩梦。“当坏消息不断积累时，”哥伦比亚大学的安妮·索菲·科罗博说，“对价格的影响就会变得指数级。”现在几乎没有机会改变能源来源了。南亚国家肯定不得不减少能源消耗。中国、日本和韩国足够富裕，可以继续进行能源交易。欧洲这个冬天不会面临严寒天气，但可能会面临巨大的取暖费用负担。■

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Buttonwood

纽扣木

Europe's economy is a mess. Its stock markets are a steal 欧洲的经济状况一团糟。其股市更是糟糕至极。

International investors still aren't interested

国际投资者仍然对此不感兴趣。

Jul 09, 2026 05:23 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:23



"THE STOCK MARKET is not the economy" might be a cliché, but it is still jarring to see quite how far the two can part ways. Surely economic growth should be good for shareholders? Yet study after study has suggested the opposite. One by Jay Ritter of the University of Florida, for instance, compared the returns on 16 countries' stock markets with their GDP growth per person between 1900 and 2002. The two appeared, if anything, to be negatively correlated—meaning that the faster a country became richer, the worse its investors tended to do.

“股票市场并非整个经济体系的一部分”这句话或许有些陈词滥调，但实际上，我们很容易发现这两者之间存在着明显的差距。难道经济增长不应该对股东有利吗？然而，一项项研究的结果却表明情况恰恰相反。例如，佛罗里达大学的杰伊·里特进行的一项研究，比较了 1900 年至 2002 年间 16 个国家的股票市场表现与人均 GDP 增长情况。结果发现，这两个指标似乎呈负相关关系——也就是说，一个国家越迅速地变得富裕，其投资者的表现往往就越差。

Mr Ritter's results are worth bearing in mind when contemplating some of the world's most underloved shares. Brief flirtations aside, it has been a long time since Europe's big markets have thrilled international investors, and there are no prizes for guessing why. The IMF reckons GDP growth in the euro area will be just 1.1% this year, compared with 1.8% for advanced economies the world over and 2.3% for America. Some of Europe's peripheral and emerging bourses are buzzing; the mainstays are not.

在考虑一些全球最不被青睐的股票时，里特先生的业绩结果值得注意。暂且不说那些短暂的表现，欧洲的主要市场已经很久没有给国际投资者带来如此高的回报了。不用说，人们很容易猜到原因。国际货币基金组织预计，今年欧元区的 GDP 增长率将仅为 1.1%，而全球发达经济体的增长率分别为 1.8% 和 2.3%。欧洲一些边缘地区和新兴市场的股市表现相当活跃，但那些传统的大型股市则表现不佳。

Worse, Europe appears increasingly ill-equipped for the 21st century. It has neither artificial-intelligence giants to compete with those in

America and China nor enough data centres to host their models. Its electricity grid is strained even without them. So is its power supply, since Europeans import nearly 60% of their energy—a vulnerability laid bare by wars in Ukraine and Iran.

更糟糕的是，欧洲似乎完全没有准备好迎接 21 世纪的挑战。它既没有能与美国和中国相媲美的人工智能巨头，也没有足够的数据中心来承载这些模型。即便没有这些挑战，欧洲的电力网络也已经不堪重负。而欧洲的能源供应同样存在隐患，因为欧洲人几乎需要进口 60% 的能源——这一弱点在乌克兰和伊朗的战争中表现得尤为明显。

In spite of all this, European shares deserve a lot more affection than they are getting. More than anywhere else in the world, the old continent's stock markets are not its economy. Even as GDP growth languishes, their fundamentals look surprisingly good.

尽管如此，欧洲的股市还是值得人们给予更多的关注的。与世界其他地区的股市相比，欧洲大陆的股市与其经济状况并没有明显的关联。即使 GDP 增长表现不佳，但欧洲股市的基本面却出人意料地良好。

For a case study, consider what happened after the Iran war closed the Strait of Hormuz. Until then, one European equity strategist says, she had spent much of her time fielding calls from international investors who worried they were overexposed to America and wanted to diversify. Capital was flowing into European equity funds more quickly than it had been for some time. When the bombs began to fall, the phone calls stopped and the capital flows all but dried up. Share prices tanked pretty much everywhere, but those of European firms then recovered far slower than American ones. It was only last month, when Hormuz tentatively reopened, that European shares began to catch up.

作为一个案例研究，可以看看伊朗战争结束后霍尔穆特海峡重新开放之后发生了什么。据一位欧洲股票策略师所说，在此之前，她大部分时间都在处理来自国际投资者的咨询，这些投资者担心自己过度依赖美国，希望进行资产多元化配置。当时，资本流入欧洲股票基金的速度比以往任何时候都要快。然而，当炸弹开始落下时，这些电话咨询

停止了，资本流动也几乎停滞了。几乎所有地区的股价都出现了下跌，但欧洲公司的股价恢复速度远远慢于美国公司。直到上个月霍尔穆特海峡重新开放后，欧洲股市才逐渐恢复。

The irony is that the strait's closure probably boosted Europe's corporate profits, even as it threatened the continent's economy—and may do so again as the war resumes. Morgan Stanley finds that 20% of the earnings underlying the MSCI Europe share index come from firms that would have benefited from the spike in commodity prices, such as energy and chemicals producers. The investment bank also estimates that only 10% of European earnings (from car- and foodmakers, for example) would have been harmed by the supply-chain disruption. Investors nevertheless see the war as a cue to shun European stocks en masse.

具有讽刺意味的是，海峡的关闭或许反而提升了欧洲企业的利润，尽管它同时也威胁到了欧洲大陆的经济。随着战争的继续，这种情况可能会再次发生。摩根士丹利指出，MSCI 欧洲指数中 20% 的收益来自那些会因大宗商品价格上涨而受益的企业，比如能源和化工行业的企业。该投资银行还估计，只有 10% 的欧洲企业（例如汽车和食品行业的企业）的收益会受到供应链中断的影响。不过，投资者仍然认为战争是一个信号，表明应该避免大量投资欧洲股票。

Europe's sclerotic growth, similarly, need not condemn its firms' bottom lines. Taken in aggregate, over half their revenue comes from outside Europe's developed economies; weighted by firms' market value (as share indices tend to be) this rises to 60%. No other similarly sized region has stock markets that are so exposed to countries beyond its borders. Investors in European share indices are betting more on the rest of the world than they are on Europe.

同样，欧洲缓慢的增长也并不一定会导致企业财务状况恶化。总体而言，超过一半的营收来自欧洲以外的经济体；如果以企业的市值来计算，这一比例上升到 60%。没有其他规模相近的地区，其股市对外部国家的依赖程度如此之高。投资欧洲股市的投资者，更多是将目光投向了世界其他地区，而非欧洲本身。

Even the burst of inflation brought on by the Iran war should be no bad thing for European shares. Around 40% of them by market value represent firms that derive earnings from real assets, from commodities and machinery to the semiconductors that power AI. Such assets tend to perform well when consumer prices are rising. Another 20% or so of Europe's stock market is made up of banking shares, which also do well when prices (and hence interest rates and lending margins) are on the way up.

即使因伊朗战争引发的通胀现象，对欧洲股市来说也不一定是坏事。大约 40% 的欧洲股市股票来自实物资产，比如大宗商品、机械设备，以及推动人工智能发展的半导体产品。当消费者物价上涨时，这类资产往往表现良好。另外，欧洲股市中约 20% 的股票属于银行业股票，当价格（以及利率和贷款成本）上升时，这些银行股票也会表现良好。

Equity analysts, therefore, are feeling more and more bullish about Europe's corporate profits, estimating that earnings per share will grow by 17% in 2026. This is admittedly only two-thirds of the growth pencilled in for American stocks, but well above the 9% consensus of two years ago. After a quiet few months European strategists might soon find their phones ringing again. If they do, it may be an idea to remind the investor on the other end that Europe's stock market is nothing like its economy. ■

因此，股票分析师对欧洲的企業利润持越来越乐观的态度。他们预计，到 2026 年，每股收益将增长 17%。当然，这一增速仅为美国股市增长预期的三分之二，但仍远高于两年前普遍预期的 9%。在经历了几个月的平静之后，欧洲的投资策略师们可能会再次收到投资者的电话。如果真是这样，或许应该提醒对方：欧洲的股市与其经济状况并不相称。■

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Free Exchange

自由交换

An ageing society might not cost too much

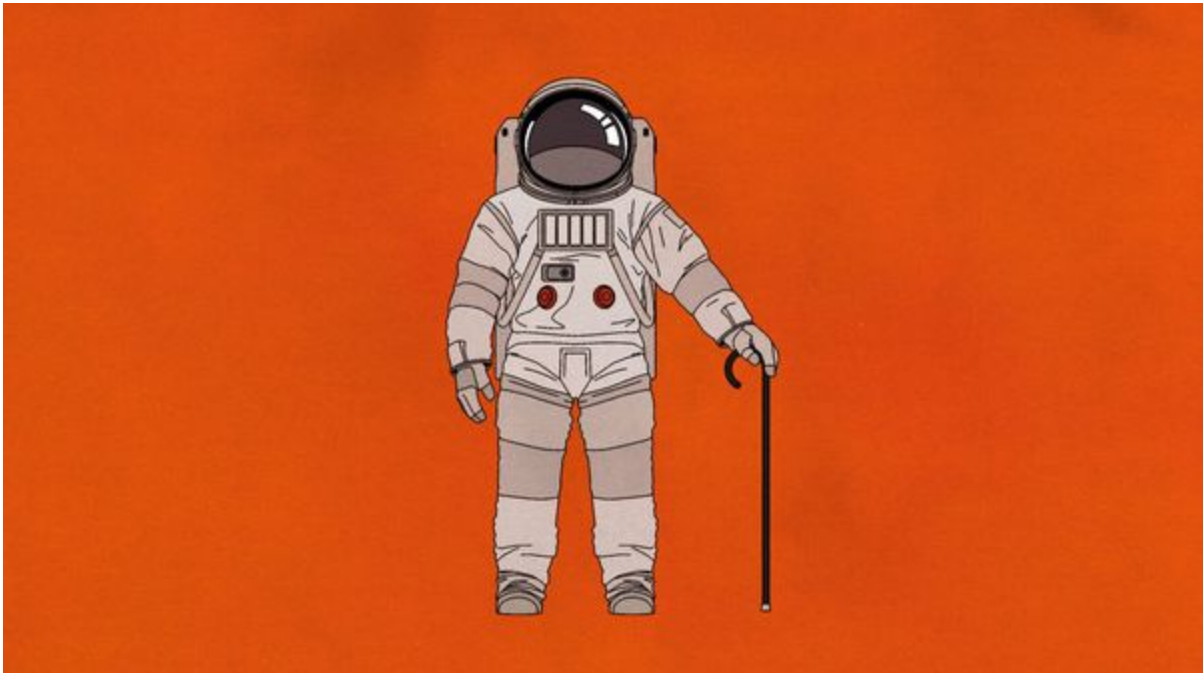
在一个老龄化社会中，成本可能不会太高。

A dystopian vision of the future may not come to pass

那个反乌托邦式的未来景象可能永远不会实现。

Jul 09, 2026 06:06 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:06



THE YEAR is 2100. It is a grim time to be of working age. Not only must you put up with rising sea levels, rampant rogue AIs and colleagues who, 80 years after the pandemic, still do not know how to mute themselves on a video call, but your take-home pay is meagre. Taxes to finance state support for the vast grey population take an ever-larger chunk of your wage. After a century of health-care spending growing faster than the economy, there is little for anything but pills, hospital beds and nurses.

现在是 2100 年。对于处于工作年龄的人来说，这确实是一个艰难的时代。不仅要应对不断上升的海平面水平、肆虐的自动化机器人，还要忍受那些在疫情过去 80 年后仍然不知道如何在视频通话中静音自己的同事。此外，你的工资收入也相当微薄。用于资助对大量老年人口提供的社会保障的税收，占去了你工资中的很大一部分。经过一个世纪以高于经济增长速度增长的医疗保健支出之后，现在除了药品、病床和护士之外，几乎没有什么其他东西了。

Economic theory lends support to science fiction. Spending on health care depends on how much it costs to provide and how much treatment is needed. Generally, the former has increased over time. Economists attribute this to Baumol's cost disease, diagnosed by William Baumol, an American economist. Technologically intensive sectors (think of manufacturing or software development) get more productive. Labour-intensive service sectors do not. A doctor's consultation takes roughly as long as it did a century ago. Yet physicians' pay must match increases in faster-growing skilled industries, or all the doctors will go to work in tech. (Baumol pointed out that a string quartet still took 45 minutes to perform a Schubert work, but was paid vastly more than when the composer was alive.)

经济理论为科幻小说提供了理论支持。在医疗保健领域的投入取决于提供服务的成本以及所需的医疗数量。通常情况下，前者随着时间的推移而不断增加。经济学家将这一现象归因于“Baumol 成本病”理论，该理论由美国经济学家威廉·鲍莫尔提出。技术密集型行业（如制造业或软件开发行业）的效率更高，而劳动密集型服务行业则不然。医生进行咨询所需的时间与一个世纪前差不多。不过，医生的薪酬必

须跟上那些增长较快的技能型行业的步伐，否则所有的医生都会进入科技行业工作。（鲍莫尔指出，一个弦乐四重奏组仍然需要 45 分钟来演奏一首舒伯特的作品，但他们的薪酬却远高于作曲家在世时的水平。）

As for the volume of health care, there is a debate over whether “expansion” outweighs “compression”. As medical knowledge improves people live longer but not for ever. Eventually they fall ill and die. The question is whether the total time spent poorly expands as the population ages, becoming more decrepit and needing more complex and expensive care, or whether the same sort of advances that keep them alive also keep them healthier. Sickness would become compressed into just a few years before death.

至于医疗保健服务的规模问题，目前存在一种争论：是应该扩大服务范围，还是减少服务数量。随着医学知识的不断进步，人们的寿命确实延长了，但并没有无限延长。最终，人们还是会生病并死去。问题在于，随着人口老龄化，人们生病和死亡的时间是否会缩短，还是说，那些让人们保持健康的进步措施，也会让他们的寿命更长。这样一来，生病的时间可能会缩短到几年之内即可结束。

Two new papers from the National Bureau of Economic Research, a repository of economic thought, suggest that the vision of health care gobbling up tax revenues may not come to pass. In the first, David Cutler and Lev Klarnet, both of Harvard University, observe that in 2024 America spent \$1trn less on health care than official forecasts from 2010. The second is by Liran Einav, of Stanford University, and Amy Finkelstein, of the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT). Using a survey of users of Medicare, America’s system of health insurance for the old, they find that, whereas expected lifetime spending on Social Security (ie, pensions) rose by 14% between 1993 and 2017, the expected cost of Medicare increased by only 6%. That is partly because elderly Americans have been collecting their pensions for longer but spending less time

seriously ill.

来自美国国家经济研究局的两篇新论文表明，那种认为医疗保健会占用大量税收收入的观点可能并不成立。在第一篇论文中，哈佛大学的大卫·卡特勒和莱文·克拉内特指出，到 2024 年，美国在医疗保健上的支出比 2010 年的预测少了 1 万亿美元。第二篇论文由斯坦福大学的利兰·埃纳夫和麻省理工学院的爱米·芬克尔斯坦撰写。他们通过对美国老年人医疗保险系统的用户进行调查后发现，虽然从 1993 年到 2017 年，老年人一生中用于社会保障（即养老金）的支出增加了 14%，但医疗保险的预计支出仅增加了 6%。这一差异部分是因为美国老年人领取养老金的时间更长，但患重病的时间却减少了。

The papers point to improvements on both sides of the equation. Start with the cost of providing health care in hospitals. Messrs Cutler and Klarnet point out that, between 2000 and 2010, it consistently rose by around 2.3 percentage points above inflation—but that later something changed. Between 2011 and 2024 hospital costs rose by only 0.5 percentage points more than overall prices. Technology has played a role. Technological improvements in health care come in two types: some are adopted because economies get richer and can afford to treat new things; others make it cheaper to provide the same outcomes. For much of the past century, the first type dominated the second. Now, it seems the second type has taken over. Baumol's cost disease turned out to be curable.

这些论文指出，无论是在医疗服务的提供成本方面，还是在其他方面，都取得了显著的改善。首先来看医院提供医疗服务所花费的成本。Cutler 和 Klarnet 指出，在 2000 年到 2010 年期间，这一成本持续以高于通货膨胀率 2.3 个百分点的速度上升。但后来情况发生了变化：从 2011 年到 2024 年，医院成本仅上升了 0.5 个百分点。技术因素在其中发挥了重要作用。医疗技术的改进分为两类：一类是因为经济日益富裕，人们能够负担得起采用新技术；另一类则是通过技术手段使提供相同医疗服务变得更加经济实惠。在过去的一个世纪里，第一类技术占主导地位。而现在，看来第二类技术已经占据了主导地位。Baumol 提出的“成本疾病”问题，其实是可以被治愈的。

On top of that, less health care is needed than was once expected. Health-care systems may have become more efficient at targeting treatments, and insurers better at saying no. The old are also getting healthier. Mr Einav and Ms Finkelstein point out that since 1993 Americans' life expectancy at age 66 has risen by 2.4 years, which are (on average) entirely healthy. They can expect an extra three years of healthy life. The amount of time spent in the severest mental and physical distress has declined by 0.6 years. That means less spent on extremely pricey residential care or home help for the infirm.

此外，现在所需的医疗保健服务比以往预期的要少。医疗保健系统在提供治疗方面变得更加高效，保险公司也能更有效地拒绝不必要的治疗请求。老年人也变得更加健康。Einav 先生和 Finkelstein 女士指出，自 1993 年以来，美国人在 66 岁时的预期寿命增加了 2.4 年，而这些人平均来说都处于健康状态。他们可以额外享受三年的健康生活。处于最严重身心痛苦状态的时间则减少了 0.6 年。这意味着人们不需要花费那么多钱在昂贵的住宅护理或老人护理上。

Improvements are not limited to America. As this newspaper pointed out three years ago, health-care spending [has slowed](#) (as a share of GDP) across the OECD, a club of mostly rich countries. Another new paper, by Sheila Diane Smith and Joseph Newhouse in the *American Journal of Health Economics*, makes the same point—and predicts that spending per person will grow by around 2% over the next decade in the OECD (excluding America), compared with 4% before 2009. Spending on health care as a share of GDP will rise by only a tenth of a percentage point each year.

这些改善并不仅限于美国。正如这份报纸在三年前指出的那样，整个经合组织国家（主要由富裕国家组成的联盟）的医疗保健支出占比已经有所下降。另一篇由 Sheila Diane Smith 和 Joseph Newhouse 在《美国健康经济学杂志》上发表的论文也提出了同样的观点——并预测，在经合组织国家（不包括美国），未来十年内人均医疗保健支出将增长约 2%，而 2009 年前这一比例仅为 4%。医疗保健支出在 GDP 中的占比每年仅会增长 0.1 个百分点。

Silver linings

令人欣慰的情节/积极的一面

The good news for the grandchildren does not end there. Another new working paper, by Daron Acemoglu, of MIT, and others, finds that ageing societies are no poorer. Much of the demographic transition has happened already, the authors note, allowing economists to estimate the effect on growth of declining birth rates. Looking across America they find that in areas with steeper falls in fertility, productivity growth among people of working age is higher. That, they theorise, is because such places have been far better at adopting labour-saving technology. There may be more old people in 2100 but the workers supporting them may have fusion-powered quantum-AI colleagues sharing the burden.

对子孙后代来说，这个好消息还不止于此。麻省理工大学的达伦·阿西莫格鲁等人另一篇新的研究论文指出，老龄化社会并不会变得更糟糕。作者们指出，人口结构的变化已经发生了很大程度，因此经济学家可以估算出出生率下降对经济增长的影响。他们研究发现，在生育率下降较为严重的地区，劳动年龄人口的生产力增长更为显著。他们认为，这是因为这些地区在采用节省劳动力的技术方面表现得更为出色。到 2100 年时，虽然老年人口可能会增多，但支撑他们的工人或许会有拥有聚变动力、能进行量子计算的人工智能同事来分担工作负担。

This does not mean all is well. Pensions will remain a pricey problem. Still, they are not an insurmountable one. According to a study by the Congressional Budget Office, a fiscal watchdog, raising the American retirement age by three years, from 67 to 70, would pay a large chunk of the extra costs of Social Security by 2100. Getting that reform, or others to defray the cost, through a polarised American politics will be hard. Yet the economics literature offers hope: demography need not be destiny after all. ■

不过，这并不意味着一切都很美好。养老金问题依然是个昂贵的难题。不过，这个问题并非不可解决。根据国会预算办公室的一项研

究，如果将美国的退休年龄推迟三年，从 67 岁提高到 70 岁，那么到 2100 年时，社会保障系统所承担的成本将会大幅减少。但在美国政治如此两极分化的情况下，要实现这一改革或其他类似的措施仍然困难重重。不过，经济学文献带来了希望：也许，人口统计因素并非决定命运的关键因素。■

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3D acceleration

3D 加速度

The future of chipmaking looks more like Manhattan than Silicon Valley

芯片制造行业的未来更像是曼哈顿，而非硅谷。

Constrained by physics and politics, chipmakers are building upwards
受到物理定律和政治因素的制约，芯片制造商们仍在不断努力进行研发工作。

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DRIVE AROUND Silicon Valley and you will see surprisingly little skyline. The landscape is dotted with low-rise offices, bungalows and malls. The microchips that gave the region its name are built in much the same way. Millions of low-rise transistors—the electrical switches which instantiate a binary 1 or 0, and thus form the basis of computing—are plonked next to each other on a wafer of silicon.

在硅谷行驶时，你会惊讶地发现几乎看不到高楼大厦的轮廓。这片土地上，低矮的办公楼、小公寓和购物中心随处可见。让这个地区获得“硅谷”之名的那些微芯片，也是以类似的方式制造的。数以百万计的低矮晶体管——这些用于实现二进制 1 或 0 的电子开关，正是计算技术的基础——被紧密地排列在硅片上。

Over the past half-century, in pursuit of higher performance, chipmakers have learned to shrink their transistors and pack them together ever more tightly. But that trick is running out of road. To keep progress going, firms are starting, at last, to build upwards. The industry's future will look less like Californian sprawl and more like the vertical cityscape of Manhattan.

在过去的半个世纪里，为了追求更高的性能，芯片制造商们不断缩小晶体管的大小，并将它们紧密地集成在一起。不过，这种方法的局限

性正在逐渐显现。为了持续推动技术进步，这些公司终于开始采用向上延伸的设计方式。未来的芯片产业将不再像加利福尼亚州那样分散布局，而会更像是曼哈顿那种垂直式的城市布局。

On June 16th, at a conference in Hawaii, Samsung Electronics, a South Korean firm, said it had managed to stack two types of transistor on top of each other, allowing it to make significant savings on space. A few days later IBM, an American firm that carries out research into advanced chipmaking, announced a vertical transistor of its own. Intel and TSMC, two other incumbent giants, are pursuing similar technology, which the industry hopes may turn up in commercial products early in the 2030s.

6月16日，在夏威夷举行的一次会议上，韩国企业三星电子宣布成功将两种不同类型的晶体管堆叠在一起，从而大大节省了空间占用。几天后，从事先进芯片制造研究的美国企业IBM也宣布研发出了一种垂直结构的晶体管。另外两家巨头——英特尔和台积电也在研发类似的技术。业界希望这些技术能在2030年代初应用于商业产品中。

China's tech champions are chasing similar ideas, but for slightly different reasons. American export controls have cut them off from the [manufacturing tools](#) necessary to build the tiniest transistors, forcing them to look for alternative ways of doing things. On May 25th Huawei, the country's leading chipmaker, announced a technology called "Logic Folding", which aims to stack entire circuits rather than individual components. Whether to escape the constraints of physics or of American sanctions, it seems the only way to go is up.

中国的科技先驱们也在追求类似的创新，不过他们的动机略有不同。美国的出口管制限制了他们使用一些制造工具的能力，这些工具是制造极其微小的晶体管所必需的。因此，他们不得不寻找其他的方法来实现目标。5月25日，中国领先的芯片制造商华为宣布了一项名为“逻辑折叠”的技术。这项技术旨在将整个电路集成在一起，而不是使用单独的组件。无论是为了摆脱物理限制还是为了规避美国制裁，看起来唯一的出路就是向上发展。

Start with physics. Making transistors smaller helps in two ways. One is simply that cramming more of them into a given area allows for more sophisticated chips. The other is that, thanks to a quirk of the device, the smaller a transistor becomes the better it performs—at least, up to a point. Smaller transistors switch on and off more quickly and consume less power while doing so. In 1965, Gordon Moore, who later co-founded Intel, predicted that the number of transistors that could fit on a piece of silicon would double roughly every year (later revised to two). The industry organised itself around what came to be known as Moore's law.

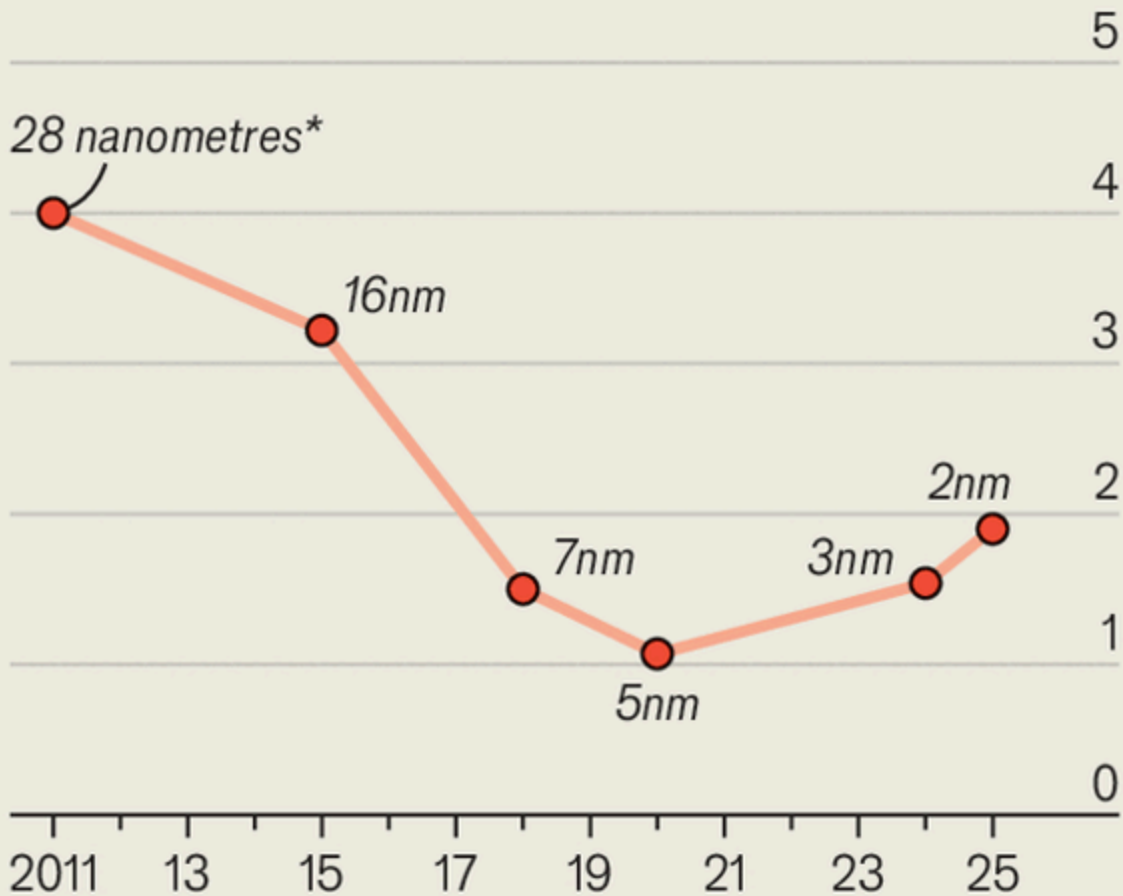
从物理学出发吧。让晶体管变得更小有两大好处。一方面，可以在更小的面积内容纳更多的晶体管，从而制造出更复杂的芯片。另一方面，由于设备的特性，晶体管越小，其性能就越好——至少在一定程度上如此。较小的晶体管可以更快地开关，同时消耗更少的电力。1965 年，后来联合创立英特尔的戈登·摩尔预测，能够集成在硅片上的晶体管数量大约每年会翻一番（后来这一预测被修正为每两年翻一番）。整个行业因此被纳入了所谓的“摩尔定律”框架之下。

But by the mid-2000s the transistors started misbehaving. They had become so tiny that current would flow even when they were meant to be switched off, wasting power and generating unwanted heat. Redesigning them bought a bit more time. Flat transistors gave way to slightly more vertical designs called FinFETs, which helped control leakage. FinFETs were followed by gate-all-around (GAA) transistors, the current state of the art.

不过，到了 21 世纪中期，晶体管开始出现性能问题。这些晶体管变得过于微小，以至于在应该关闭的状态下仍然会有电流流动，从而浪费了电力并产生了不必要的热量。重新设计晶体管后，情况有所改善。扁平式的晶体管被稍微更垂直的设计所取代，这种设计被称为 FinFET。这种设计有助于控制漏电问题。随后出现的 Gate-All-Around (GAA) 晶体管成为了当前最先进的晶体管技术。

The price of power

Cost per billion transistors, \$



Source: Bloomberg Intelligence

*Fabrication process type

The redesigns kept shrinking going, but broke its economics. For decades firms could deliver more computing power at a lower cost per transistor. No longer. Bloomberg Intelligence, a data provider, estimates that, in 2024, a billion transistors on TSMC's N3 process, then the state of the art, cost roughly 40% more than on the previous N5 process (see chart).

这些重新设计的芯片尺寸不断缩小，但成本却越来越高。几十年来，企业一直能够以更低的成本提供更多的计算能力。但现在情况不再如

此了。据数据提供商 Bloomberg Intelligence 的估计，到 2024 年，使用台积电最新的 N3 工艺制造的芯片，其每晶体管的成本将比之前的 N5 工艺高出约 40%。（参见图表）

One target for the great shift upwards is logic gates, devices built up from transistors. The simplest, an inverter or “NOT” gate, turns a 1 into a 0 or vice versa. It is made of two connected transistors placed side by side. Engineers must leave a gap to prevent the two transistors from electrically interfering with each other.

这一重大向上转变的一个目标就是逻辑门，也就是由晶体管构成的电路器件。最简单的逻辑门是异或门或“非”门，它将 1 转换为 0，或将 0 转换为 1。这种逻辑门由两个并排连接的晶体管组成。工程师们在设计这种逻辑门时，需要留出一定的间隙，以防止两个晶体管之间的电路发生相互干扰。

IBM reckons that by stacking transistors instead, by using a device called a “complementary field-effect transistor” (CFET), it can cut by half the area required for logic gates, while delivering either 50% more performance or 70% better energy efficiency. A CFET stacks one GAA transistor directly on top of another, with an insulating layer ensuring the two play nicely together.

IBM 认为，通过使用一种名为“互补式场效应晶体管”的器件，可以替代传统的晶体管结构。这种晶体管能够将逻辑门所需的面积减少一半，同时还能使性能提高 50%，或者提高 70% 的能效。互补式场效应晶体管的原理是将一个 GAA 晶体管直接叠放在另一个上面，并通过绝缘层来确保两者能够良好协作。

The firm builds its CFETs using a method called sequential manufacturing. The bottom transistor is built first. Then a second silicon wafer is flipped over and bonded to the first, a process rather like putting the top slice of a sandwich onto the bottom. The upper transistor is then built on this second, transferred layer. Intel, Samsung and TSMC, by contrast, favour a “monolithic” approach for their CFETs, in which the two transistors are built above one another

on the same silicon substrate.

这家公司采用一种名为“顺序制造”的方法来制造其 CFETs。首先制造出底部的晶体管，然后翻转另一块硅片并将其与第一个芯片粘合在一起——这个过程有点像把三明治的上面一层放在下面。之后，第二个晶体管就在这一转移层上被制造出来。相比之下，英特尔、三星和台积电则更倾向于采用“单片式”的制造方法，即将两个晶体管在同一硅基板上依次制造而成。

Serge Biesemans of IMEC, a semiconductor research organisation based in Belgium, says the monolithic option is a better fit for existing manufacturing methods—though it requires modifying tools so that they can handle the unusual geometry of stacked transistors. IBM’s sequential CFETs avoid the need to fiddle with tools, at the cost of extra manufacturing steps.

比利时的一家半导体研究机构 IMEC 的 Serge Biesemans 表示，单片结构方案更适合现有的制造工艺——不过这需要对工具进行改造，以使其能够处理堆叠式晶体管的特殊几何结构。而 IBM 的序列式 CFETs 方案则无需对工具进行任何调整，但会增加一些额外的制造步骤。

China’s push into the third dimension is driven by politics. Since 2019 America has barred ASML, a Dutch toolmaker, from selling its extreme-ultraviolet (EUV) lithography machines to China. This makes it very hard for Chinese firms to make chips with the tiniest possible components. So Huawei is trying a different tack.

中国进军第三维度的努力是由政治因素驱动的。自 2019 年以来，美国禁止荷兰企业 ASML 将其极紫外光刻机出售给中国。这使得中国企业很难制造出具有极小组件的芯片。因此，华为试图采取不同的策略。

The firm argues that a chip’s speed depends on two things: how fast its transistors can switch on and off, and how long it takes for a signal to zip through the system. The switching speeds of modern chips are so high—billions of times each second—that designers account for the time it takes for an electrical signal, which moves at

a significant fraction of the speed of light, to propagate across one.

该公司认为，芯片的速度取决于两件事：其晶体管开关的速度，以及信号在系统中传输所需的时间。现代芯片的开关速度非常快——每秒可达数十亿次开关操作。因此，设计人员需要考虑电信号在芯片内部传播所需的时间，而电信号的传播速度远远低于光速。

Because sanctions have limited the first variable, Huawei is focused on the second. “Logic Folding” splits what would normally be a single chip across two bits of silicon. Those two wafers are then placed face-to-face and joined using ultra-precise bonding.

Muhannad Bakir, a professor of engineering at the Georgia Institute of Technology in Atlanta, uses the analogy of two dots on a sheet of paper. Fold the paper so the dots touch and the distance between them almost disappears. Done *in silico*, that cuts the distances electrical signals need to travel, improving speed.

由于制裁措施限制了第一个变量的使用，华为现在专注于第二个变量的发展。“逻辑折叠”技术将通常一个芯片的功能分解为两个硅片上实现。这两个硅片被紧密地放置在一起，并通过超精确的焊接技术连接在一起。亚特兰大乔治亚理工学院的工程学教授穆罕纳德·巴基尔用纸上的两个点来类比这种技术：将纸张折叠，使得这两个点相互接触，它们之间的距离几乎消失。通过这种方式，电信号在传输过程中所需的路径被大大缩短，从而提高了性能。

Huawei reckons Logic Folding can improve energy efficiency by around 40% while also increasing performance. It claims to achieve a transistor density of roughly 238m per square millimetre—mimicking the density of TSMC’s N3 process—despite using older manufacturing tools. Such comparisons should be treated cautiously, since transistor densities are difficult to compare directly across manufacturing processes. They nonetheless illustrate the company’s ambition.

华为认为，逻辑折叠技术可以将能效提升约 40%，同时还能提高性能。该公司声称能够实现每平方毫米约 2.38 亿个晶体管的密度——这一密度与台积电 N3 工艺的密度相当。尽管使用的是较旧的制造工

具，但华为仍能够实现这样的目标。不过，这种比较应该谨慎对待，因为不同制造工艺下的晶体管密度很难直接进行比较。尽管如此，这些成就仍然体现了华为的雄心壮志。

And still I rise

即便如此，我还是会站起来。

Building tall solves some problems while creating others. One is heat, already one of the biggest limiting factors in chip design. Since the heat-generating volume of a 3D chip will rise more quickly than the surface area available to remove it, the problem is likely to get worse. Chip-design software was written for largely flat layouts and must be rethought. Wafer-to-wafer bonding demands extraordinary precision; defects in either layer can sharply reduce yields. Huawei does not expect large-scale production before around 2031.

制造高密度的芯片确实能解决一些问题，但同时也会带来新的挑战。其中一个问题是热量问题，而热量已经是芯片设计中的一大限制因素。由于 3D 芯片的发热量增长速度比其散热表面积的扩展速度更快，因此这个问题可能会更加严重。用于芯片设计的软件主要是为平面布局设计的，因此必须对其进行重新设计。晶圆与晶圆的连接也需要极高的精度，任何一层中的缺陷都可能严重降低产品的良率。华为预计在 2031 年之前不会进行大规模生产。

For rivals such as TSMC the benefits of adopting Huawei's approach are not quite worth the costs today. The company reckons it can squeeze one or two more iterations out of the old, low-rise model. Huawei has no such option. The slowing of Moore's law has made the old ways of doing things less attractive for everyone. For Huawei, as the company itself admits, politics has meant those constraints have arrived earlier, and are more pressing. ■

对于像台积电这样的竞争对手来说，目前采用华为的方法所带来的好处并不值得付出这样的代价。该公司认为，他们可以从旧的、低效率的制造模式中再优化一两次。而华为则没有这样的选择。摩尔定律的

放缓使得传统的制造方式对所有人来说都不再具有吸引力。正如华为自己所说，政治因素使得这些限制因素更早出现，并且变得更加紧迫。■

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Right there in black and white

事实就是如此，一目了然。

How to hide from killer drones

如何躲避致命的无人机

In the Ukraine war, anti-AI tactics are producing bizarre forms of camouflage

在乌克兰战争中，反人工智能的战术产生了一些奇特的伪装方式。

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IN RECENT MONTHS Russian military lorries in Ukraine have begun sporting a striking new colour scheme of vivid black-and-white stripes. As camouflage goes, it is not much use against human observers. But then, it is not intended to fool biological eyes. Its aim is to frustrate the machine-vision systems that are fitted to the Ukrainian drones that zip around battlefields looking for prey.

最近，在乌克兰，俄罗斯的军用卡车开始采用一种新的颜色搭配——鲜艳的黑白条纹。从伪装的角度来看，这种颜色对于人类观察者来说并不具有太大的迷惑效果。不过，这种颜色设计的目的并非为了欺骗人类的视觉。它的目的是干扰那些安装在乌克兰无人机上的机器视觉系统，这些无人机在战场上搜寻目标时，这种颜色搭配会使其难以被识别。

The stripes are reminiscent of the “dazzle camouflage” used by the Royal Navy in the first world war. But whereas dazzle camouflage was intended to break up a ship’s silhouette, making it difficult to judge its speed and heading, the new variant aims to fool machines into thinking that a lorry is not, in fact, a lorry at all.

这些条纹让人联想到第一次世界大战期间英国海军使用的“眩目伪装”技术。不过，眩目伪装的目的是为了模糊舰船的轮廓，使敌舰难以判断其速度和航向。而新出现的这种伪装方式则旨在欺骗敌方装备，让它们误以为那辆卡车其实并不是真正的卡车。

Machine vision is based on pattern-matching. A model is trained by exposing it to images, some of which contain lorries (or tanks, or aircraft) and some of which do not. Over zillions of exposures, the computer deduces rules that allow it to identify the things its trainers want to teach it about. Because zebra-striped trucks are unlikely to appear in the training data, says Todd Humphreys, an engineer at the University of Texas at Austin, an AI that encounters one in the real world may not realise what it is looking at.

机器视觉基于模式匹配原理。通过让模型接触各种图像来进行训练，其中一些图像中出现了卡车（或坦克、飞机等物体，而另一些图像则没有这些物体。在数以亿计的训练样本中，计算机能够总结出一些规

则，从而识别出模型需要学习的内容。正如德克萨斯大学奥斯汀分校的工程师托德·汉弗莱斯所说，如果训练数据中没有出现过斑马纹路的卡车，那么在实际场景中遇到这种卡车时，人工智能可能无法识别出它到底是什么东西。

Computers often rely on very specific features to recognise an object. That leads to a problem known as “brittleness”, in which small variations can cause bizarre misclassifications. “Adversarial examples” designed to exploit the quirks of computer vision, have been around for years. One, developed at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology in 2017, featured a plastic turtle. Misled by the pattern on its shell, a computer confidently classified it as a rifle. In another project, researchers produced stickers which, when attached to roads, caused a Tesla’s self-driving software to steer into oncoming traffic.

计算机通常依赖一些非常具体的特征来识别物体。但这会导致一种被称为“脆性问题”的问题，即微小的变化可能导致奇怪的误分类结果。那些旨在利用计算机视觉特性的“对抗性示例”已经存在多年了。例如，在 2017 年由麻省理工学院开发的一个示例中，研究人员使用了一个塑料海龟作为测试对象。由于被海龟外壳上的图案误导，计算机错误地将其分类为步枪。在另一个项目中，研究人员制造了些贴纸，当这些贴纸被贴在道路上时，会导致特斯拉的自动驾驶软件误将车辆驶入对面来车的方向。

Dr Humphreys says that efforts to counter machine vision in the Ukraine conflict work on the same principle, obscuring expected features with unexpected ones. Parked Russian aircraft have been seen with rows of old tyres on their wings to confuse image-matching software on drones. Some Russian drones also now have dazzle camouflage of their own, presumably to make it harder for Ukrainian interceptor drones to identify them.

汉弗莱斯博士指出，在乌克兰冲突中用于对抗机器视觉技术的手段也是基于同样的原理——用一些不寻常的伪装来掩盖原本应该被识别的特征。人们观察到，一些停泊的俄罗斯无人机机翼上布满了旧轮胎的

痕迹，以此来干扰无人机上的图像识别系统。此外，一些俄罗斯无人机还配备了炫目迷彩装置，这显然是为了让乌克兰的拦截无人机难以识别它们。

These tactics are likely to become more common. Presently most battlefield drones are still flown by a remote human operator, who is unlikely to be fooled by the markings. But as the drones proliferate—Ukraine aims to produce 10m this year—and technology improves, AI will take on more of the work.

这些策略可能会变得越来越常见。目前，大多数战场无人机仍然由人类操作员远程操控，他们不太可能被这些标记所迷惑。但随着无人机数量的不断增加——乌克兰计划今年生产 1000 台无人机——以及技术的不断进步，人工智能将会承担更多的工作任务。

The probable result will be an arms race pitting increasingly sophisticated machine vision systems against cleverer and cleverer methods for fooling them. The advantage from any particular camouflage pattern is likely to be temporary. After all, once zebra-striped lorries are common enough they will start to turn up in training data, and models will start to see them for what they really are. A spokesman for Brave1, an arm of the Ukrainian government that aims to accelerate military technology, acknowledged that the Russians were adapting—but said Ukraine was adapting faster. ■

很可能的结果是，一场军备竞赛将会持续下去，各种越来越复杂的机器视觉系统将与人们越来越聪明的方法来对抗。任何特定伪装方式的优势都可能只是暂时的。毕竟，一旦斑马纹图案的卡车变得足够常见，它们就会开始出现在训练数据中，而模型也会逐渐认清它们的真实面目。乌克兰政府下属的 Brave1 组织的发言人承认，俄罗斯正在调整自己的策略，但他说乌克兰的适应速度更快。■

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Hitting winners

抓住机会赢钱

A statistician's guide to Wimbledon

统计学家眼中的温布尔登网球赛

How to turn a tiny advantage into sporting glory

如何将一个微小的优势转化为体育上的辉煌成就

Jul 09, 2026 05:22 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:22



Statistics in action

统计工作的实际应用

Roger Federer won 20 major tournaments during his career. Wimbledon, which started this year on June 29th, was his happiest hunting ground: he won eight times, a men's record. Yet as Mr Federer himself has noted, he won only slightly more than half of the thousands of points he played during his career.

罗杰·费德勒在他的职业生涯中赢得了 20 个重大赛事的冠军。从 6 月 29 日开始的这次温网，是他最得意的战场：他在此项赛事中取得了 8 场胜利，创下了男子网球选手的纪录。不过，正如费德勒本人所说，他在职业生涯中赢得的成千上万场比赛里，真正取得胜利的次数仅仅略高于一半而已。

This year Mr Federer, who retired in 2022, has been watching Wimbledon from the crowd. But those less familiar with the game than he is may wonder how he—or the current crop of top players—manage to convert such a narrow advantage into a winning record.

今年，于 2022 年退休的费德勒先生是作为观众观看了温布尔登网球锦标赛的比赛。不过，那些不太熟悉这项运动的人可能会好奇，他以及当今顶尖选手们是如何将如此微小的优势转化为胜绩的。

Much of the answer lies in tennis's scoring system. Stringing points into games, games into sets, and sets into a match gives plenty of time for a small advantage to compound into a convincing win. Analysis by *The Economist* of data from major tournaments between 2014 and 2025 shows that, in the men's game, a player that is just 1% more likely to win the average point is 12.5% more likely to win the match. For women, the figure is about 10.5%.

答案主要在于网球计分系统。将分数分解为比赛、比赛组以及比赛局，这样就能为微小的优势提供足够的时间，从而带来决定性的胜利。根据《经济学人》对 2014 年至 2025 年重大赛事数据的分析，在男子网球比赛中，如果一名球员赢得平均分数的概率增加 1%，那么他赢得比赛的概率就会增加 12.5%。对于女子网球来说，这一比例约为 10.5%。

But there are quirks. One is the serve: a player is more likely to win a point when serving. Wimbledon's fast grass courts enhance the advantage, reducing the returns to non-serve skills by around 2.5% compared with other surfaces. Another oddity arises from the fact that men play up to five sets, while a women's match is capped at three. Our analysis suggests this reduces the returns to skill in the women's game by 25% compared to the men's—which makes Martina Navratilova's nine Wimbledon trophies look even more impressive.

不过，也有一些特殊之处。其中之一就是发球环节：在发球时，球员更容易赢得一分。温布尔登球场的高速草地球场进一步增强了这一优势，与其他球场相比，非发球技巧的回报降低了约 2.5%。另一个奇怪的现象是，男子比赛最多进行五盘比赛，而女子比赛则限制在三盘以内。我们的分析表明，这一规则使得女子比赛的回报降低了 25%，这使得玛蒂娜·纳夫拉蒂洛娃在温布尔登赛场上获得的九座冠军奖杯显得更加令人印象深刻。

Tennis enthusiasts have suggested more efficient ways of doing things. In 1992, Graham Pollard, a statistician then at the University of Canberra, suggested replacing the current game-set-match structure with what would be essentially a pair of tie-breaks. Players would alternate serve until one managed to pull ahead by a certain number of points (in existing tie-breaks a two-point lead is enough to win, but a higher number would reduce the effect of luck). If one player wins both games, he is the victor; if not a new pair is played. Dr Pollard reckoned his scheme could identify the better player in half the time of a typical match.

网球爱好者们提出了更有效的比赛方式。1992 年，当时在堪培拉大学工作的统计学家格雷厄姆·波拉德建议用双盘赛来替代目前的比赛模式。选手们会轮流发球，直到其中一方取得一定的分数优势（在目前的双盘赛中，两分的领先优势就足以获胜，但更高的分数则会降低运气的作用）。如果有一方赢得了两场比赛，那么他就是胜者；如果没有，则继续进行下一盘比赛。波拉德认为，他的方案能够在通常的比赛中，有一半的情况下识别出更强的选手。

Since many fans enjoy tennis for its own sake, that might not be a popular selling point (it would also leave broadcasters with a lot of dead air to fill). So how can a player make the most of a slim edge under the current rules?

由于许多球迷欣赏网球运动本身，因此这一特点可能并不适合作为销售点来推广（因为这样做还会让转播者在比赛期间有很多时间处于空白状态）。那么，球员们要如何利用现行规则下所拥有的微弱优势呢？

Being able to rise to the occasion is one important ability. A paper published in 2001 by Franc Klaassen and Jan Magnus, a pair of economists, found that serves at Wimbledon lose some of their power on break points. The serving player is 0.8% less likely than usual to win any break point, and 4.6% less likely when the score is 5-5 in the final set. Some players keep their heads better than others. A 2012 study by Julio González-Díaz, a statistician, and his colleagues found that only about half of the top 25 players by ranking were also in the top 25 for this critical ability. Mr Federer was one. As his fans have always known, part of the recipe for his success was his grace under pressure. ■

能够应对各种突发情况是一种非常重要的能力。2001 年，经济学家 Franc Klaassen 和 Jan Magnus 发表的一项研究发现，参加温布尔登网球锦标赛的球员在决胜点时的表现有所下降。与平时相比，这些球员赢得决胜点的概率降低了 0.8%，而在最终盘比分达到 5-5 时，这一概率则降低了 4.6%。有些球员确实比其他球员更能保持冷静。2012 年，统计学家 Julio González-Díaz 和他的同事们进行的一项研究发现，排名前 25 的球员中，只有大约一半具备这种关键能力。费德勒就是其中之一。正如他的粉丝们所知道的，他的成功秘诀之一就是他在压力下的冷静态度。

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Tall order

高个子订单

How the biggest trees survive droughts

那些最大的树木是如何在干旱中生存下来的？

Being tall would be a disadvantage, if not for some clever engineering

如果不用一些巧妙的设计手段，那么身高就会成为一个缺点。

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2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 05:59



TOWERING OVER 100 metres above the forest floor, the dipterocarp—named after its winged seeds, which spiral away in the wind—is the tallest tropical tree in the world. For a plant, being tall is an advantage: if your neighbours cannot overshadow you, that leaves you with the lion's share of the sunlight.

这种双子叶植物生长在森林地面上 100 米以上的高度，因其种子具有翅膀且会在风中飘动而得名。它是世界上最高的热带树木。对于这种植物来说，高大的体型确实是一种优势：如果其他植物无法遮挡阳光，那么就可以获得更多的阳光了。

But trees need water as well as light, and here being tall presents a problem. The physics of moving liquid through thin channels means that the taller a tree gets, the harder it is to pump water from the soil to the leaves in the crown. Scientists had assumed that would leave big trees, like dipterocarps, more vulnerable than their more diminutive competitors when water was scarce. But in a paper published on July 2nd in *Science*, a team led by Paulo Bittencourt of Cardiff University have shown that, thanks to some clever evolutionary engineering, that is not true.

不过，树木除了需要光照之外，还需要水。而树的高度问题就出现了：当树木越高时，将水从土壤输送到叶片就越困难。科学家们原本认为，像檀香树这样的高大树木，在缺水的情况下会比那些较小的树木更容易受到威胁。但卡迪夫大学保罗·比特滕库尔领导的团队在 7 月 2 日出版的《科学》杂志上发表的一篇论文表明，由于一些巧妙的进化工程设计，这种情况并不成立。

A tree's trunk contains a network of tubes known as xylem whose job is to ferry water from the roots to leaves. While many animals pump fluid around their bodies with a heart, trees rely on evaporation to keep the liquids flowing. As water in the leaves escapes into the air, it creates suction in the xylem. That draws more water up to fill the space. That process is aided by the properties of

water itself. Water molecules tend to cling to their neighbours, so that as one is drawn up, others follow. The molecules also adhere to the walls of the xylem, helping to counteract the downward pull of gravity.

树木的树干内部有一套管状结构，称为木质部。这些管状结构的作用是将水分从根部输送到叶片。虽然许多动物通过心脏来循环体内的液体，但树木则依靠蒸发来保持液体的流动。当叶中的水分蒸发到空气中时，会在木质部产生一种吸力，从而将更多的水分吸入树内。这一过程还得益于水的特性——水分子倾向于聚集在邻近的位置，因此当一个水分子被吸入时，其他分子也会随之被吸入。此外，水分子还会附着在木质部的壁上，从而帮助抵抗重力对水分的向下拉力。

This plumbing system, clever as it is, poses two problems for tall timber. The first is due to gravity. As the height of a tree increases, so does the tension towards the top of its xylem. If that tension gets too high the links between water molecules can break, allowing pockets of air to form and blocking the flow. The second is the length of the tubes themselves. It is harder to sip orange juice through a long straw than a short one. For the same reason—friction between the liquid and the walls, mostly—the greater the distance between a tree's roots and leaves, the harder it is for water to flow up its xylem.

尽管这种管道系统非常巧妙，但它在高大的树木上仍会带来两个问题。第一个问题是重力的影响。随着树木高度的增加，其木质部顶部的张力也会随之增大。如果这种张力过高，水分子之间的连接就会断裂，导致空气气泡的形成，从而阻碍水分的流动。第二个问题是管道本身的长度。用长吸管喝橙汁比用短吸管要困难得多。出于同样的原因——液体与管道内壁之间的摩擦作用——树木的根部与叶片之间的距离越长，水分向木质部流动的难度就越大。

These challenges had led to a prediction among dendrologists: giant trees ought to have a harder time getting water up to their leaves, leaving them more at risk of drought. And yet, says Dr Bittencourt, actual data was lacking. That is perhaps not surprising, for collecting

it is hard work. The tallest trees can be scaled only by specialist climbers.

这些挑战使得树木学家们预测：巨大的树木很难将水分输送到叶片上，因此更容易受到干旱的影响。不过，Bittencourt 博士指出，实际上缺乏相关的数据支持这一预测。这或许并不奇怪，因为收集这些数据是一件非常困难的事情。最高的树木只能由专业的攀爬者才能到达。

Fortunately, some of Dr Bittencourt's colleagues were experienced tree-climbers. The team chose as test subjects a collection of dipterocarps in a rainforest in north-eastern Borneo. Over the course of three months in 2022, the researchers measured 38 different trees. The team then monitored how fast 27 of those trees grew over 770 days from 2022 to 2024.

幸运的是，Bittencourt 博士的一些同事都是经验丰富的树木攀爬专家。研究团队在婆罗洲东北部的雨林中选择了一些龙脑木科植物作为实验对象。在 2022 年的三个月时间里，研究人员测量了 38 种不同的树木。随后，研究团队监测了这 27 棵树木从 2022 年到 2024 年间 770 天内生长的速度。

"What we found is that [the trees] were adjusting some key parameters so they could be very tall and still keep their leaves hydrated," says Dr Bittencourt. Each tree's water-transporting xylem widened as they ran from tip to base, which helps reduce resistance in the parts of the xylem closest to the ground. For the tallest trees, the widening was more pronounced than would be expected if they were simply scaled-up versions of their shorter relatives.

"我们发现，这些树木正在调整一些关键参数，使得它们能够长得非常高，同时还能保持叶片的湿润状态，"Bittencourt 博士说。每棵树的木质部在从树尖到树底的过程中都会扩大，这有助于减少靠近地面的木质部部分的阻力。对于最高的树木来说，这种扩大现象比那些较矮的同类树木更为明显。

Gravity meant that the pulling power of leaves declined as trees got taller, as expected. But the dipterocarps had accounted for that too. Their highest leaves sported higher concentrations of osmolytes—chemicals that help cells hold their shape when water is scarce. That meant they were no more susceptible to wilting than those lower down. Thanks to such clever engineering, the researchers found no relation between a tree's height and a reduction in its growth rate during a six-month drought that began in December 2023.

根据重力作用，随着树木的高度增加，树叶的吸附力会减弱，这是意料之中的现象。不过，双子叶植物也解释了这一现象。它们最顶端的叶子含有较高浓度的渗透剂——这类化学物质能在缺水时帮助细胞保持形态。这意味着它们并不比低处的叶子更容易枯萎。由于这种巧妙的设计，研究人员发现，在 2023 年 12 月开始的六个月干旱期间，树木的高度与其生长速率之间没有任何关系。

By virtue of their enormous size, the tallest 1% of trees store over half of the carbon in Earth's forests. The assumption that these giants will be the most severely affected by droughts is factored into some climate-change models. The dipterocarp's clever plumbing suggests those models may need pruning. ■

由于体型巨大，地球上最顶端的 1% 的树木能够储存超过一半的森林碳储量。一些气候变化模型都假设这些巨大的树木会受到干旱的最严重影响。而双子叶植物的特殊生长特性表明，这些模型可能需要进行修正。 ■

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Well Informed

非常了解情况

How little exercise can you get away with?

你能逃避多少锻炼任务呢？

Even tiny bursts of activity have measurable benefits

即使是很短暂的活动时段，也都能带来可测量的好处。

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FEW THINGS are as unambiguously good for you as exercise. Besides making you fitter and stronger, it cuts your risk of heart disease,

strokes, diabetes, many types of cancer and more.

没有什么东西比锻炼更能明确地带来健康益处了。锻炼不仅能让你变得更健康、更强壮，还能降低你患心脏病、中风、糖尿病、多种癌症等疾病的风险。

But how much of the cure-all do you really need? The World Health Organisation (WHO) recommends at least 150 minutes a week of moderate activity, such as easy jogging or cycling, and two sessions a week of [strength training](#). Many still fall short. In America, for instance, less than half of adults meet the minimum recommendations for just cardiovascular exercise alone.

但是，你真正需要那么多“万能药”吗？世界卫生组织建议每周至少进行 150 分钟的中等强度运动，比如轻松的慢跑或骑自行车，同时每周进行两次力量训练。不过，许多人仍然达不到这个标准。例如，在美国，只有不到一半的成年人能够完成关于心血管运动的最低要求。

Those who hate pounding the pavements need not despair, though. Even a little exercise is better than none. And a growing pile of evidence suggests that might be true even with very small amounts of exercise indeed: potentially just a few minutes a day.

不过，那些不喜欢走路的人也不必绝望。即使进行少量的锻炼也比不锻炼要好。越来越多的证据表明，即使每天只进行几分钟的锻炼也是可行的。

Scientists have long known that the returns to exercise are not constant. The biggest benefits come from doing any at all. Doing lots is better than doing just a little, but the relative improvement is smaller. A meta-analysis published in 2015 pooled data covering around 660,000 people in America and compared the amount of exercise participants claimed to do with the number who died over the following years (the average follow-up period was 14 years).

科学家们早就知道，锻炼带来的好处并非是随着时间推移而恒定不变的。最大的益处在于持续进行锻炼。大量锻炼比少量锻炼更有益，但两者之间的改善幅度相对较小。2015 年发表的一项荟萃分析汇总了约

66 万美国人的数据，比较了这些参与者声称的锻炼量与他们在随后几年内的死亡人数之间的关系（平均随访期为 14 年）。

Compared with those who did no exercise at all, people who reported doing less than the WHO's minimum had a 20% lower chance of dying over the follow-up period. Those who did between one and two times as much as the WHO guidelines saw their risk fall by 31%. The truly keen, who did two to three times more than advised, saw a drop of 37%—a much smaller jump than those who went from nothing to just a little.

与那些完全不锻炼的人相比，那些锻炼量低于世界卫生组织建议最低标准的人，在随访期间死亡的风险降低了 20%。而那些锻炼量是世界卫生组织建议量的一到两倍的人，其风险降低了 31%。而那些锻炼量是建议量的两到三倍的人，其风险降低了 37%——这一数值比那些从没有锻炼到开始少量锻炼的人要小得多。

One problem with such studies is that they rely on self-reporting, which is often unreliable. Newer studies use wearable sensors, which are more reliable and which allow more granular measurements. They suggest that even tiny, irregular spurts of exercise can have powerful health benefits.

这类研究的一个问题是，它们依赖于自我报告的数据，而自我报告往往不可靠。较新的研究则使用可穿戴传感器，这种方式更为可靠，也能进行更精细的测量。研究表明，即使是很短暂、不规则的锻炼活动，也能带来显著的健康益处。

In 2022 a group of researchers published a study that crunched data from 25,000 British people who did no organised exercise. The researchers were interested in “vigorous intermittent lifestyle physical activity”, or VILPA—short bursts of relatively intense exercise undertaken in daily life, such as running for a bus or climbing steep stairs.

在 2022 年，一组研究人员发表了一项研究，该研究分析了 25,000 名不进行有组织体育锻炼的英国人的数据。研究人员关注的是“高强度间

歇性身体活动”，即日常生活中进行的短暂而高强度的运动，比如为赶公交车而跑步，或者爬陡峭的楼梯。

Few of the participants did much VILPA—the median was just 4.4 minutes per day. But even that was associated with a reduction in the chance of dying, from any cause, of up to 30% in the following seven years for which the average participant was monitored. The correlation persisted even after the researchers tried to account for the idea that causality might run the other way, with only the already healthy capable of performing VILPA.

参与实验的人中，很少有人进行大量的 VILPA 活动——平均每天只进行 4.4 分钟。不过，即便如此，他们死亡的风险还是降低了 30%。在监测的七年时间里，平均每位参与者的死亡风险都有所下降。这种关联在研究人员尝试考虑因果关系可能相反的情况后仍然成立——只有那些已经身体健康、有能力进行 VILPA 活动的人才会受益。

Exactly why VILPAs seem to be so good for you is not yet clear (one theory is that they work in essentially the same way as high-intensity interval training, a [quick but demanding](#) method of getting into shape). But inspired by the results, some academics have started advocating “exercise snacks”: short bursts of activity that even the most gym-shy or time-pressed should be able to manage. Do some bodyweight squats while waiting for the kettle to boil, say, or knock out some star jumps during a dull Zoom meeting (but don’t forget to turn the camera off first). As the old saying goes, every little helps. In fact, it may help much more than you think. ■

目前还不清楚为什么 VILPAs 对人们如此有益（有一种理论认为，它的运作方式类似于高强度间歇训练——一种快速但要求较高的锻炼方式）。不过，基于这些发现，一些学者开始提倡“运动零食”的概念：即一些短时间的锻炼活动，即使是最不喜欢运动或时间紧张的人也能轻松完成。比如在等待水壶烧水的时候做几个自重深蹲，或者在无聊的 Zoom 会议中做几个跳跃动作吧（不过记得先关掉摄像头哦）。正如那句老话所说，点滴的努力总归会有帮助。事实上，这种帮助可能比你想象的还要大得多。■

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Game of phonies

虚假的游戏

Inside the fantasy world of Donald Trump

在唐纳德·特朗普的幻想世界中

"Regime Change" is an eye-popping report on "the most powerful man that the planet has ever known"

《政权更迭》是一份引人注目的报告，讲述了“这个世界上最具有影响力的人物”的故事。

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2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:37



Regime Change. By Maggie Haberman and Jonathan Swan. *Simon & Schuster*; 496 pages; \$34 and £28

《政权更迭》由玛吉·哈伯曼和乔纳森·斯旺撰写。西蒙与舒斯特出版社出版；共 496 页；定价 34 美元或 28 英镑。

PUNDITS OFTEN say that Trump World resembles “Game of Thrones” because it is a place where horrid people do horrid things in pursuit of power. Fiddlesticks. The main reason why Trump World is like a dragons-and-zombies saga is that its protagonists live in a land of make-believe.

专家们常常认为，特朗普的世界就像《权力的游戏》一样，因为那里有那些邪恶的人为了追求权力而做出各种可怕的事情。不过，这种说法完全错误。实际上，特朗普的世界更像是一部由龙和僵尸构成的传奇故事——它的主角们生活在一个虚构的世界中。

Especially [President Donald Trump](#), whose understanding of reality seems to be based on snippets he once heard and wishes were true. “Regime Change”, an account of his second term by two *New York Times* journalists, Maggie Haberman and Jonathan Swan, brims with examples.

尤其是唐纳德·特朗普总统，他对现实的理解似乎基于一些他曾经听到过但希望是真实的事情。《政权更迭》这本书由《纽约时报》的两位记者玛吉·哈伯曼和乔纳森·斯旺撰写，书中充满了这样的例子。

America was at its richest “from 1870 to 1913”, when it was “a [tariff](#) country”, claims Mr Trump. Actually, Americans are six times richer now than they were in 1913, even if you ignore the full benefits of new inventions such as GPS and antibiotics. The president thinks global trade means foreigners screwing Uncle Sam. So when his commerce secretary showed him that Chinese and Indian tariffs on American goods were not very high, he called the numbers “fucking bullshit” and ordered Natalie Harp, a young blonde aide whose job is to print out positive news for him, to Google up “the real numbers”. Ms Harp, “despite her best efforts”, could not find “the numbers that

didn't exist".

特朗普声称，美国在 1870 到 1913 年期间是最繁荣的时期，那时美国是一个实行关税制度的国家。实际上，现在的美国人比 1913 年时富裕了六倍，即便不考虑 GPS 和抗生素等新发明的巨大贡献。总统认为全球贸易意味着外国人在剥削美国人民。当他的商务部长向他展示中国和印度对美国商品的关税并不高时，他称这些数字为“一派胡言”，并命令负责发布积极消息的年轻金发助手娜塔莉·哈普去谷歌搜索“真实的数字”。不过，哈普尽管尽力了，还是找不到“那些根本不存在的数字”。

Much of the federal government continues to operate normally, responding more or less rationally to old-fashioned facts. But in the White House, fantasy reigns. The Philippines has no drug problems because President Rodrigo Duterte kills drug dealers without fussing about “due process”, Mr Trump told his advisers. Actually the Philippines continues to have a huge drugs problem, and Mr Duterte [will face trial](#) in The Hague later this year for crimes against humanity.

联邦政府的许多部门仍然正常运作，大致按照传统的方式来处理各种事务。但在白宫，幻想却占主导地位。特朗普告诉他的顾问们，菲律宾不存在毒品问题，因为罗德里戈·杜特尔特总统会毫不犹豫地处决毒贩，而无需考虑“法定程序”。实际上，菲律宾的毒品问题依然非常严重，杜特尔特总统今年早些时候将在海牙因反人类罪受到审判。

Some courtiers are grounded in reality, but they keep quiet about it. [Marco Rubio](#), Mr Trump's secretary of state, “never lectured the president or flaunted his own knowledge”, Ms Haberman and Mr Swan write. When facts fail to fit the message, they are memory-holed. For example, the message after the murder of [Charlie Kirk](#), a conservative activist, was that America was being overrun by left-wing terrorists. So the Justice Department website quietly took down an official study showing that far-right terrorists in America kill many

more people than left-wingers do.

一些朝臣虽然了解现实情况，但却选择保持沉默。特朗普的国务卿马克·鲁比奥“从未对总统进行过任何批评，也没有炫耀自己的知识”，哈伯曼女士和斯旺先生写道。当事实与他们的宣传观点不符时，他们便选择忽略这些事实。例如，在保守派活动人士查理·柯克被谋杀之后，媒体宣传称美国正受到左翼恐怖分子的威胁。然而，美国司法部网站上有一份官方研究报告，该报告表明，美国的右翼恐怖分子所杀害的人数远远超过左翼分子。

All of Mr Trump's aides must profess to believe that the election in 2020 was stolen. One candidate was rejected simply for praising Mike Pence, the former vice-president, who refused to pretend his boss had won. This filter lets Mr Trump select staff who are prepared to lie for him—and perhaps [break other norms](#), too.

特朗普的所有助手都必须声称相信 2020 年的选举是被操纵的。有一位候选人仅仅因为赞扬前副总统迈克·彭斯而被淘汰出局，彭斯拒绝承认自己的上司赢得了选举。这种筛选机制让特朗普能够选择那些愿意为他撒谎的人作为助手——或许他们还会打破其他规则。

Another crucial tool for manipulating reality is to redefine words. The Democratic Party “is not a political party. It is a domestic extremist organisation,” says Stephen Miller, one of Mr Trump's most extreme advisers. A terrorist is not, as the dictionary says, someone who uses violence for political or ideological ends. The label can be applied to peaceful protesters and even to groups that do not exist, such as the “Cartel de los Soles” in Venezuela. An emergency need not be a sudden crisis but can include the trade deficit, which America has coped with just fine since 1976. An “invasion” can mean drug-smuggling or even foreigners crossing the border to clean hotel rooms.

另一种操纵现实的重要手段就是重新定义词汇的含义。特朗普最激进的顾问之一斯蒂芬·米勒声称：“民主党并不是一个政党，而是一个国内极端组织。”不过，词典中所谓的“恐怖分子”并非指那些为政治或意识形态目的而使用暴力的人。这个标签可以适用于和平的抗议者，甚

至那些根本不存在的组织，比如委内瑞拉的“太阳集团”。所谓“紧急状态”并不一定意味着突发危机，也可能指贸易逆差——自 1976 年以来，美国一直能够很好地应对这种情况。而“入侵”一词则可能被用来指代毒品走私，甚至是指外国人闯入酒店房间进行清洁行为。

Fake newspeak

虚假新闻主义

It is not nit-picking to complain about Mr Trump's abuse of language. Laws consist of words. So when the president asserts the right to change their meaning, he is asserting the right to change the law. If protesters are terrorists, then federal agents who shoot them may be justified. If drug-smugglers are invaders, they can be bombed. If the war on Iran is not a war, as Mr Trump has claimed, then he does not need Congress's permission to wage it. If he can declare "emergencies" at will, he can wield emergency powers whenever he feels like it. America's courts have struck down some of these outrageous power grabs, but not all.

抱怨特朗普滥用语言并非小题大做。法律是由文字构成的。因此，当总统声称有权改变法律的含义时，实际上是在行使修改法律的权力。如果抗议者是恐怖分子，那么枪杀他们的联邦执法人员或许是有正当理由的。如果毒品走私者是入侵者，那么可以炸死他们。如果特朗普所声称的针对伊朗的战争并非战争，那么他就不需要国会的许可就可以发动这场战争。如果他可以随意宣布“紧急状态”，那么他可以随时行使紧急权力。美国的法院已经对一些这种荒谬的权力滥用行为进行了裁决，但并非所有情况都是如此。

Ms Haberman and Mr Swan offer little original analysis. Instead, they offer something that will let readers draw their own conclusions: dogged, meticulous reporting that illuminates how exceptional this White House is. [Trump-sceptical readers](#) will love it: already "Regime Change" has shot to first place on the *New York Times* bestseller list

and quickly sold out in bookshops and on Amazon in America.

哈伯曼女士和斯旺先生提供的分析并不具有创新性。相反，他们提供了一些让读者能够自行判断的内容：一份细致入微的报道，揭示了白宫的卓越之处。那些对特朗普持怀疑态度的人一定会喜欢这本书——《政权更迭》已经跃居《纽约时报》畅销书排行榜榜首，并在美国的书店和亚马逊网站上迅速售罄。

Some of the book's details are trivial: Mr Trump thinks he is a better interior decorator than anyone else; an aide saw him supergluing fancy gold decorations to an Oval Office fireplace. At other times, his vanity has global consequences. The head of the CIA told him that a plan for quick, easy regime change in Iran, as presented by Binyamin Netanyahu, Israel's prime minister, was "farcical". But Mr Trump had "a good feeling". What would the head of the CIA know about intelligence?

这本书中的一些细节其实并不重要：特朗普先生认为自己比任何人都更擅长室内装饰；有一次，他的一个助手看到他在白宫的壁炉上贴满了金色的装饰品。而有时候，他的虚荣心会带来全球性的后果。中央情报局局长告诉他，以色列总理本雅明·内塔尼亚胡提出的关于在伊朗快速轻松地更换政府的计划是“荒谬的”。不过，特朗普先生似乎对此并不在意。毕竟，中央情报局局长怎么会了解情报方面的知识呢？

Mr Trump has made billions of dollars from being president. Gulf states that need America's protection just so happen to invest huge amounts of money in his family's crypto ventures. Countries that wish to avoid punitive tariffs race to greenlight Trump golf courses or hotel projects. "Neither the president nor his family has ever engaged—or will ever engage—in conflicts of interest," declare his flacks, week after week, with impressively straight faces.

特朗普从担任总统的职位上赚得了数十亿美元。那些需要美国保护的海湾国家，恰好在他的家族加密货币项目中投入了巨额资金。那些希望避免遭受惩罚性关税的国家，纷纷抢先投资特朗普旗下的高尔夫球场和酒店项目。他的亲信们每周都宣称：“总统和他的家族从未有过，也永远不会有任何利益冲突。”他们的表情显得非常镇定。

The authors add depth to this familiar tale of shamelessness. Boris Epshteyn, a lawyer who had helped Mr Trump stay out of prison, was accused of demanding fat pay-offs from prospective second-term appointees to whisper a good word in the boss's ear, and of bad-mouthing those who refused, such as Scott Bessent, now the treasury secretary. The White House counsel urged Mr Trump to cut ties with Mr Epshteyn (who denies the allegations). Mr Trump said no. Another adviser "explained that Trump...valued lawyers he thought would do anything for him" and hated making enemies of those privy to his secrets. He had been burned before.

这些作者为这个关于无耻行为的故事增添了更多的深度。鲍里斯·埃普什琴是一名律师，他曾帮助特朗普避免入狱。他被指控要求那些可能再次获得任命的人支付巨额贿赂，以便在老板耳边说好话；他还指责那些拒绝支付贿赂的人，比如现在的财政部长斯科特·贝森特。白宫顾问建议特朗普与埃普什琴断绝关系（埃普什琴否认了这些指控）。但特朗普拒绝了这一建议。另一位顾问表示，特朗普很看重那些他认为可以为他做任何事的律师，同时他也不愿意与那些知道他秘密的人为敌。他之前就经历过这种事情。

One of Mr Trump's positive qualities is that he often gives interviews. He spent an hour with the authors, despite knowing them as critics. It was on the 17th day of his war with Iran, Brent crude was more than \$100 a barrel—and he was keen to show them plans for his [White House ballroom](#). Then he quoted "a historian" who wrote that "Donald Trump is, without question, the most powerful man that the planet has ever known." Alexander the Great and the Caesars did not have aeroplanes. Hitler, Mao and Stalin did not have Mr Trump's global reach. The "historian" who wrote this, it turned out, was a

golf caddy. ■

特朗普先生的一个优点就是他经常接受采访。尽管他知道那些采访者是评论家，但他还是花了一个小时时间与他们交谈。就在他与伊朗开战的第十七天，布伦特原油的价格超过了每桶 100 美元——而他则迫不及待地想向他们展示自己白宫宴会厅的规划方案。随后，他引用了一位“历史学家”的话，该历史学家写道：“唐纳德·特朗普无疑是有史以来最有权势的人。”然而，亚历山大大帝和凯撒王朝时期可没有飞机；希特勒、毛泽东和斯大林也远远比不上特朗普的全球影响力。而这位写下这段话的“历史学家”，其实只是一个高尔夫球助理而已。■

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The resistance movement

抵抗运动

A century on, Pilates flexes its muscles

一个世纪过去了，普拉提仍然发挥着作用。

An old exercise method is newly trendy

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ATTENDING A PILATES class means reckoning with your own feebleness. The Reformer machine—a moving carriage attached to various springs and straps—looks rather like a torture device (and, depending on your instructor’s inclination, it can be). The idea is to perform slow, controlled movements such as lunges using springs as resistance; it does not sound too bad. But then, out of nowhere, you are dripping with sweat and your knees are shaking as if you are performing a bad [Elvis](#) impersonation.

参加普拉提课程意味着要面对自己的脆弱之处。普拉提器械是一种由各种弹簧和带子连接而成的健身器材，看起来有点像一种折磨人的工具（当然，这取决于教练的喜好，它也可能被塑造成有趣的样子）。练习时，人们会利用弹簧作为阻力来做出缓慢、有控制的动作，比如弓步等。听起来还不错吧。但是，突然之间，你就会大汗淋漓，膝盖也会颤抖，就像在模仿糟糕的猫王一样。

Perhaps it is cool to be humbled, because Pilates—which can be performed on a mat as well as a machine—is absolutely on fire (emphasis on the abs). It was the fastest-growing workout type worldwide in 2025 on ClassPass, a fitness-session booking platform. Earlier this year Google searches for Reformer Pilates hit an all-time high. On social media videos often go viral—particularly ones of muscly men struggling and cursing through a session.

或许，经历一次谦卑的体验也是一种酷事吧。因为普拉提这种锻炼方式，既可以在垫子上进行，也可以在器械上进行——而且它的效果非常棒！在 ClassPass 这个健身课程预约平台上，普拉提是 2025 年全球增长最快的健身方式之一。今年，谷歌上关于“Reformer 普拉提”的搜索量达到了历史最高水平。在社交媒体上，这类视频常常迅速走红——尤其是那些展示强壮男性在锻炼过程中努力完成课程的视频。

MMCG, a property consultancy, has estimated that Club Pilates, America’s largest studio [franchise](#), grew from fewer than 50 branches in 2015 to more than 1,100 in 2024. “People are opening Pilates studios the way they opened frozen yogurt places and car washes,” says Maria Leone of Bodyline, a studio in Los Angeles, a

city renowned for toned, beach-ready bodies.

MMCG 是一家房地产咨询公司，他们估计，美国最大的普拉提工作室连锁店——Club Pilates，从 2015 年仅有不到 50 家门店，发展到 2024 年时已增至 1100 多家门店。“人们开设普拉提工作室的方式，就像他们开设冷冻酸奶店和洗车店一样，”洛杉矶的 Bodyline 公司的 Maria Leone 说道。洛杉矶以其紧致、适合海滩生活的身材而闻名。

This is not to say Pilates is new: in fact, Joseph Pilates (pictured below) opened the first studio in New York in 1926. A German fitness fanatic, he devised the system while interned in a British camp during the [first world war](#). He initially dubbed his exercises, which strengthen muscles but minimise stress on the joints, “Contrology”. Unsurprisingly the name did not stick.

这并不是说普拉提是全新的运动方式：实际上，约瑟夫·普拉蒂斯（如下图所示）于 1926 年在纽约开设了第一家普拉提工作室。这位德国健身狂热者是在第一次世界大战期间在英国的一个军营中实习时发明了这一运动方式。他最初将这种能够增强肌肉力量同时减少对关节压力的锻炼方法命名为“控制法”。不过，很可惜这个名称并没有被长久保留下来。



Looking strapping
看起来身材很健壮

The appeal of Pilates, then and now, is its emphasis on power and flexibility. The rewards of [strength training](#) are widely known and this format appeals to women who may not enjoy pumping iron in the gym, reckons Bethan Dando, a Pilates instructor. Its reputation for improving mobility, aiding muscle recovery and strengthening joints also makes it an effective complement to weightlifting, which could explain the rising interest from men. It has been endorsed by athletes including [LeBron James](#), an American basketball player, and George Ford, an English rugby player, who reckon Pilates helps with injury rehabilitation and keeps them supple.

无论是过去还是现在，普拉提的魅力都在于它强调的力量与柔韧性训练。力量训练带来的好处是众所周知的，这种训练方式很适合那些不喜欢在健身房里进行力量训练的女性，普拉提教练贝桑·丹多如是说。普拉提还能改善关节活动能力、促进肌肉恢复以及强化关节结构，因此它可以很好地与举重训练相结合，这也解释了为什么越来越多的男性开始关注普拉提了。包括美国篮球运动员勒布朗·詹姆斯和英国橄榄球运动员乔治·福特在内的许多运动员都认可普拉提的效果，他们认为普拉提有助于伤病的康复，并让肌肉保持弹性。

Can the craze stretch further? Jeff Bladt of Playlist, ClassPass's parent company, says that in some markets supply growth is outpacing that of demand, so a saturation point may be near. Many tremble at the cost: in New York, a single Reformer class will set you back around \$50. But the market is not hamstrung yet. Its fans may feel weak, but the Pilates brand is strong. ■

这种热潮还能继续蔓延下去吗？Playlist 公司的 Jeff Bladt 指出，在一些市场领域，供应增长的速度超过了需求的增长速度，因此可能已经接近饱和点了。很多人都在考虑成本问题：在纽约，一套 Reformer 器械的价格大约需要 50 美元左右。不过，市场还没有达到饱和状态。虽然粉丝们可能感觉力量不足，但 Pilates 这个品牌仍然很有影响力。■

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In with the old

属于旧的那些

Why Old Master paintings are back in vogue

为什么老大师的画作又重新流行起来了？

Attitudes towards art, value and what it takes to be a good collector are changing

人们对艺术的态度、对艺术价值的认知，以及成为一位优秀的收藏家所需的条件，都在发生着变化。

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Would you have duked it out for him?

你会为他而战吗？

ON FIRST GLANCE the painting—by an unknown Dutch artist in the 17th century—seemed unlikely to spark a bidding war. It depicts two skulls and a handwritten note asking “Uter dominus, uter servus?” (Which is the master, which is the slave?) Yet on June 30th heady bidding at an auction at Christie’s in London pushed the painting’s price to £431,000 (\$575,000), about four times the estimate. There is a “yearning for the unusual”, explains Andrew Fletcher, head of Christie’s Old Masters department, who has seen a surge of interest in “the weird and wonderful”.

乍看之下，这幅由一位不知名的荷兰艺术家在 17 世纪创作的画作似乎并不值得竞拍。画中描绘的是两颗头骨，以及一张手写的纸条，上面写着“主还是仆？”然而，在 6 月 30 日于伦敦克里斯蒂拍卖行举行的拍卖会上，这幅画的成交价飙升至 431,000 英镑（约合 575,000 美元），大约是估价的四倍。克里斯蒂拍卖行古代艺术部负责人安德鲁·弗莱彻解释说，现在人们越来越渴望看到一些不寻常的作品。他提到，人们对“奇奇怪怪”的艺术品越来越感兴趣。

Old Masters—a centuries-spanning category that includes works typically completed before 1850—have seen new life breathed into them. In that same Christie's auction records were set for six artists, including Sir Thomas Lawrence, an English painter, whose portrait of the Duke of Wellington (pictured above), the general who beat [Napoleon](#), fetched £9.7m. "It's the most optimistic moment I can remember in the Old Masters market for some years," says Mr Fletcher.

“老大师”这一类别的作品跨越了几个世纪，这些作品通常创作于 1850 年之前。如今，这些作品重新焕发了生机。在 Christie's 拍卖会上，甚至有六位艺术家的作品创下了新高。其中包括英国画家托马斯·劳伦斯爵士的肖像画——这幅画描绘了击败拿破仑的将军威灵顿公爵。这幅画的拍卖价格为 970 万英镑。“这是我近年来在‘老大师’艺术品市场上感受到的最乐观的时刻，”弗莱彻先生说道。

The value of Old Masters sales worldwide in 2025 was \$1.2bn, 30% higher than a year earlier. But data may not capture the “full story” of the uptick, as many paintings are sold privately, says Patrick Williams, a gallerist in New York. Younger buyers are showing more enthusiasm. This year around 16% of bidders in Old Masters sales at Sotheby's, another auction house, are under the age of 40, nearly triple the share from five years ago.

到 2025 年，全球范围内古大师作品的拍卖额将达到 12 亿美元，比去年同期增长 30%。不过，数据可能并未完全反映这一增长的实际情况，因为许多画作都是私下出售的。纽约的一位艺术品经销商帕特里克·威廉姆斯指出，年轻买家对古大师作品的兴趣日益浓厚。在苏富比等拍卖行举办的古大师作品拍卖会上，今年约有 16% 的竞买者年龄在 40 岁以下，这一比例几乎是五年前的三倍。



Until the 1980s Old Masters ruled the art world. But then collectors decided the category was too old-timey and turned to collecting [Impressionist](#) and contemporary works instead. Several things have changed in the past two years. First, some parts of the market for contemporary art showed signs of volatility. Collectors realised that

Old Masters are stable and significantly less expensive. “For \$250,000 you can buy a painting that could hang in the Louvre, but \$10m gets you a bad [Picasso](#),” says Mr Williams. There is also scarcity: more Old Master paintings are entering museum collections every year.

在 20 世纪 80 年代之前，古典大师作品主导了艺术界。但后来，收藏家们认为古典大师作品过于传统，于是转而开始收藏印象派和当代艺术作品。过去两年里，情况发生了一些变化。首先，当代艺术市场的某些部分出现了波动。收藏家们意识到，古典大师作品较为稳定，而且价格也相对较低。“以 25 万美元的价格，你可以买到一幅可以挂在卢浮宫里的画作；而 1000 万美元的话，你只能得到一幅质量一般的毕加索作品。”威廉姆斯先生说道。此外，当代艺术作品也变得更加稀缺了——每年都有更多的古典大师作品被纳入博物馆的收藏中。

Art buyers have also become more open-minded about mixing pictures from different periods. A “turning-point” came in 2017, says Sylvie Winckler, a Belgian collector: that was when Christie’s sold Leonardo da Vinci’s heavily restored [“Salvator Mundi”](#) for \$450m, the highest price ever paid for an artwork, in a post-war- and contemporary-art auction. It showed how older art could look sleek alongside more modern works in the white boxes many wealthy people call homes.

艺术收藏家们对融合不同时期的作品也变得更加开放了。比利时收藏家西尔维·温克勒说，一个“转折点”出现在 2017 年：当时克里斯蒂拍卖行以 4.5 亿美元的价格出售了莱昂纳多·达·芬奇经过修复的《救世主》，这是战后及当代艺术拍卖中创纪录的高价。这一事件表明，古老的艺术作品可以与现代作品一起出现在那些被许多富人视为家的白色画框中，而且看起来非常优雅。

Opinions about what constitutes “good” collecting have changed, too. Conventionally, buyers of Old Masters were like PhD candidates, specialising in areas such as 18th-century French still-lives. Today people buy art more eclectically and expansively. A new generation of collectors is driven “less by traditional connoisseurship and more

by image and the visible impact of the work itself”, says Valentina Castellani, author of “Trading Beauty”, a history of art buying.

关于什么才算“优秀的”收藏行为，人们的看法也已经发生了变化。传统上，那些收藏古老艺术品的收藏家就像博士生一样，专注于 18 世纪法国风格的静物画等领域。如今，人们购买艺术品的方式变得更加多样化了。正如《交易美丽》一书的作者瓦伦蒂娜·卡斯特拉尼所说，新一代的收藏家不再那么受传统鉴赏力的驱动，而是更看重作品的视觉效果以及其带来的影响力。



This means that [portraits](#) and figurative art are in vogue, because they are Instagrammable. People spend so much time looking at pictures of other people on social media that they are primed to connect to painted ones. There is an allure to old-fashioned fabrics and romanticising of what appears to be a simpler life (if you ignore the revolutions, plagues and awful dentistry of past eras). Charles Stewart, the boss of Sotheby's, attributes resurging interest in Old Masters to an “AI effect”: “Older things feel more artisanal and

human,” he says.

这意味着肖像画和具象艺术变得流行起来，因为它们适合在 Instagram 上分享。人们在社交媒体上花很多时间浏览他人的照片，因此他们很容易被绘画作品所吸引。复古的织物以及对简单生活的浪漫化描述也充满了吸引力——当然，这些描述都忽略了过去那些动荡的时代、瘟疫以及糟糕的牙科状况。苏富比公司的负责人查尔斯·斯图尔特将人们对古代大师作品的重新关注归因于“人工智能效应”：“那些古老的作品给人一种手工制作的感觉，充满了人情味。”

Dealers have become more masterful in marketing to a new clientele. Secular images are easier to sell than religious ones, as are works with an intriguing back story. This was evident at TEFAF Maastricht, an art fair that is the biggest gathering for Old Masters buyers and dealers, in March. Paul Smeets, a gallerist, displayed a painting by Guido Cagnacci, an Italian who died in 1663. It was of the Virgin Mary, adorned with a golden halo, reading a book. “Ten years ago we would have just left ‘Virgin Reading’ as a title,” says Mr Smeets. But instead he wanted to highlight that the sitter might have been the paramour of the artist. So he called it “Possibly a portrait of Maddalena Fontanafredda as the Virgin Reading”. Clunky, yes, but it added drama and passion to a familiar scene. The work sold quickly. Old Masters have a lot of lovers these days. ■

艺术品经销商在吸引新客户方面已经变得更加熟练了。与宗教题材相比，世俗题材更容易销售，而那些具有有趣背景故事的作品也更容易被购买。在 3 月份举行的马斯特里赫特 TEFAF 艺术展上就体现了这一点。一位画廊经理保罗·斯米茨展示了一幅由意大利艺术家吉多·卡尼亚奇创作的画作。这幅画描绘的是圣母玛利亚的形象，她戴着金色的光环，正阅读着一本书。“十年前，我们可能会只把这幅画命名为‘阅读圣母’，”斯米茨说。“但这次，他想强调这幅画的主人可能是这位艺术家的情人。于是他将其命名为‘可能是玛达莱娜·丰塔纳弗雷达作为阅读圣母的肖像’。”虽然这个标题有些古板，但它为这幅熟悉的画面增添了戏剧性和激情。这幅画很快就被卖掉了。如今，古董艺术品很受欢迎。

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Right under your nose

就在你们的眼前

The history of the human face is more than skin deep

人类面部的历史远不止表面那么简单

An exuberant new book includes physiognomy, portraiture and plastic surgery

这本新出版的书籍中包含了关于面部特征、肖像画以及整形手术的内容。

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The Face. By Fay Bound-Alberti. *Grand Central Publishing; 288 pages; \$30. Allen Lane; £25*

《面孔》。作者：Fay Bound-Alberti。出版社：Grand Central Publishing。页数：288 页。价格：30 美元。出版方：Allen Lane；售价：25 英镑。

CAST YOUR mind back to this morning. The first thing you probably did after you woke up was reach for your [smartphone](#) and hold it up in front of your bleary eyes to unlock it. Out of bed, you looked in a mirror and decided whether to shave or apply makeup. Perhaps you smilingly cajoled a child to eat or joined a Zoom call (and tried not to look at yourself).

请回想起今天早晨的情景。醒来后，你首先做的可能是拿起智能手机，将其举在模糊的视线前以解锁屏幕。从床上起来后，你照了照镜子，决定是刮胡子还是化妆。也许你还笑着哄孩子吃饭，或者参加了一个视频会议（同时努力不盯着自己的脸看）。

Central to all those actions was your face: the particular shape and arrangement of your forehead, eyes, nose, mouth and chin. Those dimensions are used to identify you (on your [passport](#), for instance,

or via your phone's Face ID). They will determine whether people trust you, fancy you or believe you are the right person for a job. If you are ever accused of a crime, they could influence whether or not the jury is inclined to find you guilty.

所有这些行为的核心就是你的面部特征：额头、眼睛、鼻子、嘴巴以及下巴的具体形状与排列。这些特征被用来识别你（例如在护照上，或者通过手机的 Face ID 技术）。它们决定了人们是否信任你、是否喜欢你，或者认为你是胜任某项工作的合适人选。如果你被指控犯下某种罪行，这些特征还将影响陪审团是否倾向于认定你有罪。

In a fascinating new book, Fay Bound-Alberti, a cultural historian, gives full expression to the many meanings of the face. She peers across millennia and regions, looking at anthropology, criminology, medical imaging, portraiture and more to argue that faces may be made up of "skin, bone and muscle", but perceptions of them are shaped by "belief systems, languages and environments". Her interest in the subject stems in part from her own experience of prosopagnosia—better known as "face blindness"—a neurological condition that means she struggles to recognise even close family members.

在一本引人入胜的新书中，文化历史学家 Fay Bound-Alberti 深入探讨了“脸”的多种含义。她跨越了数千年的时间与地域界限，从人类学、犯罪学、医学影像学、肖像艺术等多个角度进行探讨。她认为，脸由“皮肤、骨骼和肌肉”构成，但人们对脸的认知则受到“信仰体系、语言和环境”的影响。她对这一主题的兴趣部分源于她自身的经历——她患有面容识别障碍，即所谓的“脸盲症”，这种神经性疾病使得她甚至难以认出近亲的面孔。

Humans have long taken each other at face value. Pythagoras, a Greek philosopher, supposedly chose his pupils based on whether they looked intelligent. In the wake of Euclid's writings on proportion and beauty—ie, the "golden ratio"—many came to believe that "ill-

proportioned men” were “scoundrels”.

长期以来，人类总是仅凭表面印象来判断他人。希腊哲学家毕达哥拉斯据说会根据学生的外貌来判断他们是否聪明。在欧几里德关于比例与美学的论述之后，许多人开始认为“比例不匀称的人都是些卑鄙小人”。

The notion that “faces were key to a person’s social and moral status” gave authorities in ancient Greece, Rome and Persia the idea to use mutilation as a form of punishment. Criminals’ ears and noses were sliced off; eyes were gouged out and faces branded. This association of facial difference with nefarious behaviour persists: think of how many [Bond](#) villains have had scars, burns or misshapen features.

“面部特征是一个人的社会道德地位的重要体现”这一观念，让古希腊、罗马和波斯等地的统治者想到了用残害面部作为惩罚手段。当时，罪犯的耳朵和鼻子会被割掉，眼睛会被挖出，面部还会被烙上印记。这种将面部特征与邪恶行为联系起来的做法一直延续至今：想想看，在《007》系列电影中，有多少反派角色都有伤疤、烧伤或畸形的面部特征吧。

People have been judged on their looks for centuries, but they have had “only the vaguest notion” of what they looked like until relatively recently. In medieval times, “your identity would be defined by your role, your family, your village and your faith—not by your individual face,” Ms Bound-Alberti observes. That began to change in the Renaissance, which saw an explosion of portraiture. Artists produced works that sought to capture something of the sitter’s [character](#), not just their social standing. Your face became the map on which your inner world could be read. Ms Bound-Alberti calls this yoking of individuality to outward appearance “facehood”.

几个世纪以来，人们一直根据外貌来评价他人。直到最近，人们才逐渐开始了解自己的真实面貌。在中世纪，人的身份是由其角色、家庭、村庄以及信仰来定义的，而不是由个人的外貌来决定的。Bound-Alberti 女士指出，这种情况在文艺复兴时期开始发生变化，当时肖像

画领域出现了大量作品。艺术家们创作的作品旨在捕捉人物的性格特征，而不仅仅是其社会地位。此时，人的外貌成为了解读其内心世界的“地图”。Bound-Alberti 女士将这种将个性与外在形象联系起来的现象称为“面孔属性”。

As mirrors became widespread and cheap, the face became a subject of fascination. Like Narcissus gazing in the pool, people could not resist their own reflection. Photography deepened the obsession. Scientists including [Charles Darwin](#) used the technology to codify expressions and emotions; some sought to categorise and rank groups of people.

随着镜子逐渐普及且价格低廉，面部形象成为了人们着迷的对象。就像纳西索斯在池塘中凝视自己的倒影一样，人们无法抗拒自己的倒影。摄影进一步加剧了这一痴迷情绪。包括查尔斯·达尔文在内的科学家们利用这一技术来记录各种表情和情绪；有些人则试图对人群进行分类和排序。

It is the historical morsels that will stay with you long after you finish “The Face”. Who could fail to be intrigued by Justinian II’s gold prosthetic nose, or the fact that Darwin was almost denied passage on *HMS Beagle* because of his schnoz? Other passages, such as those on [cosmetic surgery](#), will feel more familiar: advertising reinforces the belief that “our faces have become projects to be perfected.”

这些历史细节会在你读完《面孔》之后仍然留在你的脑海中。谁会不对查士丁尼二世所安装的金色假鼻感到好奇呢？又或者，达尔文因为鼻子的问题几乎被拒之“小猎犬号”上。而其他关于整形手术的内容则会让人们感到更为熟悉：广告不断强化着“我们的脸庞是值得完善的对象”这一观念。

At times the reader may wish that Ms Bound-Alberti had offered more analysis alongside anecdotes. Given the book’s focus on identity, for example, it is surprising that the author skims over [deepfakes](#): studies have found that such videos can cause profound psychological harm to the person being impersonated online. Still,

this is a wide-ranging and thoughtful history. Thanks to social media, people encounter more faces than ever before; after reading this book, you will see that there is more to a face than meets the eye. ■

有时，读者会希望布丁-阿尔贝蒂女士能在讲述这些轶事的同时，提供更多相关的分析。以这本书的主题——身份认同为例，作者只是泛泛而谈地提及了“深度伪造”现象：研究表明，这类视频会对在线模仿他人的人造成严重的心理伤害。不过，这仍然是一部内容广泛且富有深意的著作。得益于社交媒体，人们如今接触到的人脸数量比以往任何时候都要多；读完这本书后，你会明白，一个人的脸庞背后隐藏着比表面看起来更多的东西。■

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Night-sky fever

夜空热

The brightest tourism trend can be found in the darkest places

最引人注目的旅游趋势往往出现在 最偏僻、最黑暗的地方。

Stargazing is an illuminating business

观星是一种很有启发性的活动。

Jul 09, 2026 06:51 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:51



Eyes on the skies

目光投向天空

FOR MILLENNIA starry nights have guided navigators, perplexed [astronomers](#) and inspired painters. But they are becoming a rarer sight. At least 80% of the world lives under light-polluted skies—a figure that rises to 99% in America and Europe. A paper published in *Science* found that between 2011 and 2022 the night sky grew almost 10% brighter each year. With so many places [awash with artificial light](#), people are increasingly seeking out the darkness.

数千年来，繁星点点的夜空一直引导着航海者、解答着天文学家的疑问，也激励着画家创作出美丽的作品。然而，如今这样的夜空已经变得越来越罕见了。世界上至少有 80% 的地区处于光污染严重的环境中——在欧美地区，这一比例高达 99%。《科学》杂志上发表的一篇论文指出，在 2011 年至 2022 年期间，夜空亮度每年增加近 10%。随着越来越多的地方被人造光源照亮，人们越来越渴望能体验到黑暗的魅力。

Many became starry-eyed during the pandemic. Confined to their homes, people took to gazing at the cosmos. (It helped that lockdown contributed to a drop in light pollution in lots of places.)

Some turned to social media—and online communities such as “SpaceTok”—for information. Once restrictions lifted, these hobbyists planned their trips accordingly.

在疫情期间，许多人变得盲目崇拜星空。人们被限制在家中，开始仰望苍穹。（幸运的是，封锁措施减少了许多地方的光污染。）有些人转向社交媒体以及如“SpaceTok”这样的在线社区来获取信息。当限制措施解除后，这些爱好者便据此安排了他们的太空旅行计划。

The forecasts for companies offering “astrotourism” and “noctourism” are anything but cloudy. In 2024 a survey by Booking.com, a travel website, found that 62% of people were interested in destinations with limited light pollution. To meet the demand for “cosmic escapism”, some hotels now provide access to [telescopes](#) and in-house astronomers. Others are offering star-bathing and moonlit meditation.

对于那些提供“太空旅游”和“夜间旅游”服务的公司来说，前景相当明朗。根据旅游网站 Booking.com 在 2024 年进行的调查，有 62% 的人对光线污染较少的旅游目的地感兴趣。为了满足人们对“宇宙逃避”的需求，一些酒店现在提供望远镜设施，甚至还有内部的天文学家。还有一些酒店则提供沐浴在星辰之下、在月光下冥想的机会。

Because the best stargazing requires seclusion, astrotourism is a boon to remote areas that do not usually lure tourists. DarkSky International, a non-profit, certifies parks and reserves with the best night-time conditions. It has seen a substantial increase in the number of applications in the past three years, growing from 16 in 2023 to 28 applications in the first half of 2026 alone.

因为最佳的观星体验需要远离人群的环境，所以天文旅游对那些通常无法吸引游客的偏远地区来说是一种福音。DarkSky International 是一家非营利组织，负责认证那些拥有最佳夜间环境的公园和保护区。在过去三年中，申请认证的天文旅游景点数量显著增加，从 2023 年的 16 个增加到 2026 年上半年的 28 个。

Astro Retreat in Maan, an Indian village in the Himalayas, has seen a surge in visitors of late. [Al Ula](#), in the Saudi Arabian desert, is going big on astrotourism by building a state-of-the-art observatory and luxury stargazing lodges. John Barentine, an astronomer in Arizona, says there is an opportunity for rural places where industries such as mining have waned.

位于喜马拉雅山脉的印度村庄马安的 Astro Retreat，近期接待的游客数量显著增加。位于沙特阿拉伯沙漠中的 Al Ula 则通过建造先进的天文台和豪华的观星旅馆，大力发展天文旅游产业。亚利桑那州的一位天文学家约翰·巴伦廷表示，对于那些因采矿等行业衰退而陷入衰退的乡村地区来说，这里确实是一个充满机会的地方。

Such trips appeal because they offer a stillness that is hard to find in much of the modern world, where “we have turned night into day in the places we live and work,” as Ruskin Hartley, DarkSky’s director, puts it. Stargazing also encourages feelings of wonderment, which are in short supply. Studies have found that those who look up report a greater sense of well-being; feelings of awe are linked to lower stress levels and a sense of tranquillity. Some credit the pastime with giving them a greater sense of perspective. As [Oscar Wilde](#) once wrote: “We are all in the gutter, but some of us are looking at the stars.” ■

这样的旅行之所以吸引人，是因为它们能带来一种在现代世界难以寻觅的宁静感。正如 DarkSky 的负责人 Ruskin Hartley 所说：“我们在生活和工作的地方，却把夜晚变成了白天。”观星还能激发人们的惊奇感，而这种感觉在当今社会已经变得十分稀缺。研究表明，那些喜欢观星的人会拥有更强烈的幸福感；而敬畏感则与较低的压力水平和宁静感息息相关。有人认为，这种活动让人们能够拥有更广阔的视野。正如奥斯卡·王尔德曾经说过：“我们都身处困境，但有些人却在仰望星空。”■

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Thread diplomacy

线程外交

The real value of the Bayeux tapestry

巴约挂毯的真正价值

The precious work, insured for \$1bn, is bound for Britain. It's more famous there than in France

这件珍贵的艺术品投保了 10 亿美元，现在正被运往英国。它在英国比在法国更为有名。

Jul 10, 2026 05:09 AM | Paris

2026 年 7 月 10 日 上午 5:09 | 巴黎



Nothing to horse around about

没什么好担心的

IT WAS AS close as the museum world comes to a clandestine operation. On July 9th, under police escort, a specially fitted lorry carrying a thousand-year-old tapestry left the town of Bayeux in Normandy. The fragile linen fabric depicting the Norman conquest of England in 1066 had been gently folded into a tailor-made and climate-regulated aluminium crate. That crate was then suspended inside a metal cage, protected from vibration by 12 steel shock-absorbers. The convoy and its precious cargo—which was embroidered in England but has been in France ever since—travelled by road to the Channel Tunnel and on to the British Museum in London, where it arrived at 3 a.m. and was greeted with applause.

这简直就像博物馆界的一项秘密行动一样。7月9日，在警察的护送下，一辆专门改装过的卡车驶出了诺曼底的巴约镇。那幅千年历史的挂毯被小心翼翼地装进一个由裁缝精心制作、能调节气候的铝制箱子里。这个箱子被悬挂在一个金属笼中，并通过12个钢制减震器来防止振动。这支运输队伍以及他们珍贵的货物——这幅画是在英格兰绘制的，但自那以后就一直保存在法国——通过公路被运到了海峡隧道，最终抵达了伦敦的大英博物馆。凌晨3点，这幅画被送到了博物馆，并受到了热烈的掌声迎接。

The loan of the Bayeux tapestry, for an exhibition opening in September, is a gesture rich in cross-Channel symbolism. In the past London museums have tried but failed to host the work. In 1953, for instance, the v&a asked to display the tapestry to mark the coronation of [Queen Elizabeth II](#), only to be told that the French authorities had changed their minds. The *News Chronicle* in London reported that the French embassy could not give a reason: "I am sorry, monsieur. We are lost. First it is yes, no, then yes, then no... and now we are in the dark."

为9月份即将开幕的展览而提供的贝尤挂毯贷款，其实是一种具有深刻跨海峡象征意义的举措。过去，伦敦的博物馆曾试图举办这一展

览，但都未能成功。例如，在 1953 年，V&A 博物馆请求展出这幅挂毯，以庆祝伊丽莎白二世女王的加冕礼，但后来被告知法国当局改变了主意。伦敦的《新闻纪事》报道说，法国大使馆无法给出具体原因：“很抱歉，先生。我们不知道该怎么办了。一开始说是可以，然后又说不行；现在则完全不知道该怎么办了。”

This time the French government, which owns the tapestry, proposed the idea. At a Franco-British summit in 2018 President Emmanuel Macron announced the loan, declaring that the tapestry “embodies the link between our two countries”. It was [two years after the Brexit vote](#), and the two nations were drifting apart; the point, says a presidential aide, was to try to bind them through culture.

这次，拥有这幅壁画的法国政府提出了这个想法。在 2018 年的一次法英峰会上，埃马纽埃尔·马克龙总统宣布了这项贷款计划，并表示这幅壁画“象征着我们两国之间的紧密联系”。那是在英国脱欧公投两年后，两国关系开始疏远；据一位总统助手所说，此举的目的是试图通过文化纽带来重新拉近两国关系。

That was easier said than done. The bilateral discussions “took more years” than Brexit, joked Mr Macron. British ministers, officials and even the king lobbied the French hard. Mr Macron, says one official involved, was “instrumental” in taking on his country’s conservation lobby—who worried about damage to the tapestry—a formidable force even for a powerful French president. New climate-control and anti-vibration technology, and the fact that the museum in Bayeux was closing for renovations anyway, also helped.

说起来容易做起来难。正如马克龙先生开玩笑说的，这次的双边谈判“花费的时间比脱欧还要长”。英国的部长们、官员们，甚至国王本人，都积极游说法国方面。据一位参与谈判的官员说，马克龙先生在抵制本国环保派别方面发挥了“关键作用”——这些派别担心会破坏生态环境。对于一位强大的法国总统来说，这确实是一个巨大的挑战。此外，新的气候控制和减震技术，以及贝尤博物馆即将进行修缮的事实，也起到了推动作用。

By last year the deal was done. In private, he describes the loan as “very special” to him. “President Macron’s key intuition”, says Peter Ricketts, the British envoy to the loan project, “was the differential impact: the tapestry is far more iconic in the UK than in France, and he knew that the exhibition would be a sensation.”

到去年，这项交易终于完成了。他私下里将这笔贷款描述为“非常特别”的举措。“马克龙总统的敏锐洞察力在于：他意识到这次展览在英国会产生比在法国更大的影响。他知道这次展览一定会引起轰动。”参与这项贷款项目的英国大使彼得·里基茨说道。

The Bayeux tapestry is central to Britain’s national story. Most schoolchildren can recite the date 1066, just as French ones can 1789. The Battle of Hastings, when William of Normandy defeated Harold II, the last Anglo-Saxon king of England, and seized the throne, was a founding moment for Britain, [remaking its governance](#), monarchy, legal system, language, architecture and much more. British tourists (along with North Americans) have long topped the list of foreign visitors to the Bayeux Museum, where the tapestry has been displayed since 1983.

贝尤挂毯是英国国家历史中的核心象征。大多数小学生都能背诵出1066年的那个日期，就像法国孩子能记住1789年一样。黑斯廷战役中，诺曼底的威廉击败了英格兰最后的盎格鲁-撒克逊国王哈罗德二世，从而夺取了王位。这一战役是英国的转折点，它重塑了英国的治理方式、君主制、法律体系、语言、建筑等等。长期以来，英国游客（以及北美游客）一直是参观贝尤博物馆的最多的外国游客群体。自1983年以来，那幅挂毯就一直被陈列在博物馆中。

The Norman conquest does not feature strongly in most French people's minds. William's glorious triumph over Harold scarcely gets a mention in school textbooks. Almost no university department studies him besides the University of Caen in Normandy, not far from Bayeux.

在大多数法国人的记忆中，诺曼征服并没有被赋予重要的地位。威廉战胜哈罗德的辉煌胜利在教科书上几乎没有被提及。除了位于诺曼底卡昂大学的学术机构之外，几乎没有其他大学会研究他。

"He's a Norman hero, not a French one," explains Véronique Gazeau, a medieval historian at the university. Although as a young duke William was a vassal of the French king, his belligerent adventures later brought him into conflict with the Capetian dynasty centred in Paris. In this sense, William was not a French conqueror but a Norman one.

“他是诺曼人中的英雄，而非法国人，”该大学的中世纪史学家维罗妮克·加佐解释道。虽然年轻的威廉作为法国国王的封臣，但他的那些冒险行为后来使他与以巴黎为中心的卡佩王朝发生了冲突。因此，威廉并非法国征服者，而是一位诺曼人英雄。

At times, though, imperialists sought to use William's exploits to support their expansionist ambitions. In 1803 Napoleon had the tapestry transported to the Louvre for public display when he was preparing his troops to invade England. During the second world war the Germans asked after it, though the French had already hurried it into safekeeping. (It was rolled onto two cylinders, stored in the

cellar of the Bayeux municipal library, and later transported to the French National Museums repository at the Château de Sourches, near Le Mans.) Jacques Dupont, inspector general of historic monuments, observed in 1941 that the Germans “frequently asked... to see the tapestry that represents the conquest of England”.

不过，有时帝国主义者试图利用威廉的这件作品来支持他们的扩张主义野心。1803 年，拿破仑在准备军队入侵英格兰时，将这幅挂毯运到了卢浮宫供公众观赏。在第二次世界大战期间，德国人也询问了关于这幅挂毯的情况，尽管法国人已经将其妥善保存起来。这幅挂毯被卷成两卷，存放在巴约市图书馆的地下室中，后来又被运往勒芒附近的索尔什城堡，存放于法国国家博物馆的收藏处。1941 年，历史遗迹保护局局长雅克·杜邦指出，德国人经常请求参观这幅象征着征服英格兰的挂毯。

Top of mind for the French or not, the prospect of loaning it has nonetheless prompted some pushback. In 2018 Antoine Verney, the chief curator at the Bayeux Museum, called it “unthinkable” to move the tapestry far from its home. Last year over 70,000 people signed a petition against the loan. Critics have suggested that moving it may cause micro-tears to the fabric and snags to the embroidery and stitching; in the worst case the fabric could rip and more holes could develop. (There are already many.)

无论这一想法是否能为法国人所接受，但将这幅画布移走的做法还是引发了一些反对意见。2018 年，贝尤博物馆的馆长安托万·韦尔尼称，将这幅画布移走是“不可想象的”。去年，有超过 7 万人签署了一份反对这项举措的请愿书。批评者指出，移动这幅画布可能会损坏画布上的细微细节，导致刺绣和缝线出现破损；在最糟糕的情况下，画布甚至可能被撕裂，产生更多的孔洞。（实际上，这样的孔洞已经有很多了。）

In for the long haul

着眼于长远发展

Since then experts in the transport, storage and display of fragile art from both sides of the Channel have worked on optimum protection. Two dry runs to London have taken place with a dummy. But some critical voices in France remain unconvinced. "They are doing their best to ensure that everything goes smoothly, but there is no guarantee," says Didier Rykner, founder of *La Tribune de l'Art*, a magazine. "I've got nothing against the English, but they could just come to Bayeux."

从那时起，来自英伦海峡两方的专家们就开始研究如何更好地保护脆弱的艺术品，以确保其运输、储存和展示过程中的安全。已经在伦敦进行了两次模拟展览的试验。不过，法国的一些人士仍然持怀疑态度。“他们确实在尽力确保一切顺利进行，但并不能保证万无一失，”《艺术论坛》杂志的创始人迪迪埃·瑞克纳说。“我对英国人没有敌意，但他们随时可能来到贝尤。”

"Zero risk does not exist," acknowledges Delphine Christophe, head of heritage and architecture at the Ministry of Culture, "but we are now extremely confident." Tests show that the custom-made casing for transport will absorb 96% of the force of shocks, a level she describes as "excellent". The tapestry, which will be displayed flat at the British Museum to limit the pressure on the fabric, is insured for a staggering £800m (\$1bn) under the British government's indemnity scheme. "It's the best guarantee that we will look after it," says Lord Ricketts.

“零风险是不存在的，”文化部遗产与建筑部门负责人德尔芬·克里斯托夫承认道，“但我们现在非常有信心。”测试表明，这种定制的运输容器能够吸收 96% 的冲击力，她认为这一性能“非常出色”。这幅挂毯将在大英博物馆平展展示，以减缓对织物的压力。根据英国政府的保险计划，这幅挂毯获得了高达 8 亿英镑（10 亿美元）的保险赔偿。“这是确保我们能够妥善保护它的最佳保障，”里克茨勋爵说道。

As the tapestry wends its way to the land that William conquered, some will call it a cheeky nod to defeat and humiliation by the French, with whom the British have a long and rivalrous history. But

the ambition may also be about winning the hearts and minds of people in France. “When the French see how hugely valued it is over there,” says an official in Paris, “it will give it a huge boost when it returns home.” Yet another victory. ■

当这幅画卷展现在威廉征服的土地上时，有些人认为这是对法国人的一次轻蔑的屈服。不过，英国与法国之间有着悠久而充满竞争的历史。但这一胜利或许也是为了赢得法国人民的心。巴黎的一位官员说：“当法国人看到自己在国外的地位如此重要时，回到自己的国家后，他们一定会感到无比振奋。”又一场胜利。■

Editor's note (July 10th): This story was updated after the Bayeux Tapestry arrived in Britain.

编辑注（7月10日）：这篇报道在贝尤挂毯抵达英国后进行了更新。

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Jul 09, 2026 05:23 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 5:23

Economic data

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	Gross domestic product				Consumer prices			Unemployment rate	
	% change on year ago:				% change on year ago:			rate	
	latest	quarter*	2026†		latest	2026†		%	
United States	2.7	Q1	2.1	2.2	4.2	May	3.8	4.2	Jun
China	5.0	Q1	5.3	4.9	1.0	Jun	1.6	5.1	May ^{‡§}
Japan	0.4	Q1	1.8	0.7	1.5	May	1.8	2.5	May
Britain	0.9	Q1	2.5	1.0	2.8	May	3.3	4.9	Mar ^{††}
Canada	-0.1	Q1	-0.1	0.8	3.2	May	2.6	6.6	May
Euro area	0.3	Q1	-0.9	0.8	2.8	Jun	2.8	6.2	May
Austria	0.9	Q1	0.8 [‡]	0.8	3.1	Jun	3.0	5.8	May
Belgium	0.8	Q1	0.9	0.7	3.0	Jun	3.5	6.3	May
France	0.9	Q1	-0.4	0.8	2.0	Jun	2.3	8.2	May
Germany	0.3	Q1	1.4	0.6	2.4	Jun	2.7	3.8	May
Greece	2.0	Q1	1.0	2.0	4.9	May	4.0	8.1	May
Italy	0.8	Q1	1.1	0.8	3.1	Jun	2.7	5.0	May
Netherlands	1.4	Q1	0.9	1.0	2.5	Jun	3.1	3.9	May
Spain	2.7	Q1	2.5	2.2	3.6	Jun	3.2	10.3	May
Czech Republic	2.2	Q1	0.8	2.0	1.5	Jun	2.0	3.0	Q1 [‡]
Denmark	6.2	Q1	6.2	3.3	1.9	May	2.0	3.1	May
Norway	1.7	Q1	1.4	1.3	3.1	May	3.2	4.6	Apr ^{††}
Poland	3.5	Q1	2.4	3.4	2.5	Jun	3.0	5.9	May [§]
Russia	-0.2	Q1	-2.5	0.7	5.3	May	5.5	2.1	May [§]
Sweden	2.2	Q1	-0.6	2.1	0.7	Jun	1.9	9.4	May [§]
Switzerland	0.5	Q1	2.6	1.0	0.5	Jun	0.6	3.1	Jun
Turkey	2.5	Q1	0.5	2.5	32.1	Jun	31.7	7.4	May [§]
Australia	2.5	Q1	1.1	1.6	4.0	May	4.1	4.4	May
Hong Kong	5.9	Q1	12.2	5.0	2.0	May	2.1	3.7	May ^{††}
India	7.8	Q1	6.4	6.5	3.9	May	4.8	6.6	Jun
Indonesia	5.6	Q1	6.0	5.0	3.3	Jun	3.5	4.7	Feb [§]
Malaysia	5.4	Q1	1.7	4.5	2.0	May	2.5	3.0	Apr [§]
Pakistan	4.8	2026 ^{**}	na	3.0	11.1	Jun	7.8	6.9	2025
Philippines	2.8	Q1	3.6	2.9	6.4	Jun	5.3	4.7	Q2 [§]
Singapore	6.0	Q1	3.9	4.8	1.8	May	2.4	2.0	Q1
South Korea	3.8	Q1	7.5	3.3	3.2	Jun	3.0	2.9	May [§]
Taiwan	14.5	Q1	6.9	10.5	2.6	Jun	1.6	3.3	May
Thailand	2.8	Q1	2.7	1.8	2.4	Jun	2.8	1.0	May [§]
Argentina	2.3	Q1	3.0	3.3	33.2	May	32.1	7.8	Q1 [§]
Brazil	1.8	Q1	4.5	2.0	4.7	May	4.7	5.6	May ^{§††}
Chile	-0.5	Q1	-1.1	1.4	4.3	Jun	3.6	9.4	May ^{§††}
Colombia	2.2	Q1	2.4	2.5	6.1	Jun	5.6	8.0	May [§]
Mexico	0.2	Q1	-2.4	0.9	3.9	May	4.0	2.7	May
Peru	3.5	Q1	3.2	2.7	4.0	Jun	3.9	4.5	May [§]
Egypt	5.0	Q1	-24.0	4.5	14.3	Jun	13.8	6.0	Q1 [§]
Israel	1.7	Q1	-3.8	3.4	1.9	May	1.9	2.8	May
Saudi Arabia	4.6	2025	na	0.9	1.8	May	2.1	3.1	Q1
South Africa	1.9	Q1	2.2	1.6	4.4	May	4.3	32.7	Q1 [§]

Source: Haver Analytics *% change on previous quarter, annual rate †The Economist Intelligence Unit estimate/forecast §Not seasonally adjusted

‡New series **Year ending June ††Latest 3 months ‡‡3-month moving average Note: Euro-area consumer prices are harmonised

Economic data

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	Current-account balance % of GDP, 2026 [†]	Budget balance % of GDP, 2026 [†]	Interest rates 10-yr gov't bonds latest, %	change on year ago, bp	Currency units per \$ Jul 9th	% change on year ago
United States	-3.4	-6.5	4.6	14.0	-	
China	3.2	-5.8	1.5 ^{\$\$}	-4.0	6.80	5.4
Japan	3.6	-1.8	2.9	136	163	-9.9
Britain	-3.4	-5.1	4.8	21.0	0.75	-1.3
Canada	-0.4	-2.1	3.6	13.0	1.42	-3.5
Euro area	2.3	-3.4	3.1	44.0	0.88	-2.3
Austria	1.1	-4.1	3.3	30.0	0.88	-2.3
Belgium	-2.7	-5.2	3.7	42.0	0.88	-2.3
France	-0.6	-5.3	3.9	55.0	0.88	-2.3
Germany	4.2	-3.7	3.1	44.0	0.88	-2.3
Greece	-5.5	0.8	3.8	38.0	0.88	-2.3
Italy	0.8	-3.0	3.9	32.0	0.88	-2.3
Netherlands	9.2	-2.6	3.2	34.0	0.88	-2.3
Spain	2.3	-2.4	3.4	17.0	0.88	-2.3
Czech Republic	0.3	-2.6	4.7	45.0	21.3	-1.0
Denmark	12.1	1.3	2.9	36.0	6.55	-2.8
Norway	14.8	9.0	4.3	49.0	9.77	3.4
Poland	-1.3	-7.0	5.5	9.0	3.77	-4.0
Russia	2.2	-3.4	16.3	159	76.4	2.3
Sweden	4.8	-2.0	2.8	48.0	9.70	-1.9
Switzerland	7.7	0.2	0.4	-3.0	0.81	-1.2
Turkey	-3.0	-3.6	31.4	198	46.8	-14.5
Australia	-3.0	-1.5	4.8	68.0	1.44	6.2
Hong Kong	4.3	-2.5	3.4	35.0	7.84	0.1
India	-1.5	-4.5	6.8	46.0	95.7	-10.4
Indonesia	-1.7	-3.5	7.2	66.0	18,078	-10.0
Malaysia	3.4	-4.1	3.6	20.0	4.08	3.9
Pakistan	-1.1	-4.7	11.8 ⁺⁺⁺	-18.0	278	2.2
Philippines	-4.1	-6.3	7.2	88.0	61.6	-8.1
Singapore	16.6	1.3	2.1	5.0	1.29	-0.8
South Korea	9.9	-1.9	4.2	140	1,505	-9.0
Taiwan	27.4	1.8	1.7	27.0	32.0	-9.1
Thailand	0.5	-5.5	2.0	43.0	33.5	-2.7
Argentina	-0.9	0.1	na	na	1,488	-15.7
Brazil	-2.6	-7.3	14.5	82.0	5.16	5.4
Chile	-2.0	-2.4	5.4	-27.0	934	1.0
Colombia	-2.4	-6.6	11.8	-47.0	3,340	21.4
Mexico	-0.4	-3.8	9.1	-3.0	17.6	5.9
Peru	2.2	-2.4	6.1	-3.0	3.40	4.7
Egypt	-5.0	-5.2	25.6	50.0	49.6	0.1
Israel	1.3	-4.0	3.7	-35.0	3.04	10.2
Saudi Arabia	-2.3	-6.1	na	na	3.76	-0.3
South Africa	-1.0	-4.4	8.5	-138	16.4	8.3

Source: Haver Analytics ^{\$\$}5-year yield ⁺⁺⁺Dollar-denominated bonds

Markets

In local currency	Index Jul 8th	% change on:	
		one week	Dec 31st 2025
United States S&P 500	7,482.7	nil	9.3
United States NAS Comp	25,870.7	-0.7	11.3
China Shanghai Comp	3,970.9	-3.4	0.1
China Shenzhen Comp	2,650.4	-7.1	4.7
Japan Nikkei 225	66,819.1	-5.2	32.7
Japan Topix	4,006.4	-0.1	17.5
Britain FTSE 100	10,489.0	0.1	5.6
Canada S&PTSX	34,935.8	0.2	10.2
Euro area EURO STOXX 50	6,204.9	-1.2	7.1
France CAC 40	8,252.7	-1.0	1.3
Germany DAX*	24,897.5	-0.6	1.7
Italy FTSE/MIB	51,817.3	0.4	15.3
Netherlands AEX	1,076.2	0.3	13.1
Spain IBEX 35	19,104.3	-1.6	10.4
Poland WIG	139,057.9	1.7	18.6
Russia RTS, \$ terms	915.7	-3.0	-17.4
Switzerland SMI	14,174.4	0.4	6.8
Turkey BIST	14,190.0	-1.1	26.0
Australia All Ord.	8,979.3	0.5	-0.4
Hong Kong Hang Seng	24,199.5	5.8	-5.6
India BSE	76,503.6	-0.5	-10.2
Indonesia IDX	5,873.4	3.1	-32.1
Malaysia KLSE	1,683.6	1.6	0.2
Pakistan KSE	181,629.4	-1.3	4.4
Singapore STI	5,369.6	4.0	15.6
South Korea KOSPI	7,246.8	-12.7	72.0
Taiwan TWI	45,734.4	-2.7	57.9
Thailand SET	1,576.3	-0.8	25.1
Argentina MERV	3,202,489.0	2.6	4.9
Brazil BVSP*	170,653.4	-0.6	5.9
Mexico IPC	66,609.6	-0.9	3.6
Egypt EGX 30	52,028.4	3.0	24.4
Israel TA-125	4,052.5	-0.6	10.6
Saudi Arabia Tadawul	10,853.7	nil	3.5
South Africa JSE AS	108,349.4	-1.2	-6.5
World, dev'd MSCI	4,811.7	nil	8.6
Emerging markets MSCI	1,677.5	-2.6	19.5

US corporate bonds, spread over Treasuries

Basis points	Dec 31st	
	latest	2025
Investment grade	89	93
High-yield	320	354

Sources: LSEG Workspace; Moscow Exchange; Standard & Poor's Global Fixed Income Research *Total return index

Commodities

The Economist commodity-price index

2020=100	Jun 30th	Jul 7th*	% change on	
			month	year
Dollar Index				
All items	148.2	150.8	0.6	15.2
Food	147.2	153.2	8.1	7.0
Industrials				
All	149.1	148.9	-5.0	23.2
Non-food agriculturals	151.8	151.2	-1.8	23.7
Metals	148.4	148.3	-5.7	23.0
Sterling Index				
All items	143.5	144.9	0.8	16.6
Euro Index				
All items	148.2	150.8	1.8	17.8
Gold				
\$ per oz	4,036.1	4,148.8	-3.4	26.0
Brent				
\$ per barrel	72.9	74.2	-18.8	5.7

Sources: CME Group; LME; LSEG Workspace; NOREXCO; NZ Wool Services; S&P Global Commodity Insights; Thompson Lloyd & Ewart; USDA *Provisional

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Obituary

讣告

- **[Mona Khalil defied danger to protect her "family"](#)**

莫娜·哈利尔不顾危险，为了保护她的“家人”而挺身而出。

To save the turtles :: Lebanon's most dedicated conservationist was killed on June 19th, aged 76

为了拯救这些海龟，黎巴嫩最杰出的环保人士在 6 月 19 日去世了，享年 76 岁。

To save the turtles

为了拯救那些海龟

Mona Khalil defied danger to protect her “family”

莫娜·哈利尔不顾危险，为了保护她的“家人”而挺身而出。

Lebanon's most dedicated conservationist was killed on June 19th, aged 76

6 月 19 日，黎巴嫩最杰出的环保人士去世了，享年 76 岁。

Jul 09, 2026 06:38 AM

2026 年 7 月 9 日 上午 06:38



IT WAS THE summer of 1999; and on a warm evening on Mansouri beach in southern Lebanon, Mona Khalil was strolling with a beer. She loved this beach. It was the world of her childhood holidays, running down to the rocky, sandy shore from her grandparents' house. Her best summers had been spent here, adventuring. All the toys she had ever needed she had picked up here, and still did: weird stones, lengths of driftwood, coloured glass bottles. They now filled her house and hung clinking in the lemon and banana trees around it. This had become her dream life.

那是 1999 年的夏天；在一个温暖的夜晚，莫娜·哈利尔在黎巴嫩南部的曼苏里海滩上散步，手里拿着一杯啤酒。她非常喜欢这个海滩。这里就是她童年假期时光的归宿——从祖父母家沿着岩石铺就、沙质细腻的海岸漫步而来。她所有需要的玩具都是在这里收集的，现在依然如此：那些奇特的石头、长短不一的沉木、彩色的玻璃瓶……这些物品现在摆满了她的房子，在柠檬树和香蕉树丛中闪闪发光。这已经成为了她的理想生活。

But suddenly on that evening she heard a noise, like a thud or a thump, quite close. The next thing she knew, someone was throwing sand at her. She looked down to see, not a dog or a fox, but a huge turtle digging a nest in which to lay her eggs. Later, when she had read more, she learned that this was a green sea turtle, a species that was critically endangered. They were herbivores, eating sea-grass and seaweed, and might live to 100 years old. This particular female would have swum hundreds, maybe even thousands, of miles to lay her eggs exactly here, where 30 years ago she had hatched. Unerring instinct had led her to Ms Khalil's feet and then, her eggs laid and covered up, wearily back into the sea again. And all Ms Khalil could think of was how beautiful she was.

但就在那晚，她突然听到一阵声音，像是沉闷的敲击声，似乎很近。接着，她看到有人向她扔沙子。她低头一看，发现那不是狗或狐狸，而是一只巨大的海龟正在筑巢产卵。后来，她读到更多关于这种海龟的信息：这是一种极度濒危的物种。海龟是草食性动物，以海草和海藻为食，寿命可达 100 年。这只雌性海龟可能游了数百甚至数千英里

才来到这里产卵——而 30 年前，它也是在这里孵化的。凭借敏锐的直觉，它找到了 Ms Khalil 的脚边，然后产卵完毕，疲惫地回到了大海中。而 Ms Khalil 则满脑子想着自己有多么美丽。

This was the point at which her life changed, and became only turtles. She did not talk much about the years before. School in Beirut, a marriage, and a son, Omar, killed at eight by a passing boat as he gazed at starfish underwater. An escape to the Netherlands during Lebanon's civil war, where she stayed for ten years and worked as a porcelain restorer. Then, in 1999, the return with her friend, Habiba Fayed, to her grandparents' house. It was falling down, swallowed in a forest of weakened trees. Together they put it to rights. She painted it orange as a homage to the Netherlands, and visitors noticed that Dutchness had touched her, too. A certain bluntness, an unLebanese reserve, a refusal to be swayed, and a dogged belief in just getting on with it.

就在那个时刻，她的生活发生了改变。她不太愿意谈论那些过去的岁月。在贝鲁特上学、结婚，还有了儿子奥马尔——他在八岁时因为凝视水中的海星而丧生。在黎巴嫩内战期间，她逃到了荷兰，在那里住了十年，并从事瓷器修复工作。1999 年，她与朋友哈比巴·法耶德一起回到了祖父母家。那栋房子正在倒塌，被一片弱小的树木所包围。她们一起努力修复它。她把房子漆成橙色，以此向荷兰表达敬意。游客们注意到，丹麦的影响也触动了她。她性格直率，没有黎巴嫩人的矜持，拒绝被任何事情左右，始终坚信只要坚持下去就能成功。

"It" was a project, soon world-famous, to protect the turtles and their nests. It included carnivorous loggerhead turtles, also endangered and also users of Mansouri beach. Government, central or local, was prostrated by war and had no possible money to give. So she funded her training of new conservationists by turning the Orange House into a B&B. It was basic, with no air-conditioning, but it was also an oasis of calm, wind chimes, home-made jam—and serious research. The high point was when she would summon her volunteers to watch as she poured out a bucket of hatchlings on the sand and the tiny creatures, flippers going frantically, scurried down

to the breaking waves.

“这个项目”很快便成为了举世闻名的项目，旨在保护海龟及其巢穴。该项目涉及的是那些濒危的食肉性海龟，它们也是曼苏里海滩的居民。由于战争的原因，政府无论是中央还是地方层面的机构都无力提供资金支持。于是，她通过把橙色住宅改造成一家民宿来资助新环保人员的培训工作。那里的环境很简朴，没有空调，但却是一个宁静的世外桃源——那里有风铃、自制果酱，还有严谨的研究工作。最令人难忘的时刻是，她会召集志愿者们一起观察：她会将一桶刚孵出的幼龟放在沙滩上，那些小海龟们就会疯狂地用鳍划水，冲向汹涌的海浪。

Their enemies were many. Dogs would dig up the nests to eat the eggs. Ghost crabs and birds ate the hatchlings, and plastic litter entangled them. Fishermen, working only just offshore, trapped adults in close-mesh nets and even disrupted their swims with dynamite. But the most insidious enemy was development. More and more flats, hotels and resorts were rising on either side of Mansouri; its unspoilt tranquillity was becoming rare. Security lights competed with the moon to confound the hatchlings' sense of direction. Yet this small, hemmed-in site was the home to which the female hatchlings would one day feel compelled to return.

它们的敌人很多。狗会翻找它们的巢穴来吃掉幼崽。幽灵蟹和鸟类也会捕食幼崽，而塑料垃圾则会让它们陷入困境。在近海地区工作的渔民们，会用密网捕捉成年幼崽，甚至用炸药破坏它们游泳的路线。但最可怕的敌人却是开发行为。曼苏里两侧越来越多的高楼大厦、酒店和度假村正在崛起，它原本纯净的宁静环境变得稀罕。安全灯与月光相互竞争，让幼崽难以判断方向。然而，这个狭小的栖息地，却是那些幼崽终将回归的家园。

She campaigned in all the ways she could think of. Before dawn she and her volunteers would patrol the shore, picking up litter and looking for fresh turtle tracks. She measured nests, roofed them with wire mesh, counted the papery-shelled eggs, helped the hatchlings out and sent her data to global conservation groups. After that, she

fought. Passionately, sometimes tearfully, she repeated that the turtles had a right to the beach. It had been theirs for the past 250m years, before humans existed. Who were humans to kick them out? All they were asking for was a short season to nest. Then they, her family, would be gone again.

她用所有能想到的办法来进行宣传。在黎明之前，她和她的志愿者们会在海岸线上巡逻，捡拾垃圾，寻找新的海龟足迹。她会测量海龟的巢穴，用铁丝网将其围起来，数一数那些有硬壳的卵的数量，帮助幼海龟破壳而出，并将这些数据发送给全球性的环保组织。之后，她继续奋斗着——有时是带着泪水，有时是充满激情地——她不断强调海龟有权拥有这片海滩。这片海滩属于海龟，自从 250 万年前人类出现之前，它就一直属于海龟。人类有什么资格把它们赶走呢？人类所要求的不过是一个短暂的筑巢季节而已。而之后，她的家人又会再次离开这里。

Many people hated her incessant “No this, no that”. She understood: without work, without food, the last thing on their minds was ecology. Almost no Lebanese came to help her; only foreigners. Some locals even turned up with Kalashnikovs. But at least she made the fishermen give up using dynamite, and persuaded two local mayors to declare the beach a *hima*, a community reserve. She tried to restrict partying there, and stop cars driving onto it. She also did her best to obstruct the building of the Palagio Beach Resort almost next door, which contravened planning rules. And she petitioned the UN peacekeepers stationed in south Lebanon to stop throwing their rubbish into the sea.

许多人讨厌她那不休止的“不，不行”的言论。她明白：在没有工作、没有食物的情况下，人们根本不会考虑环境问题。几乎没有黎巴嫩人愿意帮助她，只有外国人愿意伸出援手。甚至有些当地人带着卡拉什nikov 步枪出现了。不过，她至少让渔民们放弃了使用炸药的行为，并说服两位当地市长将这片海滩列为自然保护区。她试图限制人们在那里狂欢，不让汽车驶入这片海滩。她还竭力阻止位于附近的新帕拉吉奥海滩度假村的建设，因为这违反了规划规定。此外，她还向驻扎

在黎巴嫩南部的联合国维和部队提出请求，要求他们不要将垃圾扔进海里。

For war was the other constant consideration. The Orange House was only 12km inside the Israeli border. In 2006, when Israel attacked in nesting season, she asked Hizbullah fighters point-blank to leave the beach. They did, but then set up rockets right behind the house. She and Habiba had to flee, first to a hut on the beach, then, after the Orange House was hit, to Beirut. When they returned, it was to find a military checkpoint next door. In future, volunteers had to be cleared through security. Ironically, though, when war (or covid) emptied the beaches the turtles thrived. In 2007 she reported that around 5,000 hatchlings had successfully launched themselves.

战争也是另一个必须时刻注意的问题。橙色房子距离以色列边境只有 12 公里远。2006 年，当以色列在繁殖季节发动攻击时，她明确要求真主党武装人员立即离开海滩。他们照做了，但随后却在房子后面安置了火箭弹。她和哈比巴不得不逃离，先躲到了海滩上的一个小屋里，之后当橙色房子遭到攻击后，他们又逃到了贝鲁特。当他们回来时，发现旁边有一个军事检查站。有趣的是，当战争或新冠疫情让海滩变得空无一人时，海龟们反而茁壮成长了。2007 年，她报告说大约有 5000 只幼海龟成功孵化出来。

Nonetheless, she made the resolution never to leave Mansouri beach again. No matter what, she would stay in her dream place. She made a statue for the garden out of all the Israeli shells that had already fallen on her house. Her dealings with Hizbullah (she had to; they were the local authority) possibly compromised her, but she waved that off. She was just a civilian. Anyway, there was no other heaven but her Orange House among the trees and by the beach. That was it. That was her patch, to which she had to return; as surely as the female turtles did, with unwavering determination, over

mile after mile of rolling sea. ■

不过，她决定再也不离开曼苏里海滩了。无论如何，她都会留在那个属于她的梦想之地。她用所有落在她房子上的以色列炮弹的碎片，制作了花园的装饰品。虽然她和真主党的关系可能让她受到了一些影响，但她并不在乎。她毕竟只是个普通人而已。无论如何，除了那座位于树木间、靠近海滩的橙色小屋之外，没有其他的天堂了。那就是她的家园，她必须回到那里去——就像那些雌性海龟一样，无论遇到多少困难，都会坚定不移地回到自己的家园。

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